THIRTY-TWO SWING STANDARDS · SEVEN PARTS · LEAD-SHEET CHANGES

STEFAN'S AABA FAKE BOOK

Built from your YouTube Music playlists (uptempo swing, Lazy lindy, Bal/charleston, boogie-ish, it's complicated) and your band's own charts: a swing-dance book for the piano chair of a small band. Twenty-eight tunes are 32-bar A A B A; the other four (All the Things You Are, Autumn Leaves, All of Me, Just Friends) are the cousins you asked for, with their real forms marked. Charts are written the way the band reads them: barlines, boxed sections, repeats with first and second endings, and a simile mark when a bar repeats. Keys are the ones your band plays. The book is in seven parts, one per chair, each with all thirty-two tunes in the same alphabetical order: piano (concert, with the full notes and keyboard figures), trumpet (B♭), alto sax (E♭), tenor sax (B♭), guitar (with chord grids), bass and drums. The front matter is in concert pitch.

Symbols C– minor · CΔ7 major 7 · Cø7 half-dim · C°7 dim · C7♭9 alterations · C–7/G slash bass

Brackets small chords in brackets are common options and turnarounds **Solo map** what to lean on, per section

Glossary of symbols and terms

SET LIST ALPHABETICAL

#	TUNE	KEY	FORM	FEEL · DANCE TEMPO	FROM YOUR LISTS
01	**Ain't Misbehavin'**	**E♭**	AABA · 32	Lindy · 130–170	standard pick
02	**All of Me**	**F**	A B A C · 32	Lindy · 150–190	standard pick
03	**All the Things You Are**	**A♭**	A A′ B A″ · 36	Lindy · 150–190	Lazy lindy (Ella Fitzgerald)
04	**Autumn Leaves**	**C–**	A A B C · 32	Lindy / ballad · 100–180	Lazy lindy (Ryo Fukui)
05	**Battle of Jericho**	**F–**	AABA · 32	Lindy · 150–200	Bal/charleston (Sidney Bechet)
06	**Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen**	**C–**	AABA · 32	Lindy · 160–200	it's complicated (Ella Fitzgerald)
07	**Blue Drag**	**D–**	AABA · 32	Slow lindy / blues · 90–120	Lazy lindy (Hot Sugar Band)
08	**Blue Moon**	**E♭**	AABA · 32	Lindy / blues · 110–180	standard pick
09	**Blue Skies**	**C– → E♭**	AABA · 32	Lindy · 150–190	standard pick
10	**Comes Love**	**A–**	AABA · 32	Lindy · 130–170	standard pick
11	**Don't Get Around Much Anymore**	**C**	AABA · 32	Lindy / slow swing · 130–180	standard pick
12	**Honeysuckle Rose**	**F**	AABA · 32	Lindy · 150–190	standard pick

#	TUNE	KEY	FORM	FEEL · DANCE TEMPO	FROM YOUR LISTS
13	**I Got Rhythm**	B♭	AABA · 32	Charleston / fast lindy · 200–240	standard pick
14	**It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing)**	G– → B♭	AABA · 32	Lindy · 170–210	standard pick
15	**Jumpin' at the Woodside**	B♭	AABA · 32	Fast lindy · 200–250	standard pick
16	**Just Friends**	G	A B A B′ · 32	Lindy · Balboa · 170–220	standard pick
17	**Kansas City Stride**	G–	AABA · 32 + 8-bar intro	Lindy · Balboa · 170–210	your band's book
18	**Lester's Bounce**	G–	AABA · 32	Lindy · 130–170	Lazy lindy (Wilber & Sarpila)
19	**Lullaby of Birdland**	F– / A♭	AABA · 32	Lindy · Balboa · 150–200	standard pick
20	**Moanin'**	F–	AABA · 32	Slow lindy / blues shuffle · 100–125	uptempo swing (Art Blakey, alt. take)
21	**Oh, Lady Be Good**	G	AABA · 32	Lindy · 160–200	standard pick
22	**On the Sunny Side of the Street**	C	AABA · 32	Lazy lindy / blues · 110–140	Lazy lindy (Illinois Jacquet)
23	**Perdido**	B♭	AABA · 32	Lindy · 170–210	standard pick
24	**Puttin' On the Ritz**	F– → A♭	AABA · 32	Charleston / Balboa · 200–240	uptempo swing (Ella Fitzgerald)
25	**Ridin' and Jivin'**	F–	AABA · 32	Fast lindy · Balboa · 150	Bal/charleston (Hot Swing Sextet)
26	**Satin Doll**	C	AABA · 32	Lindy / slow swing · 130–160	standard pick
27	**A Smooth One**	F	AABA · 32	Lazy lindy · 120	Lazy lindy (Benny Goodman)
28	**Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise**	B♭–	AABA · 32	Balboa 180–210 · Lindy · 160–190	uptempo swing (Bobby Darin)
29	**Stompin' at the Savoy**	D♭	AABA · 32	Lindy 160–190 · Balboa · 190–220	standard pick
30	**Take the "A" Train**	C	AABA · 32	Lindy · 160–200	standard pick
31	**Topsy**	A–	AABA · 32	Lindy · Balboa · 165–200	uptempo swing (Royal Crown Revue)

#	TUNE	KEY	FORM	FEEL · DANCE TEMPO	FROM YOUR LISTS
32	**Undecided**	C	AABA · 32	Lindy · 170–210	standard pick

BANDSTAND BASICS FOR THE PIANO CHAIR

1. **With a bassist, give up the roots.** Left hand lives around middle C on rootless voicings (3-5-7-9 or 7-9-3-5). At Charleston tempo, just 3rds and 7ths.
2. **Head in two, solos in four.** Half-note feel on the melody, walking feel once the solos start. That's the Basie lift, and dancers feel it.
3. **Mark the bridge.** Change texture at every B (thinner, or a different rhythm). Horns and dancers both read the form off you.
4. **Intro = the last four bars** of the tune (or a I–VI–II–V vamp) at the real tempo. Ending = tag the last two bars three times.
5. **Guide tones first.** Before you solo on a tune, play one chorus of nothing but 3rd+7th of every chord in the left hand. It's the shortest road to hearing a form.
6. **Play fewer chords at fast tempos.** The bracketed turnarounds are decoration; the dancers hear the bass line and the drummer.

DANCE TEMPOS (ROUGH, BPM)

LAZY LINDY / BLUES	100 – 140
LINDY SWEET SPOT	150 – 190
UPTEMPO LINDY	190 – 220
BALBOA	180 – 240
CHARLESTON / SOLO JAZZ	200 – 260

Count the tune in at the tempo you'll keep. Dancers commit on bar one.

PENTATONICS AT DANCE TEMPO

At 200 bpm nobody can think a new scale every two beats, and nobody should. A pentatonic is five notes that sit under one hand, has no avoid notes, and covers eight bars at a time. Swing-era soloists (Lester Young above all) played the major pentatonic of the key through whole A sections and let the rhythm section supply the changes. The work is choosing the right five notes per section; after that the job is rhythm, not notes. Add the ♭5 to a minor pentatonic and you have the blues scale.

ONE PENTATONIC PER SECTION, TUNE BY TUNE

- **Ain't Misbehavin'** · E♭ major pent; bridge: C minor pent for two bars, then F7 → C7 → F7 → B♭7 by their 3rds.
- **All of Me** (in F) · F major pent; D minor pent on A7 → D–; B♭ major then B♭ minor pent on the last eight.
- **All the Things You Are** · A♭ major pent (bars 1–5), C major pent (6–8), E♭ major pent (9–13), G major pent (14–20), E major pent (21–23), A♭ major pent home. Five pentatonics, one tune.
- **Autumn Leaves** (in C–) · E♭ major pent for the major halves, C minor pent for the minor halves, A♭ major pent for the backdoor chain in C.
- **Battle of Jericho** · F minor pent / F blues, all 32 bars; E natural on the C7s if you want them heard.
- **Bei Mir** · C minor pent / blues scale, all 32 bars. F minor pent on the bridge's F– bars if you want contrast.
- **Blue Drag** · D minor pent / blues; G minor pent on the bridge's G– bars.
- **Blue Moon** · E♭ major pent over the whole loop; bridge bars 5–6: G♭ major pent (= E♭ minor pent).
- **Blue Skies** · A bars 1–5: C minor pent; bars 6–8: E♭ major pent. Bridge: E♭ major pent on the E♭ bars, E♭ minor pent on the A♭–6 bars.
- **Comes Love** (in A–) · A minor pent; A harmonic minor on the E7s; D minor pent on the bridge.
- **Don't Get Around Much** · C major pent with A7/D7/G7 money notes; bridge: F major pent then C7 → D7.
- **Honeysuckle Rose** · A: F major pent; drop to F minor pent in bars 5–8 for the blues. Bridge: F major pent over F7 and B♭, G major pent over G7.
- **I Got Rhythm** · A: B♭ major pent (+ blue D♭). Bridge: the major pent of each dominant, two bars each (D, G, C, F), or stay on B♭ minor pent for the blues version.
- **It Don't Mean a Thing** · A bars 1–4: G minor pent; bars 5–8: B♭ major pent. Bridge: B♭ major pent, E♭ major on bars 5–6.
- **Jumpin' at the Woodside** · B♭ major pent, all day; E♭ major pent on bars 5–6 if you want to move.
- **Just Friends** (in G) · G major pent; B♭ major pent on C–7 F7, A♭ major pent on B♭–7 E♭7, A major pent on the A7.
- **Kansas City Stride** (in G–) · G minor pent / blues on the riff; bridge: C major pent for six bars (G7, C, A–7), B♭ minor pent for the B♭– bars.
- **Lester's Bounce** · A: G minor pent / blues; the bass walk is the line. Bridge: G7 → C minor pent → A major pent → D7.
- **Lullaby of Birdland** · F harmonic minor for bars 1–2, A♭ major pent for the rest, bridge included.
- **Moanin'** · F minor pent / blues scale, all 32 bars. B♭ minor pent on the bridge's B♭–7.
- **Lady Be Good** · G major pent + blues; bridge: C major pent for two, G for two, then the three sharps (G♯ C♯ F♯).
- **Sunny Side of the Street** · C major pent plus the three money notes (G♯, C♯, F♯).
- **Perdido** · B♭ major pent + the B natural on G7. Bridge: same four dominants as I Got Rhythm.
- **Puttin' On the Ritz** · A: F minor pent. Bridge: A♭ major pent (the sunlight), back to F minor pent on D♭7–C7.

THE MENU, PER CHORD (SHOWN ON C)

CHORD	PENTATONIC	SOUND
CΔ7 · C6	**C major** 1 2 3 5 6	Home. Basie, Lester, every riff tune.
	G major 5 6 7 9 3	CΔ9, brighter; the 7 is in, the root is out.
C–7	**C minor** 1 ♭3 4 5 ♭7	The blues one. Add G♭ for the blues scale.
	G minor 5 ♭7 1 9 11	C–11, cooler, no 3rd.
	D minor 9 11 5 13 1	Dorian (the 13 is A natural).
C7	**C major** 1 2 3 5 6	Bright swing dominant.
	C minor 1 ♭3 4 5 ♭7	Blues over the dominant; ♭3 against the 3rd is the point.
	B♭ major ♭7 1 9 11 5	C9sus, the "modal" dominant.
	E♭ major ♯9 11 5 ♭7 1	Gospel / hard-bop blues (Moanin').
	D♭ major ♭9 ♯9 11 ♭13 ♭7	Altered; use on the V going to a minor i (G7♭9 → C– in Softly, Bei Mir).
Cø7	**A♭ major** ♭13 ♭7 1 ♭3 11	Half-diminished without the ♭5; easy.
	E♭ minor ♭3 ♭5 ♭13 ♭7 ♭9	Darker, with the ♭5. (On Dø7 that's F minor pent.)

Piano angle: stack a pentatonic in fourths and you get the "So What" voicing. D G C E A under one hand is C major pentatonic (and A minor pentatonic) in one shape; move the shape through the key for quartal comping on the static spots (Softly's A, Moanin'). For the boogie-ish list, a minor pentatonic in the low octave (C E♭ F G B♭) is already a boogie bass line.

- **Ridin' and Jivin'** · A: F minor pent / blues over the loop. Bridge: A♭ major pent (E♭7, A♭), F major pent on the F7 bars.
- **Satin Doll** · one major pentatonic per ii–V: C, D, G, G♭, then C. Bridge: F major pent, G major pent.
- **A Smooth One** · F major pent + blues over the riff. Bridge: B♭ major pent.
- **Softly** (in B♭–) · A: B♭ minor pent (the MJQ way). Bridge: D♭ major pent, then E♭ minor pent, then B♭ minor pent for the last two bars.
- **Stompin' at the Savoy** · A: D♭ major pent + E. Bridge: the major pent of each dominant (G♭, B, E, A, A♭).
- **Take the "A" Train** · C major pent everywhere except bars 3–4, where no pentatonic fits the D7♭5: play its four notes (D F♯ A♭ C) plus E.
- **Topsy** (in A–) · A minor pent / blues on the riff bars, D minor pent on the second A's D– bars; bridge: the major pent of each dominant (A, D, G, C), two bars each.
- **Undecided** · C major pent + blues; F7 bars take E♭. Bridge: C7 → F → D7 → G7, same as Sunny Side.

GLOSSARY OF MUSIC NOTATION

Everything the charts and solo maps assume you can read: the chord symbols this book uses and the ones other charts use for the same thing, the road signs on a lead sheet, the words a bandleader will say on the stand, and the scale and voicing terms in the solo maps.

CHORD SYMBOLS

HERE	ALSO WRITTEN	MEANS	NOTES
C	C, Cmaj	major triad (C E G)	Rare on a jazz chart; usually C6 or CΔ7.
C6	CM6, Cmaj6	major 6 (C E G A)	The swing-era major chord. Use it when the melody sits on the root; a Δ7 would clash.
CΔ7	Cmaj7, CM7, C△7, Cma7	major 7 (C E G B)	The Δ (delta) is the fake-book sign for "major 7".
C6/9	C6(add9), C69	major 6 with 9 (C E G A D)	A richer C6; the Basie ending chord.
C–	Cm, Cmin, C-	minor triad (C E♭ G)	The dash means minor on every iReal and Real Book chart.
C–7	Cm7, Cmin7, C-7	minor 7 (C E♭ G B♭)	The ii chord of a ii–V–I.
C–6	Cm6, Cmin6	minor 6 (C E♭ G A)	The tonic minor in Softly and Bei Mir; the A natural is the colour.
C–Δ7	Cm(maj7), CmM7, Cm△7, C-△7	minor with major 7 (C E♭ G B)	The second chord of a line cliché (C–, C–Δ7, C–7, C–6).
C7	C7, Cdom7	dominant 7 (C E G B♭)	The V chord; also I7 and IV7 in blues and riff tunes.
C9	C9, C13	dominant with 9th (or 13th) added	A 13 chord implies the 7 and 9 too. Voicing choices, not different chords; play C7 if in doubt.
C7♭9	C7-9, C7(♭9)	dominant with flat 9 (C E G B♭ D♭)	The V of a minor key. Same notes as a °7 chord a half step up without the root.
C7♯5	C+7, C7+, Caug7, C7(♯5)	dominant with raised 5 (C E G♯ B♭)	The hinge chord at the end of the All the Things You Are bridge.
C7♭5	C7-5, C7♯11, C7(♭5)	dominant with flat 5 (C E G♭ B♭)	In practice the same as 7♯11: A Train's D7♭5.
C7alt	C7♯9♭13, Calt	dominant with any of ♭9 ♯9 ♯11 ♭13	Pick the alterations; the altered scale covers all of them.
Cø7	Cm7♭5, Cm7-5, C-7(♭5)	half-diminished (C E♭ G♭ B♭)	The ø (slashed circle) is "half-diminished": the ii of a minor ii–V (Dø7 G7 C–).
C°7	Cdim7, Cdim, C°	diminished 7 (C E♭ G♭ A)	Symmetrical: C°7 = E♭°7 = G♭°7 = A°7. Usually a passing chord between two diatonic chords.
C7sus4	Csus, C7sus, G–7/C	4th replaces the 3rd (C F G B♭)	Suspended; resolves to C7 or stays as a modal sound.
C/E	C/E	C chord with E in the bass	Slash chord: chord before the slash, bass note after. C–7/F, A–Δ7/G♯ and so on.
N.C.	tacet	no chord	Melody alone or silence; a break.
(D–7 G7)		optional chord or turnaround	In this book, small chords in brackets: play them or leave them; bands differ.



A	Boxed letter: a section begins (A A B A). The bridge is B; players also call it "the middle eight", "the release" or "the channel".
4/4	Time signature, four beats to the bar. Swing feel unless the style says Latin or Shuffle.
|: :|	Repeat signs: play the bars between them twice.
1. 2.	Endings: play the bracket marked 1 the first time, go back, skip it and play 2 the second time. In this book the whole second line of an A is the ending.
%	Simile mark: repeat the previous bar.
‖	Double bar: a new section. Thin-thick bar: the end of the form.
C6 A7	Two chords in a bar: beats 1–2 and 3–4 unless a rhythm is written.
bar 17	Bars are numbered through the form: in a 32-bar AABA, bar 9 starts the second A, bar 17 the bridge, bar 25 the last A.
(Medium Swing)	Style and feel, top left. Rough tempos: Medium 120–160, Medium Up 160–200, Up 200 and above.
D.C. · D.S. · ⊕ · Fine	Road signs on other charts: D.C. (da capo) go back to the top; D.S. (dal segno) go back to the sign 𝄋; "al Coda" then jump to the coda ⊕; Fine marks the end. Not used in this book: every chart here is written out.
Concert key	What the piano plays. B♭ instruments (tenor, trumpet, clarinet) read a tone higher, E♭ instruments (alto, bari) a major sixth higher: Perdido in B♭ is C for the tenor, G for the alto.

FORM AND BANDSTAND WORDS

Head	The melody chorus, played first and last.
Chorus	One complete pass through the form (32 bars here). "Take two" means two choruses.
Turnaround	The last two bars' I–VI–II–V (or a variant) that leads back to the top.
Tag	Repeating the last phrase, usually three times, to end.
Vamp	A repeated two- or four-bar figure: an intro, or "till ready" for the singer.
Break	The band stops for two bars and the soloist plays alone.
Trading fours	Soloists alternate four-bar phrases, often with the drummer. Eights likewise.
In two / in four	Bass in half notes / walking quarters. Head in two, solos in four is the Basie shape.
Shout chorus	The loud arranged ensemble chorus near the end.
Out chorus	The last melody chorus; "take it out" means go to the ending.
Rhythm changes	The chords of I Got Rhythm. "Rhythm bridge": III7–VI7–II7–V7.
Honeysuckle bridge	I7–IV–II7–V7 (also called the Montgomery-Ward bridge).
Contrafact	A new melody on an existing tune's changes (Oleo on rhythm changes, Scrapple on Honeysuckle).
Roman numerals	Chords named by scale degree: in B♭, I = B♭, ii = C–7, V7 = F7. Lower case = minor; "7" = dominant.
ii–V–I	The basic cadence: D–7 G7 C. Minor version: Dø7 G7♭9 C–.
Secondary dominant	A dominant pointing at a chord other than I: D7 → G7 in C (V of V).
Tritone sub	A dominant replaced by the dominant a tritone away: D♭7 for G7. Same 3rd and 7th, swapped.
Line cliché	A moving inner voice under a held chord: C–, C–Δ7, C–7, C–6 (Blue Skies, It Don't Mean a Thing).
Pedal	A held bass note under changing chords (the B♭ under the Blue Skies bridge).

SOLO-MAP WORDS

Guide tones	The 3rd and 7th of each chord, and the line they trace through the changes.
Money note	The one note that names a chord in its context (G♯ on A Train's D7♭5). Highlighted in the solo maps.
Mixolydian	Major scale with ♭7; the dominant scale. G7 → G A B C D E F.
Dorian	Minor scale with a natural 6; the minor-7 scale. D–7 → D E F G A B C.
Lydian dominant	Mixolydian with ♯4. D7♯11 → D E F♯ G♯ A B C.
Harmonic minor	Minor with a raised 7; use over V7♭9 in minor (C harmonic minor over G7♭9).
Melodic minor	Minor with raised 6 and 7; the –6 and –Δ7 scale.
Altered scale	For 7alt chords: melodic minor a half step up (D♭ melodic minor over C7alt).
Diminished scale	Alternating half and whole steps; for °7 chords and 7♭9 chords.
Pentatonic	Five notes: major 1 2 3 5 6, minor 1 ♭3 4 5 ♭7. See the pentatonics page.
Blues scale	Minor pentatonic plus the ♭5.

Enclosure	Approaching a target note from above and below before landing on it.
Rootless voicing	A left-hand chord without the root (3-5-7-9 or 7-9-3-5); the bass has the root.
Shell	Two notes: 3rd and 7th (or root and 7th). Enough at fast tempos.
Block chords	Melody harmonised with four notes in the right hand, doubled an octave down in the left (Shearing, Garner, Timmons). Also "locked hands".
Stride	Left hand alternating a bass note (beats 1 and 3) with a chord (2 and 4). Waller, Johnson.
Comping	Accompanying a soloist with chords and rhythm (from "accompanying").
Charleston rhythm	A dotted quarter and an eighth: hits on beat 1 and the "and" of 2. The standard comping figure.
Quartal voicing	A chord built in fourths (D G C E A, the "So What" voicing).

PIANO

Concert pitch, with keyboard figures for every chord and scale.

#	TUNE	KEY	FORM	DANCE TEMPO
01	Ain't Misbehavin'	E♭	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
02	All of Me	F	A B A C · 32	150–190 bpm
03	All the Things You Are	A♭	A A′ B A″ · 36	150–190 bpm
04	Autumn Leaves	C–	A A B C · 32	100–180 bpm
05	Battle of Jericho	F–	AABA · 32	150–200 bpm
06	Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen	C–	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
07	Blue Drag	D–	AABA · 32	90–120 bpm
08	Blue Moon	E♭	AABA · 32	110–180 bpm
09	Blue Skies	C– → E♭	AABA · 32	150–190 bpm
10	Comes Love	A–	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
11	Don't Get Around Much Anymore	C	AABA · 32	130–180 bpm
12	Honeysuckle Rose	F	AABA · 32	150–190 bpm
13	I Got Rhythm	B♭	AABA · 32	200–240 bpm
14	It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing)	G– → B♭	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm
15	Jumpin' at the Woodside	B♭	AABA · 32	200–250 bpm
16	Just Friends	G	A B A B′ · 32	170–220 bpm
17	Kansas City Stride	G–	AABA · 32 + 8-bar intro	170–210 bpm
18	Lester's Bounce	G–	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
19	Lullaby of Birdland	F– / A♭	AABA · 32	150–200 bpm
20	Moanin'	F–	AABA · 32	100–125 bpm
21	Oh, Lady Be Good	G	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
22	On the Sunny Side of the Street	C	AABA · 32	110–140 bpm
23	Perdido	B♭	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm
24	Puttin' On the Ritz	F– → A♭	AABA · 32	200–240 bpm
25	Ridin' and Jivin'	F–	AABA · 32	150 bpm
26	Satin Doll	C	AABA · 32	130–160 bpm
27	A Smooth One	F	AABA · 32	120 bpm
28	Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise	B♭–	AABA · 32	160–190 bpm
29	Stompin' at the Savoy	D♭	AABA · 32	190–220 bpm
30	Take the “A” Train	C	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
31	Topsy	A–	AABA · 32	165–200 bpm
32	Undecided	C	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm

(Medium Swing)

Ain't Misbehavin'

Fats Waller, Harry Brooks & Andy Razaf



Key **E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written **1929**

Ain't Misbehavin' · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Stride is the sound: bass note on 1 and 3 (root, then 5th or the tenth), chord on 2 and 4; with a bassist, drop the bass notes and punch 2 and 4 only.
- Voice the E°7 in bar 1 as C7♭9 without the root (E G B♭ D♭) so it slides into F–7; A♭6 → A♭–6 in bar 4 is the tenderest bar of the tune, let the C♭ ring.
- The turnaround bars (G7 C7 | F7 B♭7) want a chromatic walk in the left hand; keep the right hand on the melody's rhythm.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A — **E♭6** G C · **E°7** G D♭ · **F–7** A♭ E♭ · **B♭7** D A♭ · **E♭7** G D♭ · **A♭6** C F · **A♭–6** B F · **C7** E B♭ · **G7** B F · **F7** A E♭

B — **C–** E♭ G · **A♭7** C G♭ · **F7** A E♭ · **C7** E B♭ · **C–7** E♭ B♭ · **B♭7** D A♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A — **E♭ major, with Waller's colours**

E♭ major pentatonic as home. The colours, one per chord: E°7 → E, E♭7 → D♭ (into A♭), A♭–6 → C♭, C7 → E, G7 → B, F7 → A. The turnaround is four dominants; hit their 3rds on the downbeats.

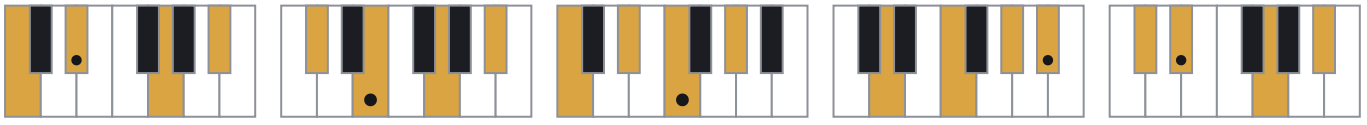
B — **C minor, then dominants home**

C minor pentatonic for bars 1–2 (A♭7 adds G♭). F7 (A, E♭) for two, C7 (E) for two is the surprise, then F7 and B♭7 (D) pull you back to E♭.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 1 as E♭6 C7/E · bar 2 as F–7 F♯°7 · bar 3 as E♭6 G7 · first-A bar 7 as E♭6 C7 · bridge bars 5–6 as B♭6 | F7 in some charts.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



E♭6
E♭ G B♭ C

E°7
E G B♭ D♭

F–7
F A♭ C E♭

B♭7
B♭ D F A♭

E♭7
E♭ G B♭ D♭



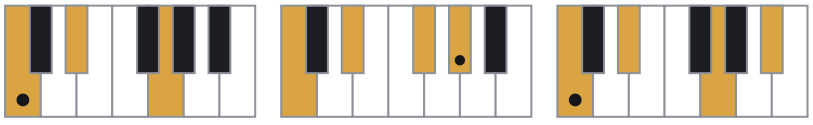
A♭6
A♭ C E♭ F

A♭–6
A♭ B E♭ F

C7
C E G B♭

G7
G B D F

F7
F A C E♭

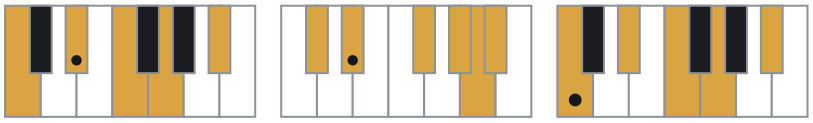


C–
C E♭ G

A♭7
A♭ C E♭ G♭

C–7
C E♭ G B♭

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · E♭ major pent
E♭ F G B♭ C

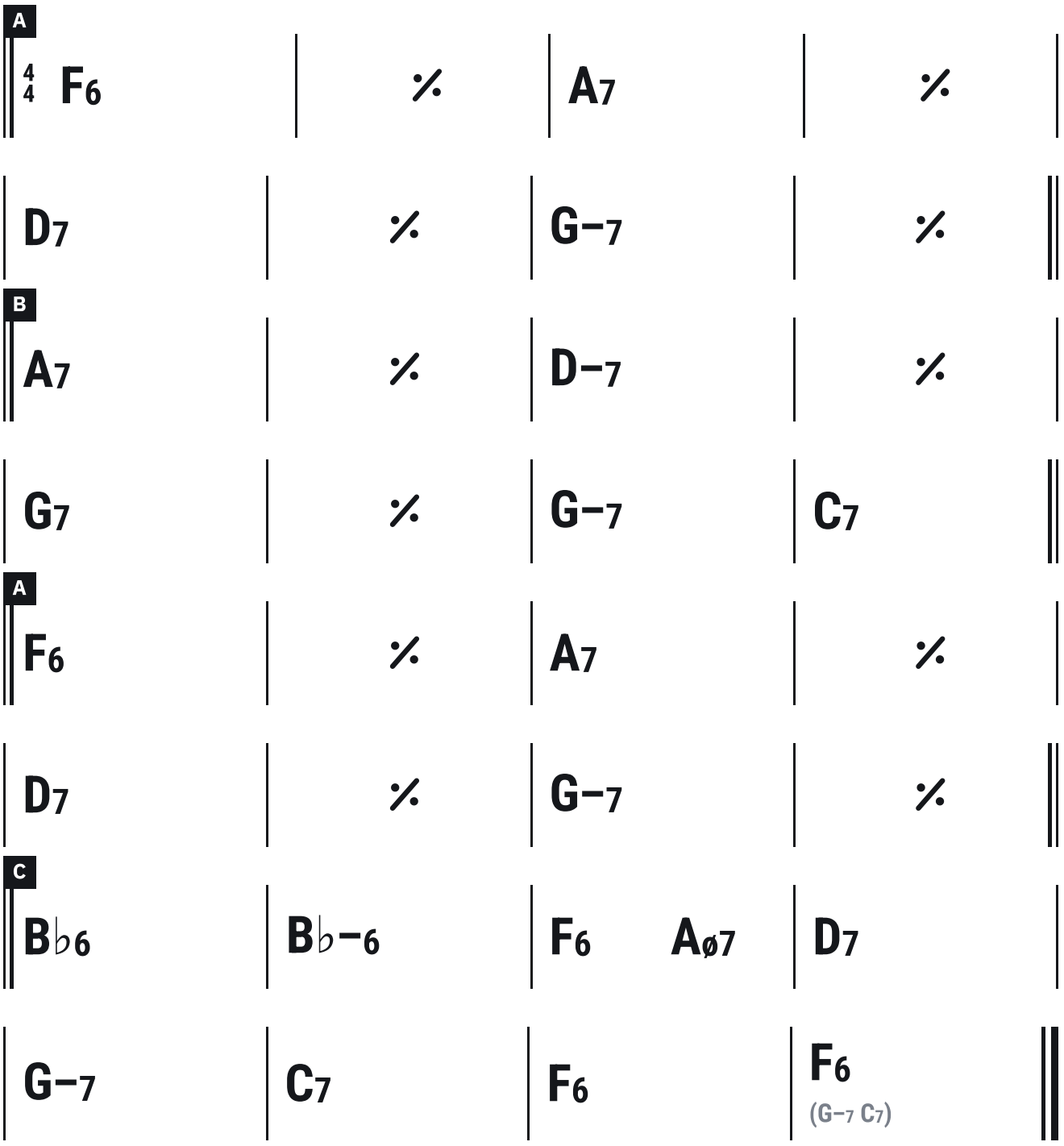
A · E♭ blues scale
E♭ G♭ A♭ A B♭ D♭

B bars 1–2 · C minor pent
C E♭ F G B♭

(Medium Swing)

All of Me

Gerald Marks & Seymour Simons



Key **F** Form **A B A C · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1931**

All of Me · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Two bars a chord: comp sparsely on the long dominants (A7, D7) and let the bass carry them; one Charleston figure per bar is plenty.
- Voice A7 as A7♭9 (C♯ E G B♭) into D–7, and the C section's B♭6 → B♭–6 with D → D♭ on top: it's the moment the whole band waits for.
- Lay out for the first two bars of the C section and come in on B♭–6. Tag: G–7 C7 | F6 three times, with C7♭9 if the singer holds the last note.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	F6	A D	A7	C♯ G	D7	F♯ C	G–7	B♭ F											
B	A7	C♯ G	D–7	F C	G7	B F	G–7	B♭ F	C7	E B♭									
C	B♭6	D G	B♭–6	D♭ G	F6	A D	Aø7	C E♭ G	D7	F♯ C	G–7	B♭ F	C7	E B♭					

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F major with two sharps bent in

F major pentatonic; A7 wants C♯ (the first surprise of the tune), D7 wants F♯, G–7 is F major again. Two bars per chord, so one idea per chord is enough.

B

A7 → D–, then G7 → G–7 C7

A7 (C♯) into D minor pentatonic for two bars; G7 (B natural) for two; G–7 C7 back to F.

C

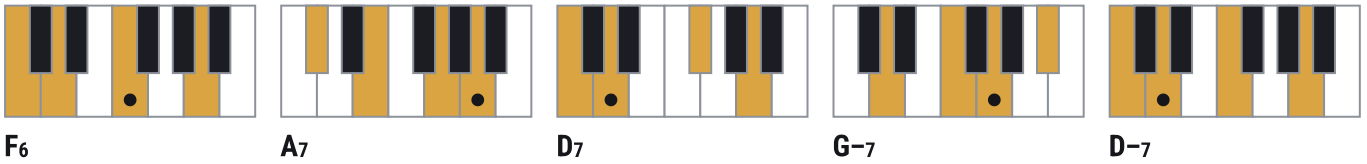
IV, iv, home

B♭ major pentatonic, then B♭ minor pentatonic over B♭–6 (D♭ is the tender note); Aø7 D7 (E♭, F♯) into G–7 C7 F6.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 3–4 of the A as A7 | A7♭9 · C bars 3–4 as F6 | D7 (no Aø7) in older charts · the Real Book's key is C: everything a fourth down.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



F6
F A C D

A7
A C♯ E G

D7
D F♯ A C

G–7
G B♭ D F

D–7
D F A C

G7
G B D F

C7
C E G B♭

B♭6
B♭ D F G

B♭–6
B♭ D♭ F G

Aø7
A C E♭ G

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · F major pent
F G A C D

B · D minor pent (A7 → D–)
D F G A C

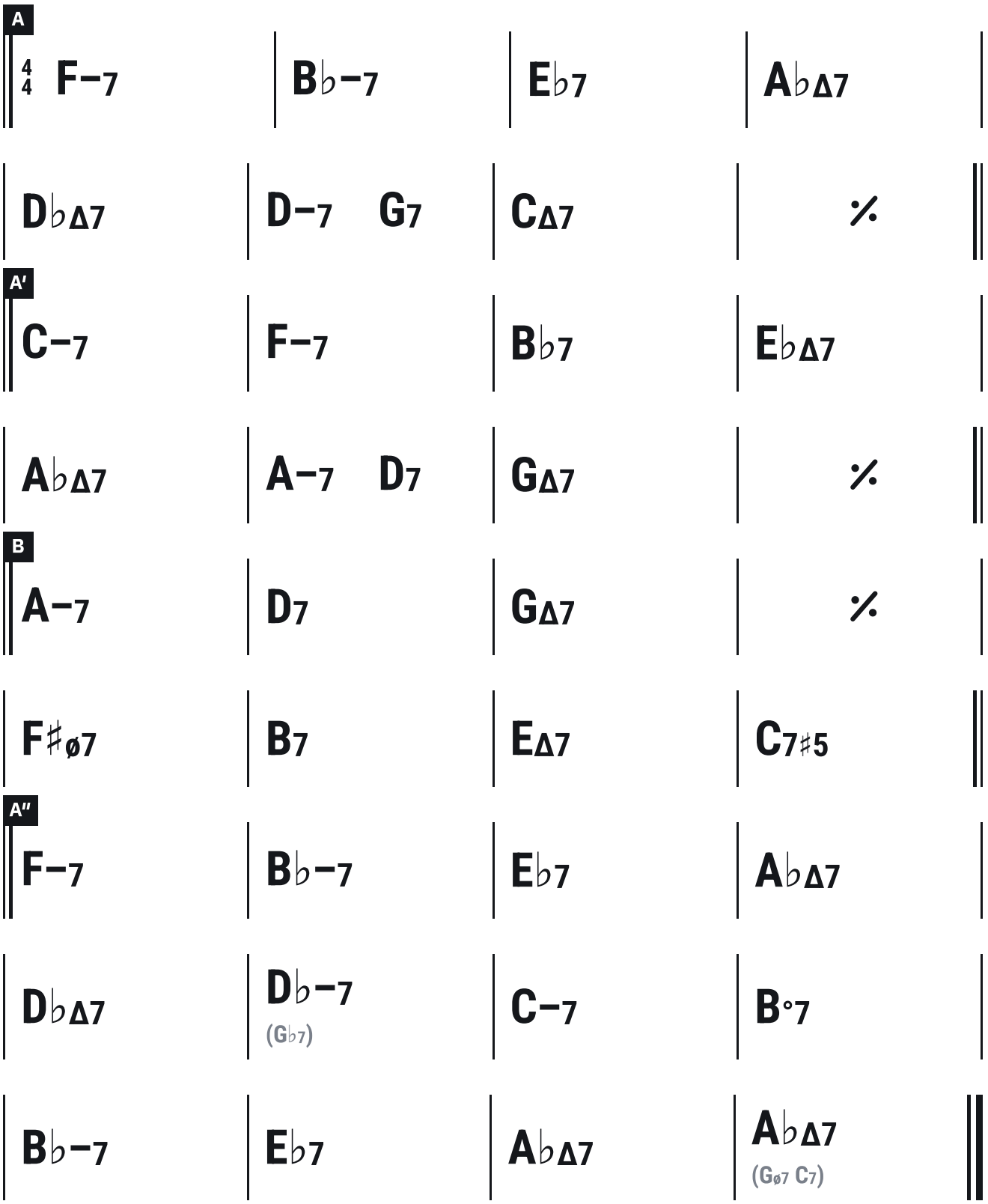
C · B♭ major pent
B♭ C D F G

C · B♭ minor pent (B♭–6)
B♭ D♭ E♭ F A♭

(Medium Swing)

All the Things You Are

Jerome Kern & Oscar Hammerstein II



Key **A♭** Form **A A′ B A″ · 36** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1939**

All the Things You Are · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Every bar is a ii–V or a I: rootless shapes (3-5-7-9 and 7-9-3-5) move by half steps through the whole tune; practise F–7 B♭–7 E♭7 A♭Δ7 D♭Δ7 with the minimum motion.
- Bar 24 (C7♯5) and bar 36 (Gø7 C7) are the two hinges: voice C7♯5 as E G♯ B♭ with D♭ on top and let it fall into F–7.
- Bars 29–32 (D♭Δ7 D♭–7 C–7 B°7) are a descending bass line: walk it in octaves and keep the right hand still.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	F–7	A♭ E♭	B♭–7	D♭ A♭	E♭7	G D♭	A♭Δ7	C G	D♭Δ7	F C	D–7	F C	G7	B F	CΔ7	E B			
A′	C–7	E♭ B♭	F–7	A♭ E♭	B♭7	D A♭	E♭Δ7	G D	A♭Δ7	C G	A–7	C G	D7	F♯ C	GΔ7	B F♯			
B	A–7	C G	D7	F♯ C	GΔ7	B F♯	F♯ø7	A C E	B7	D♯ A	EΔ7	G♯ D♯	C7♯5	E G♯ B♭					
A″	F–7	A♭ E♭	B♭–7	D♭ A♭	E♭7	G D♭	A♭Δ7	C G	D♭Δ7	F C	D♭–7	E B	C–7	E♭ B♭	B°7	D A♭			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A — **vi–ii–V–I–IV in A♭, then a side-step to C**

F–7 B♭–7 E♭7 A♭Δ7 D♭Δ7 is one scale: A♭ major, heard as a circle of fourths. Then D–7 G7 CΔ7: the money notes are B and E. The melody's first note on each chord is its 3rd or 7th; sing the melody and you're playing guide tones.

A′ — **The same thing a fourth lower: E♭, then G**

C–7 F–7 B♭7 E♭Δ7 A♭Δ7 = E♭ major. Then A–7 D7 GΔ7: F♯ and B.

B — **G major, then E major, then the door back**

A–7 D7 GΔ7 for four bars (G major). F♯ø7 B7 EΔ7: E major, so G♯ D♯ C♯. C7♯5 in the last bar is the hinge: E natural and G♯ (= A♭) pull you back to F–.

A″ — **A♭ again, with the chromatic walk-down**

As the first A through D♭Δ7, then D♭–7 (F♭ /E, C♭ /B), C–7, B°7 (D , F, A♭) into B♭–7 E♭7 A♭Δ7. Think of bars 29–32 as a bass line and play across it; it's four bars of one gesture.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 30 as D♭–7 alone or as G♭7 · bar 24 as C7♭9 or C7alt · last bar's Gø7 C7 is the turnaround into the next chorus, dropped on the out chorus.

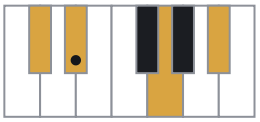
EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



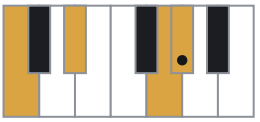
F–7
F A♭ C E♭



B♭–7
B♭ D♭ F A♭



E♭7
E♭ G B♭ D♭



A♭Δ7
A♭ C E♭ G



D♭Δ7
D♭ F A♭ C



D–7
D F A C



G7
G B D F



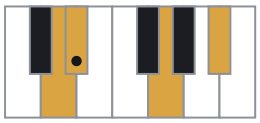
CΔ7
C E G B



C–7
C E♭ G B♭



B♭7
B♭ D F A♭



E♭Δ7

E♭ G B♭ D



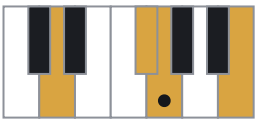
A−7

A C E G



D7

D F♯ A C



GΔ7

G B D F♯



F♯ø7

F♯ A C E



B7

B D♯ F♯ A



EΔ7

E G♯ B D♯



C7♯5

C E G♯ B♭



D♭−7

D♭ E A♭ B



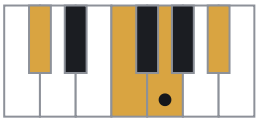
G♭7

G♭ B♭ D♭ E



B°7

B D F A♭



Gø7

G B♭ D♭ F



C7

C E G B♭

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



Bars 1–5 · A♭ major pent

A♭ B♭ C E♭ F



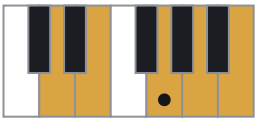
Bars 6–8 · C major pent

C D E G A



Bars 9–13 · E♭ major pent

E♭ F G B♭ C



Bars 14–20 · G major pent

G A B D E



Bars 21–23 · E major pent

E F♯ G♯ B C♯

(Medium Swing)

Autumn Leaves (Les feuilles mortes)

Joseph Kosma (Prévert / Mercer)

A

4/4 F–7	B♭7	E♭Δ7	A♭Δ7
Dø7	G7	C–	𝄎

A

F–7	B♭7	E♭Δ7	A♭Δ7
Dø7	G7	C–	𝄎

B

Dø7	G7	C–	𝄎
F–7	B♭7	E♭Δ7	A♭Δ7

C

Dø7	G7	C–7 F7	B♭–7 E♭7
A♭Δ7	Dø7 G7	C–	C– (Dø7 G7)

Key **C–** Form **A A B C · 32** Feel **Lindy / ballad** Dance tempo **100–180 bpm** Written **1945**

Autumn Leaves · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- ii–V–I in E♭ for four bars, ii–V–i in C minor for four: two rootless shapes cover the whole tune. Voice G7 as G7♭9 (B D F A♭) into C–6.
- Rubato verse if the singer does it; then head in two, solos in four. At 100 it's a blues-floor ballad with triplets; at 160 a Lindy tune.
- C section: C–7 F7 | B♭–7 E♭7 is a chain of ii–Vs falling by whole steps; walk the left hand down and keep the right hand on 3rds and 7ths.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**B♭7**	D A♭	**E♭Δ7**	G D	**A♭Δ7**	C G	**Dø7**	F A♭ C	**G7**	B F	**C–**	E♭ G					
B	**Dø7**	F A♭ C	**G7**	B F	**C–**	E♭ G	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**B♭7**	D A♭	**E♭Δ7**	G D	**A♭Δ7**	C G					
C	**Dø7**	F A♭ C	**G7**	B F	**C–7**	E♭ B♭	**F7**	A E♭	**B♭–7**	D♭ A♭	**E♭7**	G D♭	**A♭Δ7**	C G	**C–**	E♭ G			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A — **E♭ major for four bars, C minor for four**

F–7 B♭7 E♭Δ7 A♭Δ7 is one scale: E♭ major (A♭ major pentatonic also fits all four). Then Dø7 G7 C–: C harmonic minor on the G7 (B natural, A♭) and C minor pentatonic home.

B — **The A section reversed**

Minor half first (Dø7 G7 C–), major half second (F–7 B♭7 E♭ A♭). Same notes, opposite order; the trap is starting the bridge in E♭ major out of habit.

C — **Two backdoor ii–Vs sliding down, then home**

C–7 F7 → B♭–7 E♭7 → A♭Δ7: C dorian, F mixolydian (A), B♭ dorian, E♭ mixolydian (G), A♭ major. Then Dø7 G7 C– to close. Think of bars 3–5 as one gesture descending by whole steps.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 8 of each A as C–7 or C–6 · C bars 3–4 as C–7 F7 | F–7 B♭7 (a plain ii–V to E♭) · keys: G– (Real Book), E– (original), C– (here).

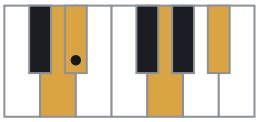
EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



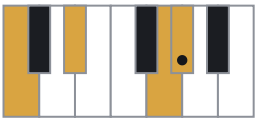
F–7
F A♭ C E♭



B♭7
B♭ D F A♭



E♭Δ7
E♭ G B♭ D



A♭Δ7
A♭ C E♭ G



Dø7
D F A♭ C



G7
G B D F



C–
C E♭ G



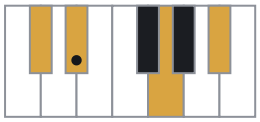
C–7
C E♭ G B♭



F7
F A C E♭

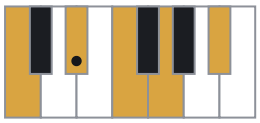


B♭–7
B♭ D♭ F A♭



E♭7
E♭ G B♭ D♭

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A bars 1–4, B bars 5–8 · E♭ major pent

E♭ F G B♭ C



A bars 5–8 · C minor pent

C E♭ F G B♭



over G7 · C harmonic minor

C D E♭ F G A♭ B



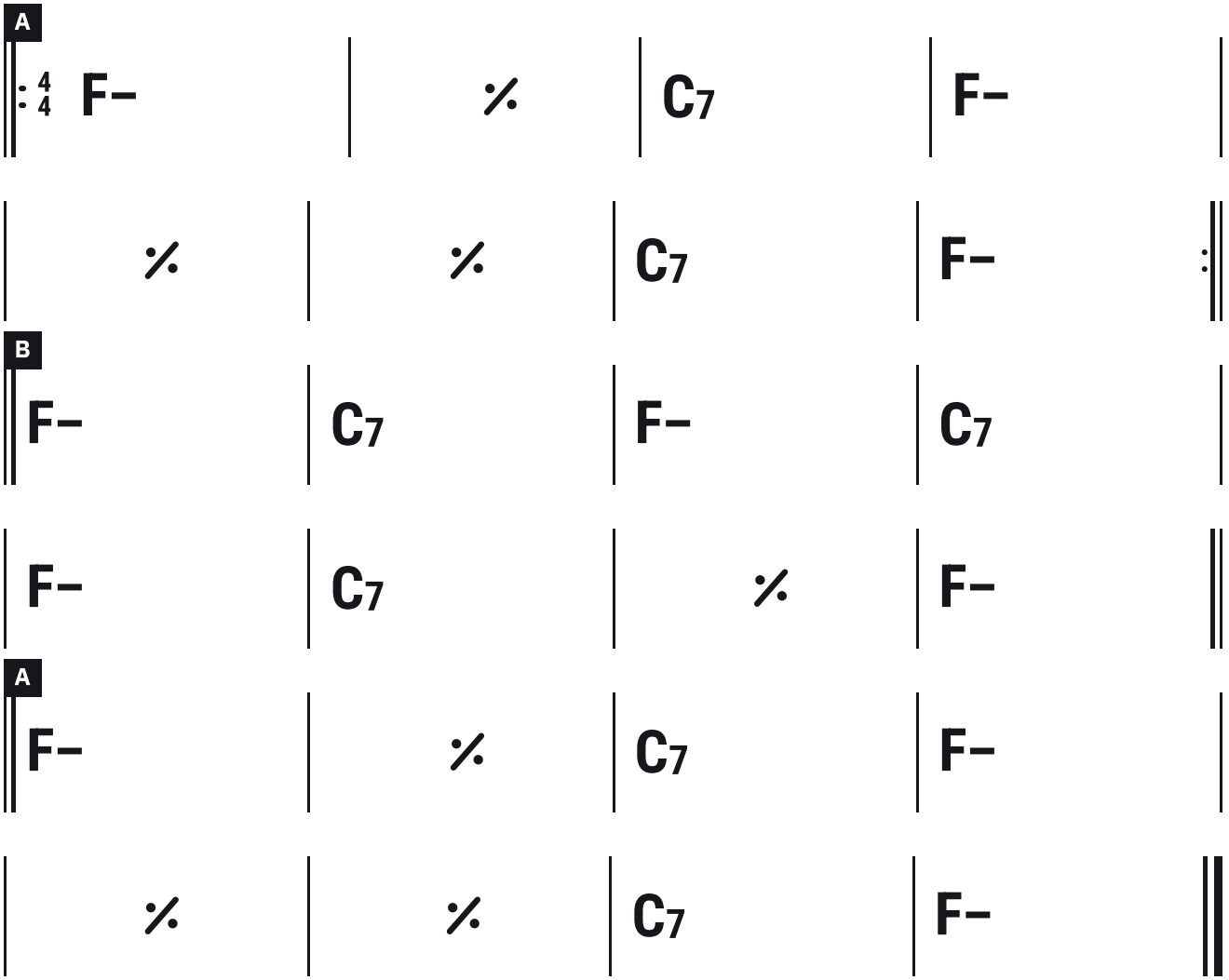
C bars 3–5 · A♭ major pent

A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

(Medium Swing)

Battle of Jericho (Joshua Fit the Battle)

Traditional spiritual, your band's arrangement



Key **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–200 bpm** Written **trad.**

Battle of Jericho · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Two chords means the arrangement is dynamics: build each A, drop the bridge to bass and snare, shout the last A in block chords.
- C7♭9 (E G B♭ D♭) on every C7 for the gospel sound; F–6 with the D natural on top for the home chord.
- Intro: walking bass alone on F for four bars, drums join, then the head.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**F–**	A♭ C	**C7**	E B♭
B	**F–**	A♭ C	**C7**	E B♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F minor, one scale

F minor pentatonic and the F blues scale cover the whole A. On C7 play E natural (F harmonic minor) if you want the chord change to be heard at all; A♭ is home.

B

The same, with twice the C7

Bars 6–7 are two bars of C7: sit on E and B♭, or do the Bechet thing and play the melody's rhythm on one note until the F– comes back.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

B♭– (iv) in bar 3 of the A if the band wants a third chord · C7♭9 throughout · some bands play the B as F– | F– | C7 | C7 twice.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



F–
F A♭ C



C7
C E G B♭

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A, B · F minor pent
F A♭ B♭ C E♭



A, B · F blues scale
F A♭ B♭ B C E♭
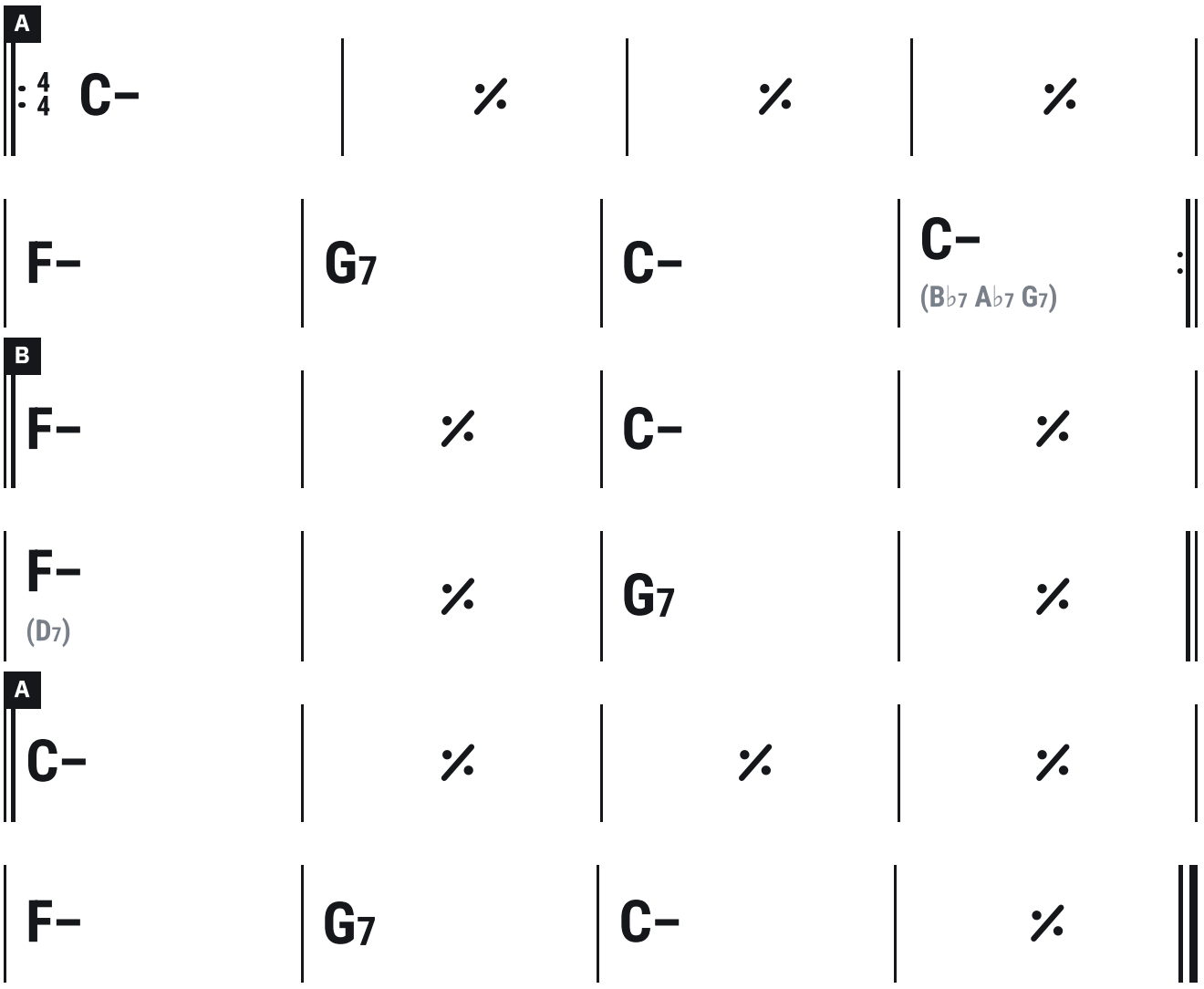


over C7 · F harmonic minor
F G A♭ B♭ C D♭ E

(Medium Swing)

Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen

Sholom Secunda



Key **C–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1932**

Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Bars 1–4: voice the left hand on the walking line C – D – E♭ – F – G – F – E♭, not on a held C–; the right hand comps a Charleston figure.
- F– → G7 → C– in bars 5–7: G7♭9 (B D F A♭) into C–6; the turnaround B♭7 A♭7 G7 in the last bar is chromatic dominants, optional at speed.
- Start at the chorus; the verse (the slow intro on the Andrews Sisters record) is rarely played instrumentally.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**C–**	E♭ G	**F–**	A♭ C	**G7**	B F	
B	**F–**	A♭ C	**C–**	E♭ G	**G7**	B F	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C minor blues language

The C minor blues scale works over the entire A; this is a minor blues tune. F–: F dorian (A♭ major). G7: C harmonic minor, B natural against A♭. The turnaround B♭7 – A♭7 – G7 is chromatic dominants: target the 3rds D C B.

B

iv → i, twice, opening into V

F– (F dorian, A♭ major pentatonic) to C–, then the second half can go II7–V7: D7 (F♯) into G7 (B). The bridge is where the tune briefly feels major; play pretty there and save the blues for the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 as G7 | G7 · bridge bars 5–6 as D7 | D7 (II7–V7) · turnaround optional at speed.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



C–
C E♭ G



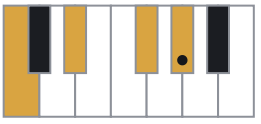
F–
F A♭ C



G7
G B D F



B♭7
B♭ D F A♭



A♭7
A♭ C E♭ G♭

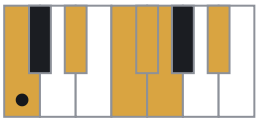


D7
D F♯ A C

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · C minor pent
C E♭ F G B♭



A · C blues scale
C E♭ F G♭ G B♭

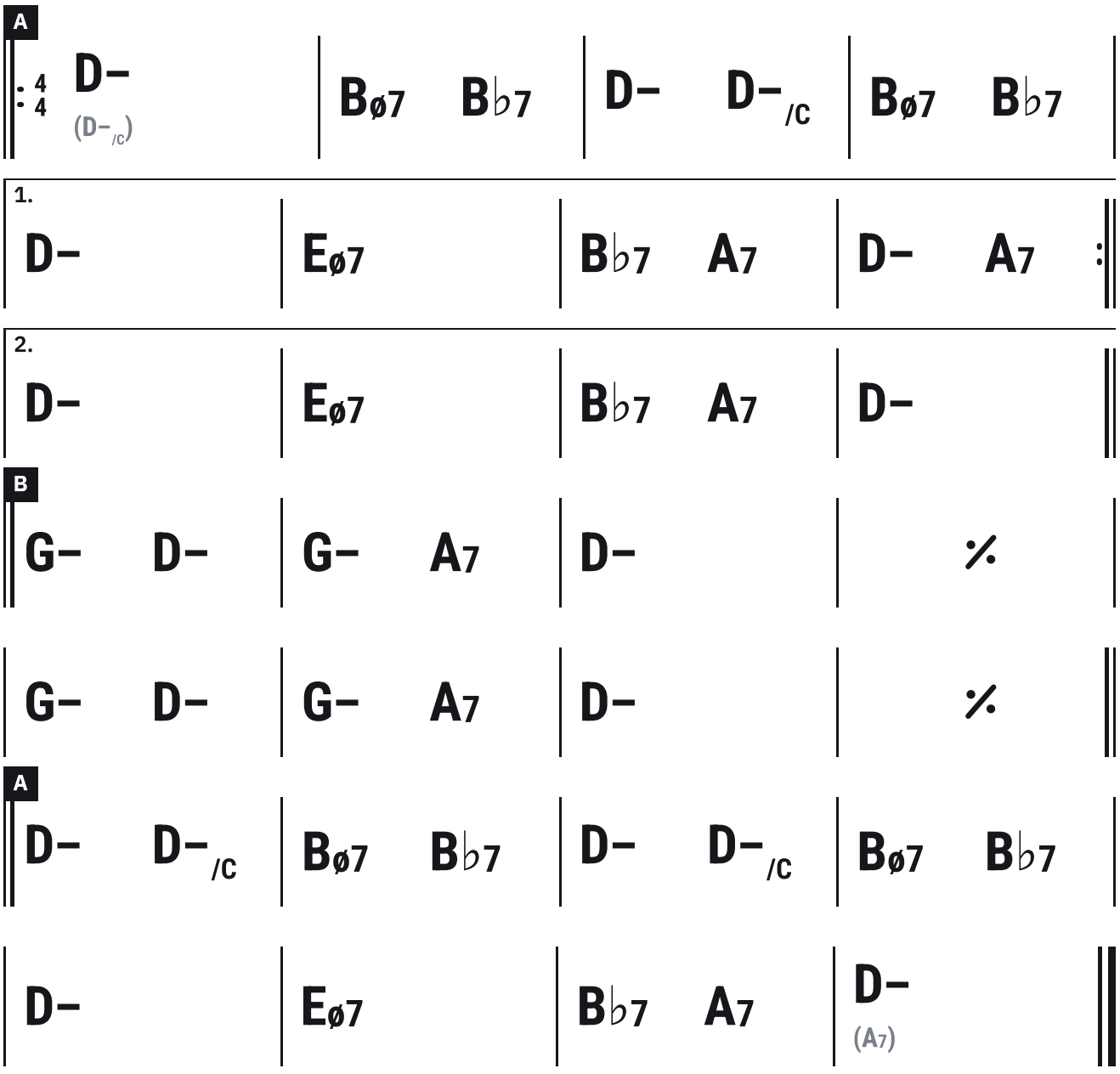


B · F minor pent
F A♭ B♭ C E♭

(Slow Swing)

Blue Drag

Josef Myrow (your Pataswing chart)



Key **D–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Slow lindy / blues** Dance tempo **90–120 bpm** Written **1932**

Blue Drag · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- 90 bpm is a blues-dance tune: slow Charleston figure in the right hand, left hand on the roots with the bass dragging the quarter notes.
- Bø7 B♭7 → D–: the ♭VI7 slide. Voice B♭7 as B♭ D A♭ (no 5th) falling to A7 (A C♯ G) and back to D–6.
- The chromatic pickup into the last A (C♯ D D♯ E, then E F in triplets) is a horn line: double it in octaves. Ending: B♭7 A7 | D– held, then the last four bars rit. on D–.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **D–** F A **Bø7** D F A **B♭7** D A♭ **D–/C** F A **Eø7** G B♭ D **A7** C♯ G

B **G–** B♭ D **D–** F A **A7** C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D minor, with a ♭VI–V slide

D minor pentatonic and blues scale at home. Bø7 B♭7: F then A♭ (B♭7's ♭7), the chord that gives the tune its drag. Eø7: B♭. B♭7 A7 at the end is the half-step slide: A♭ on the B♭7, then land C♯ on the A7.

B

iv and i, with A7 every second bar

G minor pentatonic over the G– beats, D minor pentatonic over D–; the A7s want C♯. Leave space: the bridge melody is mostly rests.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 6 as A7 or A9 (Django's rhythm section) · bar 2 as B°7 B♭7 · bridge G– as C♯°7 in some gypsy charts.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



D–
D F A



D–/C
D F A



Bø7
B D F A



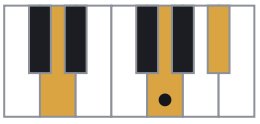
B♭7
B♭ D F A♭



Eø7
E G B♭ D



A7
A C♯ E G



G–
G B♭ D

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · D minor pent
D F G A C



A · D blues scale
D F G A♭ A C



B · G minor pent
G B♭ C D F

(Medium Swing)

Blue Moon

Richard Rodgers & Lorenz Hart



Key **E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / blues** Dance tempo **110–180 bpm** Written **1934**

Blue Moon · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- The loop (E♭6 C–7 | F–7 B♭7) is the intro and the ending: vamp it until the singer is ready, tag it to finish.
- At 110 it's a blues-dance tune with triplets in the left hand; at 170 a Lindy tune with a Charleston comp. Decide before the count-off.
- Bridge bars 5–6 (A♭–7 D♭7 | G♭6) are the slip to G♭: the same rootless shapes you used for F–7 B♭7 | E♭6, up a minor third.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**E♭6**	G C	**C–7**	E♭ B♭	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**B♭7**	D A♭			
B	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**B♭7**	D A♭	**E♭6**	G C	**A♭–7**	B G♭	**D♭7**	F B	**G♭6**	B♭ E♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

One loop, E♭ major

E♭ major pentatonic over the whole loop; C minor pentatonic is the same five notes, so the vi chord costs nothing. Land D (3rd of B♭7) on the second half of every even bar and the loop sings.

B

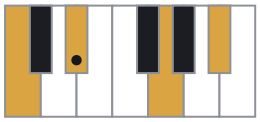
E♭, then G♭ for two bars, then home

E♭ major for bars 1–4. Bars 5–6: G♭ major pentatonic (= E♭ minor pentatonic): C♭ and G♭ are the slip. Bar 7: F7 wants A natural (F–7 wants A♭); bar 8 B♭7: D.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bars 7–8 as E♭6 | E♭6 with no turnaround · bridge bar 7 as F7 (the sheet) or F–7 (sessions) · bar 6 of the bridge as G♭Δ7.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



E♭6
E♭ G B♭ C



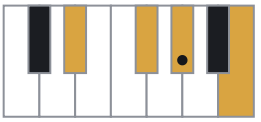
C–7
C E♭ G B♭



F–7
F A♭ C E♭



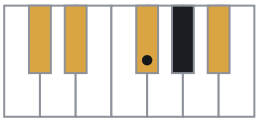
B♭7
B♭ D F A♭



A♭–7
A♭ B E♭ G♭



D♭7
D♭ F A♭ B

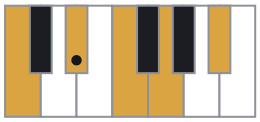


G♭6
G♭ B♭ D♭ E♭

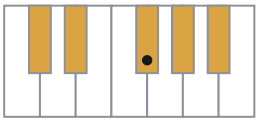


F7
F A C E♭

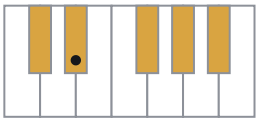
PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A, B · E♭ major pent
E♭ F G B♭ C



B bars 5–6 · G♭ major pent
G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭ E♭

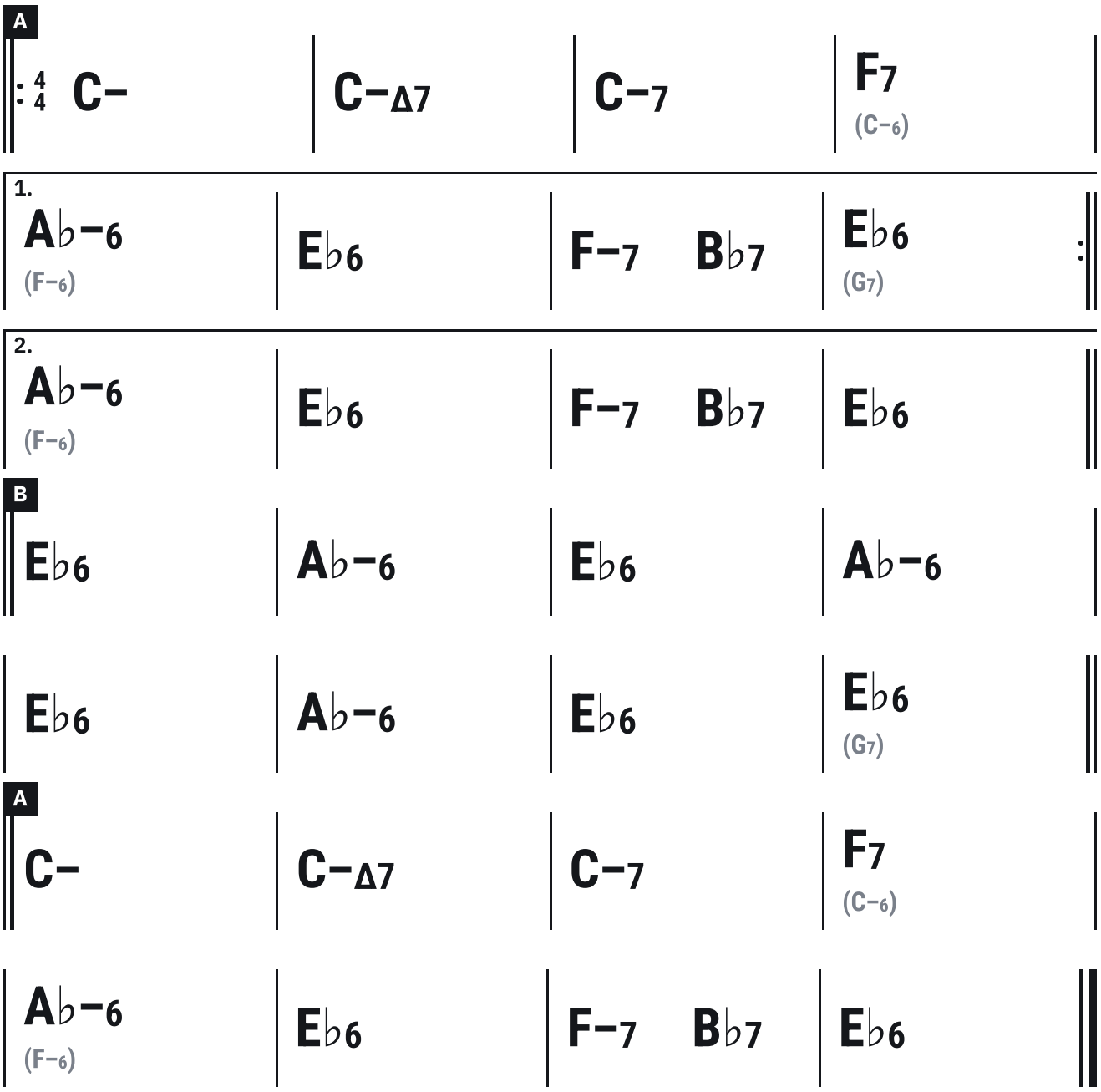


same notes as E♭ minor pent
E♭ G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭

(Medium Up Swing)

Blue Skies

Irving Berlin



Key **C– → E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1926**

Blue Skies · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Bars 1–4 are a line cliché: the inner voice walks C – B – B♭ – A under a held C– (C– | C–Δ7 | C–7 | C–6 or F7). Keep the melody still above it.
- Bar 5, A♭–6 (A♭ C♭ E♭ F) is the colour chord into E♭; the bridge alternates E♭6 and A♭–6, so pedal a B♭ in the left hand under the whole bridge and let the two chords rub.
- G7 at the end of A1 and of the bridge is optional: E♭ to C– (I → vi) works without it.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **C–** E♭ G **C–7** E♭ B♭ **F7** A E♭ **A♭–6** B F **E♭6** G C **F–7** A♭ E♭ **B♭7** D A♭

B **E♭6** G C **A♭–6** B F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C minor that is really vi of E♭

Play the cliché itself: C B B♭ A, one per bar, and build phrases around it. C dorian and C minor pentatonic over the C– bars, A natural on the F7. Bar 5, A♭–6: the colour is C♭ and F (E♭ minor pentatonic works). Bars 6–8: E♭ major home, E♭ blues scale welcome.

B

I ↔ iv in E♭: E♭ against A♭–6

E♭ major on the E♭ bars, E♭ minor pentatonic on the A♭–6 bars (A♭ C♭ E♭ F): the C♭ and G♭ are the tension. Pedal a B♭ in the left hand under the whole bridge and let the two chords rub.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bars 1–4 as the descending-bass original: C– | G7/B | E♭/B♭ | F7/A · bar 5 as F–6 or A♭7 · bridge iv as plain A♭6 in older charts · the iReal version ends the bridge Bø7 E7♭9 (in C), i.e. Dø7 G7♭9 here.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



C–
C E♭ G



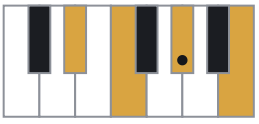
C–7
C E♭ G B♭



F7
F A C E♭



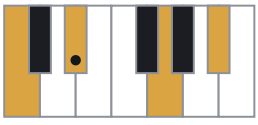
C–6
C E♭ G A



A♭–6
A♭ B E♭ F



F–6
F A♭ C D



E♭6
E♭ G B♭ C



F–7
F A♭ C E♭



B♭7
B♭ D F A♭

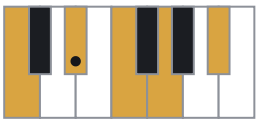


G7
G B D F

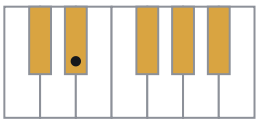
PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A bars 1–5 · C minor pent
C E♭ F G B♭



A bars 6–8, B · E♭ major pent
E♭ F G B♭ C



A♭–6 bars · E♭ minor pent
E♭ G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭

(Medium Swing)

Comes Love

Sam H. Stept (Lew Brown & Charles Tobias)



Key **A–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written **1939**

Comes Love · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Comp the title phrase (bars 7–8, Bø7 E7 | A–) as stabs with the horns; the vocal line needs the space.
- E7♭9 (G♯ B D F) is the chord: F and G♯ together is the sound of the tune. F°7 passing chords on the 'and' of 4 before each E7 for the vocal-sheet colour.
- Bridge: A7 (C♯) → D– is the one place the tune leaves A minor; voice A7 as A7♭9 into D–6.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**A–**	C E	**D–**	F A	**E7**	G♯ D	**Bø7**	D F A
B	**A7**	C♯ G	**D–**	F A	**E7**	G♯ D	**Bø7**	D F A

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A minor, harmonic minor on the E7s

A minor pentatonic at home; on E7 play G♯ (A harmonic minor, with F); Bø7 E7: F and G♯ together is the sound of the title phrase.

B

A7 → D–, then E7 home

A7 wants C♯; D minor pentatonic over the D– bars; E7 (G♯) and Bø7 E7 bring the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

F°7 passing chords on the 'and' of 4 before each E7 · bridge bars 5–6 as D– | D– · bar 2 as A– throughout for a modal reading.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



A–
A C E



D–
D F A



E7
E G♯ B D



F°7
F A♭ B D



Bø7
B D F A



A7
A C♯ E G

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · A minor pent
A C D E G



over E7 · A harmonic minor
A B C D E F G♯

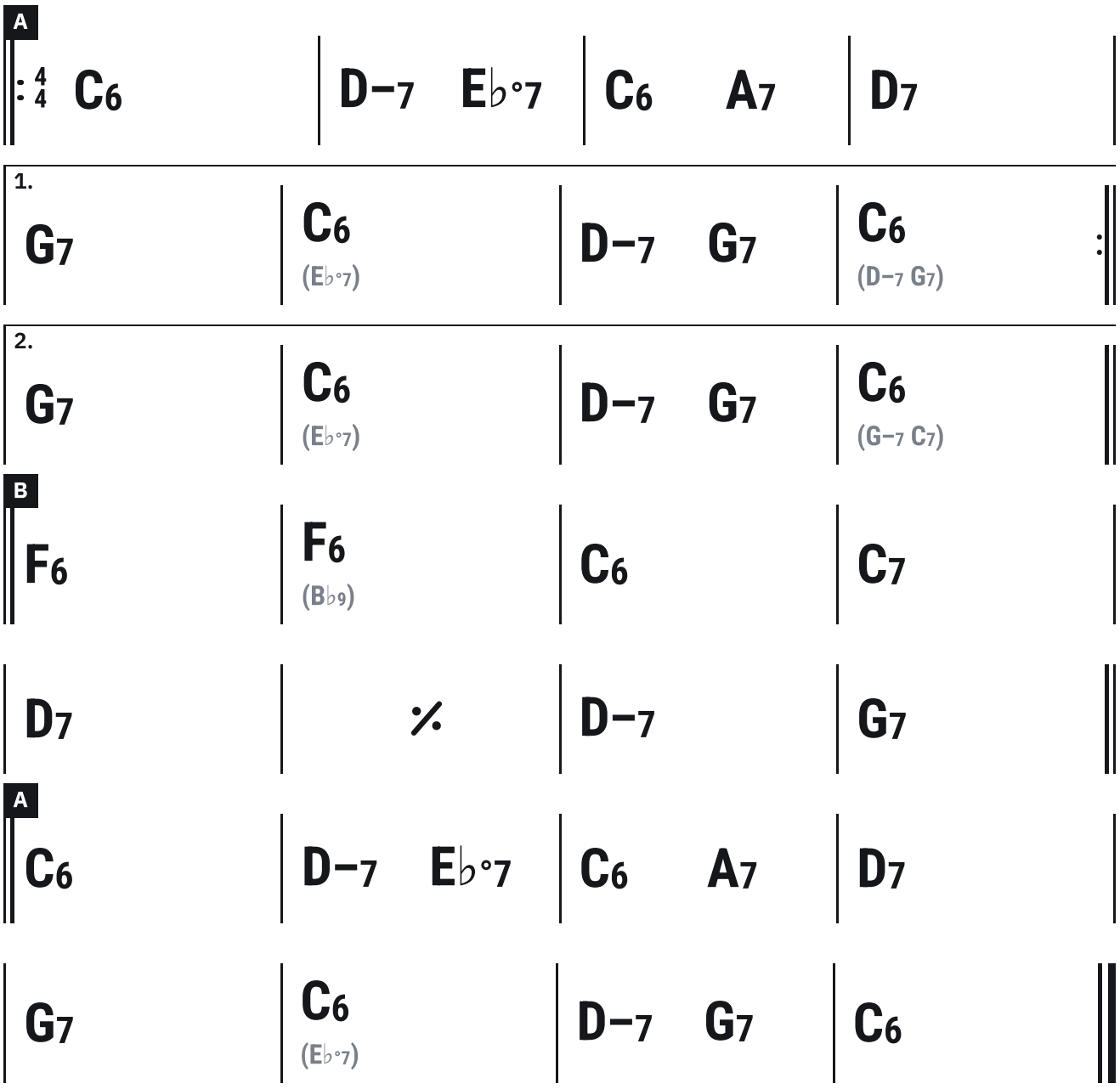


B · D minor pent
D F G A C

(Medium Swing)

Don't Get Around Much Anymore

Duke Ellington & Bob Russell



Key **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / slow swing** Dance tempo **130–180 bpm** Written **1940**

Don't Get Around Much Anymore · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Head in two, solos in four: this is the tune that shows what that contrast does for a dance floor.
- Bar 2: D–7 then E♭°7 (the colour); bar 3: C6 A7, then D7 → G7 → C: three dominants in a row, so comp them as a Charleston figure with the 3rds on top (C♯, F♯, F).
- Bridge: F6 with a B♭9 colour on bar 2 is enough until the D7; then D7 | D7 | D–7 | G7 home.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **C6** E A **D–7** F C **E♭°7** G♭ C **A7** C♯ G **D7** F♯ C **G7** B F

B **F6** A D **C6** E A **C7** E B♭ **D7** F♯ C **D–7** F C **G7** B F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C major with three dominants

C major pentatonic, bending in the one note each dominant wants: A7 → C♯, D7 → F♯, G7 → F. E♭°7 in bar 2 is the colour chord: E♭ against the C. Same trick as Sunny Side of the Street, same key.

B

F major, then C7 → D7 → D–7 G7

F major pentatonic for bars 1–3 (B♭9 adds E♭); C7 (B♭) into D7 (F♯) for two bars, then ii–V home.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as C♯°7 or F6 F♯°7 · bar 3 as E–7 E♭7 (bebop) · bridge bars 5–6 as A–7 D7 · Real-Book-style bridge: G–7 C7 | F6 | G–7 C7 | F6 | A–7 D7 | A–7 D7 | D–7 | G7.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



C6
C E G A



D–7
D F A C



E♭°7
E♭ G♭ A C



A7
A C♯ E G



D7
D F♯ A C



G7
G B D F



G–7
G B♭ D F



C7
C E G B♭



F6
F A C D



B♭9
B♭ C D F A♭

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · C major pent
C D E G A



B · F major pent
F G A C D

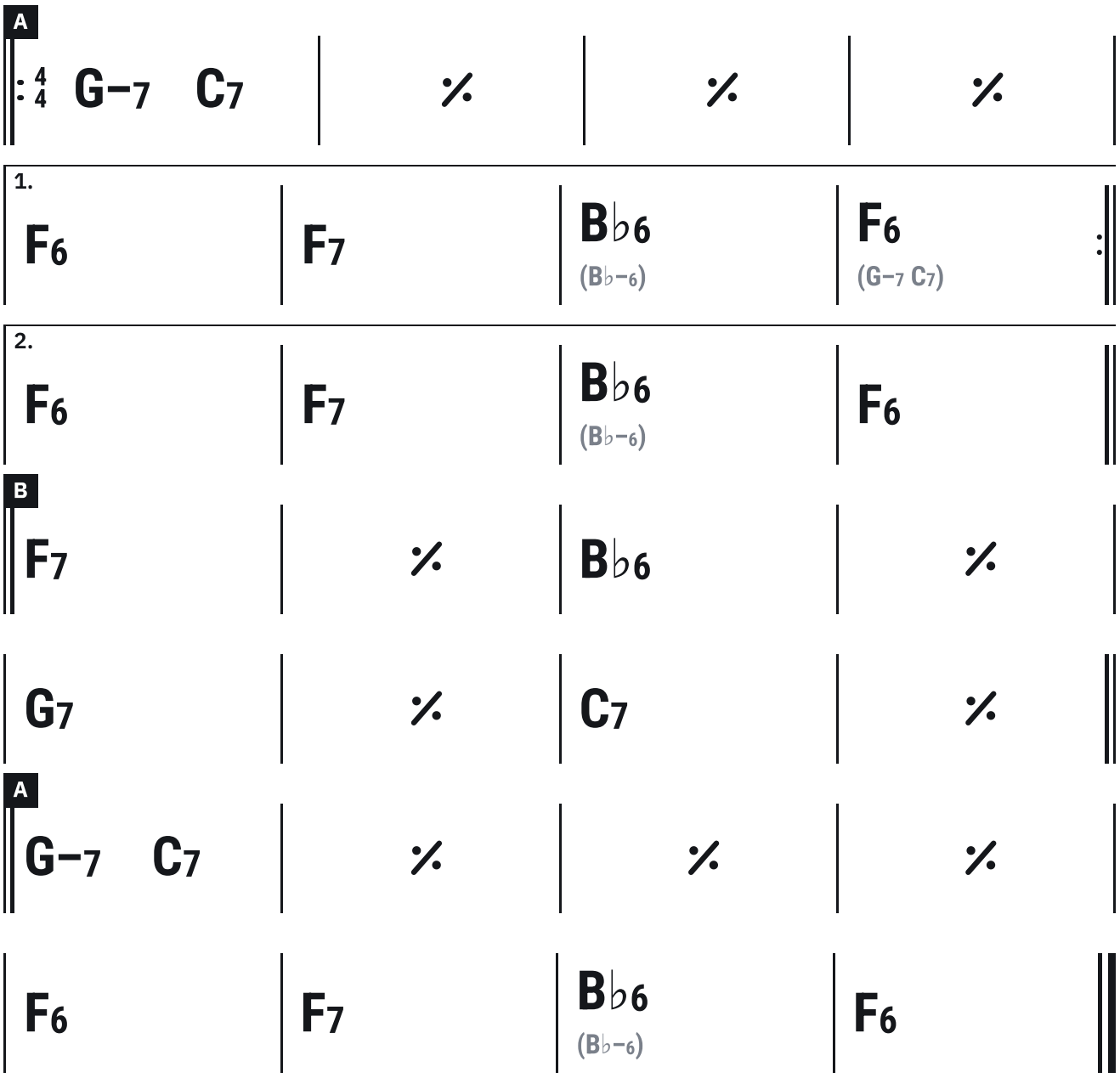


D7 bars · D major pent
D E F♯ A B

(Medium Swing)

Honeysuckle Rose

Fats Waller & Andy Razaf



Key **F** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1929**

Honeysuckle Rose · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Stride is period-correct: root or 5th on 1 and 3, chord on 2 and 4; with a bassist, keep only the 2-and-4 punches.
- Bars 1–4 are a G–7 C7 vamp: don't resolve early; the tune doesn't. Bars 5–8: F6 | F7 | B♭6 (B♭–6) | F6, with E♭ on the F7 and D♭ on the B♭–6 as the colours.
- The bridge walk-up (F, F♯°7, F/A into B♭; then G7 the same way into C7) is a stride cliché worth stealing for the comping.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	G–7	B♭ F	C7	E B♭	F6	A D	F7	A E♭	B♭6	D G
B	F7	A E♭	B♭6	D G	G7	B F	C7	E B♭		

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A **One long ii–V in F, then home**

Bars 1–4 are a vamp: C mixolydian (F major heard from the C7). Don't resolve early; the tune doesn't. Bars 5–8: F → F7 → B♭ → F. Play E♭ on the F7 in bar 6 and land on D (3rd of B♭); if the band plays B♭–6, D♭ is yours in bar 7.

B **The Honeysuckle bridge: I7 → IV → II7 → V7**

F7 (E♭) for two, B♭ major for two, G7 for two where B natural is the note, C7 (B♭) for two. Guide-tone line: A/E♭ → D/A♭ → B/F → E/B♭.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 7–8: B♭6 B♭–6 | F6 D7 (G–7 C7) · bridge bars 7–8 as G–7 | C7.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



G–7
G B♭ D F



C7
C E G B♭



F6
F A C D



F7
F A C E♭



B♭6
B♭ D F G



B♭–6
B♭ D♭ F G



G7
G B D F

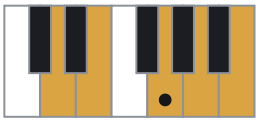
PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · F major pent
F G A C D



A bars 5–8 · F blues scale
F A♭ B♭ B C E♭

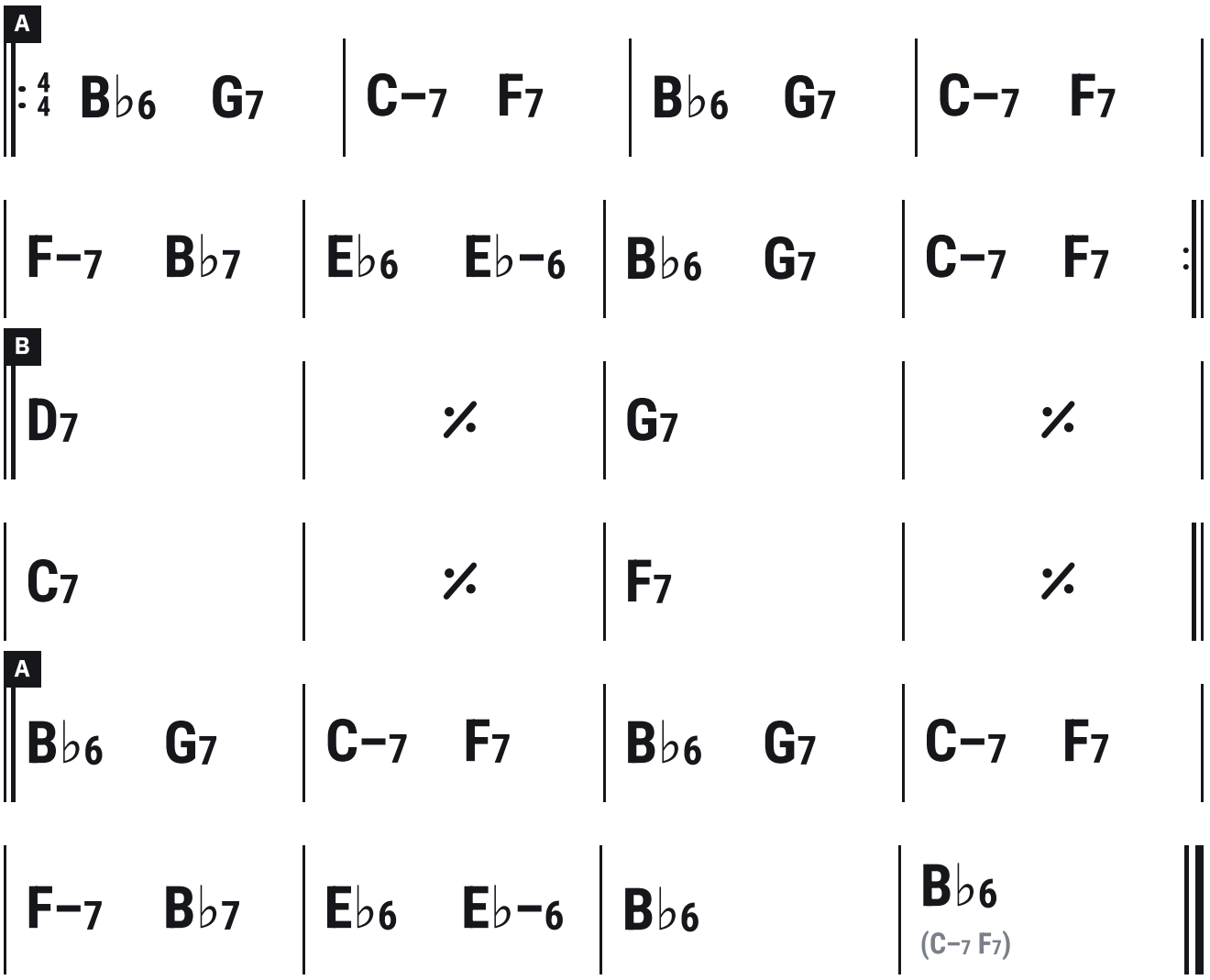


B · G7: G major pent
G A B D E

(Up Swing)

I Got Rhythm (Rhythm Changes)

George Gershwin



Key **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Charleston / fast lindy** Dance tempo **200–240 bpm** Written **1930**

I Got Rhythm · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Intro: the last four bars (B♭6 G7 | C–7 F7, twice) at tempo. Dancers hear the pulse before bar one.
- At Charleston tempo thin it out: bars 1–4 can be plain B♭6 over a walking bass; the turnarounds are decoration. Left hand: 3rd+7th shells below middle C, on 1 and 3 or on the 'and' of 2.
- Bars 5–6 (F–7 B♭7 | E♭6 E♭–6) are the only real event in the A: G → G♭ on top. Out chorus: the last A in block chords, then a Basie tag on the last two bars, three times.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	B♭6	D G	G7	B F	C–7	E♭ B♭	F7	A E♭	F–7	A♭ E♭	B♭7	D A♭	E♭6	G C	E♭–6	G♭ C
B	D7	F♯ C	G7	B F	C7	E B♭	F7	A E♭								

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

B♭ major, with B♭ blues on top

Bars 1–4: one key to the ear. B♭ major pentatonic plus the blue D♭, and the whole turnaround disappears under it. Bars 5–6 are the real event: B♭7 into E♭. Play A♭ (the ♭7) and land on G (3rd of E♭); then G♭ over E♭–6 going home. Guide tones through the turnaround: D → B (G7) → E♭ → A (F7).

B

Four dominants, two bars each, round the circle

D7 → G7 → C7 → F7. Mixolydian on each; the 3rds are the targets: F♯ B E A. Voice-lead the 3rd/7th pairs down by half step: F♯/C → B/F → E/B♭ → A/E♭. Lydian dominant (♯11) for colour: G♯ on D7, C♯ on G7.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as D–7 G7 · bar 6 as E♭6 E°7 · bebop A: B♭ B°7 | C–7 C♯°7 | D–7 D♭7 | C–7 F7.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



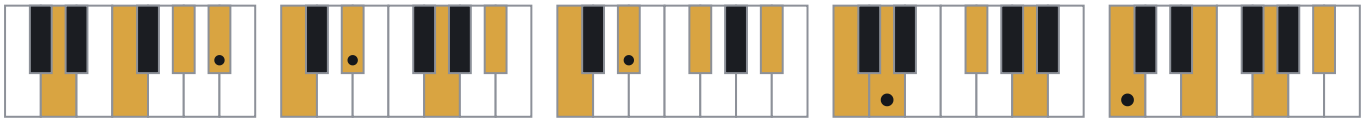
B♭6
B♭ D F G

G7
G B D F

C–7
C E♭ G B♭

F7
F A C E♭

F–7
F A♭ C E♭



B♭7
B♭ D F A♭

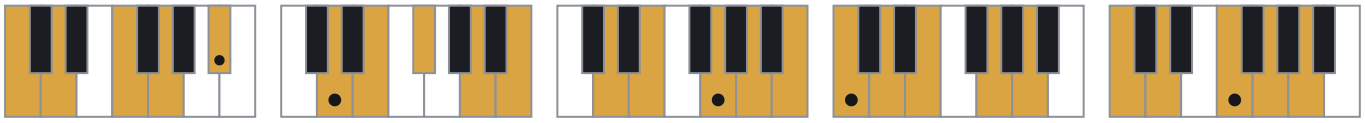
E♭6
E♭ G B♭ C

E♭–6
E♭ G♭ B♭ C

D7
D F♯ A C

C7
C E G B♭

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · B♭ major pent
B♭ C D F G

B · D7: D major pent
D E F♯ A B

B · G7: G major pent
G A B D E

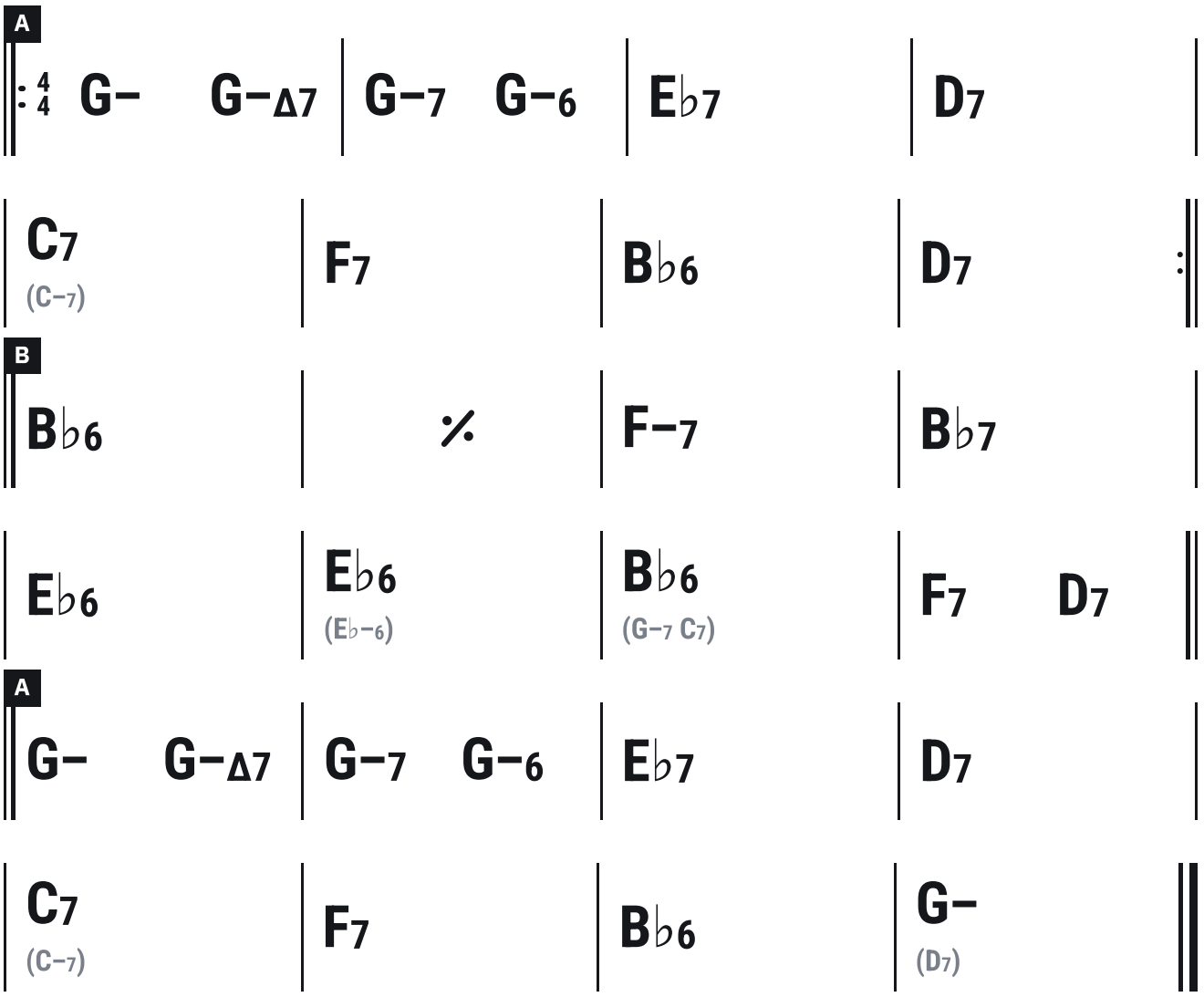
B · C7: C major pent
C D E G A

B · F7: F major pent
F G A C D

(Medium Swing)

It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing)

Duke Ellington & Irving Mills



Key **G– → B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1931**

It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing) · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Bars 1–2: play the line cliché in the left hand (G – F♯ – F – E) under G– and comp above it; E♭7 → D7 in bars 3–4 is the flamenco cadence, D♭ falling to C with F♯ on the D7.
- Bars 5–8 are the doo-wah bars: the stabs belong with the horns on the 'and' of 2 and 4 (C7 F7 | B♭6 | D7).
- The bridge is where the tune goes major: thin the comping there so the dancers feel the lift when the minor A returns.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	G–	B♭ D	G–7	B♭ F	G–6	B♭ E	E♭7	G D♭	D7	F♯ C	C7	E B♭	F7	A E♭	B♭6	D G			
B	B♭6	D G	F–7	A♭ E♭	B♭7	D A♭	E♭6	G C	F7	A E♭	D7	F♯ C							

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G minor, then four bars of B♭ major

Bars 1–2: G minor pentatonic over the line cliché G–F♯–F–E (play the cliché in the left hand, solo on top). E♭7 → D7: D♭ then F♯, the flamenco cadence. Bars 5–8: B♭ major pentatonic; E natural on C7, A on F7, and D7's F♯ to pull you home.

B

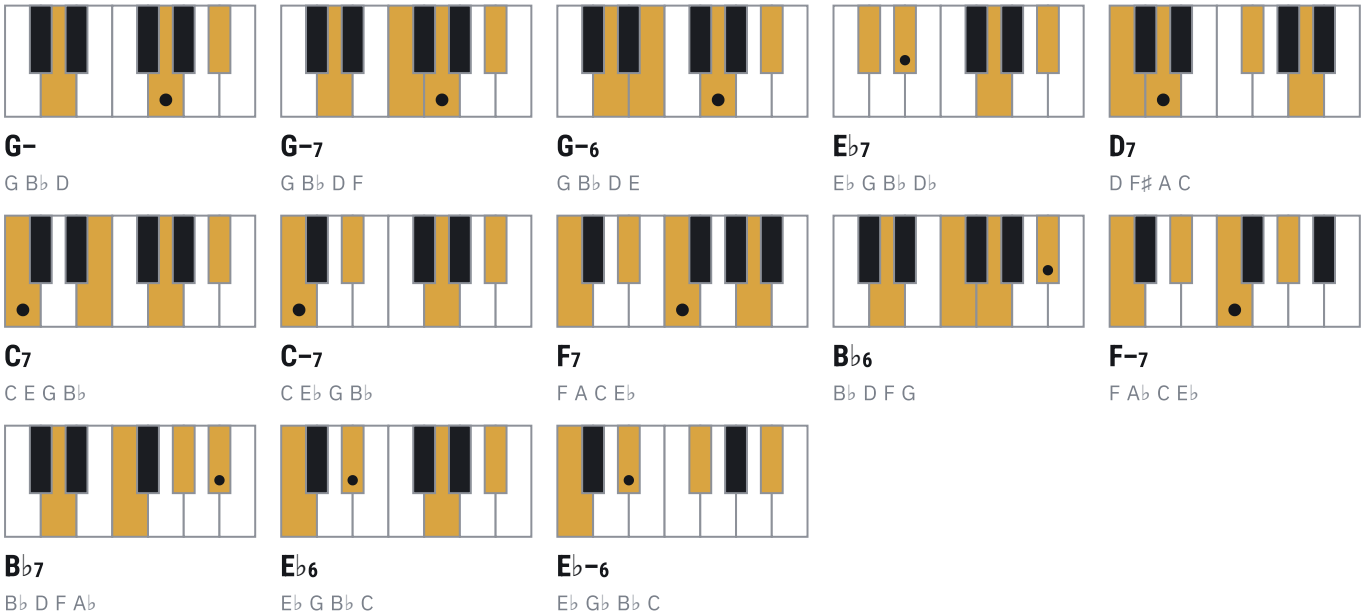
B♭ major: I → IV → home

B♭ major pentatonic for four bars (F–7 B♭7 is just a push into E♭: play A♭). E♭ major, then E♭–6 if the band plays it (G♭). F7 D7 at the end: A → F♯.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 1–2 as plain G– · doo-wah bars as C–7 | F7 | B♭6 | D7♯5, or with C♯°7 in bar 6 (iReal first ending) · bridge bars 3–4 as B♭7 | B♭7.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



G–
G B♭ D

G–7
G B♭ D F

G–6
G B♭ D E

E♭7
E♭ G B♭ D♭

D7
D F♯ A C

C7
C E G B♭

C–7
C E♭ G B♭

F7
F A C E♭

B♭6
B♭ D F G

F–7
F A♭ C E♭

B♭7
B♭ D F A♭

E♭6
E♭ G B♭ C

E♭–6
E♭ G♭ B♭ C

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A bars 1–4 · G minor pent
G B♭ C D F

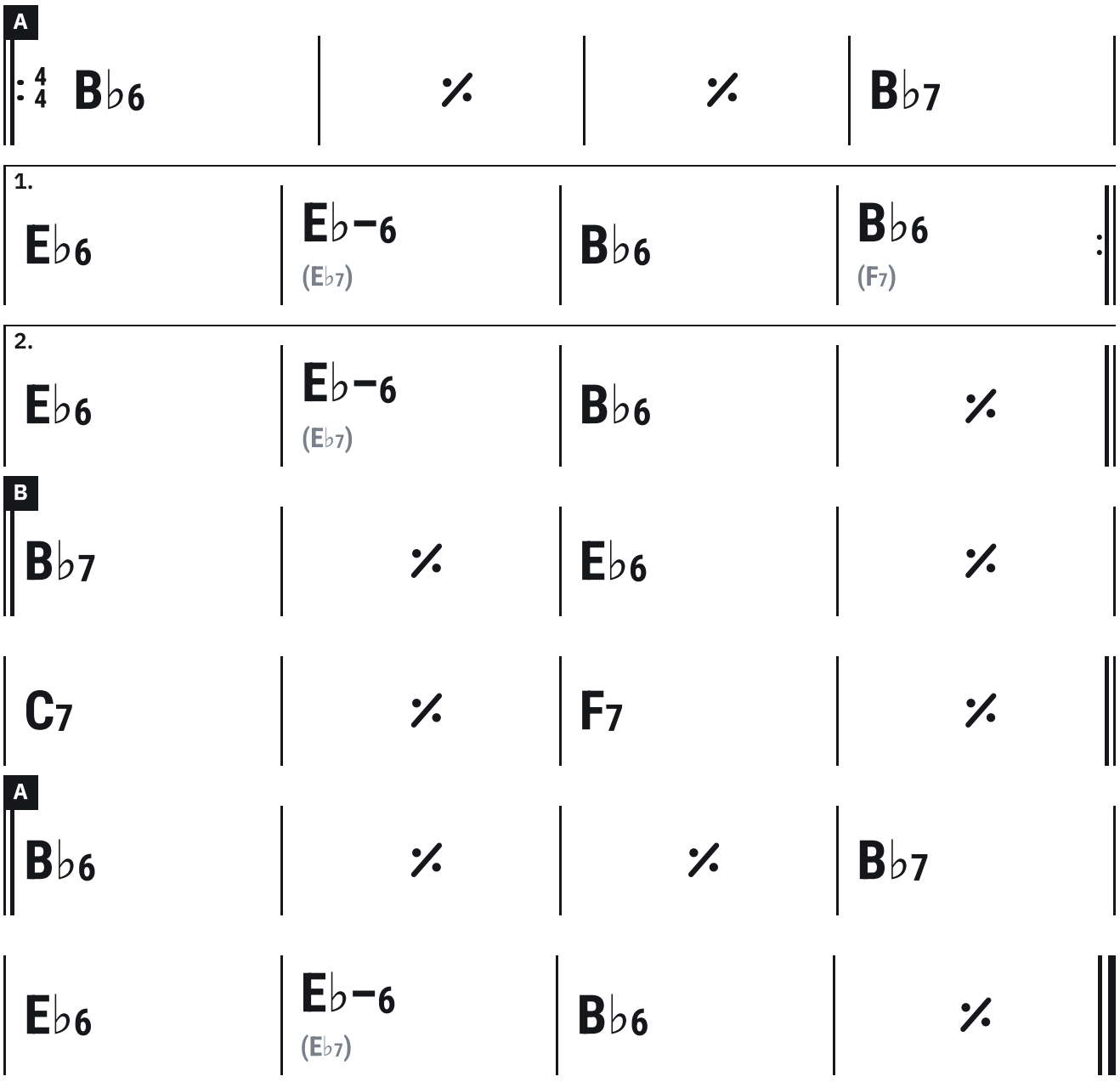
A bars 5–8, B · B♭ major pent
B♭ C D F G

B bars 5–6 · E♭ major pent
E♭ F G B♭ C

(Up Swing)

Jumpin' at the Woodside

Count Basie (Eddie Durham)



Key **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Fast lindy** Dance tempo **200–250 bpm** Written **1938**

Jumpin' at the Woodside · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- At 240 you play two chords: B♭ and E♭. Basie's comping on the record is a pair of notes every other bar; count the riffs, not the changes.
- Intro: Basie's four-bar piano figure off the record, or a straight four-bar vamp on B♭6.
- The clarinet-and-brass riff choruses at the end are the dancers' favourite moment: drop out and let them hear it.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**B♭6** D G	**B♭7** D A♭	**E♭6** G C	**E♭−6** G♭ C
B	**B♭7** D A♭	**E♭6** G C	**C7** E B♭	**F7** A E♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

B♭ major pentatonic, blues on top

The riff is B♭ major pentatonic; so is the solo. B♭7 in bar 4: A♭ . E♭ then E♭−6 in bars 5–6: G then G♭ . Then home. At this tempo, two ideas per chorus is plenty.

B

The Honeysuckle bridge in B♭

B♭7 (A♭) for two, E♭ for two, C7 (E natural) for two, F7 (A) for two. Half notes and quarter notes win at 240.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 as E♭7 | E♭7 · bar 8 F7 turnaround · some bands play a rhythm bridge (D7 G7 C7 F7) instead; ask before the count-off.

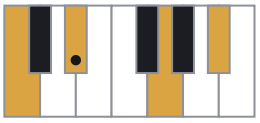
EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



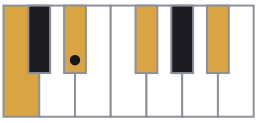
B♭6
B♭ D F G



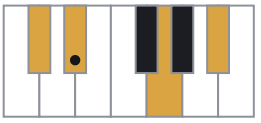
B♭7
B♭ D F A♭



E♭6
E♭ G B♭ C



E♭−6
E♭ G♭ B♭ C



E♭7
E♭ G B♭ D♭



F7
F A C E♭



C7
C E G B♭

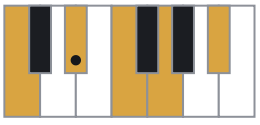
PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · B♭ major pent
B♭ C D F G



A · B♭ blues scale
B♭ D♭ E♭ E F A♭

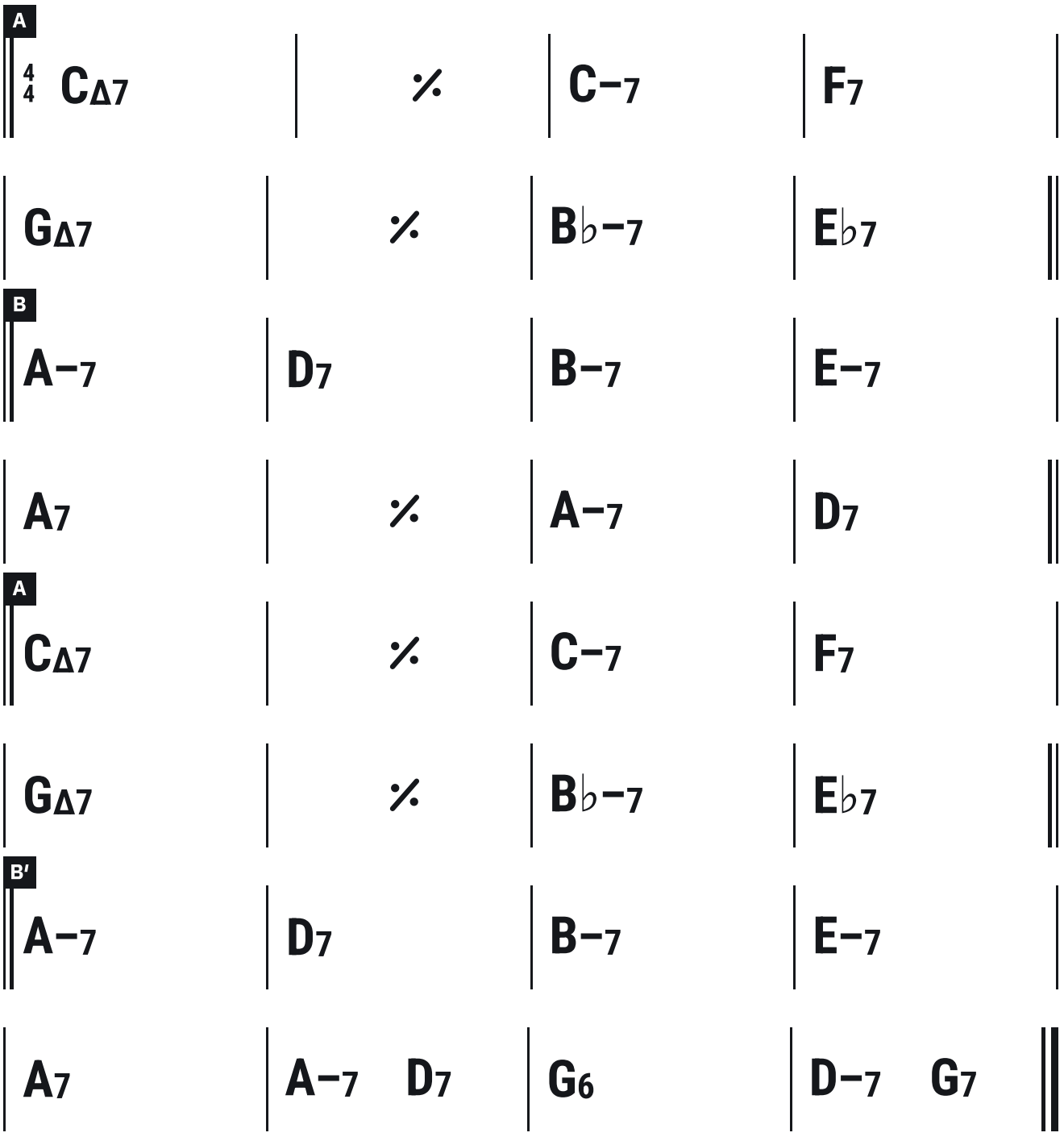


Bars 5–6, B · E♭ major pent
E♭ F G B♭ C

(Up Swing)

Just Friends

John Klenner & Sam M. Lewis



Key **G** Form **A B A B′ · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **170–220 bpm** Written **1931**

Just Friends · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Because the tune starts on IV (CΔ7), the intro is the last four bars (A–7 D7 | G6 | D–7 G7), not a I–VI–II–V vamp.
- Two backdoor ii–Vs do the work: C–7 F7 into G, B♭–7 E♭7 into A–7. Comp lightly on them so the horn's ♭7 is heard; voice F7 as F9 (A E♭ G) and E♭7 as E♭9.
- At 200 it's a Balboa tune: shells in the left hand, Charleston rhythm, and the B′ ending (A–7 D7 | G6 | D–7 G7) as the tag.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	CΔ7	E B	C–7	E♭ B♭	F7	A E♭	GΔ7	B F♯	B♭–7	D♭ A♭	E♭7	G D♭			
B	A–7	C G	D7	F♯ C	B–7	D A	E–7	G D	A7	C♯ G					
B′	A–7	C G	D7	F♯ C	B–7	D A	E–7	G D	A7	C♯ G	G6	B E	D–7	F C	G7	B F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A — **IV, backdoor, I, backdoor**

CΔ7: G major (C lydian, F♯). C–7 F7: B♭ major pentatonic (E♭ and B♭ are the backdoor notes). GΔ7: home. B♭–7 E♭7: A♭ major pentatonic (D♭, A♭) sliding into A–7.

B — **G major with one II7**

A–7 D7 and B–7 E–7 are diatonic; A7 is the II7 colour: C♯. B′: A–7 D7 G6 then D–7 G7 to set up the C chord at the top.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 of the first A as F7 | F7 (Chet's sub for GΔ7) · B′ bar 8 as D7 D♭7 the first time · bar 7–8 of the B as A–7 | D7 or A–7 D7 | G6.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



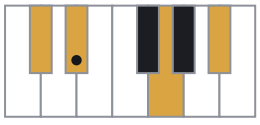
CΔ7 — C E G B

C–7 — C E♭ G B♭

F7 — F A C E♭

GΔ7 — G B D F♯

B♭–7 — B♭ D♭ F A♭



E♭7 — E♭ G B♭ D♭



A–7 — A C E G



D7 — D F♯ A C



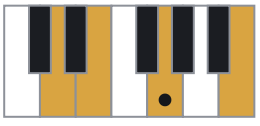
B–7 — B D F♯ A



E–7 — E G B D



A7 — A C♯ E G



G6 — G B D E

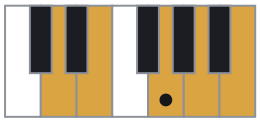


D–7 — D F A C



G7 — G B D F

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A, B · G major pent — G A B D E



C–7 F7 · B♭ major pent — B♭ C D F G



B♭–7 E♭7 · A♭ major pent — A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

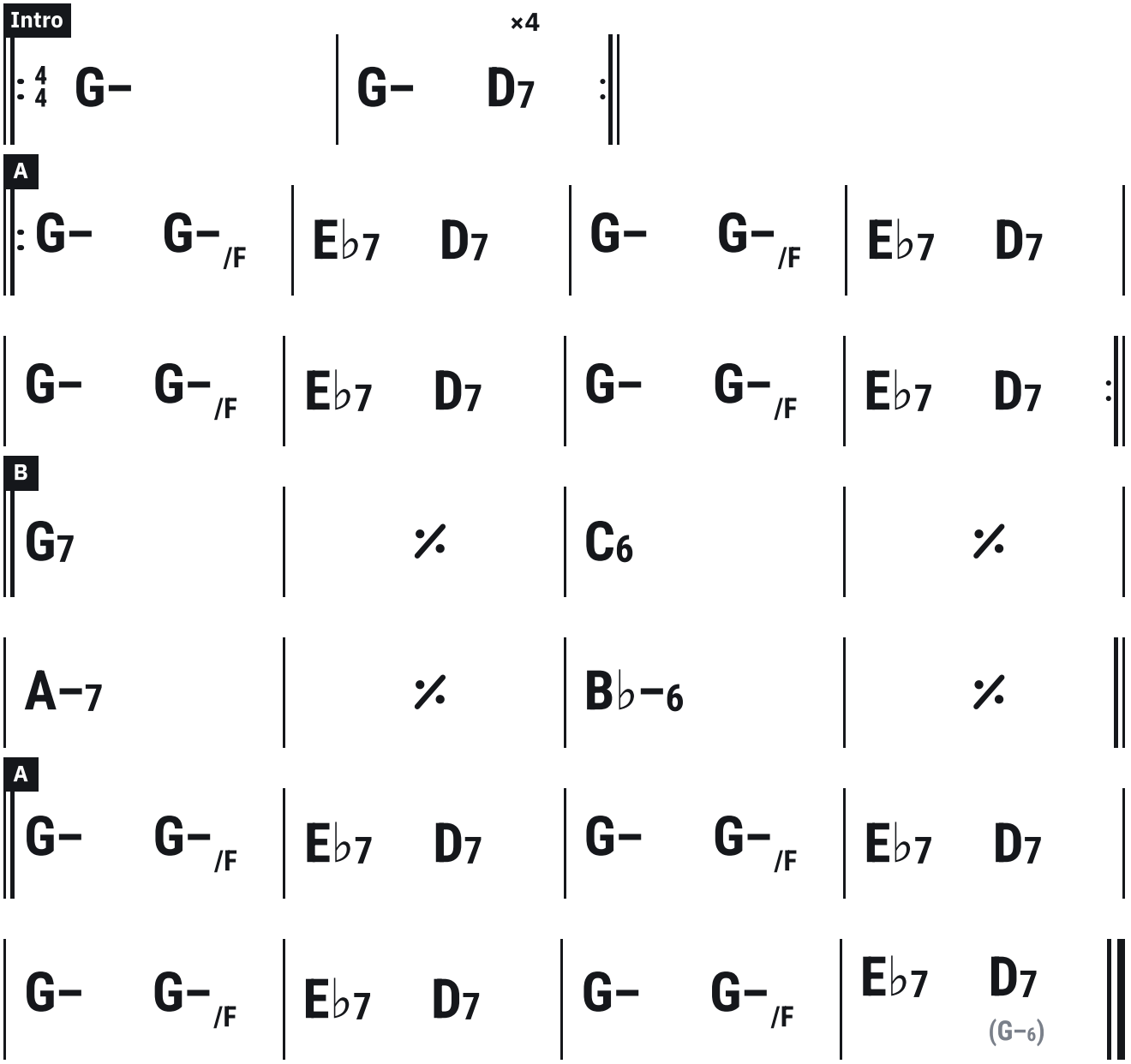


A7 · A major pent — A B C♯ E F♯

(Medium Up Swing)

Kansas City Stride

Giorgio Cuscito (Tiber River Dixieland)



Key **G–** Form **AABA · 32 + 8-bar intro** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **2011**

Kansas City Stride · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Intro the Basie way: piano alone on the vamp the first time, bass and drums join on the second, horns stack a riff on the third and fourth; the D7 on beats 3–4 of the second bar is a kick.
- Comp the A as Lester's Bounce bars 1–4: G–6 on 1, G–/F on 3, E♭7 D7 as two beats each, shells only at tempo.
- Bridge: G7 → C6 → A–7 → B♭–6, two bars each; voice B♭–6 as E♭9 without the root (D♭ F G B♭) so it slides into G–. Out: tag the last two bars three times, end on G–6 with the E on top.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

In	**G–**	B♭ D	**D7**	F♯ C					
A	**G–**	B♭ D	**G–/F**	B♭ D	**E♭7**	G D♭	**D7**	F♯ C	
B	**G7**	B F	**C6**	E A	**A–7**	C G	**B♭–6**	D♭ G	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

The Lester's Bounce riff: G– with an E♭7 D7 slide every second bar

G minor pentatonic and the G blues scale over the whole eight; the riff is the melody. The E♭7 D7 is a ♭VI7 → V7 slide: D♭ (7th of E♭7) down to C (7th of D7), and F♯ on the D7 (G harmonic minor). Anything you play on Lester's Bounce bars 1–4 works here, four times.

B

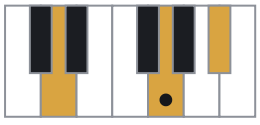
Bright for six bars, dark for two: G7 → C → A–7 → B♭–

C major pentatonic covers G7, C6 and A–7 in one go, with B natural as the colour note against the A's B♭ and F on the G7. Then B♭ minor pentatonic for the B♭–6 bars (D♭ and A♭ are the notes that say minor), and you are a half step above home: slide down into G minor pent on bar 25.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Intro one chord a bar (16 bars) · A bars 7–8 as G– | D7 to break the loop · bridge with C–6 and Aø7 for the all-minor version (that is the Lester's Bounce bridge) · B♭–6 played as E♭9 · last bar G–6.

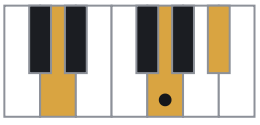
EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



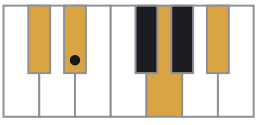
G–
G B♭ D



D7
D F♯ A C



G–/F
G B♭ D



E♭7
E♭ G B♭ D♭



G7
G B D F



C6
C E G A



A–7
A C E G

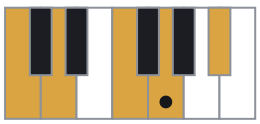


B♭–6
B♭ D♭ F G



G–6
G B♭ D E

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · G minor pent
G B♭ C D F



A · G blues scale
G B♭ C D♭ D F



B · C major pent (G7, C, A–7)
C D E G A

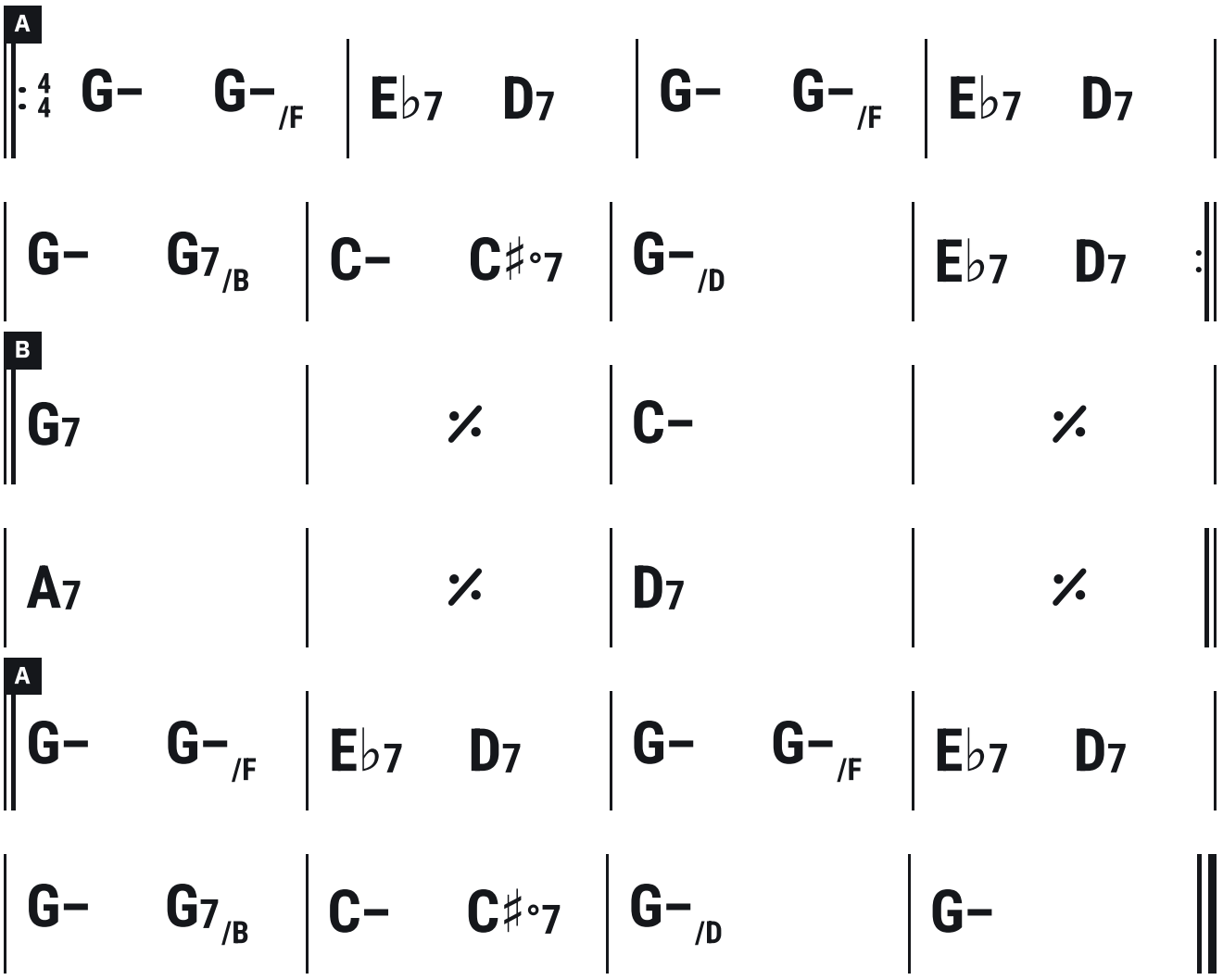


B · B♭ minor pent (B♭–)
B♭ D♭ E♭ F A♭

(Medium Swing)

Lester's Bounce

Your band's chart (Bob Wilber / Antti Sarpila recording)



Key **G–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written

Lester's Bounce · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- The score writes the riff into the piano left hand under the horns: play it, it is the arrangement (G – F – E♭ – D walking, then G – B – C – C♯ – D in bars 5–7).
- Comp in two on the head, four for solos; 140 is the Lazy-lindy tempo on your list.
- Bridge: G7 → C– → A7 → D7 (the Honeysuckle bridge in minor), two bars each; G7♭9 for the darker sound.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **G–** B♭ D **G–/F** B♭ D **E♭7** G D♭ **D7** F♯ C **G7/B** B F **C–** E♭ G **C♯°7** E B♭ **G–/D** B♭ D

B **G7** B F **C–** E♭ G **A7** C♯ G **D7** F♯ C

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G minor riff, chromatic bass in bars 5–7

G minor pentatonic and blues scale over bars 1–4; the bass line G – F – E♭ – D is the hook. Bars 5–7: G7/B (B natural) → C– → C♯°7 (C♯) → G–/D: play the bass line's climb G B C C♯ D in your line and the chords take care of themselves. E♭7 D7 at the end: G on the E♭7, F♯ on the D7.

B

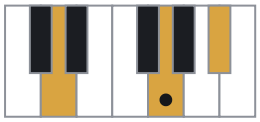
Honeysuckle bridge in minor: G7 → C– → A7 → D7

G7 (B , F) for two, C minor pentatonic for two, A7 (C♯) for two, D7 (F♯) for two. Same shape as the Honeysuckle Rose bridge with the IV turned minor.

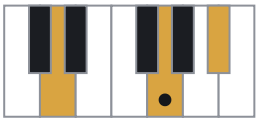
VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Your chart is the source. Bar 6 C♯°7 can be played as A7/C♯; the bridge G7 as G7♭9 for the darker sound.

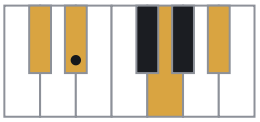
EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



G–
G B♭ D



G–/F
G B♭ D



E♭7
E♭ G B♭ D♭



D7
D F♯ A C



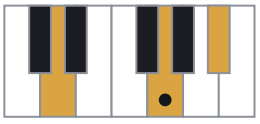
G7/B
G B D F



C–
C E♭ G



C♯°7
C♯ E G B♭



G–/D
G B♭ D



G7
G B D F



A7
A C♯ E G

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · G minor pent
G B♭ C D F



A · G blues scale
G B♭ C D♭ D F



B bars 3–4 · C minor pent
C E♭ F G B♭



B · A7: A major pent
A B C♯ E F♯

(Medium Swing)

Lullaby of Birdland

George Shearing



Key **F− / A♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **150–200 bpm** Written **1952**

Lullaby of Birdland · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- The Shearing sound: locked-hands block chords, melody on top and doubled an octave below; try it on the head, then open up for the solos.
- Two chords a bar means rootless shapes moving by step: F–6 Dø7 | Gø7 C7 | F–7 D♭Δ7 | B♭–7 E♭7; at Balboa tempo comp roots and 3rds only.
- Bridge: two iii–VI–ii–V–I chains in A♭ (Cø7 F7♭9 | B♭–7 | E♭7♭9 | A♭Δ7) with C7♭9 at the end to drop back to F–: voice the ♭9s (G♭ on F7, F♭ on E♭7, D♭ on C7).

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **F–6** A♭ D · **Dø7** F A♭ C · **Gø7** B♭ D♭ F · **C7** E B♭ · **F–7** A♭ E♭ · **D♭Δ7** F C · **B♭–7** D♭ A♭ · **E♭7** G D♭ · **C–7** E♭ B♭ · **A♭Δ7** C G · **D♭9** F B

B **Cø7** E♭ G♭ B♭ · **F7♭9** G♭ A E♭ · **B♭–7** D♭ A♭ · **E♭7♭9** E G D♭ · **A♭Δ7** C G · **C7♭9** D♭ E B♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F minor for two bars, A♭ major for the rest

F harmonic minor over Dø7–Gø7–C7 (E natural is the note). From bar 3 think A♭ major pentatonic: B♭–7 E♭7 A♭ and C–7 F–7 B♭–7 E♭7 are all one scale. D♭9 in bar 7: C♭ . Gø7 C7 at the end: D♭ then E .

B

A♭ major, iii–VI–ii–V–I twice

A♭ major pentatonic for the whole bridge; on each F7♭9 play A natural and G♭ , on E♭7♭9 play G and F♭ . The last bar's C7♭9 (E , D♭) is the door back to F minor.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as G7♭9 C7♭9 · bars 3–4 as F–7 B♭–7 | E♭7 A♭Δ7 (Real-Book shape) · bridge bars 1–2 as A♭Δ7 | A♭Δ7 in older charts.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



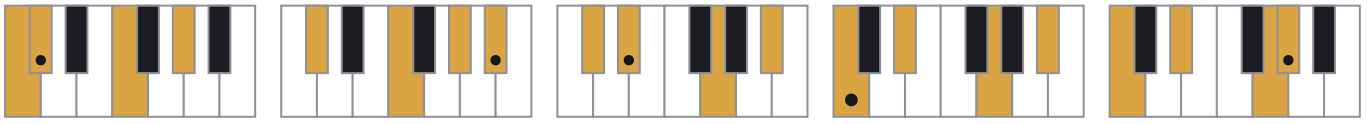
F–6
F A♭ C D

Dø7
D F A♭ C

Gø7
G B♭ D♭ F

C7
C E G B♭

F–7
F A♭ C E♭



D♭Δ7
D♭ F A♭ C

B♭–7
B♭ D♭ F A♭

E♭7
E♭ G B♭ D♭

C–7
C E♭ G B♭

A♭Δ7
A♭ C E♭ G



D♭9
D♭ E♭ F A♭ B

Cø7
C E♭ G♭ B♭

F7♭9
F G♭ A C E♭

E♭7♭9
E♭ E G B♭ D♭

C7♭9
C D♭ E G B♭

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A bars 1–2 · F harmonic minor
F G A♭ B♭ C D♭ E
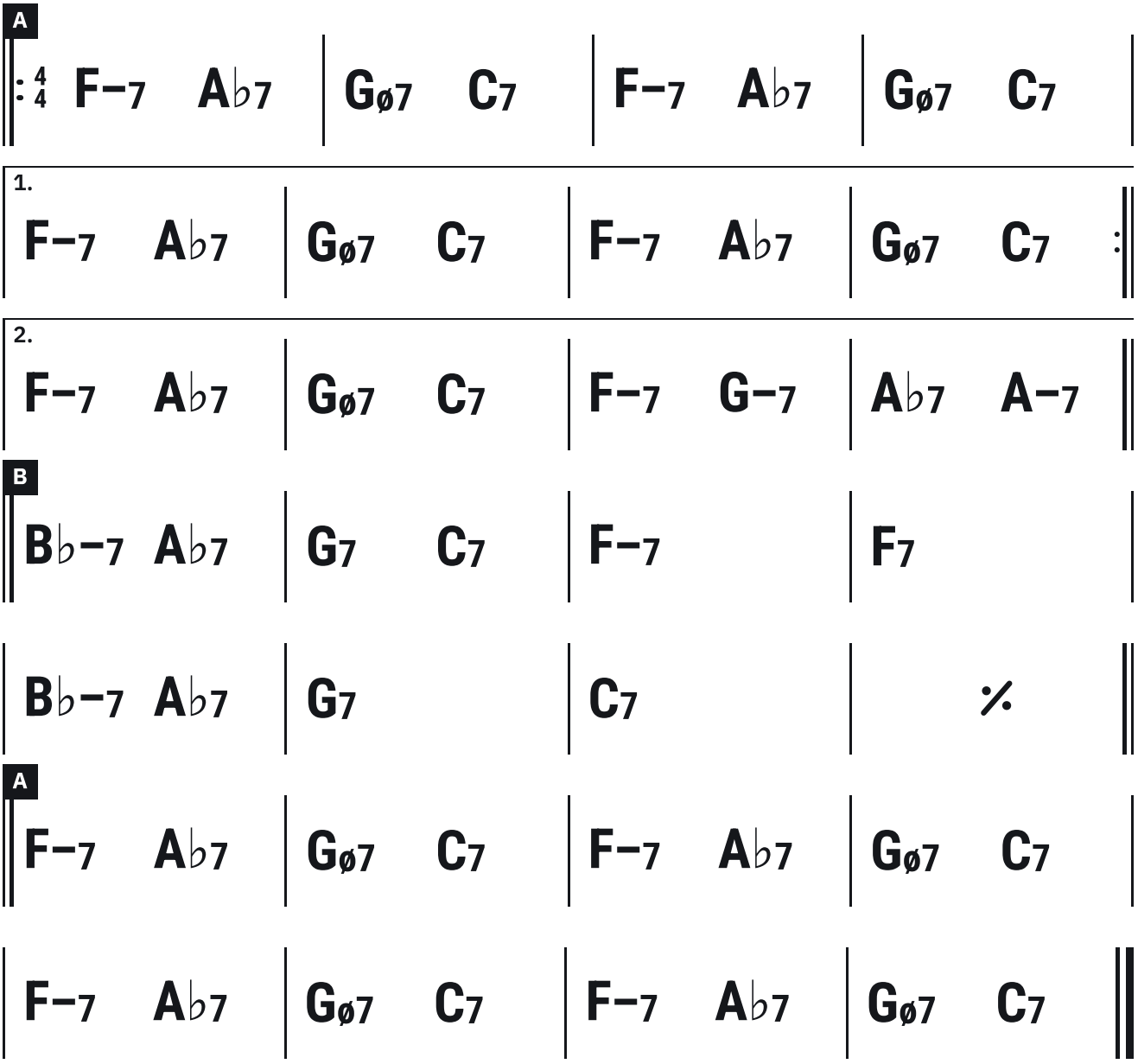
A, B · A♭ major pent
A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

over F–6 · F minor pent
F A♭ B♭ C E♭

(Slow Shuffle)

Moanin'

Bobby Timmons



Key **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Slow lindy / blues shuffle** Dance tempo **100–125 bpm** Written **1958**

Moanin' · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- You play the call (bars 1, 3, 5 over F–), the band answers (bars 2, 4, 6: the gospel 'amen', B♭/F → F with the A natural): block chords, Timmons style, melody on top.
- The answer chord is major against your minor call; that clash is the point, don't 'fix' it to F–.
- Solo changes: F–7 A♭7 | Gø7 C7 every two bars; the second ending walks up F– G– A♭ A– into the B♭– 7 of the bridge. Blakey's record is a shuffle at about 110: don't rush it.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**A♭7**	C G♭	**Gø7**	B♭ D♭ F	**C7**	E B♭	**G–7**	B♭ F	**A–7**	C G
B	**B♭–7**	D♭ A♭	**A♭7**	C G♭	**G7**	B F	**C7**	E B♭	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**F7**	A E♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F minor blues, chromatic dominants underneath

F minor blues scale and F dorian over everything; the A♭7 – G7 – C7 chain is just a bass line under the blues scale. Target **E** natural (3rd of C7) at the end of each two-bar unit, then slide back to **A♭** . Gospel grace notes: G into A♭, B into C.

B

B♭–7 → A♭7 → G7 → C7, then V

Descending bass B♭ – A♭ – G, then C7. Lean on 3rds: **D♭** **C** **B** **E** . F7 in bar 4 is V of B♭–: **A** natural and E♭. Second half opens out: two whole bars of C7, so say something and leave space.

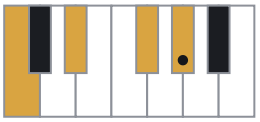
VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Some charts keep the solo A as plain F–7 for eight bars · answer sometimes written B♭ | F7 · bridge bar 4 as F7♭9.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



F–7
F A♭ C E♭



A♭7
A♭ C E♭ G♭



Gø7
G B♭ D♭ F



C7
C E G B♭



G–7
G B♭ D F



A–7
A C E G



B♭–7
B♭ D♭ F A♭



G7
G B D F



F7
F A C E♭

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · F minor pent
F A♭ B♭ C E♭



A · F blues scale
F A♭ B♭ B C E♭

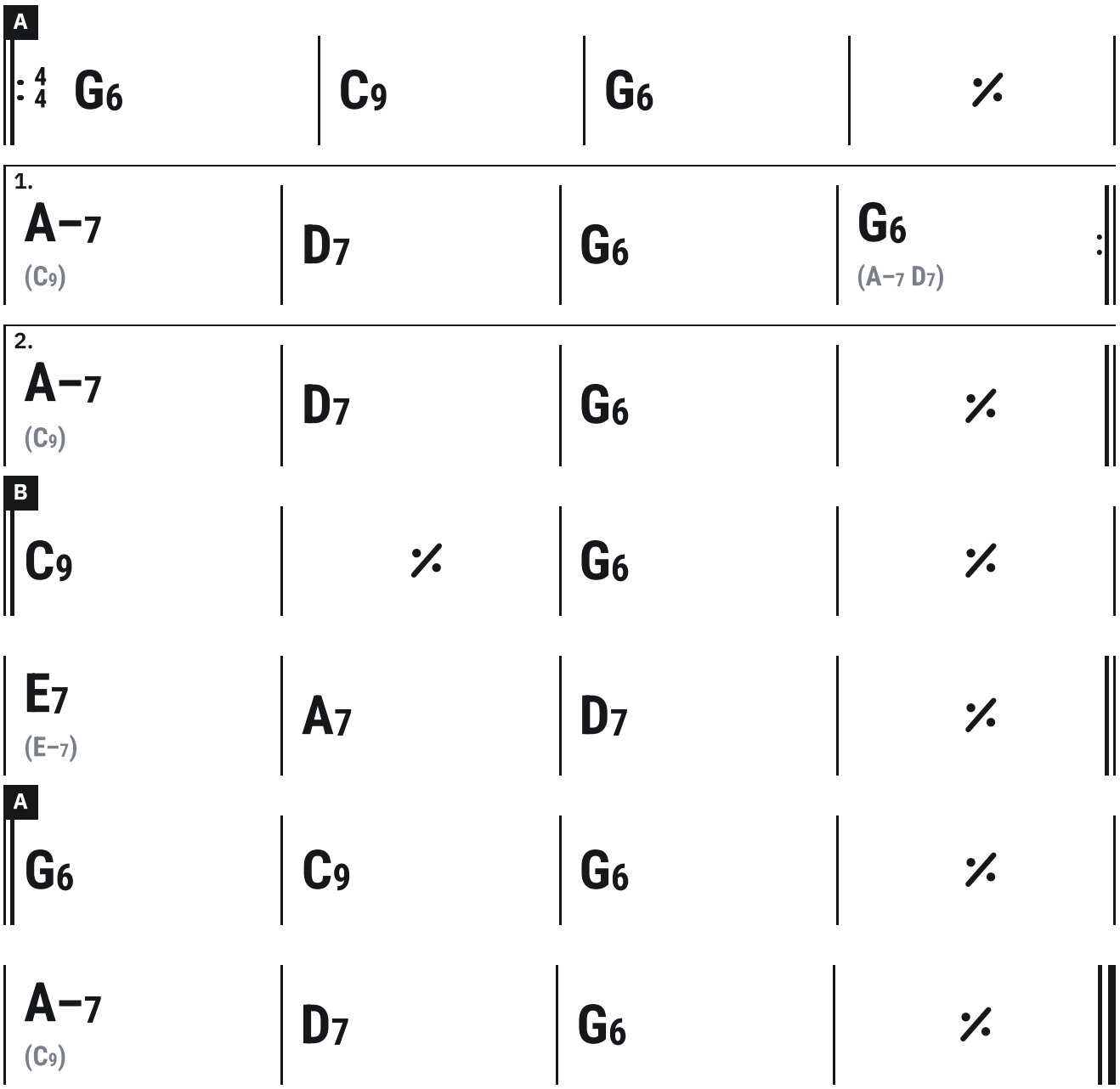


B · B♭ minor pent
B♭ D♭ E♭ F A♭

(Medium Swing)

Oh, Lady Be Good

George & Ira Gershwin



Key **G** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1924**

Oh, Lady Be Good · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Four bars of G with a 'fat dominant IV' (C9) in bar 2: Basie comps C6 under it while the horns play C9; either is right. Keep it light: a riff-and-blues tune, not a chord tune.
- Bars 5–6 A–7 D7 (F rising to F♯ on top) and home; the bridge C9 | C9 | G6 | G6 | E7 | A7 | D7 | D7 is three sharps in a row: G♯ C♯ F♯ on the downbeats.
- Lester Young's 1936 record is the solo bible; Ella's 1947 scat version is how a singer rides it.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**G6** B E	**C9** E B♭	**A–7** C G	**D7** F♯ C
B	**C9** E B♭	**G6** B E	**E7** G♯ D	**A7** C♯ G	**D7** F♯ C

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G major, four bars, then a ii–V

G major pentatonic plus the blues scale; the C9's B♭ against the band's B is the blues in bar 2. Bars 5–6, A–7 D7: F rising to F♯.

B

IV, I, then VI7 → II7 → V7

C major for two bars (C9: B♭), G for two, then the chain: E7 wants G♯, A7 wants C♯, D7 wants F♯. Play those three notes on the downbeats and you've played the bridge.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 5 as A7 or C9 · bridge bars 1–2 as G7 | G7 (Honeysuckle shape) · bar 8 of A2 as D7 into the bridge.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



G6
G B D E

C9
C D E G B♭

A–7
A C E G

D7
D F♯ A C

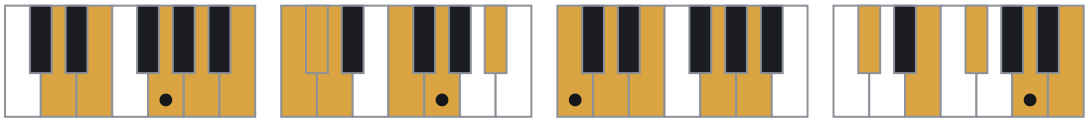
E7
E G♯ B D



E–7
E G B D

A7
A C♯ E G

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · G major pent
G A B D E

A · G blues scale
G B♭ C D♭ D F

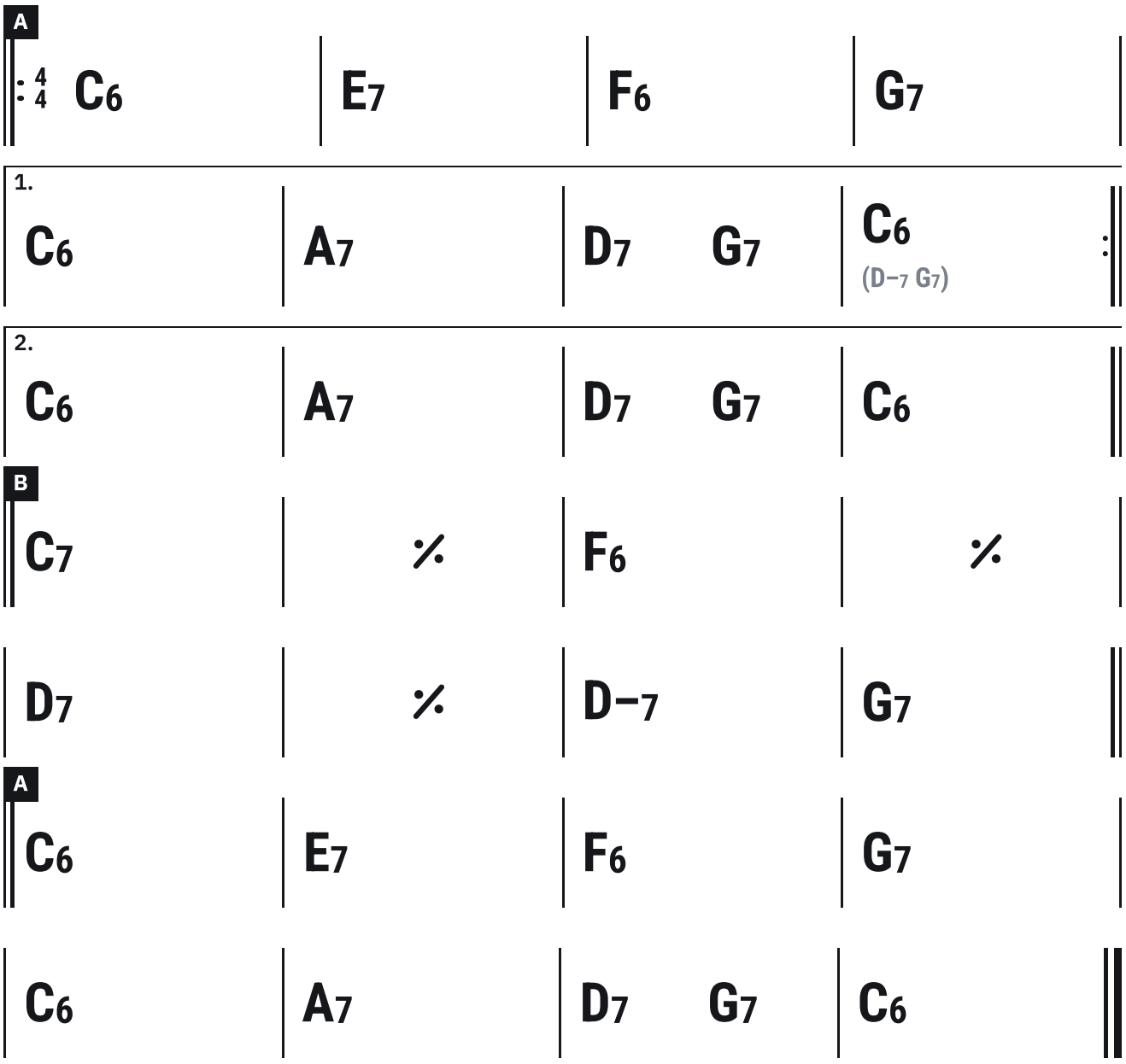
B bars 1–2 · C major pent
C D E G A

B · A7: A major pent
A B C♯ E F♯

(Medium Swing)

On the Sunny Side of the Street

Jimmy McHugh & Dorothy Fields



Key **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lazy lindy / blues** Dance tempo **110–140 bpm** Written **1930**

On the Sunny Side of the Street · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- 120 is the Lazy-lindy tempo: head in two (half-note feel), solos in four. Comp sparsely on the head; the melody is the show. Fill the gaps in bars 7–8 of each A.
- Three dominants each want one note: E7 (G♯) in bar 2, A7 (C♯) in bar 6, D7 (F♯) in bar 7; put them on top of the voicings.
- Intro: four bars of C6 | A7 | D7 G7 | C6, which is also the ending tag.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	C6	E A	E7	G♯ D	F6	A D	G7	B F	A7	C♯ G	D7	F♯ C	
B	C7	E B♭	F6	A D	D7	F♯ C	D–7	F C	G7	B F			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C major, bending three notes in

C major pentatonic all the way, except the three dominants that each ask for one note: E7 wants G♯ (bar 2), A7 wants C♯ (bar 6), D7 wants F♯ (bar 7). Hit those on the beat and the tune is in the room.

B

C7 → F → D7 → D–7 G7

C mixolydian (B♭) for two bars, F major for two, D7 (F♯) for two, then ii–V home. C blues scale sits fine over the first four bars.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–7 also played A–7 | D7 | D–7 G7 · bridge as G–7 C7 | G–7 C7 | F6 | F6 | A–7 D7 | A–7 D7 | D–7 | G7, or ending D7 | D7 | G7 | G7.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



C6
C E G A



E7
E G♯ B D



F6
F A C D



G7
G B D F



A7
A C♯ E G



D7
D F♯ A C



D–7
D F A C



C7
C E G B♭

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · C major pent
C D E G A



A, B · C blues scale
C E♭ F G♭ G B♭



B · F major pent
F G A C D
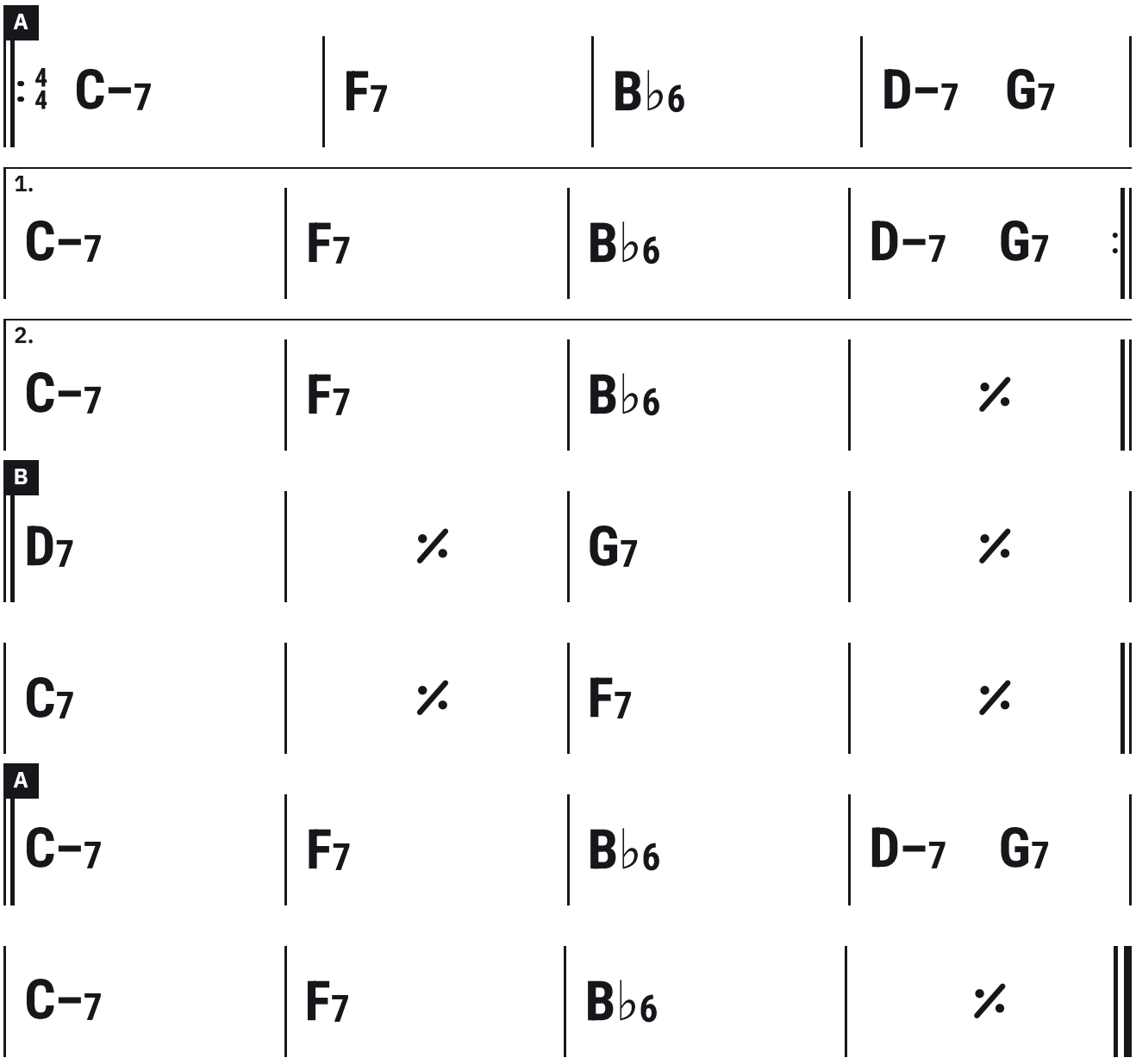


B · D7: D major pent
D E F♯ A B

(Medium Up Swing)

Perdido

Juan Tizol



Key **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1941**

Perdido · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- The riff is the whole head: comp in two and leave the riff to the horns. A perfect first tune for a set; count it at 190.
- The A is a ii–V–I–VI loop (C–7 F7 | B♭6 | D–7 G7) twice; the only non-diatonic note you need is B natural on G7. Voice G7 as G7♭9 or G7♯5 into C–7.
- Bridge: D7 G7 C7 F7, two bars each, exactly the I Got Rhythm bridge.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **C–7** E♭ B♭ **F7** A E♭ **B♭6** D G **D–7** F C **G7** B F

B **D7** F♯ C **G7** B F **C7** E B♭ **F7** A E♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

B♭ major with a VI7 pull

The riff is B♭ major pentatonic and so is the solo; the only non-diatonic note you need is **B** natural on G7, which drops you onto C–7 every four bars. Blues scale over the F7s.

B

The rhythm bridge: D7 G7 C7 F7

Two bars each; targets **F♯** **B** **E** **A**. Identical to the I Got Rhythm bridge, so anything you play there works here.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A as B♭6 | B♭6 | B♭6 | B♭6 | C–7 F7 | C–7 F7 | B♭6 | B♭6 in some charts · bridge bar 4 as G7♯5 (Hawkins' rhythm section).

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



C–7
C E♭ G B♭



F7
F A C E♭



B♭6
B♭ D F G



D–7
D F A C



G7
G B D F



D7
D F♯ A C



C7
C E G B♭

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · B♭ major pent
B♭ C D F G



A · B♭ blues scale
B♭ D♭ E♭ E F A♭



B · D7: D major pent (then G, C, F)
D E F♯ A B

(Up Swing)

Puttin' On the Ritz

Irving Berlin



Key **F– → A♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Charleston / Balboa** Dance tempo **200–240 bpm** Written **1929**

Puttin' On the Ritz · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- At Charleston tempo play the A as F– and C7 only; the D♭7 in bar 7 is a one-beat colour on the way home.
- The bridge is literally written in Charleston rhythm (long–short, long–short): comp that figure on the B (B♭–7 E♭7 A♭6) and the dancers will hear the tune before the horns do.
- D♭7 → C7 at the end of the bridge slams the door back to F–: voice D♭7 as F C♭ with E♭ on top falling to C7's E B♭.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **F–** A♭ C **C7** E B♭ **D♭7** F B

B **B♭–7** D♭ A♭ **E♭7** G D♭ **A♭6** C F **D♭7** F B **C7** E B♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F minor, C7 = F harmonic minor

F minor pentatonic and blues scale on the F– bars; on C7, E natural with D♭ (F harmonic minor). The D♭7 – C7 slide: D♭7's F/C♭ falls to C7's E /B♭. Berlin's melody is a minor arpeggio shifted across the bar; shift your own three-note cell the same way.

B

Relative major A♭: ii–V–I twice

B♭ dorian, E♭ mixolydian and A♭ major are one scale: A♭ major . Play sunlight for seven bars, then D♭7 – C7 slams the door back to F–; land on E for the C7.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bar 4–5 as one bar C7 and one bar F– in some charts · bridge ending as D♭7 | C7 over two bars.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



F–
F A♭ C



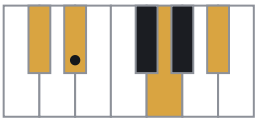
C7
C E G B♭



D♭7
D♭ F A♭ B



B♭–7
B♭ D♭ F A♭



E♭7
E♭ G B♭ D♭



A♭6
A♭ C E♭ F

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · F minor pent
F A♭ B♭ C E♭



A, over C7 · F harmonic minor
F G A♭ B♭ C D♭ E



B · A♭ major pent
A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

(Up Swing)

Ridin' and Jivin'

Earl Hines, your band's chart



Key **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Fast lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **150 bpm** Written **1939**

Ridin' and Jivin' · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- The score: 4-bar intro, 8-bar post-intro vamp on the A loop with the horns in, then A (repeated) B A at 150; the bridge is marked 'slide in F slooow'. Hines's 1939 record has the piano intro worth stealing.
- Comp the loop as a riff, two chords a bar (F–7 F–7/E♭ | D♭7 C7), shells only at 150, and let the bass carry F – E♭ – D♭ – C.
- The last time through, the final bars are played slow: watch the leader.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **F–7** A♭ E♭ **F–7/E♭** A♭ E♭ **D♭7** F B **C7** E B♭

B **E♭7** G D♭ **A♭6** C F **A♭7** C G♭ **F7** A E♭ **B♭–7** D♭ A♭ **B°7** D A♭ **C7** E B♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F minor over a four-chord loop

F minor pentatonic and blues scale all the way; the loop's bass line F – E♭ – D♭ – C is the hook. Name the chords when you want to: D♭ on D♭7, E natural on C7, then back to A♭.

B

♭VII7 → ♭III → I7 → iv → V

E♭7: E♭ mixolydian (D♭ , G). A♭ then A♭7 (G♭). F7 is the surprise: A natural, two bars of major in a minor tune. B♭–7 B°7 C7: D♭ → D → E, a chromatic climb into the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Your chart is the source. Hines's record has more passing chords in the bridge; the bass line is the same.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



F–7
F A♭ C E♭



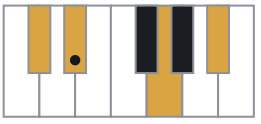
F–7/E♭
F A♭ C E♭



D♭7
D♭ F A♭ B



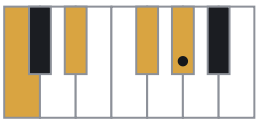
C7
C E G B♭



E♭7
E♭ G B♭ D♭



A♭6
A♭ C E♭ F



A♭7
A♭ C E♭ G♭



F7
F A C E♭



B♭–7
B♭ D♭ F A♭



B°7
B D F A♭

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · F minor pent
F A♭ B♭ C E♭



A · F blues scale
F A♭ B♭ B C E♭



B · A♭ major pent (E♭7, A♭)
A♭ B♭ C E♭ F



B bars 5–6 · F major pent (F7)
F G A C D

(Medium Swing)

Satin Doll

Duke Ellington & Billy Strayhorn



Key **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / slow swing** Dance tempo **130–160 bpm** Written **1953**

Satin Doll · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Ellington's two-chord piano intro and the famous tag ending are expected by every bandleader; learn both off the record.
- Comp the ii–Vs as a Charleston figure (dotted quarter + eighth); voice A♭–7 D♭7 as the same rootless shape you used for D–7 G7, a half step up.
- 140 is the floor's tempo; singers take it slower, let them.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	D–7	F C	G7	B F	E–7	G D	A7	C♯ G	A–7	C G	D7	F♯ C	A♭–7	B G♭	D♭7	F B	C6	E A
B	G–7	B♭ F	C7	E B♭	F6	A D	A–7	C G	D7	F♯ C	G7	B F							

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

Think the target key of each ii–V

D–7 G7: C major pentatonic. E–7 A7: D major pentatonic (C♯ , F♯). A–7 D7: G major pentatonic (F♯). A♭–7 D♭7: G♭ major pentatonic (C♭ , F), which lands you a half step above C so the resolution is physical. Then C.

B

F major, then G major, then V

G–7 C7 F: F major pentatonic (B♭ on the C7). A–7 D7: G major pentatonic (F♯). Two bars of G7: F natural, and leave space for the drummer.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

First-A bar 8 as E–7 A7 · bar 6 as D–7 G7 (the sheet) instead of the tritone sub · bridge bars 7–8 as D–7 G7 | D–7 G7.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



D–7
D F A C



G7
G B D F



E–7
E G B D



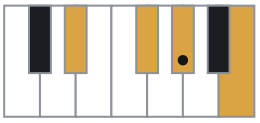
A7
A C♯ E G



A–7
A C E G



D7
D F♯ A C



A♭–7
A♭ B E♭ G♭



D♭7
D♭ F A♭ B



C6
C E G A



G–7
G B♭ D F



C7
C E G B♭



F6
F A C D

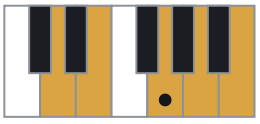
PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



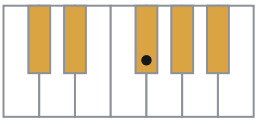
D–7 G7 · C major pent
C D E G A



E–7 A7 · D major pent
D E F♯ A B



A–7 D7 · G major pent
G A B D E



A♭–7 D♭7 · G♭ major pent
G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭ E♭
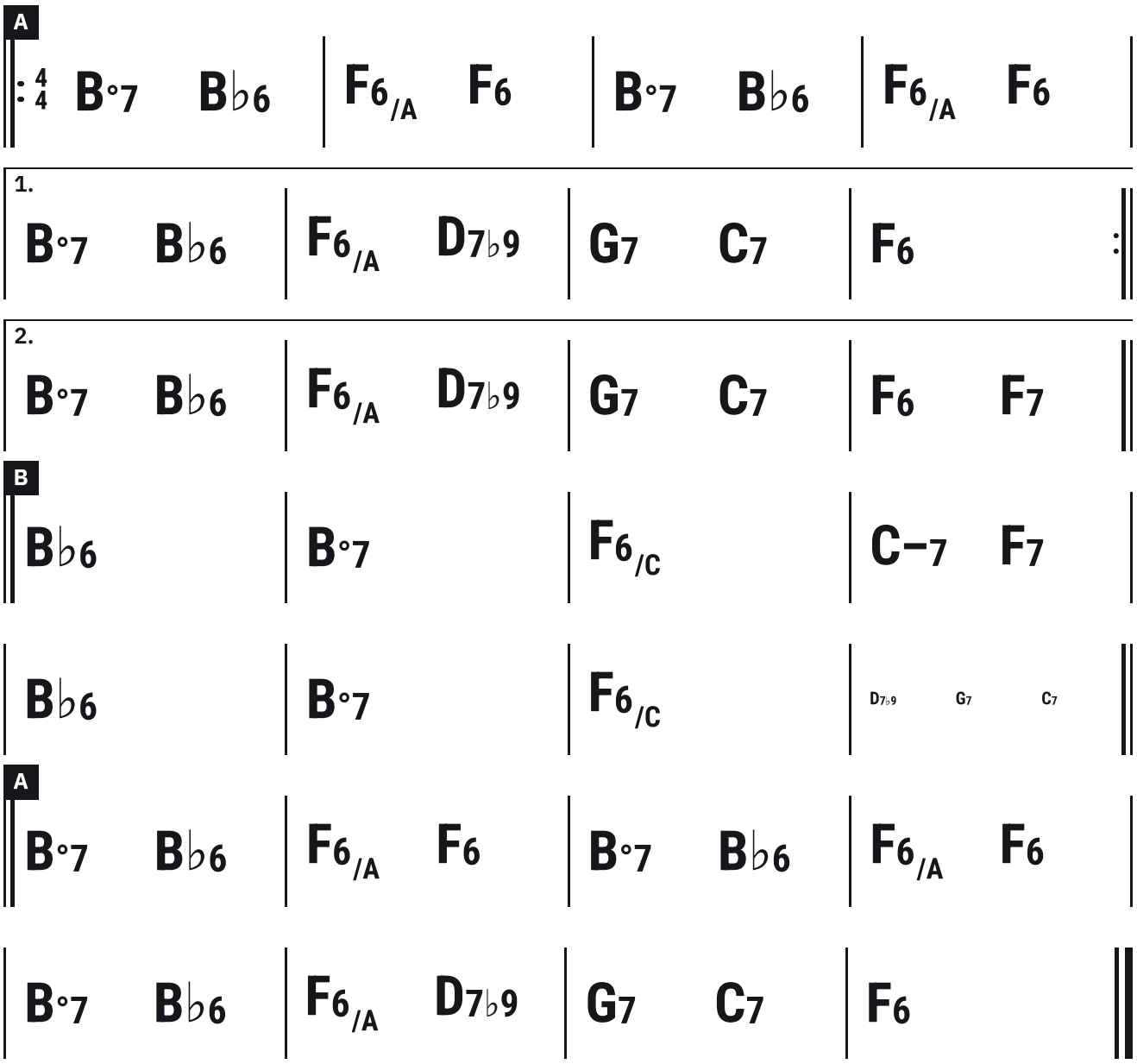


B · F major pent
F G A C D

(Medium Swing)

A Smooth One

Benny Goodman & Charlie Christian



Key **F** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lazy lindy** Dance tempo **120 bpm** Written **1941**

A Smooth One · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Christian's riff is the whole tune: play it in octaves in the left hand with the bass (B – B♭ – A – F) and the band is there.
- The sheet at 120: intro 8 bars piano and drums, A with repeat (second ending F6 F7 into the bridge), B, A, then the tag F6 | G7 C7 | F6 (N.C. pickup) | G7 C7 | F6. The last bar of the bridge has three chords: one beat, one beat, two beats.
- B°7 is a G7♭9 in disguise (B natural); D7♭9 → G7 → C7 in bars 6–7 of the A: F♯ and E♭, then B, then E on top.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	B°7	D A♭	B♭6	D G	$F6_{/A}$	A D	F6	A D	D7♭9	E♭ F♯ C	G7	B F	C7	E B♭	F7	A E♭
B	B♭6	D G	B°7	D A♭	$F6_{/C}$	A D	C–7	E♭ B♭	F7	A E♭	D7♭9	E♭ F♯ C	G7	B F	C7	E B♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F major over a walking bass riff

F major pentatonic; the riff's bass B – B♭ – A – F is the melody's shadow, so play it in the left hand and solo above it. B°7 is a G7♭9 in disguise: B natural. D7♭9 → F♯ and E♭; G7 → B; C7 → E.

B

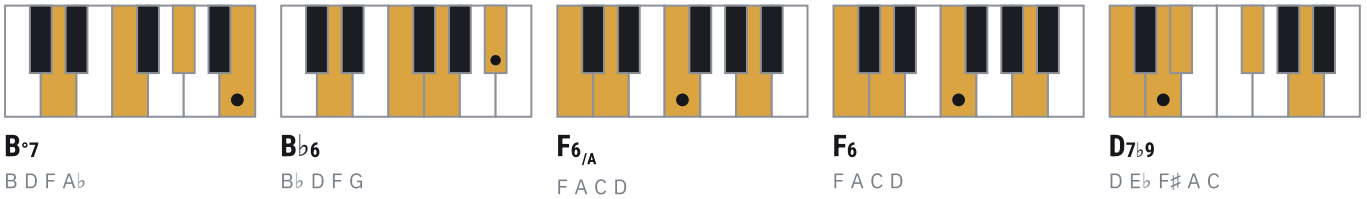
The riff from IV, then three dominants in a bar

B♭ major pentatonic over B♭6, B°7 and F6/C; C–7 F7 is a backdoor ii–V back to B♭ (E♭). The last bar, D7♭9 G7 C7: F♯ B E, one per chord, on the beat.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Jam charts read the A as F | F7/C B°7 | B♭–6 F/A: B♭–6 is the ear's version of your B♭6 under the melody's D natural · session key F; the Goodman/Christian record may be in A♭.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



B°7 B D F A♭ · **B♭6** B♭ D F G · **$F6_{/A}$** F A C D · **F6** F A C D · **D7♭9** D E♭ F♯ A C



G7 G B D F · **C7** C E G B♭ · **F7** F A C E♭ · **$F6_{/C}$** F A C D · **C–7** C E♭ G B♭

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · F major pent F G A C D · **A · F blues scale** F A♭ B♭ B C E♭ · **B · B♭ major pent** B♭ C D F G

(Latin / Swing)

Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise

Sigmund Romberg



Key **B♭−** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Balboa 180–210 · Lindy** Dance tempo **160–190 bpm** Written **1928**

Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Rootless minor voicings: B♭–6/9 (D♭ F G C), Cø7 (E♭ G♭ B♭ D♭), F7♭9 (A C E♭ G♭). The whole A is three shapes.
- Latin on the A (straight eighths, bass in two), swing on the bridge: the Artie Shaw arrangement that made the tune a standard does exactly this; on a dance floor it reads as Bal on the A, Lindy on the bridge.
- The second ending (E♭–7 A♭7) sets up the D♭ bridge: D♭6 | D♭6 (D♭7) | B♭7♭9 | B♭7♭9 | E♭–7 | E♭–7 (E°7) | Cø7 (C7) | F7♭9 back to B♭–.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**B♭–6**	D♭ G	**Cø7**	E♭ G♭ B♭	**F7**	A E♭	**E♭–7**	G♭ D♭	**A♭7**	C G♭	
B	**D♭6**	F B♭	**B♭7♭9**	B D A♭	**E♭–7**	G♭ D♭	**Cø7**	E♭ G♭ B♭	**F7♭9**	G♭ A E♭	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

One minor ii–V–i, eight times

B♭–6 = B♭ melodic minor / B♭ dorian; the G natural is the MJQ colour. F7 = B♭ harmonic minor: G♭ and A. Or do what the MJQ did and treat the A as one B♭ minor zone: B♭ minor pentatonic and blues scale straight across, resolving to D♭ or F on each B♭–6. Tritone sub to try: G♭7 for Cø7–F7.

B

Relative major: D♭ → B♭7♭9 → E♭– → C7 → F7♭9

D♭ major for two bars. B♭7♭9 = E♭ harmonic minor (D natural, C♭, G♭) pulling to E♭–7 (E♭ dorian, G♭ major). Then C7 / Cø7 (E or E♭) into F7♭9 (A + G♭) and back to B♭–. Target 3rds: F → D → G♭ → E → A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bridge in the original sheet (transposed): D♭ | D♭ D♭7/C♭ | B♭7♭9 | B♭7♭9 | E♭– E♭–/D♭ | C7 | F7♭9 | F7♭9 · learnjazzstandards sub: D♭ | Fø7 B♭7 | E♭–7 | Gø7 C7 | F7 · session key C–: everything a whole step up.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



B♭–6

B♭ D♭ F G



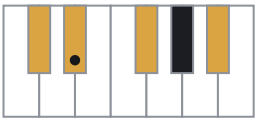
Cø7

C E♭ G♭ B♭



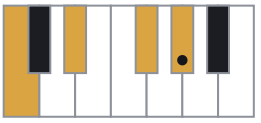
F7

F A C E♭



E♭–7

E♭ G♭ B♭ D♭



A♭7

A♭ C E♭ G♭



D♭6

D♭ F A♭ B♭



D♭7

D♭ F A♭ B



B♭7♭9

B♭ B D F A♭



E°7

E G B♭ D♭



C7

C E G B♭



F7♭9

F G♭ A C E♭

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · B♭ minor pent

B♭ D♭ E♭ F A♭



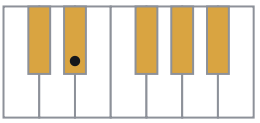
A, over F7 · B♭ harmonic minor

B♭ C D♭ E♭ F G♭ A



B bars 1–2 · D♭ major pent

D♭ E♭ F A♭ B♭



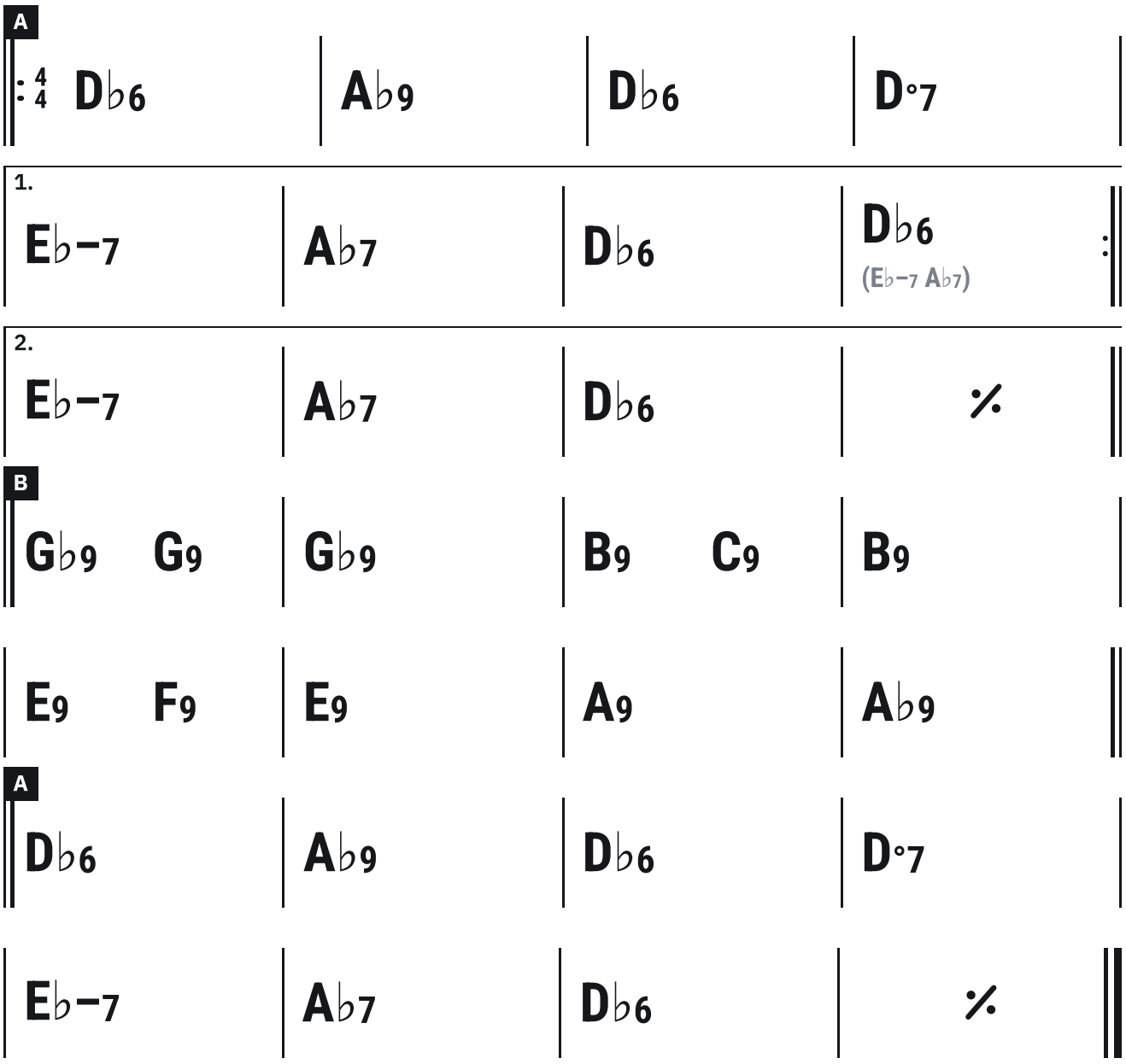
B bars 5–6 · E♭ minor pent

E♭ G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭

(Medium Swing)

Stompin' at the Savoy

Edgar Sampson



Key **D♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy 160–190 · Balboa** Dance tempo **190–220 bpm** Written **1934**

Stompin' at the Savoy · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Chick Webb's 1934 record is the template: the A is a band riff, so comp it as a riff (one rhythmic figure), not as sustained chords.
- At Balboa tempo keep the A to D♭6 and A♭7 stabs; save the full changes (D°7 in bar 4, E♭–7 A♭7 in bars 5–6) for the out chorus.
- Bridge: G♭9 → B9 → E9 → A9 → A♭9, dominants dropping a fourth, with a half-step push (G9, C9, F9) on beats 3–4 of the first bar of each pair; 9ths and 13ths are voicing choices, the bass line is the point.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	D♭6	F B♭	A♭9	C G♭	D°7	F B	E♭–7	G♭ D♭	A♭7	C G♭					
B	G♭9	B♭ E	G9	B F	B9	D♯ A	C9	E B♭	E9	G♯ D	F9	A E♭	A9	C♯ G	A♭9	C G♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A — **D♭ major, start to finish**

It's a riff tune: D♭ major pentatonic plus the blue E (♭3) covers the whole A. On bar 4, D°7 wants D and B (or think A♭7♭9). Bars 5–6 are a plain ii–V back to D♭.

B — **G♭7 → B7 → E7 → A7 → A♭7**

Dominants dropping a fourth. Mixolydian on each. Target the 3rds: B♭ D♯ G♯ C♯ C. The 3rd/7th pairs each fall a half step: B♭/E → A/D♯ → G♯/D → G/C♯ → G♭/C. Play that line alone once and you'll never lose the bridge again.

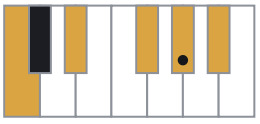
VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bar 2 as D♭6 A♭7 · bars 7–8 as D♭6 B♭–7 | E♭–7 A♭7 (the Clifford Brown/Max Roach version).

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



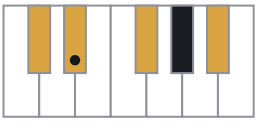
D♭6
D♭ F A♭ B♭



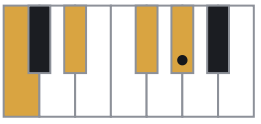
A♭9
A♭ B♭ C E♭ G♭



D°7
D F A♭ B



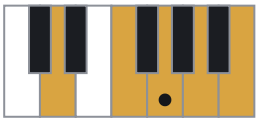
E♭–7
E♭ G♭ B♭ D♭



A♭7
A♭ C E♭ G♭



G♭9
G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭ E



G9
G A B D F



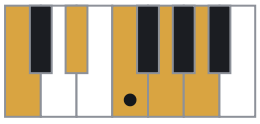
B9
B C♯ D♯ F♯ A



C9
C D E G B♭



E9
E F♯ G♯ B D



F9
F G A C E♭



A9
A B C♯ E G

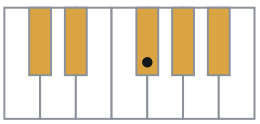
PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



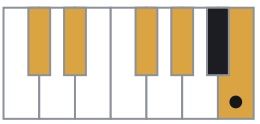
A · D♭ major pent
D♭ E♭ F A♭ B♭



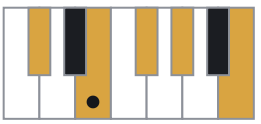
A · D♭ blues scale
D♭ E G♭ G A♭ B



B · G♭7: G♭ major pent
G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭ E♭



B · B7: B major pent
B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯



B · E7: E major pent
E F♯ G♯ B C♯



B · A7: A major pent

A B C♯ E F♯



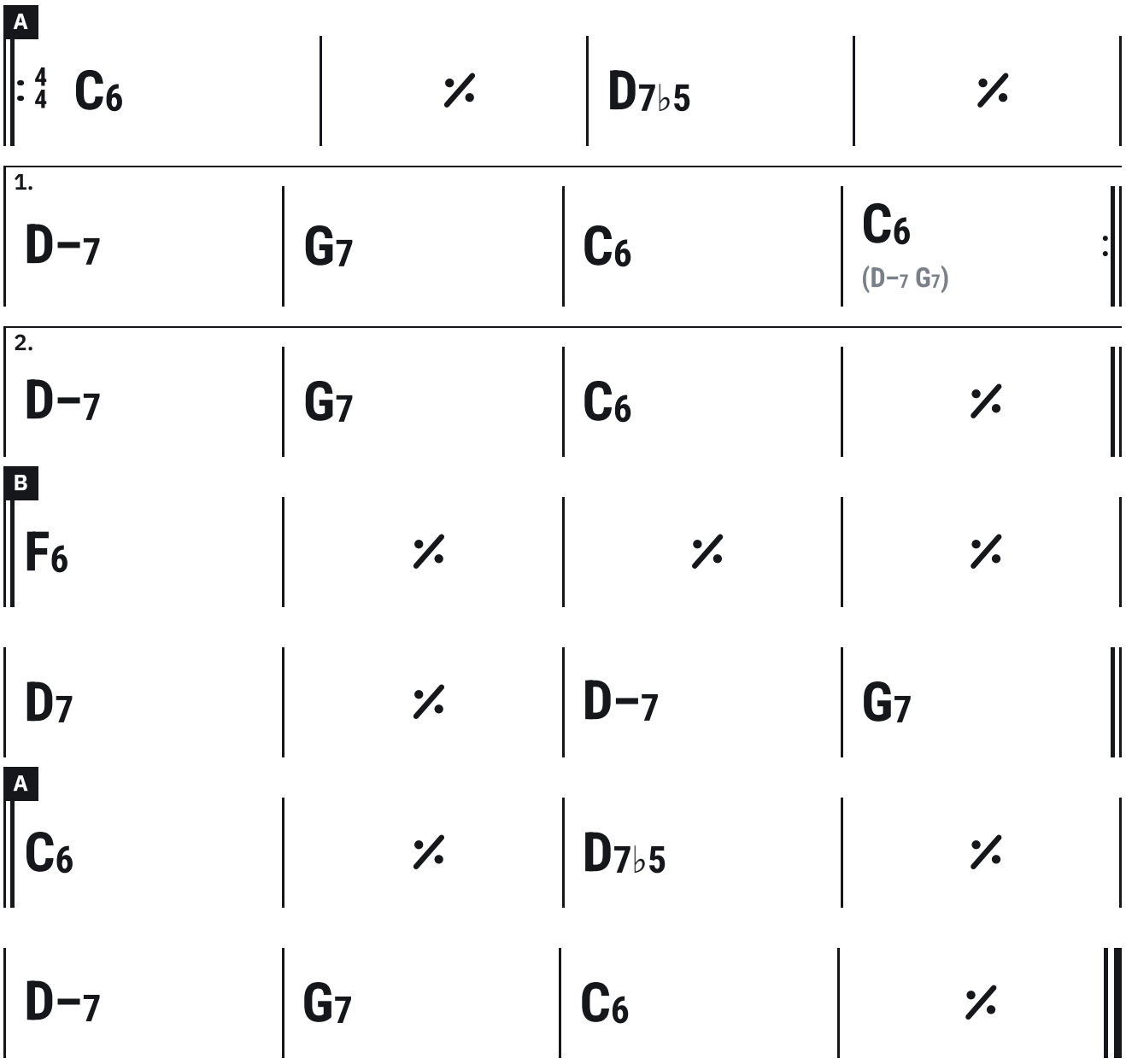
B · A♭7: A♭ major pent

A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

(Medium Up Swing)

Take the “A” Train

Billy Strayhorn



Key **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1941**

Take the “A” Train · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Learn Strayhorn's four-bar piano intro off the Ellington record. Every bandleader will look at you for it.
- Comp the D7♭5 bars (3–4) with the rootless F♯–A♭–C–E voicing and a Charleston rhythm; it sounds like the band.
- Ending: the three-note tag repeated, then a flat-VI chord (A♭6) before the final C6. Ellington did it, so can you.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	C6	E A	D7♭5	F♯ A♭ C	D−7	F C	G7	B F
B	F6	A D	D7	F♯ C	D−7	F C	G7	B F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C major, with one special chord

Bars 1–2: C major pentatonic. Bars 3–4 are the tune's sound: D lydian dominant (D E F♯ G♯ A B C), the F♯ and G♯ together. Bars 5–8: plain ii–V–I in C.

B

F major (IV), then D7 home

Four bars of F major; then D7 where F♯ is the money note (C♯ for lydian colour), into D–7 G7 and back to C.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 3–4 as D9♯11 · bridge bars 5–6 as D7 | D7♭9 · some charts split A1's last bar as C6 A7 | D–7 G7.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



C6
C E G A



D7♭5
D F♯ A♭ C



D−7
D F A C



G7
G B D F



F6
F A C D



D7
D F♯ A C

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · C major pent
C D E G A



A bars 3–4 · D7♭5 + E
D F♯ A♭ C E



B · F major pent
F G A C D
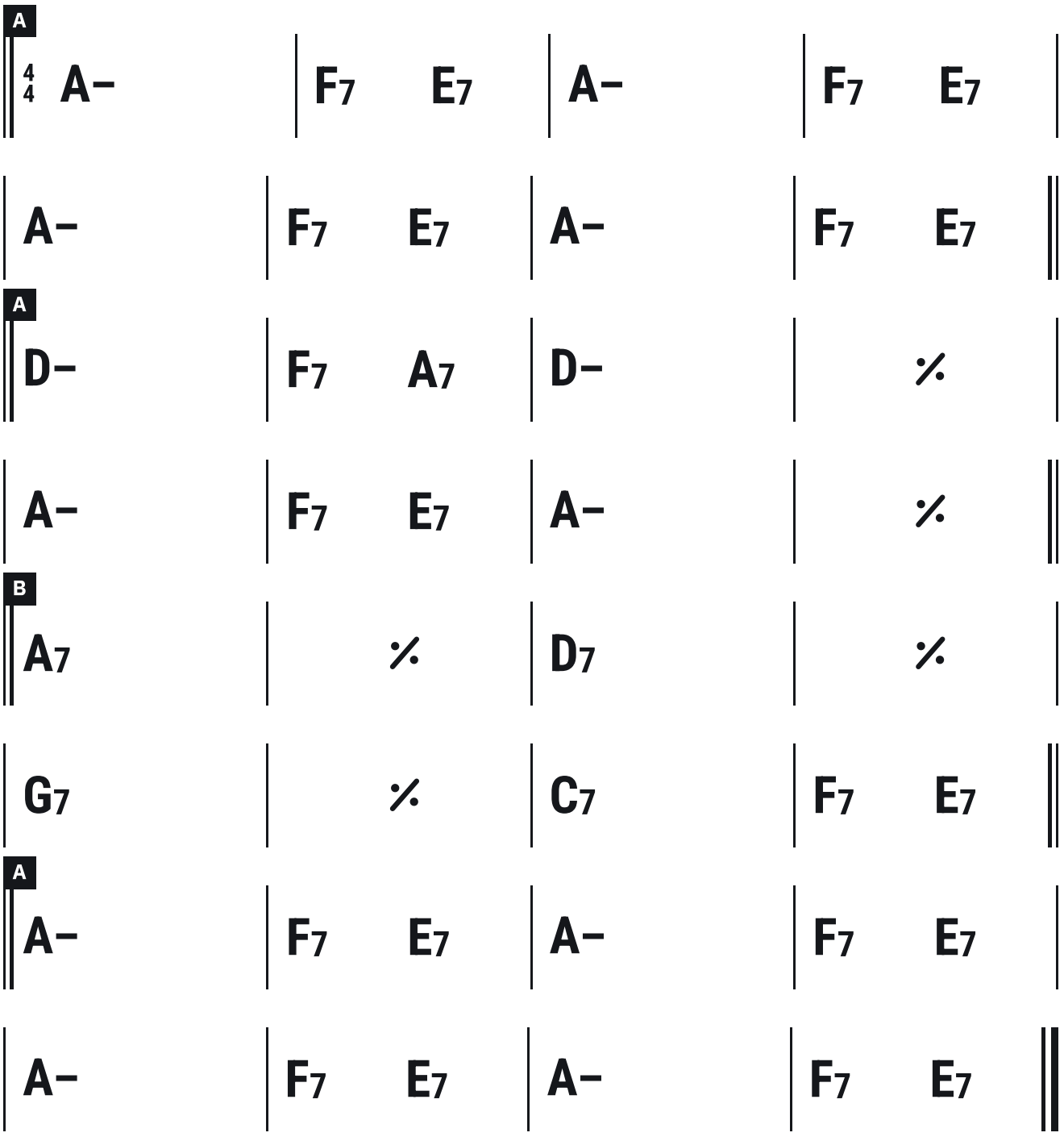


B · D7: D major pent
D E F♯ A B

(Medium Up Swing)

Topsy

Eddie Durham & Edgar Battle (for Count Basie)



Key **A–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **165–200 bpm** Written **1937**

Topsy · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- Basie 1937 is the original: the riff is the whole head, so comp it as a riff (one figure, A–6 with the F7 E7 as two beats each on the even bars).
- The bass part hits the F and E on beats 1 and 3 of the turnaround bars, so keep the F7 E7 as two beats each, not anticipated; the second A's D– bars as D–6.
- Bridge: A7 → D7 → G7 → C7, two bars each (the I Got Rhythm bridge a fifth up), then F7 E7 as the slide home; end the last chorus on A– instead of the turnaround.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**A–**	C E	**F7**	A E♭	**E7**	G♯ D	**D–**	F A	**A7**	C♯ G	
B	**A7**	C♯ G	**D7**	F♯ C	**G7**	B F	**C7**	E B♭	**F7**	A E♭	**E7**	G♯ D

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A minor, with F7 E7 every other bar

A minor pentatonic and the A blues scale carry the riff bars. The F7 E7 bars are a ♭VI7 → V7 slide: E♭ (the 7th of F7) sliding to D (7th of E7), and G♯ on the E7 (A harmonic minor). The second A's D– bars: D minor pentatonic, with C♯ on the A7 in bar 10.

B

Cycle of dominants: A7 → D7 → G7 → C7, then F7 E7

Two bars each, by their 3rds: C♯ (A7), F♯ (D7), B (G7), E (C7). It's the I Got Rhythm bridge moved up a 5th, so the same lines work. The horns' pickup figure (♯7 – 1 – 2 of each dominant) is the melody; quote it. Bar 24's F7 E7 is the slide home.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

The F7 E7 bars as plain E7 at fast tempos · the second A's D– bars as D–6 · bridge played as A7 | A7 | D7 | D7 | G7 | G7 | C7 | C7 with the F7 E7 moved into the pickup bar · last bar as A– when the tune ends.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



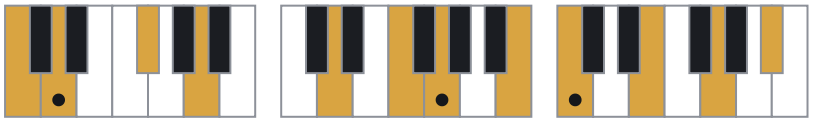
A–
A C E

F7
F A C E♭

E7
E G♯ B D

D–
D F A

A7
A C♯ E G

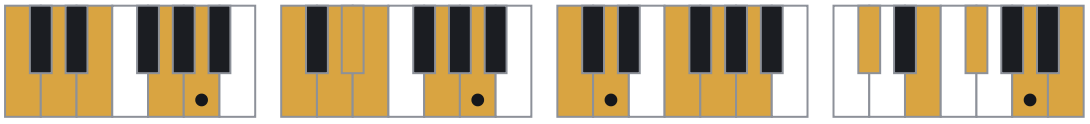


D7
D F♯ A C

G7
G B D F

C7
C E G B♭

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · A minor pent
A C D E G

A · A blues scale
A C D E♭ E G

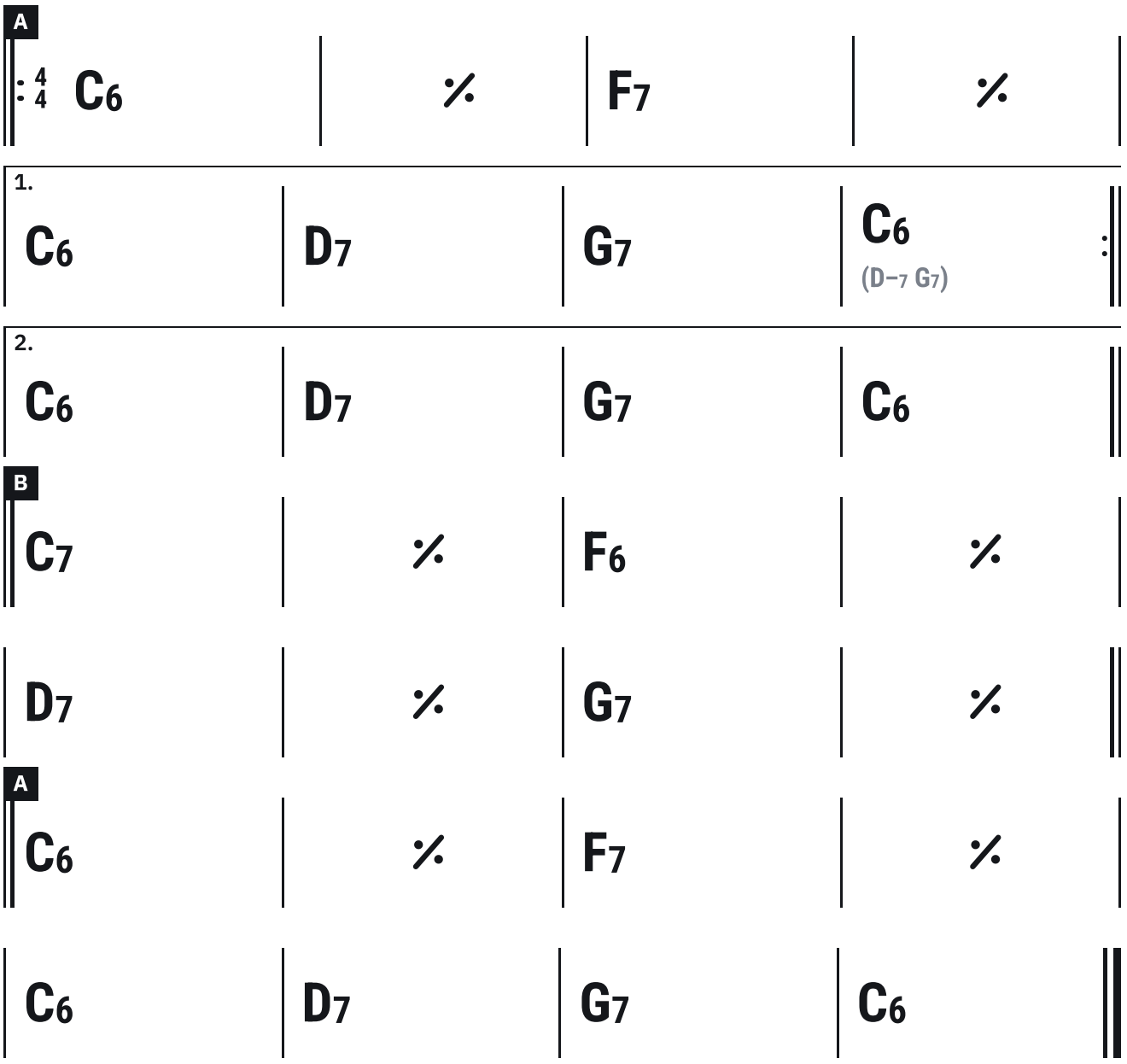
2nd A · D minor pent
D F G A C

B · A major pent (then D, G, C)
A B C♯ E F♯

(Medium Up Swing)

Undecided

Charlie Shavers



Key **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1938**

Undecided · Piano

HOW TO PLAY IT · Piano

- The head is call-and-response: horns state the phrase, you answer in the gaps of bars 2 and 4 with a two-note stab.
- Comp a Charleston figure on the A; the Webb band's rhythm is the dancers' template. F7 bars (3–4): E♭ on top; D7 (bar 6): F♯.
- Bridge: C7 → F → D7 → G7 (the Honeysuckle bridge in C); count it at 190 for a Lindy floor.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**C6** E A	**F7** A E♭	**D7** F♯ C	**G7** B F
B	**C7** E B♭	**F6** A D	**D7** F♯ C	**G7** B F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C major with a blues IV

C major pentatonic plus the C blues scale; on the F7 bars play E♭ (its ♭7) against the band. D7 wants F♯, G7 wants F; that's the whole A.

B

C7 → F → D7 → G7

C mixolydian (B♭) for two, F major for two, D7 (F♯ , C♯ for lydian colour) for two, G7 home. Same bridge as Sunny Side of the Street, so solos transfer.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–7 as D–7 | B♭7 A♭7 | G7 (the chromatic walk-down in the Ames Brothers / Kirby charts) · bar 8 turnaround optional · bridge bars 7–8 as G7 | A–7 D7 into the last A.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · coloured keys are the chord tones, the dot is the root



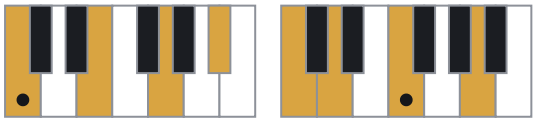
C6
C E G A

F7
F A C E♭

D7
D F♯ A C

G7
G B D F

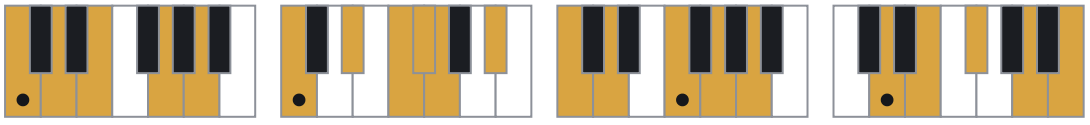
D–7
D F A C



C7
C E G B♭

F6
F A C D

PENTATONICS TO LEAN ON · one octave, root dotted



A · C major pent
C D E G A

F7 bars · C blues scale
C E♭ F G♭ G B♭

B · F major pent
F G A C D

B · D7: D major pent
D E F♯ A B

TRUMPET IN B♭
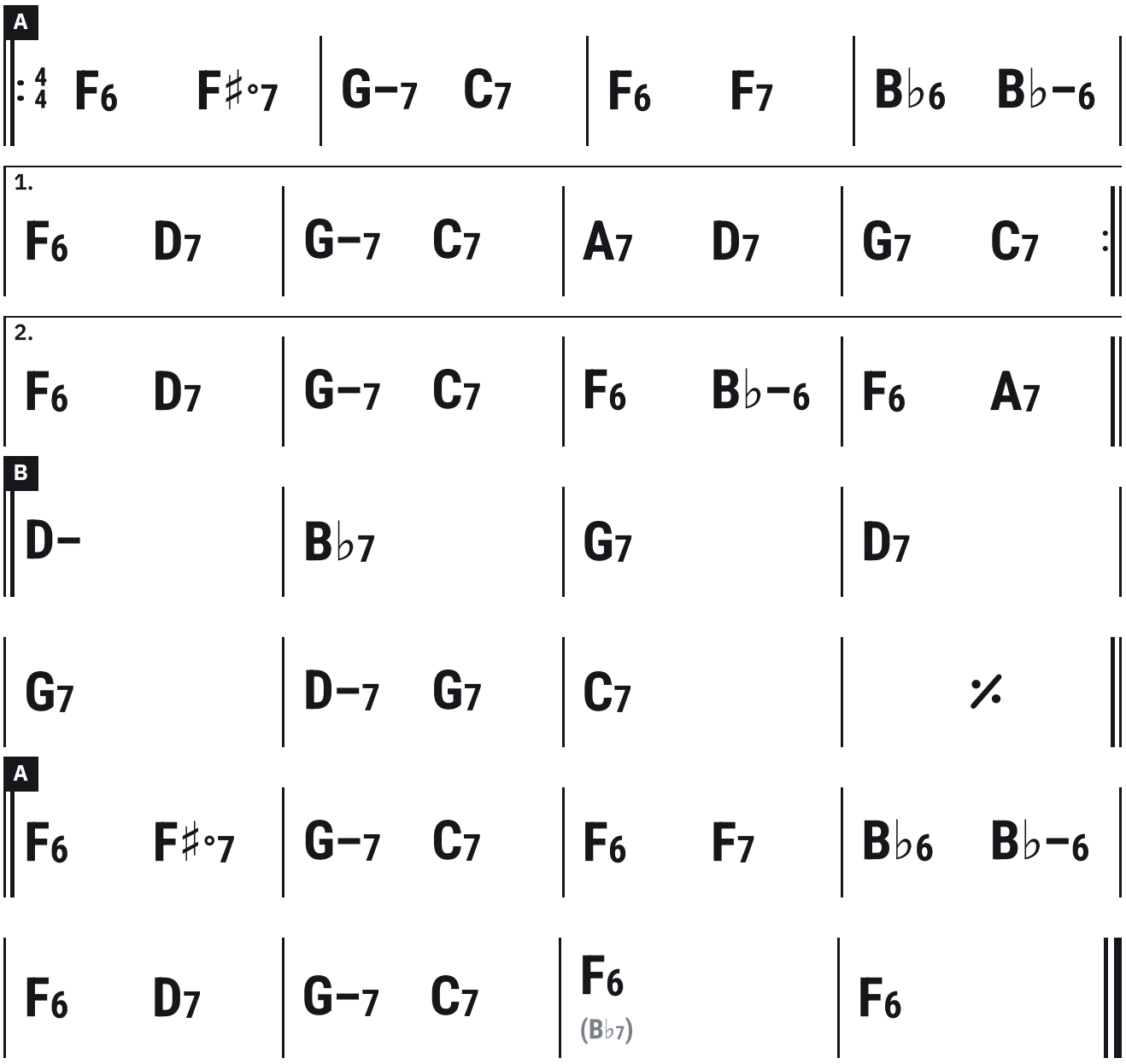
B♭ instrument: everything on these pages is written a whole step above concert pitch (concert B♭ reads as C).

#	TUNE	WRITTEN KEY	CONCERT	FORM	DANCE TEMPO
01	Ain't Misbehavin'	F	E♭	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
02	All of Me	G	F	A B A C · 32	150–190 bpm
03	All the Things You Are	B♭	A♭	A A′ B A″ · 36	150–190 bpm
04	Autumn Leaves	D–	C–	A A B C · 32	100–180 bpm
05	Battle of Jericho	G–	F–	AABA · 32	150–200 bpm
06	Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen	D–	C–	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
07	Blue Drag	E–	D–	AABA · 32	90–120 bpm
08	Blue Moon	F	E♭	AABA · 32	110–180 bpm
09	Blue Skies	D– → F	C– → E♭	AABA · 32	150–190 bpm
10	Comes Love	B–	A–	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
11	Don't Get Around Much Anymore	D	C	AABA · 32	130–180 bpm
12	Honeysuckle Rose	G	F	AABA · 32	150–190 bpm
13	I Got Rhythm	C	B♭	AABA · 32	200–240 bpm
14	It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing)	A– → C	G– → B♭	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm
15	Jumpin' at the Woodside	C	B♭	AABA · 32	200–250 bpm
16	Just Friends	A	G	A B A B′ · 32	170–220 bpm
17	Kansas City Stride	A–	G–	AABA · 32 + 8-bar intro	170–210 bpm
18	Lester's Bounce	A–	G–	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
19	Lullaby of Birdland	G– / B♭	F– / A♭	AABA · 32	150–200 bpm
20	Moanin'	G–	F–	AABA · 32	100–125 bpm
21	Oh, Lady Be Good	A	G	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
22	On the Sunny Side of the Street	D	C	AABA · 32	110–140 bpm
23	Perdido	C	B♭	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm
24	Puttin' On the Ritz	G– → B♭	F– → A♭	AABA · 32	200–240 bpm
25	Ridin' and Jivin'	G–	F–	AABA · 32	150 bpm
26	Satin Doll	D	C	AABA · 32	130–160 bpm
27	A Smooth One	G	F	AABA · 32	120 bpm
28	Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise	C–	B♭–	AABA · 32	160–190 bpm
29	Stompin' at the Savoy	E♭	D♭	AABA · 32	190–220 bpm
30	Take the “A” Train	D	C	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
31	Topsy	B–	A–	AABA · 32	165–200 bpm
32	Undecided	D	C	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm

(Medium Swing)

Ain't Misbehavin'

Fats Waller, Harry Brooks & Andy Razaf



Written key **F** Concert **E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written **1929**

Ain't Misbehavin' · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- Waller phrasing: on the beat and behind it. Lay back on the long notes, especially the pickup into bar 1 and the held notes in bars 7–8.
- Each colour chord asks for one note: F♯ on F♯°7, D♭ on B♭–6, F♯ again on D7 in bar 5, C♯ on A7. Land them on the downbeat and the harmony is in your line.
- Bridge: the line climbs through D minor into G7 and D7; play the D7 bars bright, with F♯, then let G7 and C7 bring you down.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **F6** A D **F♯°7** A E♭ **G–7** B♭ F **C7** E B♭ **F7** A E♭ **B♭6** D G **B♭–6** D♭ G **D7** F♯ C **A7** C♯ G **G7** B F

B **D–** F A **B♭7** D A♭ **G7** B F **D7** F♯ C **D–7** F C **C7** E B♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F major, with Waller's colours

F major pentatonic as home. The colours, one per chord: F♯°7 → F♯, F7 → E♭ (into B♭), B♭–6 → D♭, D7 → F♯, A7 → C♯, G7 → B. The turnaround is four dominants; hit their 3rds on the downbeats.

B

D minor, then dominants home

D minor pentatonic for bars 1–2 (B♭7 adds A♭). G7 (B , F) for two, D7 (F♯) for two is the surprise, then G7 and C7 (E) pull you back to F.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 1 as F6 D7/F♯ · bar 2 as G–7 G♯°7 · bar 3 as F6 A7 · first-B bar 7 as F6 D7 · bridge bars 5–6 as C6 | G7 in some charts.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · F major pent F G A C D

A · F blues scale F A♭ B♭ B C E♭

B bars 1–2 · D minor pent D F G A C

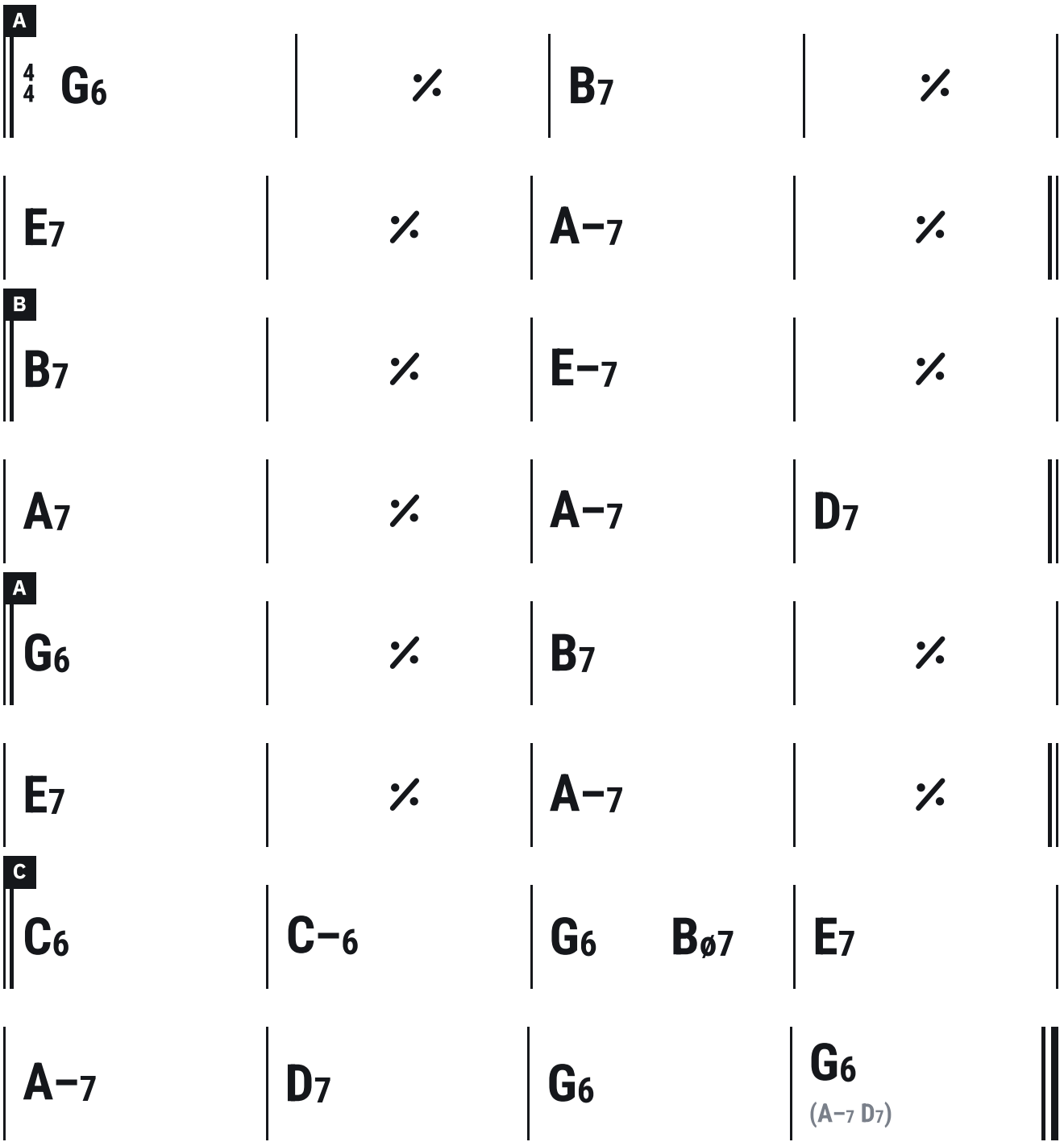
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

F6	F A C D
F♯°7	F♯ A C E♭
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
B♭6	B♭ D F G
B♭–6	B♭ D♭ F G
D7	D F♯ A C
A7	A C♯ E G
G7	G B D F
D–	D F A
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
D–7	D F A C

(Medium Swing)

All of Me

Gerald Marks & Seymour Simons



Written key **G** Concert **F** Form **A B A C · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1931**

All of Me · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- Long notes over moving dominants: hold them and let the band move under you. B7 (bars 3–4) wants D♯, E7 (bars 5–6) wants G♯ in your line.
- Phrase in two-bar units; the written melody is one idea per chord, and so should the solo be.
- C section: C → C–6 → G is the emotional peak: E♭ on the C–6, then down to D. Hold the last note; the band tags under you.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**G6** B E	**B7** D♯ A	**E7** G♯ D	**A–7** C G									
B	**B7** D♯ A	**E–7** G D	**A7** C♯ G	**A–7** C G	**D7** F♯ C								
C	**C6** E A	**C–6** E♭ A	**G6** B E	**Bø7** D F A	**E7** G♯ D	**A–7** C G	**D7** F♯ C						

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G major with two sharps bent in

G major pentatonic; B7 wants D♯ (the first surprise of the tune), E7 wants G♯, A–7 is G major again. Two bars per chord, so one idea per chord is enough.

B

B7 → E–, then A7 → A–7 D7

B7 (D♯) into E minor pentatonic for two bars; A7 (C♯ natural) for two; A–7 D7 back to G.

C

IV, iv, home

C major pentatonic, then C minor pentatonic over C–6 (E♭ is the tender note); Bø7 E7 (F , G♯) into A–7 D7 G6.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 3–4 of the A as B7 | B7♭9 · C bars 3–4 as G6 | E7 (no Bø7) in older charts · the Real Book's key is C: everything a fourth down.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G major pent G A B D E

B · E minor pent (B7 → E–) E G A B D

C · C major pent C D E G A

C · C minor pent (C–6) C E♭ F G B♭

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G6	G B D E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
A–7	A C E G
E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G
D7	D F♯ A C
C6	C E G A
C–6	C E♭ G A
Bø7	B D F A

(Medium Swing)

All the Things You Are

Jerome Kern & Oscar Hammerstein II

A

4/4 G–7	C–7	F7	B♭Δ7
E♭Δ7	E–7 A7	DΔ7	𝄎

A′

D–7	G–7	C7	FΔ7
B♭Δ7	B–7 E7	AΔ7	𝄎

B

B–7	E7	AΔ7	𝄎
G♯ø7	C♯7	F♯Δ7	D7♯5

A″

G–7	C–7	F7	B♭Δ7
E♭Δ7	E♭–7 (A♭7)	D–7	C♯°7
C–7	F7	B♭Δ7	B♭Δ7 (Aø7 D7)

Written key **B♭** Concert **A♭** Form **A A′ B A″ · 36** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1939**

All the Things You Are · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The melody is the guide-tone line: the first note of each bar is the 3rd or 7th of the chord. Learn the melody and you have the changes.
- Phrase across the barlines: G–7 C–7 F7 B♭Δ7 E♭Δ7 is one scale (B♭ major), so one long line fits five chords; the key changes at E–7 A7 and that is where to breathe.
- The last A is twelve bars, and bar 29 (E♭Δ7 → E♭–7) is the warning that the ending is coming. Count it; the dancers won't.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	G–7	B♭ F	C–7	E♭ B♭	F7	A E♭	B♭Δ7	D A	E♭Δ7	G D	E–7	G D	A7	C♯ G	DΔ7	F♯ C♯					
A′	D–7	F C	G–7	B♭ F	C7	E B♭	FΔ7	A E	B♭Δ7	D A	B–7	D A	E7	G♯ D	AΔ7	C♯ G♯					
B	B–7	D A	E7	G♯ D	AΔ7	C♯ G♯	G♯ø7	B D F♯	C♯7	F B	F♯Δ7	A♯ F	D7♯5	F♯ A♯ C							
A″	G–7	B♭ F	C–7	E♭ B♭	F7	A E♭	B♭Δ7	D A	E♭Δ7	G D	E♭–7	G♭ D♭	D–7	F C	C♯°7	E B♭					

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A — **vi–ii–V–I–IV in B♭, then a side-step to D**

G–7 C–7 F7 B♭Δ7 E♭Δ7 is one scale: B♭ major, heard as a circle of fourths. Then E–7 A7 DΔ7: the money notes are C♯ and F♯. The melody's first note on each chord is its 3rd or 7th; sing the melody and you're playing guide tones.

A′ — **The same thing a fourth lower: F, then A**

D–7 G–7 C7 FΔ7 B♭Δ7 = F major. Then B–7 E7 AΔ7: G♯ and C♯.

B — **A major, then F♯ major, then the door back**

B–7 E7 AΔ7 for four bars (A major). G♯ø7 C♯7 F♯Δ7: F♯ major, so A♯ F D♯. D7♯5 in the last bar is the hinge: F♯ natural and A♯ (= B♭) pull you back to G–.

A″ — **B♭ again, with the chromatic walk-down**

As the first A through E♭Δ7, then E♭–7 (G♭ /F♯, D♭ /C♯), D–7, C♯°7 (E , G, B♭) into C–7 F7 B♭Δ7. Think of bars 29–32 as a bass line and play across it; it's four bars of one gesture.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 30 as E♭–7 alone or as A♭7 · bar 24 as D7♭9 or D7alt · last bar's Aø7 D7 is the turnaround into the next chorus, dropped on the out chorus.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

Bars 1–5 · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

Bars 6–8 · D major pent D E F♯ A B

Bars 9–13 · F major pent F G A C D

Bars 14–20 · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

Bars 21–23 · F♯ major pent F♯ G♯ A♯ C♯ D♯

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G–7	G B♭ D F
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
B♭Δ7	B♭ D F A
E♭Δ7	E♭ G B♭ D
E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G
DΔ7	D F♯ A C♯
D–7	D F A C
C7	C E G B♭
FΔ7	F A C E
B–7	B D F♯ A

E7	E G♯ B D
AΔ7	A C♯ E G♯
G♯ø7	G♯ B D F♯
C♯7	C♯ F G♯ B
F♯Δ7	F♯ A♯ C♯ F
D7♯5	D F♯ A♯ C
E♭−7	E♭ G♭ B♭ D♭
A♭7	A♭ C E♭ G♭
C♯°7	C♯ E G B♭
Aø7	A C E♭ G
D7	D F♯ A C

(Medium Swing)

Autumn Leaves (Les feuilles mortes)

Joseph Kosma (Prévert / Mercer)

A

4/4 G–7	C7	FΔ7	B♭Δ7
Eø7	A7	D–	𝄎

A

G–7	C7	FΔ7	B♭Δ7
Eø7	A7	D–	𝄎

B

Eø7	A7	D–	𝄎
G–7	C7	FΔ7	B♭Δ7

C

Eø7	A7	D–7 G7	C–7 F7
B♭Δ7	Eø7 A7	D–	D– (Eø7 A7)

Written key **D–** Concert **C–** Form **A A B C · 32** Feel **Lindy / ballad** Dance tempo **100–180 bpm**

Written **1945**

Autumn Leaves · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The melody climbs through G–7 C7 FΔ7 B♭Δ7 by thirds: an arpeggio exercise in disguise, so solo the same way.
- Bars 5–6 of each A (Eø7 A7) are the minor turn: C♯ and B♭ on the A7, then D minor pentatonic. The bridge is the same two halves in reverse, so don't start it in F out of habit.
- C section: D–7 G7 → C–7 F7 → B♭Δ7 falls by whole steps; a line that drops a whole step every two beats fits all three bars.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**G–7**	B♭ F	**C7**	E B♭	**FΔ7**	A E	**B♭Δ7**	D A	**Eø7**	G B♭ D	**A7**	C♯ G	**D–**	F A					
B	**Eø7**	G B♭ D	**A7**	C♯ G	**D–**	F A	**G–7**	B♭ F	**C7**	E B♭	**FΔ7**	A E	**B♭Δ7**	D A					
C	**Eø7**	G B♭ D	**A7**	C♯ G	**D–7**	F C	**G7**	B F	**C–7**	E♭ B♭	**F7**	A E♭	**B♭Δ7**	D A	**D–**	F A			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F major for four bars, D minor for four

G–7 C7 FΔ7 B♭Δ7 is one scale: F major (B♭ major pentatonic also fits all four). Then Eø7 A7 D–: D harmonic minor on the A7 (C♯ natural, B♭) and D minor pentatonic home.

B

The A section reversed

Minor half first (Eø7 A7 D–), major half second (G–7 C7 F B♭). Same notes, opposite order; the trap is starting the bridge in F major out of habit.

C

Two backdoor ii–Vs sliding down, then home

D–7 G7 → C–7 F7 → B♭Δ7: D dorian, G mixolydian (B), C dorian, F mixolydian (A), B♭ major. Then Eø7 A7 D– to close. Think of bars 3–5 as one gesture descending by whole steps.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 8 of each A as D–7 or D–6 · C bars 3–4 as D–7 G7 | G–7 C7 (a plain ii–V to F) · keys: A– (Real Book), F♯– (original), D– (here).

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A bars 1–4, B bars 5–8 · F major pent F G A C D

A bars 5–8 · D minor pent D F G A C

over A7 · D harmonic minor D E F G A B♭ C♯

C bars 3–5 · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

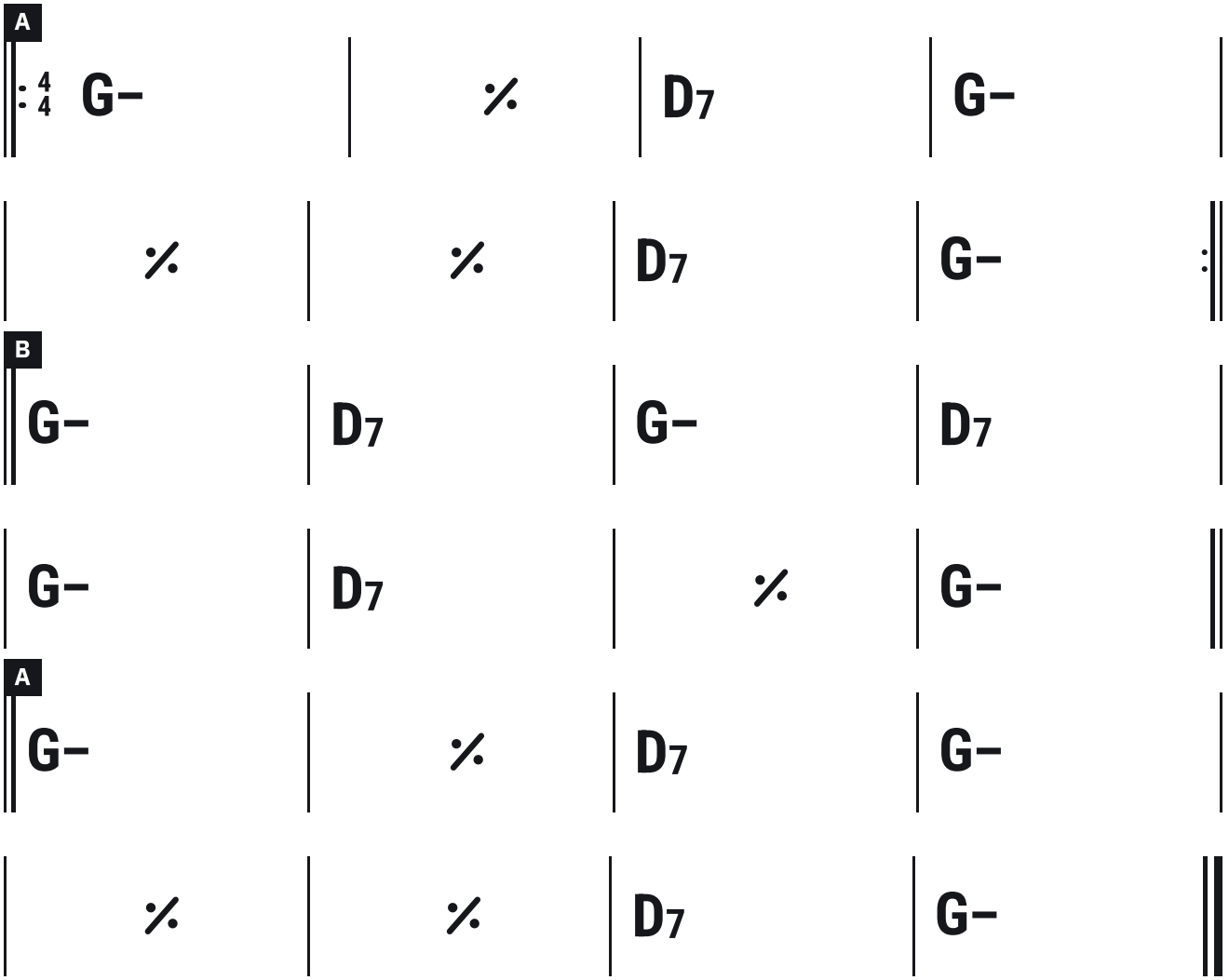
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
FΔ7	F A C E
B♭Δ7	B♭ D F A
Eø7	E G B♭ D
A7	A C♯ E G
D–	D F A
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭

(Medium Swing)

Battle of Jericho (Joshua Fit the Battle)

Traditional spiritual, your band's arrangement



Written key **G–** Concert **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–200 bpm** Written **trad.**

Battle of Jericho · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The spiritual's melody is the riff: short, hard attack on the chorus (A sections), legato on the verse (bridge).
- Solos: G minor pentatonic and the G blues scale cover everything. On D7 (bars 3 and 7 of each A, bars 2, 4, 6–7 of the bridge) land F♯ and the change is heard.
- Bars 6–7 of the bridge are two bars of D7: hold a note (F♯ or C) or repeat the melody's rhythm on it until G– returns, Bechet-style.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**G–**	B♭ D	**D7**	F♯ C
B	**G–**	B♭ D	**D7**	F♯ C

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G minor, one scale

G minor pentatonic and the G blues scale cover the whole A. On D7 play F♯ natural (G harmonic minor) if you want the chord change to be heard at all; B♭ is home.

B

The same, with twice the D7

Bars 6–7 are two bars of D7: sit on F♯ and C, or do the Bechet thing and play the melody's rhythm on one note until the G– comes back.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

C– (iv) in bar 3 of the A if the band wants a third chord · D7♭9 throughout · some bands play the B as G– | G– | D7 | D7 twice.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A, B · G minor pent	G B♭ C D F
A, B · G blues scale	G B♭ C D♭ D F
over D7 · G harmonic minor	G A B♭ C D E♭ F♯

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G–	G B♭ D
D7	D F♯ A C

(Medium Swing)

Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen

Sholom Secunda



Written key **D–** Concert **C–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1932**

Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The melody is a minor blues: bend the F and C, growl on the long notes; it's the tune the European swing floor knows best, so play it straight before you play it fancy.
- Solos: D minor blues scale over the entire A. On A7 (bar 6) C♯ against B♭ is the harmonic-minor colour; the bridge's G– bars want B♭ major pentatonic.
- The bridge (G– for two, D– for two, twice) is where the tune relaxes; play prettier there and save the blues for the last A.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D–**	F A	**G–**	B♭ D	**A7**	C♯ G
B	**G–**	B♭ D	**D–**	F A	**A7**	C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D minor blues language

The D minor blues scale works over the entire A; this is a minor blues tune. G–: G dorian (B♭ major). A7: D harmonic minor, C♯ natural against B♭. The turnaround C7 – B♭7 – A7 is chromatic dominants: target the 3rds E D C♯.

B

iv → i, twice, opening into V

G– (G dorian, B♭ major pentatonic) to D–, then the second half can go II7–V7: E7 (G♯) into A7 (C♯). The bridge is where the tune briefly feels major; play pretty there and save the blues for the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 as A7 | A7 · bridge bars 5–6 as E7 | E7 (II7–V7) · turnaround optional at speed.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D minor pent	D F G A C
A · D blues scale	D F G A♭ A C
B · G minor pent	G B♭ C D F

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D–	D F A
G–	G B♭ D
A7	A C♯ E G
C7	C E G B♭
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
E7	E G♯ B D

(Slow Swing)

Blue Drag

Josef Myrow (your Pataswing chart)



Written key **E–** Concert **D–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Slow lindy / blues** Dance tempo **90–120 bpm**

Written **1932**

Blue Drag · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- Slow and behind the beat; Grappelli's phrasing on Django's record is the model: long notes with a slow vibrato at the end.
- The pickup into the last A, D♯ E F F♯ then F♯ G in triplets, is yours: in unison with the other horn, loud and even.
- Solos: E minor pentatonic and blues at home; B♭ on the C7 bars (its ♭7) and D♯ on B7 are the two notes that name the drag.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**E–**	G B	**C♯ø7**	E G B	**C7**	E B♭	**E–/D**	G B	**F♯ø7**	A C E	**B7**	D♯ A
B	**A–**	C E	**E–**	G B	**B7**	D♯ A						

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

E minor, with a ♭VI–V slide

E minor pentatonic and blues scale at home. C♯ø7 C7: G then B♭ (C7's ♭7), the chord that gives the tune its drag. F♯ø7: C. C7 B7 at the end is the half-step slide: B♭ on the C7, then land D♯ on the B7.

B

iv and i, with B7 every second bar

A minor pentatonic over the A– beats, E minor pentatonic over E–; the B7s want D♯. Leave space: the bridge melody is mostly rests.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 6 as B7 or B9 (Django's rhythm section) · bar 2 as C♯°7 C7 · bridge A– as D♯°7 in some gypsy charts.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · E minor pent	E G A B D
A · E blues scale	E G A B♭ B D
B · A minor pent	A C D E G
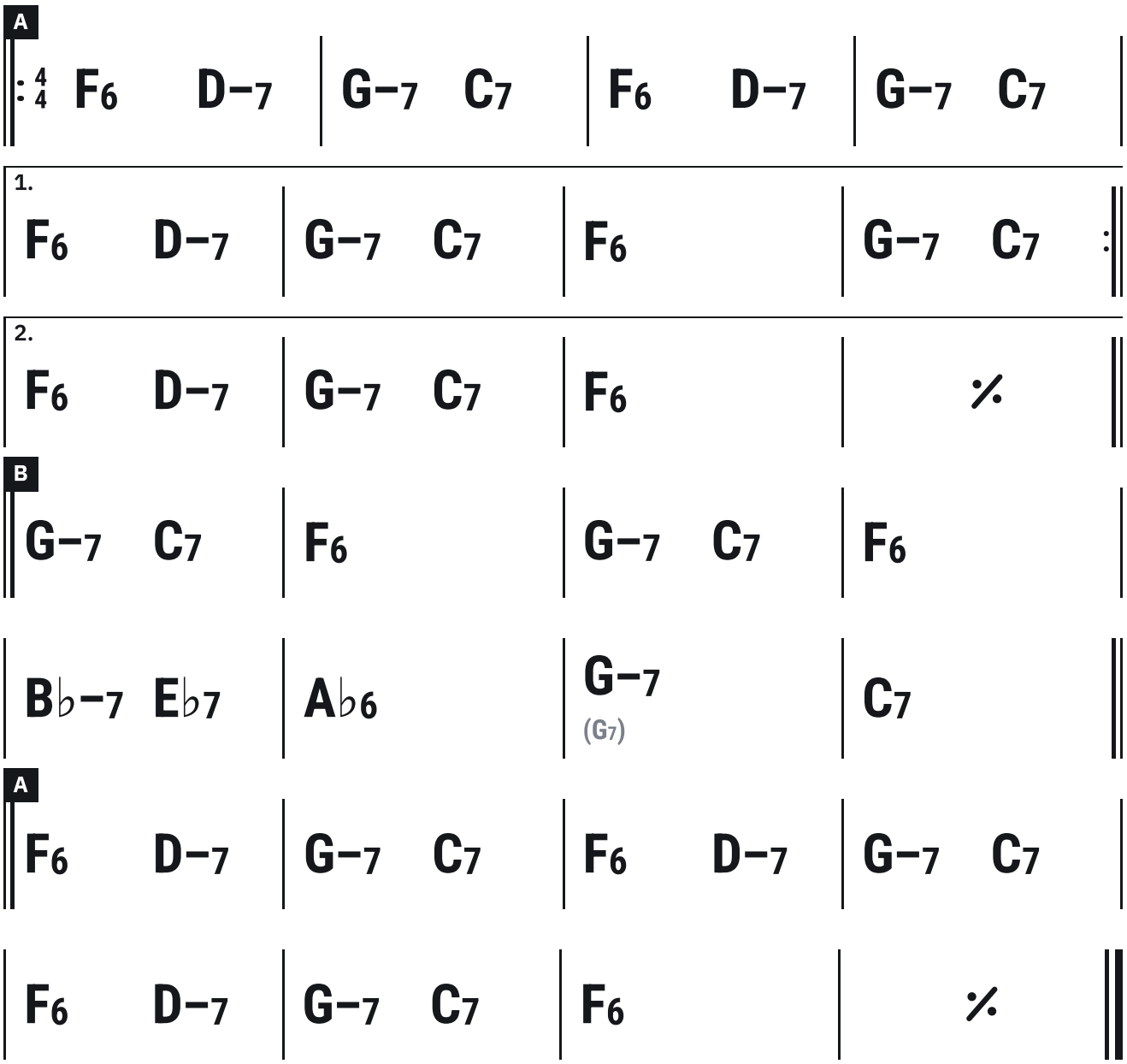
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

E–	E G B
E–/D	E G B
C♯ø7	C♯ E G B
C7	C E G B♭
F♯ø7	F♯ A C E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
A–	A C E

(Medium Swing)

Blue Moon

Richard Rodgers & Lorenz Hart



Written key **F** Concert **E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / blues** Dance tempo **110–180 bpm**

Written **1934**

Blue Moon · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- Long notes over the loop; the harmony moves under you every two beats, so hold the note and let it do the work.
- Bridge: the melody steps into A♭ in bars 5–6 (D♭ and A♭ are the new notes), then G7 or G–7 and C7 bring you back; it's the only place the tune leaves F.
- Solos: F major pentatonic over the whole loop; land E (3rd of C7) on beat 3 of every even bar and the loop sings.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**F6**	A D	**D–7**	F C	**G–7**	B♭ F	**C7**	E B♭			
B	**G–7**	B♭ F	**C7**	E B♭	**F6**	A D	**B♭–7**	D♭ A♭	**E♭7**	G D♭	**A♭6**	C F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

One loop, F major

F major pentatonic over the whole loop; D minor pentatonic is the same five notes, so the vi chord costs nothing. Land **E** (3rd of C7) on the second half of every even bar and the loop sings.

B

F, then A♭ for two bars, then home

F major for bars 1–4. Bars 5–6: A♭ major pentatonic (= F minor pentatonic): **D♭** and **A♭** are the slip. Bar 7: G7 wants **B** natural (G–7 wants B♭); bar 8 C7: **E** .

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bars 7–8 as F6 | F6 with no turnaround · bridge bar 7 as G7 (the sheet) or G–7 (sessions) · bar 6 of the bridge as A♭Δ7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A, B · F major pent	F G A C D
B bars 5–6 · A♭ major pent	A♭ B♭ C E♭ F
same notes as F minor pent	F A♭ B♭ C E♭

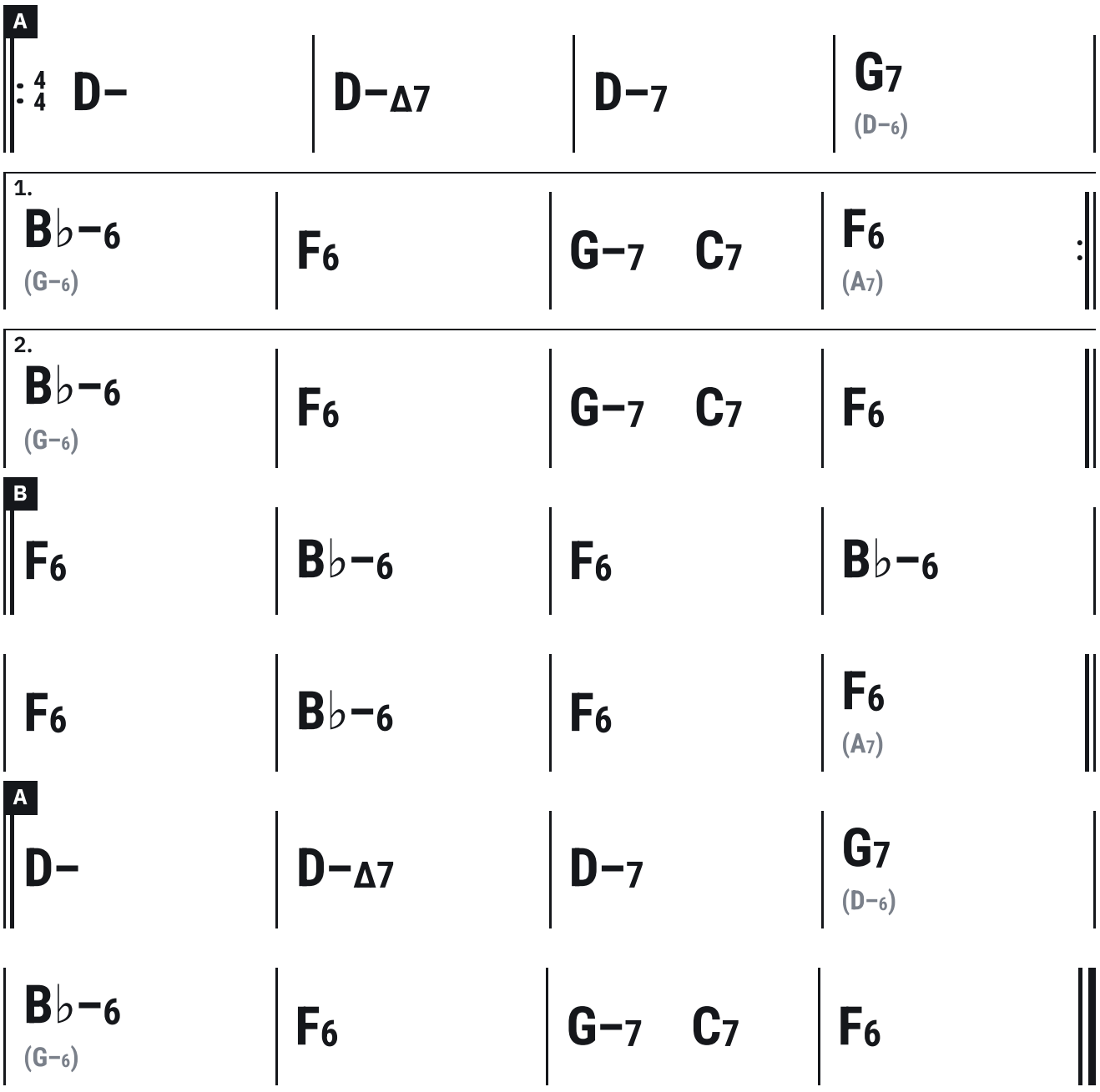
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

F6	F A C D
D–7	D F A C
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
B♭–7	B♭ D♭ F A♭
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
A♭6	A♭ C E♭ F
G7	G B D F

(Medium Up Swing)

Blue Skies

Irving Berlin



Written key **D− → F** Concert **C− → E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm**

Written **1926**

Blue Skies · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The melody sits on the line cliché: the first four bars are one note (A) with the harmony moving; play it dead straight and let the band supply the colour.
- Bar 5 (B♭–6) wants D♭ in your line; bars 6–8 are F major and the F blues scale is welcome.
- Bridge: F against B♭–6 every bar; D♭ and A♭ on the B♭–6 bars are the tension, F major pentatonic the release.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D–**	F A	**D–7**	F C	**G7**	B F	**B♭–6**	D♭ G	**F6**	A D	**G–7**	B♭ F	**C7**	E B♭	
B	**F6**	A D	**B♭–6**	D♭ G											

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D minor that is really vi of F

Play the cliché itself: D C♯ C B, one per bar, and build phrases around it. D dorian and D minor pentatonic over the D– bars, B natural on the G7. Bar 5, B♭–6: the colour is D♭ and G (F minor pentatonic works). Bars 6–8: F major home, F blues scale welcome.

B

I ↔ iv in F: F against B♭–6

F major on the F bars, F minor pentatonic on the B♭–6 bars (B♭ D♭ F G): the D♭ and A♭ are the tension. Pedal a C in the left hand under the whole bridge and let the two chords rub.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bars 1–4 as the descending-bass original: D– | A7/C♯ | F/C | G7/B · bar 5 as G–6 or B♭7 · bridge iv as plain B♭6 in older charts · the iReal version ends the bridge C♯ø7 F♯7♭9 (in D), i.e. Eø7 A7♭9 here.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A bars 1–5 · D minor pent D F G A C

A bars 6–8, B · F major pent F G A C D

B♭–6 bars · F minor pent F A♭ B♭ C E♭

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D–maj7	D F A
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
D–6	D F A B
B♭–6	B♭ D♭ F G
G–6	G B♭ D E
F6	F A C D
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
A7	A C♯ E G

(Medium Swing)

Comes Love

Sam H. Stept (Lew Brown & Charles Tobias)



Written key **B–** Concert **A–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written **1939**

Comes Love · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- A vocal tune: phrase it like a lyric, the title phrase (bars 7–8) short and dry, and lay back on the F♯7 bars.
- Solos: B minor pentatonic at home, A♯ on every F♯7 (B harmonic minor), G and A♯ together on C♯ø7 F♯7. Bridge: D♯ on B7, E minor pentatonic on the E– bars.
- At the slow tempo (Billie Holiday, 90) the horn is the second voice behind the singer: fills in the gaps, never over the words.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**B–** D F♯	**E–** G B	**F♯7** A♯ E	**C♯ø7** E G B	
B	**B7** D♯ A	**E–** G B	**F♯7** A♯ E	**C♯ø7** E G B	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A **B minor, harmonic minor on the F♯7s**

B minor pentatonic at home; on F♯7 play A♯ (B harmonic minor, with G); C♯ø7 F♯7: G and A♯ together is the sound of the title phrase.

B **B7 → E–, then F♯7 home**

B7 wants D♯; E minor pentatonic over the E– bars; F♯7 (A♯) and C♯ø7 F♯7 bring the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

G°7 passing chords on the 'and' of 4 before each F♯7 · bridge bars 5–6 as E– | E– · bar 2 as B– throughout for a modal reading.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · B minor pent B D E F♯ A

over F♯7 · B harmonic minor B C♯ D E F♯ G A♯

B · E minor pent E G A B D

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

B–	B D F♯
E–	E G B
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E
G°7	G B♭ D♭ E
C♯ø7	C♯ E G B
B7	B D♯ F♯ A

(Medium Swing)

Don't Get Around Much Anymore

Duke Ellington & Bob Russell



Written key **D** Concert **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / slow swing** Dance tempo **130–180 bpm**

Written **1940**

Don't Get Around Much Anymore · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The melody hangs on one lyric line through B7 → E7 → A7: hold the long notes and let the dominants move under you; D♯ (B7) and G♯ (E7) are the two notes to lean on in a solo.
- F°7 in bar 2 is the colour chord: F against the D is the tune's blue note.
- Bridge: four bars of G, then D7 (C) into E7 (G♯), then ii–V home; the melody climbs through it, so play the climb with a crescendo.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D6**	F♯ B	**E–7**	G D	**F°7**	A♭ D	**B7**	D♯ A	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G
B	**G6**	B E	**D6**	F♯ B	**D7**	F♯ C	**E7**	G♯ D	**E–7**	G D	**A7**	C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D major with three dominants

D major pentatonic, bending in the one note each dominant wants: B7 → D♯, E7 → G♯, A7 → G. F°7 in bar 2 is the colour chord: F against the D. Same trick as Sunny Side of the Street, same key.

B

G major, then D7 → E7 → E–7 A7

G major pentatonic for bars 1–3 (C9 adds F); D7 (C) into E7 (G♯) for two bars, then ii–V home.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as D♯°7 or G6 G♯°7 · bar 3 as F♯–7 F7 (bebop) · bridge bars 5–6 as B–7 E7 · Real-Book-style bridge: A–7 D7 | G6 | A–7 D7 | G6 | B–7 E7 | B–7 E7 | E–7 | A7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D major pent D E F♯ A B

B · G major pent G A B D E

E7 bars · E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯
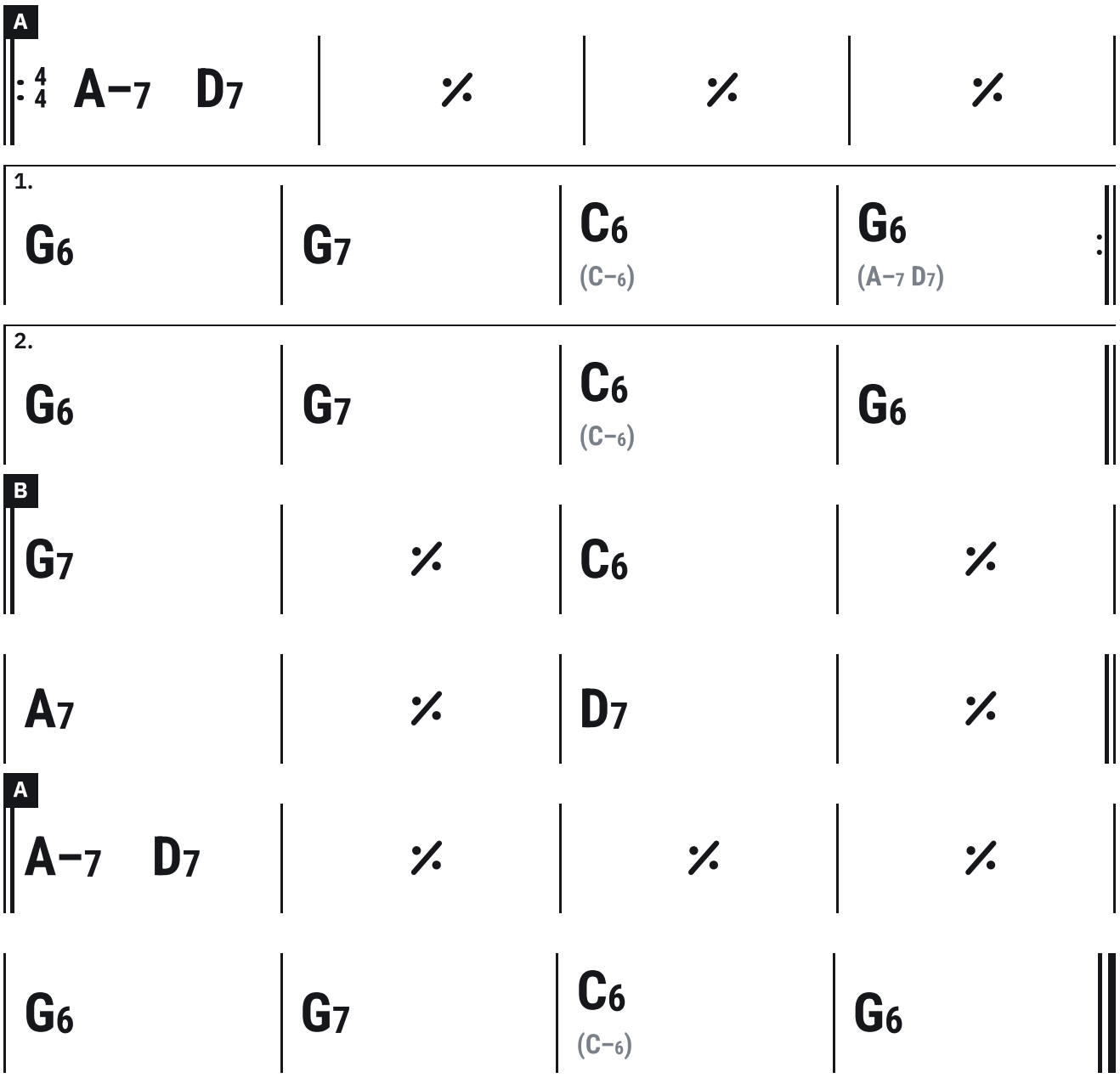
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D6	D F♯ A B
E–7	E G B D
F°7	F A♭ B D
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
A7	A C♯ E G
A–7	A C E G
D7	D F♯ A C
G6	G B D E
C9	C D E G B♭

(Medium Swing)

Honeysuckle Rose

Fats Waller & Andy Razaf



Written key **G** Concert **F** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1929**

Honeysuckle Rose · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The melody is a riff on A–7 D7 for four bars: short and bouncy; quote the first bar in your solo, everyone since Bird has.
- Bars 5–8 move: G → G7 → C → G. F on the G7 (bar 6) landing on E (3rd of C) is the line.
- Bridge (G7 | G7 | C | C | A7 | A7 | D7 | D7): two bars a chord; F → E → C♯ → C is the guide-tone line, one note per two bars.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**A–7**	C G	**D7**	F♯ C	**G6**	B E	**G7**	B F	**C6**	E A
B	**G7**	B F	**C6**	E A	**A7**	C♯ G	**D7**	F♯ C		

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

One long ii–V in G, then home

Bars 1–4 are a vamp: D mixolydian (G major heard from the D7). Don't resolve early; the tune doesn't. Bars 5–8: G → G7 → C → G. Play **F** on the G7 in bar 6 and land on **E** (3rd of C); if the band plays C–6, **E♭** is yours in bar 7.

B

The Honeysuckle bridge: I7 → IV → II7 → V7

G7 (F) for two, C major for two, A7 for two where **C♯** natural is the note, D7 (C) for two. Guide-tone line: B/F → E/B♭ → C♯/G → F♯/C.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 7–8: C6 C–6 | G6 E7 (A–7 D7) · bridge bars 7–8 as A–7 | D7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G major pent G A B D E

A bars 5–8 · G blues scale G B♭ C D♭ D F

B · A7: A major pent A B C♯ E F♯
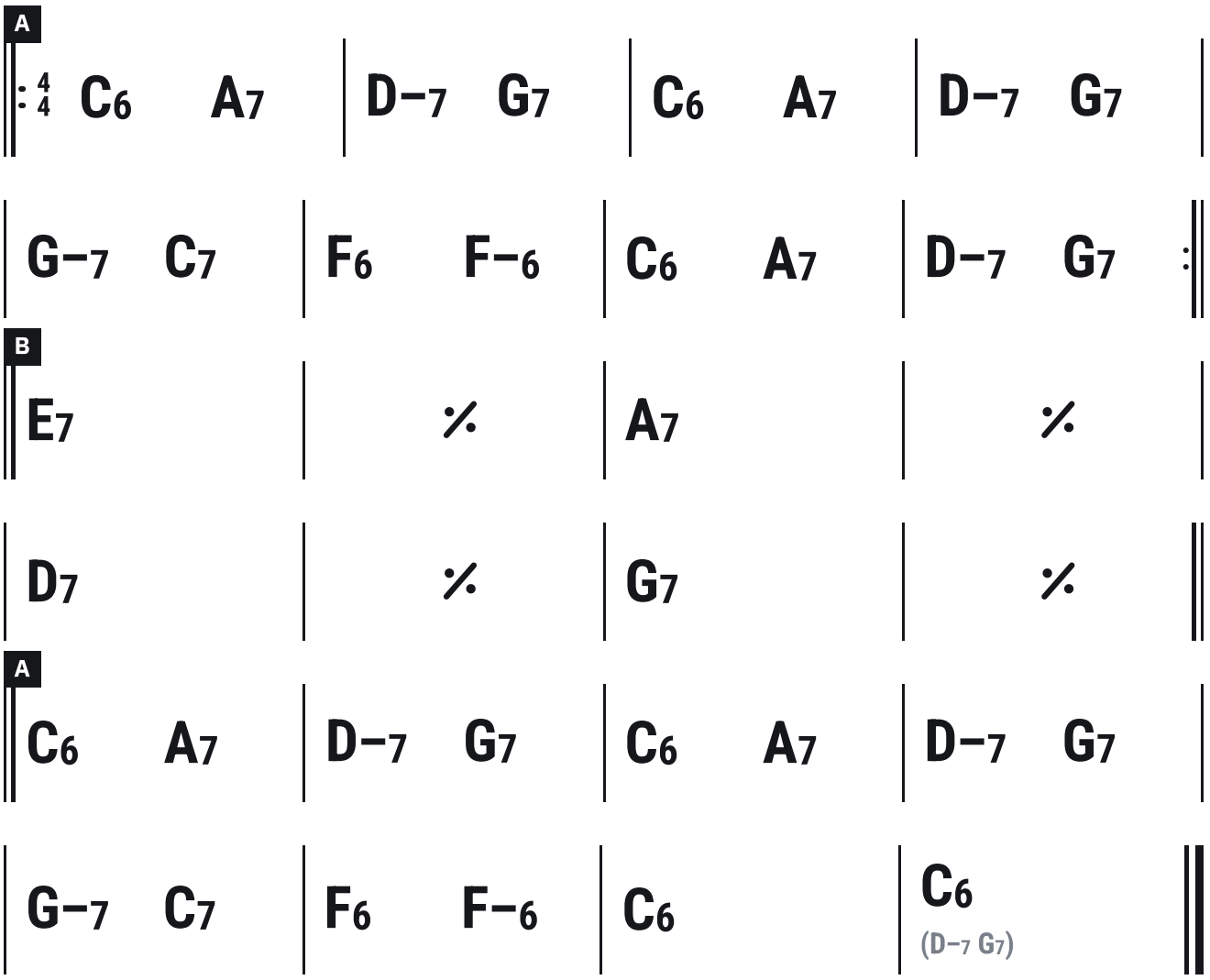
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A–7	A C E G
D7	D F♯ A C
G6	G B D E
G7	G B D F
C6	C E G A
C–6	C E♭ G A
A7	A C♯ E G

(Up Swing)

I Got Rhythm (Rhythm Changes)

George Gershwin



Written key **C** Concert **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Charleston / fast lindy** Dance tempo **200–240 bpm**

Written **1930**

I Got Rhythm · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- Riff heads (Lester Leaps In, Cotton Tail) live on these changes: play the head short and in unison, and solo in C major pentatonic plus the blue E♭ over bars 1–4; the turnarounds are the rhythm section's problem.
- Bars 5–6 are the event: B♭ on the C7 into A (3rd of F), then A♭ over F–6 going home.
- Bridge: E7 → A7 → D7 → G7, two bars each. The 3rds G♯ C♯ F♯ B on the downbeats are the bridge; a line that falls a half step every two bars (G♯/D → C♯/G → F♯/C → B/F) never gets lost.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**C6**	E A	**A7**	C♯ G	**D–7**	F C	**G7**	B F	**G–7**	B♭ F	**C7**	E B♭	**F6**	A D	**F–6**	A♭ D			
B	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G	**D7**	F♯ C	**G7**	B F											

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C major, with C blues on top

Bars 1–4: one key to the ear. C major pentatonic plus the blue E♭, and the whole turnaround disappears under it. Bars 5–6 are the real event: C7 into F. Play B♭ (the ♭7) and land on A (3rd of F); then A♭ over F–6 going home. Guide tones through the turnaround: E → C♯ (A7) → F → B (G7).

B

Four dominants, two bars each, round the circle

E7 → A7 → D7 → G7. Mixolydian on each; the 3rds are the targets: G♯ C♯ F♯ B. Voice-lead the 3rd/7th pairs down by half step: G♯/D → C♯/G → F♯/C → B/F. Lydian dominant (♯11) for colour: A♯ on E7, D♯ on A7.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as E–7 A7 · bar 6 as F6 F♯°7 · bebop A: C C♯°7 | D–7 D♯°7 | E–7 E♭7 | D–7 G7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · C major pent C D E G A

B · E7: E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

B · A7: A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

B · D7: D major pent D E F♯ A B

B · G7: G major pent G A B D E

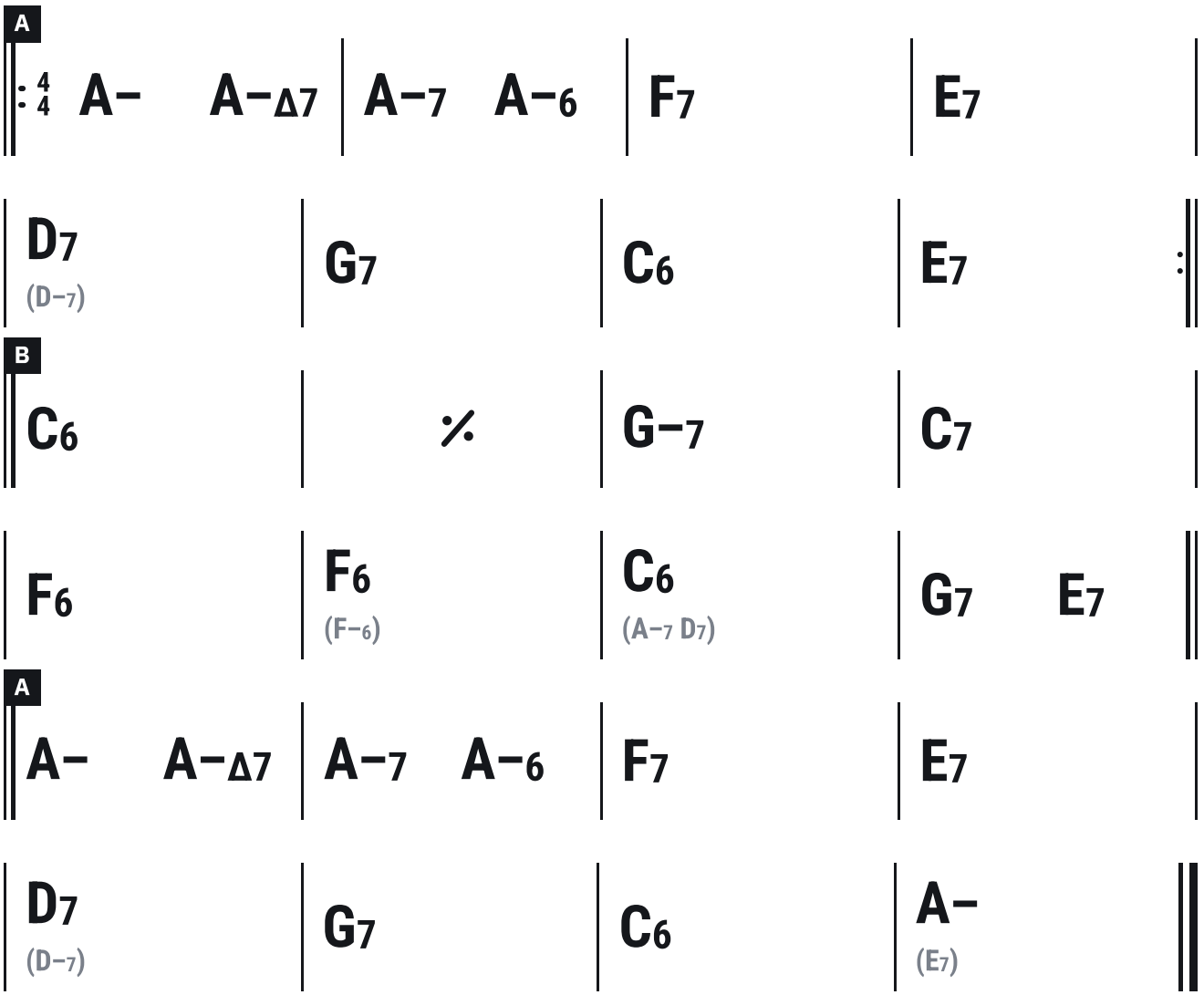
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

C6	C E G A
A7	A C♯ E G
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
F6	F A C D
F–6	F A♭ C D
E7	E G♯ B D
D7	D F♯ A C

(Medium Swing)

It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing)

Duke Ellington & Irving Mills



Written key **A– → C** Concert **G– → B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm**

Written **1931**

It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing) · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The doo-wah answer in bars 5–8 is yours: short, on the 'and' of 2 and 4, with the piano stabbing the same rhythm; the head is call-and-response with the rhythm section.
- Solos: A minor pentatonic over the cliché bars, E♭ then G♯ on F7 → E7, C major pentatonic for bars 5–8 with F♯ on D7 and B on G7.
- Bridge: C major for four bars (G–7 C7 is a push into F: play B♭), F then F–6 (A♭), and G7 E7 at the end: B → G♯ to drop back into A minor.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**A–**	C E	**A–7**	C G	**A–6**	C F♯	**F7**	A E♭	**E7**	G♯ D	**D7**	F♯ C	**G7**	B F	**C6**	E A
B	**C6**	E A	**G–7**	B♭ F	**C7**	E B♭	**F6**	A D	**G7**	B F	**E7**	G♯ D				

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A minor, then four bars of C major

Bars 1–2: A minor pentatonic over the line cliché A–G♯–G–F♯ (play the cliché in the left hand, solo on top). F7 → E7: E♭ then G♯, the flamenco cadence. Bars 5–8: C major pentatonic; F♯ natural on D7, B on G7, and E7's G♯ to pull you home.

B

C major: I → IV → home

C major pentatonic for four bars (G–7 C7 is just a push into F: play B♭). F major, then F–6 if the band plays it (A♭). G7 E7 at the end: B → G♯.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 1–2 as plain A– · doo-wah bars as D–7 | G7 | C6 | E7♯5, or with D♯°7 in bar 6 (iReal first ending) · bridge bars 3–4 as C7 | C7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A bars 1–4 · A minor pent A C D E G

A bars 5–8, B · C major pent C D E G A

B bars 5–6 · F major pent F G A C D

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A–maj7	A C E
A–7	A C E G
A–6	A C E F♯
F7	F A C E♭
E7	E G♯ B D
D7	D F♯ A C
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
C6	C E G A
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
F6	F A C D
F–6	F A♭ C D

(Up Swing)

Jumpin' at the Woodside

Count Basie (Eddie Durham)



Written key **C** Concert **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Fast lindy** Dance tempo **200–250 bpm** Written **1938**

Jumpin' at the Woodside · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- A riff tune: the riff is C major pentatonic, short and in unison; the head is stacked riffs, so each horn holds its own riff for the chorus.
- Solos: C major pentatonic with the blues on top; B♭ on the C7 (bar 4), A then A♭ on F → F–6 (bars 5–6). At this tempo two ideas per chorus is plenty.
- Bridge: C7 (B♭) for two, F for two, D7 (F♯) for two, G7 (B) for two; half notes and quarter notes win at 240. The riff-chorus ending is yours: stack riffs, louder each chorus.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	C6	E A	C7	E B♭	F6	A D	F–6	A♭ D
B	C7	E B♭	F6	A D	D7	F♯ C	G7	B F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A **C major pentatonic, blues on top**

The riff is C major pentatonic; so is the solo. C7 in bar 4: B♭. F then F–6 in bars 5–6: A then A♭. Then home. At this tempo, two ideas per chorus is plenty.

B **The Honeysuckle bridge in C**

C7 (B♭) for two, F for two, D7 (F♯ natural) for two, G7 (B) for two. Half notes and quarter notes win at 240.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 as F7 | F7 · bar 8 G7 turnaround · some bands play a rhythm bridge (E7 A7 D7 G7) instead; ask before the count-off.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · C major pent C D E G A

A · C blues scale C E♭ F G♭ G B♭

Bars 5–6, B · F major pent F G A C D

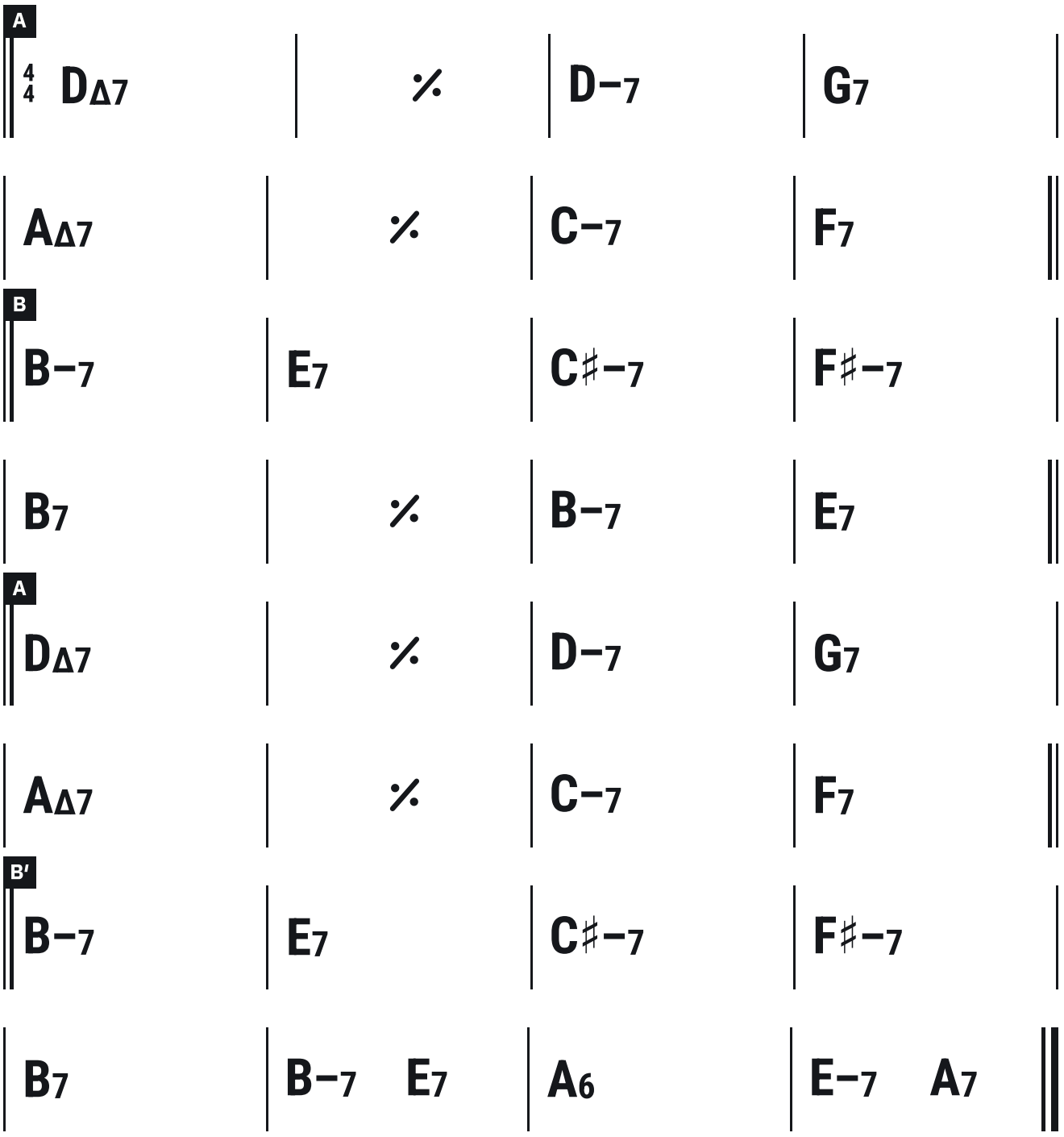
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

C6	C E G A
C7	C E G B♭
F6	F A C D
F–6	F A♭ C D
F7	F A C E♭
G7	G B D F
D7	D F♯ A C

(Up Swing)

Just Friends

John Klenner & Sam M. Lewis



Written key **A** Concert **G** Form **A B A B′ · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **170–220 bpm**

Written **1931**

Just Friends · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The melody starts on IV (DΔ7) and sits on G♯, the lydian note, so it sounds like A major from bar 1; Chet Baker 1959 is the model: behind the beat, no vibrato until the end of the note.
- The two backdoor ii–Vs are the tune: D–7 G7 (bars 3–4) wants F and C in your line; C–7 F7 (bars 7–8) wants E♭ and B♭, sliding into B–7.
- B section: B–7 E7 C♯–7 F♯–7 is all A major; B7 in bars 5–6 is the one II7, so D♯ is the note. B′ ends on E–7 A7, the turnaround into D for the next chorus; end the last one on A6.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**DΔ7**	F♯ C♯	**D–7**	F C	**G7**	B F	**AΔ7**	C♯ G♯	**C–7**	E♭ B♭	**F7**	A E♭							
B	**B–7**	D A	**E7**	G♯ D	**C♯–7**	E B	**F♯–7**	A E	**B7**	D♯ A									
B′	**B–7**	D A	**E7**	G♯ D	**C♯–7**	E B	**F♯–7**	A E	**B7**	D♯ A	**A6**	C♯ F♯	**E–7**	G D	**A7**	C♯ G			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

IV, backdoor, I, backdoor

DΔ7: A major (D lydian, G♯). D–7 G7: C major pentatonic (F and C are the backdoor notes). AΔ7: home. C–7 F7: B♭ major pentatonic (E♭, B♭) sliding into B–7.

B

A major with one II7

B–7 E7 and C♯–7 F♯–7 are diatonic; B7 is the II7 colour: D♯.
B′: B–7 E7 A6 then E–7 A7 to set up the D chord at the top.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 of the first A as G7 | G7 (Chet's sub for AΔ7) · B′ bar 8 as E7 E♭7 the first time · bar 7–8 of the B as B–7 | E7 or B–7 E7 | A6.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A, B · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯
D–7 G7 · C major pent C D E G A
C–7 F7 · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G
B7 · B major pent B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯

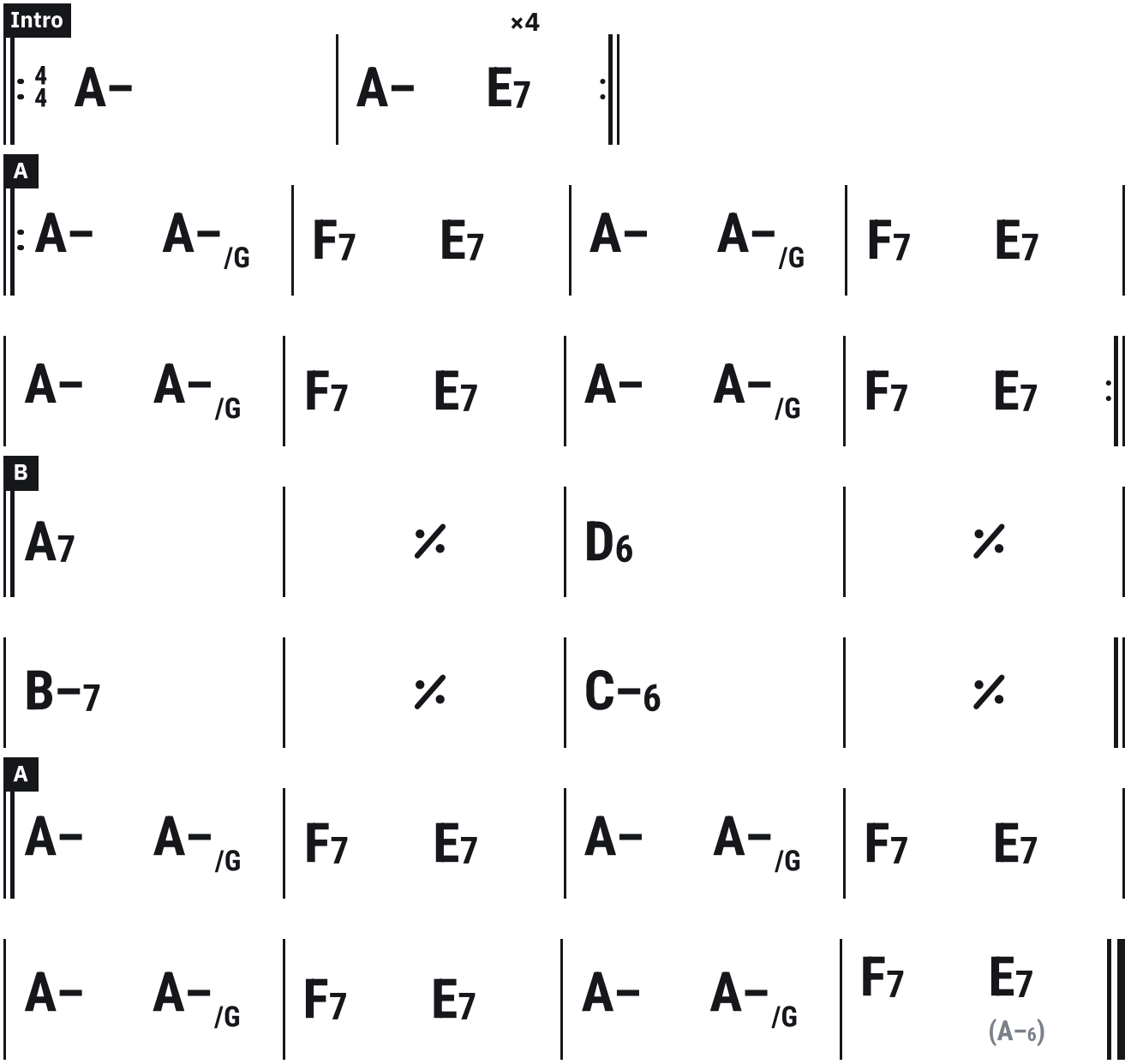
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

DΔ7	D F♯ A C♯
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
AΔ7	A C♯ E G♯
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
B–7	B D F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
C♯–7	C♯ E G♯ B
F♯–7	F♯ A C♯ E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
A6	A C♯ E F♯
E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G

(Medium Up Swing)

Kansas City Stride

Giorgio Cuscito (Tiber River Dixieland)



Written key **A–** Concert **G–** Form **AABA · 32 + 8-bar intro** Feel **Lindy · Balboa**

Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **2011**

Kansas City Stride · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The riff over A– is the head; the F7 E7 bars are the answer, so phrase riff / answer, riff / answer, four times, and keep the E7 bar short.
- Solos: A minor pentatonic and blues on the riff bars; E♭ down to D on F7 → E7 and G♯ on the E7 name the slide. Bridge: D major pentatonic covers A7, D6 and B–7 (six bars), then E♭ and B♭ on the C–6 bars, a half step above home.
- Intro: the horns stack a riff on the third and fourth time through the vamp; make it a two-bar figure that leaves the E7 kick (beats 3–4 of bar 2) to the rhythm section.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

In	**A–**	C E	**E7**	G♯ D					
A	**A–**	C E	**A–/G**	C E	**F7**	A E♭	**E7**	G♯ D	
B	**A7**	C♯ G	**D6**	F♯ B	**B–7**	D A	**C–6**	E♭ A	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

The Lester's Bounce riff: A– with an F7 E7 slide every second bar

A minor pentatonic and the A blues scale over the whole eight; the riff is the melody. The F7 E7 is a ♭VI7 → V7 slide: E♭ (7th of F7) down to D (7th of E7), and G♯ on the E7 (A harmonic minor). Anything you play on Lester's Bounce bars 1–4 works here, four times.

B

Bright for six bars, dark for two: A7 → D → B–7 → C–

D major pentatonic covers A7, D6 and B–7 in one go, with C♯ natural as the colour note against the A's C and G on the A7. Then C minor pentatonic for the C–6 bars (E♭ and B♭ are the notes that say minor), and you are a half step above home: slide down into A minor pent on bar 25.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Intro one chord a bar (16 bars) · A bars 7–8 as A– | E7 to break the loop · bridge with D–6 and Bø7 for the all-minor version (that is the Lester's Bounce bridge) · C–6 played as F9 · last bar A–6.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · A minor pent A C D E G

A · A blues scale A C D E♭ E G

B · D major pent (A7, C, B–7) D E F♯ A B

B · C minor pent (C–) C E♭ F G B♭

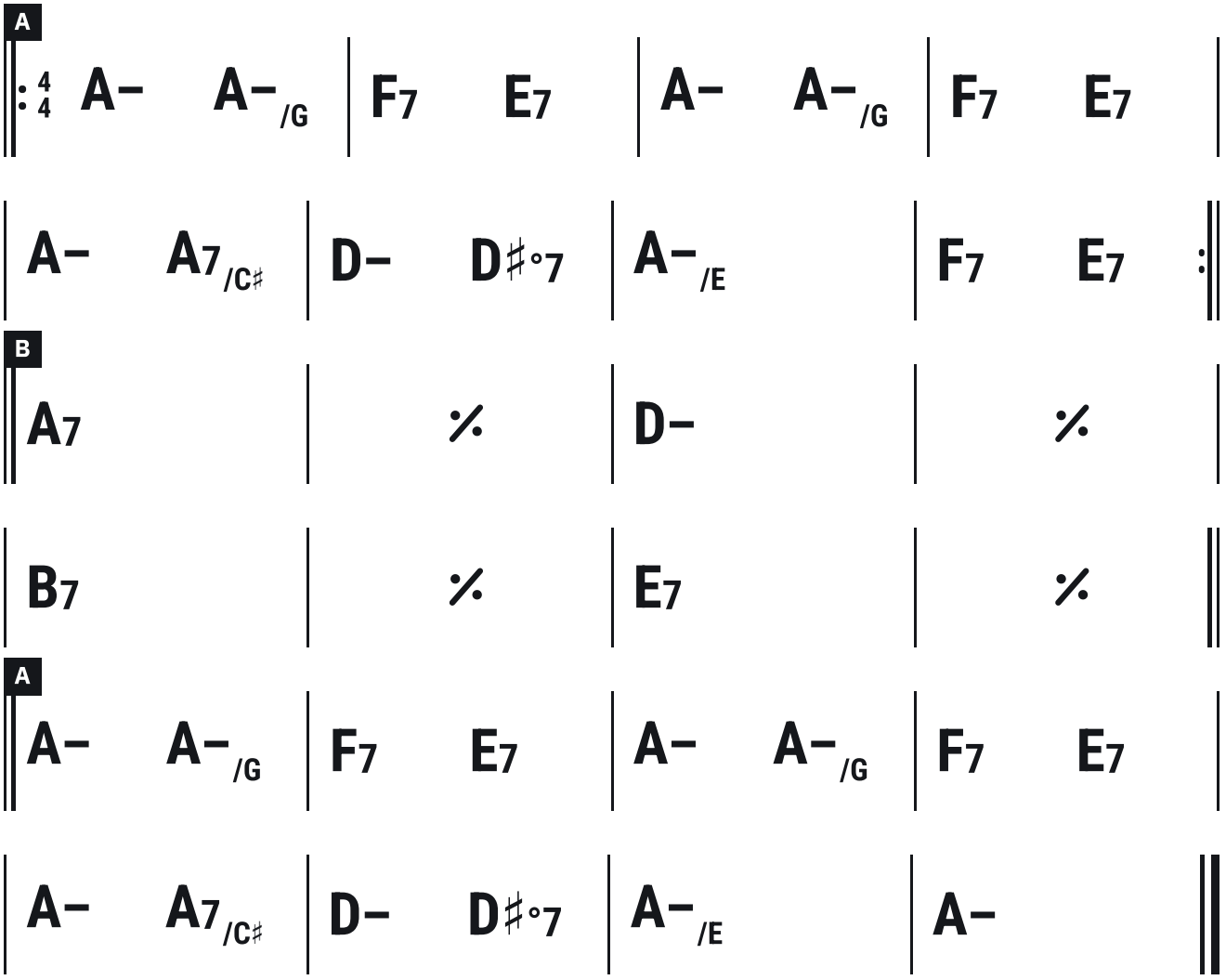
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A–	A C E
E7	E G♯ B D
A–/G	A C E
F7	F A C E♭
A7	A C♯ E G
D6	D F♯ A B
B–7	B D F♯ A
C–6	C E♭ G A
A–6	A C E F♯

(Medium Swing)

Lester's Bounce

Your band's chart (Bob Wilber / Antti Sarpila recording)



Written key **A–** Concert **G–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written

Lester's Bounce · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- Clarinet-and-soprano phrasing (Wilber & Sarpila) is the model: the riff sits on the beat, the answer in bars 5–7 climbs with the bass; play the climb (A C♯ D D♯ E) in unison with the rhythm section.
- Solos: A minor pentatonic and blues over bars 1–4 (the bass line A G F E is the hook); bars 5–7 follow the bass climb A C♯ D D♯ E; F7 E7: A then G♯.
- Bridge: A7 (C♯, G) for two, D minor pentatonic for two, B7 (D♯) for two, E7 (G♯) for two. The 4-bar intro vamp is the A loop: come in with the riff on the fifth bar.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**A–**	C E	**A–**/G	C E	**F7**	A E♭	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**/C♯	C♯ G	**D–**	F A	**D♯°7**	F♯ C	**A–**/E	C E
B	**A7**	C♯ G	**D–**	F A	**B7**	D♯ A	**E7**	G♯ D

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A minor riff, chromatic bass in bars 5–7

A minor pentatonic and blues scale over bars 1–4; the bass line A – G – F – E is the hook. Bars 5–7: A7/C♯ (C♯ natural) → D– → D♯°7 (D♯) → A–/E: play the bass line's climb A C♯ D D♯ E in your line and the chords take care of themselves. F7 E7 at the end: A on the F7, G♯ on the E7.

B

Honeysuckle bridge in minor: A7 → D– → B7 → E7

A7 (C♯ , G) for two, D minor pentatonic for two, B7 (D♯) for two, E7 (G♯) for two. Same shape as the Honeysuckle Rose bridge with the IV turned minor.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Your chart is the source. Bar 6 D♯°7 can be played as B7/D♯; the bridge A7 as A7♭9 for the darker sound.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · A minor pent A C D E G

A · A blues scale A C D E♭ E G

B bars 3–4 · D minor pent D F G A C

B · B7: B major pent B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯
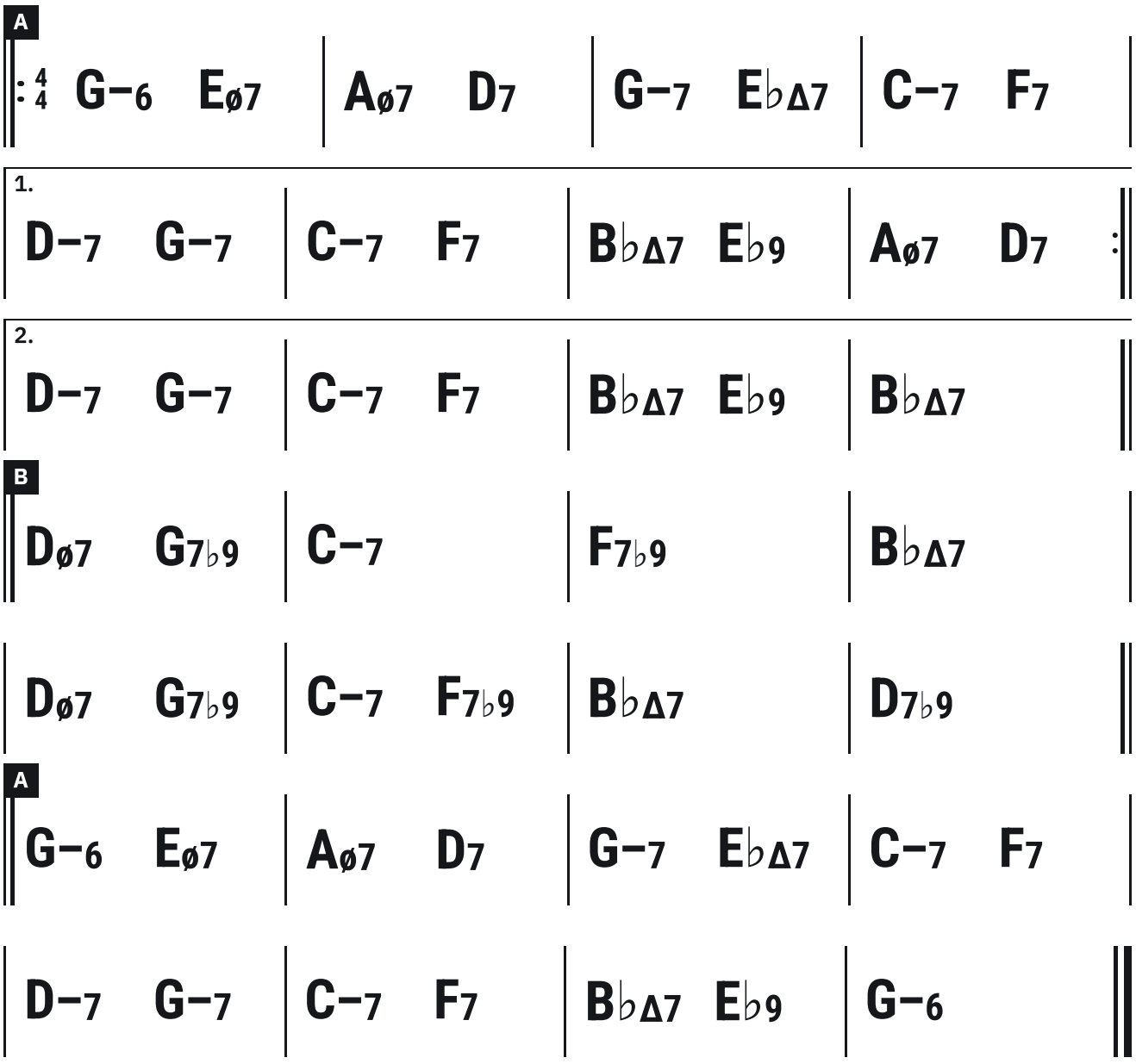
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A–	A C E
A–/G	A C E
F7	F A C E♭
E7	E G♯ B D
A7/C♯	A C♯ E G
D–	D F A
D♯°7	D♯ F♯ A C
A–/E	A C E
A7	A C♯ E G
B7	B D♯ F♯ A

(Medium Swing)

Lullaby of Birdland

George Shearing



Written key **G– / B♭** Concert **F– / A♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **150–200 bpm**

Written **1952**

Lullaby of Birdland · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- Bars 1–2 are G minor (F♯ on the D7), bar 3 onward is B♭ major: the melody's leap in bar 3 marks the key change; play it as a lift.
- Solos: G harmonic minor over Eø7 Aø7 D7 (bars 1–2), then B♭ major pentatonic for everything else; E♭9 in bar 7 wants D♭, Aø7 D7 at the end wants E♭ then F♯.
- Bridge: B♭ major throughout; on each G7♭9 play B natural and A♭, on F7♭9 A and G♭. The last bar's D7♭9 (F♯, E♭) is the door back to G minor.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **G−6** B♭ E **Eø7** G B♭ D **Aø7** C E♭ G **D7** F♯ C **G−7** B♭ F **E♭Δ7** G D **C−7** E♭ B♭ **F7** A E♭ **D−7** F C **B♭Δ7** D A **E♭9** G D♭

B **Dø7** F A♭ C **G7♭9** A♭ B F **C−7** E♭ B♭ **F7♭9** G♭ A E♭ **B♭Δ7** D A **D7♭9** E♭ F♯ C

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G minor for two bars, B♭ major for the rest

G harmonic minor over Eø7–Aø7–D7 (F♯ natural is the note). From bar 3 think B♭ major pentatonic: C–7 F7 B♭ and D–7 G–7 C–7 F7 are all one scale. E♭9 in bar 7: D♭ . Aø7 D7 at the end: E♭ then F♯ .

B

B♭ major, iii–VI–ii–V–I twice

B♭ major pentatonic for the whole bridge; on each G7♭9 play B natural and A♭ , on F7♭9 play A and G♭ . The last bar's D7♭9 (F♯ , E♭) is the door back to G minor.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as A7♭9 D7♭9 · bars 3–4 as G–7 C–7 | F7 B♭Δ7 (Real-Book shape) · bridge bars 1–2 as B♭Δ7 | B♭Δ7 in older charts.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A bars 1–2 · G harmonic minor G A B♭ C D E♭ F♯

A, B · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

over G–6 · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G−6	G B♭ D E
Eø7	E G B♭ D
Aø7	A C E♭ G
D7	D F♯ A C
G−7	G B♭ D F
E♭Δ7	E♭ G B♭ D
C−7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
D−7	D F A C
B♭Δ7	B♭ D F A
E♭9	E♭ F G B♭ D♭
Dø7	D F A♭ C
G7♭9	G A♭ B D F
F7♭9	F G♭ A C E♭
D7♭9	D E♭ F♯ A C

(Slow Shuffle)

Moanin'

Bobby Timmons



Written key **G–** Concert **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Slow lindy / blues shuffle** Dance tempo **100–125 bpm**

Written **1958**

Moanin' · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The head is call-and-response: the piano calls, you answer in unison in bars 2, 4, 6 with the two-note 'amen' figure (B natural, the major 3rd, against the minor call); play it fat and together.
- Solos: G minor blues scale and G dorian over everything; target F♯ (3rd of D7) at the end of each two-bar unit and slide back to B♭. Gospel grace notes: A into B♭, C♯ into D.
- Bridge: C–7 B♭7 | A7 D7 | G–7 | G7 | C–7 B♭7 | A7 | D7 | D7: lean on the 3rds E♭ D C♯ F♯; two whole bars of D7 at the end, so say something and leave space.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**G–7**	B♭ F	**B♭7**	D A♭	**A∅7**	C E♭ G	**D7**	F♯ C	**A–7**	C G	**B–7**	D A
B	**C–7**	E♭ B♭	**B♭7**	D A♭	**A7**	C♯ G	**D7**	F♯ C	**G–7**	B♭ F	**G7**	B F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G minor blues, chromatic dominants underneath

G minor blues scale and G dorian over everything; the B♭7 – A7 – D7 chain is just a bass line under the blues scale. Target F♯ natural (3rd of D7) at the end of each two-bar unit, then slide back to B♭. Gospel grace notes: A into B♭, C♯ into D.

B

C–7 → B♭7 → A7 → D7, then V

Descending bass C – B♭ – A, then D7. Lean on 3rds: E♭ D C♯ F♯. G7 in bar 4 is V of C–: B natural and F. Second half opens out: two whole bars of D7, so say something and leave space.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Some charts keep the solo A as plain G–7 for eight bars · answer sometimes written C | G7 · bridge bar 4 as G7♭9.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

A · G blues scale G B♭ C D♭ D F

B · C minor pent C E♭ F G B♭

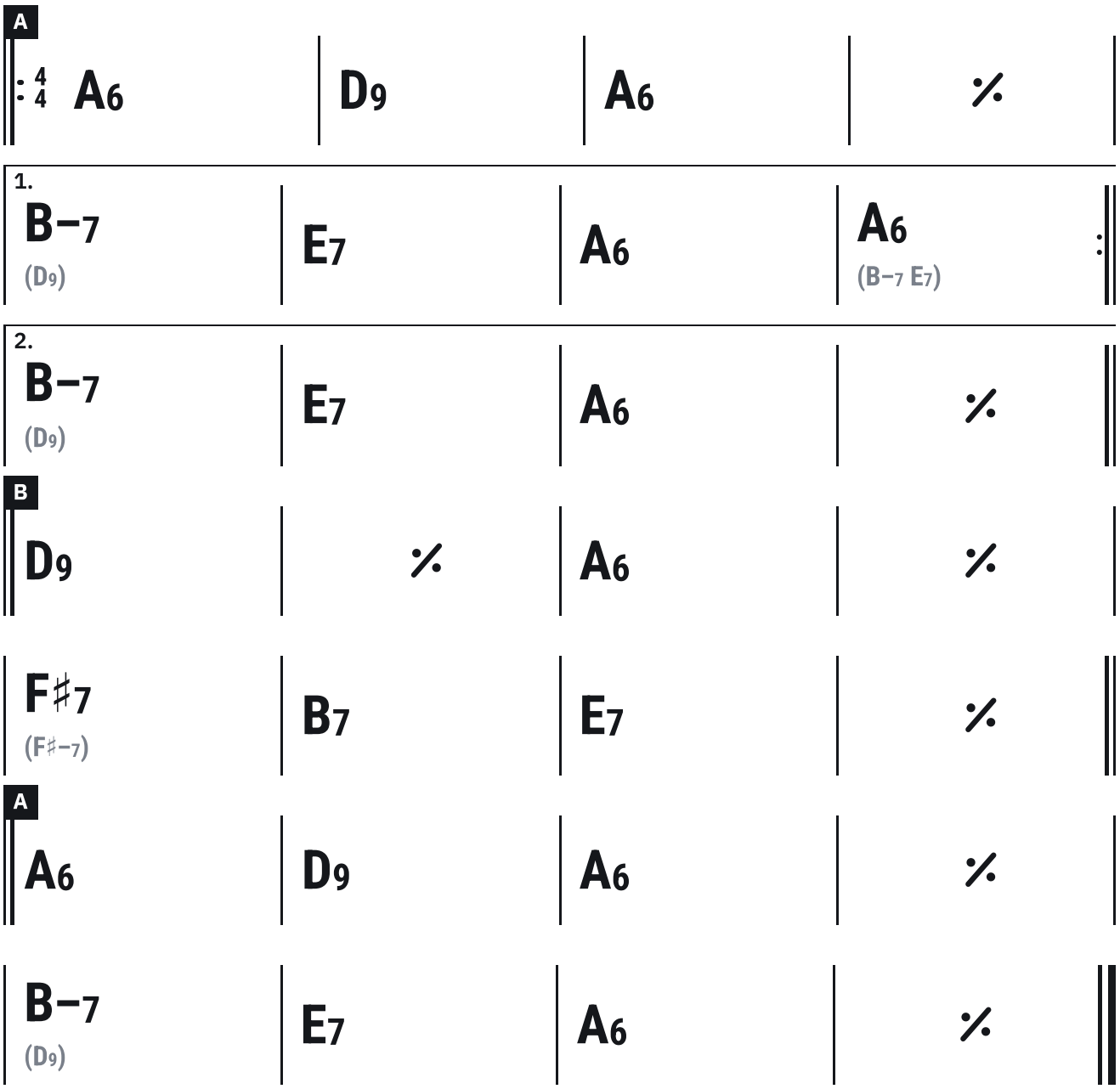
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G–7	G B♭ D F
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
A∅7	A C E♭ G
D7	D F♯ A C
A–7	A C E G
B–7	B D F♯ A
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
A7	A C♯ E G
G7	G B D F

(Medium Swing)

Oh, Lady Be Good

George & Ira Gershwin



Written key **A** Concert **G** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1924**

Oh, Lady Be Good · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- Lester Young 1936 is the whole language for this tune: light, behind the beat, A major pentatonic with the blues scale, phrases that start late in the bar.
- Bar 2 (D9): the C against the band's C♯ is the blues in the tune; bars 5–6 (B–7 E7): G rising to G♯.
- Bridge: D major for two bars (C on the D9), A for two, then F♯7 → B7 → E7: A♯, D♯, G♯ on the downbeats and you've played the bridge.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**A6**	C♯ F♯	**D9**	F♯ C	**B–7**	D A	**E7**	G♯ D			
B	**D9**	F♯ C	**A6**	C♯ F♯	**F♯7**	A♯ E	**B7**	D♯ A	**E7**	G♯ D	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A major, four bars, then a ii–V

A major pentatonic plus the blues scale; the D9's C against the band's C♯ is the blues in bar 2. Bars 5–6, B–7 E7: G rising to G♯.

B

IV, I, then VI7 → II7 → V7

D major for two bars (D9: C), A for two, then the chain: F♯7 wants A♯, B7 wants D♯, E7 wants G♯. Play those three notes on the downbeats and you've played the bridge.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 5 as B7 or D9 · bridge bars 1–2 as A7 | A7 (Honeysuckle shape) · bar 8 of A2 as E7 into the bridge.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

A · A blues scale A C D E♭ E G

B bars 1–2 · D major pent D E F♯ A B

B · B7: B major pent B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯

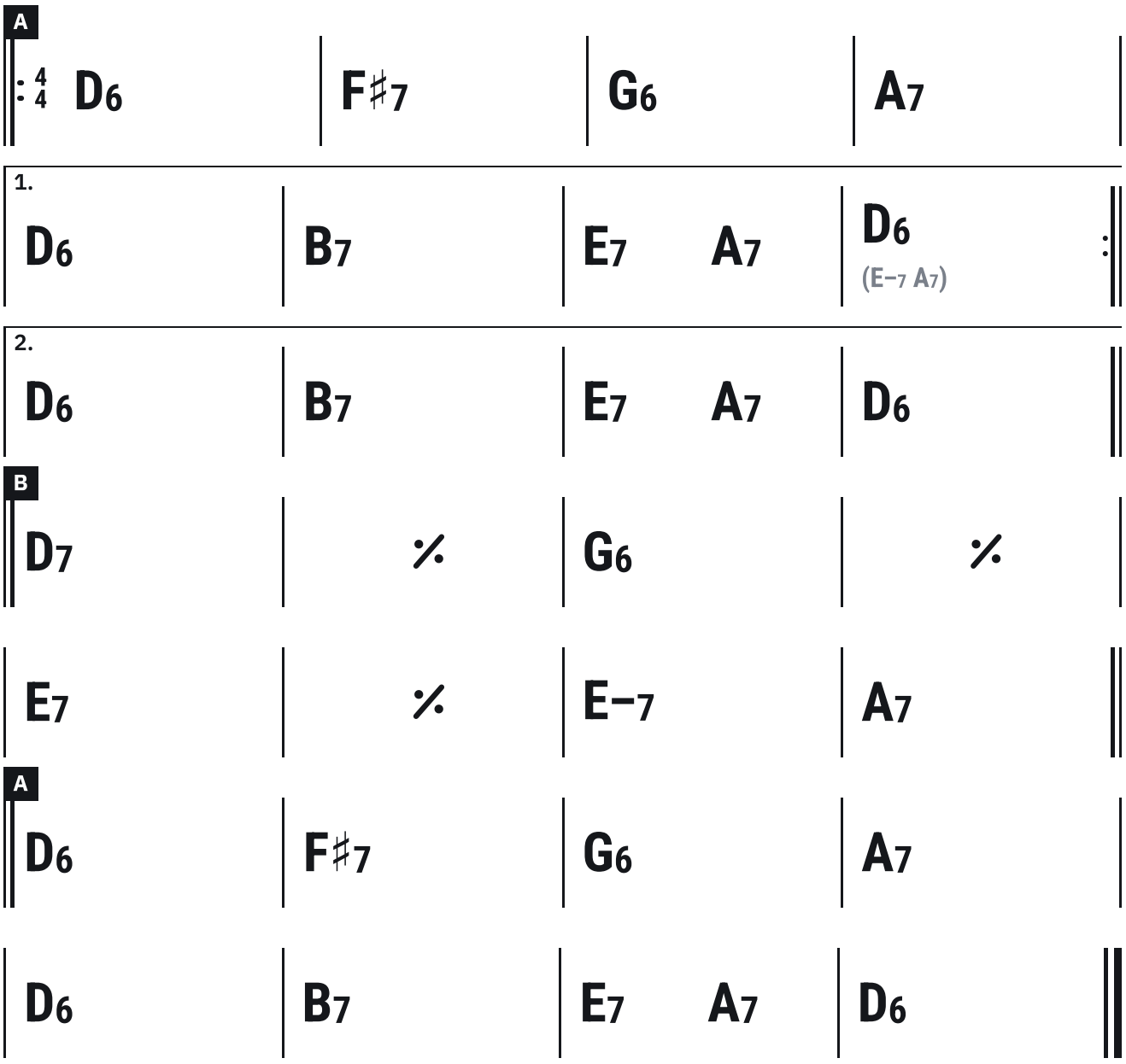
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A6	A C♯ E F♯
D9	D E F♯ A C
B–7	B D F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E
F♯–7	F♯ A C♯ E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A

(Medium Swing)

On the Sunny Side of the Street

Jimmy McHugh & Dorothy Fields



Written key **D** Concert **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lazy lindy / blues** Dance tempo **110–140 bpm**

Written **1930**

On the Sunny Side of the Street · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- Lay back: the melody sits behind the beat at 120, and the long notes in bars 1 and 5 (D6) want a slow vibrato at the end.
- Three dominants, three notes: A♯ on F♯7 (bar 2), D♯ on B7 (bar 6), G♯ on E7 (bar 7). Hit those on the beat and the tune is in the room; D major pentatonic covers the rest.
- Bridge: D7 (C) for two bars, G for two, E7 (G♯) for two, E–7 A7 home; the D blues scale sits fine over the first four bars.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	D6 F♯ B	F♯7 A♯ E	G6 B E	A7 C♯ G	B7 D♯ A	E7 G♯ D			
B	D7 F♯ C	G6 B E	E7 G♯ D	E–7 G D	A7 C♯ G				

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D major, bending three notes in

D major pentatonic all the way, except the three dominants that each ask for one note: F♯7 wants A♯ (bar 2), B7 wants D♯ (bar 6), E7 wants G♯ (bar 7). Hit those on the beat and the tune is in the room.

B

D7 → G → E7 → E–7 A7

D mixolydian (C) for two bars, G major for two, E7 (G♯) for two, then ii–V home. D blues scale sits fine over the first four bars.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–7 also played B–7 | E7 | E–7 A7 · bridge as A–7 D7 | A–7 D7 | G6 | G6 | B–7 E7 | B–7 E7 | E–7 | A7, or ending E7 | E7 | A7 | A7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D major pent D E F♯ A B

A, B · D blues scale D F G A♭ A C

B · G major pent G A B D E

B · E7: E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

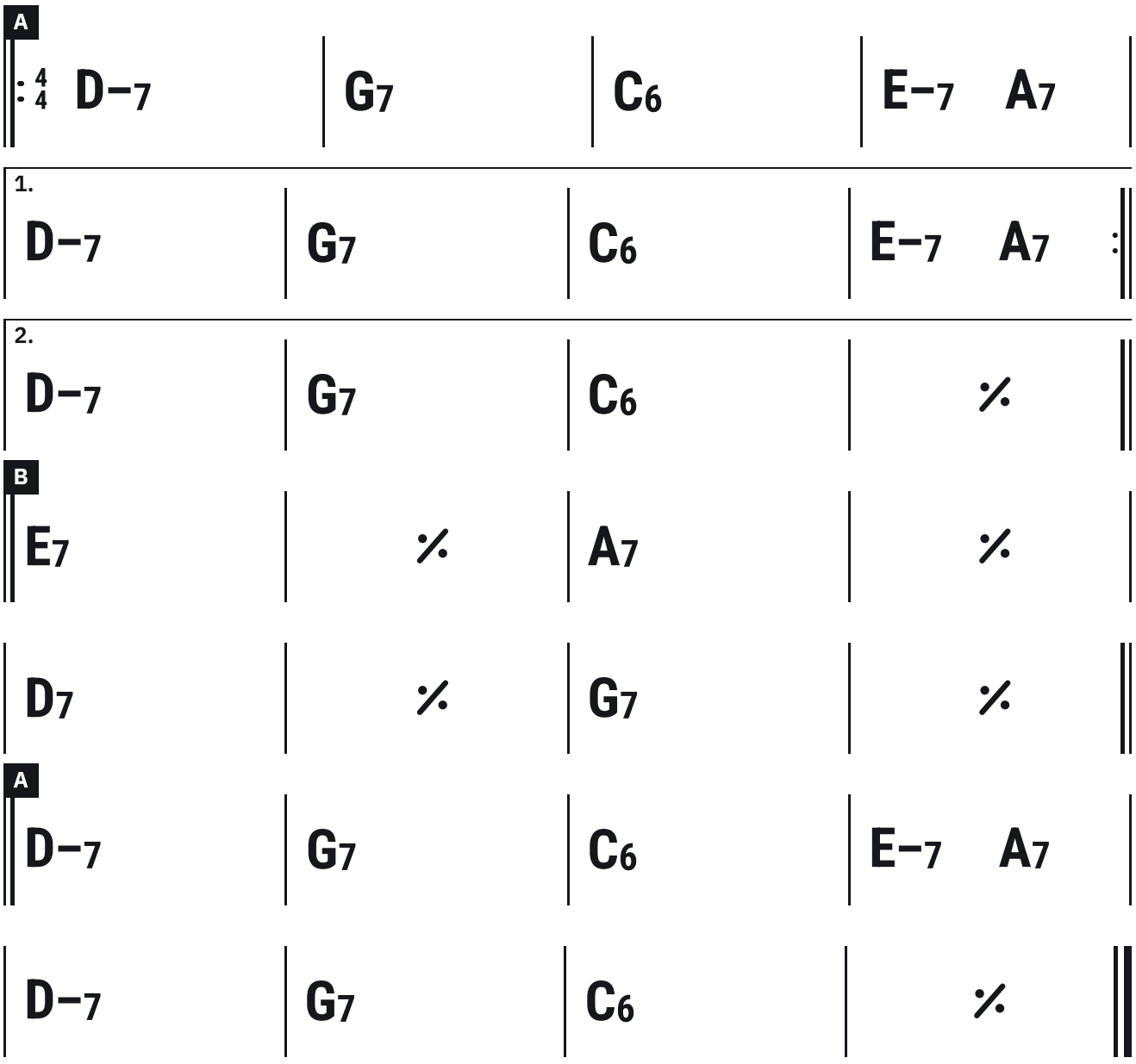
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D6	D F♯ A B
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E
G6	G B D E
A7	A C♯ E G
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
E–7	E G B D
D7	D F♯ A C

(Medium Up Swing)

Perdido

Juan Tizol



Written key **C** Concert **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1941**

Perdido · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The riff (C major pentatonic, two bars long) is the head: in unison, short, and let the rhythm section answer in bars 3–4 (C6 | E–7 A7).
- Solos: C major pentatonic; C♯ on A7 drops you onto D–7 every four bars; the blues scale over the G7s.
- Bridge: the rhythm bridge E7 → A7 → D7 → G7; 3rds G♯ C♯ F♯ B on the downbeats. Anything you play on I Got Rhythm's bridge works here.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D–7**	F C	**G7**	B F	**C6**	E A	**E–7**	G D	**A7**	C♯ G
B	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G	**D7**	F♯ C	**G7**	B F		

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C major with a VI7 pull

The riff is C major pentatonic and so is the solo; the only non-diatonic note you need is C♯ natural on A7, which drops you onto D–7 every four bars. Blues scale over the G7s.

B

The rhythm bridge: E7 A7 D7 G7

Two bars each; targets G♯ C♯ F♯ B. Identical to the I Got Rhythm bridge, so anything you play there works here.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A as C6 | C6 | C6 | C6 | D–7 G7 | D–7 G7 | C6 | C6 in some charts · bridge bar 4 as A7♯5 (Hawkins' rhythm section).

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · C major pent C D E G A

A · C blues scale C E♭ F G♭ G B♭

B · E7: E major pent (then A, C, G) E F♯ G♯ B C♯

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
C6	C E G A
E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G
E7	E G♯ B D
D7	D F♯ A C

(Up Swing)

Puttin' On the Ritz

Irving Berlin



Written key **G– → B♭** Concert **F– → A♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Charleston / Balboa**

Dance tempo **200–240 bpm** Written **1929**

Puttin' On the Ritz · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- Berlin's melody is a minor arpeggio displaced across the barline: count it, don't feel it, until it's in your body; the rhythm is the tune.
- A: G minor pentatonic and blues; F♯ on D7 (bars 4–5), the E♭7 → D7 slide in bar 7. Bridge: B♭ major for seven bars (C–7 F7 B♭6 twice), bright and legato, then E♭7 D7: land F♯ on the D7.
- Breathe in bar 8 of each A (G–, held): the melody rests there and the Charleston tempo gives you nothing else.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **G–** B♭ D **D7** F♯ C **E♭7** G D♭

B **C–7** E♭ B♭ **F7** A E♭ **B♭6** D G **E♭7** G D♭ **D7** F♯ C

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G minor, D7 = G harmonic minor

G minor pentatonic and blues scale on the G– bars; on D7, F♯ natural with E♭ (G harmonic minor). The E♭7 – D7 slide: E♭7's G/D♭ falls to D7's F♯ /C. Berlin's melody is a minor arpeggio shifted across the bar; shift your own three-note cell the same way.

B

Relative major B♭: ii–V–I twice

C dorian, F mixolydian and B♭ major are one scale: B♭ major. Play sunlight for seven bars, then E♭7 – D7 slams the door back to G–; land on F♯ for the D7.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bar 4–5 as one bar D7 and one bar G– in some charts · bridge ending as E♭7 | D7 over two bars.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

A, over D7 · G harmonic minor G A B♭ C D E♭ F♯

B · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

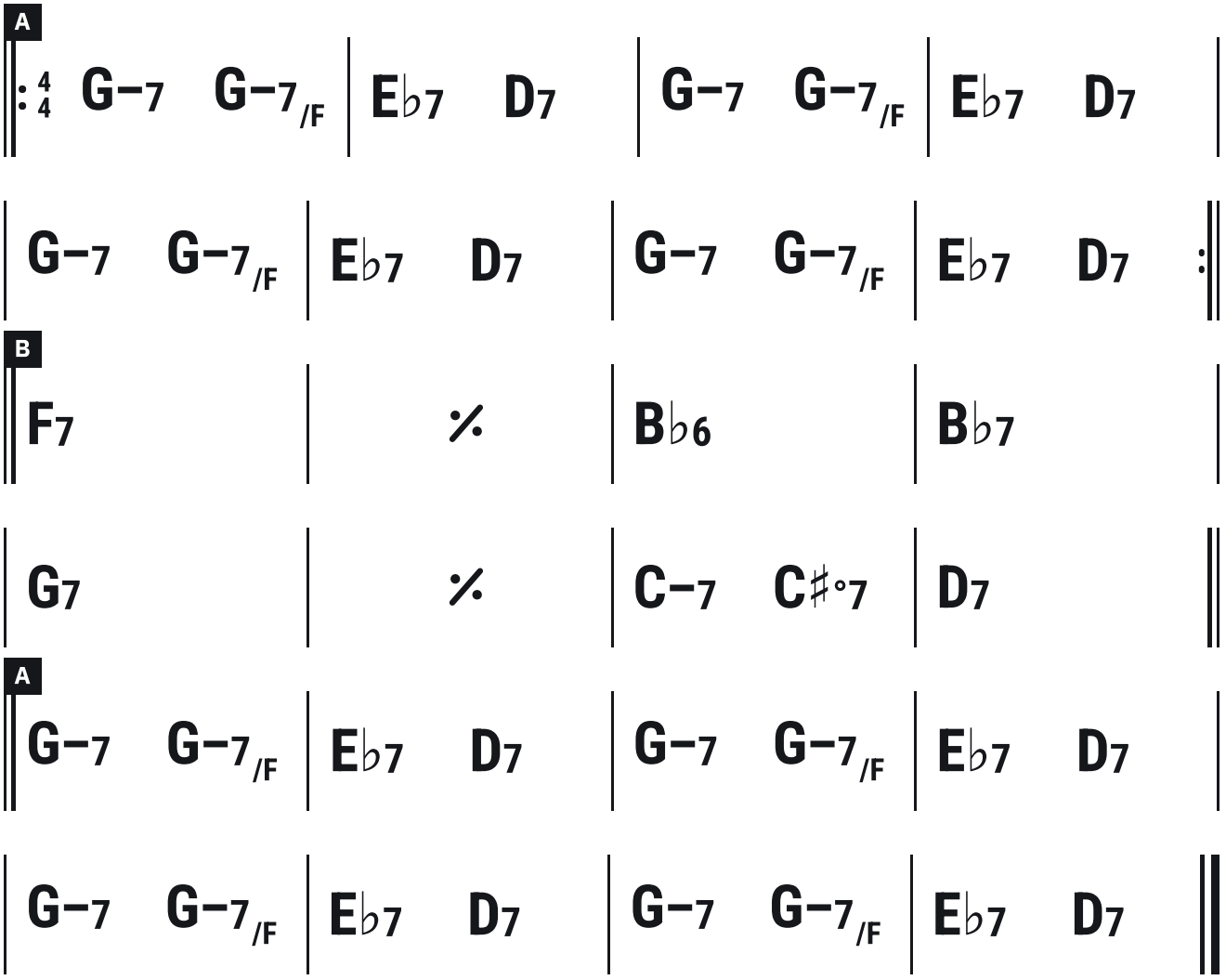
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G–	G B♭ D
D7	D F♯ A C
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
B♭6	B♭ D F G

(Up Swing)

Ridin' and Jivin'

Earl Hines, your band's chart



Written key **G–** Concert **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Fast lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **150 bpm**

Written **1939**

Ridin' and Jivin' · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The loop is a four-chord riff (i, i/♭7, ♭VI7, V7): the head is a riff on it, so play short notes in unison and let the bass line G – F – E♭ – D be the floor.
- Solos: G minor pentatonic and blues all the way; E♭ on E♭7 and F♯ on D7 when you want to name the chords. Bridge: F7 (E♭, A), B♭ then B♭7 (A♭), G7 (B natural: two bars of major in a minor tune), then C–7 C♯°7 D7: E♭ → E → F♯, a chromatic climb into the last A.
- The bridge is marked 'slide in G slooow' on the score: a glissando into the G7 bars. The post-intro is eight bars of the loop with the horns riffing before the head.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **G–7** B♭ F **G–7/F** B♭ F **E♭7** G D♭ **D7** F♯ C

B **F7** A E♭ **B♭6** D G **B♭7** D A♭ **G7** B F **C–7** E♭ B♭ **C♯°7** E B♭ **D7** F♯ C

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G minor over a four-chord loop

G minor pentatonic and blues scale all the way; the loop's bass line G – F – E♭ – D is the hook. Name the chords when you want to: E♭ on E♭7, F♯ natural on D7, then back to B♭.

B

♭VII7 → ♭III → I7 → iv → V

F7: F mixolydian (E♭ , A). B♭ then B♭7 (A♭). G7 is the surprise: B natural, two bars of major in a minor tune. C–7 C♯°7 D7: E♭ → E → F♯ , a chromatic climb into the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Your chart is the source. Hines's record has more passing chords in the bridge; the bass line is the same.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

A · G blues scale G B♭ C D♭ D F

B · B♭ major pent (F7, B♭) B♭ C D F G

B bars 5–6 · G major pent (G7) G A B D E

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G–7	G B♭ D F
G–7/F	G B♭ D F
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
D7	D F♯ A C
F7	F A C E♭
B♭6	B♭ D F G
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
G7	G B D F
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
C♯°7	C♯ E G B♭

(Medium Swing)

Satin Doll

Duke Ellington & Billy Strayhorn



Written key **D** Concert **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / slow swing** Dance tempo **130–160 bpm**

Written **1953**

Satin Doll · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The melody is the same two-note figure moved up by step (E–7 A7 → F♯–7 B7): play the second one exactly like the first, a step higher, and the tune is instantly recognisable.
- Solos: think the target key of each ii–V: D major on E–7 A7, E major (D♯, G♯) on F♯–7 B7, A major (G♯) on B–7 E7, A♭ major (D♭, G) on B♭–7 E♭7, then D.
- Bridge: G major (C on the D7) for four bars, A major (G♯) on B–7 E7, then two bars of A7: G natural, and leave space for the drummer.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **E–7** G D **A7** C♯ G **F♯–7** A E **B7** D♯ A **B–7** D A **E7** G♯ D **B♭–7** D♭ A♭ **E♭7** G D♭ **D6** F♯ B

B **A–7** C G **D7** F♯ C **G6** B E **B–7** D A **E7** G♯ D **A7** C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

Think the target key of each ii–V

E–7 A7: D major pentatonic. F♯–7 B7: E major pentatonic (D♯ , G♯). B–7 E7: A major pentatonic (G♯). B♭–7 E♭7: A♭ major pentatonic (D♭ , G), which lands you a half step above D so the resolution is physical. Then D.

B

G major, then A major, then V

A–7 D7 G: G major pentatonic (C on the D7). B–7 E7: A major pentatonic (G♯). Two bars of A7: G natural, and leave space for the drummer.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

First-B bar 8 as F♯–7 B7 · bar 6 as E–7 A7 (the sheet) instead of the tritone sub · bridge bars 7–8 as E–7 A7 | E–7 A7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

E–7 A7 · D major pent D E F♯ A B

F♯–7 B7 · E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

B–7 E7 · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

B♭–7 E♭7 · A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

B · G major pent G A B D E
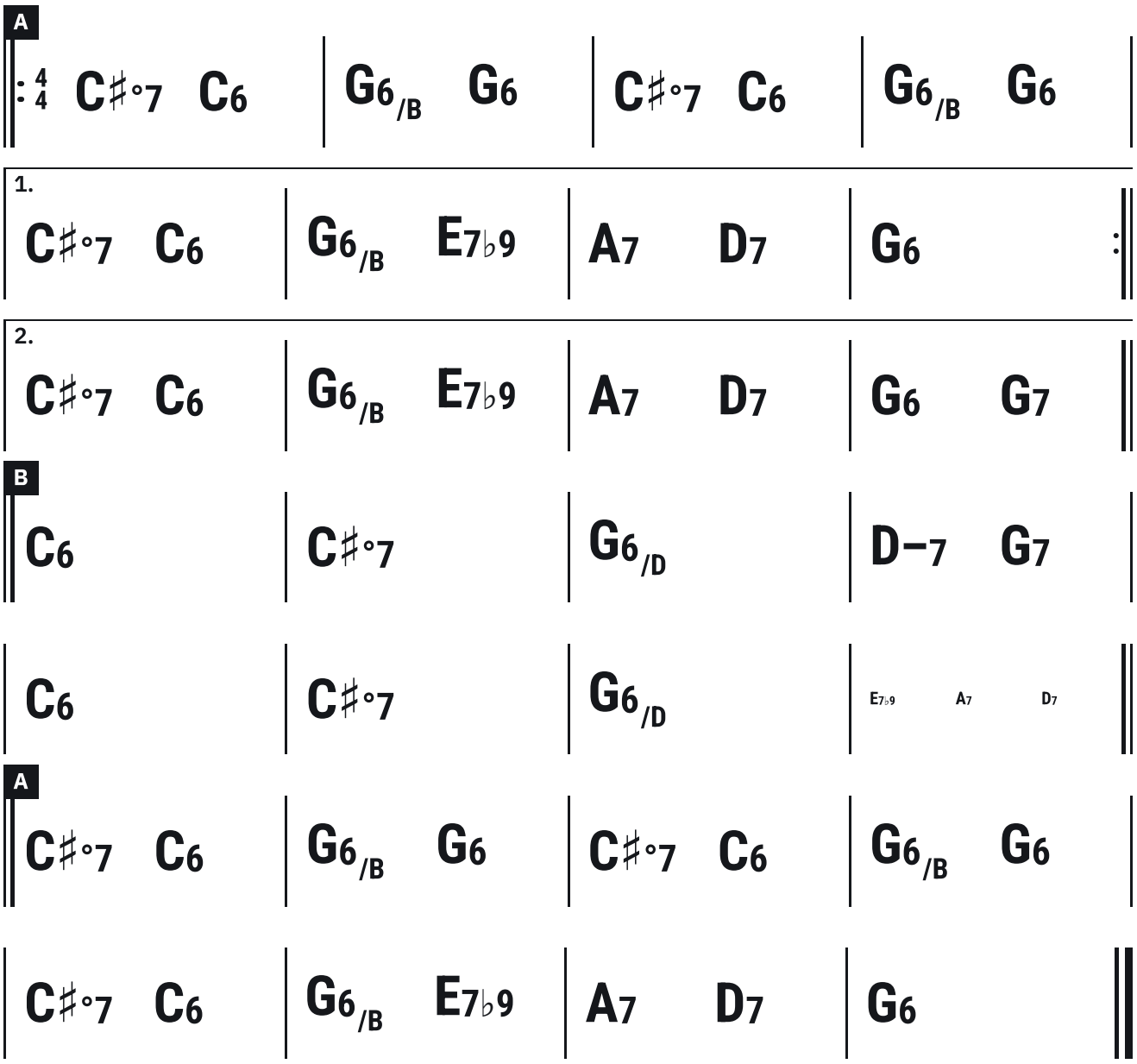
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G
F♯–7	F♯ A C♯ E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
B–7	B D F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
B♭–7	B♭ D♭ F A♭
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
D6	D F♯ A B
A–7	A C E G
D7	D F♯ A C
G6	G B D E

(Medium Swing)

A Smooth One

Benny Goodman & Charlie Christian



Written key **G** Concert **F** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lazy lindy** Dance tempo **120 bpm** Written **1941**

A Smooth One · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The riff is the melody and it sits on the bass line C♯ – C – B – G: legato and lazy at 120, Goodman Sextet style; the clarinet or sax leads, the trumpet doubles an octave below.
- Solos: G major pentatonic over the riff; C♯°7 on C♯°7, G♯ and F on E7♭9, C♯ on A7, F♯ on D7. Bridge: C major pentatonic over C6, C♯°7, G6/D; D–7 G7 is a backdoor ii–V back to C (F); the last bar's E7♭9 A7 D7 wants G♯ C♯ F♯, one per chord, on the beat.
- Intro: 8 bars of piano and drums, you enter at the top of the A; the second ending (G6 G7) leads into the bridge. The tag has an N.C. pickup bar: breathe, then play it.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	C♯°7	E B♭	C6	E A	G6/B	B E	G6	B E	E7♭9	F G♯ D	A7	C♯ G	D7	F♯ C	G7	B F
B	C6	E A	C♯°7	E B♭	G6/D	B E	D–7	F C	G7	B F	E7♭9	F G♯ D	A7	C♯ G	D7	F♯ C

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G major over a walking bass riff

G major pentatonic; the riff's bass C♯ – C – B – G is the melody's shadow, so play it in the left hand and solo above it. C♯°7 is an A7♭9 in disguise: C♯ natural. E7♭9 → G♯ and F; A7 → C♯; D7 → F♯.

B

The riff from IV, then three dominants in a bar

C major pentatonic over C6, C♯°7 and G6/D; D–7 G7 is a backdoor ii–V back to C (F). The last bar, E7♭9 A7 D7: G♯ C♯ F♯, one per chord, on the beat.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Jam charts read the A as G | G7/D C♯°7 | C–6 G/A: C–6 is the ear's version of your C6 under the melody's E natural · session key G; the Goodman/Christian record may be in B♭.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G major pent	G A B D E
A · G blues scale	G B♭ C D♭ D F
B · C major pent	C D E G A

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

C♯°7	C♯ E G B♭
C6	C E G A
G6/B	G B D E
G6	G B D E
E7♭9	E F G♯ B D
A7	A C♯ E G
D7	D F♯ A C
G7	G B D F
G6/D	G B D E
D–7	D F A C

(Latin / Swing)

Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise

Sigmund Romberg



Written key **C−** Concert **B♭−** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Balboa 180–210 · Lindy** Dance tempo **160–190 bpm**

Written **1928**

Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- One minor ii–V–i eight times under a melody that barely moves: a dark, straight tone on the Latin A, then open up and swing on the bridge.
- Solos: treat the A as one C minor zone (C minor pentatonic and blues, the MJQ way), or name the changes: A natural on C–6, A♭ and B on G7. Bridge: E♭ major for two bars, C7♭9 (E natural, D♭) pulling to F–7 (A♭ major pentatonic), then D7 or Dø7 (F♯ or F) into G7♭9 (B, A♭) home. Target 3rds: G → E → A♭ → F♯ → B.
- Sonny Rollins at the Village Vanguard is the tempo and phrasing reference; he plays it a whole step above this key, so lines lifted from the record come down a step.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**C–6**	E♭ A	**Dø7**	F A♭ C	**G7**	B F	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**B♭7**	D A♭					
B	**E♭6**	G C	**C7♭9**	D♭ E B♭	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**Dø7**	F A♭ C	**G7♭9**	A♭ B F					

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

One minor ii–V–i, eight times

C–6 = C melodic minor / C dorian; the A natural is the MJQ colour. G7 = C harmonic minor: A♭ and B. Or do what the MJQ did and treat the A as one C minor zone: C minor pentatonic and blues scale straight across, resolving to E♭ or G on each C–6. Tritone sub to try: A♭7 for Dø7–G7.

B

Relative major: E♭ → C7♭9 → F– → D7 → G7♭9

E♭ major for two bars. C7♭9 = F harmonic minor (E natural, D♭, A♭) pulling to F–7 (F dorian, A♭ major). Then D7 / Dø7 (F♯ or F) into G7♭9 (B + A♭) and back to C–. Target 3rds: G → E → A♭ → F♯ → B.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bridge in the original sheet (transposed): E♭ | E♭ E♭7/D♭ | C7♭9 | C7♭9 | F– F–/E♭ | D7 | G7♭9 | G7♭9 · learnjazzstandards sub: E♭ | Gø7 C7 | F–7 | Aø7 D7 | G7 · session key D–: everything a whole step up.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · C minor pent C E♭ F G B♭

A, over G7 · C harmonic minor C D E♭ F G A♭ B

B bars 1–2 · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

B bars 5–6 · F minor pent F A♭ B♭ C E♭

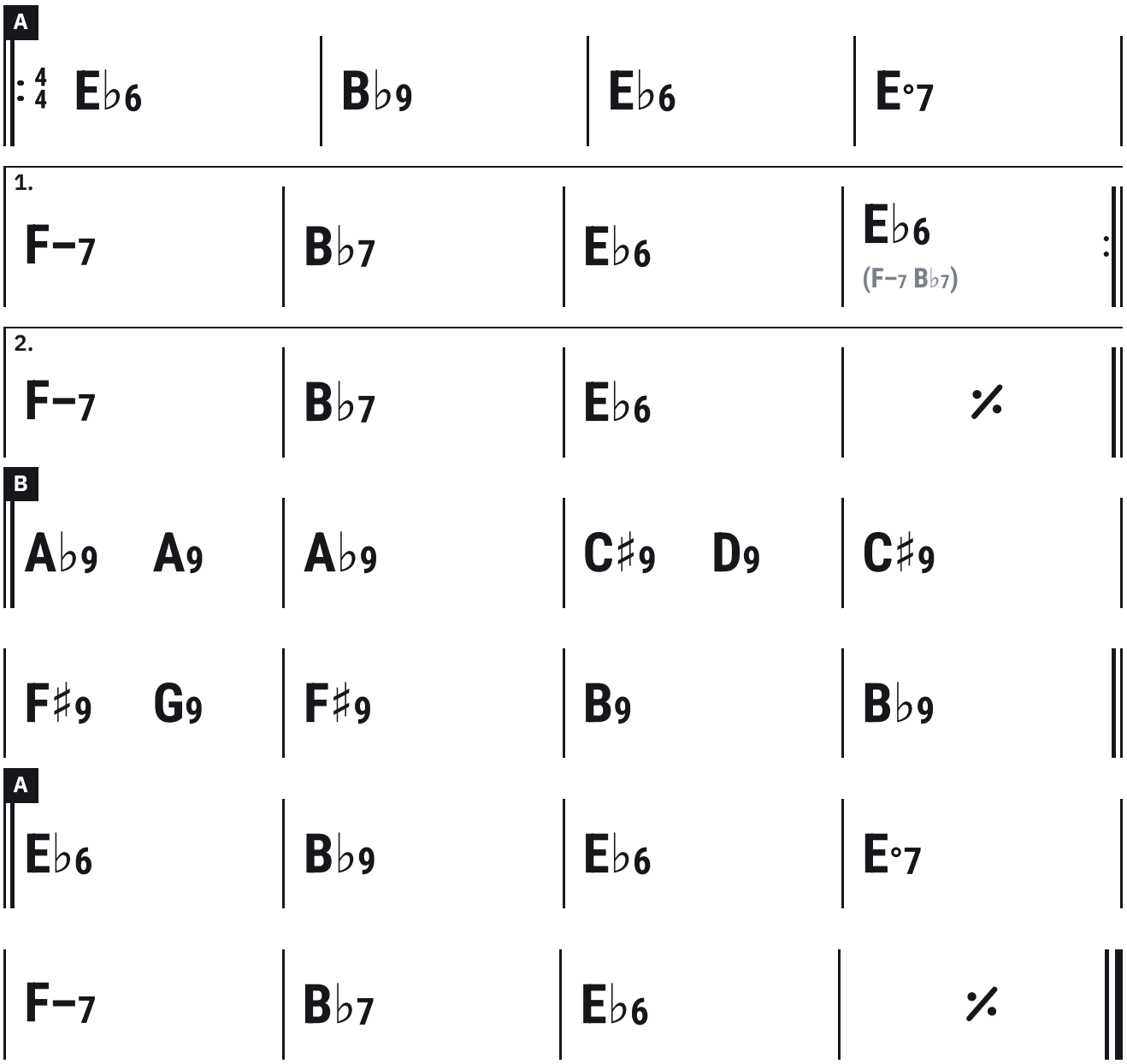
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

C–6	C E♭ G A
Dø7	D F A♭ C
G7	G B D F
F–7	F A♭ C E♭
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
E♭6	E♭ G B♭ C
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
C7♭9	C D♭ E G B♭
F♯°7	F♯ A C E♭
D7	D F♯ A C
G7♭9	G A♭ B D F

(Medium Swing)

Stompin' at the Savoy

Edgar Sampson



Written key **E♭** Concert **D♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy 160–190 · Balboa** Dance tempo **190–220 bpm**

Written **1934**

Stompin' at the Savoy · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The A is a riff in E♭ major pentatonic (plus the blue F♯): short, together, and let the rhythm section's riff answer. The held notes over bars 5–8 are where the Lindy floor breathes.
- Solos: E♭ major pentatonic plus F♯ for the whole A; E natural and C♯ on the E°7 in bar 4 (or think B♭7♭9). Bridge: A♭7 → C♯7 → F♯7 → B7 → B♭7, dominants dropping a fourth; 3rds C F A♯ D♯ D. The 3rd/7th pairs fall a half step each time (C/F♯ → B/F → A♯/E → A/D♯ → A♭/D): play that line alone once and you'll never lose the bridge.
- Ignore the half-step pushes (A9, D9, G9) on beats 3–4 of the bridge's odd bars: they're the rhythm section's, not yours.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**E♭6**	G C	**B♭9**	D A♭	**E°7**	G D♭	**F−7**	A♭ E♭	**B♭7**	D A♭									
B	**A♭9**	C G♭	**A9**	C♯ G	**C♯9**	F B	**D9**	F♯ C	**F♯9**	A♯ E	**G9**	B F	**B9**	D♯ A	**B♭9**	D A♭			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

E♭ major, start to finish

It's a riff tune: E♭ major pentatonic plus the blue F♯ (♭3) covers the whole A. On bar 4, E°7 wants E and C♯ (or think B♭7♭9). Bars 5–6 are a plain ii–V back to E♭.

B

A♭7 → C♯7 → F♯7 → B7 → B♭7

Dominants dropping a fourth. Mixolydian on each. Target the 3rds: C F A♯ D♯ D. The 3rd/7th pairs each fall a half step: C/F♯ → B/F → A♯/E → A/D♯ → A♭/D. Play that line alone once and you'll never lose the bridge again.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bar 2 as E♭6 B♭7 · bars 7–8 as E♭6 C–7 | F–7 B♭7 (the Clifford Brown/Max Roach version).

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

A · E♭ blues scale E♭ G♭ A♭ A B♭ D♭

B · A♭7: A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

B · C♯7: C♯ major pent C♯ D♯ F G♯ A♯

B · F♯7: F♯ major pent F♯ G♯ A♯ C♯ D♯

B · B7: B major pent B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯

B · B♭7: B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

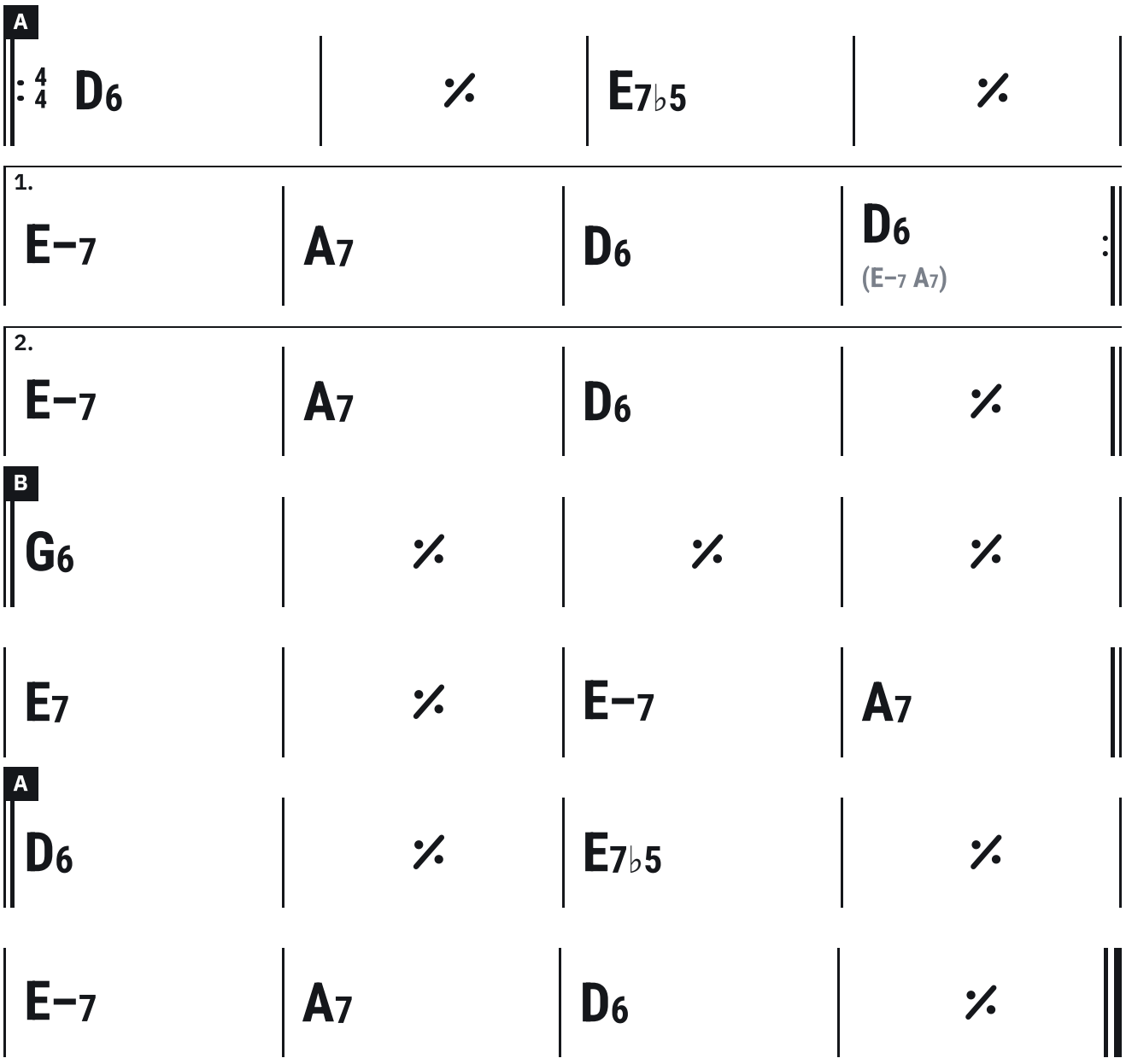
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

E♭6	E♭ G B♭ C
B♭9	B♭ C D F A♭
E°7	E G B♭ D♭
F−7	F A♭ C E♭
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
A♭9	A♭ B♭ C E♭ G♭
A9	A B C♯ E G
C♯9	C♯ D♯ F G♯ B
D9	D E F♯ A C
F♯9	F♯ G♯ A♯ C♯ E
G9	G A B D F
B9	B C♯ D♯ F♯ A

(Medium Up Swing)

Take the “A” Train

Billy Strayhorn



Written key **D** Concert **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1941**

Take the “A” Train · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The long notes in bars 3–4 sit on the E7♭5 (the A♯ is the tune's sound): play them straight and bright; Ray Nance's trumpet lead is the model.
- Solos: D major pentatonic in bars 1–2, E lydian dominant (E F♯ G♯ A♯ B C♯ D) in bars 3–4 with G♯ and A♯ together, plain ii–V–I in bars 5–8. Bridge: four bars of G major, then E7 (G♯, D♯ for lydian colour), E–7 A7 home.
- The ending is a three-note tag repeated, then a ♭VI (B♭6) before the final D6: the tag is a horn line, in unison, and hold the last note through the B♭6.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D6**	F♯ B	**E7♭5**	G♯ B♭ D	**E–7**	G D	**A7**	C♯ G
B	**G6**	B E	**E7**	G♯ D	**E–7**	G D	**A7**	C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D major, with one special chord

Bars 1–2: D major pentatonic. Bars 3–4 are the tune's sound: E lydian dominant (E F♯ G♯ A♯ B C♯ D), the G♯ and A♯ together. Bars 5–8: plain ii–V–I in D.

B

G major (IV), then E7 home

Four bars of G major; then E7 where G♯ is the money note (D♯ for lydian colour), into E–7 A7 and back to D.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 3–4 as E9♯11 · bridge bars 5–6 as E7 | E7♭9 · some charts split A1's last bar as D6 B7 | E–7 A7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D major pent D E F♯ A B

A bars 3–4 · E7♭5 + F♯ E G♯ B♭ D F♯

B · G major pent G A B D E

B · E7: E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯
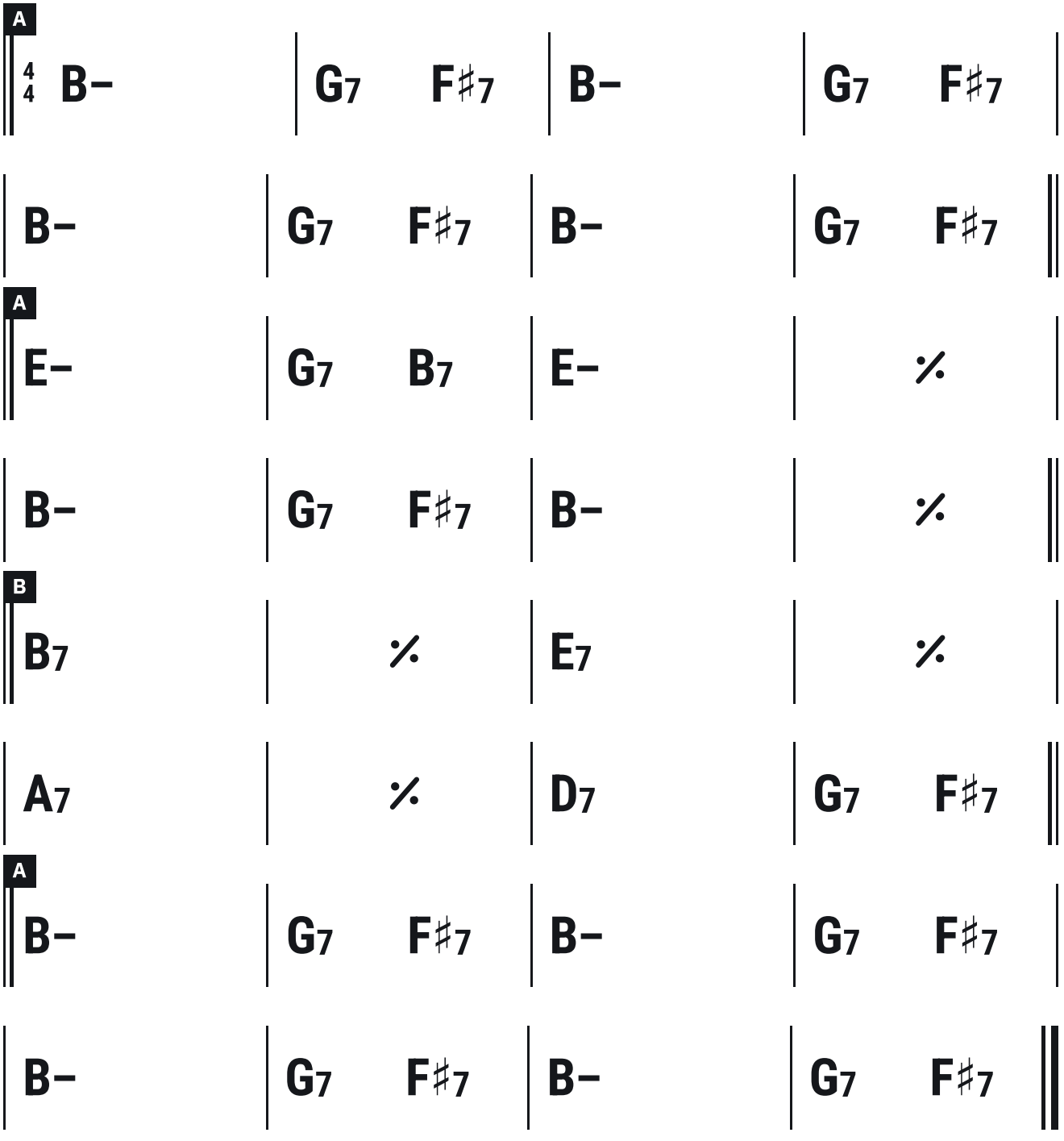
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D6	D F♯ A B
E7♭5	E G♯ B♭ D
E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G
G6	G B D E
E7	E G♯ B D

(Medium Up Swing)

Topsy

Eddie Durham & Edgar Battle (for Count Basie)



Written key **B–** Concert **A–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **165–200 bpm**

Written **1937**

Topsy · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- The riff (B minor pentatonic, two bars) is the head; the G7 F♯7 bars are the rhythm section's answer, so play the riff short and leave the even bars open.
- Bar 16: your pickup A♯ B C♯ into the bridge (over the B–) is on the score, and the bridge figure (♯7 – 1 – 2 of each dominant: A♯ B C♯, D♯ E F♯, G♯ A B, C♯ D E) is the bridge melody; play it in unison.
- Solos: B minor pentatonic and blues on the riff bars; F sliding to E on G7 → F♯7, A♯ on the F♯7; E minor pentatonic for the second A's E– bars (D♯ on the B7 in bar 10). Bridge: D♯, G♯, C♯, F♯ on the downbeats of B7, E7, A7, D7.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**B–**	D F♯	**G7**	B F	**F♯7**	A♯ E	**E–**	G B	**B7**	D♯ A	
B	**B7**	D♯ A	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G	**D7**	F♯ C	**G7**	B F	**F♯7**	A♯ E

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

B minor, with G7 F♯7 every other bar

B minor pentatonic and the B blues scale carry the riff bars. The G7 F♯7 bars are a ♭VI7 → V7 slide: F (the 7th of G7) sliding to E (7th of F♯7), and A♯ on the F♯7 (B harmonic minor). The second A's E– bars: E minor pentatonic, with D♯ on the B7 in bar 10.

B

Cycle of dominants: B7 → E7 → A7 → D7, then G7 F♯7

Two bars each, by their 3rds: D♯ (B7), G♯ (E7), C♯ (A7), F♯ (D7). It's the I Got Rhythm bridge moved up a 5th, so the same lines work. The horns' pickup figure (♯7 – 1 – 2 of each dominant) is the melody; quote it. Bar 24's G7 F♯7 is the slide home.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

The G7 F♯7 bars as plain F♯7 at fast tempos · the second A's E– bars as E–6 · bridge played as B7 | B7 | E7 | E7 | A7 | A7 | D7 | D7 with the G7 F♯7 moved into the pickup bar · last bar as B– when the tune ends.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · B minor pent B D E F♯ A

A · B blues scale B D E F F♯ A

2nd A · E minor pent E G A B D

B · B major pent (then E, A, D) B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯

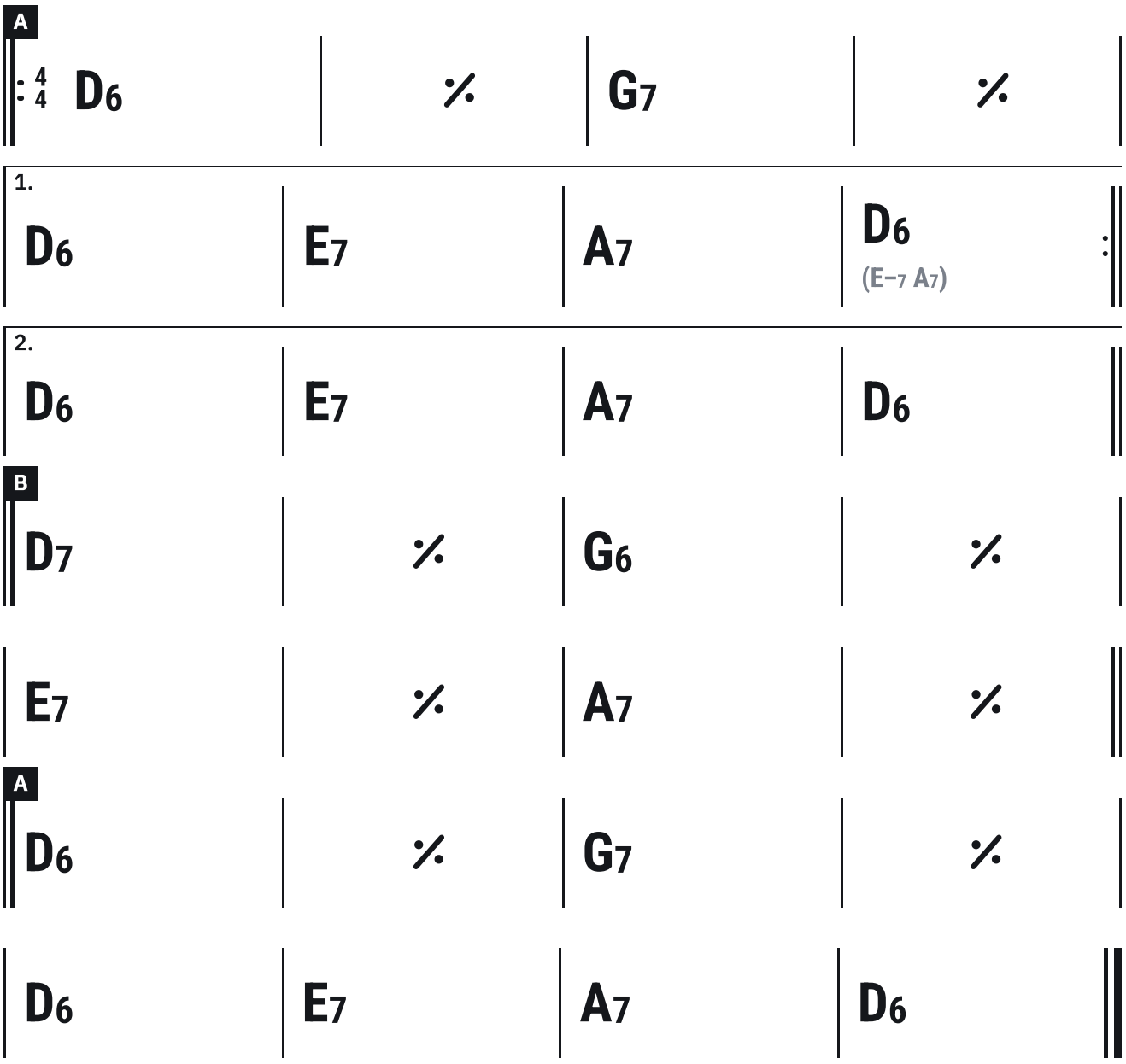
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

B–	B D F♯
G7	G B D F
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E
E–	E G B
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
A7	A C♯ E G
D7	D F♯ A C

(Medium Up Swing)

Undecided

Charlie Shavers



Written key **D** Concert **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1938**

Undecided · Trumpet in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Trumpet in B♭

- Call-and-response head: you state the phrase in bars 1 and 3, the rhythm section answers in bars 2 and 4; keep the phrase short and the gaps empty. Ella's 1939 version is the phrasing reference.
- Solos: D major pentatonic plus the D blues scale; F on the G7 bars (3–4) against the band, G♯ on E7 (bar 6), G on A7. Bridge: D7 (C) for two, G for two, E7 (G♯) for two, A7 home: the Sunny Side bridge, so solos transfer.
- The last A ends on D6 with no turnaround; hold the last note while the rhythm section stops.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D6**	F♯ B	**G7**	B F	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G
B	**D7**	F♯ C	**G6**	B E	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D major with a blues IV

D major pentatonic plus the D blues scale; on the G7 bars play F (its ♭7) against the band. E7 wants G♯, A7 wants G; that's the whole A.

B

D7 → G → E7 → A7

D mixolydian (C) for two, G major for two, E7 (G♯ , D♯ for lydian colour) for two, A7 home. Same bridge as Sunny Side of the Street, so solos transfer.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–7 as E–7 | C7 B♭7 | A7 (the chromatic walk-down in the Ames Brothers / Kirby charts) · bar 8 turnaround optional · bridge bars 7–8 as A7 | B–7 E7 into the last A.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D major pent D E F♯ A B

G7 bars · D blues scale D F G A♭ A C

B · G major pent G A B D E

B · E7: E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D6	D F♯ A B
G7	G B D F
E7	E G♯ B D
A7	A C♯ E G
E–7	E G B D
D7	D F♯ A C
G6	G B D E

ALTO SAX IN E♭
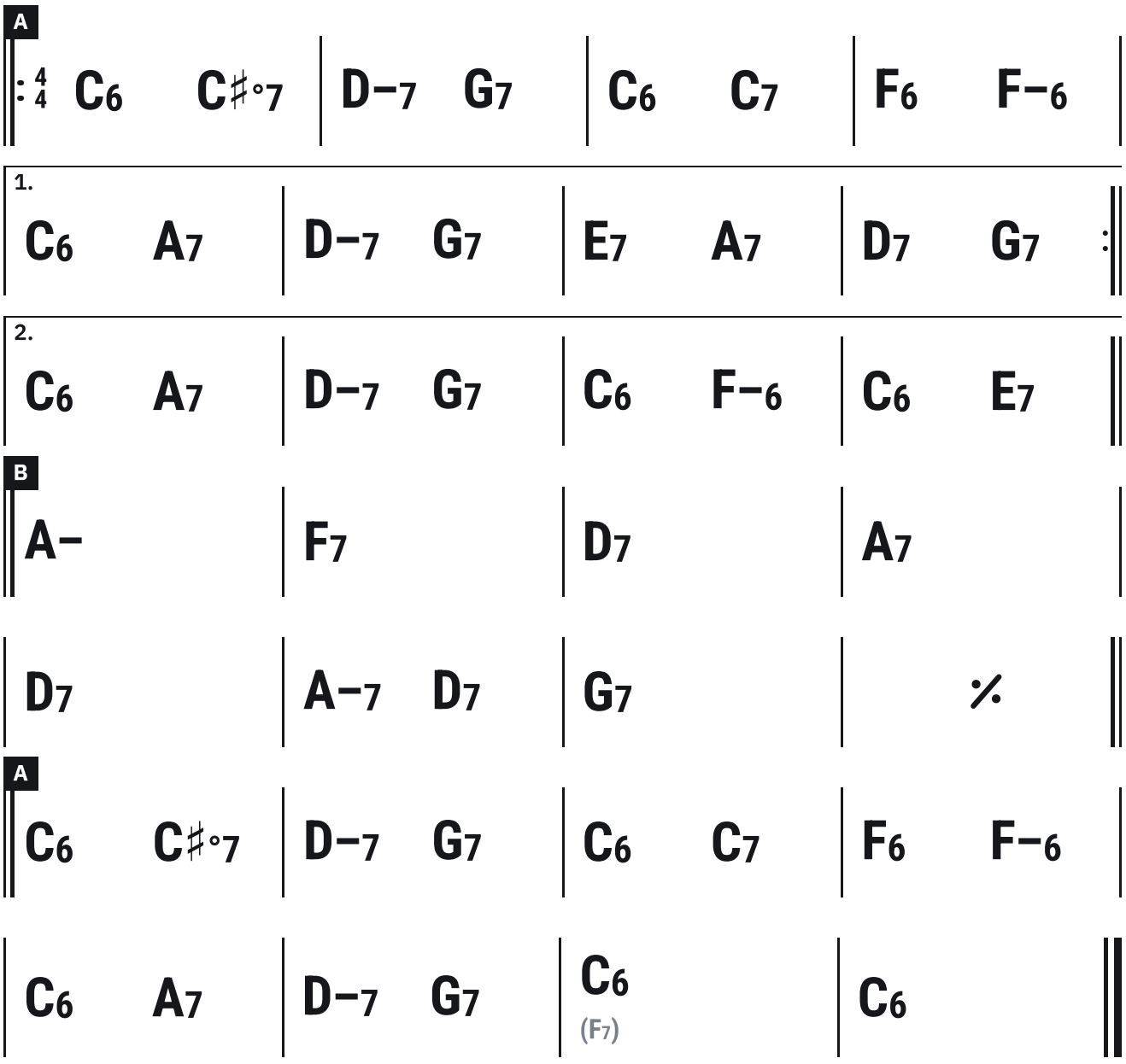
E♭ instrument: everything on these pages is written a major sixth above concert pitch (concert E♭ reads as C).

#	TUNE	WRITTEN KEY	CONCERT	FORM	DANCE TEMPO
01	Ain't Misbehavin'	C	E♭	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
02	All of Me	D	F	A B A C · 32	150–190 bpm
03	All the Things You Are	F	A♭	A A′ B A″ · 36	150–190 bpm
04	Autumn Leaves	A–	C–	A A B C · 32	100–180 bpm
05	Battle of Jericho	D–	F–	AABA · 32	150–200 bpm
06	Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen	A–	C–	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
07	Blue Drag	B–	D–	AABA · 32	90–120 bpm
08	Blue Moon	C	E♭	AABA · 32	110–180 bpm
09	Blue Skies	A– → C	C– → E♭	AABA · 32	150–190 bpm
10	Comes Love	F♯–	A–	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
11	Don't Get Around Much Anymore	A	C	AABA · 32	130–180 bpm
12	Honeysuckle Rose	D	F	AABA · 32	150–190 bpm
13	I Got Rhythm	G	B♭	AABA · 32	200–240 bpm
14	It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing)	E– → G	G– → B♭	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm
15	Jumpin' at the Woodside	G	B♭	AABA · 32	200–250 bpm
16	Just Friends	E	G	A B A B′ · 32	170–220 bpm
17	Kansas City Stride	E–	G–	AABA · 32 + 8-bar intro	170–210 bpm
18	Lester's Bounce	E–	G–	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
19	Lullaby of Birdland	D– / F	F– / A♭	AABA · 32	150–200 bpm
20	Moanin'	D–	F–	AABA · 32	100–125 bpm
21	Oh, Lady Be Good	E	G	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
22	On the Sunny Side of the Street	A	C	AABA · 32	110–140 bpm
23	Perdido	G	B♭	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm
24	Puttin' On the Ritz	D– → F	F– → A♭	AABA · 32	200–240 bpm
25	Ridin' and Jivin'	D–	F–	AABA · 32	150 bpm
26	Satin Doll	A	C	AABA · 32	130–160 bpm
27	A Smooth One	D	F	AABA · 32	120 bpm
28	Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise	G–	B♭–	AABA · 32	160–190 bpm
29	Stompin' at the Savoy	B♭	D♭	AABA · 32	190–220 bpm
30	Take the “A” Train	A	C	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
31	Topsy	F♯–	A–	AABA · 32	165–200 bpm
32	Undecided	A	C	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm

(Medium Swing)

Ain't Misbehavin'

Fats Waller, Harry Brooks & Andy Razaf



Written key **C** Concert **E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written **1929**

Ain't Misbehavin' · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- Waller phrasing: on the beat and behind it. Lay back on the long notes, especially the pickup into bar 1 and the held notes in bars 7–8.
- Each colour chord asks for one note: C♯ on C♯°7, A♭ on F–6, C♯ again on A7 in bar 5, G♯ on E7. Land them on the downbeat and the harmony is in your line.
- Bridge: the line climbs through A minor into D7 and A7; play the A7 bars bright, with C♯, then let D7 and G7 bring you down.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **C6** E A **C♯°7** E B♭ **D–7** F C **G7** B F **C7** E B♭ **F6** A D **F–6** A♭ D **A7** C♯ G **E7** G♯ D **D7** F♯ C

B **A–** C E **F7** A E♭ **D7** F♯ C **A7** C♯ G **A–7** C G **G7** B F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A **C major, with Waller's colours**

C major pentatonic as home. The colours, one per chord: C♯°7 → C♯, C7 → B♭ (into F), F–6 → A♭, A7 → C♯, E7 → G♯, D7 → F♯. The turnaround is four dominants; hit their 3rds on the downbeats.

B **A minor, then dominants home**

A minor pentatonic for bars 1–2 (F7 adds E♭). D7 (F♯, C) for two, A7 (C♯) for two is the surprise, then D7 and G7 (B) pull you back to C.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 1 as C6 A7/C♯ · bar 2 as D–7 D♯°7 · bar 3 as C6 E7 · first-F♯ bar 7 as C6 A7 · bridge bars 5–6 as G6 | D7 in some charts.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · C major pent C D E G A

A · C blues scale C E♭ F G♭ G B♭

B bars 1–2 · A minor pent A C D E G

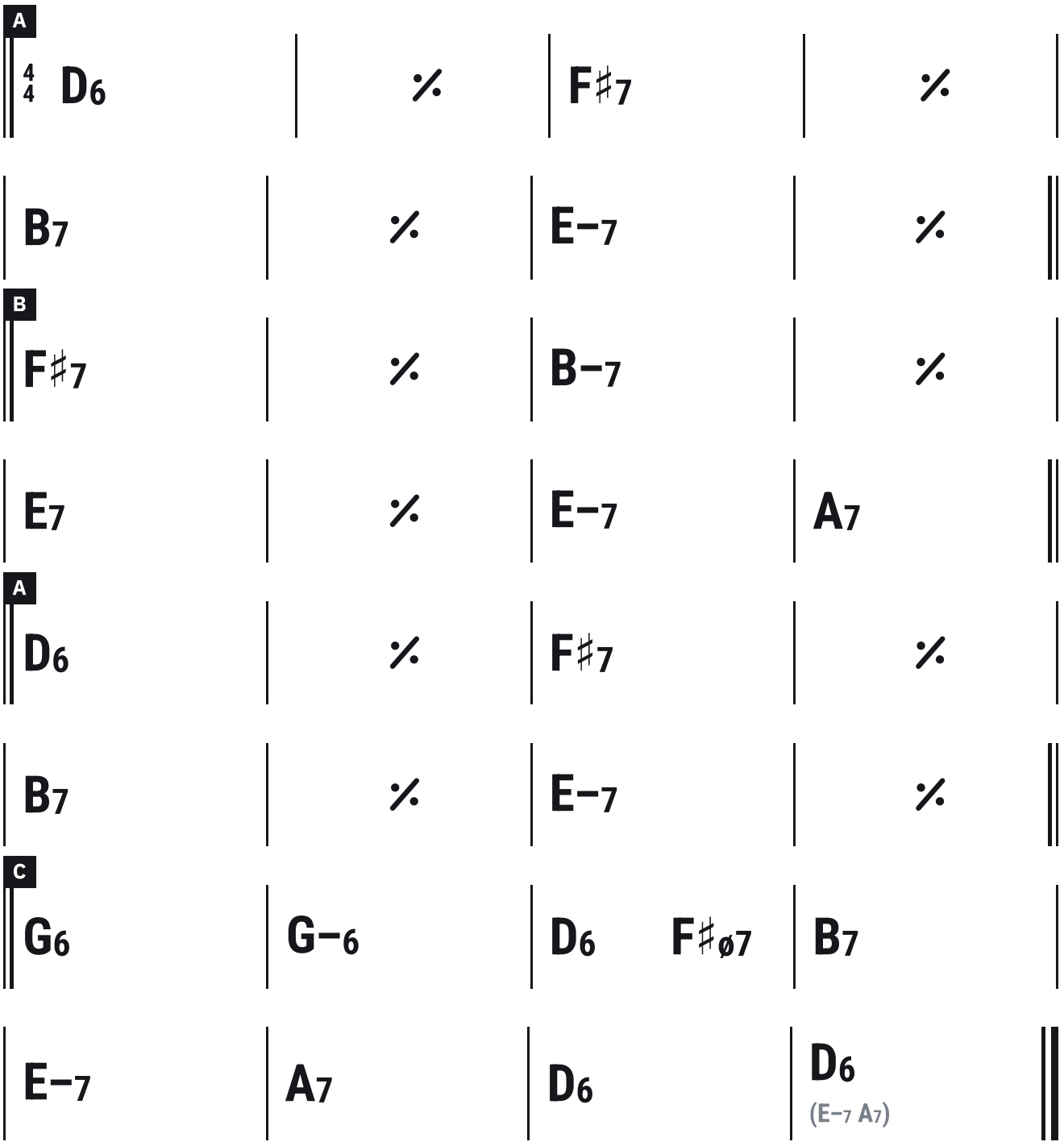
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

C6	C E G A
C♯°7	C♯ E G B♭
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
C7	C E G B♭
F6	F A C D
F–6	F A♭ C D
A7	A C♯ E G
E7	E G♯ B D
D7	D F♯ A C
A–	A C E
F7	F A C E♭
A–7	A C E G

(Medium Swing)

All of Me

Gerald Marks & Seymour Simons



Written key **D** Concert **F** Form **A B A C · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1931**

All of Me · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- Long notes over moving dominants: hold them and let the band move under you. F♯7 (bars 3–4) wants A♯, B7 (bars 5–6) wants D♯ in your line.
- Phrase in two-bar units; the written melody is one idea per chord, and so should the solo be.
- C section: G → G–6 → D is the emotional peak: B♭ on the G–6, then down to A. Hold the last note; the band tags under you.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D6**	F♯ B	**F♯7**	A♯ E	**B7**	D♯ A	**E–7**	G D							
B	**F♯7**	A♯ E	**B–7**	D A	**E7**	G♯ D	**E–7**	G D	**A7**	C♯ G					
C	**G6**	B E	**G–6**	B♭ E	**D6**	F♯ B	**F♯ø7**	A C E	**B7**	D♯ A	**E–7**	G D	**A7**	C♯ G	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D major with two sharps bent in

D major pentatonic; F♯7 wants A♯ (the first surprise of the tune), B7 wants D♯, E–7 is D major again. Two bars per chord, so one idea per chord is enough.

B

F♯7 → B–, then E7 → E–7 A7

F♯7 (A♯) into B minor pentatonic for two bars; E7 (G♯ natural) for two; E–7 A7 back to D.

C

IV, iv, home

G major pentatonic, then G minor pentatonic over G–6 (B♭ is the tender note); F♯ø7 B7 (C , D♯) into E–7 A7 D6.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 3–4 of the A as F♯7 | F♯7♭9 · C bars 3–4 as D6 | B7 (no F♯ø7) in older charts · the Real Book's key is C: everything a fourth down.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D major pent D E F♯ A B

B · B minor pent (F♯7 → B–) B D E F♯ A

C · G major pent G A B D E

C · G minor pent (G–6) G B♭ C D F

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D6	D F♯ A B
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
E–7	E G B D
B–7	B D F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
A7	A C♯ E G
G6	G B D E
G–6	G B♭ D E
F♯ø7	F♯ A C E

(Medium Swing)

All the Things You Are

Jerome Kern & Oscar Hammerstein II

A

4/4 D–7	G–7	C7	FΔ7
B♭Δ7	B–7 E7	AΔ7	𝄎

A′

A–7	D–7	G7	CΔ7
FΔ7	F♯–7 B7	EΔ7	𝄎

B

F♯–7	B7	EΔ7	𝄎
D♯ø7	G♯7	C♯Δ7	A7♯5

A″

D–7	G–7	C7	FΔ7
B♭Δ7	B♭–7 (E♭7)	A–7	G♯°7
G–7	C7	FΔ7	FΔ7 (Eø7 A7)

Written key **F** Concert **A♭** Form **A A′ B A″ · 36** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1939**

All the Things You Are · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The melody is the guide-tone line: the first note of each bar is the 3rd or 7th of the chord. Learn the melody and you have the changes.
- Phrase across the barlines: D–7 G–7 C7 FΔ7 B♭Δ7 is one scale (F major), so one long line fits five chords; the key changes at B–7 E7 and that is where to breathe.
- The last A is twelve bars, and bar 29 (B♭Δ7 → B♭–7) is the warning that the ending is coming. Count it; the dancers won't.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	D–7	F C	G–7	B♭ F	C7	E B♭	FΔ7	A E	B♭Δ7	D A	B–7	D A	E7	G♯ D	AΔ7	C♯ G♯					
A′	A–7	C G	D–7	F C	G7	B F	CΔ7	E B	FΔ7	A E	F♯–7	A E	B7	D♯ A	EΔ7	G♯ D♯					
B	F♯–7	A E	B7	D♯ A	EΔ7	G♯ D♯	D♯ø7	F♯ A C♯	G♯7	C F♯	C♯Δ7	F C	A7♯5	C♯ F G							
A″	D–7	F C	G–7	B♭ F	C7	E B♭	FΔ7	A E	B♭Δ7	D A	B♭–7	D♭ A♭	A–7	C G	G♯°7	B F					

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A — **vi–ii–V–I–IV in F, then a side-step to A**

D–7 G–7 C7 FΔ7 B♭Δ7 is one scale: F major, heard as a circle of fourths. Then B–7 E7 AΔ7: the money notes are G♯ and C♯. The melody's first note on each chord is its 3rd or 7th; sing the melody and you're playing guide tones.

A′ — **The same thing a fourth lower: C, then E**

A–7 D–7 G7 CΔ7 FΔ7 = C major. Then F♯–7 B7 EΔ7: D♯ and G♯.

B — **E major, then C♯ major, then the door back**

F♯–7 B7 EΔ7 for four bars (E major). D♯ø7 G♯7 C♯Δ7: C♯ major, so F C A♯. A7♯5 in the last bar is the hinge: C♯ natural and F (= F) pull you back to D–.

A″ — **F again, with the chromatic walk-down**

As the first A through B♭Δ7, then B♭–7 (D♭/C♯, A♭/G♯), A–7, G♯°7 (B, D, F) into G–7 C7 FΔ7. Think of bars 29–32 as a bass line and play across it; it's four bars of one gesture.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 30 as B♭–7 alone or as E♭7 · bar 24 as A7♭9 or A7alt · last bar's Eø7 A7 is the turnaround into the next chorus, dropped on the out chorus.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

Bars 1–5 · F major pent F G A C D

Bars 6–8 · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

Bars 9–13 · C major pent C D E G A

Bars 14–20 · E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

Bars 21–23 · C♯ major pent C♯ D♯ F G♯ A♯

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D–7	D F A C
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
FΔ7	F A C E
B♭Δ7	B♭ D F A
B–7	B D F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
AΔ7	A C♯ E G♯
A–7	A C E G
G7	G B D F
CΔ7	C E G B
F♯–7	F♯ A C♯ E

B7	B D♯ F♯ A
EΔ7	E G♯ B D♯
D♯ø7	D♯ F♯ A C♯
G♯7	G♯ C D♯ F♯
C♯Δ7	C♯ F G♯ C
A7♯5	A C♯ F G
B♭−7	B♭ D♭ F A♭
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
G♯°7	G♯ B D F
Eø7	E G B♭ D
A7	A C♯ E G

(Medium Swing)

Autumn Leaves (Les feuilles mortes)

Joseph Kosma (Prévert / Mercer)

A

4/4 D–7	G7	CΔ7	FΔ7
Bø7	E7	A–	𝄎

A

D–7	G7	CΔ7	FΔ7
Bø7	E7	A–	𝄎

B

Bø7	E7	A–	𝄎
D–7	G7	CΔ7	FΔ7

C

Bø7	E7	A–7 D7	G–7 C7
FΔ7	Bø7 E7	A–	A– (Bø7 E7)

Written key **A–** Concert **C–** Form **A A B C · 32** Feel **Lindy / ballad** Dance tempo **100–180 bpm**

Written **1945**

Autumn Leaves · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The melody climbs through D–7 G7 CΔ7 FΔ7 by thirds: an arpeggio exercise in disguise, so solo the same way.
- Bars 5–6 of each A (Bø7 E7) are the minor turn: G♯ and F on the E7, then A minor pentatonic. The bridge is the same two halves in reverse, so don't start it in C out of habit.
- C section: A–7 D7 → G–7 C7 → FΔ7 falls by whole steps; a line that drops a whole step every two beats fits all three bars.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	D–7	F C	G7	B F	CΔ7	E B	FΔ7	A E	Bø7	D F A	E7	G♯ D	A–	C E							
B	Bø7	D F A	E7	G♯ D	A–	C E	D–7	F C	G7	B F	CΔ7	E B	FΔ7	A E							
C	Bø7	D F A	E7	G♯ D	A–7	C G	D7	F♯ C	G–7	B♭ F	C7	E B♭	FΔ7	A E	A–	C E					

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C major for four bars, A minor for four

D–7 G7 CΔ7 FΔ7 is one scale: C major (F major pentatonic also fits all four). Then Bø7 E7 A–: A harmonic minor on the E7 (G♯ natural, F) and A minor pentatonic home.

B

The A section reversed

Minor half first (Bø7 E7 A–), major half second (D–7 G7 C F). Same notes, opposite order; the trap is starting the bridge in C major out of habit.

C

Two backdoor ii–Vs sliding down, then home

A–7 D7 → G–7 C7 → FΔ7: A dorian, D mixolydian (F♯), G dorian, C mixolydian (E), F major. Then Bø7 E7 A– to close. Think of bars 3–5 as one gesture descending by whole steps.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 8 of each A as A–7 or A–6 · C bars 3–4 as A–7 D7 | D–7 G7 (a plain ii–V to C) · keys: E– (Real Book), C♯– (original), A– (here).

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A bars 1–4, B bars 5–8 · C major pent C D E G A

A bars 5–8 · A minor pent A C D E G

over E7 · A harmonic minor A B C D E F G♯

C bars 3–5 · F major pent F G A C D

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
CΔ7	C E G B
FΔ7	F A C E
Bø7	B D F A
E7	E G♯ B D
A–	A C E
A–7	A C E G
D7	D F♯ A C
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭

(Medium Swing)

Battle of Jericho (Joshua Fit the Battle)

Traditional spiritual, your band's arrangement



Written key **D–** Concert **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–200 bpm** Written **trad.**

Battle of Jericho · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The spiritual's melody is the riff: short, hard attack on the chorus (A sections), legato on the verse (bridge).
- Solos: D minor pentatonic and the D blues scale cover everything. On A7 (bars 3 and 7 of each A, bars 2, 4, 6–7 of the bridge) land C♯ and the change is heard.
- Bars 6–7 of the bridge are two bars of A7: hold a note (C♯ or G) or repeat the melody's rhythm on it until D– returns, Bechet-style.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D–**	F A	**A7**	C♯ G
B	**D–**	F A	**A7**	C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D minor, one scale

D minor pentatonic and the D blues scale cover the whole A. On A7 play C♯ natural (D harmonic minor) if you want the chord change to be heard at all; F is home.

B

The same, with twice the A7

Bars 6–7 are two bars of A7: sit on C♯ and G, or do the Bechet thing and play the melody's rhythm on one note until the D– comes back.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

G– (iv) in bar 3 of the A if the band wants a third chord · A7♭9 throughout · some bands play the B as D– | D– | A7 | A7 twice.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A, B · D minor pent	D F G A C
A, B · D blues scale	D F G A♭ A C
over A7 · D harmonic minor	D E F G A B♭ C♯

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D–	D F A
A7	A C♯ E G

(Medium Swing)

Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen

Sholom Secunda



Written key **A–** Concert **C–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1932**

Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The melody is a minor blues: bend the C and G, growl on the long notes; it's the tune the European swing floor knows best, so play it straight before you play it fancy.
- Solos: A minor blues scale over the entire A. On E7 (bar 6) G♯ against F is the harmonic-minor colour; the bridge's D– bars want F major pentatonic.
- The bridge (D– for two, A– for two, twice) is where the tune relaxes; play prettier there and save the blues for the last A.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**A–** C E	**D–** F A	**E7** G♯ D
B	**D–** F A	**A–** C E	**E7** G♯ D

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A minor blues language

The A minor blues scale works over the entire A; this is a minor blues tune. D–: D dorian (F major). E7: A harmonic minor, G♯ natural against F. The turnaround G7 – F7 – E7 is chromatic dominants: target the 3rds B A G♯.

B

iv → i, twice, opening into V

D– (D dorian, F major pentatonic) to A–, then the second half can go II7–V7: B7 (D♯) into E7 (G♯). The bridge is where the tune briefly feels major; play pretty there and save the blues for the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 as E7 | E7 · bridge bars 5–6 as B7 | B7 (II7–V7) · turnaround optional at speed.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · A minor pent	A C D E G
A · A blues scale	A C D E♭ E G
B · D minor pent	D F G A C

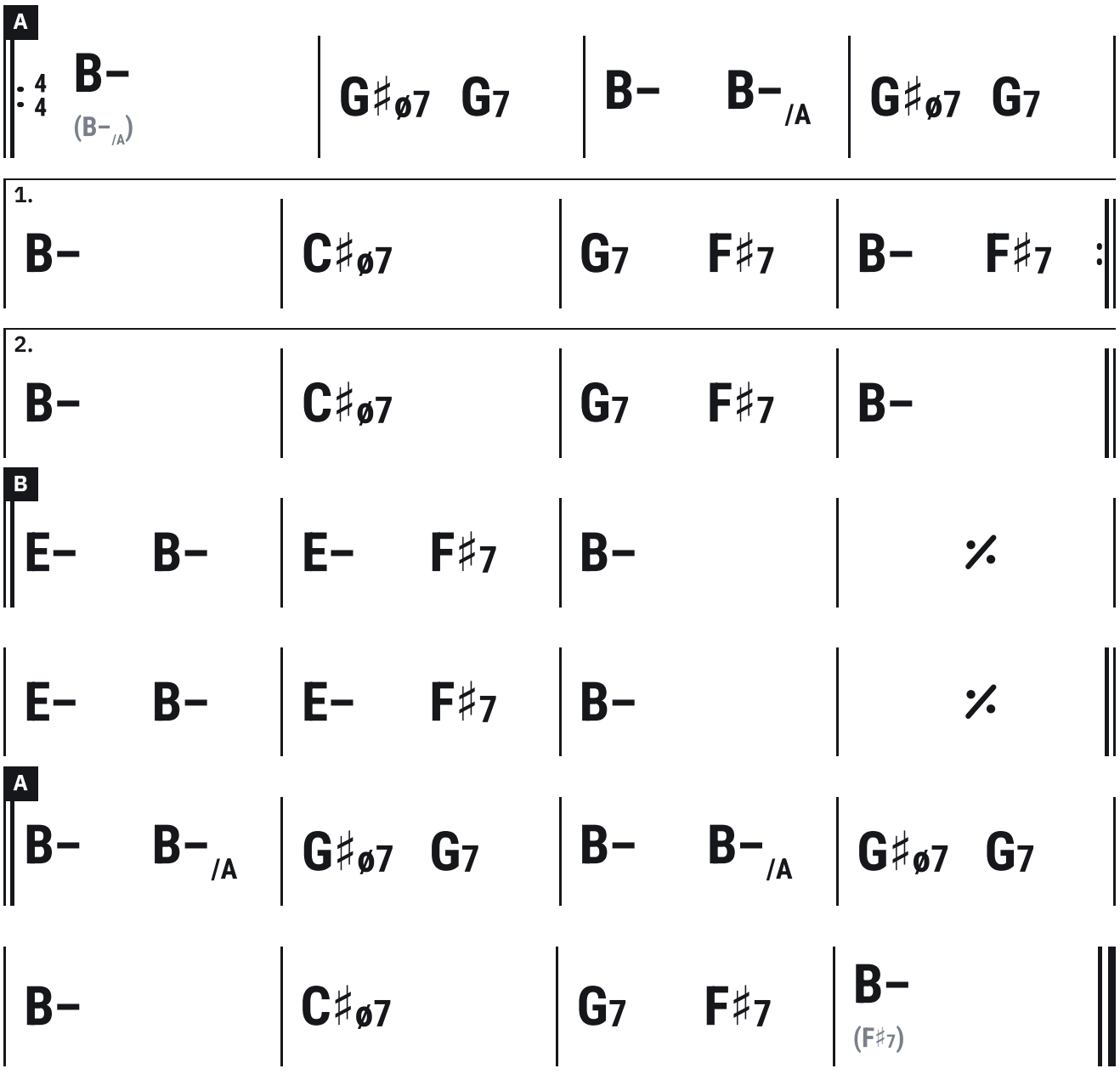
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A–	A C E
D–	D F A
E7	E G♯ B D
G7	G B D F
F7	F A C E♭
B7	B D♯ F♯ A

(Slow Swing)

Blue Drag

Josef Myrow (your Pataswing chart)



Written key **B–** Concert **D–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Slow lindy / blues** Dance tempo **90–120 bpm**

Written **1932**

Blue Drag · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- Slow and behind the beat; Grappelli's phrasing on Django's record is the model: long notes with a slow vibrato at the end.
- The pickup into the last A, A♯ B C C♯ then C♯ D in triplets, is yours: in unison with the other horn, loud and even.
- Solos: B minor pentatonic and blues at home; F on the G7 bars (its ♭7) and A♯ on F♯7 are the two notes that name the drag.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **B–** D F♯ **G♯ø7** B D F♯ **G7** B F **B–/A** D F♯ **C♯ø7** E G B **F♯7** A♯ E

B **E–** G B **B–** D F♯ **F♯7** A♯ E

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

B minor, with a ♭VI–V slide

B minor pentatonic and blues scale at home. G♯ø7 G7: D then F (G7's ♭7), the chord that gives the tune its drag. C♯ø7: G. G7 F♯7 at the end is the half-step slide: F on the G7, then land A♯ on the F♯7.

B

iv and i, with F♯7 every second bar

E minor pentatonic over the E– beats, B minor pentatonic over B–; the F♯7s want A♯. Leave space: the bridge melody is mostly rests.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 6 as F♯7 or F♯9 (Django's rhythm section) · bar 2 as G♯°7 G7 · bridge E– as A♯°7 in some gypsy charts.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · B minor pent B D E F♯ A

A · B blues scale B D E F F♯ A

B · E minor pent E G A B D
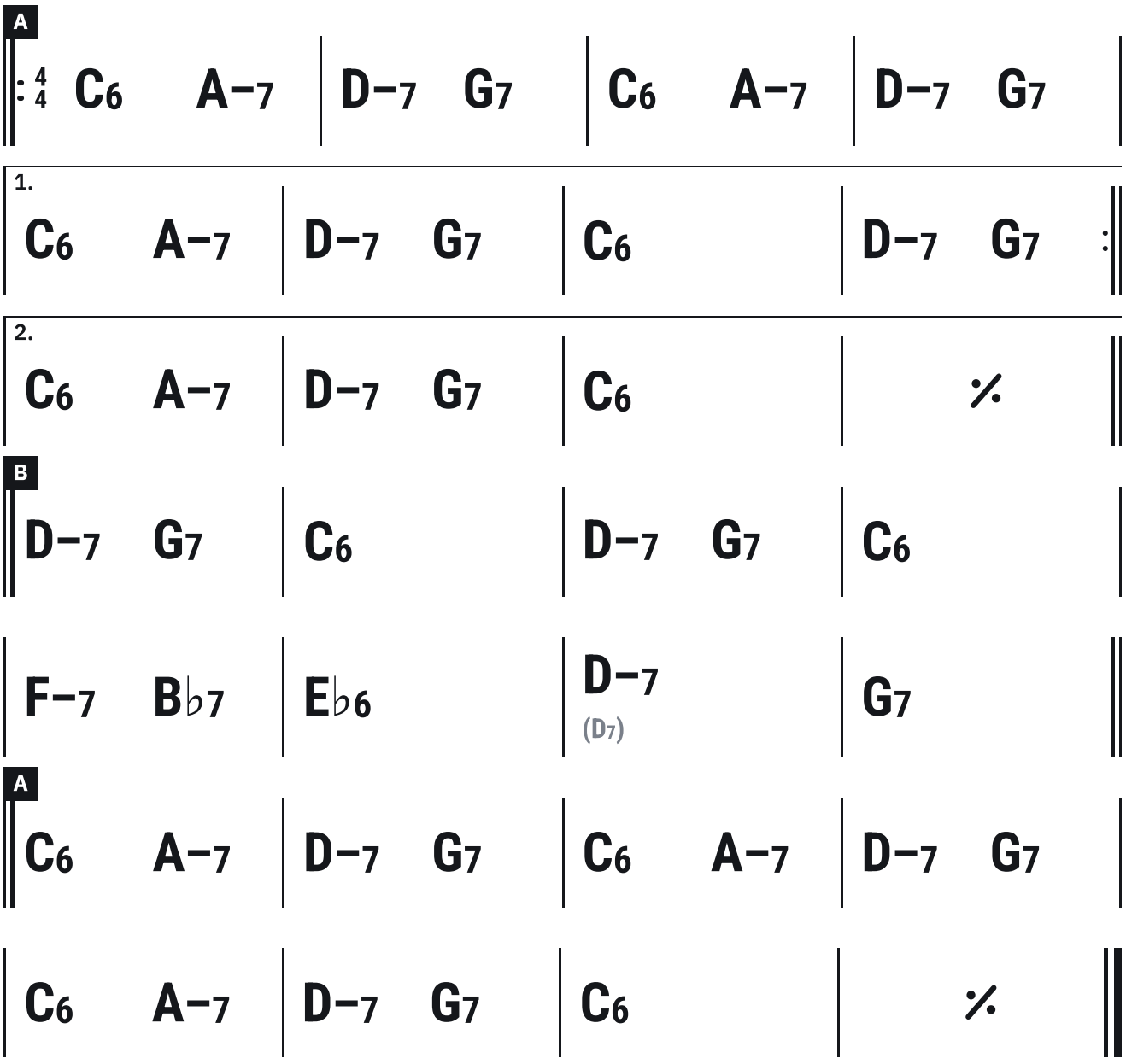
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

B–	B D F♯
B–/A	B D F♯
G♯ø7	G♯ B D F♯
G7	G B D F
C♯ø7	C♯ E G B
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E
E–	E G B

(Medium Swing)

Blue Moon

Richard Rodgers & Lorenz Hart



Written key **C** Concert **E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / blues** Dance tempo **110–180 bpm**

Written **1934**

Blue Moon · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- Long notes over the loop; the harmony moves under you every two beats, so hold the note and let it do the work.
- Bridge: the melody steps into E♭ in bars 5–6 (A♭ and E♭ are the new notes), then D7 or D–7 and G7 bring you back; it's the only place the tune leaves C.
- Solos: C major pentatonic over the whole loop; land B (3rd of G7) on beat 3 of every even bar and the loop sings.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**C6**	E A	**A–7**	C G	**D–7**	F C	**G7**	B F			
B	**D–7**	F C	**G7**	B F	**C6**	E A	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**B♭7**	D A♭	**E♭6**	G C

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

One loop, C major

C major pentatonic over the whole loop; A minor pentatonic is the same five notes, so the vi chord costs nothing. Land **B** (3rd of G7) on the second half of every even bar and the loop sings.

B

C, then E♭ for two bars, then home

C major for bars 1–4. Bars 5–6: E♭ major pentatonic (= C minor pentatonic): **A♭** and **E♭** are the slip. Bar 7: D7 wants **F♯** natural (D–7 wants F); bar 8 G7: **B** .

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bars 7–8 as C6 | C6 with no turnaround · bridge bar 7 as D7 (the sheet) or D–7 (sessions) · bar 6 of the bridge as E♭Δ7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A, B · C major pent	C D E G A
B bars 5–6 · E♭ major pent	E♭ F G B♭ C
same notes as C minor pent	C E♭ F G B♭
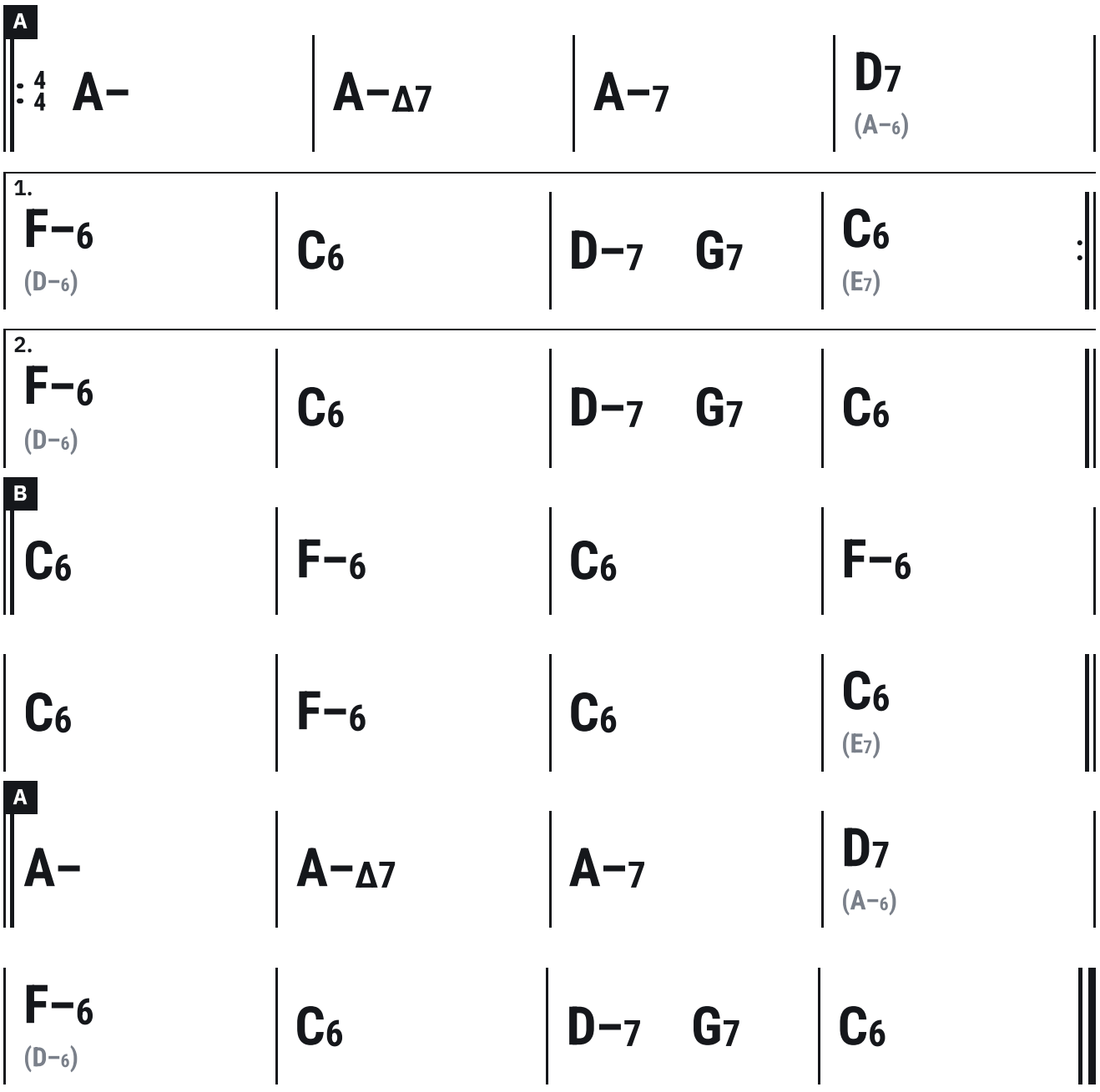
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

C6	C E G A
A–7	A C E G
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
F–7	F A♭ C E♭
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
E♭6	E♭ G B♭ C
D7	D F♯ A C

(Medium Up Swing)

Blue Skies

Irving Berlin



Written key **A– → C** Concert **C– → E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm**

Written **1926**

Blue Skies · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The melody sits on the line cliché: the first four bars are one note (E) with the harmony moving; play it dead straight and let the band supply the colour.
- Bar 5 (F–6) wants A♭ in your line; bars 6–8 are C major and the C blues scale is welcome.
- Bridge: C against F–6 every bar; A♭ and E♭ on the F–6 bars are the tension, C major pentatonic the release.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**A–**	C E	**A–7**	C G	**D7**	F♯ C	**F–6**	A♭ D	**C6**	E A	**D–7**	F C	**G7**	B F
B	**C6**	E A	**F–6**	A♭ D										

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A minor that is really vi of C

Play the cliché itself: A G♯ G F♯, one per bar, and build phrases around it. A dorian and A minor pentatonic over the A– bars, F♯ natural on the D7. Bar 5, F–6: the colour is A♭ and D (C minor pentatonic works). Bars 6–8: C major home, C blues scale welcome.

B

I ↔ iv in C: C against F–6

C major on the C bars, C minor pentatonic on the F–6 bars (F A♭ C D): the A♭ and E♭ are the tension. Pedal a G in the left hand under the whole bridge and let the two chords rub.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bars 1–4 as the descending-bass original: A– | E7/G♯ | C/G | D7/F♯ · bar 5 as D–6 or F7 · bridge iv as plain F6 in older charts · the iReal version ends the bridge G♯ø7 C♯7♭9 (in A), i.e. Bø7 E7♭9 here.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A bars 1–5 · A minor pent A C D E G

A bars 6–8, B · C major pent C D E G A

F–6 bars · C minor pent C E♭ F G B♭

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A–maj7	A C E
A–7	A C E G
D7	D F♯ A C
A–6	A C E F♯
F–6	F A♭ C D
D–6	D F A B
C6	C E G A
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
E7	E G♯ B D

(Medium Swing)

Comes Love

Sam H. Stept (Lew Brown & Charles Tobias)



Written key **F♯–** Concert **A–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written **1939**

Comes Love · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- A vocal tune: phrase it like a lyric, the title phrase (bars 7–8) short and dry, and lay back on the C♯7 bars.
- Solos: F♯ minor pentatonic at home, F on every C♯7 (F♯ harmonic minor), D and F together on G♯ø7 C♯7. Bridge: A♯ on F♯7, B minor pentatonic on the B– bars.
- At the slow tempo (Billie Holiday, 90) the horn is the second voice behind the singer: fills in the gaps, never over the words.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**F♯–**	A C♯	**B–**	D F♯	**C♯7**	F B	**G♯ø7**	B D F♯
B	**F♯7**	A♯ E	**B–**	D F♯	**C♯7**	F B	**G♯ø7**	B D F♯

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F♯ minor, harmonic minor on the C♯7s

F♯ minor pentatonic at home; on C♯7 play F (F♯ harmonic minor, with D); G♯ø7 C♯7: D and F together is the sound of the title phrase.

B

F♯7 → B–, then C♯7 home

F♯7 wants A♯; B minor pentatonic over the B– bars; C♯7 (F) and G♯ø7 C♯7 bring the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

D°7 passing chords on the 'and' of 4 before each C♯7 · bridge bars 5–6 as B– | B– · bar 2 as F♯– throughout for a modal reading.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · F♯ minor pent F♯ A B C♯ E

over C♯7 · F♯ harmonic minor F♯ G♯ A B C♯ D F

B · B minor pent B D E F♯ A

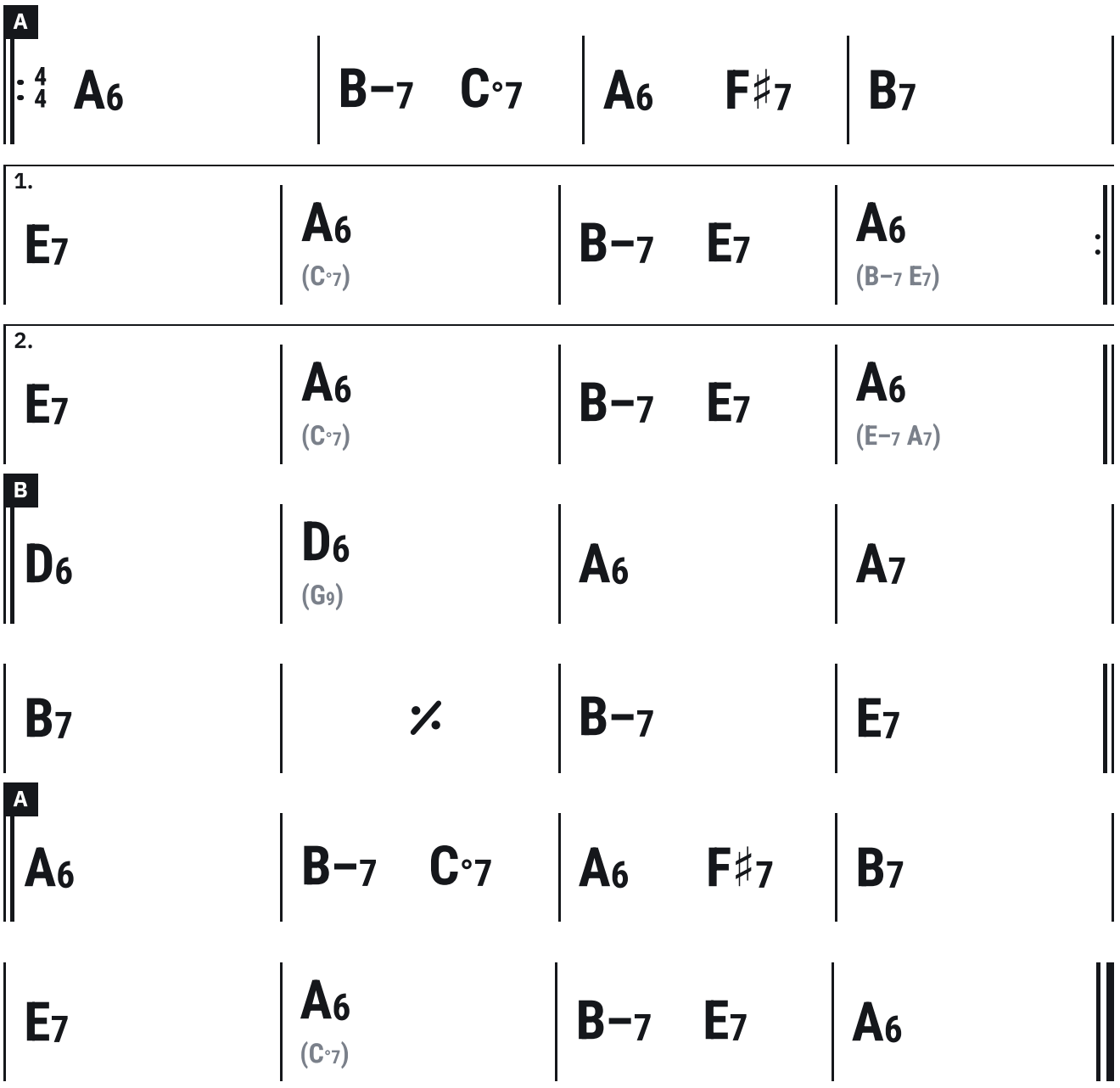
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

F♯–	F♯ A C♯
B–	B D F♯
C♯7	C♯ F G♯ B
D°7	D F A♭ B
G♯ø7	G♯ B D F♯
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E

(Medium Swing)

Don't Get Around Much Anymore

Duke Ellington & Bob Russell



Written key **A** Concert **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / slow swing** Dance tempo **130–180 bpm**

Written **1940**

Don't Get Around Much Anymore · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The melody hangs on one lyric line through F♯7 → B7 → E7: hold the long notes and let the dominants move under you; A♯ (F♯7) and D♯ (B7) are the two notes to lean on in a solo.
- C°7 in bar 2 is the colour chord: C against the A is the tune's blue note.
- Bridge: four bars of D, then A7 (G) into B7 (D♯), then ii–V home; the melody climbs through it, so play the climb with a crescendo.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**A6**	C♯ F♯	**B–7**	D A	**C°7**	E♭ A	**F♯7**	A♯ E	**B7**	D♯ A	**E7**	G♯ D	
B	**D6**	F♯ B	**A6**	C♯ F♯	**A7**	C♯ G	**B7**	D♯ A	**B–7**	D A	**E7**	G♯ D	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A major with three dominants

A major pentatonic, bending in the one note each dominant wants: F♯7 → A♯, B7 → D♯, E7 → D. C°7 in bar 2 is the colour chord: C against the A. Same trick as Sunny Side of the Street, same key.

B

D major, then A7 → B7 → B–7 E7

D major pentatonic for bars 1–3 (G9 adds C); A7 (G) into B7 (D♯) for two bars, then ii–V home.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as A♯°7 or D6 D♯°7 · bar 3 as C♯–7 C7 (bebop) · bridge bars 5–6 as F♯–7 B7 · Real-Book-style bridge: E–7 A7 | D6 | E–7 A7 | D6 | F♯–7 B7 | F♯–7 B7 | B–7 | E7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

B · D major pent D E F♯ A B

B7 bars · B major pent B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯
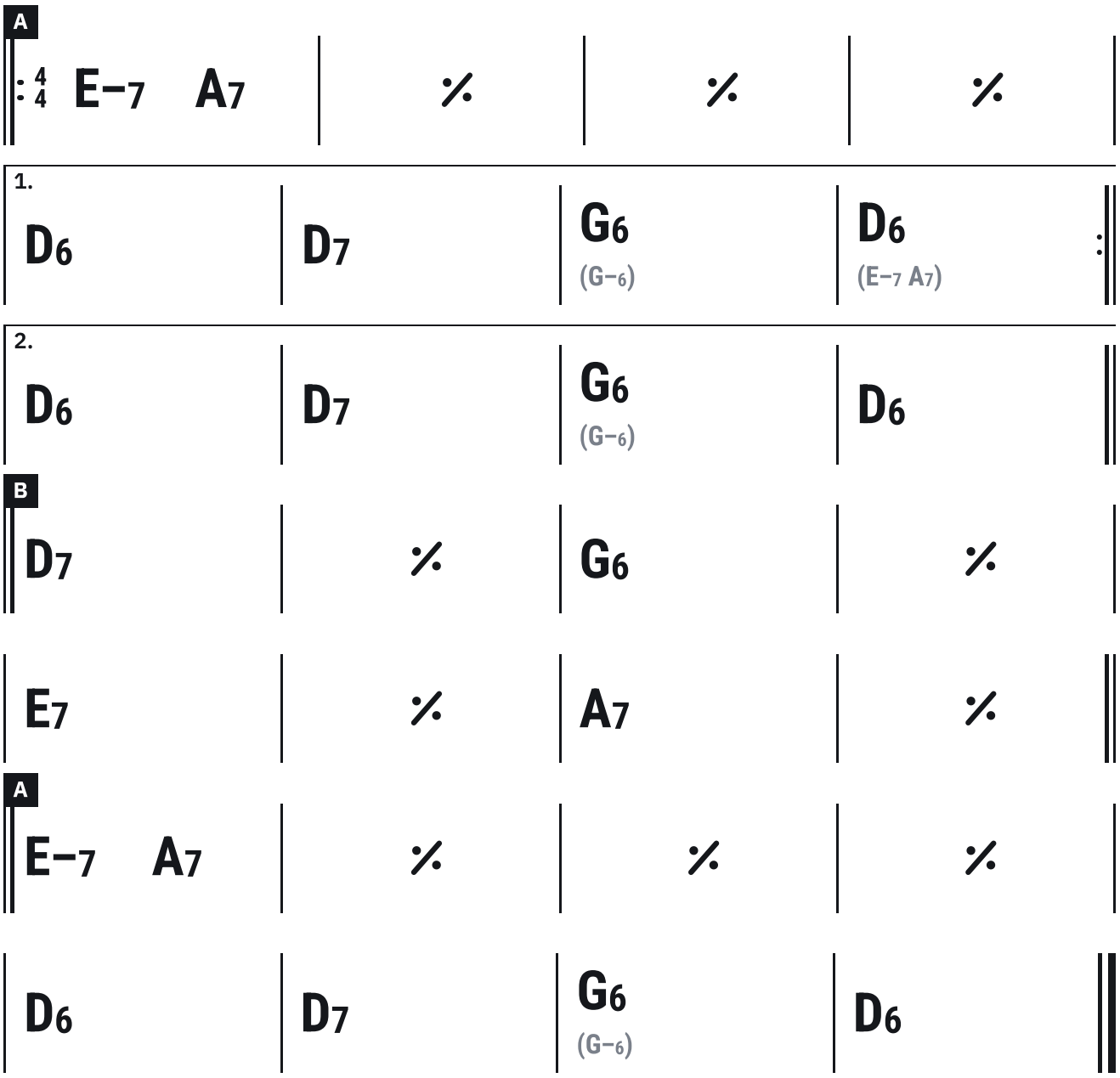
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A6	A C♯ E F♯
B–7	B D F♯ A
C°7	C E♭ G♭ A
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G
D6	D F♯ A B
G9	G A B D F

(Medium Swing)

Honeysuckle Rose

Fats Waller & Andy Razaf



Written key **D** Concert **F** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1929**

Honeysuckle Rose · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The melody is a riff on E–7 A7 for four bars: short and bouncy; quote the first bar in your solo, everyone since Bird has.
- Bars 5–8 move: D → D7 → G → D. C on the D7 (bar 6) landing on B (3rd of G) is the line.
- Bridge (D7 | D7 | G | G | E7 | E7 | A7 | A7): two bars a chord; C → B → G♯ → G is the guide-tone line, one note per two bars.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**E–7**	G D	**A7**	C♯ G	**D6**	F♯ B	**D7**	F♯ C	**G6**	B E	
B	**D7**	F♯ C	**G6**	B E	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

One long ii–V in D, then home

Bars 1–4 are a vamp: A mixolydian (D major heard from the A7). Don't resolve early; the tune doesn't. Bars 5–8: D → D7 → G → D. Play **C** on the D7 in bar 6 and land on **B** (3rd of G); if the band plays G–6, **B♭** is yours in bar 7.

B

The Honeysuckle bridge: I7 → IV → II7 → V7

D7 (C) for two, G major for two, E7 for two where **G♯** natural is the note, A7 (G) for two. Guide-tone line: F♯/C → B/F → G♯/D → C♯/G.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 7–8: G6 G–6 | D6 B7 (E–7 A7) · bridge bars 7–8 as E–7 | A7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D major pent D E F♯ A B

A bars 5–8 · D blues scale D F G A♭ A C

B · E7: E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

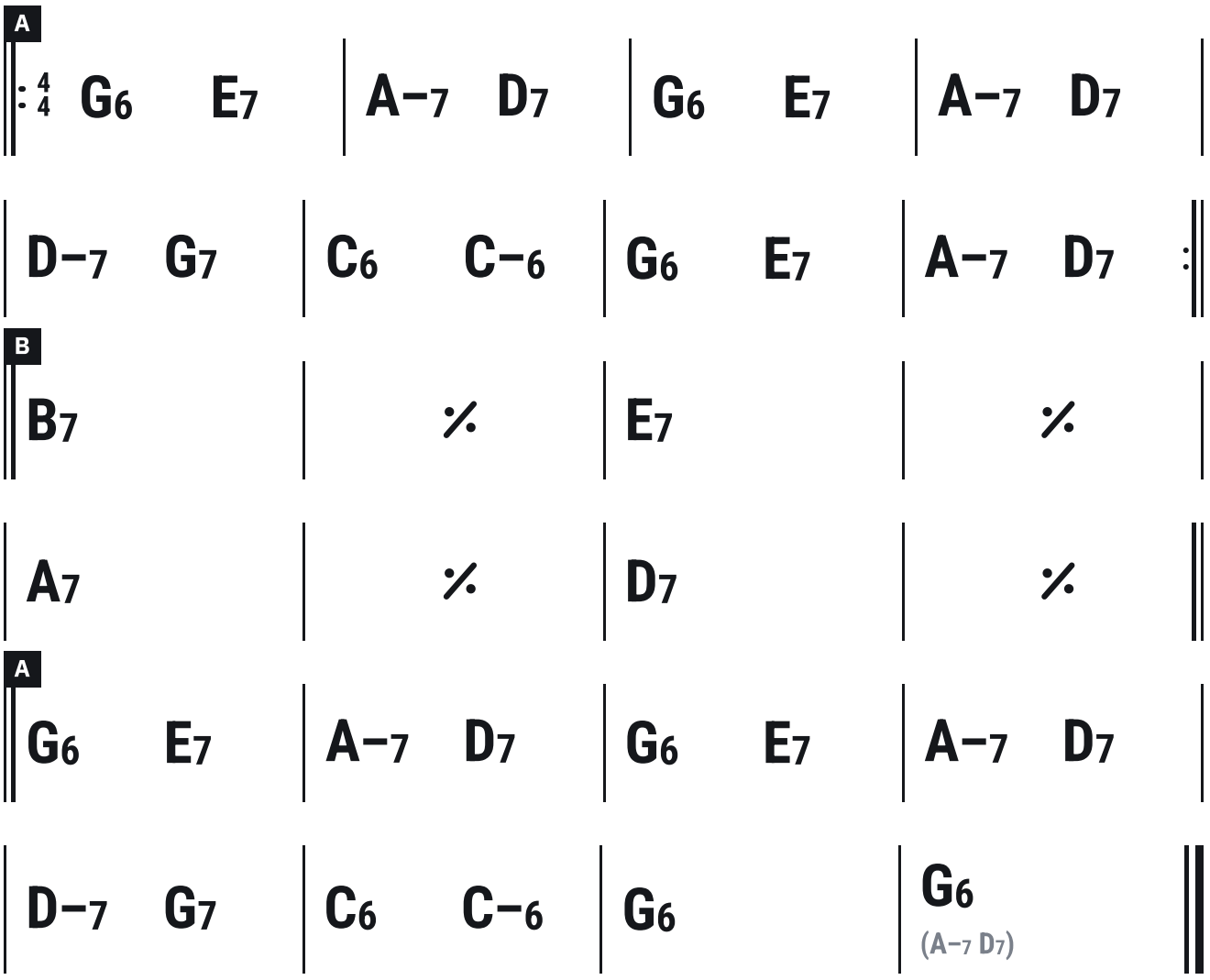
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G
D6	D F♯ A B
D7	D F♯ A C
G6	G B D E
G–6	G B♭ D E
E7	E G♯ B D

(Up Swing)

I Got Rhythm (Rhythm Changes)

George Gershwin



Written key **G** Concert **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Charleston / fast lindy** Dance tempo **200–240 bpm**

Written **1930**

I Got Rhythm · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- Riff heads (Lester Leaps In, Cotton Tail) live on these changes: play the head short and in unison, and solo in G major pentatonic plus the blue B♭ over bars 1–4; the turnarounds are the rhythm section's problem.
- Bars 5–6 are the event: F on the G7 into E (3rd of C), then E♭ over C–6 going home.
- Bridge: B7 → E7 → A7 → D7, two bars each. The 3rds D♯ G♯ C♯ F♯ on the downbeats are the bridge; a line that falls a half step every two bars (D♯/A → G♯/D → C♯/G → F♯/C) never gets lost.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**G6**	B E	**E7**	G♯ D	**A–7**	C G	**D7**	F♯ C	**D–7**	F C	**G7**	B F	**C6**	E A	**C–6**	E♭ A
B	**B7**	D♯ A	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G	**D7**	F♯ C								

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G major, with G blues on top

Bars 1–4: one key to the ear. G major pentatonic plus the blue B♭, and the whole turnaround disappears under it. Bars 5–6 are the real event: G7 into C. Play **F** (the ♭7) and land on **E** (3rd of C); then **E♭** over C–6 going home. Guide tones through the turnaround: B → G♯ (E7) → C → F♯ (D7).

B

Four dominants, two bars each, round the circle

B7 → E7 → A7 → D7. Mixolydian on each; the 3rds are the targets: **D♯** **G♯** **C♯** **F♯**. Voice-lead the 3rd/7th pairs down by half step: D♯/A → G♯/D → C♯/G → F♯/C. Lydian dominant (♯11) for colour: F on B7, A♯ on E7.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as B–7 E7 · bar 6 as C6 C♯°7 · bebop A: G G♯°7 | A–7 A♯°7 | B–7 B♭7 | A–7 D7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G major pent	G A B D E
B · B7: B major pent	B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯
B · E7: E major pent	E F♯ G♯ B C♯
B · A7: A major pent	A B C♯ E F♯
B · D7: D major pent	D E F♯ A B

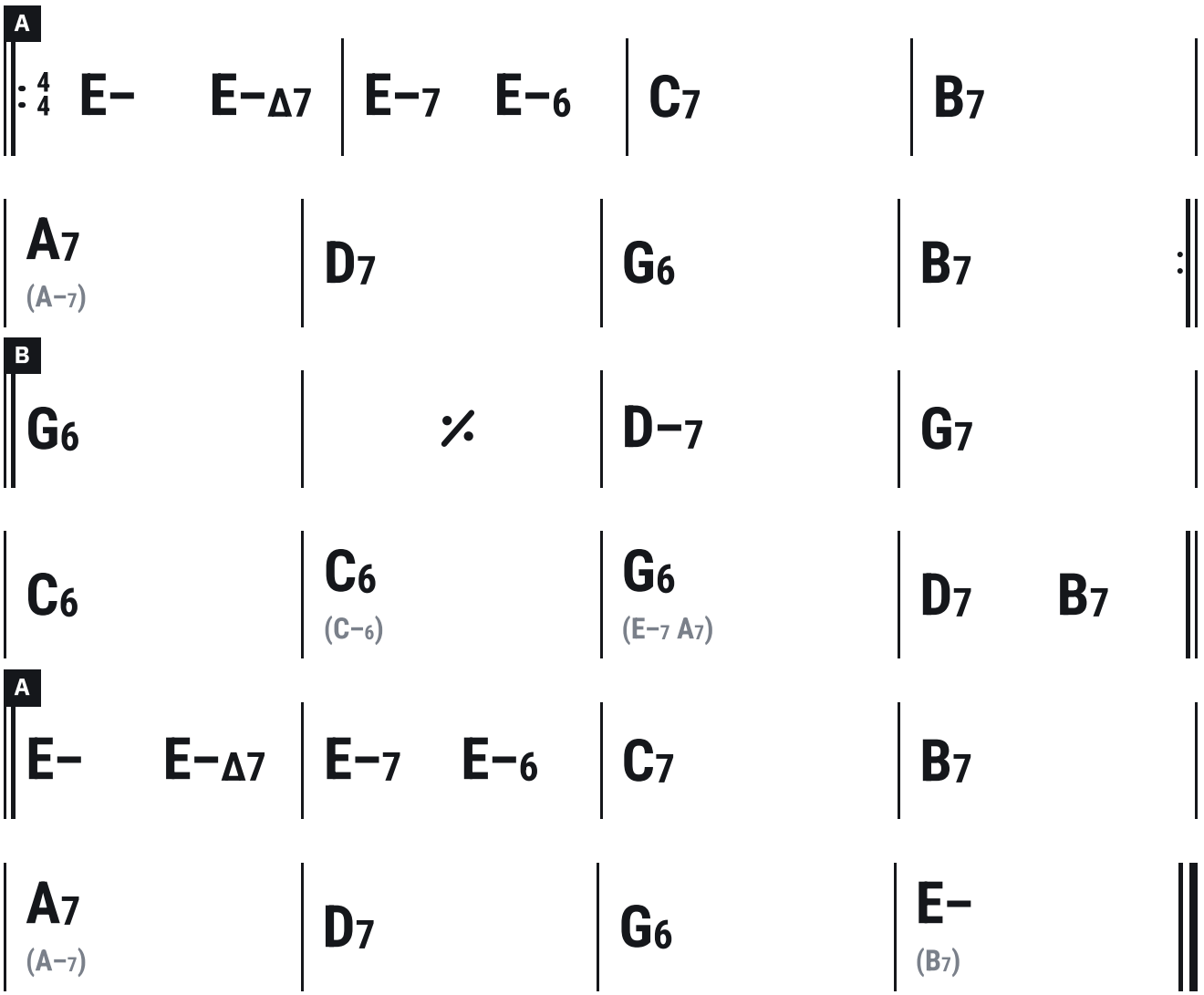
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G6	G B D E
E7	E G♯ B D
A–7	A C E G
D7	D F♯ A C
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
C6	C E G A
C–6	C E♭ G A
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
A7	A C♯ E G

(Medium Swing)

It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing)

Duke Ellington & Irving Mills



Written key **E– → G** Concert **G– → B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm**

Written **1931**

It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing) · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The doo-wah answer in bars 5–8 is yours: short, on the 'and' of 2 and 4, with the piano stabbing the same rhythm; the head is call-and-response with the rhythm section.
- Solos: E minor pentatonic over the cliché bars, B♭ then D♯ on C7 → B7, G major pentatonic for bars 5–8 with C♯ on A7 and F♯ on D7.
- Bridge: G major for four bars (D–7 G7 is a push into C: play F), C then C–6 (E♭), and D7 B7 at the end: F♯ → D♯ to drop back into E minor.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**E–**	G B	**E–7**	G D	**E–6**	G C♯	**C7**	E B♭	**B7**	D♯ A	**A7**	C♯ G	**D7**	F♯ C	**G6**	B E
B	**G6**	B E	**D–7**	F C	**G7**	B F	**C6**	E A	**D7**	F♯ C	**B7**	D♯ A				

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

E minor, then four bars of G major

Bars 1–2: E minor pentatonic over the line cliché E–D♯–D–C♯ (play the cliché in the left hand, solo on top). C7 → B7: B♭ then D♯, the flamenco cadence. Bars 5–8: G major pentatonic; C♯ natural on A7, F♯ on D7, and B7's D♯ to pull you home.

B

G major: I → IV → home

G major pentatonic for four bars (D–7 G7 is just a push into C: play F). C major, then C–6 if the band plays it (E♭). D7 B7 at the end: F♯ → D♯.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 1–2 as plain E– · doo-wah bars as A–7 | D7 | G6 | B7♯5, or with A♯°7 in bar 6 (iReal first ending) · bridge bars 3–4 as G7 | G7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A bars 1–4 · E minor pent E G A B D

A bars 5–8, B · G major pent G A B D E

B bars 5–6 · C major pent C D E G A
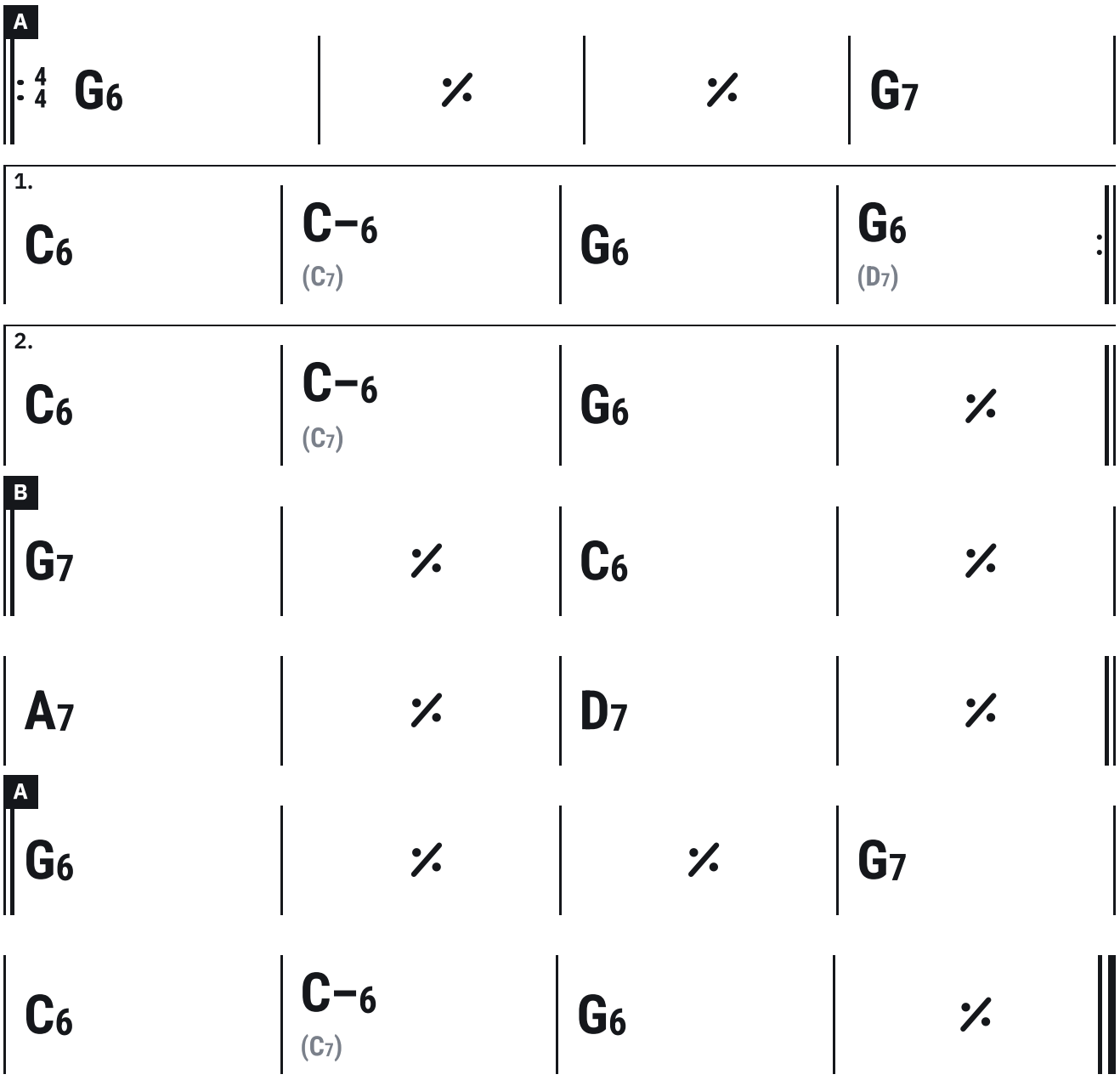
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

E–maj7	E G B
E–7	E G B D
E–6	E G B C♯
C7	C E G B♭
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
A7	A C♯ E G
A–7	A C E G
D7	D F♯ A C
G6	G B D E
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
C6	C E G A
C–6	C E♭ G A

(Up Swing)

Jumpin' at the Woodside

Count Basie (Eddie Durham)



Written key **G** Concert **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Fast lindy** Dance tempo **200–250 bpm** Written **1938**

Jumpin' at the Woodside · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- A riff tune: the riff is G major pentatonic, short and in unison; the head is stacked riffs, so each horn holds its own riff for the chorus.
- Solos: G major pentatonic with the blues on top; F on the G7 (bar 4), E then E♭ on C → C–6 (bars 5–6). At this tempo two ideas per chorus is plenty.
- Bridge: G7 (F) for two, C for two, A7 (C♯) for two, D7 (F♯) for two; half notes and quarter notes win at 240. The riff-chorus ending is yours: stack riffs, louder each chorus.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**G6**	B E	**G7**	B F	**C6**	E A	**C–6**	E♭ A
B	**G7**	B F	**C6**	E A	**A7**	C♯ G	**D7**	F♯ C

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G major pentatonic, blues on top

The riff is G major pentatonic; so is the solo. G7 in bar 4: F. C then C–6 in bars 5–6: E then E♭. Then home. At this tempo, two ideas per chorus is plenty.

B

The Honeysuckle bridge in G

G7 (F) for two, C for two, A7 (C♯ natural) for two, D7 (F♯) for two. Half notes and quarter notes win at 240.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 as C7 | C7 · bar 8 D7 turnaround · some bands play a rhythm bridge (B7 E7 A7 D7) instead; ask before the count-off.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G major pent G A B D E

A · G blues scale G B♭ C D♭ D F

Bars 5–6, B · C major pent C D E G A

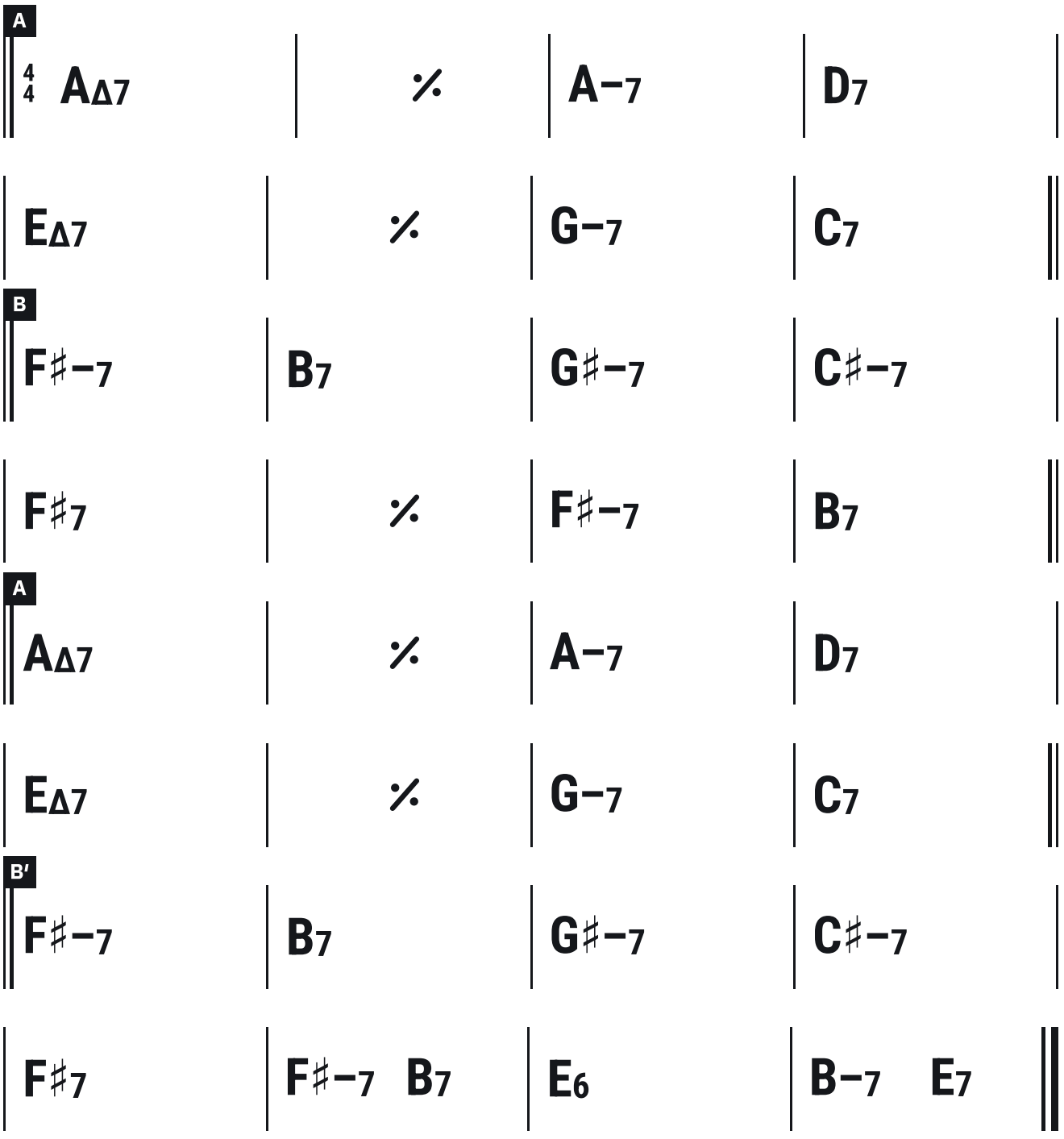
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G6	G B D E
G7	G B D F
C6	C E G A
C–6	C E♭ G A
C7	C E G B♭
D7	D F♯ A C
A7	A C♯ E G

(Up Swing)

Just Friends

John Klenner & Sam M. Lewis



Written key **E** Concert **G** Form **A B A B′ · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **170–220 bpm**

Written **1931**

Just Friends · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The melody starts on IV (AΔ7) and sits on D♯, the lydian note, so it sounds like E major from bar 1; Chet Baker 1959 is the model: behind the beat, no vibrato until the end of the note.
- The two backdoor ii–Vs are the tune: A–7 D7 (bars 3–4) wants C and G in your line; G–7 C7 (bars 7–8) wants B♭ and F, sliding into F♯–7.
- B section: F♯–7 B7 G♯–7 C♯–7 is all E major; F♯7 in bars 5–6 is the one II7, so A♯ is the note. B′ ends on B–7 E7, the turnaround into A for the next chorus; end the last one on E6.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**AΔ7**	C♯ G♯	**A–7**	C G	**D7**	F♯ C	**EΔ7**	G♯ D♯	**G–7**	B♭ F	**C7**	E B♭							
B	**F♯–7**	A E	**B7**	D♯ A	**G♯–7**	B F♯	**C♯–7**	E B	**F♯7**	A♯ E									
B′	**F♯–7**	A E	**B7**	D♯ A	**G♯–7**	B F♯	**C♯–7**	E B	**F♯7**	A♯ E	**E6**	G♯ C♯	**B–7**	D A	**E7**	G♯ D			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

IV, backdoor, I, backdoor

AΔ7: E major (A lydian, D♯). A–7 D7: G major pentatonic (C and G are the backdoor notes). EΔ7: home. G–7 C7: F major pentatonic (B♭, F) sliding into F♯–7.

B

E major with one II7

F♯–7 B7 and G♯–7 C♯–7 are diatonic; F♯7 is the II7 colour: A♯. B′: F♯–7 B7 E6 then B–7 E7 to set up the A chord at the top.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 of the first A as D7 | D7 (Chet's sub for EΔ7) · B′ bar 8 as B7 B♭7 the first time · bar 7–8 of the B as F♯–7 | B7 or F♯–7 B7 | E6.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A, B · E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

A–7 D7 · G major pent G A B D E

G–7 C7 · F major pent F G A C D

F♯7 · F♯ major pent F♯ G♯ A♯ C♯ D♯

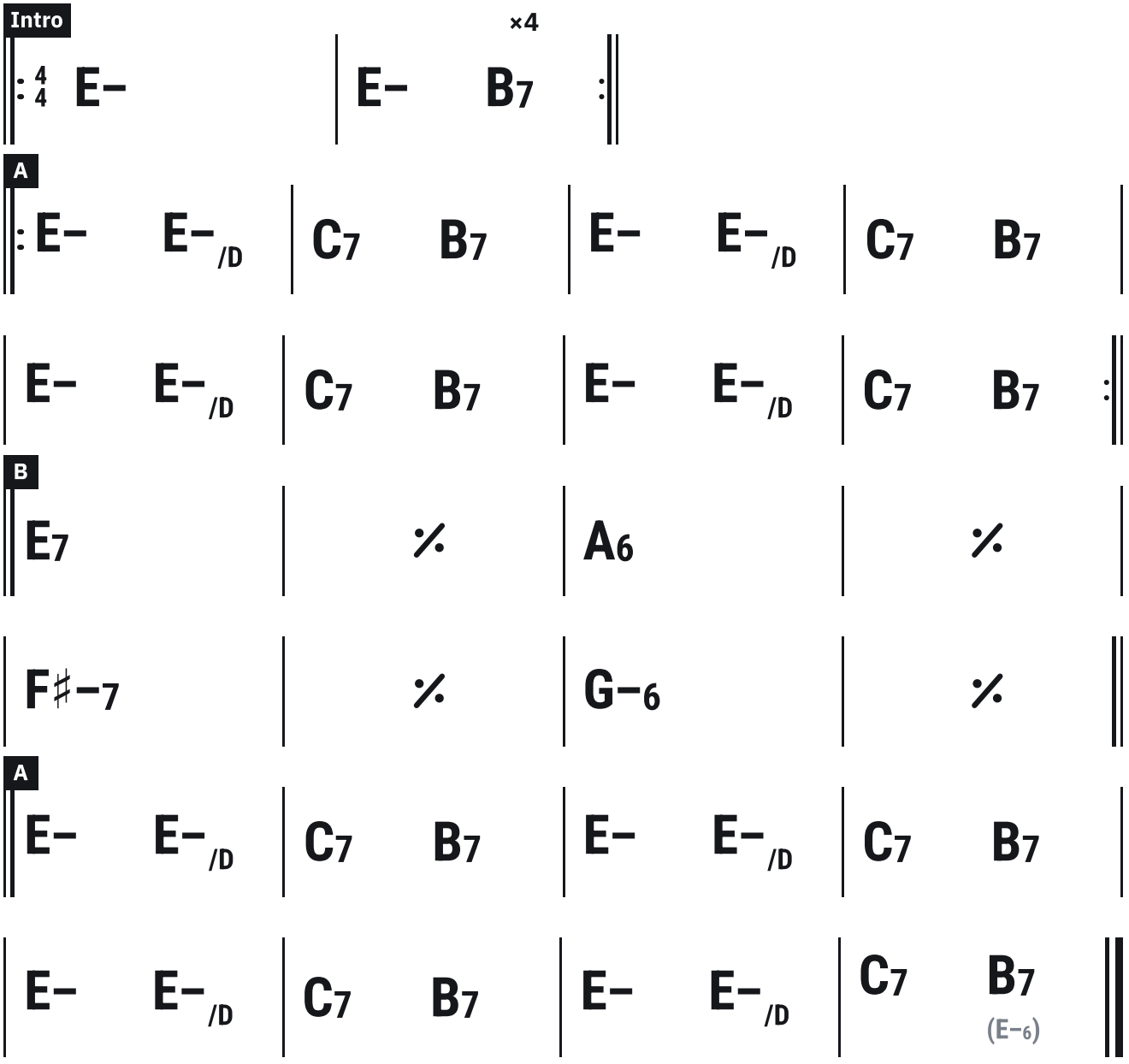
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

AΔ7	A C♯ E G♯
A–7	A C E G
D7	D F♯ A C
EΔ7	E G♯ B D♯
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
F♯–7	F♯ A C♯ E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
G♯–7	G♯ B D♯ F♯
C♯–7	C♯ E G♯ B
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E
E6	E G♯ B C♯
B–7	B D F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D

(Medium Up Swing)

Kansas City Stride

Giorgio Cuscito (Tiber River Dixieland)



Written key **E–** Concert **G–** Form **AABA · 32 + 8-bar intro** Feel **Lindy · Balboa**

Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **2011**

Kansas City Stride · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The riff over E– is the head; the C7 B7 bars are the answer, so phrase riff / answer, riff / answer, four times, and keep the B7 bar short.
- Solos: E minor pentatonic and blues on the riff bars; B♭ down to A on C7 → B7 and D♯ on the B7 name the slide. Bridge: A major pentatonic covers E7, A6 and F♯–7 (six bars), then B♭ and F on the G–6 bars, a half step above home.
- Intro: the horns stack a riff on the third and fourth time through the vamp; make it a two-bar figure that leaves the B7 kick (beats 3–4 of bar 2) to the rhythm section.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

In	**E–**	G B	**B7**	D♯ A					
A	**E–**	G B	**E–/D**	G B	**C7**	E B♭	**B7**	D♯ A	
B	**E7**	G♯ D	**A6**	C♯ F♯	**F♯–7**	A E	**G–6**	B♭ E	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

The Lester's Bounce riff: E– with a C7 B7 slide every second bar

E minor pentatonic and the E blues scale over the whole eight; the riff is the melody. The C7 B7 is a ♭VI7 → V7 slide: B♭ (7th of C7) down to A (7th of B7), and D♯ on the B7 (E harmonic minor). Anything you play on Lester's Bounce bars 1–4 works here, four times.

B

Bright for six bars, dark for two: E7 → A → F♯–7 → G–

A major pentatonic covers E7, A6 and F♯–7 in one go, with G♯ natural as the colour note against the A's G and D on the E7. Then G minor pentatonic for the G–6 bars (B♭ and F are the notes that say minor), and you are a half step above home: slide down into E minor pent on bar 25.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Intro one chord a bar (16 bars) · A bars 7–8 as E– | B7 to break the loop · bridge with A–6 and F♯ø7 for the all-minor version (that is the Lester's Bounce bridge) · G–6 played as C9 · last bar E–6.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · E minor pent E G A B D

A · E blues scale E G A B♭ B D

B · A major pent (E7, C, F♯–7) A B C♯ E F♯

B · G minor pent (G–) G B♭ C D F

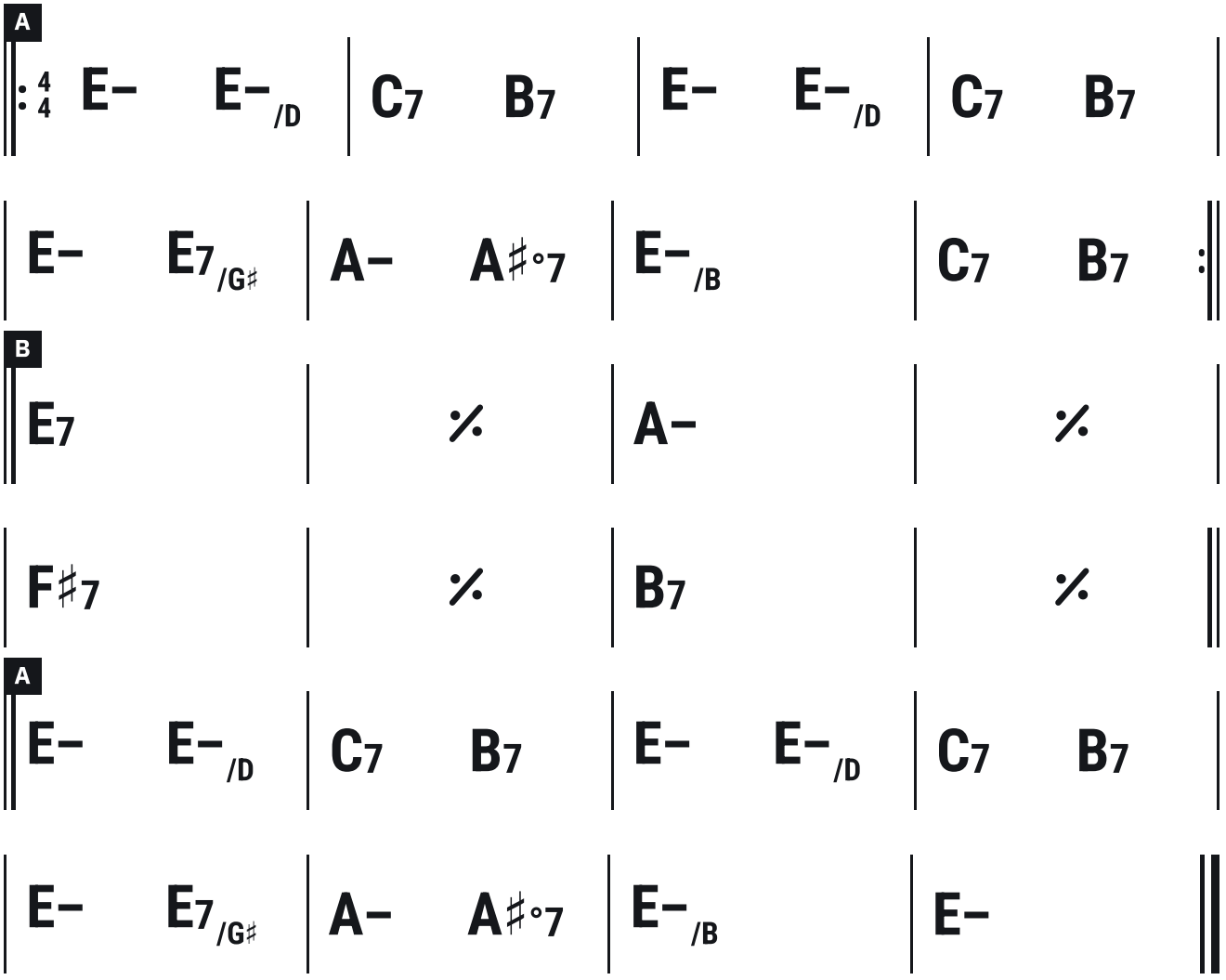
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

E–	E G B
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
E–/D	E G B
C7	C E G B♭
E7	E G♯ B D
A6	A C♯ E F♯
F♯–7	F♯ A C♯ E
G–6	G B♭ D E
E–6	E G B C♯

(Medium Swing)

Lester's Bounce

Your band's chart (Bob Wilber / Antti Sarpila recording)



Written key **E–** Concert **G–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written

Lester's Bounce · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- Clarinet-and-soprano phrasing (Wilber & Sarpila) is the model: the riff sits on the beat, the answer in bars 5–7 climbs with the bass; play the climb (E G♯ A A♯ B) in unison with the rhythm section.
- Solos: E minor pentatonic and blues over bars 1–4 (the bass line E D C B is the hook); bars 5–7 follow the bass climb E G♯ A A♯ B; C7 B7: E then D♯.
- Bridge: E7 (G♯, D) for two, A minor pentatonic for two, F♯7 (A♯) for two, B7 (D♯) for two. The 4-bar intro vamp is the A loop: come in with the riff on the fifth bar.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **E–** G B **E–/D** G B **C7** E B♭ **B7** D♯ A **E7/G♯** G♯ D **A–** C E **A♯°7** C♯ G **E–/B** G B

B **E7** G♯ D **A–** C E **F♯7** A♯ E **B7** D♯ A

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

E minor riff, chromatic bass in bars 5–7

E minor pentatonic and blues scale over bars 1–4; the bass line E – D – C – B is the hook. Bars 5–7: E7/G♯ (G♯ natural) → A– → A♯°7 (A♯) → E–/B: play the bass line's climb E G♯ A A♯ B in your line and the chords take care of themselves. C7 B7 at the end: E on the C7, D♯ on the B7.

B

Honeysuckle bridge in minor: E7 → A– → F♯7 → B7

E7 (G♯ , D) for two, A minor pentatonic for two, F♯7 (A♯) for two, B7 (D♯) for two. Same shape as the Honeysuckle Rose bridge with the IV turned minor.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Your chart is the source. Bar 6 A♯°7 can be played as F♯7/A♯; the bridge E7 as E7♭9 for the darker sound.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · E minor pent E G A B D

A · E blues scale E G A B♭ B D

B bars 3–4 · A minor pent A C D E G

B · F♯7: F♯ major pent F♯ G♯ A♯ C♯ D♯

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

E–	E G B
E–/D	E G B
C7	C E G B♭
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
E7/G♯	E G♯ B D
A–	A C E
A♯°7	A♯ C♯ E G
E–/B	E G B
E7	E G♯ B D
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E

(Medium Swing)

Lullaby of Birdland

George Shearing



Written key **D− / F** Concert **F− / A♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **150–200 bpm**

Written **1952**

Lullaby of Birdland · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- Bars 1–2 are D minor (C♯ on the A7), bar 3 onward is F major: the melody's leap in bar 3 marks the key change; play it as a lift.
- Solos: D harmonic minor over Bø7 Eø7 A7 (bars 1–2), then F major pentatonic for everything else; B♭9 in bar 7 wants A♭, Eø7 A7 at the end wants B♭ then C♯.
- Bridge: F major throughout; on each D7♭9 play F♯ and E♭, on C7♭9 E and D♭. The last bar's A7♭9 (C♯, B♭) is the door back to D minor.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **D−6** F B **Bø7** D F A **Eø7** G B♭ D **A7** C♯ G **D−7** F C **B♭Δ7** D A **G−7** B♭ F **C7** E B♭ **A−7** C G **FΔ7** A E **B♭9** D A♭

B **Aø7** C E♭ G **D7♭9** E♭ F♯ C **G−7** B♭ F **C7♭9** D♭ E B♭ **FΔ7** A E **A7♭9** B♭ C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D minor for two bars, F major for the rest

D harmonic minor over Bø7–Eø7–A7 (C♯ natural is the note). From bar 3 think F major pentatonic: G–7 C7 F and A–7 D–7 G–7 C7 are all one scale. B♭9 in bar 7: A♭ . Eø7 A7 at the end: B♭ then C♯ .

B

F major, iii–VI–ii–V–I twice

F major pentatonic for the whole bridge; on each D7♭9 play F♯ natural and E♭ , on C7♭9 play E and D♭ . The last bar's A7♭9 (C♯ , B♭) is the door back to D minor.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as E7♭9 A7♭9 · bars 3–4 as D–7 G–7 | C7 FΔ7 (Real-Book shape) · bridge bars 1–2 as FΔ7 | FΔ7 in older charts.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A bars 1–2 · D harmonic minor D E F G A B♭ C♯

A, B · F major pent F G A C D

over D–6 · D minor pent D F G A C

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D−6	D F A B
Bø7	B D F A
Eø7	E G B♭ D
A7	A C♯ E G
D−7	D F A C
B♭Δ7	B♭ D F A
G−7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
A−7	A C E G
FΔ7	F A C E
B♭9	B♭ C D F A♭
Aø7	A C E♭ G
D7♭9	D E♭ F♯ A C
C7♭9	C D♭ E G B♭
A7♭9	A B♭ C♯ E G

(Slow Shuffle)

Moanin'

Bobby Timmons



Written key **D−** Concert **F−** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Slow lindy / blues shuffle** Dance tempo **100–125 bpm**

Written **1958**

Moanin' · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The head is call-and-response: the piano calls, you answer in unison in bars 2, 4, 6 with the two-note 'amen' figure (F♯, the major 3rd, against the minor call); play it fat and together.
- Solos: D minor blues scale and D dorian over everything; target C♯ (3rd of A7) at the end of each two-bar unit and slide back to F. Gospel grace notes: E into F, G♯ into A.
- Bridge: G–7 F7 | E7 A7 | D–7 | D7 | G–7 F7 | E7 | A7 | A7: lean on the 3rds B♭ A G♯ C♯; two whole bars of A7 at the end, so say something and leave space.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D–7**	F C	**F7**	A E♭	**Eø7**	G B♭ D	**A7**	C♯ G	**E–7**	G D	**F♯–7**	A E
B	**G–7**	B♭ F	**F7**	A E♭	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G	**D–7**	F C	**D7**	F♯ C

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D minor blues, chromatic dominants underneath

D minor blues scale and D dorian over everything; the F7 – E7 – A7 chain is just a bass line under the blues scale. Target C♯ natural (3rd of A7) at the end of each two-bar unit, then slide back to F. Gospel grace notes: E into F, G♯ into A.

B

G–7 → F7 → E7 → A7, then V

Descending bass G – F – E, then A7. Lean on 3rds: B♭ A G♯ C♯. D7 in bar 4 is V of G–: F♯ natural and C. Second half opens out: two whole bars of A7, so say something and leave space.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Some charts keep the solo A as plain D–7 for eight bars · answer sometimes written G | D7 · bridge bar 4 as D7♭9.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D minor pent D F G A C

A · D blues scale D F G A♭ A C

B · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

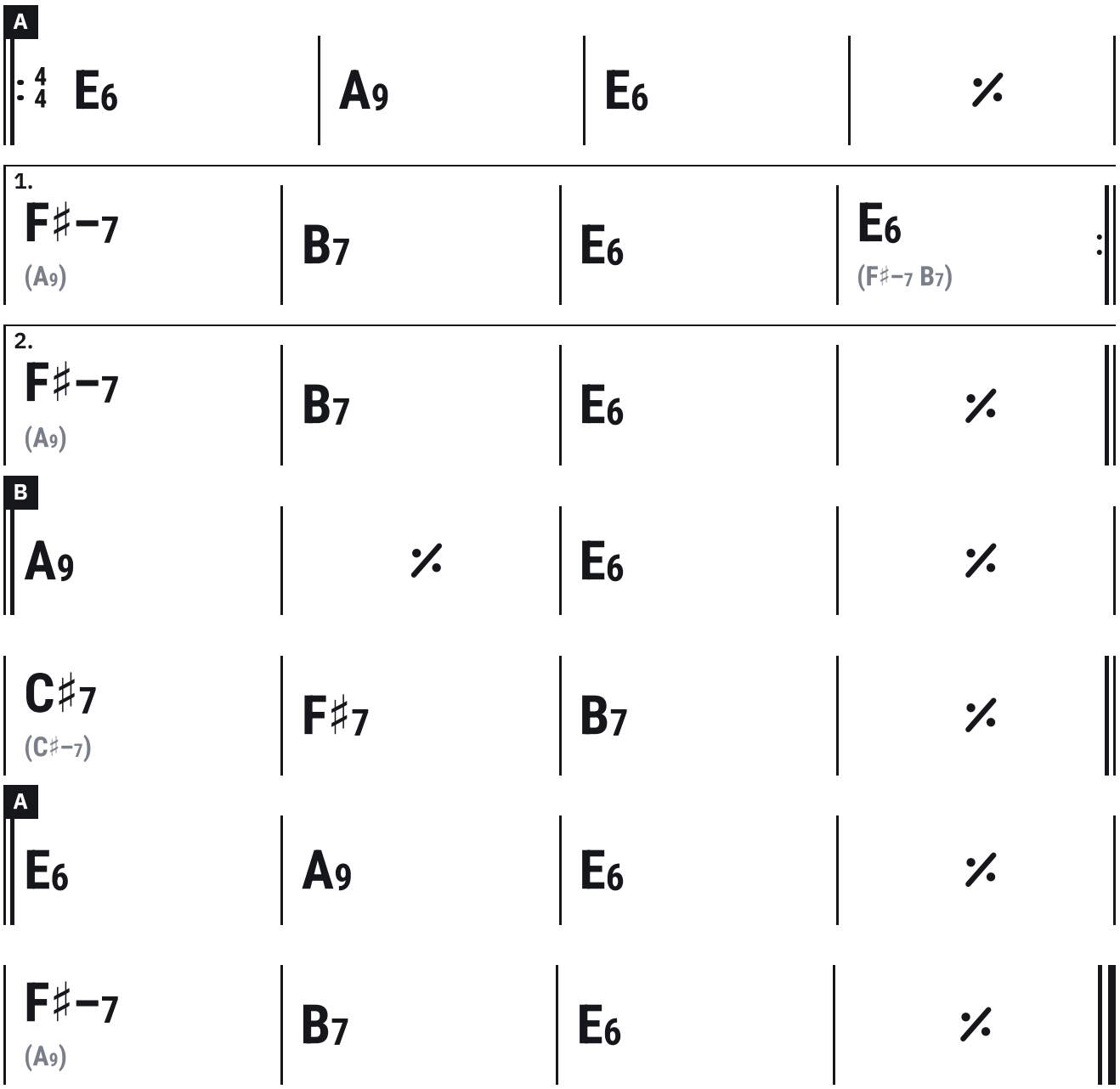
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D–7	D F A C
F7	F A C E♭
Eø7	E G B♭ D
A7	A C♯ E G
E–7	E G B D
F♯–7	F♯ A C♯ E
G–7	G B♭ D F
E7	E G♯ B D
D7	D F♯ A C

(Medium Swing)

Oh, Lady Be Good

George & Ira Gershwin



Written key **E** Concert **G** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1924**

Oh, Lady Be Good · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- Lester Young 1936 is the whole language for this tune: light, behind the beat, E major pentatonic with the blues scale, phrases that start late in the bar.
- Bar 2 (A9): the G against the band's G♯ is the blues in the tune; bars 5–6 (F♯–7 B7): D rising to D♯.
- Bridge: A major for two bars (G on the A9), E for two, then C♯7 → F♯7 → B7: F, A♯, D♯ on the downbeats and you've played the bridge.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **E6** G♯ C♯ **A9** C♯ G **F♯–7** A E **B7** D♯ A

B **A9** C♯ G **E6** G♯ C♯ **C♯7** F B **F♯7** A♯ E **B7** D♯ A

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

E major, four bars, then a ii–V

E major pentatonic plus the blues scale; the A9's **G** against the band's G♯ is the blues in bar 2. Bars 5–6, F♯–7 B7: **D** rising to **D♯**.

B

IV, I, then VI7 → II7 → V7

A major for two bars (A9: G), E for two, then the chain: C♯7 wants **F**, F♯7 wants **A♯**, B7 wants **D♯**. Play those three notes on the downbeats and you've played the bridge.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 5 as F♯7 or A9 · bridge bars 1–2 as E7 | E7 (Honeysuckle shape) · bar 8 of A2 as B7 into the bridge.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

A · E blues scale E G A B♭ B D

B bars 1–2 · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

B · F♯7: F♯ major pent F♯ G♯ A♯ C♯ D♯

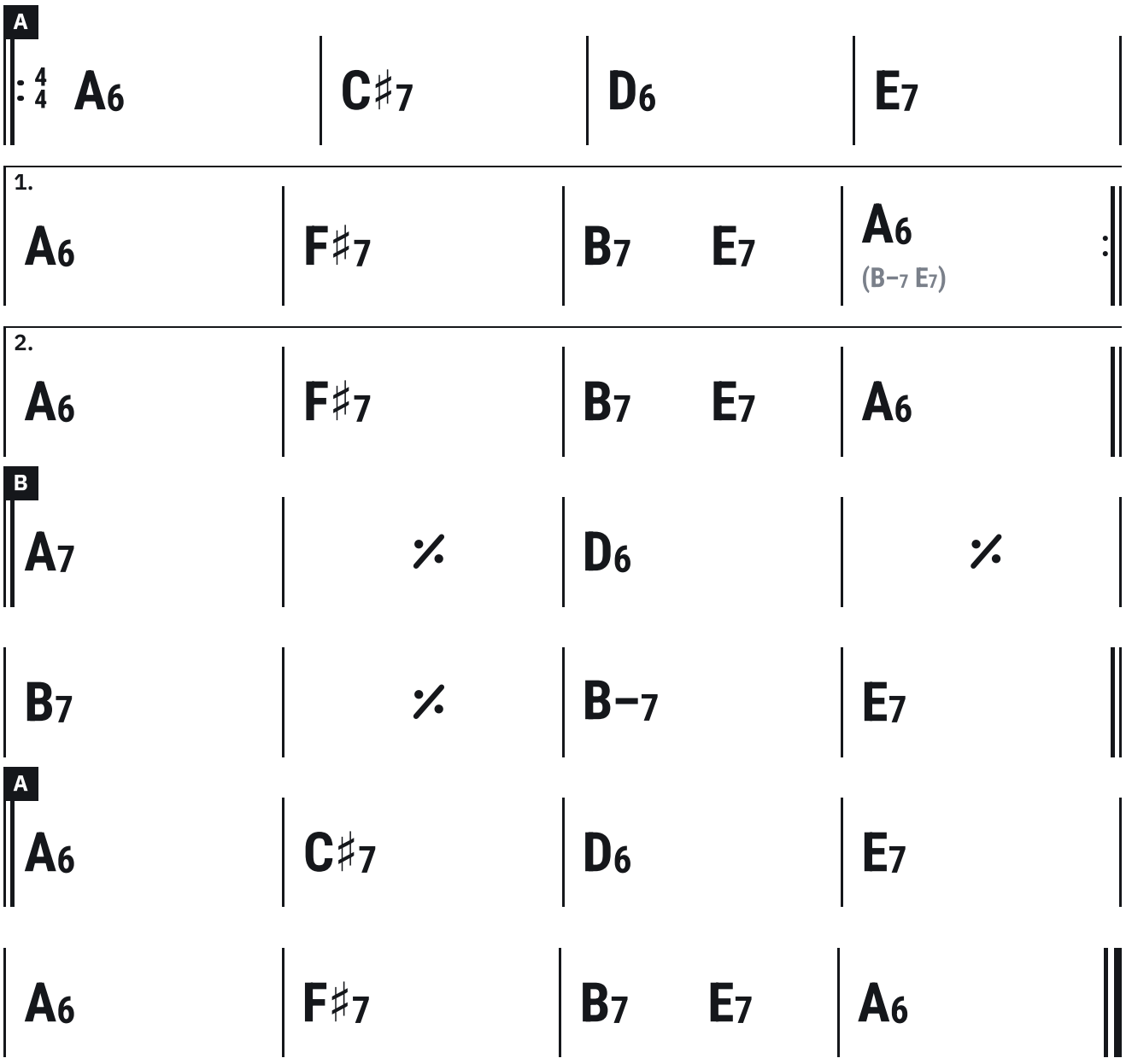
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

E6	E G♯ B C♯
A9	A B C♯ E G
F♯–7	F♯ A C♯ E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
C♯7	C♯ F G♯ B
C♯–7	C♯ E G♯ B
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E

(Medium Swing)

On the Sunny Side of the Street

Jimmy McHugh & Dorothy Fields



Written key **A** Concert **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lazy lindy / blues** Dance tempo **110–140 bpm**

Written **1930**

On the Sunny Side of the Street · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- Lay back: the melody sits behind the beat at 120, and the long notes in bars 1 and 5 (A6) want a slow vibrato at the end.
- Three dominants, three notes: F on C♯7 (bar 2), A♯ on F♯7 (bar 6), D♯ on B7 (bar 7). Hit those on the beat and the tune is in the room; A major pentatonic covers the rest.
- Bridge: A7 (G) for two bars, D for two, B7 (D♯) for two, B–7 E7 home; the A blues scale sits fine over the first four bars.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**A6**	C♯ F♯	**C♯7**	F B	**D6**	F♯ B	**E7**	G♯ D	**F♯7**	A♯ E	**B7**	D♯ A
B	**A7**	C♯ G	**D6**	F♯ B	**B7**	D♯ A	**B–7**	D A	**E7**	G♯ D		

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A major, bending three notes in

A major pentatonic all the way, except the three dominants that each ask for one note: C♯7 wants F (bar 2), F♯7 wants A♯ (bar 6), B7 wants D♯ (bar 7). Hit those on the beat and the tune is in the room.

B

A7 → D → B7 → B–7 E7

A mixolydian (G) for two bars, D major for two, B7 (D♯) for two, then ii–V home. A blues scale sits fine over the first four bars.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–7 also played F♯–7 | B7 | B–7 E7 · bridge as E–7 A7 | E–7 A7 | D6 | D6 | F♯–7 B7 | F♯–7 B7 | B–7 | E7, or ending B7 | B7 | E7 | E7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

A, B · A blues scale A C D E♭ E G

B · D major pent D E F♯ A B

B · B7: B major pent B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯
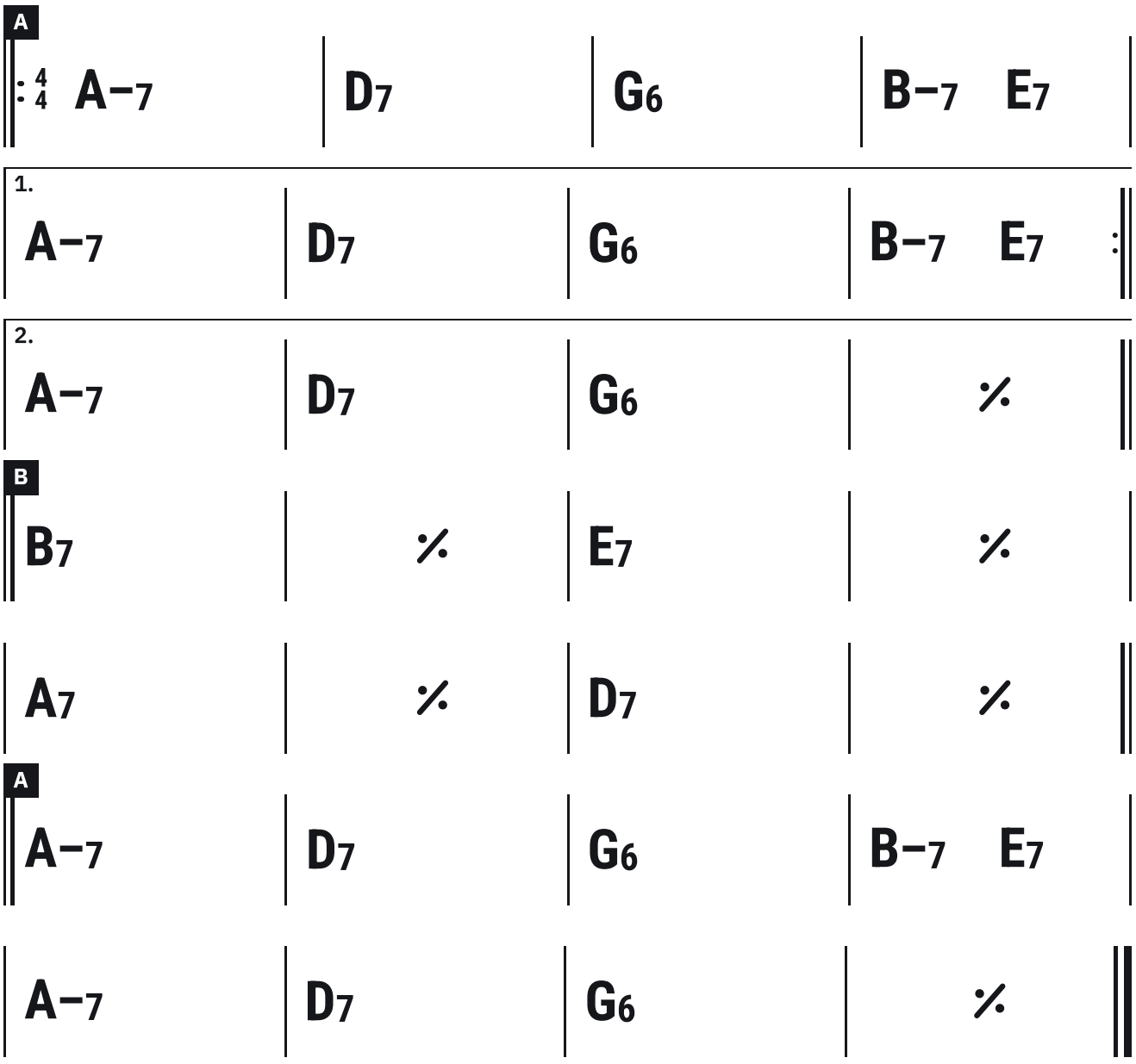
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A6	A C♯ E F♯
C♯7	C♯ F G♯ B
D6	D F♯ A B
E7	E G♯ B D
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
B–7	B D F♯ A
A7	A C♯ E G

(Medium Up Swing)

Perdido

Juan Tizol



Written key **G** Concert **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1941**

Perdido · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The riff (G major pentatonic, two bars long) is the head: in unison, short, and let the rhythm section answer in bars 3–4 (G6 | B–7 E7).
- Solos: G major pentatonic; G♯ on E7 drops you onto A–7 every four bars; the blues scale over the D7s.
- Bridge: the rhythm bridge B7 → E7 → A7 → D7; 3rds D♯ G♯ C♯ F♯ on the downbeats. Anything you play on I Got Rhythm's bridge works here.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**A–7**	C G	**D7**	F♯ C	**G6**	B E	**B–7**	D A	**E7**	G♯ D
B	**B7**	D♯ A	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G	**D7**	F♯ C		

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G major with a VI7 pull

The riff is G major pentatonic and so is the solo; the only non-diatonic note you need is G♯ natural on E7, which drops you onto A–7 every four bars. Blues scale over the D7s.

B

The rhythm bridge: B7 E7 A7 D7

Two bars each; targets D♯ G♯ C♯ F♯. Identical to the I Got Rhythm bridge, so anything you play there works here.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A as G6 | G6 | G6 | G6 | A–7 D7 | A–7 D7 | G6 | G6 in some charts · bridge bar 4 as E7♯5 (Hawkins' rhythm section).

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G major pent G A B D E

A · G blues scale G B♭ C D♭ D F

B · B7: B major pent (then E, C, D) B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯

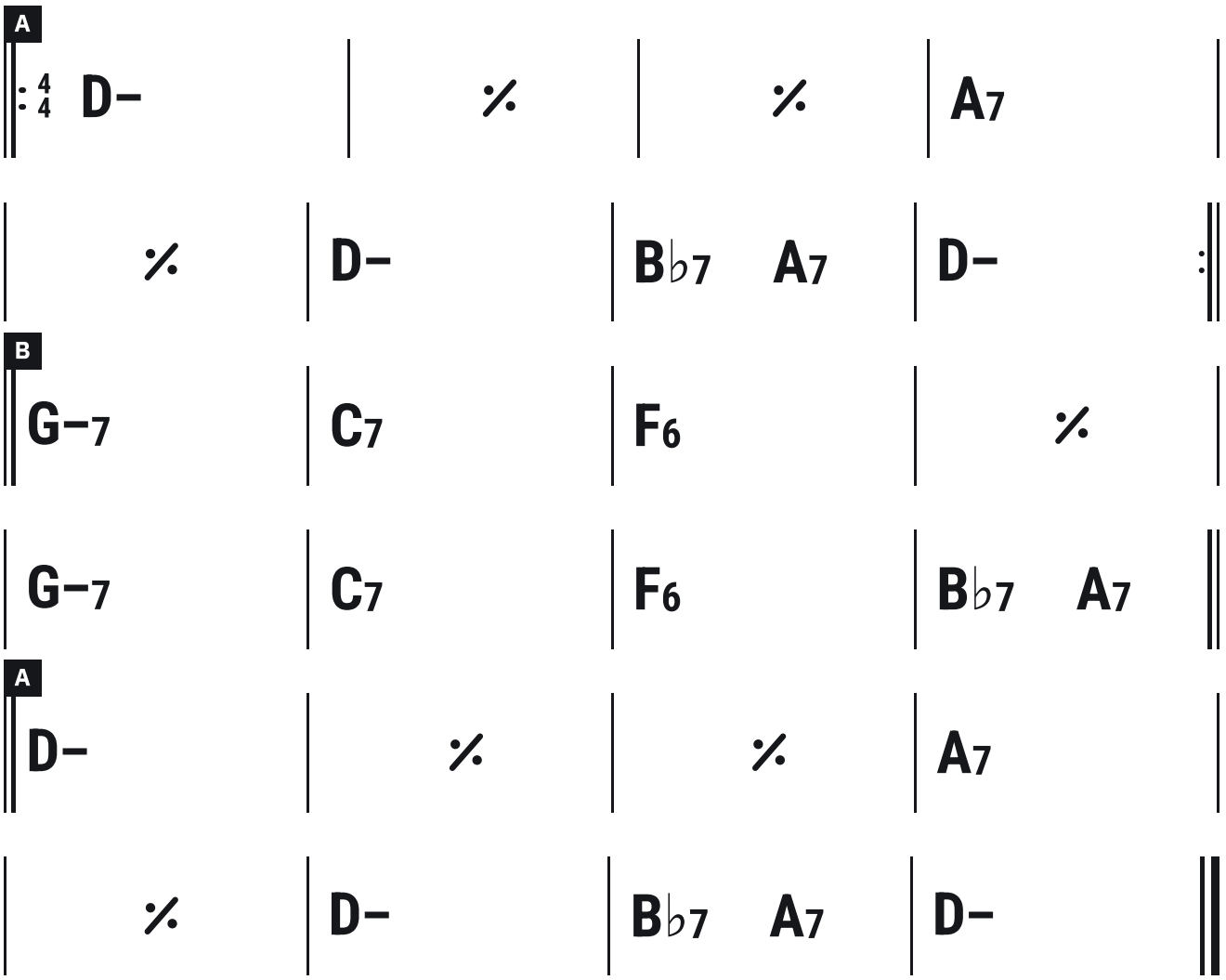
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A–7	A C E G
D7	D F♯ A C
G6	G B D E
B–7	B D F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
A7	A C♯ E G

(Up Swing)

Puttin' On the Ritz

Irving Berlin



Written key **D– → F** Concert **F– → A♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Charleston / Balboa**

Dance tempo **200–240 bpm** Written **1929**

Puttin' On the Ritz · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- Berlin's melody is a minor arpeggio displaced across the barline: count it, don't feel it, until it's in your body; the rhythm is the tune.
- A: D minor pentatonic and blues; C♯ on A7 (bars 4–5), the B♭7 → A7 slide in bar 7. Bridge: F major for seven bars (G–7 C7 F6 twice), bright and legato, then B♭7 A7: land C♯ on the A7.
- Breathe in bar 8 of each A (D–, held): the melody rests there and the Charleston tempo gives you nothing else.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **D–** F A **A7** C♯ G **B♭7** D A♭

B **G–7** B♭ F **C7** E B♭ **F6** A D **B♭7** D A♭ **A7** C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D minor, A7 = D harmonic minor

D minor pentatonic and blues scale on the D– bars; on A7, C♯ natural with B♭ (D harmonic minor). The B♭7 – A7 slide: B♭7's D/A♭ falls to A7's C♯ /G. Berlin's melody is a minor arpeggio shifted across the bar; shift your own three-note cell the same way.

B

Relative major F: ii–V–I twice

G dorian, C mixolydian and F major are one scale: F major. Play sunlight for seven bars, then B♭7 – A7 slams the door back to D–; land on C♯ for the A7.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bar 4–5 as one bar A7 and one bar D– in some charts · bridge ending as B♭7 | A7 over two bars.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D minor pent D F G A C

A, over A7 · D harmonic minor D E F G A B♭ C♯

B · F major pent F G A C D

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D–	D F A
A7	A C♯ E G
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
F6	F A C D

(Up Swing)

Ridin' and Jivin'

Earl Hines, your band's chart



Written key **D–** Concert **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Fast lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **150 bpm**

Written **1939**

Ridin' and Jivin' · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The loop is a four-chord riff (i, i/♭7, ♭VI7, V7): the head is a riff on it, so play short notes in unison and let the bass line D – C – B♭ – A be the floor.
- Solos: D minor pentatonic and blues all the way; B♭ on B♭7 and C♯ on A7 when you want to name the chords. Bridge: C7 (B♭, E), F then F7 (E♭), D7 (F♯: two bars of major in a minor tune), then G–7 G♯°7 A7: B♭ → B → C♯, a chromatic climb into the last A.
- The bridge is marked 'slide in D slooow' on the score: a glissando into the D7 bars. The post-intro is eight bars of the loop with the horns riffing before the head.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **D–7** F C **D–7/C** F C **B♭7** D A♭ **A7** C♯ G

B **C7** E B♭ **F6** A D **F7** A E♭ **D7** F♯ C **G–7** B♭ F **G♯°7** B F **A7** C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D minor over a four-chord loop

D minor pentatonic and blues scale all the way; the loop's bass line D – C – B♭ – A is the hook. Name the chords when you want to: B♭ on B♭7, C♯ natural on A7, then back to F.

B

♭VII7 → ♭III → I7 → iv → V

C7: C mixolydian (B♭ , E). F then F7 (E♭). D7 is the surprise: F♯ natural, two bars of major in a minor tune. G–7 G♯°7 A7: B♭ → B → C♯ , a chromatic climb into the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Your chart is the source. Hines's record has more passing chords in the bridge; the bass line is the same.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D minor pent D F G A C

A · D blues scale D F G A♭ A C

B · F major pent (C7, F) F G A C D

B bars 5–6 · D major pent (D7) D E F♯ A B

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D–7	D F A C
D–7/C	D F A C
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
A7	A C♯ E G
C7	C E G B♭
F6	F A C D
F7	F A C E♭
D7	D F♯ A C
G–7	G B♭ D F
G♯°7	G♯ B D F

(Medium Swing)

Satin Doll

Duke Ellington & Billy Strayhorn



Written key **A** Concert **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / slow swing** Dance tempo **130–160 bpm**

Written **1953**

Satin Doll · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The melody is the same two-note figure moved up by step (B–7 E7 → C♯–7 F♯7): play the second one exactly like the first, a step higher, and the tune is instantly recognisable.
- Solos: think the target key of each ii–V: A major on B–7 E7, B major (A♯, D♯) on C♯–7 F♯7, E major (D♯) on F♯–7 B7, E♭ major (A♭, D) on F–7 B♭7, then A.
- Bridge: D major (G on the A7) for four bars, E major (D♯) on F♯–7 B7, then two bars of E7: D natural, and leave space for the drummer.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **B–7** D A **E7** G♯ D **C♯–7** E B **F♯7** A♯ E **F♯–7** A E **B7** D♯ A **F–7** A♭ E♭ **B♭7** D A♭ **A6** C♯ F♯

B **E–7** G D **A7** C♯ G **D6** F♯ B **F♯–7** A E **B7** D♯ A **E7** G♯ D

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

Think the target key of each ii–V

B–7 E7: A major pentatonic. C♯–7 F♯7: B major pentatonic (A♯ , D♯). F♯–7 B7: E major pentatonic (D♯). F–7 B♭7: E♭ major pentatonic (A♭ , D), which lands you a half step above A so the resolution is physical. Then A.

B

D major, then E major, then V

E–7 A7 D: D major pentatonic (G on the A7). F♯–7 B7: E major pentatonic (D♯). Two bars of E7: D natural, and leave space for the drummer.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

First-F♯ bar 8 as C♯–7 F♯7 · bar 6 as B–7 E7 (the sheet) instead of the tritone sub · bridge bars 7–8 as B–7 E7 | B–7 E7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

B–7 E7 · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

C♯–7 F♯7 · B major pent B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯

F♯–7 B7 · E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

F–7 B♭7 · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

B · D major pent D E F♯ A B
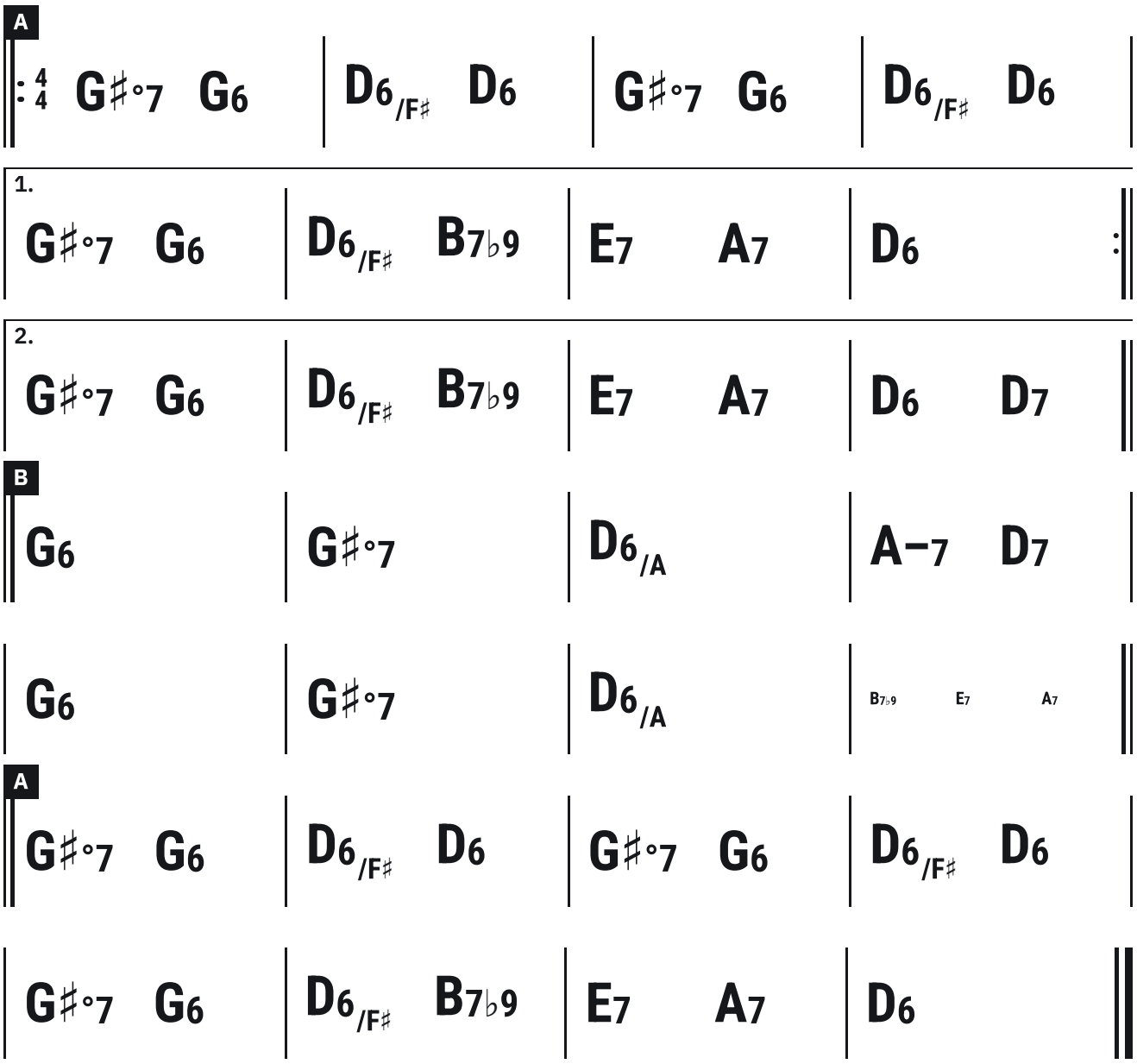
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

B–7	B D F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
C♯–7	C♯ E G♯ B
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E
F♯–7	F♯ A C♯ E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
F–7	F A♭ C E♭
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
A6	A C♯ E F♯
E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G
D6	D F♯ A B

(Medium Swing)

A Smooth One

Benny Goodman & Charlie Christian



Written key **D** Concert **F** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lazy lindy** Dance tempo **120 bpm** Written **1941**

A Smooth One · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The riff is the melody and it sits on the bass line G♯ – G – F♯ – D: legato and lazy at 120, Goodman Sextet style; the clarinet or sax leads, the trumpet doubles an octave below.
- Solos: D major pentatonic over the riff; G♯ on G♯°7, D♯ and C on B7♭9, G♯ on E7, C♯ on A7. Bridge: G major pentatonic over G6, G♯°7, D6/A; A–7 D7 is a backdoor ii–V back to G (C); the last bar's B7♭9 E7 A7 wants D♯ G♯ C♯, one per chord, on the beat.
- Intro: 8 bars of piano and drums, you enter at the top of the A; the second ending (D6 D7) leads into the bridge. The tag has an N.C. pickup bar: breathe, then play it.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**G♯°7**	B F	**G6**	B E	**D6/F♯**	F♯ B	**D6**	F♯ B	**B7♭9**	C D♯ A	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G	**D7**	F♯ C			
B	**G6**	B E	**G♯°7**	B F	**D6/A**	F♯ B	**A–7**	C G	**D7**	F♯ C	**B7♭9**	C D♯ A	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D major over a walking bass riff

D major pentatonic; the riff's bass G♯ – G – F♯ – D is the melody's shadow, so play it in the left hand and solo above it. G♯°7 is an E7♭9 in disguise: G♯ natural. B7♭9 → D♯ and C ; E7 → G♯ ; A7 → C♯ .

B

The riff from IV, then three dominants in a bar

G major pentatonic over G6, G♯°7 and D6/A; A–7 D7 is a backdoor ii–V back to G (C). The last bar, B7♭9 E7 A7: D♯ G♯ C♯ , one per chord, on the beat.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Jam charts read the A as D | D7/A G♯°7 | G–6 D/A: G–6 is the ear's version of your G6 under the melody's B natural · session key D; the Goodman/Christian record may be in F.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D major pent D E F♯ A B

A · D blues scale D F G A♭ A C

B · G major pent G A B D E

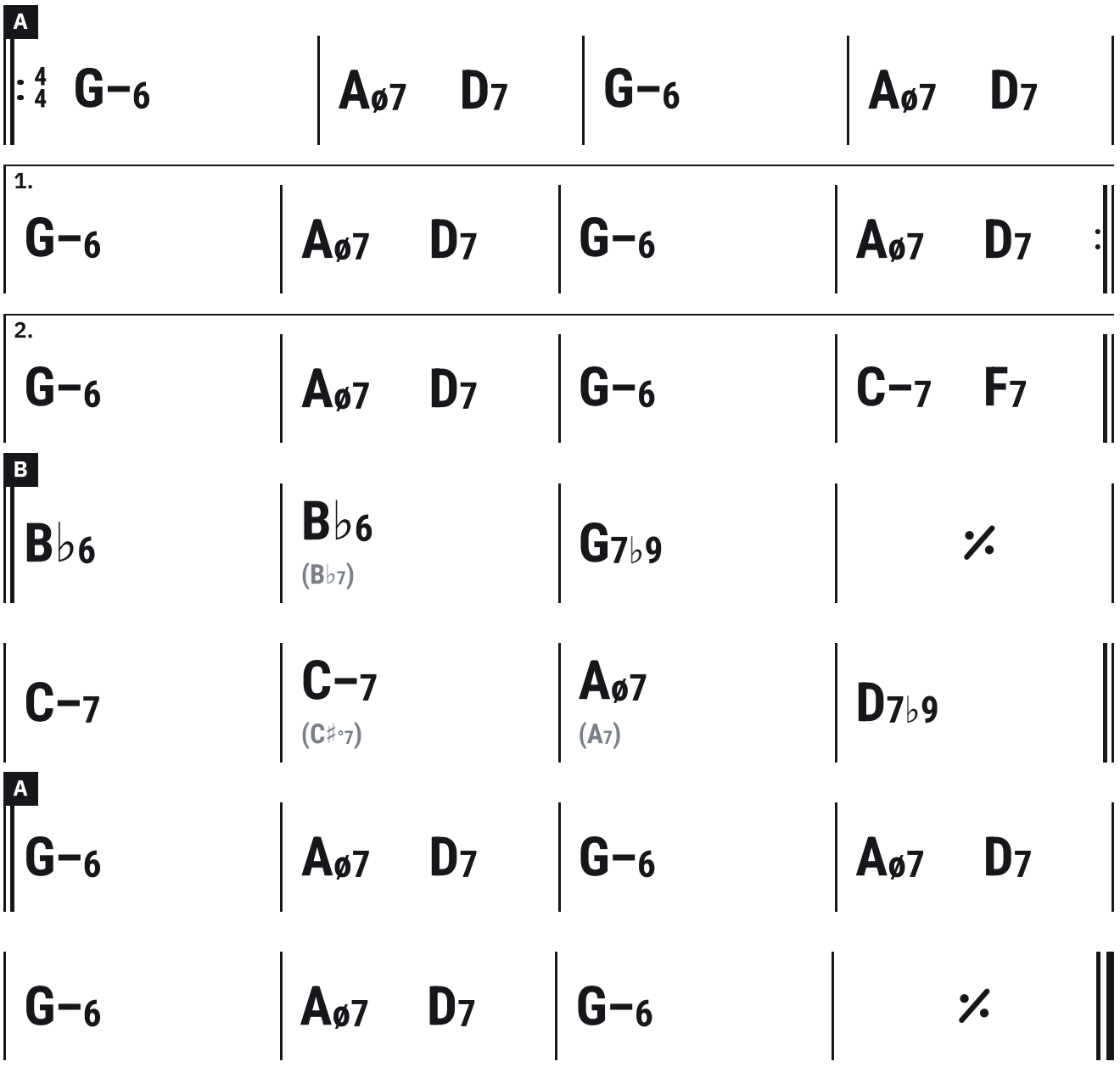
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G♯°7	G♯ B D F
G6	G B D E
D6/F♯	D F♯ A B
D6	D F♯ A B
B7♭9	B C D♯ F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
A7	A C♯ E G
D7	D F♯ A C
D6/A	D F♯ A B
A–7	A C E G

(Latin / Swing)

Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise

Sigmund Romberg



Written key **G−** Concert **B♭−** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Balboa 180–210 · Lindy** Dance tempo **160–190 bpm**

Written **1928**

Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- One minor ii–V–i eight times under a melody that barely moves: a dark, straight tone on the Latin A, then open up and swing on the bridge.
- Solos: treat the A as one G minor zone (G minor pentatonic and blues, the MJQ way), or name the changes: E natural on G–6, E♭ and F♯ on D7. Bridge: B♭ major for two bars, G7♭9 (B natural, A♭) pulling to C–7 (E♭ major pentatonic), then A7 or Aø7 (C♯ or C) into D7♭9 (F♯, E♭) home. Target 3rds: D → B → E♭ → C♯ → F♯.
- Sonny Rollins at the Village Vanguard is the tempo and phrasing reference; he plays it a whole step above this key, so lines lifted from the record come down a step.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**G–6**	B♭ E	**Aø7**	C E♭ G	**D7**	F♯ C	**C–7**	E♭ B♭	**F7**	A E♭					
B	**B♭6**	D G	**G7♭9**	A♭ B F	**C–7**	E♭ B♭	**Aø7**	C E♭ G	**D7♭9**	E♭ F♯ C					

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

One minor ii–V–i, eight times

G–6 = G melodic minor / G dorian; the **E** natural is the MJQ colour. D7 = G harmonic minor: **E♭** and **F♯**. Or do what the MJQ did and treat the A as one G minor zone: G minor pentatonic and blues scale straight across, resolving to **B♭** or **D** on each G–6. Tritone sub to try: E♭7 for Aø7–D7.

B

Relative major: B♭ → G7♭9 → C– → A7 → D7♭9

B♭ major for two bars. G7♭9 = C harmonic minor (**B** natural, A♭, E♭) pulling to C–7 (C dorian, E♭ major). Then A7 / Aø7 (**C♯** or **C**) into D7♭9 (**F♯** + E♭) and back to G–. Target 3rds: D → B → E♭ → C♯ → F♯.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bridge in the original sheet (transposed): B♭ | B♭ B♭7/A♭ | G7♭9 | G7♭9 | C– C–/B♭ | A7 | D7♭9 | D7♭9 · learnjazzstandards sub: B♭ | Dø7 G7 | C–7 | Eø7 A7 | D7 · session key A–: everything a whole step up.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

A, over D7 · G harmonic minor G A B♭ C D E♭ F♯

B bars 1–2 · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

B bars 5–6 · C minor pent C E♭ F G B♭

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G–6	G B♭ D E
Aø7	A C E♭ G
D7	D F♯ A C
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
B♭6	B♭ D F G
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
G7♭9	G A♭ B D F
C♯°7	C♯ E G B♭
A7	A C♯ E G
D7♭9	D E♭ F♯ A C

(Medium Swing)

Stompin' at the Savoy

Edgar Sampson



Written key **B♭** Concert **D♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy 160–190 · Balboa** Dance tempo **190–220 bpm**

Written **1934**

Stompin' at the Savoy · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The A is a riff in B♭ major pentatonic (plus the blue C♯): short, together, and let the rhythm section's riff answer. The held notes over bars 5–8 are where the Lindy floor breathes.
- Solos: B♭ major pentatonic plus C♯ for the whole A; B natural and G♯ on the B°7 in bar 4 (or think F7♭9). Bridge: E♭7 → G♯7 → C♯7 → F♯7 → F7, dominants dropping a fourth; 3rds G C F A♯ A. The 3rd/7th pairs fall a half step each time (G/C♯ → F♯/C → F/B → E/A♯ → E♭/A): play that line alone once and you'll never lose the bridge.
- Ignore the half-step pushes (E9, A9, D9) on beats 3–4 of the bridge's odd bars: they're the rhythm section's, not yours.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**B♭6**	D G	**F9**	A E♭	**B°7**	D A♭	**C−7**	E♭ B♭	**F7**	A E♭									
B	**E♭9**	G D♭	**E9**	G♯ D	**G♯9**	C F♯	**A9**	C♯ G	**C♯9**	F B	**D9**	F♯ C	**F♯9**	A♯ E	**F9**	A E♭			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

B♭ major, start to finish

It's a riff tune: B♭ major pentatonic plus the blue C♯ (♭3) covers the whole A. On bar 4, B°7 wants B and G♯ (or think F7♭9). Bars 5–6 are a plain ii–V back to B♭.

B

E♭7 → G♯7 → C♯7 → F♯7 → F7

Dominants dropping a fourth. Mixolydian on each. Target the 3rds: G C F A♯ A. The 3rd/7th pairs each fall a half step: G/C♯ → F♯/C → F/B → E/A♯ → E♭/A. Play that line alone once and you'll never lose the bridge again.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bar 2 as B♭6 F7 · bars 7–8 as B♭6 G–7 | C–7 F7 (the Clifford Brown/Max Roach version).

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

A · B♭ blues scale B♭ D♭ E♭ E F A♭

B · E♭7: E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

B · G♯7: G♯ major pent G♯ A♯ C D♯ F

B · C♯7: C♯ major pent C♯ D♯ F G♯ A♯

B · F♯7: F♯ major pent F♯ G♯ A♯ C♯ D♯

B · F7: F major pent F G A C D

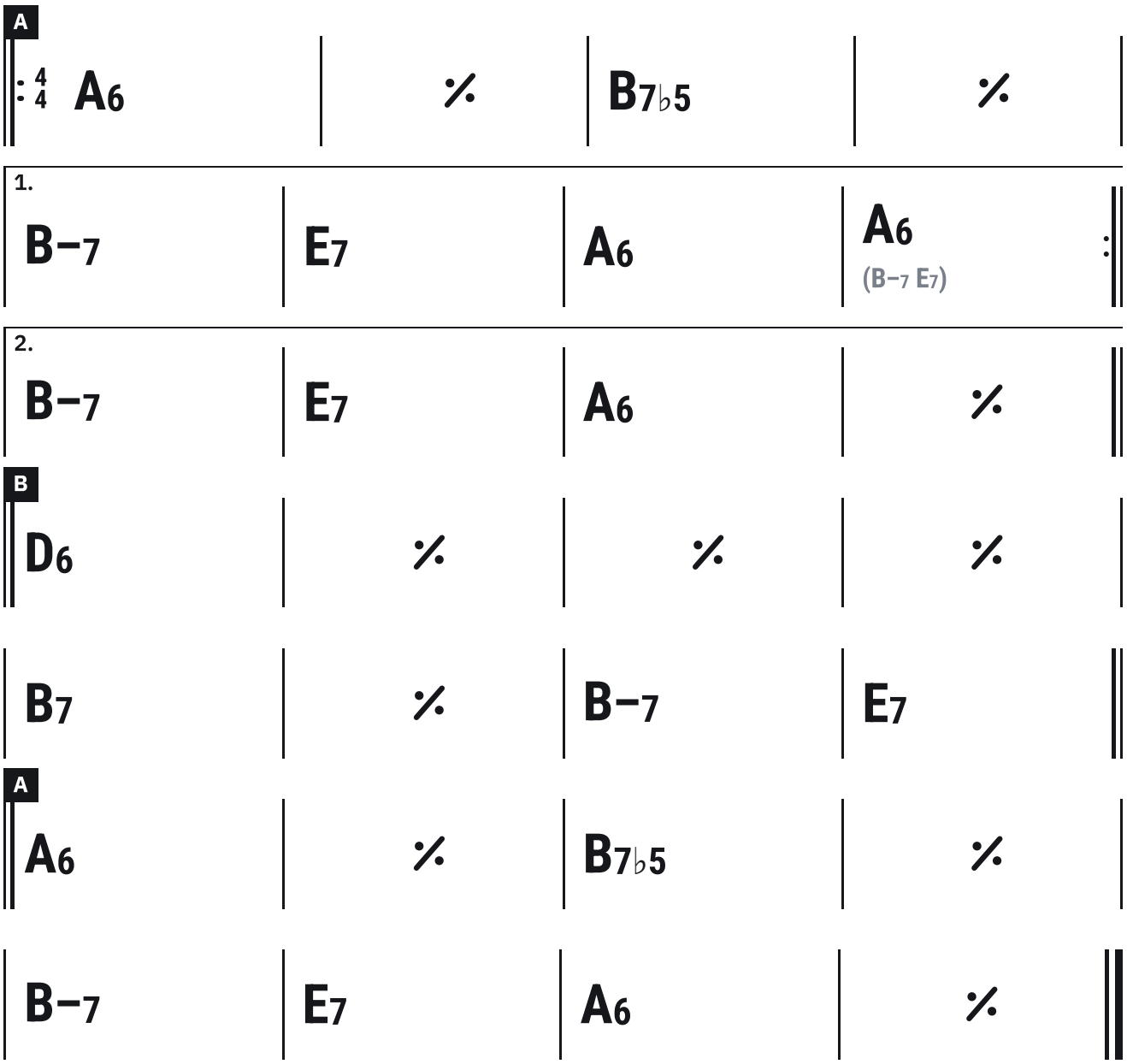
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

B♭6	B♭ D F G
F9	F G A C E♭
B°7	B D F A♭
C−7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
E♭9	E♭ F G B♭ D♭
E9	E F♯ G♯ B D
G♯9	G♯ A♯ C D♯ F♯
A9	A B C♯ E G
C♯9	C♯ D♯ F G♯ B
D9	D E F♯ A C
F♯9	F♯ G♯ A♯ C♯ E

(Medium Up Swing)

Take the “A” Train

Billy Strayhorn



Written key **A** Concert **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1941**

Take the “A” Train · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The long notes in bars 3–4 sit on the B7♭5 (the F is the tune's sound): play them straight and bright; Ray Nance's trumpet lead is the model.
- Solos: A major pentatonic in bars 1–2, B lydian dominant (B C♯ D♯ F F♯ G♯ A) in bars 3–4 with D♯ and F together, plain ii–V–I in bars 5–8. Bridge: four bars of D major, then B7 (D♯, A♯ for lydian colour), B–7 E7 home.
- The ending is a three-note tag repeated, then a ♭VI (F6) before the final A6: the tag is a horn line, in unison, and hold the last note through the F6.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**A6**	C♯ F♯	**B7♭5**	D♯ F A	**B–7**	D A	**E7**	G♯ D
B	**D6**	F♯ B	**B7**	D♯ A	**B–7**	D A	**E7**	G♯ D

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A major, with one special chord

Bars 1–2: A major pentatonic. Bars 3–4 are the tune's sound: B lydian dominant (B C♯ D♯ F F♯ G♯ A), the D♯ and F together. Bars 5–8: plain ii–V–I in A.

B

D major (IV), then B7 home

Four bars of D major; then B7 where D♯ is the money note (A♯ for lydian colour), into B–7 E7 and back to A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 3–4 as B9♯11 · bridge bars 5–6 as B7 | B7♭9 · some charts split A1's last bar as A6 F♯7 | B–7 E7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

A bars 3–4 · B7♭5 + C♯ B D♯ F A C♯

B · D major pent D E F♯ A B

B · B7: B major pent B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯
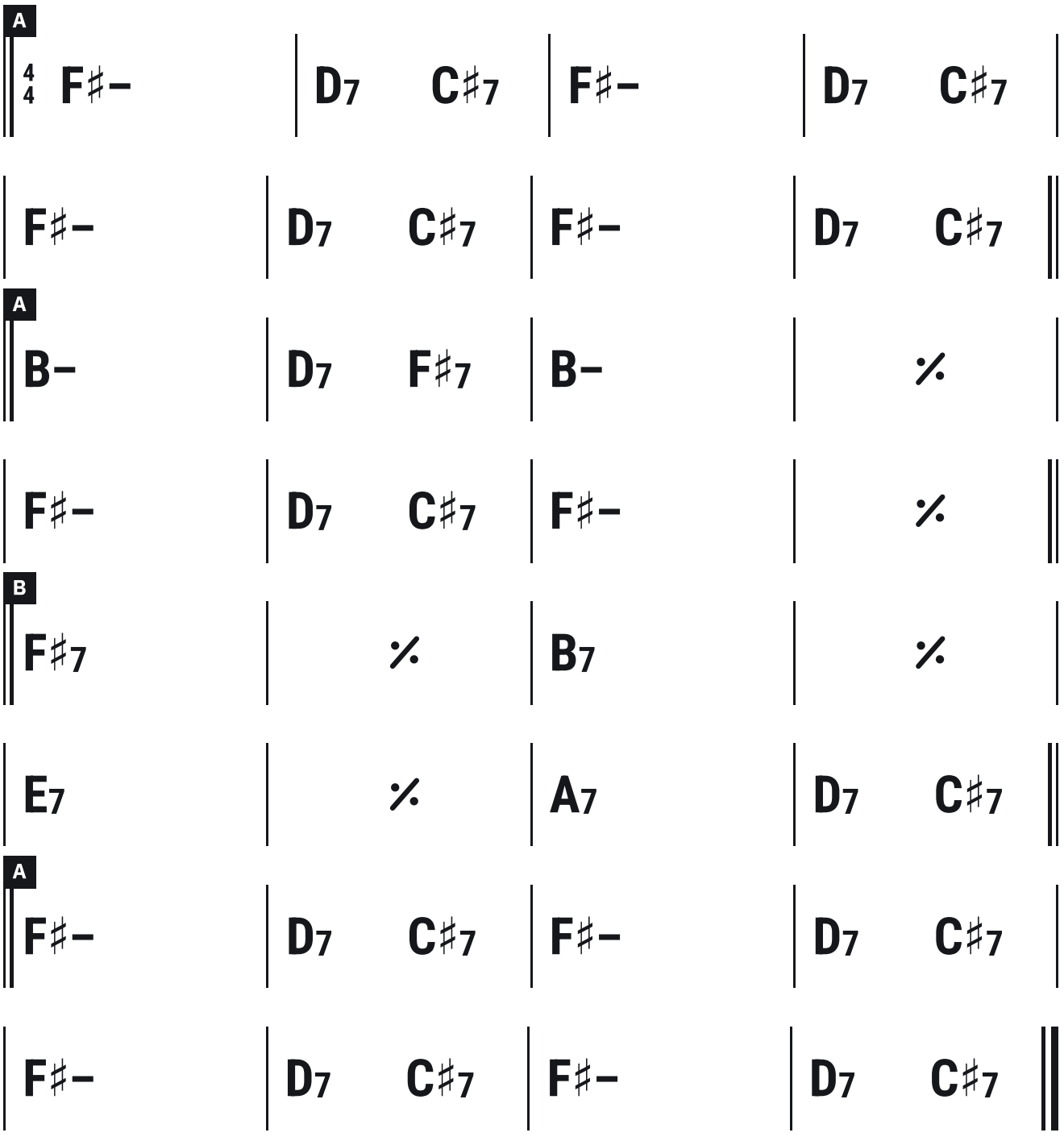
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A6	A C♯ E F♯
B7♭5	B D♯ F A
B–7	B D F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
D6	D F♯ A B
B7	B D♯ F♯ A

(Medium Up Swing)

Topsy

Eddie Durham & Edgar Battle (for Count Basie)



Written key **F♯–** Concert **A–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **165–200 bpm**

Written **1937**

Topsy · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- The riff (F♯ minor pentatonic, two bars) is the head; the D7 C♯7 bars are the rhythm section's answer, so play the riff short and leave the even bars open.
- Bar 16: your pickup F F♯ G♯ into the bridge (over the F♯–) is on the score, and the bridge figure (♯7 – 1 – 2 of each dominant: F F♯ G♯, A♯ B C♯, D♯ E F♯, G♯ A B) is the bridge melody; play it in unison.
- Solos: F♯ minor pentatonic and blues on the riff bars; C sliding to B on D7 → C♯7, F on the C♯7; B minor pentatonic for the second A's B– bars (A♯ on the F♯7 in bar 10). Bridge: A♯, D♯, G♯, C♯ on the downbeats of F♯7, B7, E7, A7.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**F♯–**	A C♯	**D7**	F♯ C	**C♯7**	F B	**B–**	D F♯	**F♯7**	A♯ E	
B	**F♯7**	A♯ E	**B7**	D♯ A	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G	**D7**	F♯ C	**C♯7**	F B

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F♯ minor, with D7 C♯7 every other bar

F♯ minor pentatonic and the F♯ blues scale carry the riff bars. The D7 C♯7 bars are a ♭VI7 → V7 slide: C (the 7th of D7) sliding to B (7th of C♯7), and F on the C♯7 (F♯ harmonic minor). The second A's B– bars: B minor pentatonic, with A♯ on the F♯7 in bar 10.

B

Cycle of dominants: F♯7 → B7 → E7 → A7, then D7 C♯7

Two bars each, by their 3rds: A♯ (F♯7), D♯ (B7), G♯ (E7), C♯ (A7). It's the I Got Rhythm bridge moved up a 5th, so the same lines work. The horns' pickup figure (♯7 – 1 – 2 of each dominant) is the melody; quote it. Bar 24's D7 C♯7 is the slide home.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

The D7 C♯7 bars as plain C♯7 at fast tempos · the second A's B– bars as B–6 · bridge played as F♯7 | F♯7 | B7 | B7 | E7 | E7 | A7 | A7 with the D7 C♯7 moved into the pickup bar · last bar as F♯– when the tune ends.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · F♯ minor pent F♯ A B C♯ E

A · F♯ blues scale F♯ A B C C♯ E

2nd A · B minor pent B D E F♯ A

B · F♯ major pent (then B, E, A) F♯ G♯ A♯ C♯ D♯

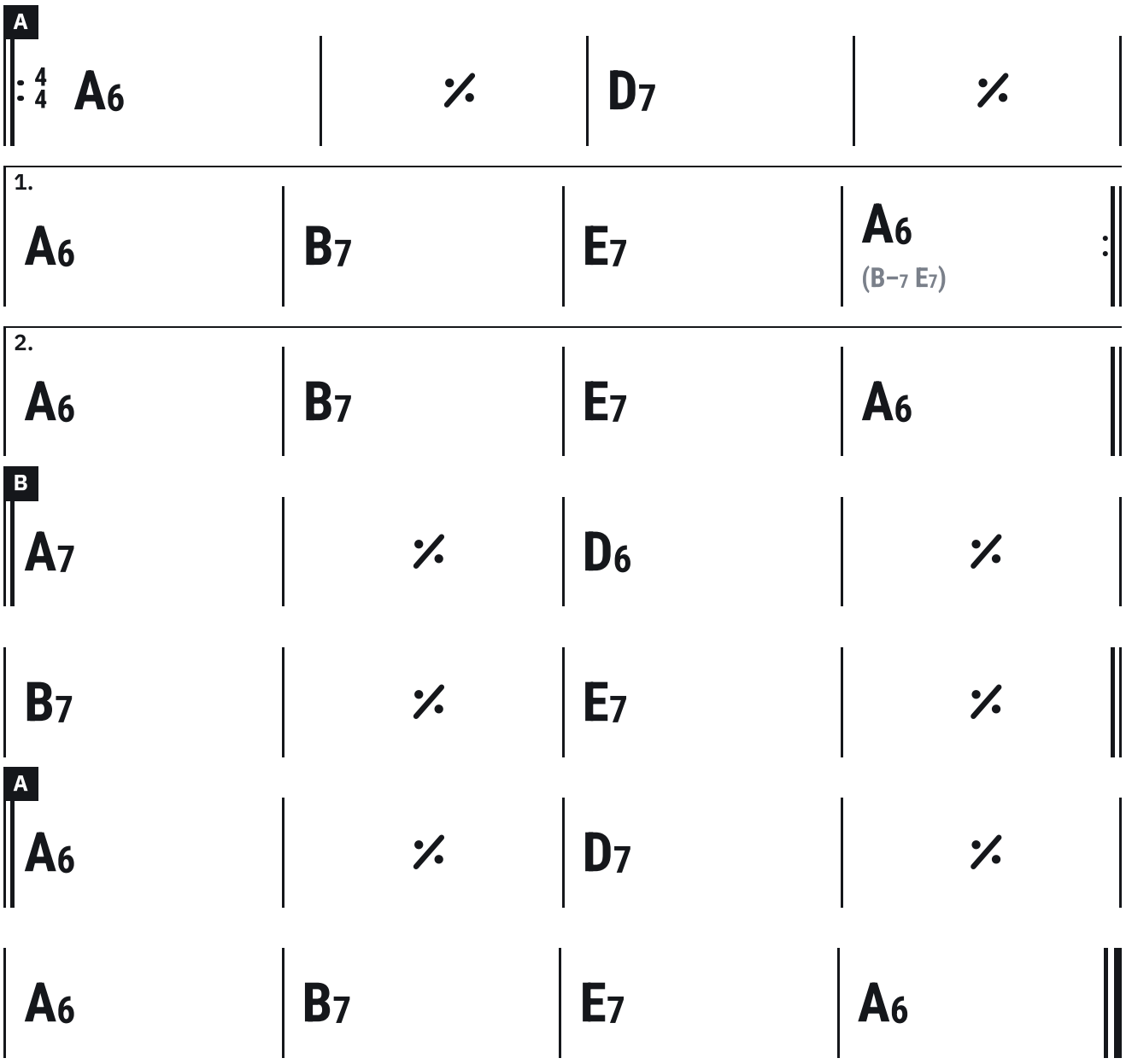
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

F♯–	F♯ A C♯
D7	D F♯ A C
C♯7	C♯ F G♯ B
B–	B D F♯
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
A7	A C♯ E G

(Medium Up Swing)

Undecided

Charlie Shavers



Written key **A** Concert **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1938**

Undecided · Alto Sax in E♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Alto Sax in E♭

- Call-and-response head: you state the phrase in bars 1 and 3, the rhythm section answers in bars 2 and 4; keep the phrase short and the gaps empty. Ella's 1939 version is the phrasing reference.
- Solos: A major pentatonic plus the A blues scale; C on the D7 bars (3–4) against the band, D♯ on B7 (bar 6), D on E7. Bridge: A7 (G) for two, D for two, B7 (D♯) for two, E7 home: the Sunny Side bridge, so solos transfer.
- The last A ends on A6 with no turnaround; hold the last note while the rhythm section stops.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**A6** C♯ F♯	**D7** F♯ C	**B7** D♯ A	**E7** G♯ D
B	**A7** C♯ G	**D6** F♯ B	**B7** D♯ A	**E7** G♯ D

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A major with a blues IV

A major pentatonic plus the A blues scale; on the D7 bars play C (its ♭7) against the band. B7 wants D♯, E7 wants D; that's the whole A.

B

A7 → D → B7 → E7

A mixolydian (G) for two, D major for two, B7 (D♯ , A♯ for lydian colour) for two, E7 home. Same bridge as Sunny Side of the Street, so solos transfer.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–7 as B–7 | G7 F7 | E7 (the chromatic walk-down in the Ames Brothers / Kirby charts) · bar 8 turnaround optional · bridge bars 7–8 as E7 | F♯–7 B7 into the last A.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

D7 bars · A blues scale A C D E♭ E G

B · D major pent D E F♯ A B

B · B7: B major pent B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A6	A C♯ E F♯
D7	D F♯ A C
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
B–7	B D F♯ A
A7	A C♯ E G
D6	D F♯ A B

TENOR SAX IN B♭
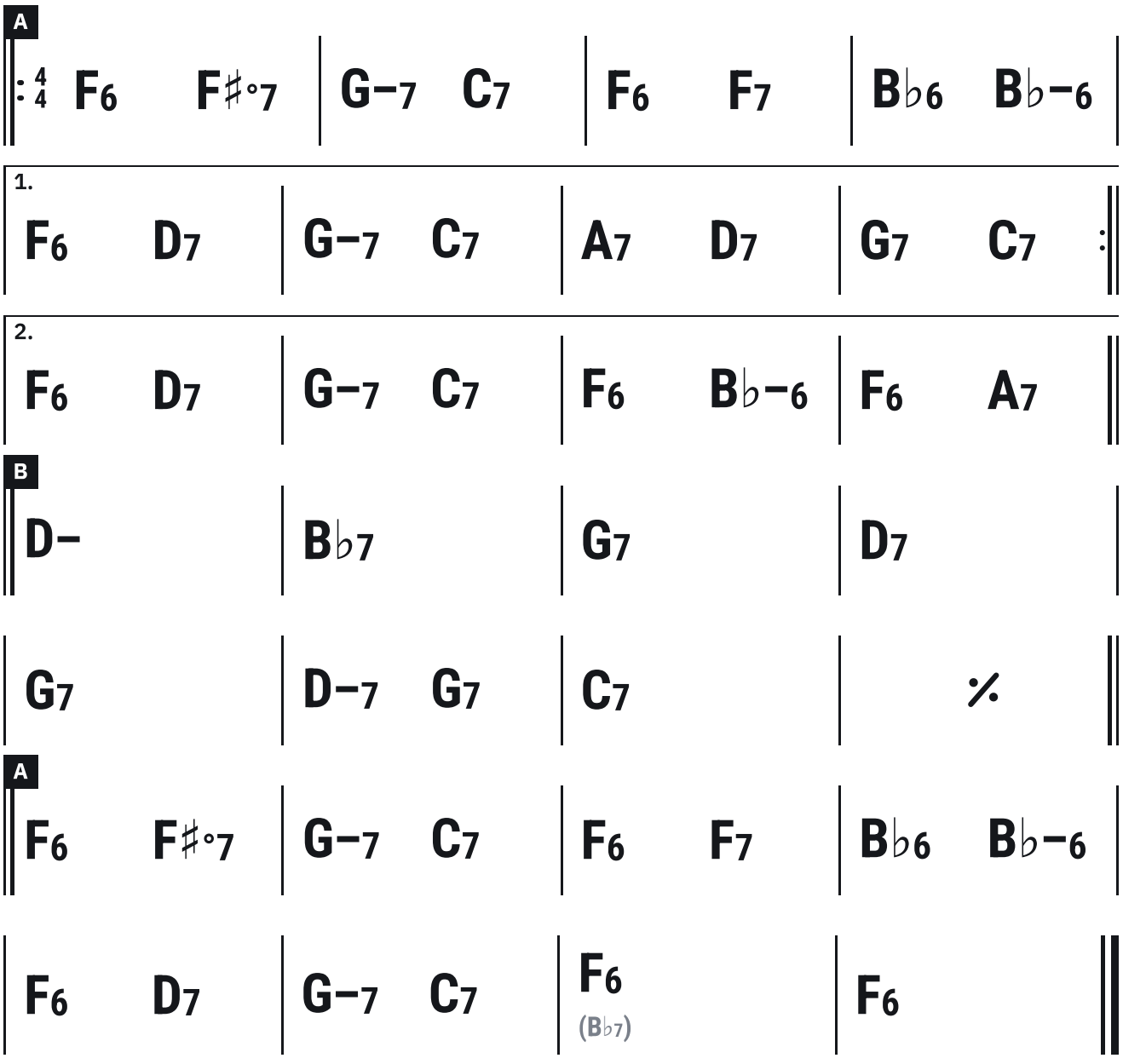
B♭ instrument: written a whole step above concert pitch, the same written changes as the trumpet part.

#	TUNE	WRITTEN KEY	CONCERT	FORM	DANCE TEMPO
01	Ain't Misbehavin'	F	E♭	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
02	All of Me	G	F	A B A C · 32	150–190 bpm
03	All the Things You Are	B♭	A♭	A A′ B A″ · 36	150–190 bpm
04	Autumn Leaves	D–	C–	A A B C · 32	100–180 bpm
05	Battle of Jericho	G–	F–	AABA · 32	150–200 bpm
06	Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen	D–	C–	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
07	Blue Drag	E–	D–	AABA · 32	90–120 bpm
08	Blue Moon	F	E♭	AABA · 32	110–180 bpm
09	Blue Skies	D– → F	C– → E♭	AABA · 32	150–190 bpm
10	Comes Love	B–	A–	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
11	Don't Get Around Much Anymore	D	C	AABA · 32	130–180 bpm
12	Honeysuckle Rose	G	F	AABA · 32	150–190 bpm
13	I Got Rhythm	C	B♭	AABA · 32	200–240 bpm
14	It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing)	A– → C	G– → B♭	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm
15	Jumpin' at the Woodside	C	B♭	AABA · 32	200–250 bpm
16	Just Friends	A	G	A B A B′ · 32	170–220 bpm
17	Kansas City Stride	A–	G–	AABA · 32 + 8-bar intro	170–210 bpm
18	Lester's Bounce	A–	G–	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
19	Lullaby of Birdland	G– / B♭	F– / A♭	AABA · 32	150–200 bpm
20	Moanin'	G–	F–	AABA · 32	100–125 bpm
21	Oh, Lady Be Good	A	G	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
22	On the Sunny Side of the Street	D	C	AABA · 32	110–140 bpm
23	Perdido	C	B♭	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm
24	Puttin' On the Ritz	G– → B♭	F– → A♭	AABA · 32	200–240 bpm
25	Ridin' and Jivin'	G–	F–	AABA · 32	150 bpm
26	Satin Doll	D	C	AABA · 32	130–160 bpm
27	A Smooth One	G	F	AABA · 32	120 bpm
28	Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise	C–	B♭–	AABA · 32	160–190 bpm
29	Stompin' at the Savoy	E♭	D♭	AABA · 32	190–220 bpm
30	Take the “A” Train	D	C	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
31	Topsy	B–	A–	AABA · 32	165–200 bpm
32	Undecided	D	C	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm

(Medium Swing)

Ain't Misbehavin'

Fats Waller, Harry Brooks & Andy Razaf



Written key **F** Concert **E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written **1929**

Ain't Misbehavin' · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- Waller phrasing: on the beat and behind it. Lay back on the long notes, especially the pickup into bar 1 and the held notes in bars 7–8.
- Each colour chord asks for one note: F♯ on F♯°7, D♭ on B♭–6, F♯ again on D7 in bar 5, C♯ on A7. Land them on the downbeat and the harmony is in your line.
- Bridge: the line climbs through D minor into G7 and D7; play the D7 bars bright, with F♯, then let G7 and C7 bring you down.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **F6** A D **F♯°7** A E♭ **G–7** B♭ F **C7** E B♭ **F7** A E♭ **B♭6** D G **B♭–6** D♭ G **D7** F♯ C **A7** C♯ G **G7** B F

B **D–** F A **B♭7** D A♭ **G7** B F **D7** F♯ C **D–7** F C **C7** E B♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F major, with Waller's colours

F major pentatonic as home. The colours, one per chord: F♯°7 → F♯, F7 → E♭ (into B♭), B♭–6 → D♭, D7 → F♯, A7 → C♯, G7 → B. The turnaround is four dominants; hit their 3rds on the downbeats.

B

D minor, then dominants home

D minor pentatonic for bars 1–2 (B♭7 adds A♭). G7 (B , F) for two, D7 (F♯) for two is the surprise, then G7 and C7 (E) pull you back to F.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 1 as F6 D7/F♯ · bar 2 as G–7 G♯°7 · bar 3 as F6 A7 · first-B bar 7 as F6 D7 · bridge bars 5–6 as C6 | G7 in some charts.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · F major pent F G A C D

A · F blues scale F A♭ B♭ B C E♭

B bars 1–2 · D minor pent D F G A C

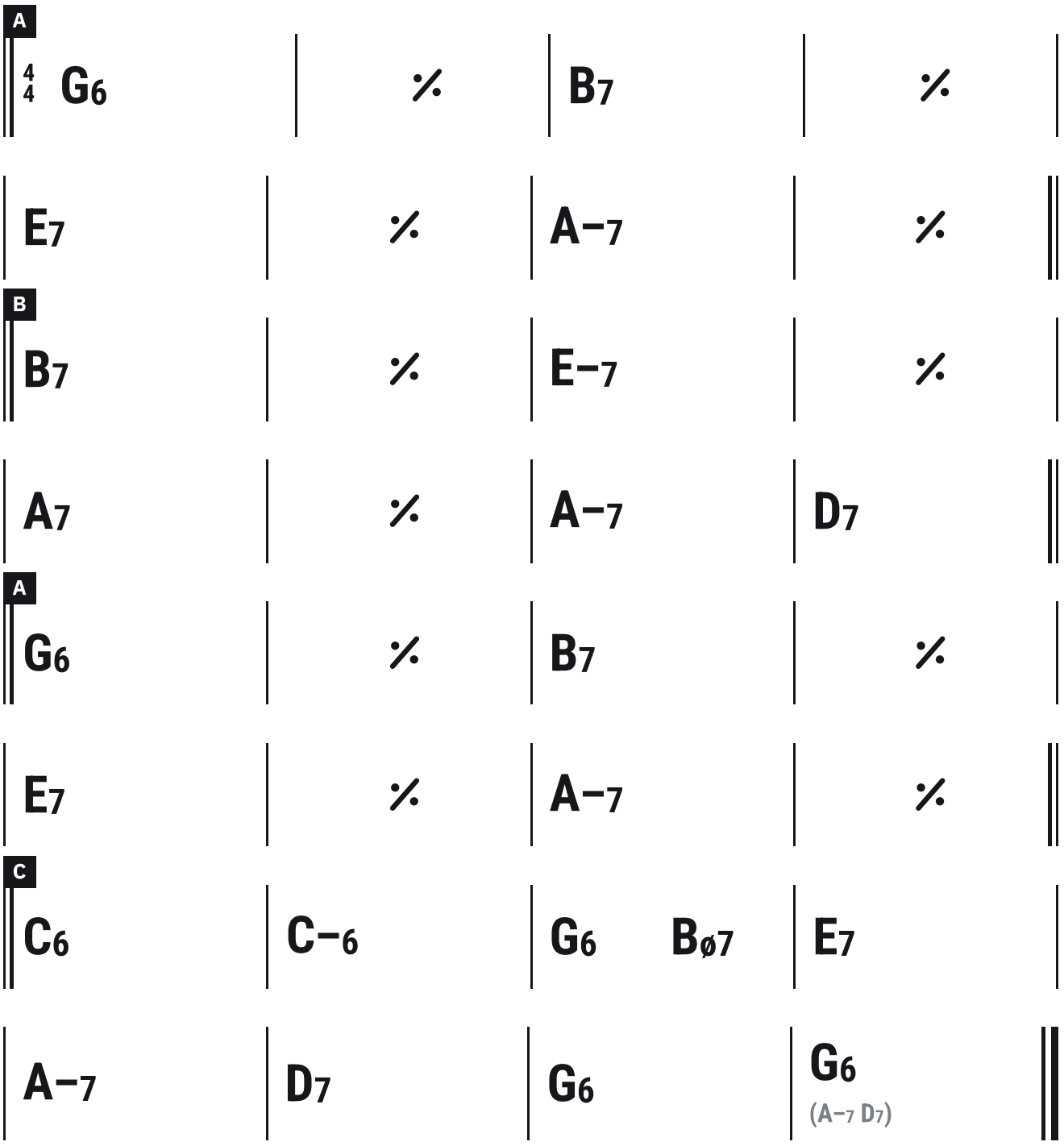
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

F6	F A C D
F♯°7	F♯ A C E♭
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
B♭6	B♭ D F G
B♭–6	B♭ D♭ F G
D7	D F♯ A C
A7	A C♯ E G
G7	G B D F
D–	D F A
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
D–7	D F A C

(Medium Swing)

All of Me

Gerald Marks & Seymour Simons



Written key **G** Concert **F** Form **A B A C · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1931**

All of Me · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- Long notes over moving dominants: hold them and let the band move under you. B7 (bars 3–4) wants D♯, E7 (bars 5–6) wants G♯ in your line.
- Phrase in two-bar units; the written melody is one idea per chord, and so should the solo be.
- C section: C → C–6 → G is the emotional peak: E♭ on the C–6, then down to D. Hold the last note; the band tags under you.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**G6**	B E	**B7**	D♯ A	**E7**	G♯ D	**A–7**	C G							
B	**B7**	D♯ A	**E–7**	G D	**A7**	C♯ G	**A–7**	C G	**D7**	F♯ C					
C	**C6**	E A	**C–6**	E♭ A	**G6**	B E	**Bø7**	D F A	**E7**	G♯ D	**A–7**	C G	**D7**	F♯ C	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G major with two sharps bent in

G major pentatonic; B7 wants D♯ (the first surprise of the tune), E7 wants G♯, A–7 is G major again. Two bars per chord, so one idea per chord is enough.

B

B7 → E–, then A7 → A–7 D7

B7 (D♯) into E minor pentatonic for two bars; A7 (C♯ natural) for two; A–7 D7 back to G.

C

IV, iv, home

C major pentatonic, then C minor pentatonic over C–6 (E♭ is the tender note); Bø7 E7 (F , G♯) into A–7 D7 G6.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 3–4 of the A as B7 | B7♭9 · C bars 3–4 as G6 | E7 (no Bø7) in older charts · the Real Book's key is C: everything a fourth down.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G major pent G A B D E

B · E minor pent (B7 → E–) E G A B D

C · C major pent C D E G A

C · C minor pent (C–6) C E♭ F G B♭

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G6	G B D E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
A–7	A C E G
E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G
D7	D F♯ A C
C6	C E G A
C–6	C E♭ G A
Bø7	B D F A

(Medium Swing)

All the Things You Are

Jerome Kern & Oscar Hammerstein II

A

4/4 G–7	C–7	F7	B♭Δ7
E♭Δ7	E–7 A7	DΔ7	𝄎

A′

D–7	G–7	C7	FΔ7
B♭Δ7	B–7 E7	AΔ7	𝄎

B

B–7	E7	AΔ7	𝄎
G♯ø7	C♯7	F♯Δ7	D7♯5

A″

G–7	C–7	F7	B♭Δ7
E♭Δ7	E♭–7 (A♭7)	D–7	C♯°7
C–7	F7	B♭Δ7	B♭Δ7 (Aø7 D7)

Written key **B♭** Concert **A♭** Form **A A′ B A″ · 36** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1939**

All the Things You Are · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The melody is the guide-tone line: the first note of each bar is the 3rd or 7th of the chord. Learn the melody and you have the changes.
- Phrase across the barlines: G–7 C–7 F7 B♭Δ7 E♭Δ7 is one scale (B♭ major), so one long line fits five chords; the key changes at E–7 A7 and that is where to breathe.
- The last A is twelve bars, and bar 29 (E♭Δ7 → E♭–7) is the warning that the ending is coming. Count it; the dancers won't.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	G–7	B♭ F	C–7	E♭ B♭	F7	A E♭	B♭Δ7	D A	E♭Δ7	G D	E–7	G D	A7	C♯ G	DΔ7	F♯ C♯					
A′	D–7	F C	G–7	B♭ F	C7	E B♭	FΔ7	A E	B♭Δ7	D A	B–7	D A	E7	G♯ D	AΔ7	C♯ G♯					
B	B–7	D A	E7	G♯ D	AΔ7	C♯ G♯	G♯ø7	B D F♯	C♯7	F B	F♯Δ7	A♯ F	D7♯5	F♯ A♯ C							
A″	G–7	B♭ F	C–7	E♭ B♭	F7	A E♭	B♭Δ7	D A	E♭Δ7	G D	E♭–7	G♭ D♭	D–7	F C	C♯°7	E B♭					

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A — **vi–ii–V–I–IV in B♭, then a side-step to D**

G–7 C–7 F7 B♭Δ7 E♭Δ7 is one scale: B♭ major, heard as a circle of fourths. Then E–7 A7 DΔ7: the money notes are C♯ and F♯. The melody's first note on each chord is its 3rd or 7th; sing the melody and you're playing guide tones.

A′ — **The same thing a fourth lower: F, then A**

D–7 G–7 C7 FΔ7 B♭Δ7 = F major. Then B–7 E7 AΔ7: G♯ and C♯.

B — **A major, then F♯ major, then the door back**

B–7 E7 AΔ7 for four bars (A major). G♯ø7 C♯7 F♯Δ7: F♯ major, so A♯ F D♯. D7♯5 in the last bar is the hinge: F♯ natural and A♯ (= B♭) pull you back to G–.

A″ — **B♭ again, with the chromatic walk-down**

As the first A through E♭Δ7, then E♭–7 (G♭ /F♯, D♭ /C♯), D–7, C♯°7 (E , G, B♭) into C–7 F7 B♭Δ7. Think of bars 29–32 as a bass line and play across it; it's four bars of one gesture.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 30 as E♭–7 alone or as A♭7 · bar 24 as D7♭9 or D7alt · last bar's Aø7 D7 is the turnaround into the next chorus, dropped on the out chorus.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

Bars 1–5 · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

Bars 6–8 · D major pent D E F♯ A B

Bars 9–13 · F major pent F G A C D

Bars 14–20 · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

Bars 21–23 · F♯ major pent F♯ G♯ A♯ C♯ D♯

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G–7	G B♭ D F
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
B♭Δ7	B♭ D F A
E♭Δ7	E♭ G B♭ D
E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G
DΔ7	D F♯ A C♯
D–7	D F A C
C7	C E G B♭
FΔ7	F A C E
B–7	B D F♯ A

E7	E G♯ B D
AΔ7	A C♯ E G♯
G♯ø7	G♯ B D F♯
C♯7	C♯ F G♯ B
F♯Δ7	F♯ A♯ C♯ F
D7♯5	D F♯ A♯ C
E♭−7	E♭ G♭ B♭ D♭
A♭7	A♭ C E♭ G♭
C♯°7	C♯ E G B♭
Aø7	A C E♭ G
D7	D F♯ A C

(Medium Swing)

Autumn Leaves (Les feuilles mortes)

Joseph Kosma (Prévert / Mercer)

A

4/4 G–7	C7	FΔ7	B♭Δ7
Eø7	A7	D–	𝄎

A

G–7	C7	FΔ7	B♭Δ7
Eø7	A7	D–	𝄎

B

Eø7	A7	D–	𝄎
G–7	C7	FΔ7	B♭Δ7

C

Eø7	A7	D–7 G7	C–7 F7
B♭Δ7	Eø7 A7	D–	D– (Eø7 A7)

Written key **D–** Concert **C–** Form **A A B C · 32** Feel **Lindy / ballad** Dance tempo **100–180 bpm**

Written **1945**

Autumn Leaves · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The melody climbs through G–7 C7 FΔ7 B♭Δ7 by thirds: an arpeggio exercise in disguise, so solo the same way.
- Bars 5–6 of each A (Eø7 A7) are the minor turn: C♯ and B♭ on the A7, then D minor pentatonic. The bridge is the same two halves in reverse, so don't start it in F out of habit.
- C section: D–7 G7 → C–7 F7 → B♭Δ7 falls by whole steps; a line that drops a whole step every two beats fits all three bars.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	G–7	B♭ F	C7	E B♭	FΔ7	A E	B♭Δ7	D A	Eø7	G B♭ D	A7	C♯ G	D–	F A					
B	Eø7	G B♭ D	A7	C♯ G	D–	F A	G–7	B♭ F	C7	E B♭	FΔ7	A E	B♭Δ7	D A					
C	Eø7	G B♭ D	A7	C♯ G	D–7	F C	G7	B F	C–7	E♭ B♭	F7	A E♭	B♭Δ7	D A	D–	F A			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F major for four bars, D minor for four

G–7 C7 FΔ7 B♭Δ7 is one scale: F major (B♭ major pentatonic also fits all four). Then Eø7 A7 D–: D harmonic minor on the A7 (C♯ natural, B♭) and D minor pentatonic home.

B

The A section reversed

Minor half first (Eø7 A7 D–), major half second (G–7 C7 F B♭). Same notes, opposite order; the trap is starting the bridge in F major out of habit.

C

Two backdoor ii–Vs sliding down, then home

D–7 G7 → C–7 F7 → B♭Δ7: D dorian, G mixolydian (B), C dorian, F mixolydian (A), B♭ major. Then Eø7 A7 D– to close. Think of bars 3–5 as one gesture descending by whole steps.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 8 of each A as D–7 or D–6 · C bars 3–4 as D–7 G7 | G–7 C7 (a plain ii–V to F) · keys: A– (Real Book), F♯– (original), D– (here).

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A bars 1–4, B bars 5–8 · F major pent F G A C D

A bars 5–8 · D minor pent D F G A C

over A7 · D harmonic minor D E F G A B♭ C♯

C bars 3–5 · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

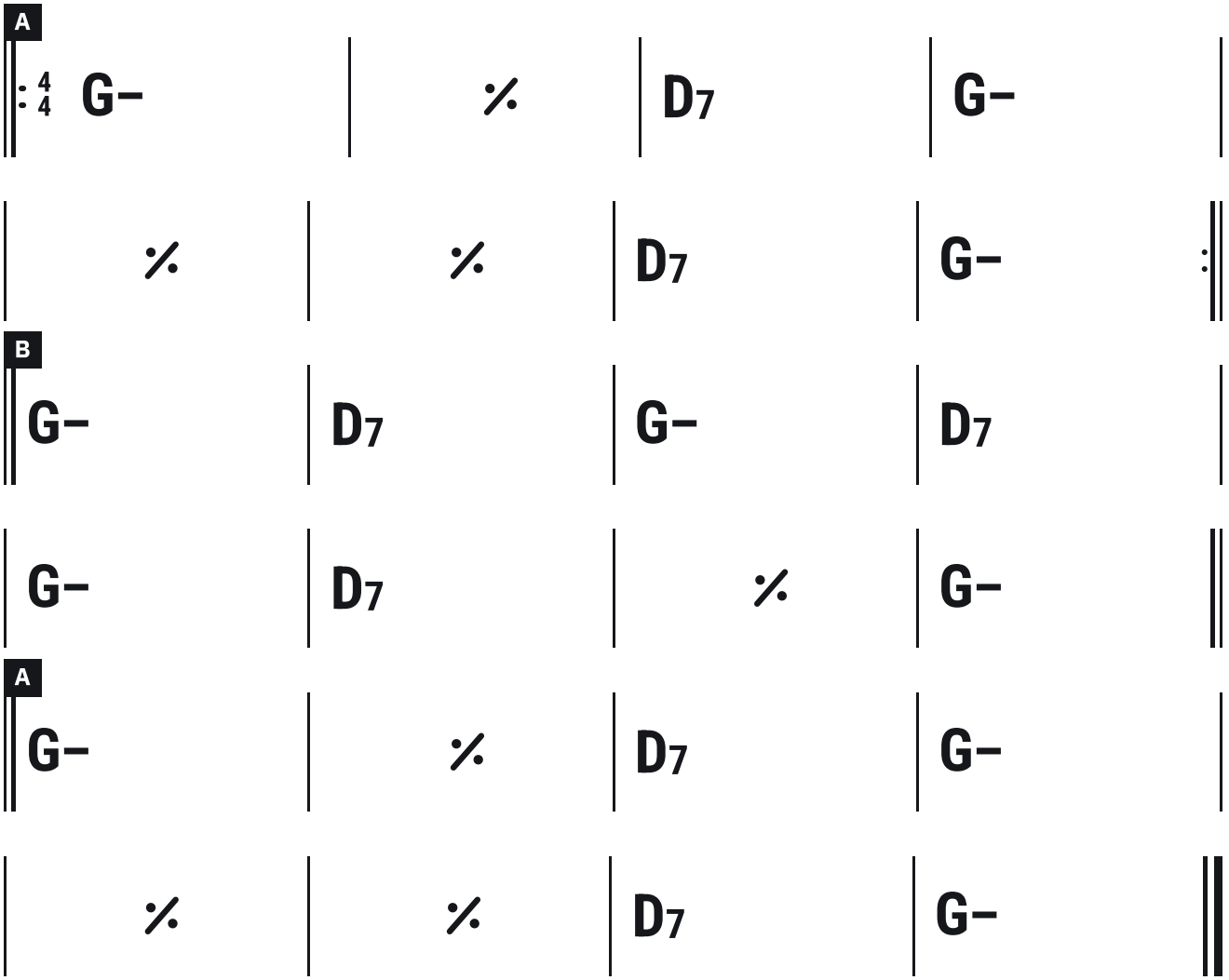
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
FΔ7	F A C E
B♭Δ7	B♭ D F A
Eø7	E G B♭ D
A7	A C♯ E G
D–	D F A
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭

(Medium Swing)

Battle of Jericho (Joshua Fit the Battle)

Traditional spiritual, your band's arrangement



Written key **G–** Concert **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–200 bpm** Written **trad.**

Battle of Jericho · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The spiritual's melody is the riff: short, hard attack on the chorus (A sections), legato on the verse (bridge).
- Solos: G minor pentatonic and the G blues scale cover everything. On D7 (bars 3 and 7 of each A, bars 2, 4, 6–7 of the bridge) land F♯ and the change is heard.
- Bars 6–7 of the bridge are two bars of D7: hold a note (F♯ or C) or repeat the melody's rhythm on it until G– returns, Bechet-style.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**G–**	B♭ D	**D7**	F♯ C
B	**G–**	B♭ D	**D7**	F♯ C

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G minor, one scale

G minor pentatonic and the G blues scale cover the whole A. On D7 play F♯ natural (G harmonic minor) if you want the chord change to be heard at all; B♭ is home.

B

The same, with twice the D7

Bars 6–7 are two bars of D7: sit on F♯ and C, or do the Bechet thing and play the melody's rhythm on one note until the G– comes back.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

C– (iv) in bar 3 of the A if the band wants a third chord · D7♭9 throughout · some bands play the B as G– | G– | D7 | D7 twice.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A, B · G minor pent	G B♭ C D F
A, B · G blues scale	G B♭ C D♭ D F
over D7 · G harmonic minor	G A B♭ C D E♭ F♯

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G–	G B♭ D
D7	D F♯ A C

(Medium Swing)

Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen

Sholom Secunda



Written key **D–** Concert **C–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1932**

Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The melody is a minor blues: bend the F and C, growl on the long notes; it's the tune the European swing floor knows best, so play it straight before you play it fancy.
- Solos: D minor blues scale over the entire A. On A7 (bar 6) C♯ against B♭ is the harmonic-minor colour; the bridge's G– bars want B♭ major pentatonic.
- The bridge (G– for two, D– for two, twice) is where the tune relaxes; play prettier there and save the blues for the last A.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D–**	F A	**G–**	B♭ D	**A7**	C♯ G
B	**G–**	B♭ D	**D–**	F A	**A7**	C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D minor blues language

The D minor blues scale works over the entire A; this is a minor blues tune. G–: G dorian (B♭ major). A7: D harmonic minor, C♯ natural against B♭. The turnaround C7 – B♭7 – A7 is chromatic dominants: target the 3rds E D C♯.

B

iv → i, twice, opening into V

G– (G dorian, B♭ major pentatonic) to D–, then the second half can go II7–V7: E7 (G♯) into A7 (C♯). The bridge is where the tune briefly feels major; play pretty there and save the blues for the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 as A7 | A7 · bridge bars 5–6 as E7 | E7 (II7–V7) · turnaround optional at speed.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D minor pent	D F G A C
A · D blues scale	D F G A♭ A C
B · G minor pent	G B♭ C D F

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D–	D F A
G–	G B♭ D
A7	A C♯ E G
C7	C E G B♭
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
E7	E G♯ B D

(Slow Swing)

Blue Drag

Josef Myrow (your Pataswing chart)



Written key **E–** Concert **D–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Slow lindy / blues** Dance tempo **90–120 bpm**

Written **1932**

Blue Drag · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- Slow and behind the beat; Grappelli's phrasing on Django's record is the model: long notes with a slow vibrato at the end.
- The pickup into the last A, D♯ E F F♯ then F♯ G in triplets, is yours: in unison with the other horn, loud and even.
- Solos: E minor pentatonic and blues at home; B♭ on the C7 bars (its ♭7) and D♯ on B7 are the two notes that name the drag.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**E–**	G B	**C♯ø7**	E G B	**C7**	E B♭	**E–/D**	G B	**F♯ø7**	A C E	**B7**	D♯ A
B	**A–**	C E	**E–**	G B	**B7**	D♯ A						

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A **E minor, with a ♭VI–V slide**

E minor pentatonic and blues scale at home. C♯ø7 C7: G then B♭ (C7's ♭7), the chord that gives the tune its drag. F♯ø7: C. C7 B7 at the end is the half-step slide: B♭ on the C7, then land D♯ on the B7.

B **iv and i, with B7 every second bar**

A minor pentatonic over the A– beats, E minor pentatonic over E–; the B7s want D♯. Leave space: the bridge melody is mostly rests.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 6 as B7 or B9 (Django's rhythm section) · bar 2 as C♯°7 C7 · bridge A– as D♯°7 in some gypsy charts.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · E minor pent	E G A B D
A · E blues scale	E G A B♭ B D
B · A minor pent	A C D E G
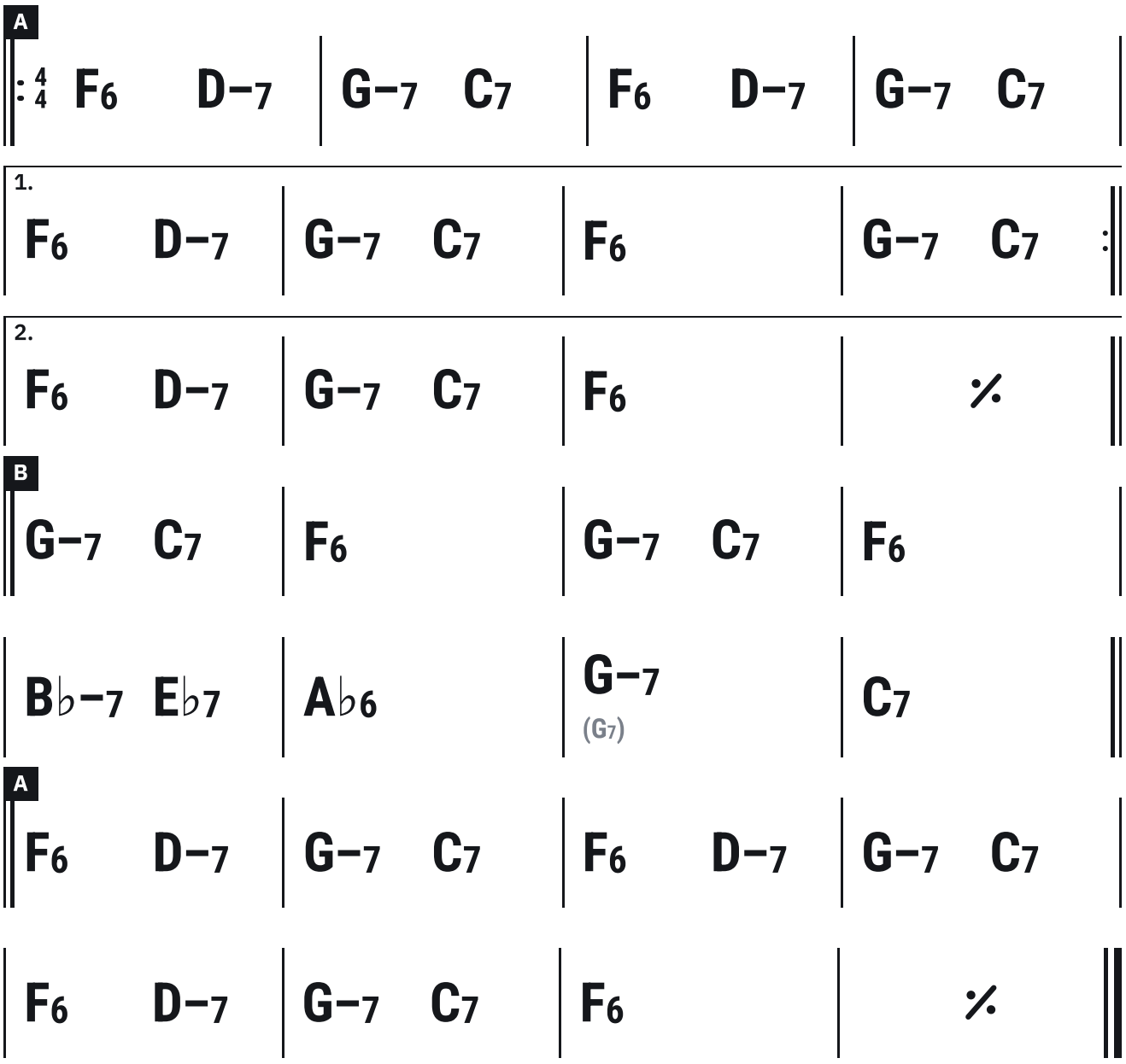
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

E–	E G B
E–/D	E G B
C♯ø7	C♯ E G B
C7	C E G B♭
F♯ø7	F♯ A C E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
A–	A C E

(Medium Swing)

Blue Moon

Richard Rodgers & Lorenz Hart



Written key **F** Concert **E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / blues** Dance tempo **110–180 bpm**

Written **1934**

Blue Moon · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- Long notes over the loop; the harmony moves under you every two beats, so hold the note and let it do the work.
- Bridge: the melody steps into A♭ in bars 5–6 (D♭ and A♭ are the new notes), then G7 or G–7 and C7 bring you back; it's the only place the tune leaves F.
- Solos: F major pentatonic over the whole loop; land E (3rd of C7) on beat 3 of every even bar and the loop sings.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**F6**	A D	**D–7**	F C	**G–7**	B♭ F	**C7**	E B♭			
B	**G–7**	B♭ F	**C7**	E B♭	**F6**	A D	**B♭–7**	D♭ A♭	**E♭7**	G D♭	**A♭6**	C F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

One loop, F major

F major pentatonic over the whole loop; D minor pentatonic is the same five notes, so the vi chord costs nothing. Land **E** (3rd of C7) on the second half of every even bar and the loop sings.

B

F, then A♭ for two bars, then home

F major for bars 1–4. Bars 5–6: A♭ major pentatonic (= F minor pentatonic): **D♭** and **A♭** are the slip. Bar 7: G7 wants **B** natural (G–7 wants B♭); bar 8 C7: **E** .

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bars 7–8 as F6 | F6 with no turnaround · bridge bar 7 as G7 (the sheet) or G–7 (sessions) · bar 6 of the bridge as A♭Δ7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A, B · F major pent	F G A C D
B bars 5–6 · A♭ major pent	A♭ B♭ C E♭ F
same notes as F minor pent	F A♭ B♭ C E♭

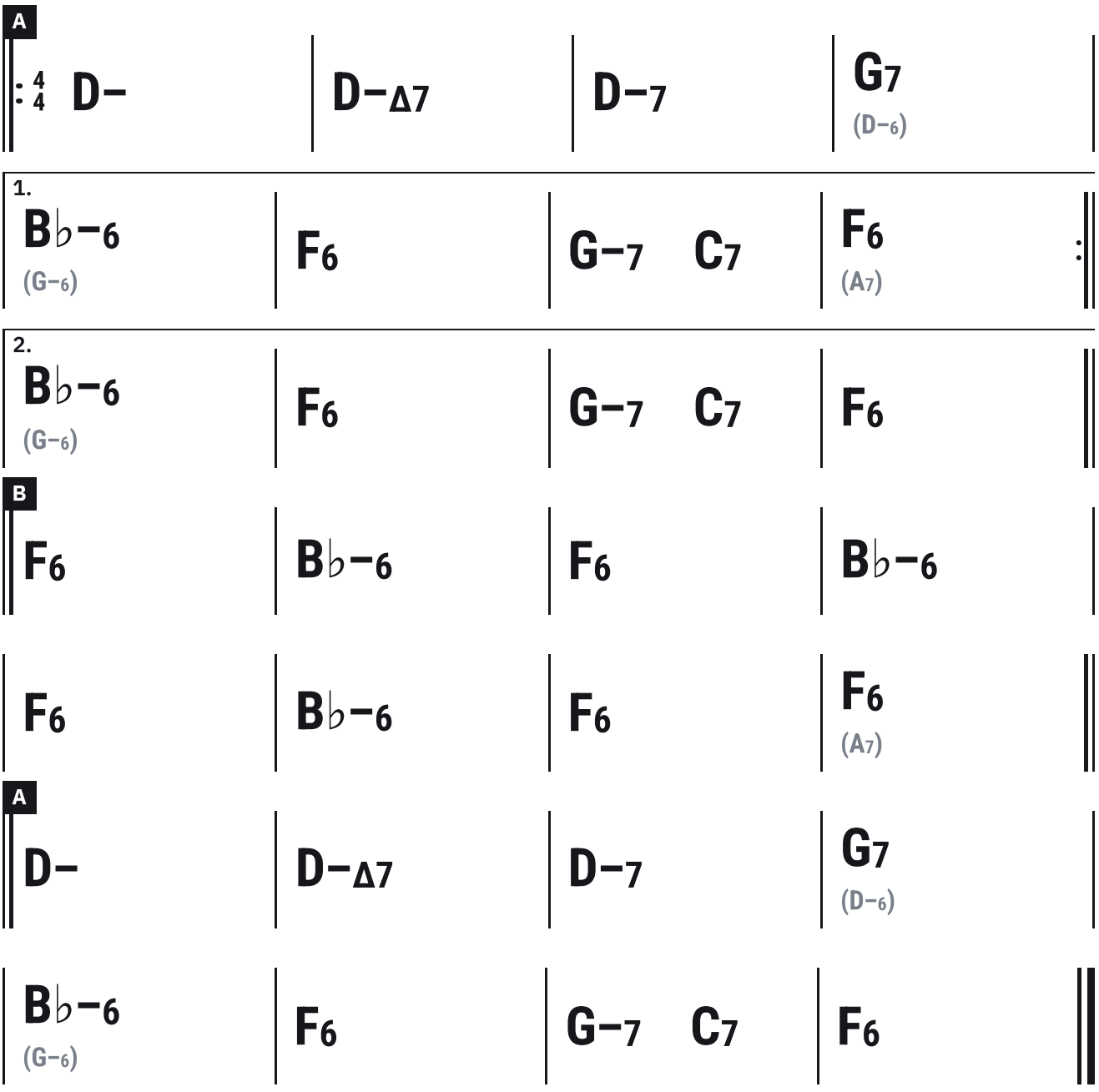
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

F6	F A C D
D–7	D F A C
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
B♭–7	B♭ D♭ F A♭
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
A♭6	A♭ C E♭ F
G7	G B D F

(Medium Up Swing)

Blue Skies

Irving Berlin



Written key **D– → F** Concert **C– → E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm**

Written **1926**

Blue Skies · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The melody sits on the line cliché: the first four bars are one note (A) with the harmony moving; play it dead straight and let the band supply the colour.
- Bar 5 (B♭–6) wants D♭ in your line; bars 6–8 are F major and the F blues scale is welcome.
- Bridge: F against B♭–6 every bar; D♭ and A♭ on the B♭–6 bars are the tension, F major pentatonic the release.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D–**	F A	**D–7**	F C	**G7**	B F	**B♭–6**	D♭ G	**F6**	A D	**G–7**	B♭ F	**C7**	E B♭	
B	**F6**	A D	**B♭–6**	D♭ G											

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D minor that is really vi of F

Play the cliché itself: D C♯ C B, one per bar, and build phrases around it. D dorian and D minor pentatonic over the D– bars, B natural on the G7. Bar 5, B♭–6: the colour is D♭ and G (F minor pentatonic works). Bars 6–8: F major home, F blues scale welcome.

B

I ↔ iv in F: F against B♭–6

F major on the F bars, F minor pentatonic on the B♭–6 bars (B♭ D♭ F G): the D♭ and A♭ are the tension. Pedal a C in the left hand under the whole bridge and let the two chords rub.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bars 1–4 as the descending-bass original: D– | A7/C♯ | F/C | G7/B · bar 5 as G–6 or B♭7 · bridge iv as plain B♭6 in older charts · the iReal version ends the bridge C♯ø7 F♯7♭9 (in D), i.e. Eø7 A7♭9 here.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A bars 1–5 · D minor pent D F G A C

A bars 6–8, B · F major pent F G A C D

B♭–6 bars · F minor pent F A♭ B♭ C E♭

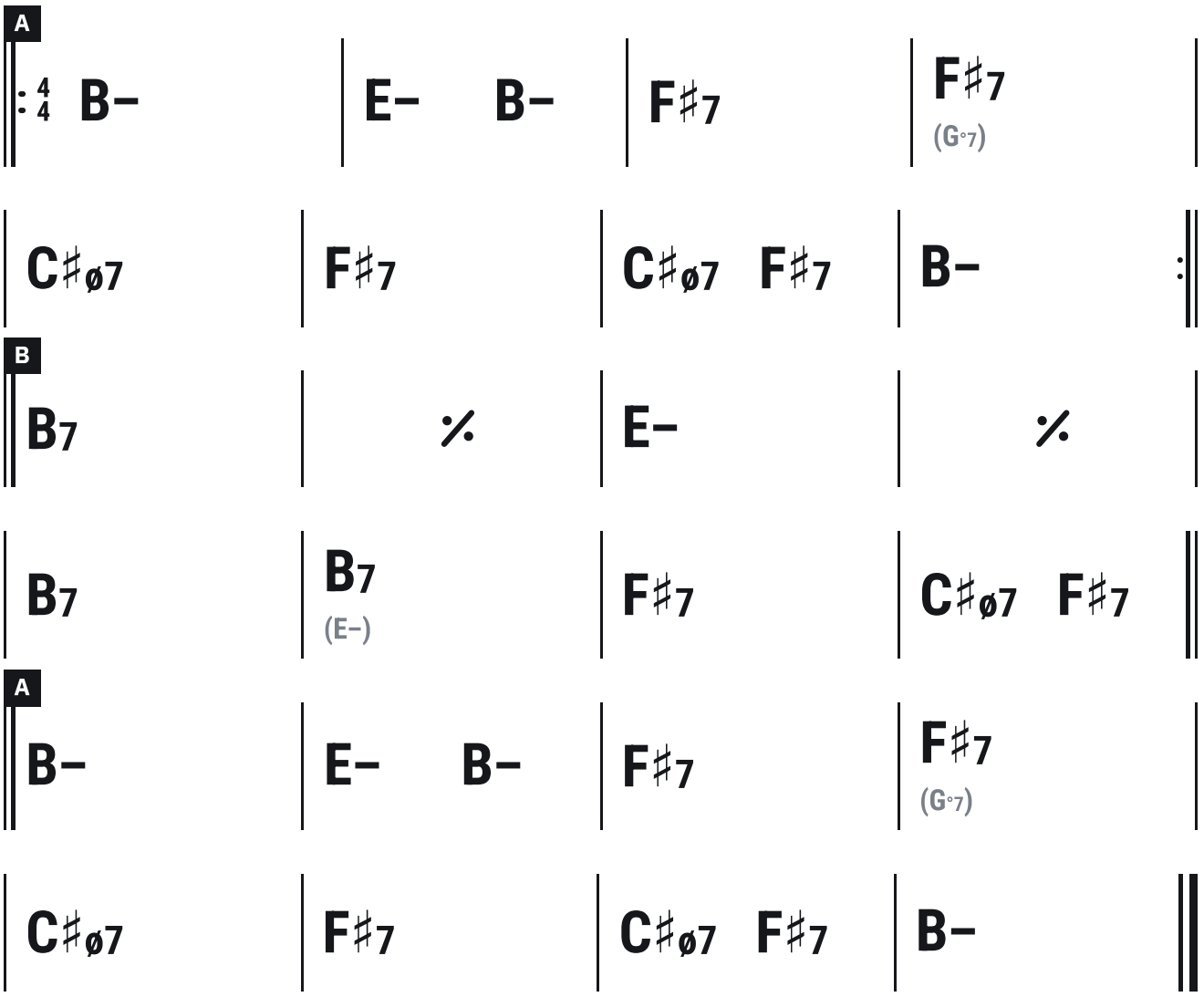
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D–maj7	D F A
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
D–6	D F A B
B♭–6	B♭ D♭ F G
G–6	G B♭ D E
F6	F A C D
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
A7	A C♯ E G

(Medium Swing)

Comes Love

Sam H. Stept (Lew Brown & Charles Tobias)



Written key **B–** Concert **A–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written **1939**

Comes Love · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- A vocal tune: phrase it like a lyric, the title phrase (bars 7–8) short and dry, and lay back on the F♯7 bars.
- Solos: B minor pentatonic at home, A♯ on every F♯7 (B harmonic minor), G and A♯ together on C♯ø7 F♯7. Bridge: D♯ on B7, E minor pentatonic on the E– bars.
- At the slow tempo (Billie Holiday, 90) the horn is the second voice behind the singer: fills in the gaps, never over the words.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**B–** D F♯	**E–** G B	**F♯7** A♯ E	**C♯ø7** E G B	
B	**B7** D♯ A	**E–** G B	**F♯7** A♯ E	**C♯ø7** E G B	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

B minor, harmonic minor on the F♯7s

B minor pentatonic at home; on F♯7 play A♯ (B harmonic minor, with G); C♯ø7 F♯7: G and A♯ together is the sound of the title phrase.

B

B7 → E–, then F♯7 home

B7 wants D♯; E minor pentatonic over the E– bars; F♯7 (A♯) and C♯ø7 F♯7 bring the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

G°7 passing chords on the 'and' of 4 before each F♯7 · bridge bars 5–6 as E– | E– · bar 2 as B– throughout for a modal reading.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · B minor pent B D E F♯ A

over F♯7 · B harmonic minor B C♯ D E F♯ G A♯

B · E minor pent E G A B D

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

B–	B D F♯
E–	E G B
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E
G°7	G B♭ D♭ E
C♯ø7	C♯ E G B
B7	B D♯ F♯ A

(Medium Swing)

Don't Get Around Much Anymore

Duke Ellington & Bob Russell



Written key **D** Concert **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / slow swing** Dance tempo **130–180 bpm**

Written **1940**

Don't Get Around Much Anymore · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The melody hangs on one lyric line through B7 → E7 → A7: hold the long notes and let the dominants move under you; D♯ (B7) and G♯ (E7) are the two notes to lean on in a solo.
- F°7 in bar 2 is the colour chord: F against the D is the tune's blue note.
- Bridge: four bars of G, then D7 (C) into E7 (G♯), then ii–V home; the melody climbs through it, so play the climb with a crescendo.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	D6	F♯ B	E–7	G D	F°7	A♭ D	B7	D♯ A	E7	G♯ D	A7	C♯ G
B	G6	B E	D6	F♯ B	D7	F♯ C	E7	G♯ D	E–7	G D	A7	C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D major with three dominants

D major pentatonic, bending in the one note each dominant wants: B7 → D♯, E7 → G♯, A7 → G. F°7 in bar 2 is the colour chord: F against the D. Same trick as Sunny Side of the Street, same key.

B

G major, then D7 → E7 → E–7 A7

G major pentatonic for bars 1–3 (C9 adds F); D7 (C) into E7 (G♯) for two bars, then ii–V home.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as D♯°7 or G6 G♯°7 · bar 3 as F♯–7 F7 (bebop) · bridge bars 5–6 as B–7 E7 · Real-Book-style bridge: A–7 D7 | G6 | A–7 D7 | G6 | B–7 E7 | B–7 E7 | E–7 | A7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D major pent D E F♯ A B

B · G major pent G A B D E

E7 bars · E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯
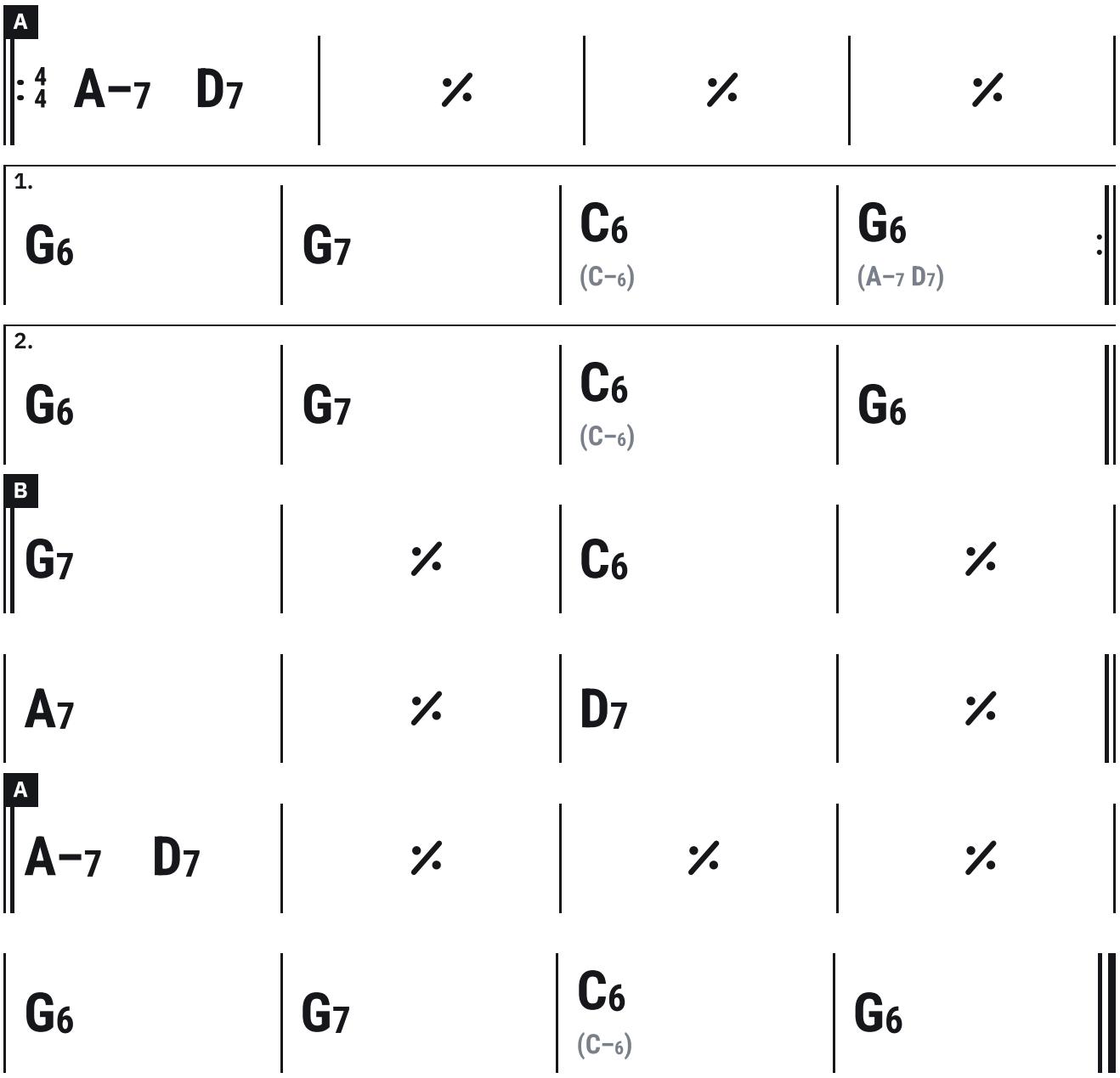
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D6	D F♯ A B
E–7	E G B D
F°7	F A♭ B D
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
A7	A C♯ E G
A–7	A C E G
D7	D F♯ A C
G6	G B D E
C9	C D E G B♭

(Medium Swing)

Honeysuckle Rose

Fats Waller & Andy Razaf



Written key **G** Concert **F** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1929**

Honeysuckle Rose · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The melody is a riff on A–7 D7 for four bars: short and bouncy; quote the first bar in your solo, everyone since Bird has.
- Bars 5–8 move: G → G7 → C → G. F on the G7 (bar 6) landing on E (3rd of C) is the line.
- Bridge (G7 | G7 | C | C | A7 | A7 | D7 | D7): two bars a chord; F → E → C♯ → C is the guide-tone line, one note per two bars.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**A–7**	C	G	**D7**	F♯	C	**G6**	B	E	**G7**	B	F	**C6**	E	A
B	**G7**	B	F	**C6**	E	A	**A7**	C♯	G	**D7**	F♯	C			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

One long ii–V in G, then home

Bars 1–4 are a vamp: D mixolydian (G major heard from the D7). Don't resolve early; the tune doesn't. Bars 5–8: G → G7 → C → G. Play **F** on the G7 in bar 6 and land on **E** (3rd of C); if the band plays C–6, **E♭** is yours in bar 7.

B

The Honeysuckle bridge: I7 → IV → II7 → V7

G7 (F) for two, C major for two, A7 for two where **C♯** natural is the note, D7 (C) for two. Guide-tone line: B/F → E/B♭ → C♯/G → F♯/C.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 7–8: C6 C–6 | G6 E7 (A–7 D7) · bridge bars 7–8 as A–7 | D7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G major pent G A B D E

A bars 5–8 · G blues scale G B♭ C D♭ D F

B · A7: A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

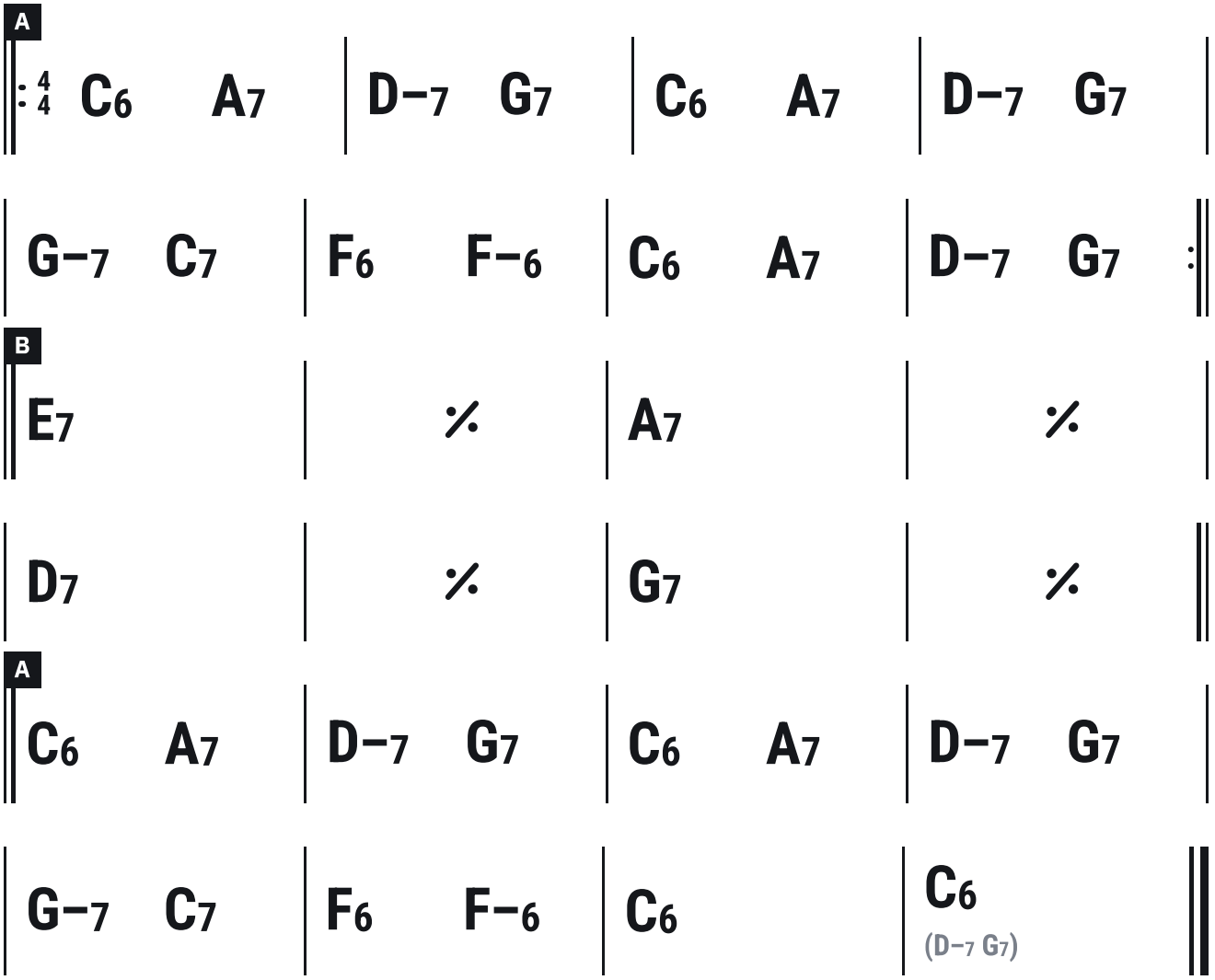
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A–7	A C E G
D7	D F♯ A C
G6	G B D E
G7	G B D F
C6	C E G A
C–6	C E♭ G A
A7	A C♯ E G

(Up Swing)

I Got Rhythm (Rhythm Changes)

George Gershwin



Written key **C** Concert **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Charleston / fast lindy** Dance tempo **200–240 bpm**

Written **1930**

I Got Rhythm · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- Riff heads (Lester Leaps In, Cotton Tail) live on these changes: play the head short and in unison, and solo in C major pentatonic plus the blue E♭ over bars 1–4; the turnarounds are the rhythm section's problem.
- Bars 5–6 are the event: B♭ on the C7 into A (3rd of F), then A♭ over F–6 going home.
- Bridge: E7 → A7 → D7 → G7, two bars each. The 3rds G♯ C♯ F♯ B on the downbeats are the bridge; a line that falls a half step every two bars (G♯/D → C♯/G → F♯/C → B/F) never gets lost.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**C6**	E A	**A7**	C♯ G	**D–7**	F C	**G7**	B F	**G–7**	B♭ F	**C7**	E B♭	**F6**	A D	**F–6**	A♭ D			
B	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G	**D7**	F♯ C	**G7**	B F											

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C major, with C blues on top

Bars 1–4: one key to the ear. C major pentatonic plus the blue E♭, and the whole turnaround disappears under it. Bars 5–6 are the real event: C7 into F. Play B♭ (the ♭7) and land on A (3rd of F); then A♭ over F–6 going home. Guide tones through the turnaround: E → C♯ (A7) → F → B (G7).

B

Four dominants, two bars each, round the circle

E7 → A7 → D7 → G7. Mixolydian on each; the 3rds are the targets: G♯ C♯ F♯ B. Voice-lead the 3rd/7th pairs down by half step: G♯/D → C♯/G → F♯/C → B/F. Lydian dominant (♯11) for colour: A♯ on E7, D♯ on A7.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as E–7 A7 · bar 6 as F6 F♯°7 · bebop A: C C♯°7 | D–7 D♯°7 | E–7 E♭7 | D–7 G7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · C major pent C D E G A

B · E7: E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

B · A7: A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

B · D7: D major pent D E F♯ A B

B · G7: G major pent G A B D E

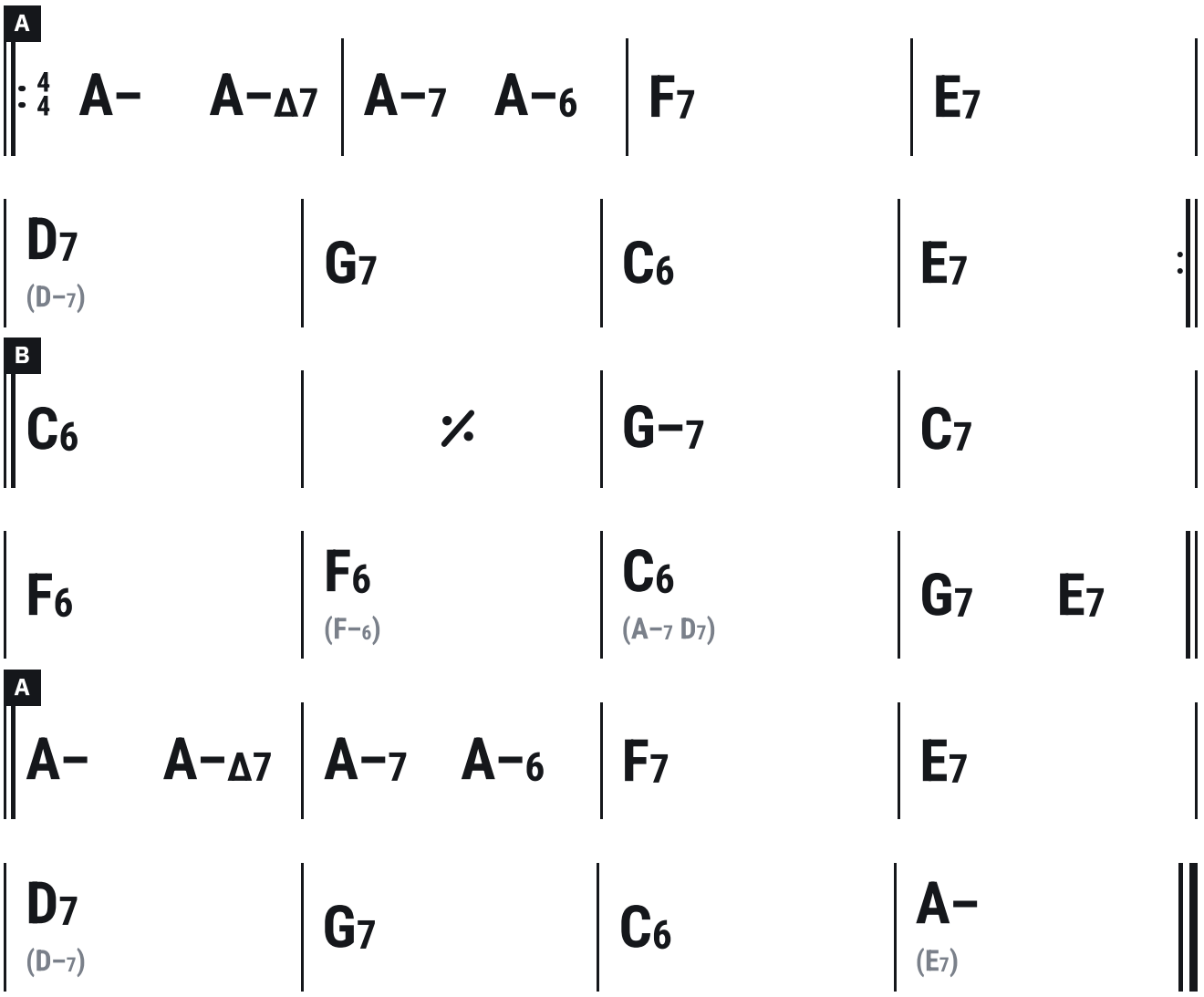
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

C6	C E G A
A7	A C♯ E G
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
F6	F A C D
F–6	F A♭ C D
E7	E G♯ B D
D7	D F♯ A C

(Medium Swing)

It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing)

Duke Ellington & Irving Mills



Written key **A– → C** Concert **G– → B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm**

Written **1931**

It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing) · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The doo-wah answer in bars 5–8 is yours: short, on the 'and' of 2 and 4, with the piano stabbing the same rhythm; the head is call-and-response with the rhythm section.
- Solos: A minor pentatonic over the cliché bars, E♭ then G♯ on F7 → E7, C major pentatonic for bars 5–8 with F♯ on D7 and B on G7.
- Bridge: C major for four bars (G–7 C7 is a push into F: play B♭), F then F–6 (A♭), and G7 E7 at the end: B → G♯ to drop back into A minor.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**A–**	C E	**A–7**	C G	**A–6**	C F♯	**F7**	A E♭	**E7**	G♯ D	**D7**	F♯ C	**G7**	B F	**C6**	E A
B	**C6**	E A	**G–7**	B♭ F	**C7**	E B♭	**F6**	A D	**G7**	B F	**E7**	G♯ D				

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A minor, then four bars of C major

Bars 1–2: A minor pentatonic over the line cliché A–G♯–G–F♯ (play the cliché in the left hand, solo on top). F7 → E7: E♭ then G♯, the flamenco cadence. Bars 5–8: C major pentatonic; F♯ natural on D7, B on G7, and E7's G♯ to pull you home.

B

C major: I → IV → home

C major pentatonic for four bars (G–7 C7 is just a push into F: play B♭). F major, then F–6 if the band plays it (A♭). G7 E7 at the end: B → G♯.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 1–2 as plain A– · doo-wah bars as D–7 | G7 | C6 | E7♯5, or with D♯°7 in bar 6 (iReal first ending) · bridge bars 3–4 as C7 | C7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A bars 1–4 · A minor pent A C D E G

A bars 5–8, B · C major pent C D E G A

B bars 5–6 · F major pent F G A C D

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A–maj7	A C E
A–7	A C E G
A–6	A C E F♯
F7	F A C E♭
E7	E G♯ B D
D7	D F♯ A C
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
C6	C E G A
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
F6	F A C D
F–6	F A♭ C D

(Up Swing)

Jumpin' at the Woodside

Count Basie (Eddie Durham)



Written key **C** Concert **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Fast lindy** Dance tempo **200–250 bpm** Written **1938**

Jumpin' at the Woodside · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- A riff tune: the riff is C major pentatonic, short and in unison; the head is stacked riffs, so each horn holds its own riff for the chorus.
- Solos: C major pentatonic with the blues on top; B♭ on the C7 (bar 4), A then A♭ on F → F–6 (bars 5–6). At this tempo two ideas per chorus is plenty.
- Bridge: C7 (B♭) for two, F for two, D7 (F♯) for two, G7 (B) for two; half notes and quarter notes win at 240. The riff-chorus ending is yours: stack riffs, louder each chorus.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	C6	E A	C7	E B♭	F6	A D	F–6	A♭ D
B	C7	E B♭	F6	A D	D7	F♯ C	G7	B F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C major pentatonic, blues on top

The riff is C major pentatonic; so is the solo. C7 in bar 4: B♭. F then F–6 in bars 5–6: A then A♭. Then home. At this tempo, two ideas per chorus is plenty.

B

The Honeysuckle bridge in C

C7 (B♭) for two, F for two, D7 (F♯ natural) for two, G7 (B) for two. Half notes and quarter notes win at 240.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 as F7 | F7 · bar 8 G7 turnaround · some bands play a rhythm bridge (E7 A7 D7 G7) instead; ask before the count-off.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · C major pent C D E G A

A · C blues scale C E♭ F G♭ G B♭

Bars 5–6, B · F major pent F G A C D

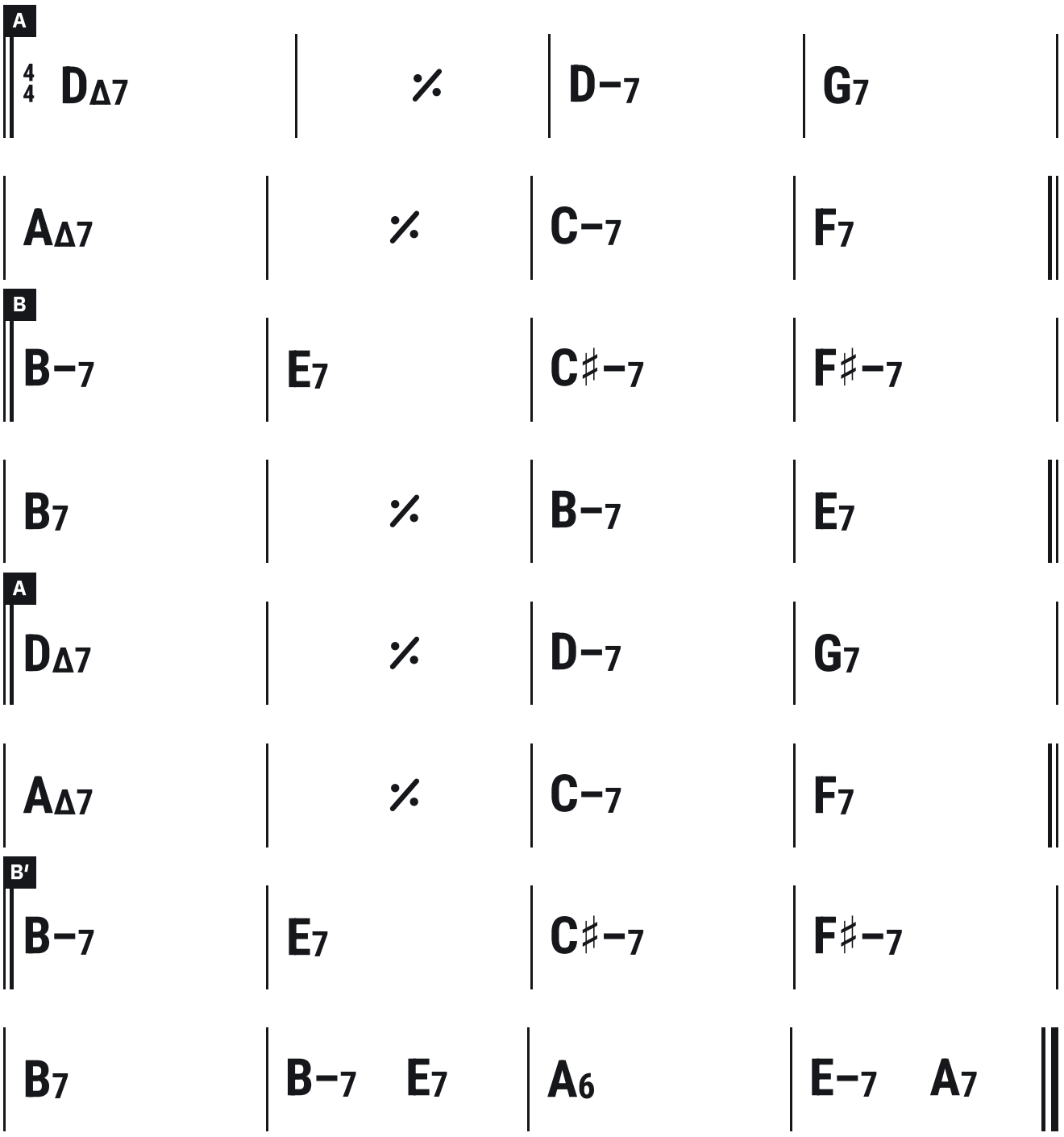
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

C6	C E G A
C7	C E G B♭
F6	F A C D
F–6	F A♭ C D
F7	F A C E♭
G7	G B D F
D7	D F♯ A C

(Up Swing)

Just Friends

John Klenner & Sam M. Lewis



Written key **A** Concert **G** Form **A B A B′ · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **170–220 bpm**

Written **1931**

Just Friends · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The melody starts on IV (DΔ7) and sits on G♯, the lydian note, so it sounds like A major from bar 1; Chet Baker 1959 is the model: behind the beat, no vibrato until the end of the note.
- The two backdoor ii–Vs are the tune: D–7 G7 (bars 3–4) wants F and C in your line; C–7 F7 (bars 7–8) wants E♭ and B♭, sliding into B–7.
- B section: B–7 E7 C♯–7 F♯–7 is all A major; B7 in bars 5–6 is the one II7, so D♯ is the note. B′ ends on E–7 A7, the turnaround into D for the next chorus; end the last one on A6.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D**Δ7	F♯ C♯	**D**–7	F C	**G**7	B F	**A**Δ7	C♯ G♯	**C**–7	E♭ B♭	**F**7	A E♭							
B	**B**–7	D A	**E**7	G♯ D	**C**♯–7	E B	**F**♯–7	A E	**B**7	D♯ A									
B′	**B**–7	D A	**E**7	G♯ D	**C**♯–7	E B	**F**♯–7	A E	**B**7	D♯ A	**A**6	C♯ F♯	**E**–7	G D	**A**7	C♯ G			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

IV, backdoor, I, backdoor

DΔ7: A major (D lydian, G♯). D–7 G7: C major pentatonic (F and C are the backdoor notes). AΔ7: home. C–7 F7: B♭ major pentatonic (E♭, B♭) sliding into B–7.

B

A major with one II7

B–7 E7 and C♯–7 F♯–7 are diatonic; B7 is the II7 colour: D♯.
B′: B–7 E7 A6 then E–7 A7 to set up the D chord at the top.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 of the first A as G7 | G7 (Chet's sub for AΔ7) · B′ bar 8 as E7 E♭7 the first time · bar 7–8 of the B as B–7 | E7 or B–7 E7 | A6.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A, B · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯
D–7 G7 · C major pent C D E G A
C–7 F7 · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G
B7 · B major pent B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯

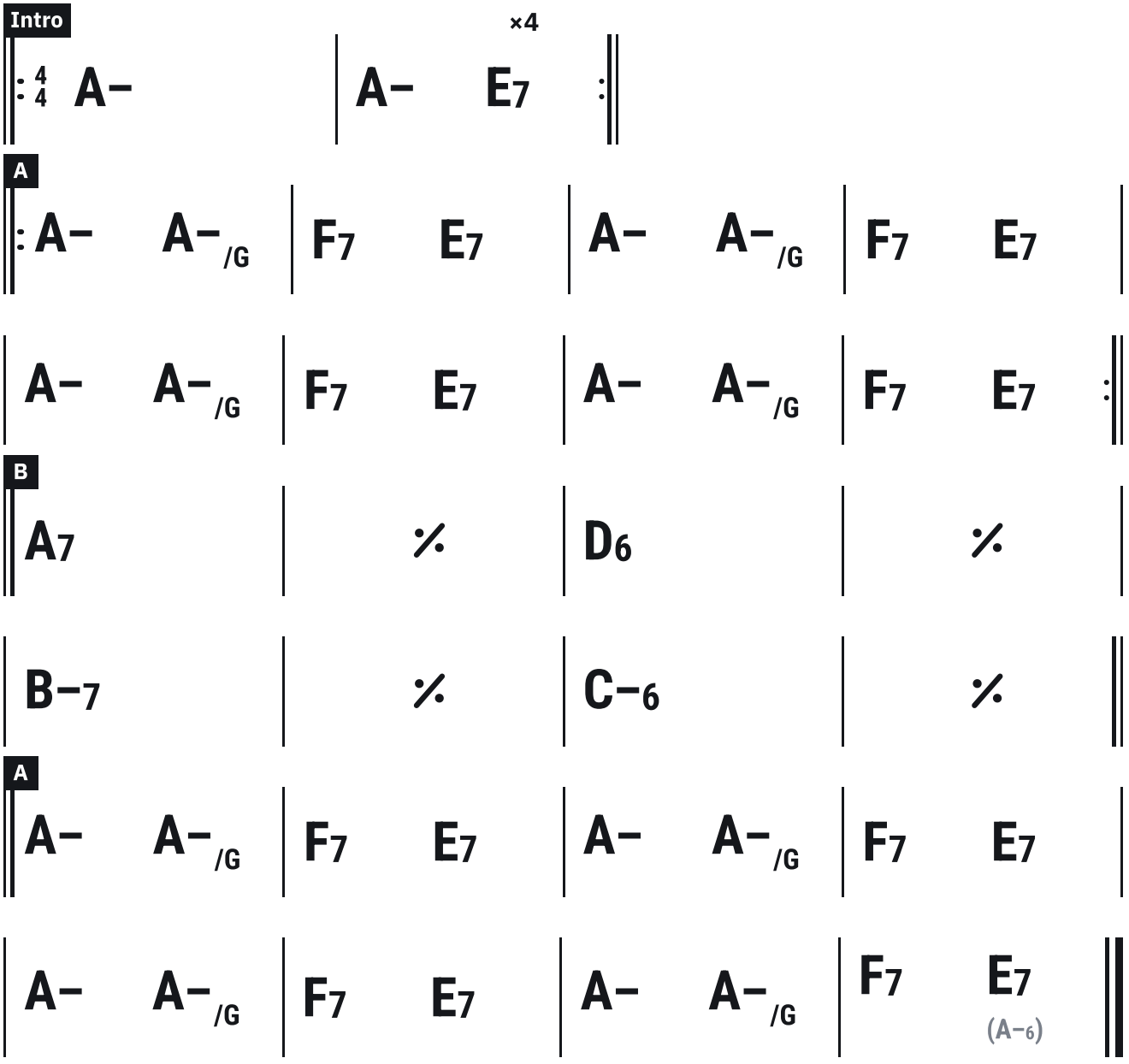
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

DΔ7	D F♯ A C♯
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
AΔ7	A C♯ E G♯
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
B–7	B D F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
C♯–7	C♯ E G♯ B
F♯–7	F♯ A C♯ E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
A6	A C♯ E F♯
E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G

(Medium Up Swing)

Kansas City Stride

Giorgio Cuscito (Tiber River Dixieland)



Written key **A–** Concert **G–** Form **AABA · 32 + 8-bar intro** Feel **Lindy · Balboa**

Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **2011**

Kansas City Stride · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The riff over A– is the head; the F7 E7 bars are the answer, so phrase riff / answer, riff / answer, four times, and keep the E7 bar short.
- Solos: A minor pentatonic and blues on the riff bars; E♭ down to D on F7 → E7 and G♯ on the E7 name the slide. Bridge: D major pentatonic covers A7, D6 and B–7 (six bars), then E♭ and B♭ on the C–6 bars, a half step above home.
- Intro: the horns stack a riff on the third and fourth time through the vamp; make it a two-bar figure that leaves the E7 kick (beats 3–4 of bar 2) to the rhythm section.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

In	**A–**	C E	**E7**	G♯ D					
A	**A–**	C E	**A–/G**	C E	**F7**	A E♭	**E7**	G♯ D	
B	**A7**	C♯ G	**D6**	F♯ B	**B–7**	D A	**C–6**	E♭ A	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

The Lester's Bounce riff: A– with an F7 E7 slide every second bar

A minor pentatonic and the A blues scale over the whole eight; the riff is the melody. The F7 E7 is a ♭VI7 → V7 slide: E♭ (7th of F7) down to D (7th of E7), and G♯ on the E7 (A harmonic minor). Anything you play on Lester's Bounce bars 1–4 works here, four times.

B

Bright for six bars, dark for two: A7 → D → B–7 → C–

D major pentatonic covers A7, D6 and B–7 in one go, with C♯ natural as the colour note against the A's C and G on the A7. Then C minor pentatonic for the C–6 bars (E♭ and B♭ are the notes that say minor), and you are a half step above home: slide down into A minor pent on bar 25.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Intro one chord a bar (16 bars) · A bars 7–8 as A– | E7 to break the loop · bridge with D–6 and Bø7 for the all-minor version (that is the Lester's Bounce bridge) · C–6 played as F9 · last bar A–6.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · A minor pent A C D E G

A · A blues scale A C D E♭ E G

B · D major pent (A7, C, B–7) D E F♯ A B

B · C minor pent (C–) C E♭ F G B♭

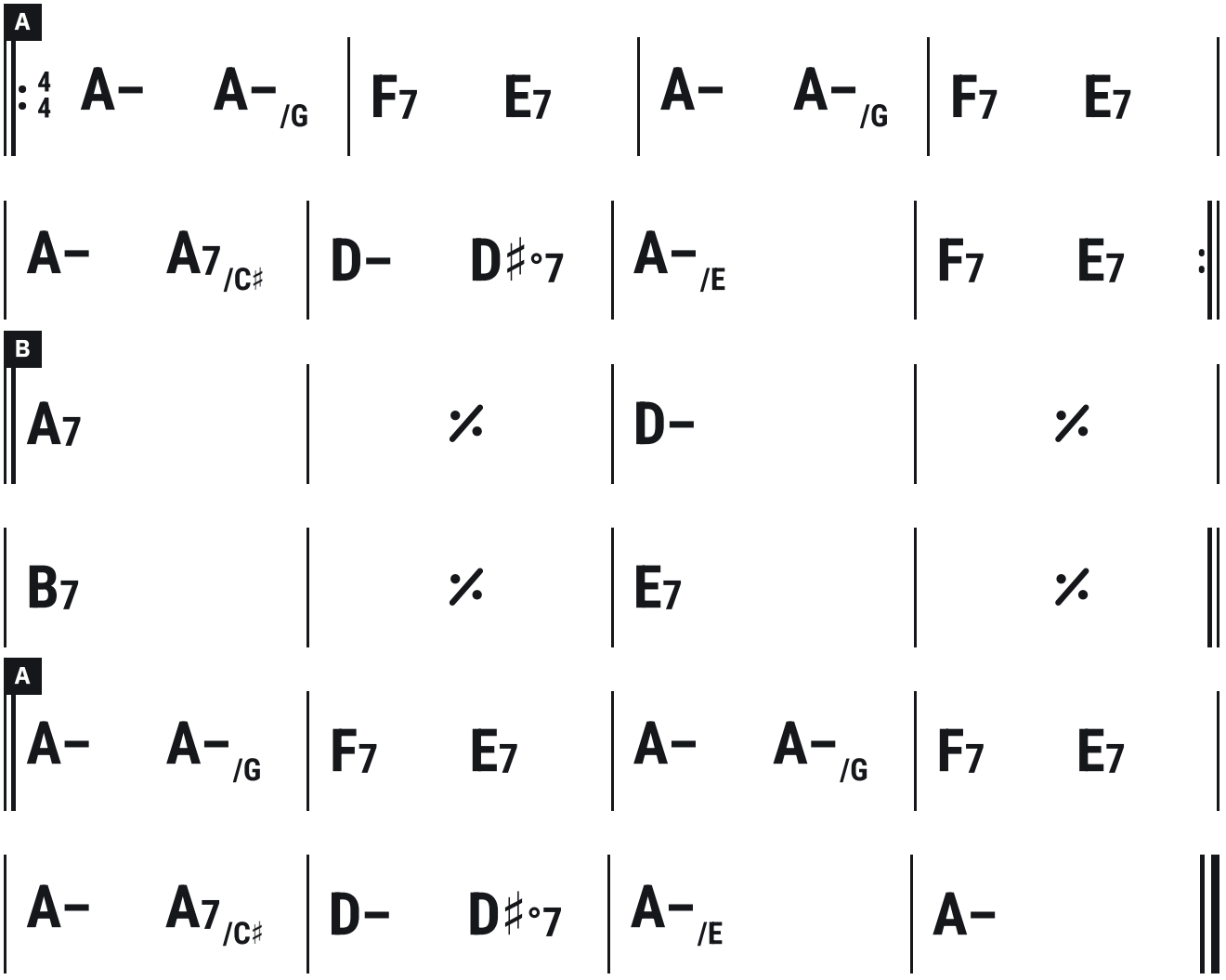
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A–	A C E
E7	E G♯ B D
A–/G	A C E
F7	F A C E♭
A7	A C♯ E G
D6	D F♯ A B
B–7	B D F♯ A
C–6	C E♭ G A
A–6	A C E F♯

(Medium Swing)

Lester's Bounce

Your band's chart (Bob Wilber / Antti Sarpila recording)



Written key **A–** Concert **G–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written

Lester's Bounce · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- Clarinet-and-soprano phrasing (Wilber & Sarpila) is the model: the riff sits on the beat, the answer in bars 5–7 climbs with the bass; play the climb (A C♯ D D♯ E) in unison with the rhythm section.
- Solos: A minor pentatonic and blues over bars 1–4 (the bass line A G F E is the hook); bars 5–7 follow the bass climb A C♯ D D♯ E; F7 E7: A then G♯.
- Bridge: A7 (C♯, G) for two, D minor pentatonic for two, B7 (D♯) for two, E7 (G♯) for two. The 4-bar intro vamp is the A loop: come in with the riff on the fifth bar.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**A–**	C E	**A–**/G	C E	**F7**	A E♭	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**/C♯	C♯ G	**D–**	F A	**D♯°7**	F♯ C	**A–**/E	C E			
B	**A7**	C♯ G	**D–**	F A	**B7**	D♯ A	**E7**	G♯ D											

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A minor riff, chromatic bass in bars 5–7

A minor pentatonic and blues scale over bars 1–4; the bass line A – G – F – E is the hook. Bars 5–7: A7/C♯ (C♯ natural) → D– → D♯°7 (D♯) → A–/E: play the bass line's climb A C♯ D D♯ E in your line and the chords take care of themselves. F7 E7 at the end: A on the F7, G♯ on the E7.

B

Honeysuckle bridge in minor: A7 → D– → B7 → E7

A7 (C♯ , G) for two, D minor pentatonic for two, B7 (D♯) for two, E7 (G♯) for two. Same shape as the Honeysuckle Rose bridge with the IV turned minor.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Your chart is the source. Bar 6 D♯°7 can be played as B7/D♯; the bridge A7 as A7♭9 for the darker sound.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · A minor pent A C D E G

A · A blues scale A C D E♭ E G

B bars 3–4 · D minor pent D F G A C

B · B7: B major pent B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯
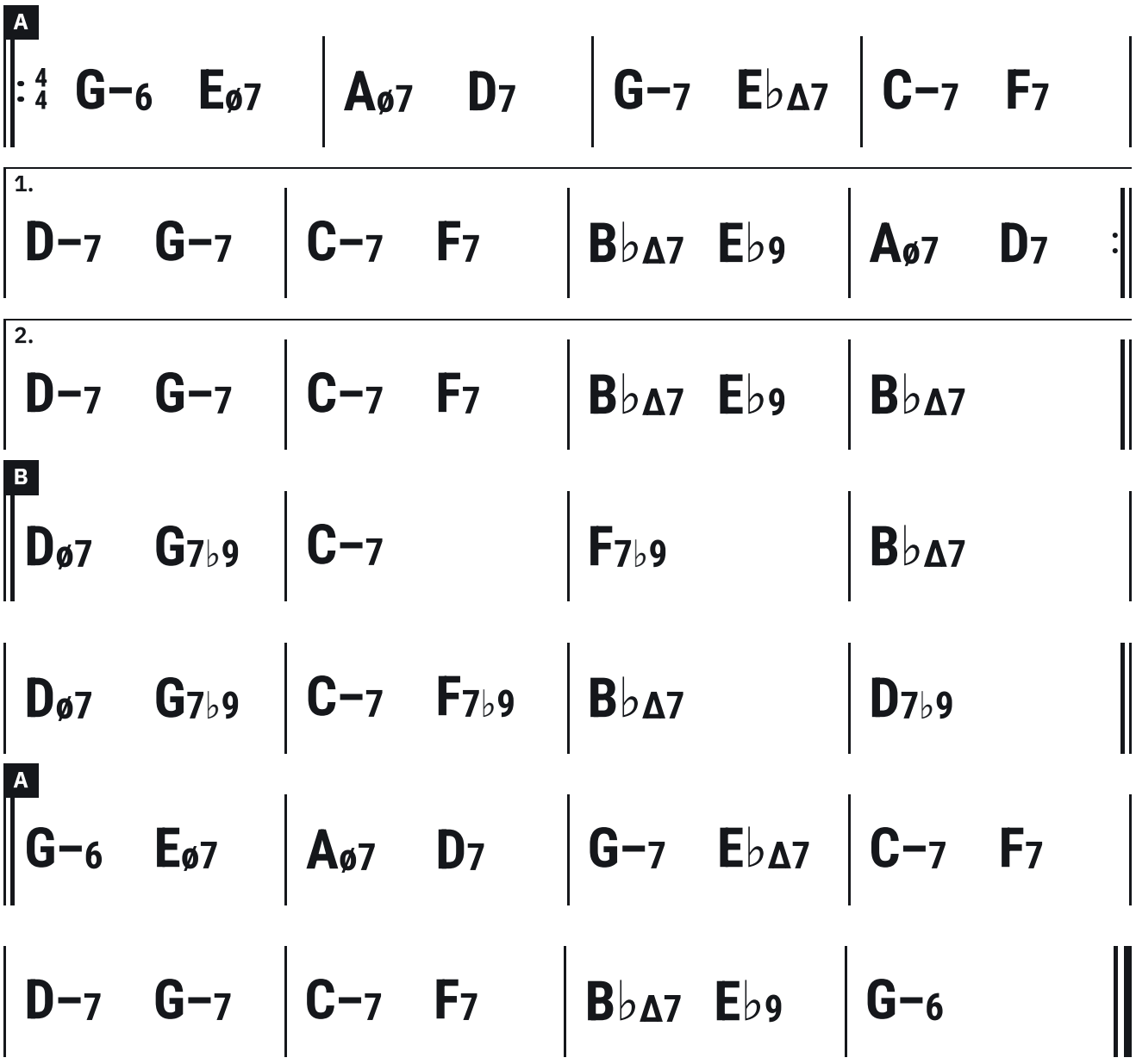
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A–	A C E
A–/G	A C E
F7	F A C E♭
E7	E G♯ B D
A7/C♯	A C♯ E G
D–	D F A
D♯°7	D♯ F♯ A C
A–/E	A C E
A7	A C♯ E G
B7	B D♯ F♯ A

(Medium Swing)

Lullaby of Birdland

George Shearing



Written key **G– / B♭** Concert **F– / A♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **150–200 bpm**

Written **1952**

Lullaby of Birdland · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- Bars 1–2 are G minor (F♯ on the D7), bar 3 onward is B♭ major: the melody's leap in bar 3 marks the key change; play it as a lift.
- Solos: G harmonic minor over Eø7 Aø7 D7 (bars 1–2), then B♭ major pentatonic for everything else; E♭9 in bar 7 wants D♭, Aø7 D7 at the end wants E♭ then F♯.
- Bridge: B♭ major throughout; on each G7♭9 play B natural and A♭, on F7♭9 A and G♭. The last bar's D7♭9 (F♯, E♭) is the door back to G minor.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **G−6** B♭ E · **Eø7** G B♭ D · **Aø7** C E♭ G · **D7** F♯ C · **G−7** B♭ F · **E♭Δ7** G D · **C−7** E♭ B♭ · **F7** A E♭ · **D−7** F C · **B♭Δ7** D A · **E♭9** G D♭

B **Dø7** F A♭ C · **G7♭9** A♭ B F · **C−7** E♭ B♭ · **F7♭9** G♭ A E♭ · **B♭Δ7** D A · **D7♭9** E♭ F♯ C

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G minor for two bars, B♭ major for the rest

G harmonic minor over Eø7–Aø7–D7 (F♯ natural is the note). From bar 3 think B♭ major pentatonic: C–7 F7 B♭ and D–7 G–7 C–7 F7 are all one scale. E♭9 in bar 7: D♭ . Aø7 D7 at the end: E♭ then F♯ .

B

B♭ major, iii–VI–ii–V–I twice

B♭ major pentatonic for the whole bridge; on each G7♭9 play B natural and A♭ , on F7♭9 play A and G♭ . The last bar's D7♭9 (F♯ , E♭) is the door back to G minor.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as A7♭9 D7♭9 · bars 3–4 as G–7 C–7 | F7 B♭Δ7 (Real-Book shape) · bridge bars 1–2 as B♭Δ7 | B♭Δ7 in older charts.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A bars 1–2 · G harmonic minor G A B♭ C D E♭ F♯

A, B · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

over G–6 · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G−6	G B♭ D E
Eø7	E G B♭ D
Aø7	A C E♭ G
D7	D F♯ A C
G−7	G B♭ D F
E♭Δ7	E♭ G B♭ D
C−7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
D−7	D F A C
B♭Δ7	B♭ D F A
E♭9	E♭ F G B♭ D♭
Dø7	D F A♭ C
G7♭9	G A♭ B D F
F7♭9	F G♭ A C E♭
D7♭9	D E♭ F♯ A C

(Slow Shuffle)

Moanin'

Bobby Timmons



Written key **G–** Concert **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Slow lindy / blues shuffle** Dance tempo **100–125 bpm**

Written **1958**

Moanin' · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The head is call-and-response: the piano calls, you answer in unison in bars 2, 4, 6 with the two-note 'amen' figure (B natural, the major 3rd, against the minor call); play it fat and together.
- Solos: G minor blues scale and G dorian over everything; target F♯ (3rd of D7) at the end of each two-bar unit and slide back to B♭. Gospel grace notes: A into B♭, C♯ into D.
- Bridge: C–7 B♭7 | A7 D7 | G–7 | G7 | C–7 B♭7 | A7 | D7 | D7: lean on the 3rds E♭ D C♯ F♯; two whole bars of D7 at the end, so say something and leave space.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**G–7**	B♭ F	**B♭7**	D A♭	**A∅7**	C E♭ G	**D7**	F♯ C	**A–7**	C G	**B–7**	D A
B	**C–7**	E♭ B♭	**B♭7**	D A♭	**A7**	C♯ G	**D7**	F♯ C	**G–7**	B♭ F	**G7**	B F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G minor blues, chromatic dominants underneath

G minor blues scale and G dorian over everything; the B♭7 – A7 – D7 chain is just a bass line under the blues scale. Target F♯ natural (3rd of D7) at the end of each two-bar unit, then slide back to B♭. Gospel grace notes: A into B♭, C♯ into D.

B

C–7 → B♭7 → A7 → D7, then V

Descending bass C – B♭ – A, then D7. Lean on 3rds: E♭ D C♯ F♯. G7 in bar 4 is V of C–: B natural and F. Second half opens out: two whole bars of D7, so say something and leave space.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Some charts keep the solo A as plain G–7 for eight bars · answer sometimes written C | G7 · bridge bar 4 as G7♭9.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

A · G blues scale G B♭ C D♭ D F

B · C minor pent C E♭ F G B♭

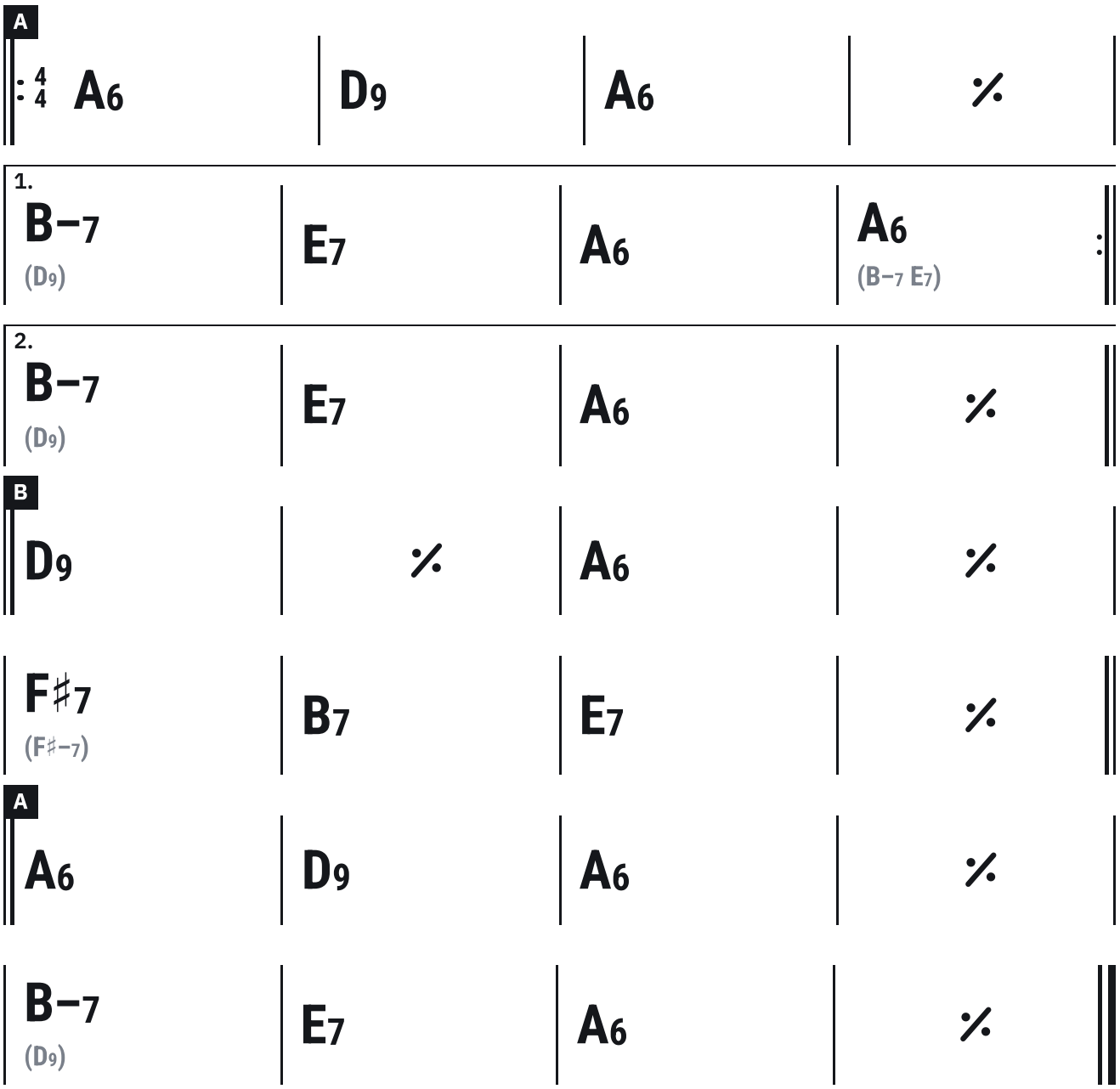
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G–7	G B♭ D F
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
A∅7	A C E♭ G
D7	D F♯ A C
A–7	A C E G
B–7	B D F♯ A
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
A7	A C♯ E G
G7	G B D F

(Medium Swing)

Oh, Lady Be Good

George & Ira Gershwin



Written key **A** Concert **G** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1924**

Oh, Lady Be Good · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- Lester Young 1936 is the whole language for this tune: light, behind the beat, A major pentatonic with the blues scale, phrases that start late in the bar.
- Bar 2 (D9): the C against the band's C♯ is the blues in the tune; bars 5–6 (B–7 E7): G rising to G♯.
- Bridge: D major for two bars (C on the D9), A for two, then F♯7 → B7 → E7: A♯, D♯, G♯ on the downbeats and you've played the bridge.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**A6**	C♯ F♯	**D9**	F♯ C	**B–7**	D A	**E7**	G♯ D			
B	**D9**	F♯ C	**A6**	C♯ F♯	**F♯7**	A♯ E	**B7**	D♯ A	**E7**	G♯ D	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A major, four bars, then a ii–V

A major pentatonic plus the blues scale; the D9's C against the band's C♯ is the blues in bar 2. Bars 5–6, B–7 E7: G rising to G♯.

B

IV, I, then VI7 → II7 → V7

D major for two bars (D9: C), A for two, then the chain: F♯7 wants A♯, B7 wants D♯, E7 wants G♯. Play those three notes on the downbeats and you've played the bridge.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 5 as B7 or D9 · bridge bars 1–2 as A7 | A7 (Honeysuckle shape) · bar 8 of A2 as E7 into the bridge.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

A · A blues scale A C D E♭ E G

B bars 1–2 · D major pent D E F♯ A B

B · B7: B major pent B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯

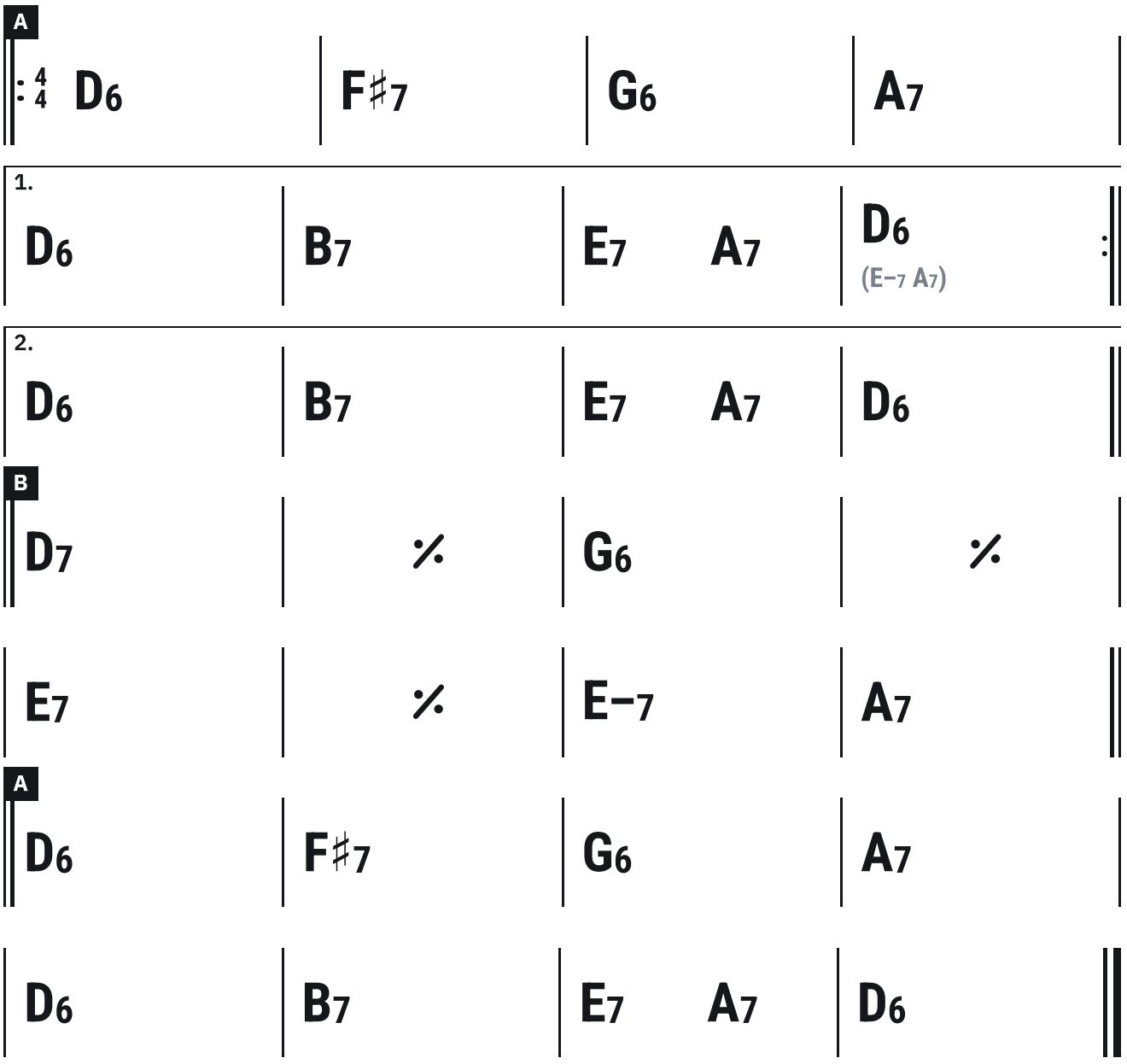
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

A6	A C♯ E F♯
D9	D E F♯ A C
B–7	B D F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E
F♯–7	F♯ A C♯ E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A

(Medium Swing)

On the Sunny Side of the Street

Jimmy McHugh & Dorothy Fields



Written key **D** Concert **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lazy lindy / blues** Dance tempo **110–140 bpm**

Written **1930**

On the Sunny Side of the Street · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- Lay back: the melody sits behind the beat at 120, and the long notes in bars 1 and 5 (D6) want a slow vibrato at the end.
- Three dominants, three notes: A♯ on F♯7 (bar 2), D♯ on B7 (bar 6), G♯ on E7 (bar 7). Hit those on the beat and the tune is in the room; D major pentatonic covers the rest.
- Bridge: D7 (C) for two bars, G for two, E7 (G♯) for two, E–7 A7 home; the D blues scale sits fine over the first four bars.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D6** F♯ B	**F♯7** A♯ E	**G6** B E	**A7** C♯ G	**B7** D♯ A	**E7** G♯ D
B	**D7** F♯ C	**G6** B E	**E7** G♯ D	**E–7** G D	**A7** C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D major, bending three notes in

D major pentatonic all the way, except the three dominants that each ask for one note: F♯7 wants A♯ (bar 2), B7 wants D♯ (bar 6), E7 wants G♯ (bar 7). Hit those on the beat and the tune is in the room.

B

D7 → G → E7 → E–7 A7

D mixolydian (C) for two bars, G major for two, E7 (G♯) for two, then ii–V home. D blues scale sits fine over the first four bars.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–7 also played B–7 | E7 | E–7 A7 · bridge as A–7 D7 | A–7 D7 | G6 | G6 | B–7 E7 | B–7 E7 | E–7 | A7, or ending E7 | E7 | A7 | A7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D major pent D E F♯ A B

A, B · D blues scale D F G A♭ A C

B · G major pent G A B D E

B · E7: E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

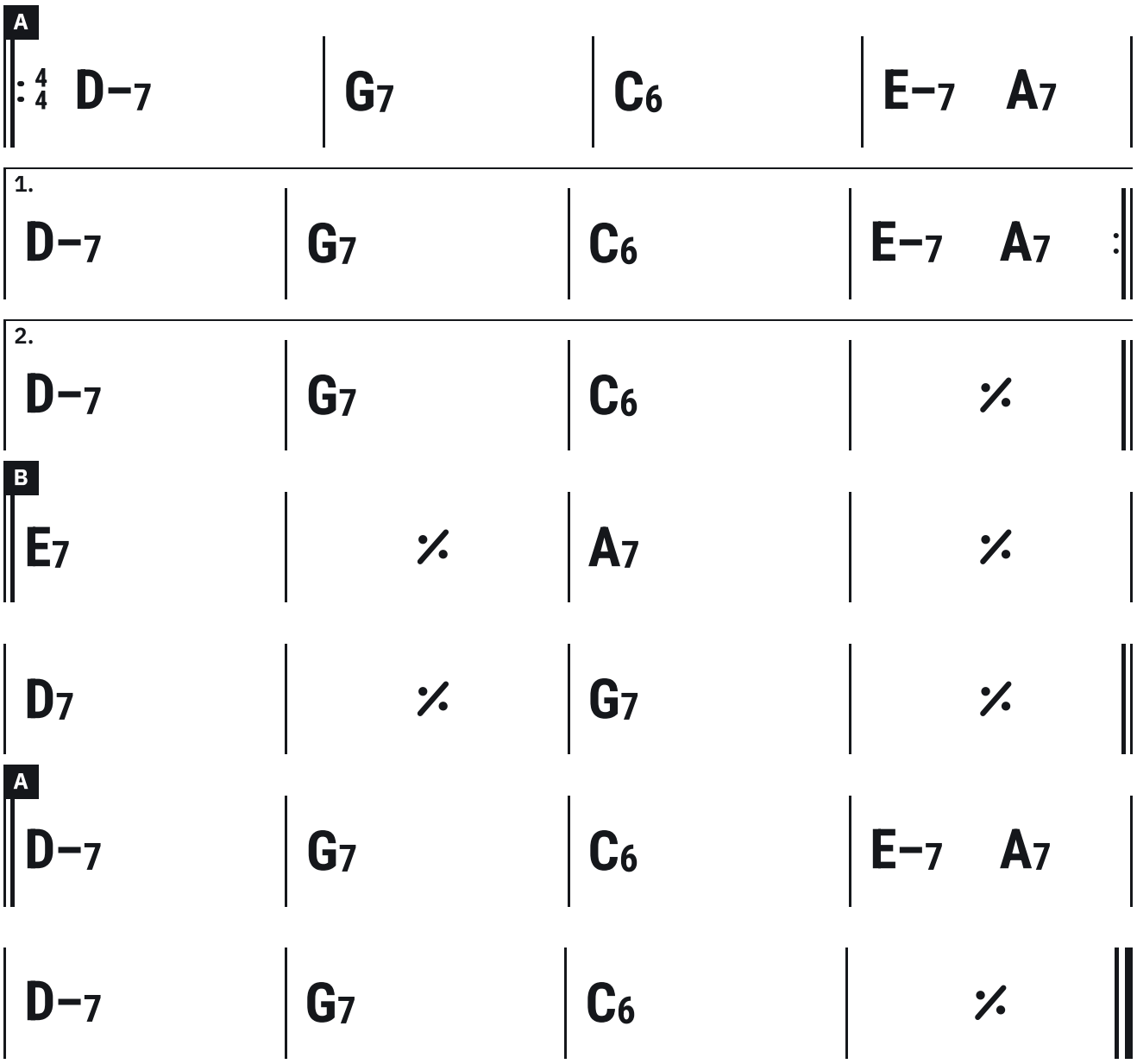
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D6	D F♯ A B
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E
G6	G B D E
A7	A C♯ E G
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
E–7	E G B D
D7	D F♯ A C

(Medium Up Swing)

Perdido

Juan Tizol



Written key **C** Concert **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1941**

Perdido · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The riff (C major pentatonic, two bars long) is the head: in unison, short, and let the rhythm section answer in bars 3–4 (C6 | E–7 A7).
- Solos: C major pentatonic; C♯ on A7 drops you onto D–7 every four bars; the blues scale over the G7s.
- Bridge: the rhythm bridge E7 → A7 → D7 → G7; 3rds G♯ C♯ F♯ B on the downbeats. Anything you play on I Got Rhythm's bridge works here.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D–7** F C	**G7** B F	**C6** E A	**E–7** G D	**A7** C♯ G		
B	**E7** G♯ D	**A7** C♯ G	**D7** F♯ C	**G7** B F			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C major with a VI7 pull

The riff is C major pentatonic and so is the solo; the only non-diatonic note you need is C♯ natural on A7, which drops you onto D–7 every four bars. Blues scale over the G7s.

B

The rhythm bridge: E7 A7 D7 G7

Two bars each; targets G♯ C♯ F♯ B. Identical to the I Got Rhythm bridge, so anything you play there works here.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A as C6 | C6 | C6 | C6 | D–7 G7 | D–7 G7 | C6 | C6 in some charts · bridge bar 4 as A7♯5 (Hawkins' rhythm section).

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · C major pent C D E G A

A · C blues scale C E♭ F G♭ G B♭

B · E7: E major pent (then A, C, G) E F♯ G♯ B C♯

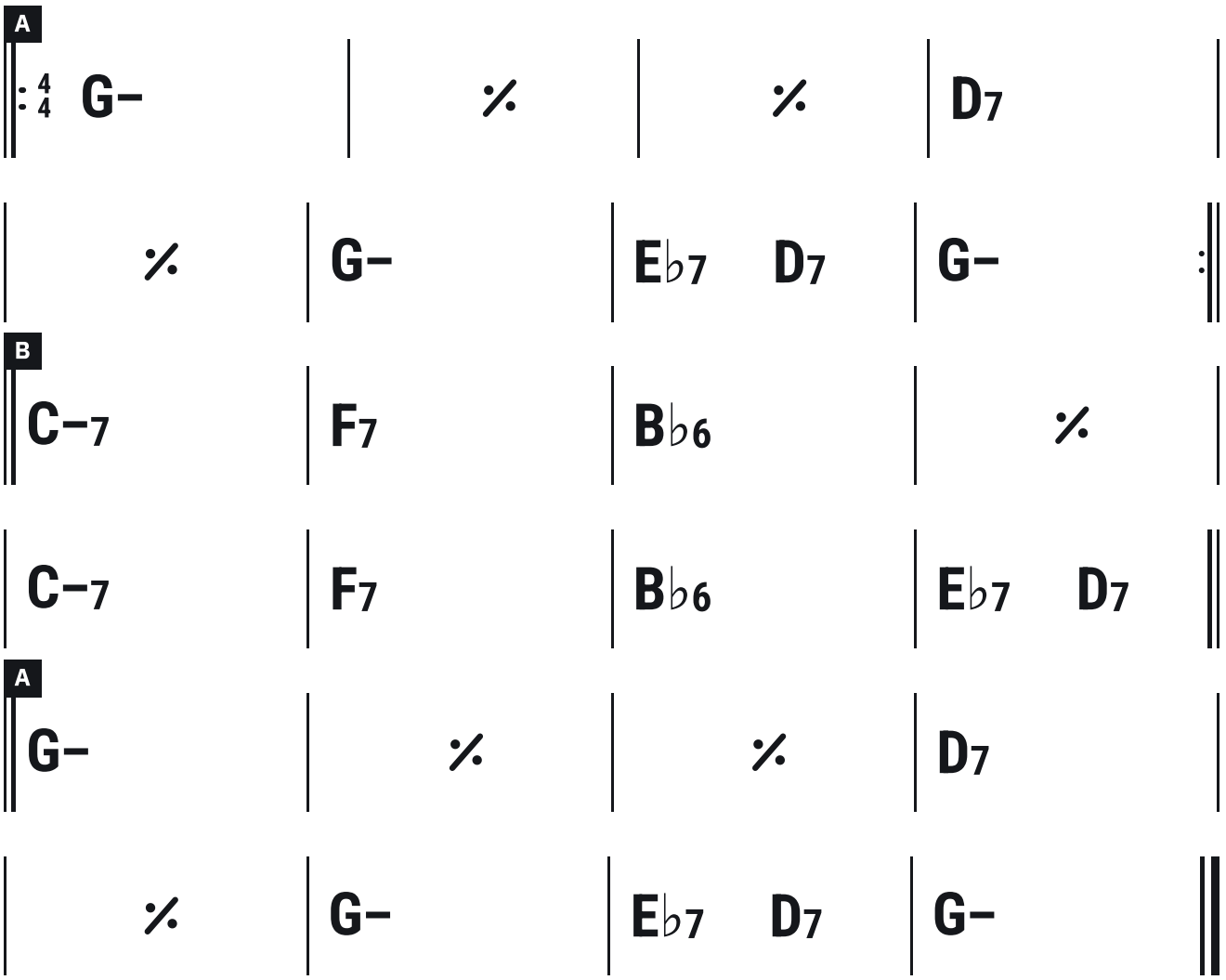
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
C6	C E G A
E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G
E7	E G♯ B D
D7	D F♯ A C

(Up Swing)

Puttin' On the Ritz

Irving Berlin



Written key **G– → B♭** Concert **F– → A♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Charleston / Balboa**

Dance tempo **200–240 bpm** Written **1929**

Puttin' On the Ritz · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- Berlin's melody is a minor arpeggio displaced across the barline: count it, don't feel it, until it's in your body; the rhythm is the tune.
- A: G minor pentatonic and blues; F♯ on D7 (bars 4–5), the E♭7 → D7 slide in bar 7. Bridge: B♭ major for seven bars (C–7 F7 B♭6 twice), bright and legato, then E♭7 D7: land F♯ on the D7.
- Breathe in bar 8 of each A (G–, held): the melody rests there and the Charleston tempo gives you nothing else.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**G–**	B♭ D	**D7**	F♯ C	**E♭7**	G D♭					
B	**C–7**	E♭ B♭	**F7**	A E♭	**B♭6**	D G	**E♭7**	G D♭	**D7**	F♯ C	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G minor, D7 = G harmonic minor

G minor pentatonic and blues scale on the G– bars; on D7, F♯ natural with E♭ (G harmonic minor). The E♭7 – D7 slide: E♭7's G/D♭ falls to D7's F♯ /C. Berlin's melody is a minor arpeggio shifted across the bar; shift your own three-note cell the same way.

B

Relative major B♭: ii–V–I twice

C dorian, F mixolydian and B♭ major are one scale: B♭ major. Play sunlight for seven bars, then E♭7 – D7 slams the door back to G–; land on F♯ for the D7.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bar 4–5 as one bar D7 and one bar G– in some charts · bridge ending as E♭7 | D7 over two bars.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

A, over D7 · G harmonic minor G A B♭ C D E♭ F♯

B · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

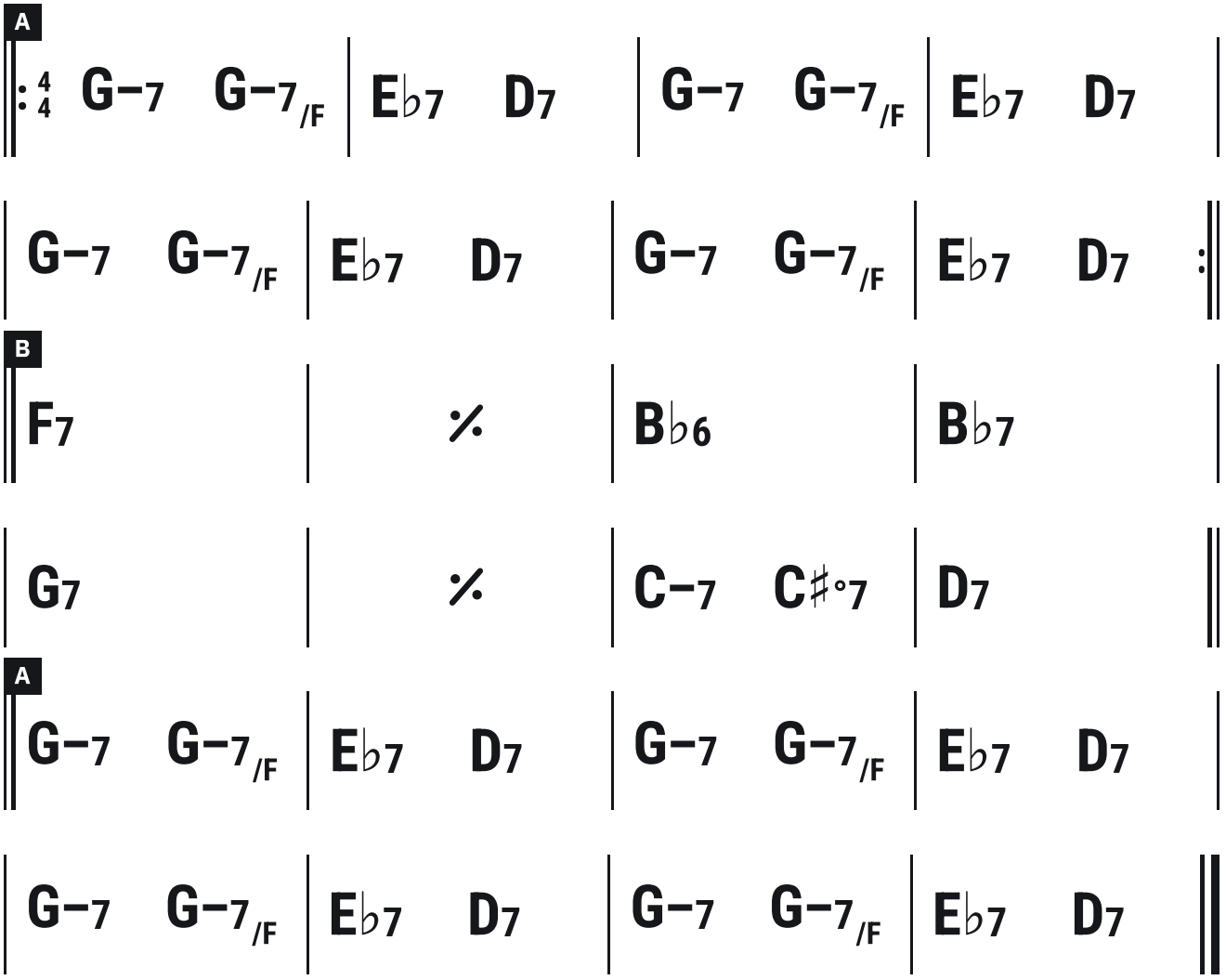
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G–	G B♭ D
D7	D F♯ A C
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
B♭6	B♭ D F G

(Up Swing)

Ridin' and Jivin'

Earl Hines, your band's chart



Written key **G–** Concert **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Fast lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **150 bpm**

Written **1939**

Ridin' and Jivin' · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The loop is a four-chord riff (i, i/♭7, ♭VI7, V7): the head is a riff on it, so play short notes in unison and let the bass line G – F – E♭ – D be the floor.
- Solos: G minor pentatonic and blues all the way; E♭ on E♭7 and F♯ on D7 when you want to name the chords. Bridge: F7 (E♭, A), B♭ then B♭7 (A♭), G7 (B natural: two bars of major in a minor tune), then C–7 C♯°7 D7: E♭ → E → F♯, a chromatic climb into the last A.
- The bridge is marked 'slide in G slooow' on the score: a glissando into the G7 bars. The post-intro is eight bars of the loop with the horns riffing before the head.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **G–7** B♭ F **G–7/F** B♭ F **E♭7** G D♭ **D7** F♯ C

B **F7** A E♭ **B♭6** D G **B♭7** D A♭ **G7** B F **C–7** E♭ B♭ **C♯°7** E B♭ **D7** F♯ C

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G minor over a four-chord loop

G minor pentatonic and blues scale all the way; the loop's bass line G – F – E♭ – D is the hook. Name the chords when you want to: E♭ on E♭7, F♯ natural on D7, then back to B♭.

B

♭VII7 → ♭III → I7 → iv → V

F7: F mixolydian (E♭ , A). B♭ then B♭7 (A♭). G7 is the surprise: B natural, two bars of major in a minor tune. C–7 C♯°7 D7: E♭ → E → F♯ , a chromatic climb into the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Your chart is the source. Hines's record has more passing chords in the bridge; the bass line is the same.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

A · G blues scale G B♭ C D♭ D F

B · B♭ major pent (F7, B♭) B♭ C D F G

B bars 5–6 · G major pent (G7) G A B D E

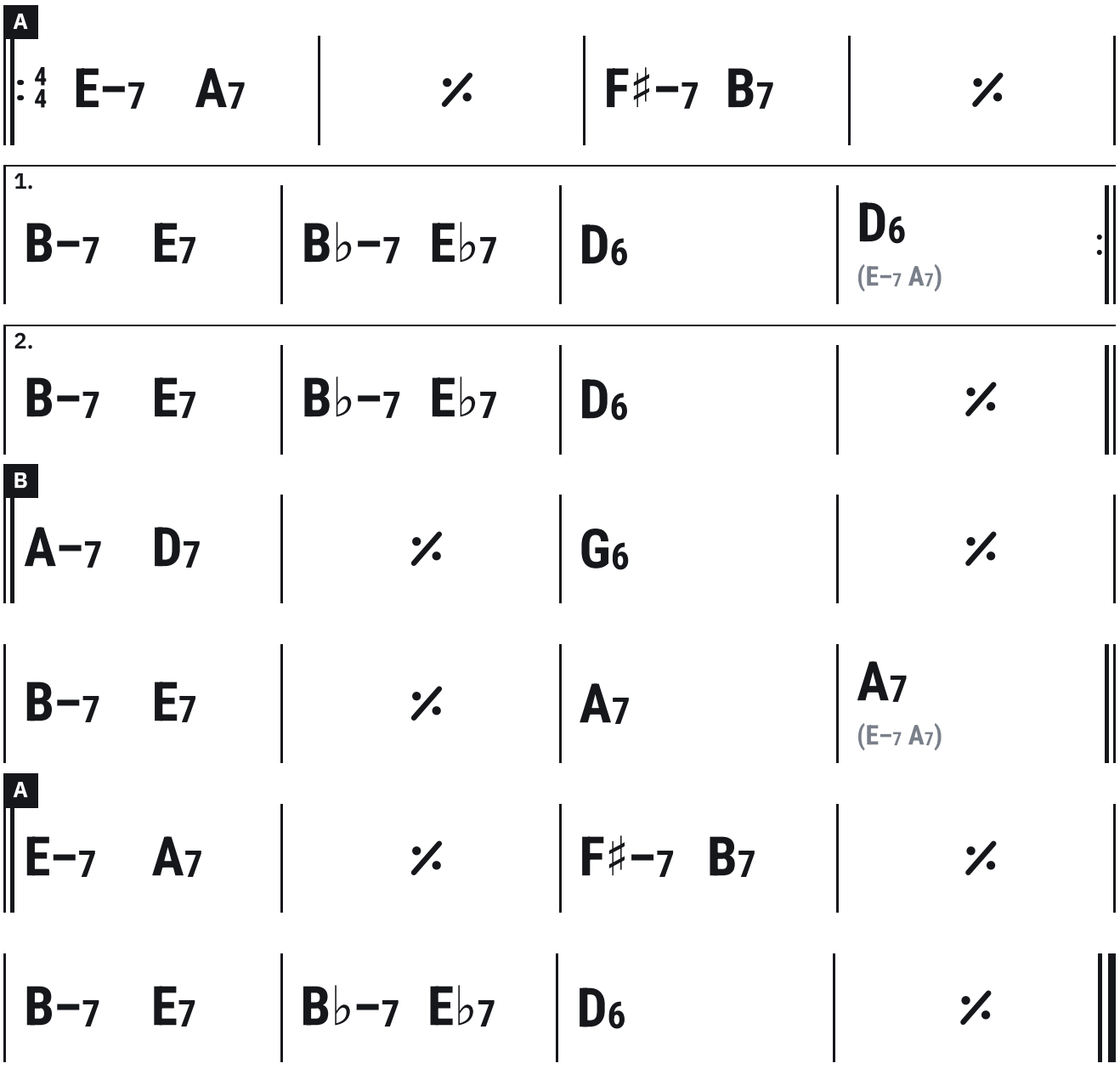
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

G–7	G B♭ D F
G–7/F	G B♭ D F
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
D7	D F♯ A C
F7	F A C E♭
B♭6	B♭ D F G
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
G7	G B D F
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
C♯°7	C♯ E G B♭

(Medium Swing)

Satin Doll

Duke Ellington & Billy Strayhorn



Written key **D** Concert **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / slow swing** Dance tempo **130–160 bpm**

Written **1953**

Satin Doll · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The melody is the same two-note figure moved up by step (E–7 A7 → F♯–7 B7): play the second one exactly like the first, a step higher, and the tune is instantly recognisable.
- Solos: think the target key of each ii–V: D major on E–7 A7, E major (D♯, G♯) on F♯–7 B7, A major (G♯) on B–7 E7, A♭ major (D♭, G) on B♭–7 E♭7, then D.
- Bridge: G major (C on the D7) for four bars, A major (G♯) on B–7 E7, then two bars of A7: G natural, and leave space for the drummer.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A **E–7** G D **A7** C♯ G **F♯–7** A E **B7** D♯ A **B–7** D A **E7** G♯ D **B♭–7** D♭ A♭ **E♭7** G D♭ **D6** F♯ B

B **A–7** C G **D7** F♯ C **G6** B E **B–7** D A **E7** G♯ D **A7** C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

Think the target key of each ii–V

E–7 A7: D major pentatonic. F♯–7 B7: E major pentatonic (D♯ , G♯). B–7 E7: A major pentatonic (G♯). B♭–7 E♭7: A♭ major pentatonic (D♭ , G), which lands you a half step above D so the resolution is physical. Then D.

B

G major, then A major, then V

A–7 D7 G: G major pentatonic (C on the D7). B–7 E7: A major pentatonic (G♯). Two bars of A7: G natural, and leave space for the drummer.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

First-B bar 8 as F♯–7 B7 · bar 6 as E–7 A7 (the sheet) instead of the tritone sub · bridge bars 7–8 as E–7 A7 | E–7 A7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

E–7 A7 · D major pent D E F♯ A B

F♯–7 B7 · E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

B–7 E7 · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

B♭–7 E♭7 · A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

B · G major pent G A B D E
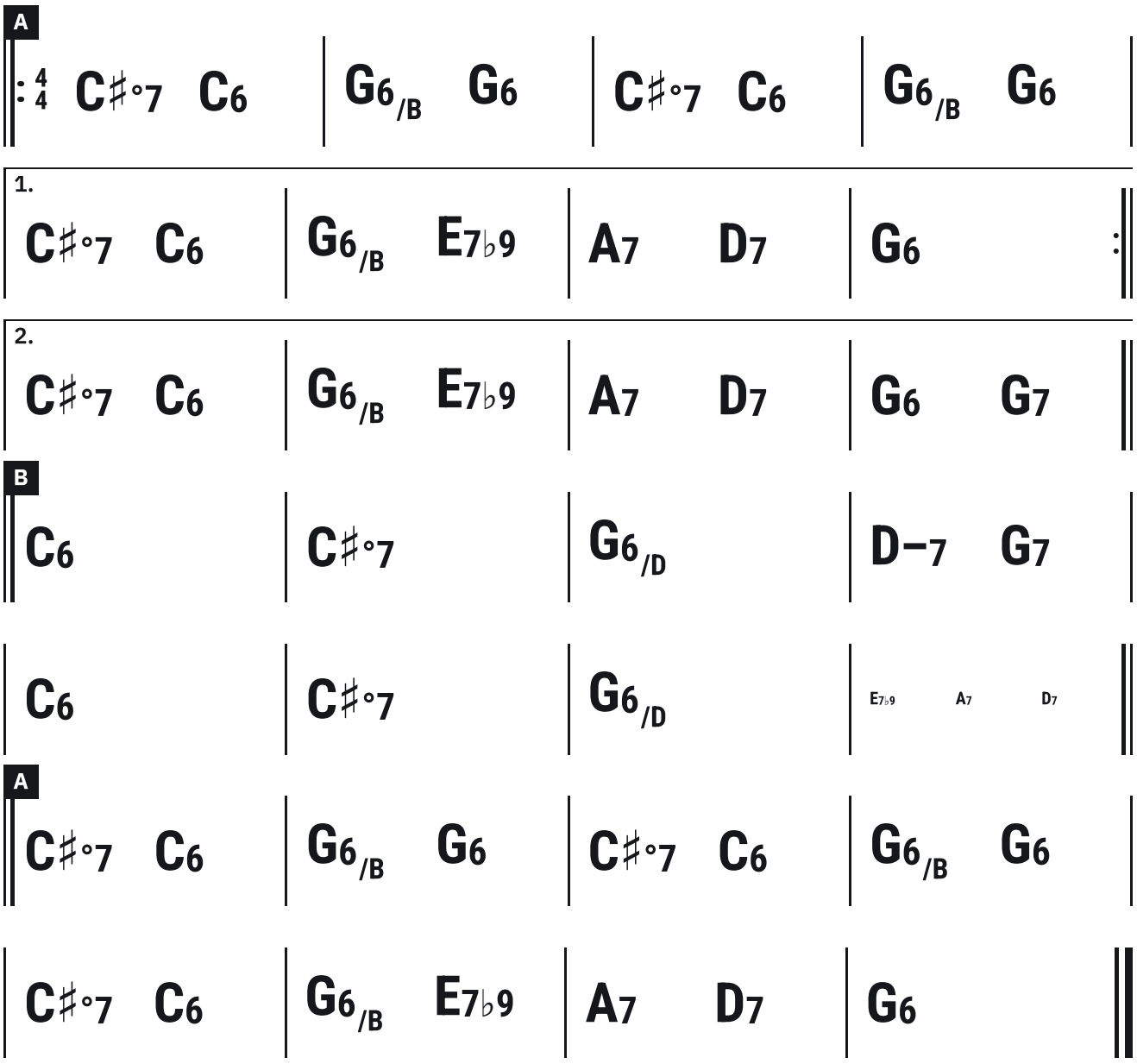
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G
F♯–7	F♯ A C♯ E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
B–7	B D F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
B♭–7	B♭ D♭ F A♭
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
D6	D F♯ A B
A–7	A C E G
D7	D F♯ A C
G6	G B D E

(Medium Swing)

A Smooth One

Benny Goodman & Charlie Christian



Written key **G** Concert **F** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lazy lindy** Dance tempo **120 bpm** Written **1941**

A Smooth One · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The riff is the melody and it sits on the bass line C♯ – C – B – G: legato and lazy at 120, Goodman Sextet style; the clarinet or sax leads, the trumpet doubles an octave below.
- Solos: G major pentatonic over the riff; C♯ on C♯°7, G♯ and F on E7♭9, C♯ on A7, F♯ on D7. Bridge: C major pentatonic over C6, C♯°7, G6/D; D–7 G7 is a backdoor ii–V back to C (F); the last bar's E7♭9 A7 D7 wants G♯ C♯ F♯, one per chord, on the beat.
- Intro: 8 bars of piano and drums, you enter at the top of the A; the second ending (G6 G7) leads into the bridge. The tag has an N.C. pickup bar: breathe, then play it.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**C♯°7** E B♭	**C6** E A	**G6/B** B E	**G6** B E	**E7♭9** F G♯ D	**A7** C♯ G	**D7** F♯ C	**G7** B F
B	**C6** E A	**C♯°7** E B♭	**G6/D** B E	**D–7** F C	**G7** B F	**E7♭9** F G♯ D	**A7** C♯ G	**D7** F♯ C

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G major over a walking bass riff

G major pentatonic; the riff's bass C♯ – C – B – G is the melody's shadow, so play it in the left hand and solo above it. C♯°7 is an A7♭9 in disguise: C♯ natural. E7♭9 → G♯ and F; A7 → C♯; D7 → F♯.

B

The riff from IV, then three dominants in a bar

C major pentatonic over C6, C♯°7 and G6/D; D–7 G7 is a backdoor ii–V back to C (F). The last bar, E7♭9 A7 D7: G♯ C♯ F♯, one per chord, on the beat.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Jam charts read the A as G | G7/D C♯°7 | C–6 G/A: C–6 is the ear's version of your C6 under the melody's E natural · session key G; the Goodman/Christian record may be in B♭.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · G major pent	G A B D E
A · G blues scale	G B♭ C D♭ D F
B · C major pent	C D E G A

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

C♯°7	C♯ E G B♭
C6	C E G A
G6/B	G B D E
G6	G B D E
E7♭9	E F G♯ B D
A7	A C♯ E G
D7	D F♯ A C
G7	G B D F
G6/D	G B D E
D–7	D F A C

(Latin / Swing)

Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise

Sigmund Romberg



Written key **C−** Concert **B♭−** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Balboa 180–210 · Lindy** Dance tempo **160–190 bpm**

Written **1928**

Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- One minor ii–V–i eight times under a melody that barely moves: a dark, straight tone on the Latin A, then open up and swing on the bridge.
- Solos: treat the A as one C minor zone (C minor pentatonic and blues, the MJQ way), or name the changes: A natural on C–6, A♭ and B on G7. Bridge: E♭ major for two bars, C7♭9 (E natural, D♭) pulling to F–7 (A♭ major pentatonic), then D7 or Dø7 (F♯ or F) into G7♭9 (B, A♭) home. Target 3rds: G → E → A♭ → F♯ → B.
- Sonny Rollins at the Village Vanguard is the tempo and phrasing reference; he plays it a whole step above this key, so lines lifted from the record come down a step.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**C–6**	E♭ A	**Dø7**	F A♭ C	**G7**	B F	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**B♭7**	D A♭					
B	**E♭6**	G C	**C7♭9**	D♭ E B♭	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**Dø7**	F A♭ C	**G7♭9**	A♭ B F					

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A **One minor ii–V–i, eight times**

C–6 = C melodic minor / C dorian; the A natural is the MJQ colour. G7 = C harmonic minor: A♭ and B. Or do what the MJQ did and treat the A as one C minor zone: C minor pentatonic and blues scale straight across, resolving to E♭ or G on each C–6. Tritone sub to try: A♭7 for Dø7–G7.

B **Relative major: E♭ → C7♭9 → F– → D7 → G7♭9**

E♭ major for two bars. C7♭9 = F harmonic minor (E natural, D♭, A♭) pulling to F–7 (F dorian, A♭ major). Then D7 / Dø7 (F♯ or F) into G7♭9 (B + A♭) and back to C–. Target 3rds: G → E → A♭ → F♯ → B.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bridge in the original sheet (transposed): E♭ | E♭ E♭7/D♭ | C7♭9 | C7♭9 | F– F–/E♭ | D7 | G7♭9 | G7♭9 · learnjazzstandards sub: E♭ | Gø7 C7 | F–7 | Aø7 D7 | G7 · session key D–: everything a whole step up.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · C minor pent C E♭ F G B♭

A, over G7 · C harmonic minor C D E♭ F G A♭ B

B bars 1–2 · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

B bars 5–6 · F minor pent F A♭ B♭ C E♭

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

C–6	C E♭ G A
Dø7	D F A♭ C
G7	G B D F
F–7	F A♭ C E♭
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
E♭6	E♭ G B♭ C
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
C7♭9	C D♭ E G B♭
F♯°7	F♯ A C E♭
D7	D F♯ A C
G7♭9	G A♭ B D F

(Medium Swing)

Stompin' at the Savoy

Edgar Sampson



Written key **E♭** Concert **D♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy 160–190 · Balboa** Dance tempo **190–220 bpm**

Written **1934**

Stompin' at the Savoy · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The A is a riff in E♭ major pentatonic (plus the blue F♯): short, together, and let the rhythm section's riff answer. The held notes over bars 5–8 are where the Lindy floor breathes.
- Solos: E♭ major pentatonic plus F♯ for the whole A; E natural and C♯ on the E°7 in bar 4 (or think B♭7♭9). Bridge: A♭7 → C♯7 → F♯7 → B7 → B♭7, dominants dropping a fourth; 3rds C F A♯ D♯ D. The 3rd/7th pairs fall a half step each time (C/F♯ → B/F → A♯/E → A/D♯ → A♭/D): play that line alone once and you'll never lose the bridge.
- Ignore the half-step pushes (A9, D9, G9) on beats 3–4 of the bridge's odd bars: they're the rhythm section's, not yours.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**E♭6**	G C	**B♭9**	D A♭	**E°7**	G D♭	**F−7**	A♭ E♭	**B♭7**	D A♭									
B	**A♭9**	C G♭	**A9**	C♯ G	**C♯9**	F B	**D9**	F♯ C	**F♯9**	A♯ E	**G9**	B F	**B9**	D♯ A	**B♭9**	D A♭			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

E♭ major, start to finish

It's a riff tune: E♭ major pentatonic plus the blue F♯ (♭3) covers the whole A. On bar 4, E°7 wants E and C♯ (or think B♭7♭9). Bars 5–6 are a plain ii–V back to E♭.

B

A♭7 → C♯7 → F♯7 → B7 → B♭7

Dominants dropping a fourth. Mixolydian on each. Target the 3rds: C F A♯ D♯ D. The 3rd/7th pairs each fall a half step: C/F♯ → B/F → A♯/E → A/D♯ → A♭/D. Play that line alone once and you'll never lose the bridge again.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bar 2 as E♭6 B♭7 · bars 7–8 as E♭6 C–7 | F–7 B♭7 (the Clifford Brown/Max Roach version).

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

A · E♭ blues scale E♭ G♭ A♭ A B♭ D♭

B · A♭7: A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

B · C♯7: C♯ major pent C♯ D♯ F G♯ A♯

B · F♯7: F♯ major pent F♯ G♯ A♯ C♯ D♯

B · B7: B major pent B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯

B · B♭7: B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

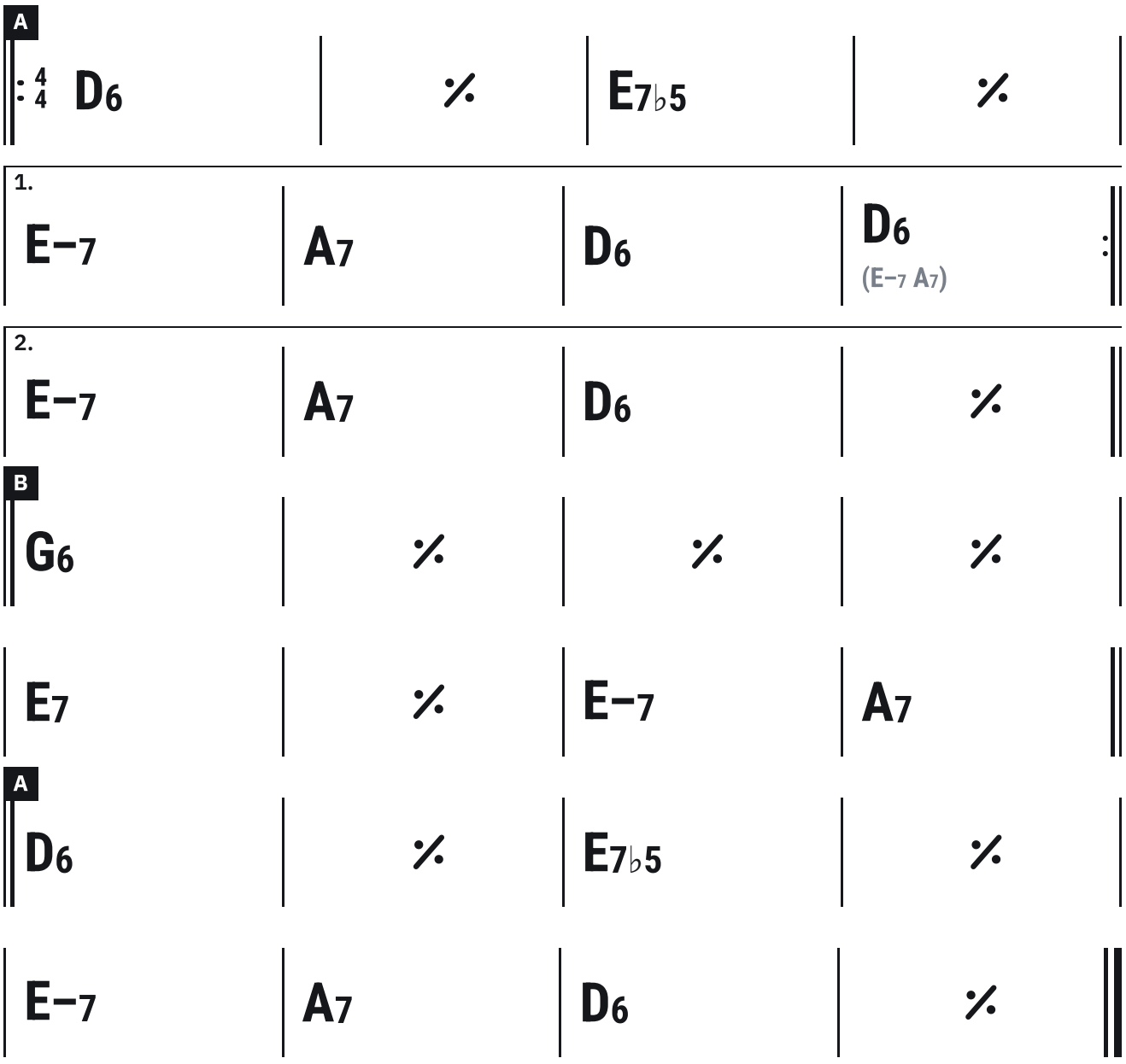
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

E♭6	E♭ G B♭ C
B♭9	B♭ C D F A♭
E°7	E G B♭ D♭
F−7	F A♭ C E♭
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
A♭9	A♭ B♭ C E♭ G♭
A9	A B C♯ E G
C♯9	C♯ D♯ F G♯ B
D9	D E F♯ A C
F♯9	F♯ G♯ A♯ C♯ E
G9	G A B D F
B9	B C♯ D♯ F♯ A

(Medium Up Swing)

Take the “A” Train

Billy Strayhorn



Written key **D** Concert **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1941**

Take the “A” Train · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The long notes in bars 3–4 sit on the E7♭5 (the A♯ is the tune's sound): play them straight and bright; Ray Nance's trumpet lead is the model.
- Solos: D major pentatonic in bars 1–2, E lydian dominant (E F♯ G♯ A♯ B C♯ D) in bars 3–4 with G♯ and A♯ together, plain ii–V–I in bars 5–8. Bridge: four bars of G major, then E7 (G♯, D♯ for lydian colour), E–7 A7 home.
- The ending is a three-note tag repeated, then a ♭VI (B♭6) before the final D6: the tag is a horn line, in unison, and hold the last note through the B♭6.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D6**	F♯ B	**E7♭5**	G♯ B♭ D	**E–7**	G D	**A7**	C♯ G
B	**G6**	B E	**E7**	G♯ D	**E–7**	G D	**A7**	C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D major, with one special chord

Bars 1–2: D major pentatonic. Bars 3–4 are the tune's sound: E lydian dominant (E F♯ G♯ A♯ B C♯ D), the G♯ and A♯ together. Bars 5–8: plain ii–V–I in D.

B

G major (IV), then E7 home

Four bars of G major; then E7 where G♯ is the money note (D♯ for lydian colour), into E–7 A7 and back to D.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 3–4 as E9♯11 · bridge bars 5–6 as E7 | E7♭9 · some charts split A1's last bar as D6 B7 | E–7 A7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D major pent D E F♯ A B

A bars 3–4 · E7♭5 + F♯ E G♯ B♭ D F♯

B · G major pent G A B D E

B · E7: E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯
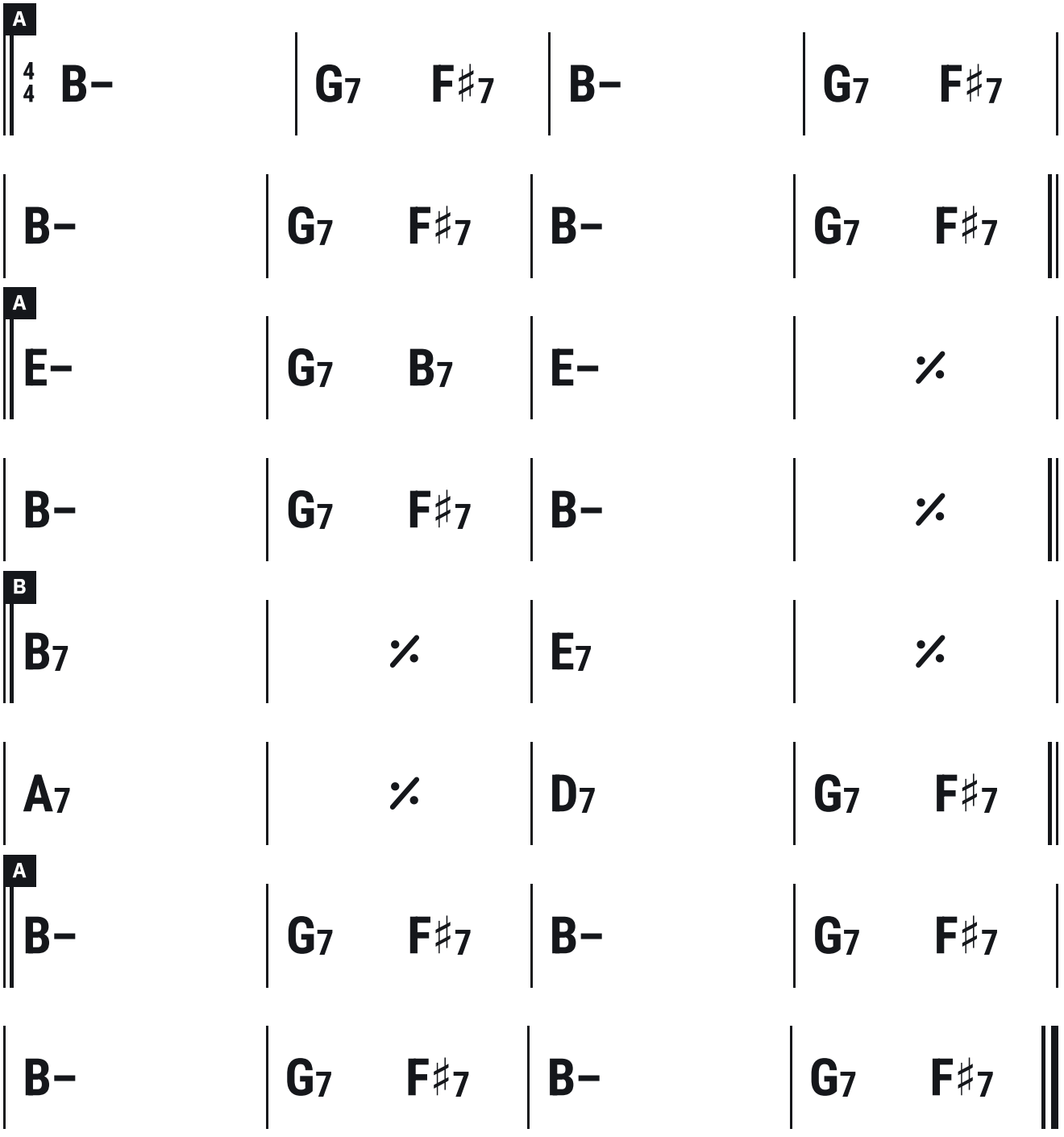
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D6	D F♯ A B
E7♭5	E G♯ B♭ D
E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G
G6	G B D E
E7	E G♯ B D

(Medium Up Swing)

Topsy

Eddie Durham & Edgar Battle (for Count Basie)



Written key **B–** Concert **A–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **165–200 bpm**

Written **1937**

Topsy · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- The riff (B minor pentatonic, two bars) is the head; the G7 F♯7 bars are the rhythm section's answer, so play the riff short and leave the even bars open.
- Bar 16: your pickup A♯ B C♯ into the bridge (over the B–) is on the score, and the bridge figure (♯7 – 1 – 2 of each dominant: A♯ B C♯, D♯ E F♯, G♯ A B, C♯ D E) is the bridge melody; play it in unison.
- Solos: B minor pentatonic and blues on the riff bars; F sliding to E on G7 → F♯7, A♯ on the F♯7; E minor pentatonic for the second A's E– bars (D♯ on the B7 in bar 10). Bridge: D♯, G♯, C♯, F♯ on the downbeats of B7, E7, A7, D7.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**B–**	D F♯	**G7**	B F	**F♯7**	A♯ E	**E–**	G B	**B7**	D♯ A	
B	**B7**	D♯ A	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G	**D7**	F♯ C	**G7**	B F	**F♯7**	A♯ E

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

B minor, with G7 F♯7 every other bar

B minor pentatonic and the B blues scale carry the riff bars. The G7 F♯7 bars are a ♭VI7 → V7 slide: F (the 7th of G7) sliding to E (7th of F♯7), and A♯ on the F♯7 (B harmonic minor). The second A's E– bars: E minor pentatonic, with D♯ on the B7 in bar 10.

B

Cycle of dominants: B7 → E7 → A7 → D7, then G7 F♯7

Two bars each, by their 3rds: D♯ (B7), G♯ (E7), C♯ (A7), F♯ (D7). It's the I Got Rhythm bridge moved up a 5th, so the same lines work. The horns' pickup figure (♯7 – 1 – 2 of each dominant) is the melody; quote it. Bar 24's G7 F♯7 is the slide home.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

The G7 F♯7 bars as plain F♯7 at fast tempos · the second A's E– bars as E–6 · bridge played as B7 | B7 | E7 | E7 | A7 | A7 | D7 | D7 with the G7 F♯7 moved into the pickup bar · last bar as B– when the tune ends.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · B minor pent B D E F♯ A

A · B blues scale B D E F F♯ A

2nd A · E minor pent E G A B D

B · B major pent (then E, A, D) B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯

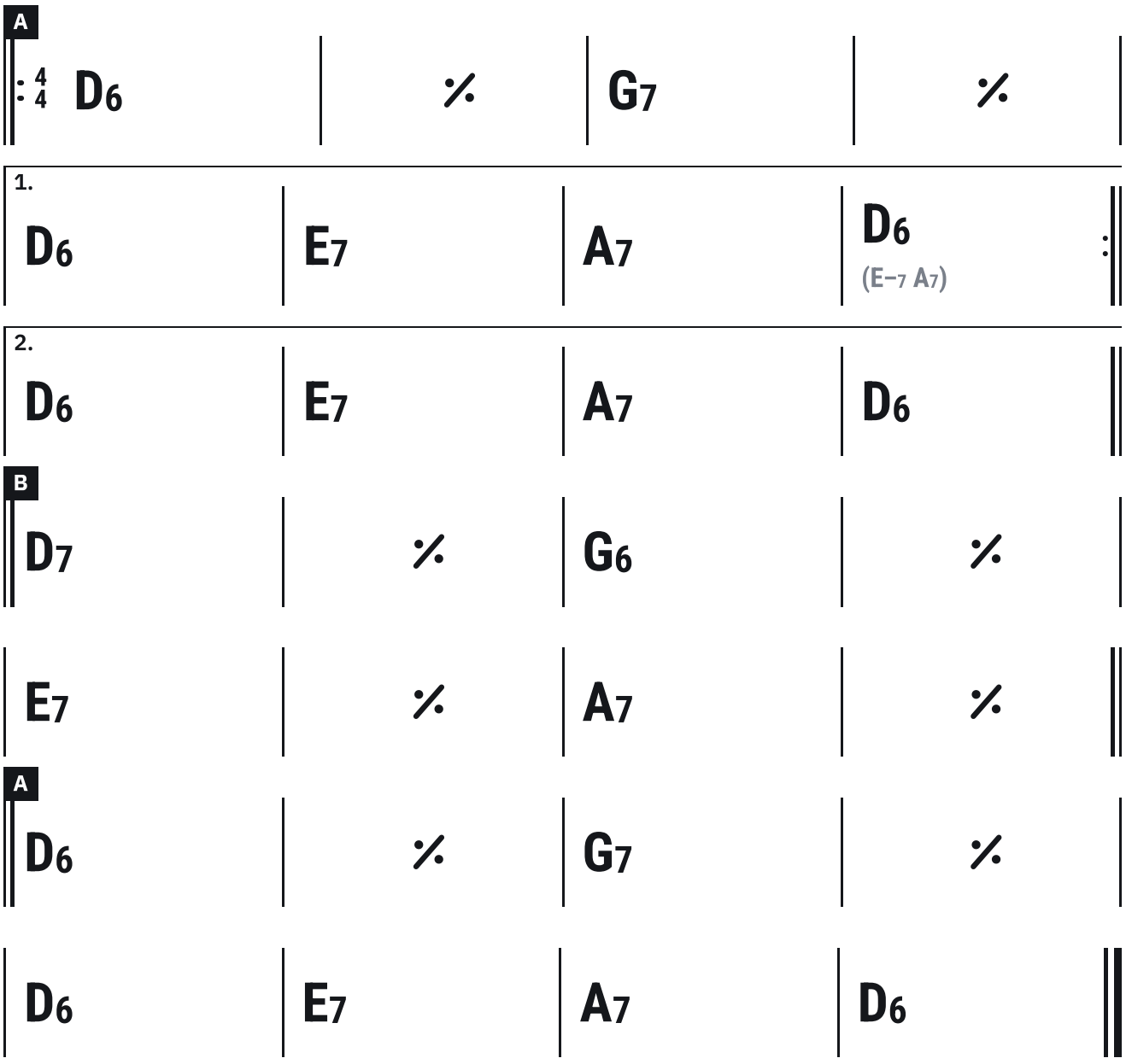
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

B–	B D F♯
G7	G B D F
F♯7	F♯ A♯ C♯ E
E–	E G B
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
E7	E G♯ B D
A7	A C♯ E G
D7	D F♯ A C

(Medium Up Swing)

Undecided

Charlie Shavers



Written key **D** Concert **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1938**

Undecided · Tenor Sax in B♭

HOW TO PLAY IT · Tenor Sax in B♭

- Call-and-response head: you state the phrase in bars 1 and 3, the rhythm section answers in bars 2 and 4; keep the phrase short and the gaps empty. Ella's 1939 version is the phrasing reference.
- Solos: D major pentatonic plus the D blues scale; F on the G7 bars (3–4) against the band, G♯ on E7 (bar 6), G on A7. Bridge: D7 (C) for two, G for two, E7 (G♯) for two, A7 home: the Sunny Side bridge, so solos transfer.
- The last A ends on D6 with no turnaround; hold the last note while the rhythm section stops.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard; written pitch

A	**D6**	F♯ B	**G7**	B F	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G
B	**D7**	F♯ C	**G6**	B E	**E7**	G♯ D	**A7**	C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D major with a blues IV

D major pentatonic plus the D blues scale; on the G7 bars play F (its ♭7) against the band. E7 wants G♯, A7 wants G; that's the whole A.

B

D7 → G → E7 → A7

D mixolydian (C) for two, G major for two, E7 (G♯ , D♯ for lydian colour) for two, A7 home. Same bridge as Sunny Side of the Street, so solos transfer.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–7 as E–7 | C7 B♭7 | A7 (the chromatic walk-down in the Ames Brothers / Kirby charts) · bar 8 turnaround optional · bridge bars 7–8 as A7 | B–7 E7 into the last A.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root, written pitch

A · D major pent D E F♯ A B

G7 bars · D blues scale D F G A♭ A C

B · G major pent G A B D E

B · E7: E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart, written pitch

D6	D F♯ A B
G7	G B D F
E7	E G♯ B D
A7	A C♯ E G
E–7	E G B D
D7	D F♯ A C
G6	G B D E

GUITAR

Concert pitch, with a Freddie Green three-note voicing for every chord (root, 7th or 6th, 3rd; four notes for ø7, °7 and 7♭5). Minor chords are voiced as minor sixths, altered dominants as plain 7ths, slash chords as the chord above the slash.

#	TUNE	KEY	FORM	DANCE TEMPO
01	**Ain't Misbehavin'**	**E♭**	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
02	**All of Me**	**F**	A B A C · 32	150–190 bpm
03	**All the Things You Are**	**A♭**	A A′ B A″ · 36	150–190 bpm
04	**Autumn Leaves**	**C–**	A A B C · 32	100–180 bpm
05	**Battle of Jericho**	**F–**	AABA · 32	150–200 bpm
06	**Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen**	**C–**	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
07	**Blue Drag**	**D–**	AABA · 32	90–120 bpm
08	**Blue Moon**	**E♭**	AABA · 32	110–180 bpm
09	**Blue Skies**	**C– → E♭**	AABA · 32	150–190 bpm
10	**Comes Love**	**A–**	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
11	**Don't Get Around Much Anymore**	**C**	AABA · 32	130–180 bpm
12	**Honeysuckle Rose**	**F**	AABA · 32	150–190 bpm
13	**I Got Rhythm**	**B♭**	AABA · 32	200–240 bpm
14	**It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing)**	**G– → B♭**	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm
15	**Jumpin' at the Woodside**	**B♭**	AABA · 32	200–250 bpm
16	**Just Friends**	**G**	A B A B′ · 32	170–220 bpm
17	**Kansas City Stride**	**G–**	AABA · 32 + 8-bar intro	170–210 bpm
18	**Lester's Bounce**	**G–**	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
19	**Lullaby of Birdland**	**F– / A♭**	AABA · 32	150–200 bpm
20	**Moanin'**	**F–**	AABA · 32	100–125 bpm
21	**Oh, Lady Be Good**	**G**	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
22	**On the Sunny Side of the Street**	**C**	AABA · 32	110–140 bpm
23	**Perdido**	**B♭**	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm
24	**Puttin' On the Ritz**	**F– → A♭**	AABA · 32	200–240 bpm
25	**Ridin' and Jivin'**	**F–**	AABA · 32	150 bpm
26	**Satin Doll**	**C**	AABA · 32	130–160 bpm
27	**A Smooth One**	**F**	AABA · 32	120 bpm
28	**Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise**	**B♭–**	AABA · 32	160–190 bpm
29	**Stompin' at the Savoy**	**D♭**	AABA · 32	190–220 bpm
30	**Take the “A” Train**	**C**	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
31	**Topsy**	**A–**	AABA · 32	165–200 bpm
32	**Undecided**	**C**	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm

(Medium Swing)

Ain't Misbehavin'

Fats Waller, Harry Brooks & Andy Razaf



Key **E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written **1929**

Ain't Misbehavin' · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Four to the bar, Freddie Green style; let the top voice move E♭ → E → F on the first three chords (E♭6, E°7, F–7) so the comping has a line.
- Two chords a bar means two shapes a bar, both on the low strings, minimum motion: A♭6 to A♭–6 is one finger, C to C♭.
- On the turnaround bars (G7 C7 | F7 B♭7) either walk the bass string chromatically with the bassist or stay out of the way; never both.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **E♭6** G C **E°7** G D♭ **F–7** A♭ E♭ **B♭7** D A♭ **E♭7** G D♭ **A♭6** C F **A♭–6** B F **C7** E B♭ **G7** B F **F7** A E♭

B **C–** E♭ G **A♭7** C G♭ **F7** A E♭ **C7** E B♭ **C–7** E♭ B♭ **B♭7** D A♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A **E♭ major, with Waller's colours**

E♭ major pentatonic as home. The colours, one per chord: E°7 → E, E♭7 → D♭ (into A♭), A♭–6 → C♭, C7 → E, G7 → B, F7 → A. The turnaround is four dominants; hit their 3rds on the downbeats.

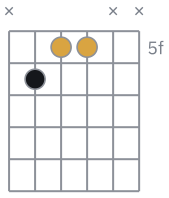
B **C minor, then dominants home**

C minor pentatonic for bars 1–2 (A♭7 adds G♭). F7 (A, E♭) for two, C7 (E) for two is the surprise, then F7 and B♭7 (D) pull you back to E♭.

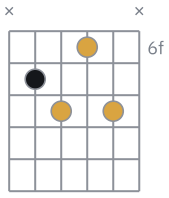
VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 1 as E♭6 C7/E · bar 2 as F–7 F♯°7 · bar 3 as E♭6 G7 · first-A bar 7 as E♭6 C7 · bridge bars 5–6 as B♭6 | F7 in some charts.

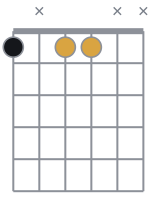
EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



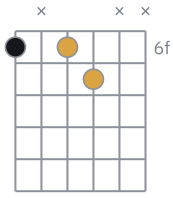
E♭6
E♭ G B♭ C



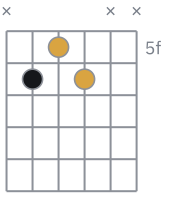
E°7
E G B♭ D♭



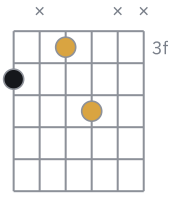
F–7
F A♭ C E♭



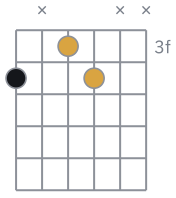
B♭7
B♭ D F A♭



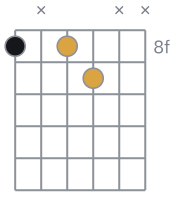
E♭7
E♭ G B♭ D♭



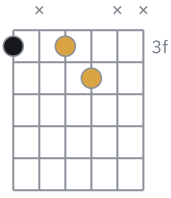
A♭6
A♭ C E♭ F



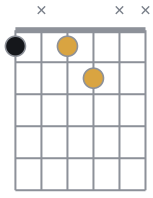
A♭–6
A♭ B E♭ F



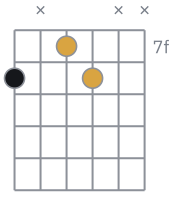
C7
C E G B♭



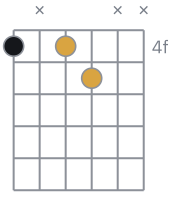
G7
G B D F



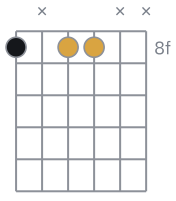
F7
F A C E♭



C–
C E♭ G



A♭7
A♭ C E♭ G♭



C–7
C E♭ G B♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

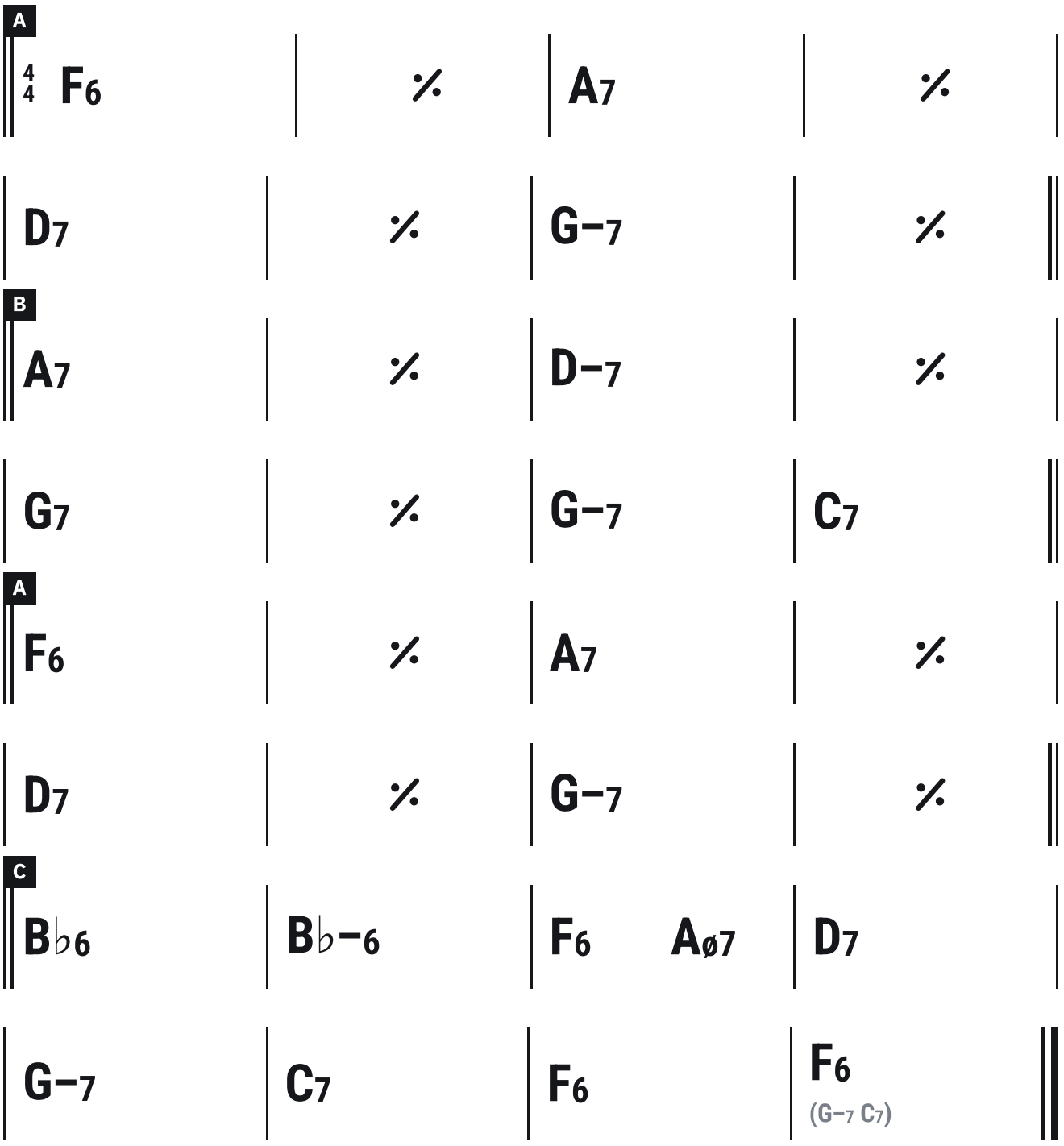
A · E♭ blues scale E♭ G♭ A♭ A B♭ D♭

B bars 1–2 · C minor pent C E♭ F G B♭

(Medium Swing)

All of Me

Gerald Marks & Seymour Simons



Key **F** Form **A B A C · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1931**

All of Me · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Four to the bar, with the top voice stepping C♯ (A7) → F♯ (D7) → F (G–7): the 3rds tell the story.
- The opening and closing bars are F6: 6th-string F6 shape, and plain 7 shapes for A7 and D7.
- On B♭6 → B♭–6 in the C section move one finger, D to D♭, and let it ring: that is the tune.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	F6	A D	A7	C♯ G	D7	F♯ C	G–7	B♭ F							
B	A7	C♯ G	D–7	F C	G7	B F	G–7	B♭ F	C7	E B♭					
C	B♭6	D G	B♭–6	D♭ G	F6	A D	Aø7	C E♭ G	D7	F♯ C	G–7	B♭ F	C7	E B♭	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F major with two sharps bent in

F major pentatonic; A7 wants C♯ (the first surprise of the tune), D7 wants F♯, G–7 is F major again. Two bars per chord, so one idea per chord is enough.

B

A7 → D–, then G7 → G–7 C7

A7 (C♯) into D minor pentatonic for two bars; G7 (B natural) for two; G–7 C7 back to F.

C

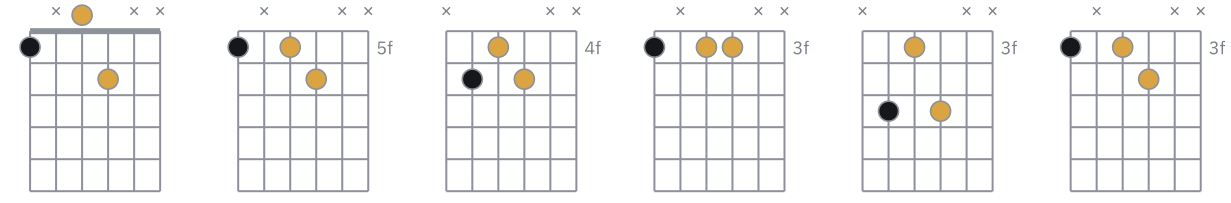
IV, iv, home

B♭ major pentatonic, then B♭ minor pentatonic over B♭–6 (D♭ is the tender note); Aø7 D7 (E♭, F♯) into G–7 C7 F6.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 3–4 of the A as A7 | A7♭9 · C bars 3–4 as F6 | D7 (no Aø7) in older charts · the Real Book's key is C: everything a fourth down.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



F6 F A C D

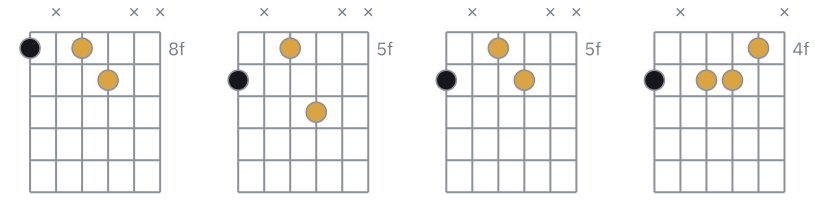
A7 A C♯ E G

D7 D F♯ A C

G–7 G B♭ D F

D–7 D F A C

G7 G B D F



C7 C E G B♭

B♭6 B♭ D F G

B♭–6 B♭ D♭ F G

Aø7 A C E♭ G

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · F major pent F G A C D

B · D minor pent (A7 → D–) D F G A C

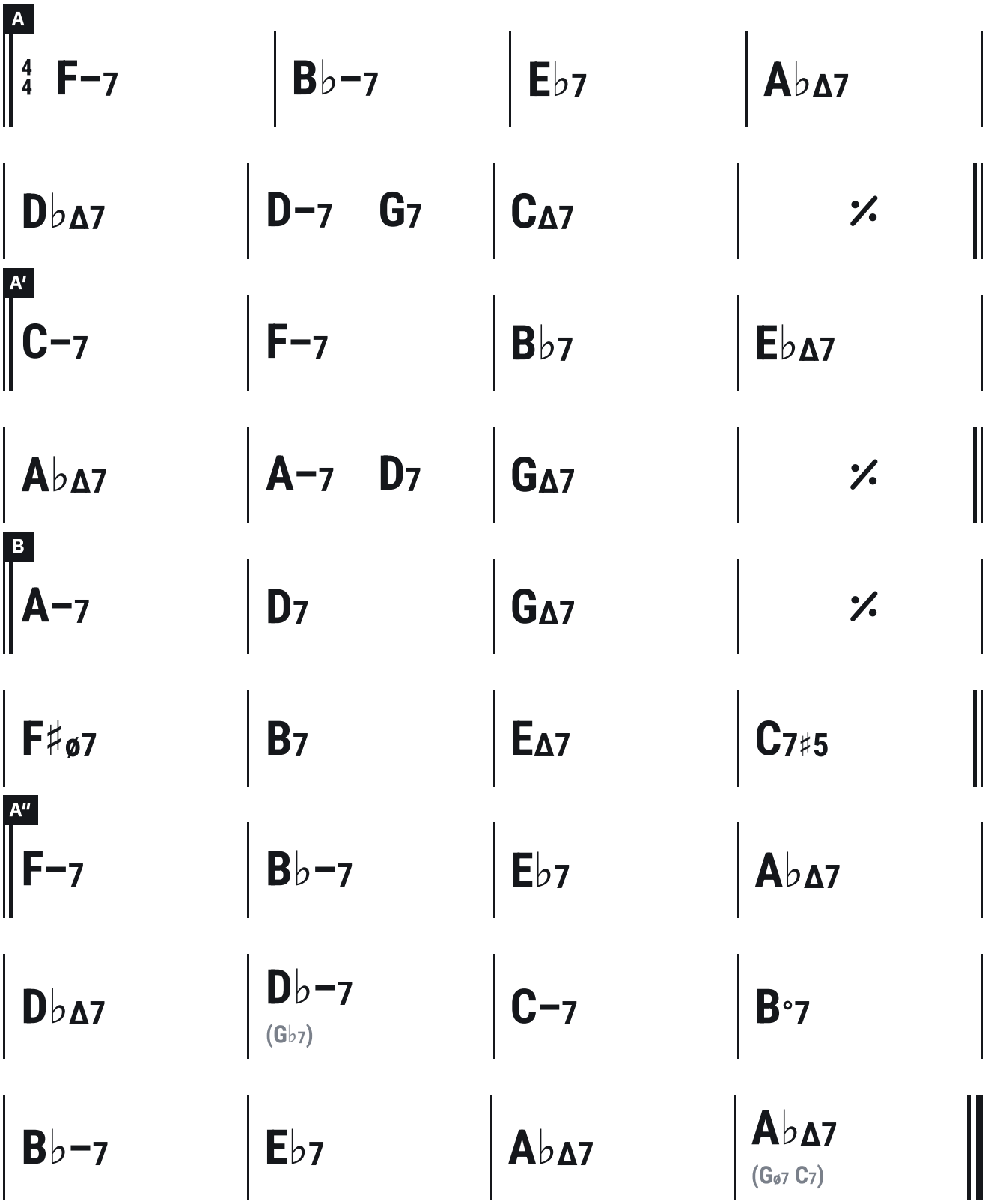
C · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

C · B♭ minor pent (B♭–6) B♭ D♭ E♭ F A♭

(Medium Swing)

All the Things You Are

Jerome Kern & Oscar Hammerstein II



Key **A♭** Form **A A′ B A″ · 36** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1939**

All the Things You Are · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Four to the bar with ii–V shells; move the top voice down by half steps through each ii–V–I.
- Comp lightly on the bridge (A–7 D7 GΔ7, F♯ø7 B7 EΔ7): two sharp keys in a row, so plan the shapes before the gig.
- The walk-down in bars 29–32 (D♭ – D♭ – C – B in the bass) belongs to the bassist: play half notes there.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	F–7	A♭ E♭	B♭–7	D♭ A♭	E♭7	G D♭	A♭Δ7	C G	D♭Δ7	F C	D–7	F C	G7	B F	CΔ7	E B			
A′	C–7	E♭ B♭	F–7	A♭ E♭	B♭7	D A♭	E♭Δ7	G D	A♭Δ7	C G	A–7	C G	D7	F♯ C	GΔ7	B F♯			
B	A–7	C G	D7	F♯ C	GΔ7	B F♯	F♯ø7	A C E	B7	D♯ A	EΔ7	G♯ D♯	C7♯5	E G♯ B♭					
A″	F–7	A♭ E♭	B♭–7	D♭ A♭	E♭7	G D♭	A♭Δ7	C G	D♭Δ7	F C	D♭–7	E B	C–7	E♭ B♭	B°7	D A♭			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A — **vi–ii–V–I–IV in A♭, then a side-step to C**

F–7 B♭–7 E♭7 A♭Δ7 D♭Δ7 is one scale: A♭ major, heard as a circle of fourths. Then D–7 G7 CΔ7: the money notes are B and E. The melody's first note on each chord is its 3rd or 7th; sing the melody and you're playing guide tones.

A′ — **The same thing a fourth lower: E♭, then G**

C–7 F–7 B♭7 E♭Δ7 A♭Δ7 = E♭ major. Then A–7 D7 GΔ7: F♯ and B.

B — **G major, then E major, then the door back**

A–7 D7 GΔ7 for four bars (G major). F♯ø7 B7 EΔ7: E major, so G♯ D♯ C♯. C7♯5 in the last bar is the hinge: E natural and G♯ (= A♭) pull you back to F–.

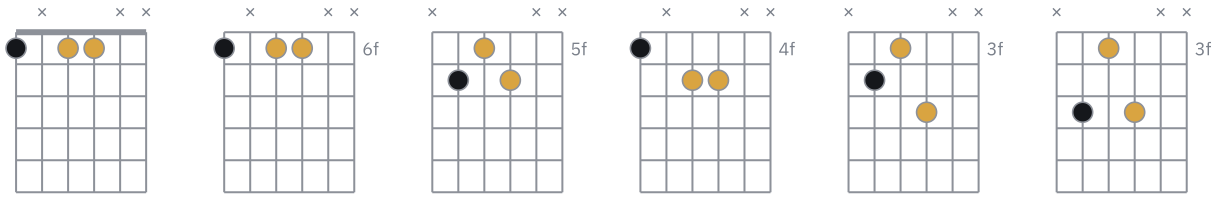
A″ — **A♭ again, with the chromatic walk-down**

As the first A through D♭Δ7, then D♭–7 (F♭ /E, C♭ /B), C–7, B°7 (D , F, A♭) into B♭–7 E♭7 A♭Δ7. Think of bars 29–32 as a bass line and play across it; it's four bars of one gesture.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 30 as D♭–7 alone or as G♭7 · bar 24 as C7♭9 or C7alt · last bar's Gø7 C7 is the turnaround into the next chorus, dropped on the out chorus.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



F–7 — F A♭ C E♭

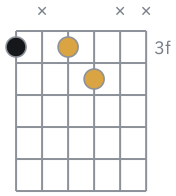
B♭–7 — B♭ D♭ F A♭

E♭7 — E♭ G B♭ D♭

A♭Δ7 — A♭ C E♭ G

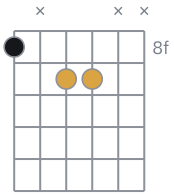
D♭Δ7 — D♭ F A♭ C

D–7 — D F A C



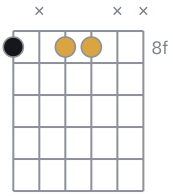
G7

G B D F



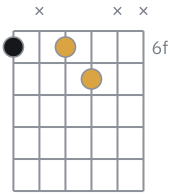
CΔ7

C E G B



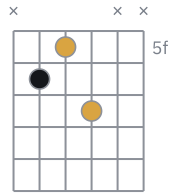
C−7

C E♭ G B♭



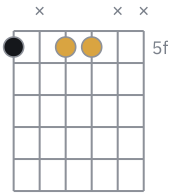
B♭7

B♭ D F A♭



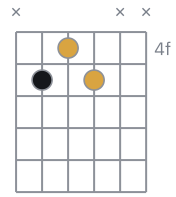
E♭Δ7

E♭ G B♭ D



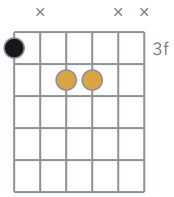
A−7

A C E G



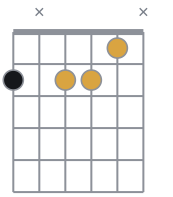
D7

D F♯ A C



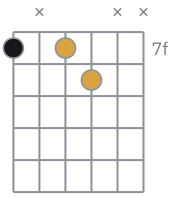
GΔ7

G B D F♯



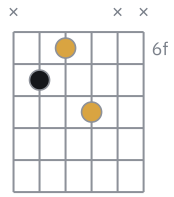
F♯ø7

F♯ A C E



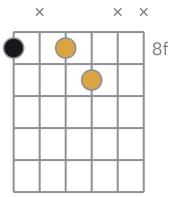
B7

B D♯ F♯ A



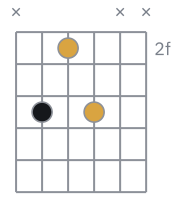
EΔ7

E G♯ B D♯



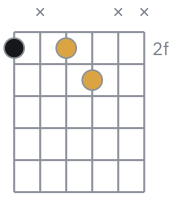
C7♯5

C E G♯ B♭



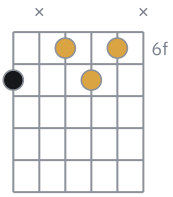
D♭−7

D♭ E A♭ B



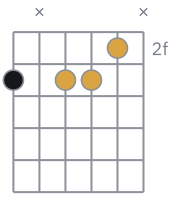
G♭7

G♭ B♭ D♭ E



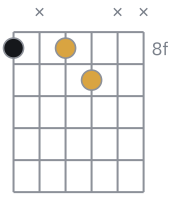
B°7

B D F A♭



Gø7

G B♭ D♭ F



C7

C E G B♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

Bars 1–5 · A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

Bars 6–8 · C major pent C D E G A

Bars 9–13 · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

Bars 14–20 · G major pent G A B D E

Bars 21–23 · E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

(Medium Swing)

Autumn Leaves (Les feuilles mortes)

Joseph Kosma (Prévert / Mercer)

A

4/4 F–7	B♭7	E♭Δ7	A♭Δ7
Dø7	G7	C–	𝄎

A

F–7	B♭7	E♭Δ7	A♭Δ7
Dø7	G7	C–	𝄎

B

Dø7	G7	C–	𝄎
F–7	B♭7	E♭Δ7	A♭Δ7

C

Dø7	G7	C–7 F7	B♭–7 E♭7
A♭Δ7	Dø7 G7	C–	C– (Dø7 G7)

Key **C–** Form **A A B C · 32** Feel **Lindy / ballad** Dance tempo **100–180 bpm** Written **1945**

Autumn Leaves · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Four to the bar; ii–V shells with the 7th on top falling to the 3rd of the next chord (A♭ on B♭7 → G on E♭Δ7).
- G7 on the minor turns as G7♭9 (A♭ on top); C–6 rather than C–7 for the home chord in a swing feel.
- If there's a rubato verse, comp it in free time with the piano laying out, then set the two-feel in bar 1 of the A.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	F–7	A♭ E♭	B♭7	D A♭	E♭Δ7	G D	A♭Δ7	C G	Dø7	F A♭ C	G7	B F	C–	E♭ G					
B	Dø7	F A♭ C	G7	B F	C–	E♭ G	F–7	A♭ E♭	B♭7	D A♭	E♭Δ7	G D	A♭Δ7	C G					
C	Dø7	F A♭ C	G7	B F	C–7	E♭ B♭	F7	A E♭	B♭–7	D♭ A♭	E♭7	G D♭	A♭Δ7	C G	C–	E♭ G			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A — **E♭ major for four bars, C minor for four**

F–7 B♭7 E♭Δ7 A♭Δ7 is one scale: E♭ major (A♭ major pentatonic also fits all four). Then Dø7 G7 C–: C harmonic minor on the G7 (B natural, A♭) and C minor pentatonic home.

B — **The A section reversed**

Minor half first (Dø7 G7 C–), major half second (F–7 B♭7 E♭ A♭). Same notes, opposite order; the trap is starting the bridge in E♭ major out of habit.

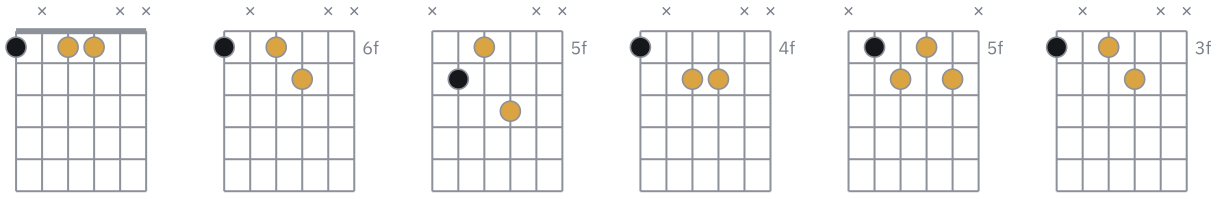
C — **Two backdoor ii–Vs sliding down, then home**

C–7 F7 → B♭–7 E♭7 → A♭Δ7: C dorian, F mixolydian (A), B♭ dorian, E♭ mixolydian (G), A♭ major. Then Dø7 G7 C– to close. Think of bars 3–5 as one gesture descending by whole steps.

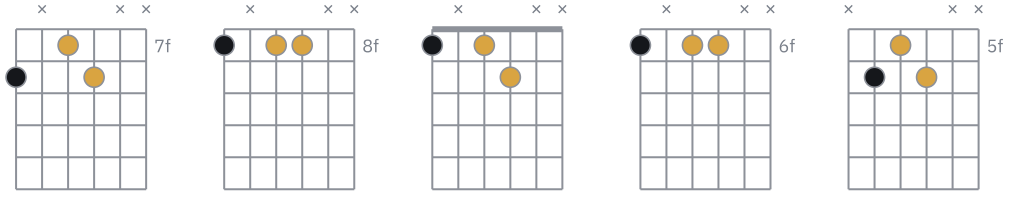
VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 8 of each A as C–7 or C–6 · C bars 3–4 as C–7 F7 | F–7 B♭7 (a plain ii–V to E♭) · keys: G– (Real Book), E– (original), C– (here).

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



F–7 F A♭ C E♭ · **B♭7** B♭ D F A♭ · **E♭Δ7** E♭ G B♭ D · **A♭Δ7** A♭ C E♭ G · **Dø7** D F A♭ C · **G7** G B D F



C– C E♭ G · **C–7** C E♭ G B♭ · **F7** F A C E♭ · **B♭–7** B♭ D♭ F A♭ · **E♭7** E♭ G B♭ D♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A bars 1–4, B bars 5–8 · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

A bars 5–8 · C minor pent C E♭ F G B♭

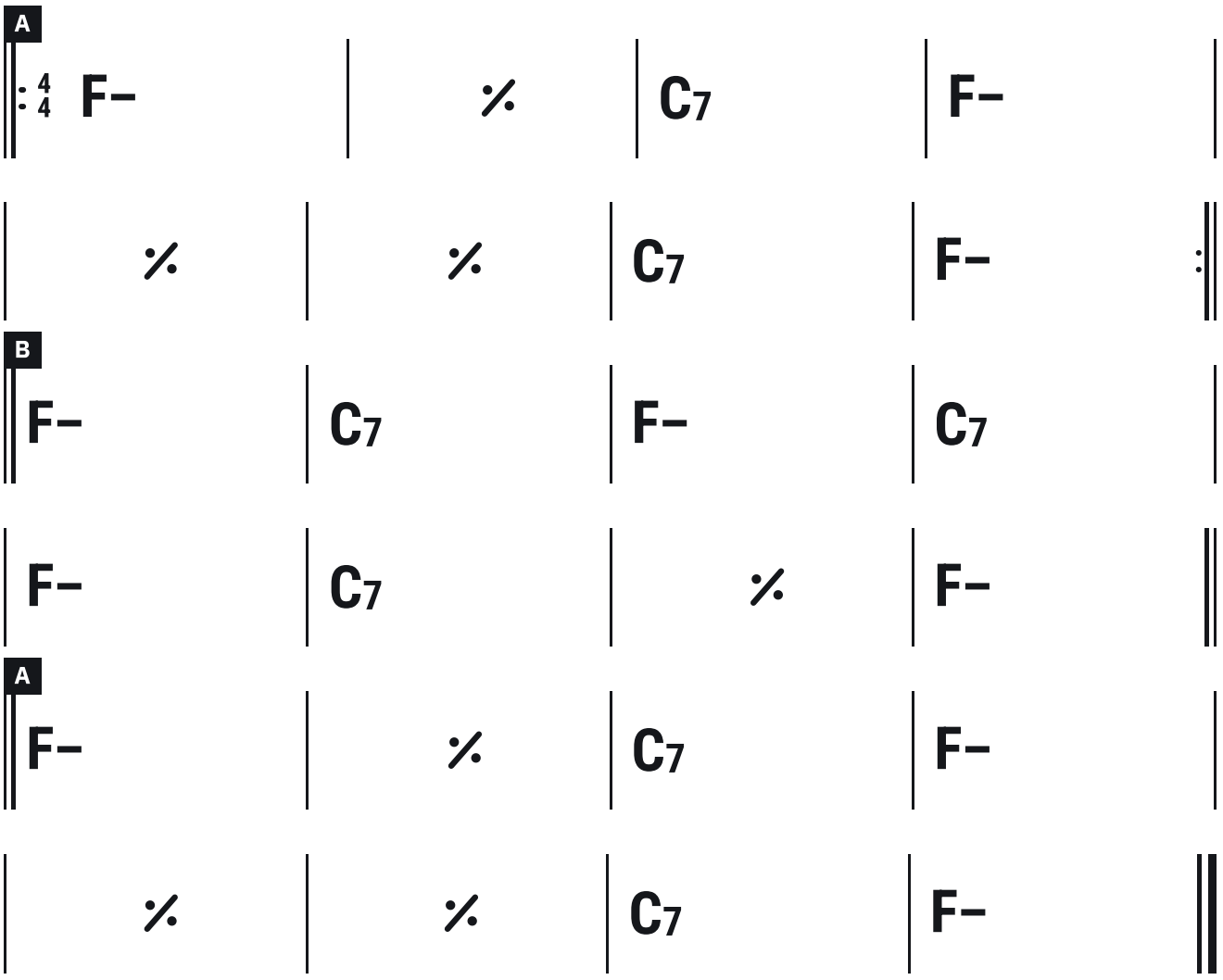
over G7 · C harmonic minor C D E♭ F G A♭ B

C bars 3–5 · A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

(Medium Swing)

Battle of Jericho (Joshua Fit the Battle)

Traditional spiritual, your band's arrangement



Key **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–200 bpm** Written **trad.**

Battle of Jericho · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Four to the bar on F–6 and C7; it's a two-chord tune, so the rhythm is the content: accent 2 and 4 harder as each A builds.
- Drop out on the bridge with the piano if the arrangement goes to bass and drums; come back for the last A at full volume.
- C7♭9 (the 7 shape with D♭ on top) for the darker gospel colour.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**F–**	A♭ C	**C7**	E B♭
B	**F–**	A♭ C	**C7**	E B♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F minor, one scale

F minor pentatonic and the F blues scale cover the whole A. On C7 play **E** natural (F harmonic minor) if you want the chord change to be heard at all; **A♭** is home.

B

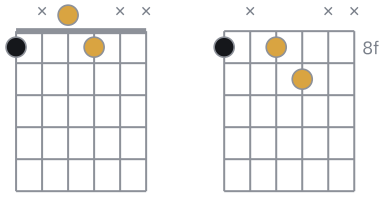
The same, with twice the C7

Bars 6–7 are two bars of C7: sit on **E** and **B♭**, or do the Bechet thing and play the melody's rhythm on one note until the F– comes back.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

B♭– (iv) in bar 3 of the A if the band wants a third chord · C7♭9 throughout · some bands play the B as F– | F– | C7 | C7 twice.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



F–
F A♭ C

C7
C E G B♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A, B · F minor pent F A♭ B♭ C E♭

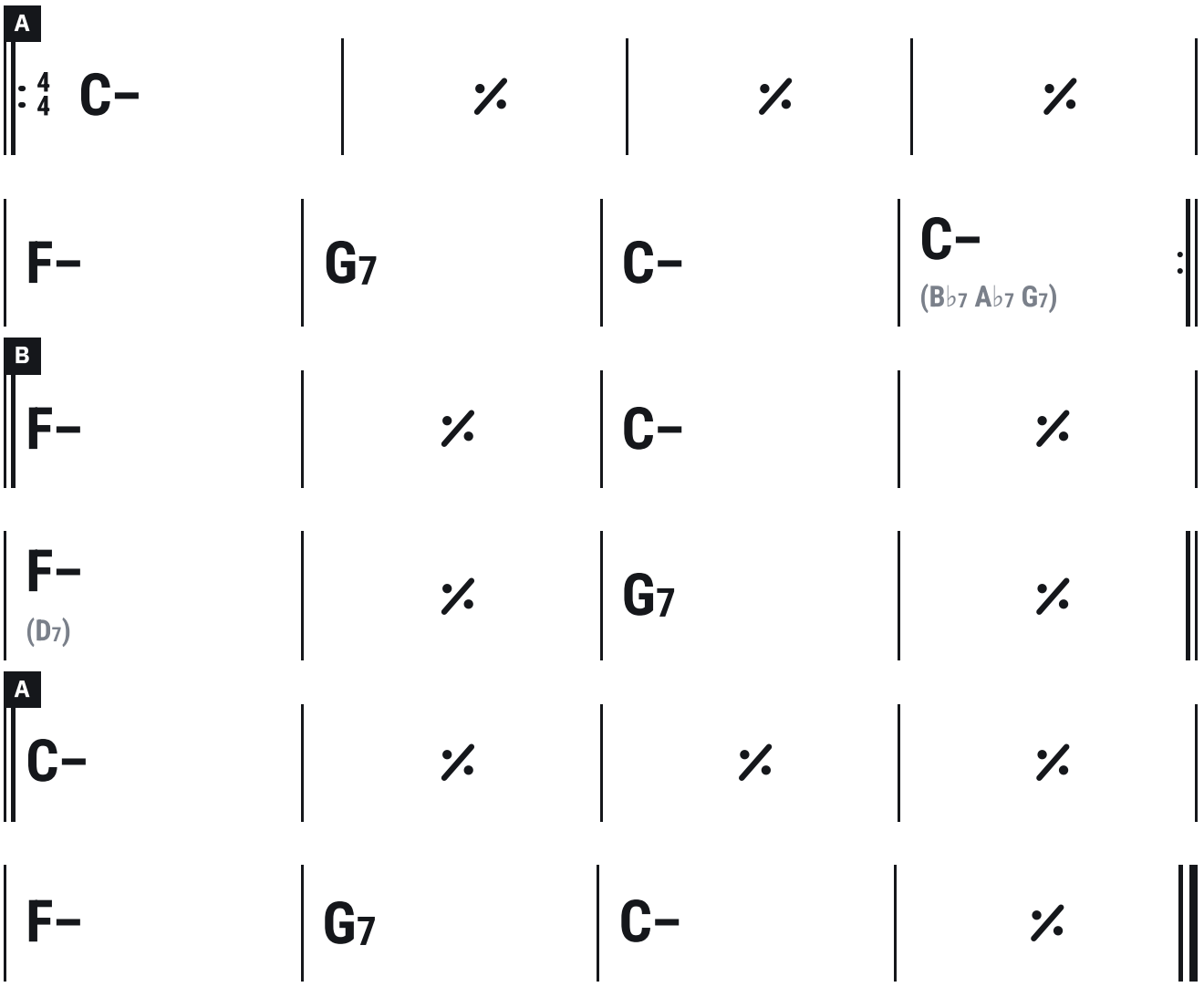
A, B · F blues scale F A♭ B♭ B C E♭

over C7 · F harmonic minor F G A♭ B♭ C D♭ E

(Medium Swing)

Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen

Sholom Secunda



Key **C–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1932**

Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Four to the bar on C–6 for bars 1–4 (the bass walks under you); F–6 and G7 in bars 5–6; back to C–6.
- The Charleston figure (hit on 1, hit on the 'and' of 2) with the piano is the Hot Sugar Band groove; alternate it with straight four between choruses.
- Bridge: F–6 for two bars, C–6 for two, twice; D7 in bars 5–6 if the band plays the II7–V7 version.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**C–**	E♭ G	**F–**	A♭ C	**G7**	B F
B	**F–**	A♭ C	**C–**	E♭ G	**G7**	B F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C minor blues language

The C minor blues scale works over the entire A; this is a minor blues tune. F–: F dorian (A♭ major). G7: C harmonic minor, B natural against A♭. The turnaround B♭7 – A♭7 – G7 is chromatic dominants: target the 3rds D C B.

B

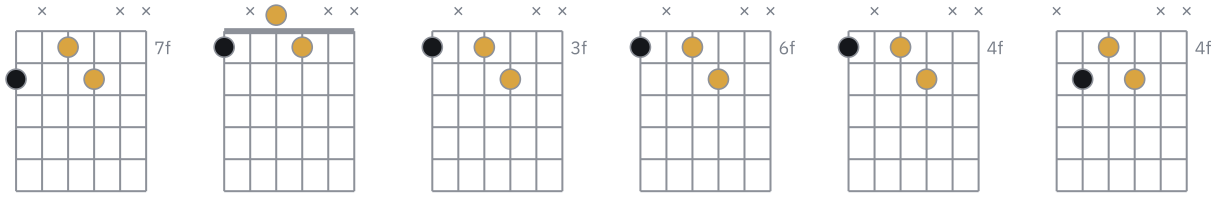
iv → i, twice, opening into V

F– (F dorian, A♭ major pentatonic) to C–, then the second half can go II7–V7: D7 (F♯) into G7 (B). The bridge is where the tune briefly feels major; play pretty there and save the blues for the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 as G7 | G7 · bridge bars 5–6 as D7 | D7 (II7–V7) · turnaround optional at speed.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



C–	F–	G7	B♭7	A♭7	D7
C E♭ G	F A♭ C	G B D F	B♭ D F A♭	A♭ C E♭ G♭	D F♯ A C

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · C minor pent C E♭ F G B♭

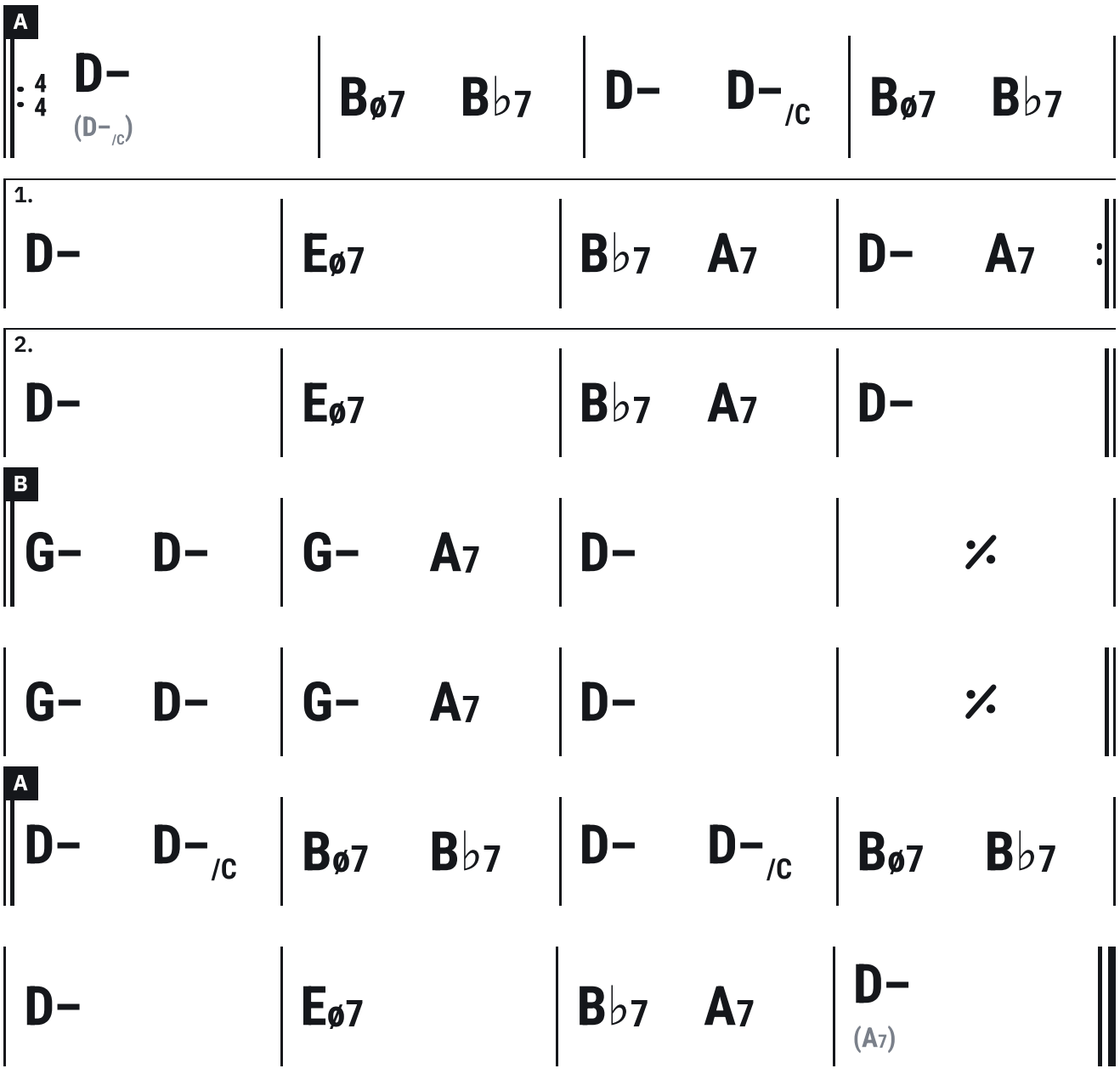
A · C blues scale C E♭ F G♭ G B♭

B · F minor pent F A♭ B♭ C E♭

(Slow Swing)

Blue Drag

Josef Myrow (your Pataswing chart)



Key **D–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Slow lindy / blues** Dance tempo **90–120 bpm** Written **1932**

Blue Drag · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- La pompe or four to the bar, but at 90: heavy on 2 and 4, let the bass drag; this is a gypsy-swing tune.
- D–6 for the home chord; Bø7 → B♭7 → A7 are three shapes a fret apart, so the whole A sits in one position.
- Bridge (G– D– | G– A7): two chords a bar, half-note strums; leave the last two bars of the bridge open for the pickup.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **D–** F A **Bø7** D F A **B♭7** D A♭ **D–/C** F A **E♭7** G B♭ D **A7** C♯ G

B **G–** B♭ D **D–** F A **A7** C♯ G

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D minor, with a ♭VI–V slide

D minor pentatonic and blues scale at home. Bø7 B♭7: F then A♭ (B♭7's ♭7), the chord that gives the tune its drag. E♭7: B♭. B♭7 A7 at the end is the half-step slide: A♭ on the B♭7, then land C♯ on the A7.

B

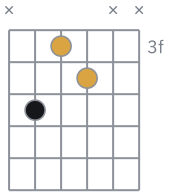
iv and i, with A7 every second bar

G minor pentatonic over the G– beats, D minor pentatonic over D–; the A7s want C♯. Leave space: the bridge melody is mostly rests.

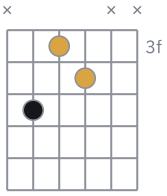
VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 6 as A7 or A9 (Django's rhythm section) · bar 2 as B°7 B♭7 · bridge G– as C♯°7 in some gypsy charts.

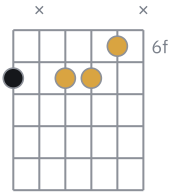
EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



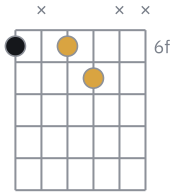
D–
D F A



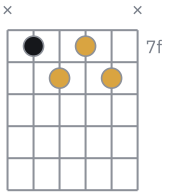
D–/C
D F A



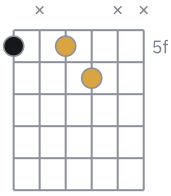
Bø7
B D F A



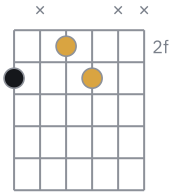
B♭7
B♭ D F A♭



E♭7
E G B♭ D



A7
A C♯ E G



G–
G B♭ D

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · D minor pent D F G A C

A · D blues scale D F G A♭ A C

B · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

(Medium Swing)

Blue Moon

Richard Rodgers & Lorenz Hart



Key **E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / blues** Dance tempo **110–180 bpm** Written **1934**

Blue Moon · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Two chords a bar means half-note strums: E♭6 C–7 | F–7 B♭7, all on the low strings; four to the bar if the band plays it as a Lindy tune.
- Bridge bars 5–6 are the loop shapes moved up a minor third (A♭–7 D♭7 | G♭6); bar 7 F7 or F–7 as the band plays it.
- At 110 strum light triplets on 2 and 4, blues-dance style.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **E♭6** G C **C–7** E♭ B♭ **F–7** A♭ E♭ **B♭7** D A♭

B **F–7** A♭ E♭ **B♭7** D A♭ **E♭6** G C **A♭–7** B G♭ **D♭7** F B **G♭6** B♭ E♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

One loop, E♭ major

E♭ major pentatonic over the whole loop; C minor pentatonic is the same five notes, so the vi chord costs nothing. Land **D** (3rd of B♭7) on the second half of every even bar and the loop sings.

B

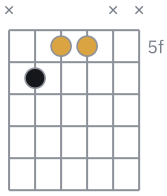
E♭, then G♭ for two bars, then home

E♭ major for bars 1–4. Bars 5–6: G♭ major pentatonic (= E♭ minor pentatonic): **C♭** and **G♭** are the slip. Bar 7: F7 wants **A** natural (F–7 wants A♭); bar 8 B♭7: **D**.

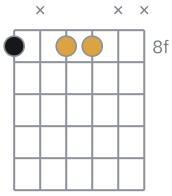
VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bars 7–8 as E♭6 | E♭6 with no turnaround · bridge bar 7 as F7 (the sheet) or F–7 (sessions) · bar 6 of the bridge as G♭Δ7.

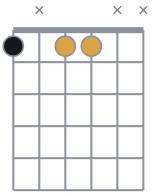
EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



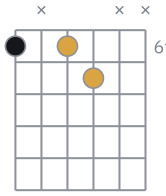
E♭6
E♭ G B♭ C



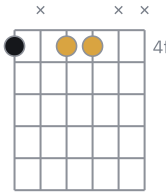
C–7
C E♭ G B♭



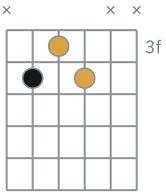
F–7
F A♭ C E♭



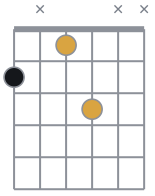
B♭7
B♭ D F A♭



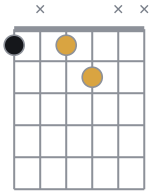
A♭–7
A♭ B E♭ G♭



D♭7
D♭ F A♭ B



G♭6
G♭ B♭ D♭ E♭



F7
F A C E♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A, B · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

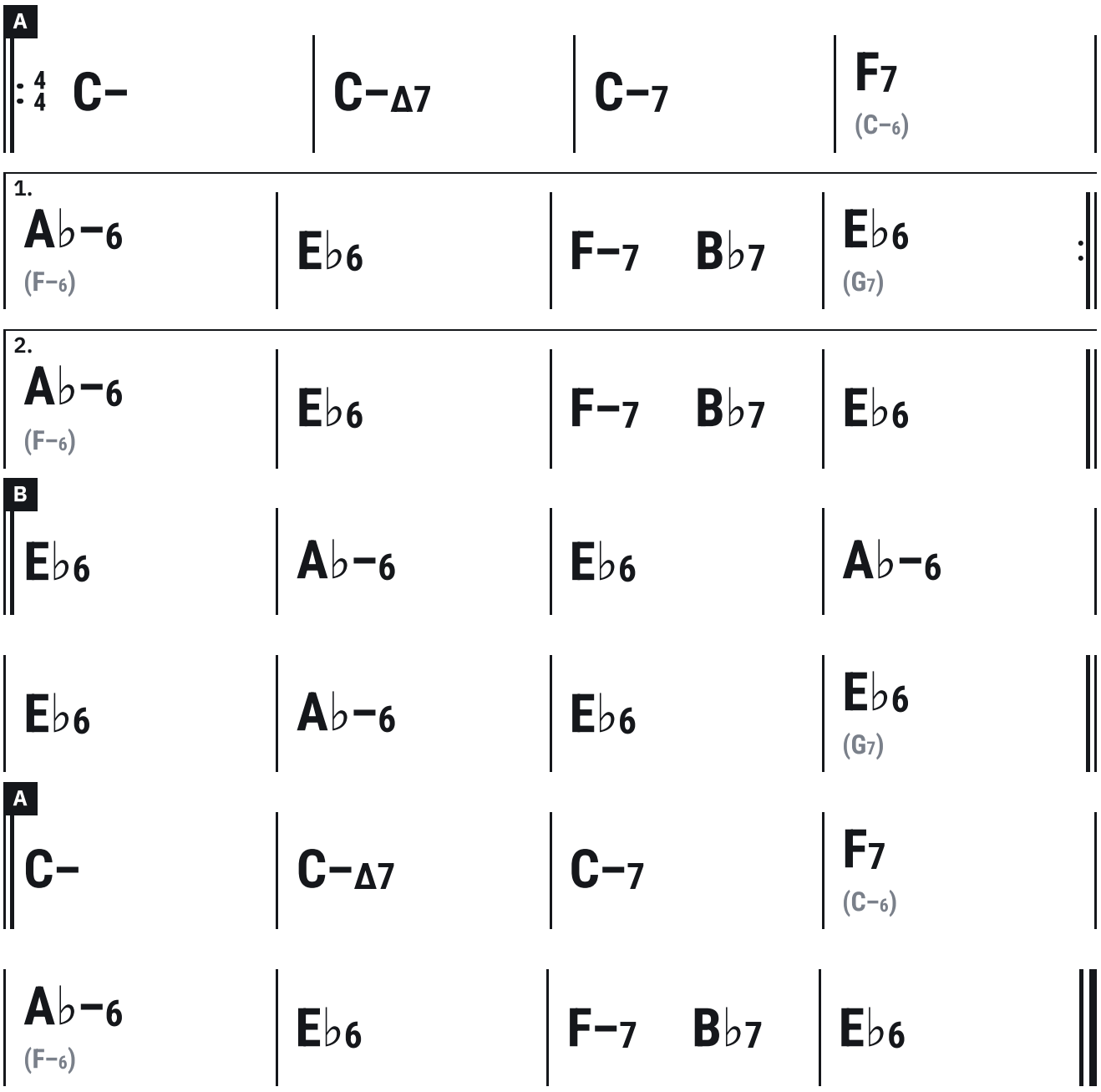
B bars 5–6 · G♭ major pent G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭ E♭

same notes as E♭ minor pent E♭ G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭

(Medium Up Swing)

Blue Skies

Irving Berlin



Key **C– → E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1926**

Blue Skies · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Bars 1–4: C–, C–Δ7, C–7, C–6 (the inner voice C B B♭ A), or hold C–6 and let the piano have the cliché.
- A♭–6 (6th-string shape, 4th fret) against E♭6 (5th-string shape, 6th fret): practise the switch, the bridge is nothing else.
- Four to the bar; the 1938 Goodman/Henderson version is the Lindy reference.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**C–**	E♭ G	**C–7**	E♭ B♭	**F7**	A E♭	**A♭–6**	B F	**E♭6**	G C	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**B♭7**	D A♭
B	**E♭6**	G C	**A♭–6**	B F											

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C minor that is really vi of E♭

Play the cliché itself: C B B♭ A, one per bar, and build phrases around it. C dorian and C minor pentatonic over the C– bars, A natural on the F7. Bar 5, A♭–6: the colour is C♭ and F (E♭ minor pentatonic works). Bars 6–8: E♭ major home, E♭ blues scale welcome.

B

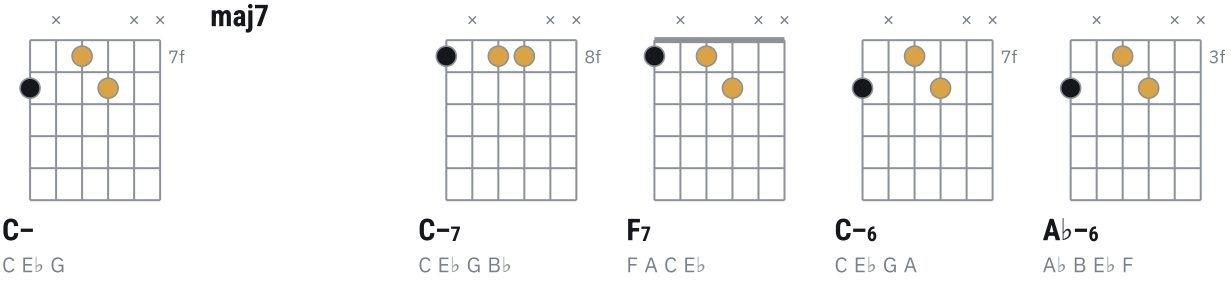
I ⇔ iv in E♭: E♭ against A♭–6

E♭ major on the E♭ bars, E♭ minor pentatonic on the A♭–6 bars (A♭ C♭ E♭ F): the C♭ and G♭ are the tension. Pedal a B♭ in the left hand under the whole bridge and let the two chords rub.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bars 1–4 as the descending-bass original: C– | G7/B | E♭/B♭ | F7/A · bar 5 as F–6 or A♭7 · bridge iv as plain A♭6 in older charts · the iReal version ends the bridge Bø7 E7♭9 (in C), i.e. Dø7 G7♭9 here.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



C– C E♭ G

C–7 C E♭ G B♭

F7 F A C E♭

C–6 C E♭ G A

A♭–6 A♭ B E♭ F

F–6 F A♭ C D

E♭6 E♭ G B♭ C

F–7 F A♭ C E♭

B♭7 B♭ D F A♭

G7 G B D F

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A bars 1–5 · C minor pent C E♭ F G B♭
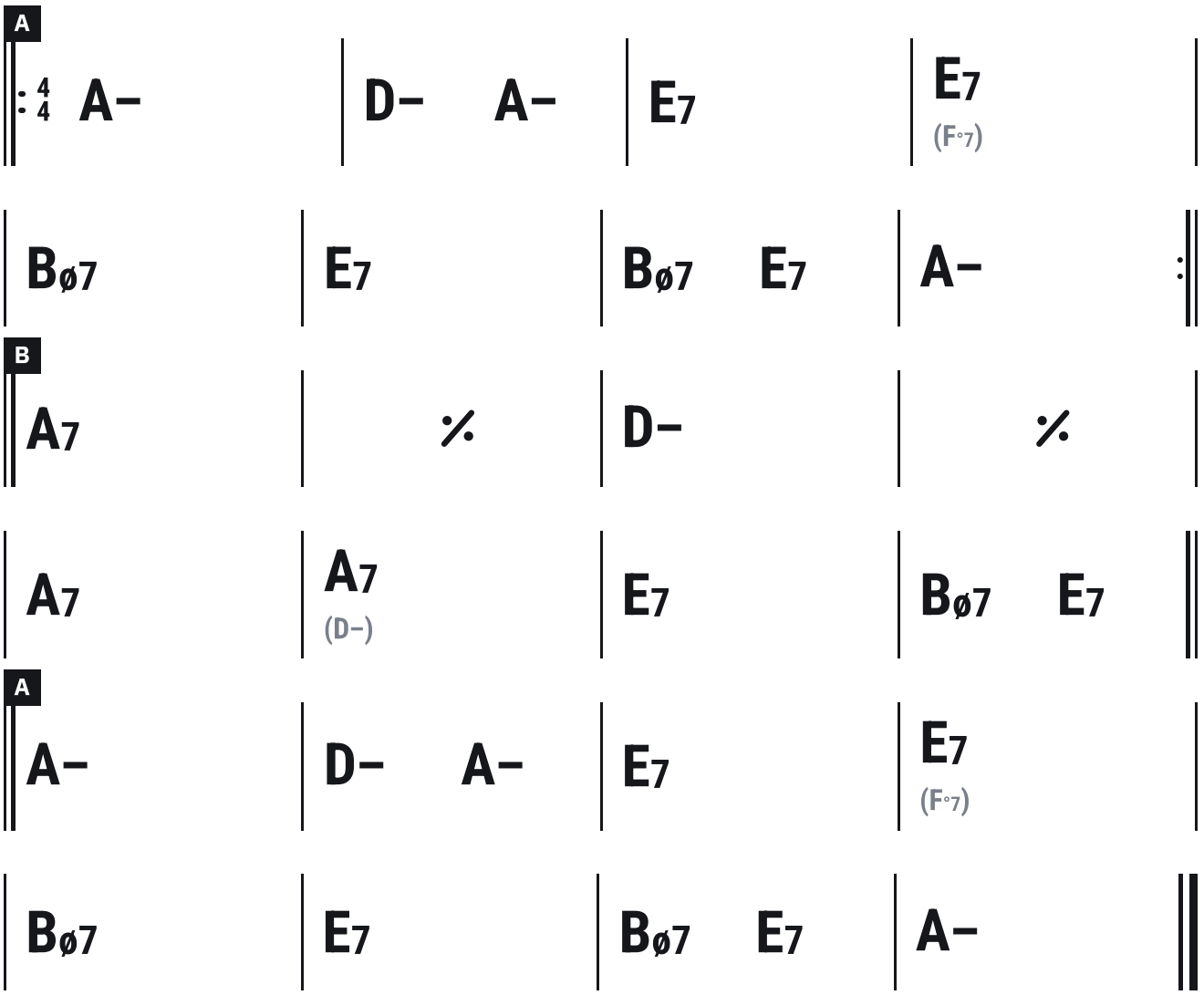
A bars 6–8, B · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

A♭–6 bars · E♭ minor pent E♭ G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭

(Medium Swing)

Comes Love

Sam H. Stept (Lew Brown & Charles Tobias)



Key **A–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written **1939**

Comes Love · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- A–6 (6th string, 5th fret), Bø7 (6th string, 7th fret) and E7 (5th string, 7th fret) cover the A in one position.
- Four to the bar, light; stab the title phrase (bars 7–8) with the horns and the piano.
- Bridge: A7 for two bars, D–6 for two, A7, E7: the A7 is the only colour change, so make the C♯ heard.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**A–**	C E	**D–**	F A	**E7**	G♯ D	**Bø7**	D F A
B	**A7**	C♯ G	**D–**	F A	**E7**	G♯ D	**Bø7**	D F A

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A minor, harmonic minor on the E7s

A minor pentatonic at home; on E7 play G♯ (A harmonic minor, with F); Bø7 E7: F and G♯ together is the sound of the title phrase.

B

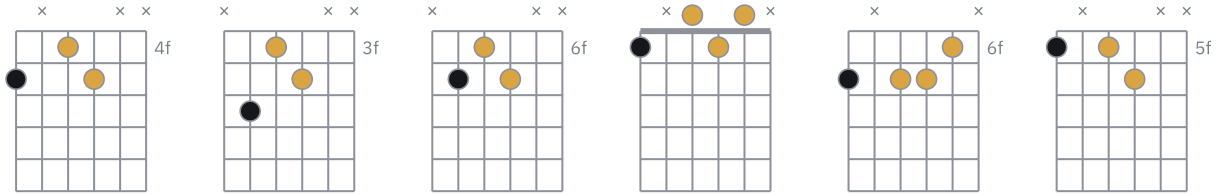
A7 → D–, then E7 home

A7 wants C♯; D minor pentatonic over the D– bars; E7 (G♯) and Bø7 E7 bring the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

F°7 passing chords on the 'and' of 4 before each E7 · bridge bars 5–6 as D– | D– · bar 2 as A– throughout for a modal reading.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



A–	**D–**	**E7**	**F°7**	**Bø7**	**A7**
A C E	D F A	E G♯ B D	F A♭ B D	B D F A	A C♯ E G

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · A minor pent A C D E G

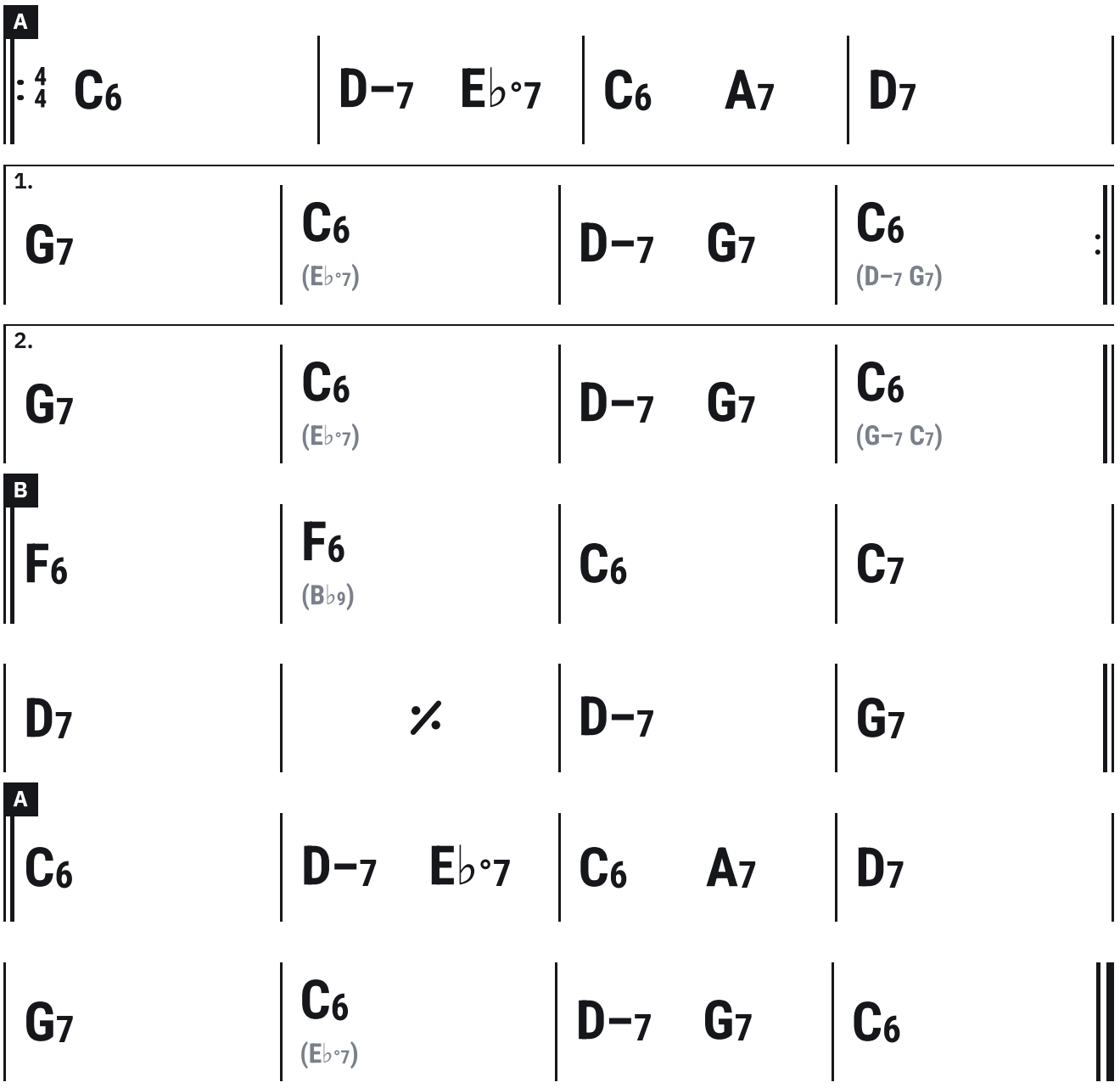
over E7 · A harmonic minor A B C D E F G♯

B · D minor pent D F G A C

(Medium Swing)

Don't Get Around Much Anymore

Duke Ellington & Bob Russell



Key **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / slow swing** Dance tempo **130–180 bpm** Written **1940**

Don't Get Around Much Anymore · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Four to the bar; E♭°7 (5th-string shape, 6th fret) sits one fret above the D–7 shape in bar 2, then C6 A7 | D7 | G7 | C6.
- Bridge: F6 for two bars (the B♭9 colour is the piano's), C6, C7, D7 for two, D–7 G7.
- At 120 behind a singer, half-note strums and let the bass walk; at 170 play four.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **C6** E A **D–7** F C **E♭°7** G♭ C **A7** C♯ G **D7** F♯ C **G7** B F

B **F6** A D **C6** E A **C7** E B♭ **D7** F♯ C **D–7** F C **G7** B F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C major with three dominants

C major pentatonic, bending in the one note each dominant wants: A7 → C♯, D7 → F♯, G7 → F. E♭°7 in bar 2 is the colour chord: E♭ against the C. Same trick as Sunny Side of the Street, same key.

B

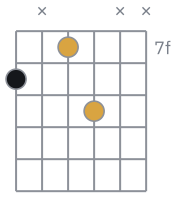
F major, then C7 → D7 → D–7 G7

F major pentatonic for bars 1–3 (B♭9 adds E♭); C7 (B♭) into D7 (F♯) for two bars, then ii–V home.

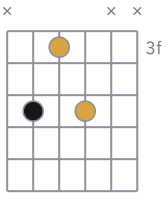
VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as C♯°7 or F6 F♯°7 · bar 3 as E–7 E♭7 (bebop) · bridge bars 5–6 as A–7 D7 · Real-Book-style bridge: G–7 C7 | F6 | G–7 C7 | F6 | A–7 D7 | A–7 D7 | D–7 | G7.

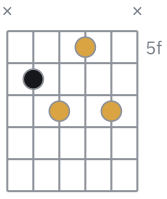
EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



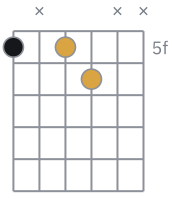
C6
C E G A



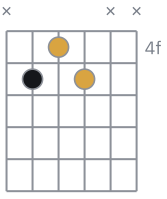
D–7
D F A C



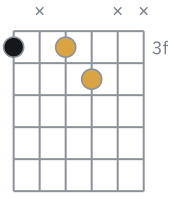
E♭°7
E♭ G♭ A C



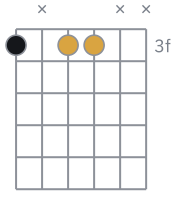
A7
A C♯ E G



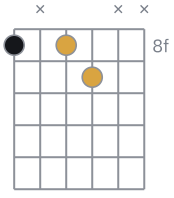
D7
D F♯ A C



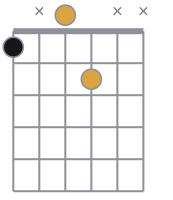
G7
G B D F



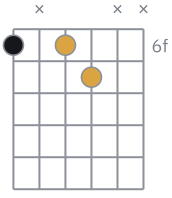
G–7
G B♭ D F



C7
C E G B♭



F6
F A C D



B♭9
B♭ C D F A♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · C major pent C D E G A

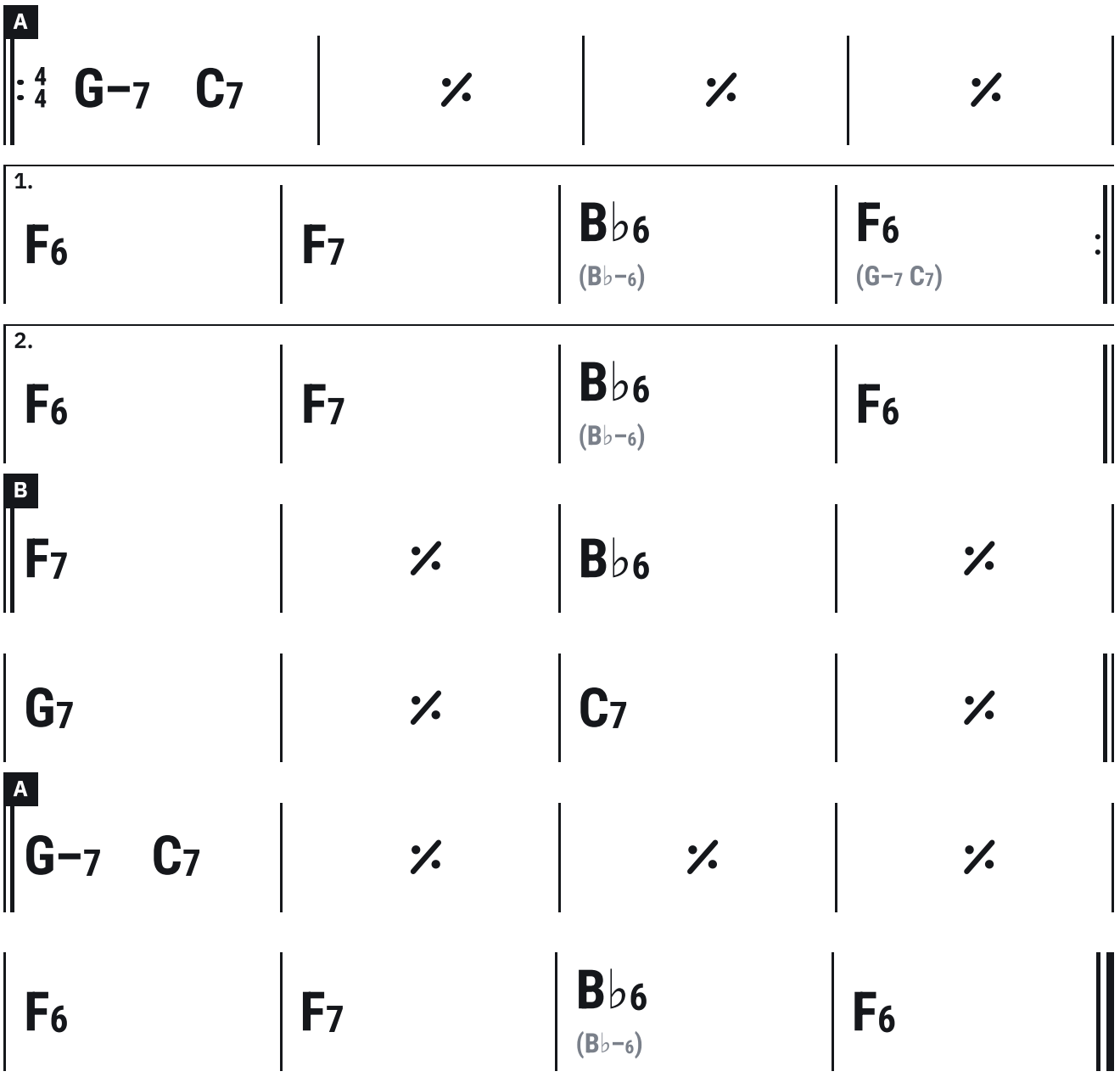
B · F major pent F G A C D

D7 bars · D major pent D E F♯ A B

(Medium Swing)

Honeysuckle Rose

Fats Waller & Andy Razaf



Key **F** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1929**

Honeysuckle Rose · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Four to the bar with G–7 and C7 alternating every two beats in bars 1–4; it's a vamp, keep it even.
- Bars 5–8: F6 | F7 | B♭6 (B♭–6) | F6: F6 → F7 is one finger (D to E♭).
- Bridge walk-up: F6, F♯°7, F6/A into B♭6 (then the same from G7 into C7) is the classic rhythm-guitar move here; three shapes a fret apart.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**G–7**	B♭ F	**C7**	E B♭	**F6**	A D	**F7**	A E♭	**B♭6**	D G
B	**F7**	A E♭	**B♭6**	D G	**G7**	B F	**C7**	E B♭		

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

One long ii–V in F, then home

Bars 1–4 are a vamp: C mixolydian (F major heard from the C7). Don't resolve early; the tune doesn't. Bars 5–8: F → F7 → B♭ → F. Play **E♭** on the F7 in bar 6 and land on **D** (3rd of B♭); if the band plays B♭–6, **D♭** is yours in bar 7.

B

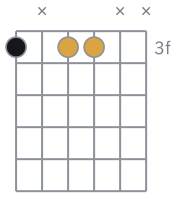
The Honeysuckle bridge: I7 → IV → II7 → V7

F7 (E♭) for two, B♭ major for two, G7 for two where **B** natural is the note, C7 (B♭) for two. Guide-tone line: A/E♭ → D/A♭ → B/F → E/B♭.

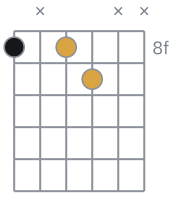
VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 7–8: B♭6 B♭–6 | F6 D7 (G–7 C7) · bridge bars 7–8 as G–7 | C7.

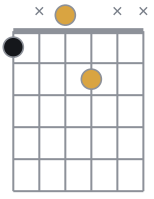
EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



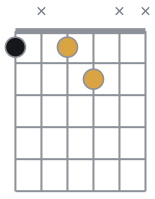
G–7
G B♭ D F



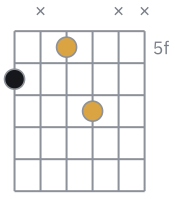
C7
C E G B♭



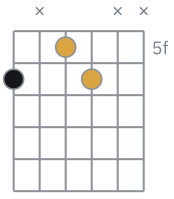
F6
F A C D



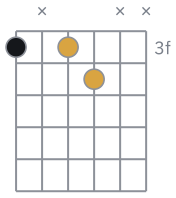
F7
F A C E♭



B♭6
B♭ D F G



B♭–6
B♭ D♭ F G



G7
G B D F

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · F major pent F G A C D

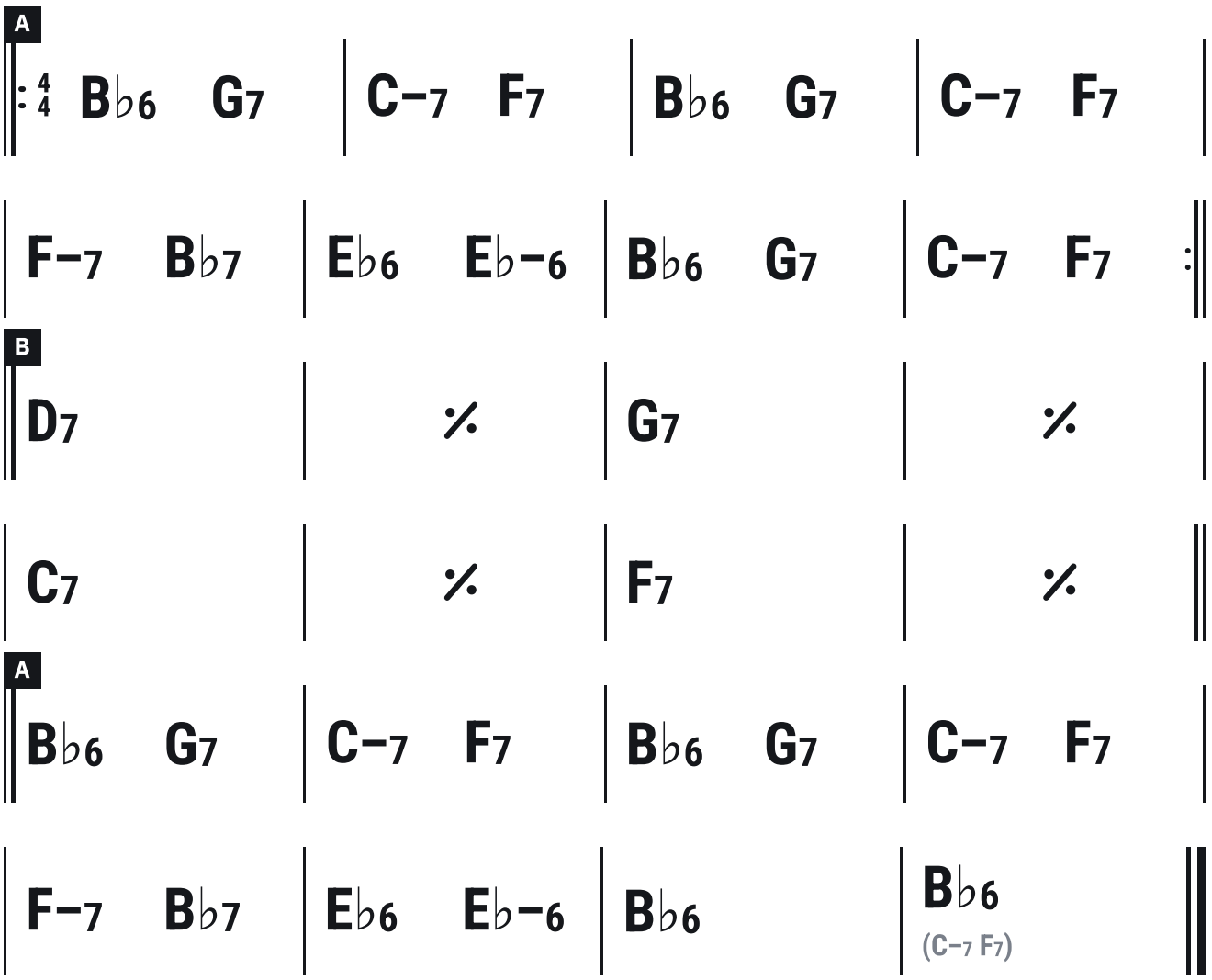
A bars 5–8 · F blues scale F A♭ B♭ B C E♭

B · G7: G major pent G A B D E

(Up Swing)

I Got Rhythm (Rhythm Changes)

George Gershwin



Key **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Charleston / fast lindy** Dance tempo **200–240 bpm** Written **1930**

I Got Rhythm · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Four to the bar, two shapes a bar in the A (B♭6 G7 | C–7 F7); at 240 play B♭6 and F7 only and let the bass have the turnaround.
- Bars 5–6: F–7 B♭7 | E♭6 E♭–6: E♭6 → E♭–6 is one finger (G to G♭); make it heard.
- Bridge: D7 G7 C7 F7, two bars each: 5th-string D7 at the 5th fret, G7 at the 3rd, C7 at the 8th, F7 at the 1st.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**B♭6**	D G	**G7**	B F	**C–7**	E♭ B♭	**F7**	A E♭	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**B♭7**	D A♭	**E♭6**	G C	**E♭–6**	G♭ C
B	**D7**	F♯ C	**G7**	B F	**C7**	E B♭	**F7**	A E♭								

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

B♭ major, with B♭ blues on top

Bars 1–4: one key to the ear. B♭ major pentatonic plus the blue D♭, and the whole turnaround disappears under it. Bars 5–6 are the real event: B♭7 into E♭. Play A♭ (the ♭7) and land on G (3rd of E♭); then G♭ over E♭–6 going home. Guide tones through the turnaround: D → B (G7) → E♭ → A (F7).

B

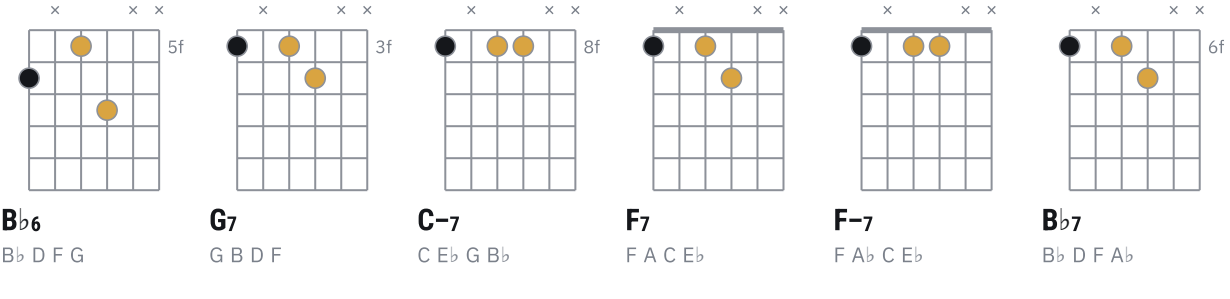
Four dominants, two bars each, round the circle

D7 → G7 → C7 → F7. Mixolydian on each; the 3rds are the targets: F♯ B E A. Voice-lead the 3rd/7th pairs down by half step: F♯/C → B/F → E/B♭ → A/E♭. Lydian dominant (♯11) for colour: G♯ on D7, C♯ on G7.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as D–7 G7 · bar 6 as E♭6 E°7 · bebop A: B♭ B°7 | C–7 C♯°7 | D–7 D♭7 | C–7 F7.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



B♭6 — B♭ D F G

G7 — G B D F

C–7 — C E♭ G B♭

F7 — F A C E♭

F–7 — F A♭ C E♭

B♭7 — B♭ D F A♭

E♭6 — E♭ G B♭ C

E♭–6 — E♭ G♭ B♭ C

D7 — D F♯ A C

C7 — C E G B♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

B · D7: D major pent D E F♯ A B

B · G7: G major pent G A B D E

B · C7: C major pent C D E G A

B · F7: F major pent F G A C D

(Medium Swing)

It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing)

Duke Ellington & Irving Mills



Key **G– → B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1931**

It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing) · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Bars 1–2: G–, G–Δ7, G–7, G–6 (the inner voice G F♯ F E) or hold G–6 and let the piano move; E♭7 → D7 in bars 3–4 is two shapes a half step apart.
- Doo-wah bars: stab C7 F7 | B♭6 | D7 with the horns on the 'and' of 2 and 4, then back to four to the bar.
- Bridge: B♭6 for two, F–7 B♭7, E♭6 for two (E♭–6), B♭6, F7 D7: plain shapes, lighter strum, so the return to G minor is felt.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**G–**	B♭ D	**G–7**	B♭ F	**G–6**	B♭ E	**E♭7**	G D♭	**D7**	F♯ C	**C7**	E B♭	**F7**	A E♭	**B♭6**	D G			
B	**B♭6**	D G	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**B♭7**	D A♭	**E♭6**	G C	**F7**	A E♭	**D7**	F♯ C							

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G minor, then four bars of B♭ major

Bars 1–2: G minor pentatonic over the line cliché G–F♯–F–E (play the cliché in the left hand, solo on top). E♭7 → D7: D♭ then F♯, the flamenco cadence. Bars 5–8: B♭ major pentatonic; E natural on C7, A on F7, and D7's F♯ to pull you home.

B

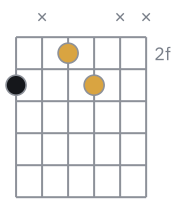
B♭ major: I → IV → home

B♭ major pentatonic for four bars (F–7 B♭7 is just a push into E♭: play A♭). E♭ major, then E♭–6 if the band plays it (G♭). F7 D7 at the end: A → F♯.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

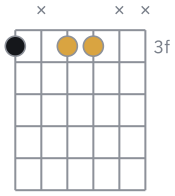
Bars 1–2 as plain G– · doo-wah bars as C–7 | F7 | B♭6 | D7♯5, or with C♯°7 in bar 6 (iReal first ending) · bridge bars 3–4 as B♭7 | B♭7.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root

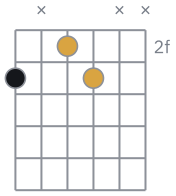


G–
G B♭ D

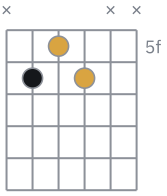
maj7



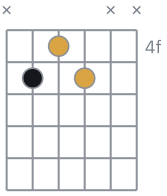
G–7
G B♭ D F



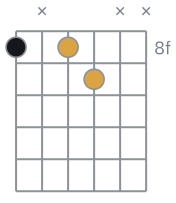
G–6
G B♭ D E



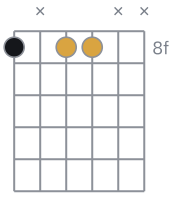
E♭7
E♭ G B♭ D♭



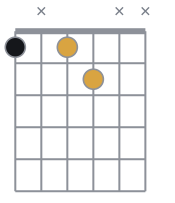
D7
D F♯ A C



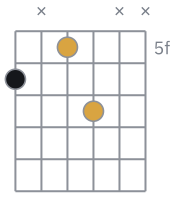
C7
C E G B♭



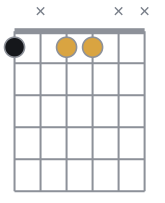
C–7
C E♭ G B♭



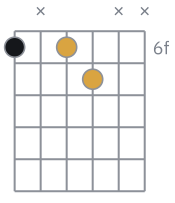
F7
F A C E♭



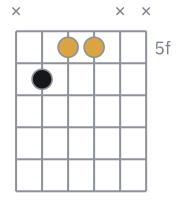
B♭6
B♭ D F G



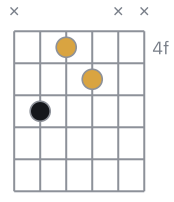
F–7
F A♭ C E♭



B♭7
B♭ D F A♭



E♭6
E♭ G B♭ C



E♭–6
E♭ G♭ B♭ C

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A bars 1–4 · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

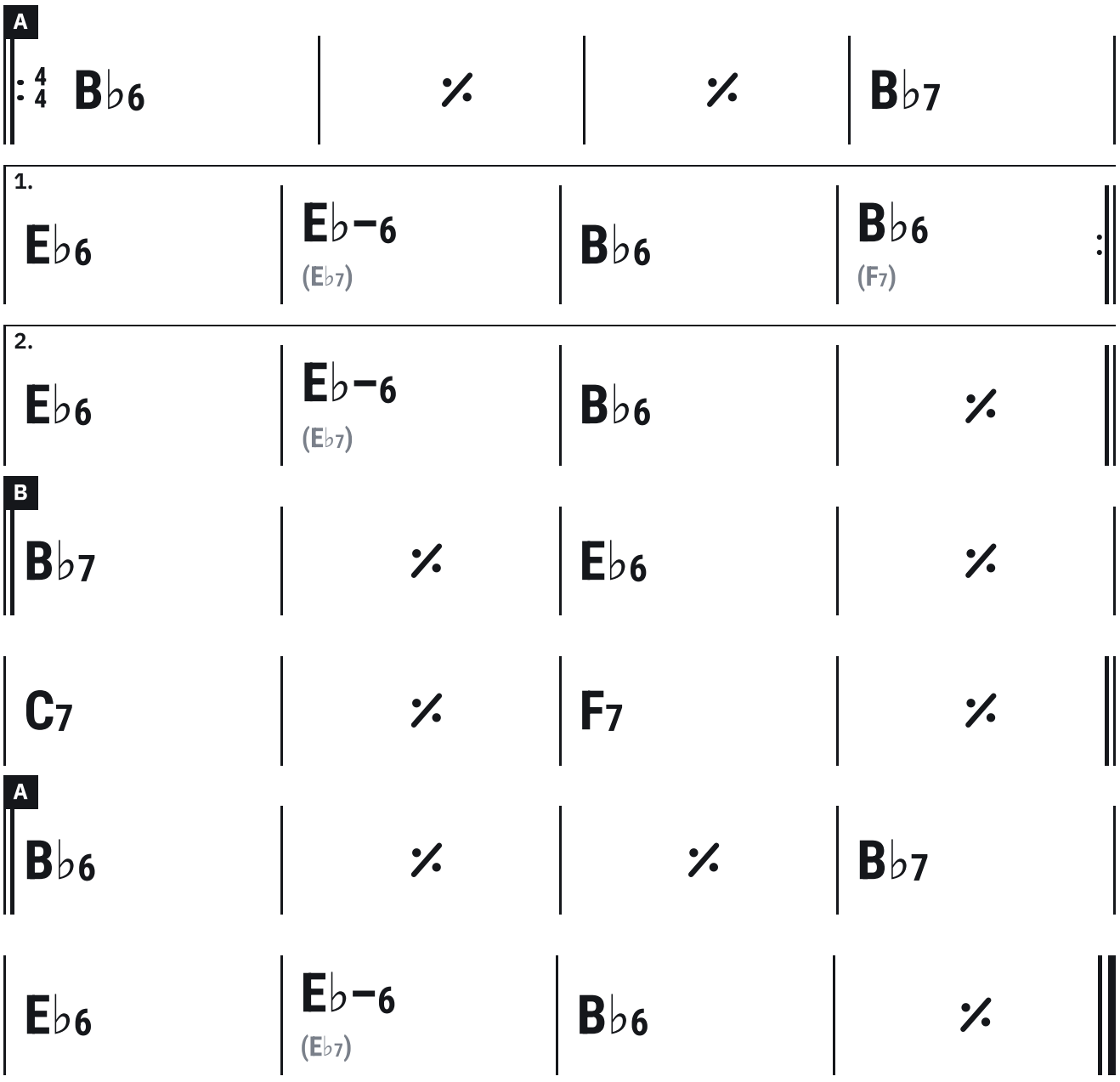
A bars 5–8, B · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

B bars 5–6 · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

(Up Swing)

Jumpin' at the Woodside

Count Basie (Eddie Durham)



Key **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Fast lindy** Dance tempo **200–250 bpm** Written **1938**

Jumpin' at the Woodside · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- At 240, two chords: B♭6 and E♭6, four to the bar, no fills; the bass and drums carry the tempo and you are the pulse's edge.
- Bar 4 B♭7 and bars 5–6 E♭6 E♭–6 are the only movement in the A; play them as one-finger changes.
- Bridge: B♭7 | B♭7 | E♭6 | E♭6 | C7 | C7 | F7 | F7: two bars a chord, the only place to breathe.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**B♭6**	D G	**B♭7**	D A♭	**E♭6**	G C	**E♭–6**	G♭ C
B	**B♭7**	D A♭	**E♭6**	G C	**C7**	E B♭	**F7**	A E♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

B♭ major pentatonic, blues on top

The riff is B♭ major pentatonic; so is the solo. B♭7 in bar 4: A♭ . E♭ then E♭–6 in bars 5–6: G then G♭ . Then home. At this tempo, two ideas per chorus is plenty.

B

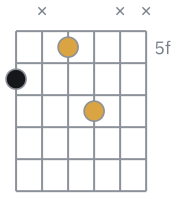
The Honeysuckle bridge in B♭

B♭7 (A♭) for two, E♭ for two, C7 (E natural) for two, F7 (A) for two. Half notes and quarter notes win at 240.

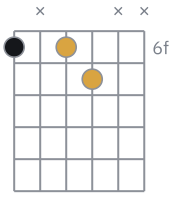
VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 as E♭7 | E♭7 · bar 8 F7 turnaround · some bands play a rhythm bridge (D7 G7 C7 F7) instead; ask before the count-off.

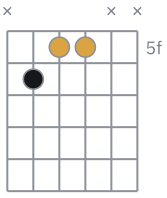
EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



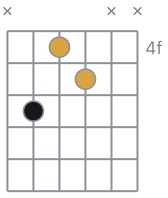
B♭6
B♭ D F G



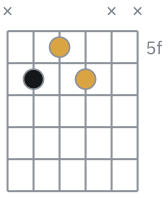
B♭7
B♭ D F A♭



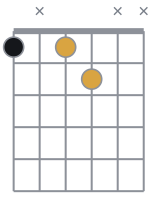
E♭6
E♭ G B♭ C



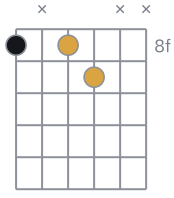
E♭–6
E♭ G♭ B♭ C



E♭7
E♭ G B♭ D♭



F7
F A C E♭



C7
C E G B♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

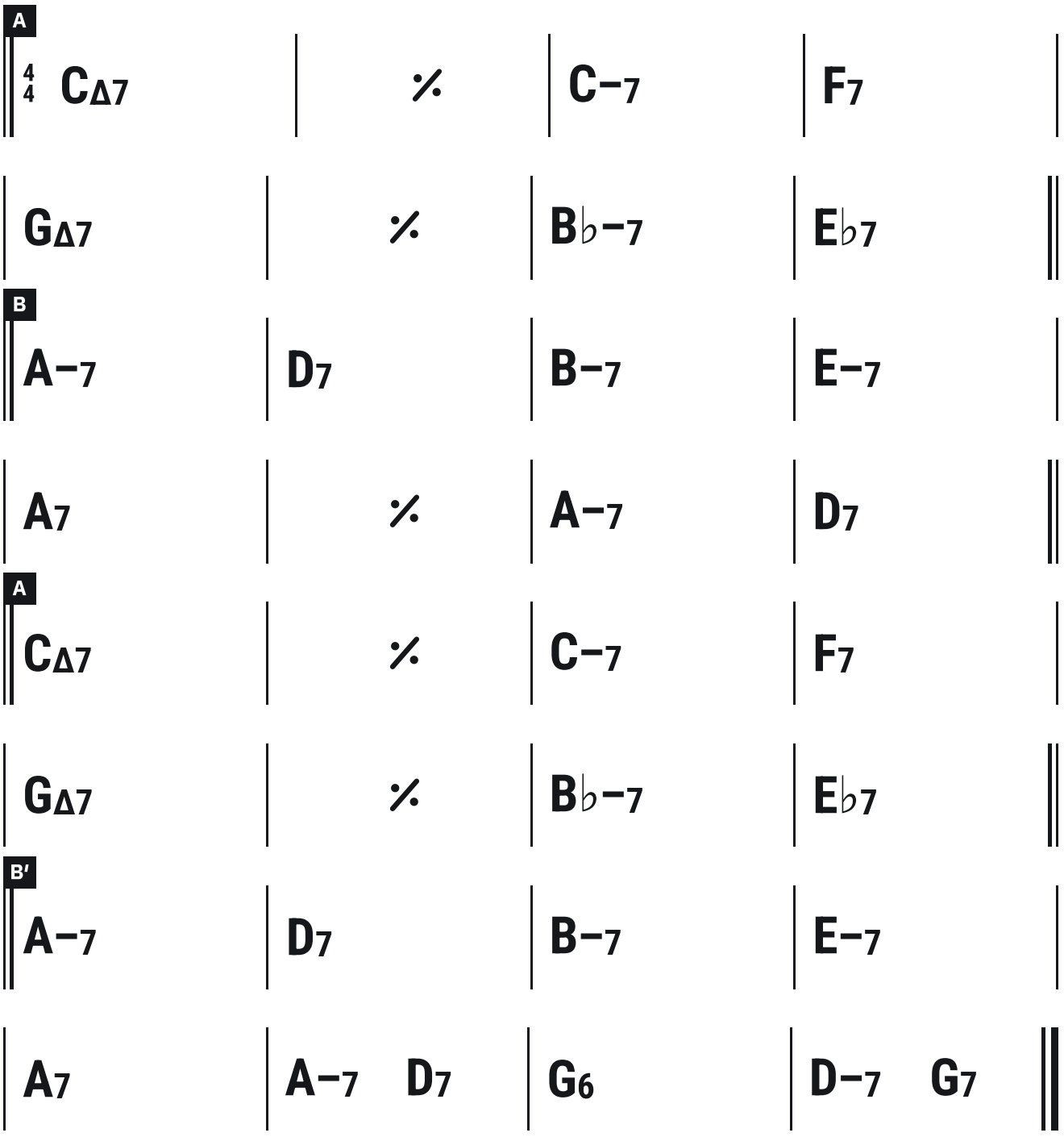
A · B♭ blues scale B♭ D♭ E♭ E F A♭

Bars 5–6, B · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

(Up Swing)

Just Friends

John Klenner & Sam M. Lewis



Key **G** Form **A B A B′ · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **170–220 bpm** Written **1931**

Just Friends · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Four to the bar, light, so the horn's ♭7s on the backdoor bars are heard; C6 and G6 instead of the Δ7s if they clash with the melody.
- The backdoor ii–Vs sit in one position each: C–7 (6th string, 8th fret) with F7 on the 5th string at the 8th; B♭–7 (6th string, 6th fret) with E♭7 on the 5th string at the 6th.
- Intro and tag are the last four bars (A–7 D7 | G6 | D–7 G7); at 200 it's a Balboa tune, so two-beat strums are fine.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**CΔ7**	E B	**C–7**	E♭ B♭	**F7**	A E♭	**GΔ7**	B F♯	**B♭–7**	D♭ A♭	**E♭7**	G D♭			
B	**A–7**	C G	**D7**	F♯ C	**B–7**	D A	**E–7**	G D	**A7**	C♯ G					
B′	**A–7**	C G	**D7**	F♯ C	**B–7**	D A	**E–7**	G D	**A7**	C♯ G	**G6**	B E	**D–7**	F C	**G7**	B F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

IV, backdoor, I, backdoor

CΔ7: G major (C lydian, F♯). C–7 F7: B♭ major pentatonic (E♭ and B♭ are the backdoor notes). GΔ7: home. B♭–7 E♭7: A♭ major pentatonic (D♭ , A♭) sliding into A–7.

B

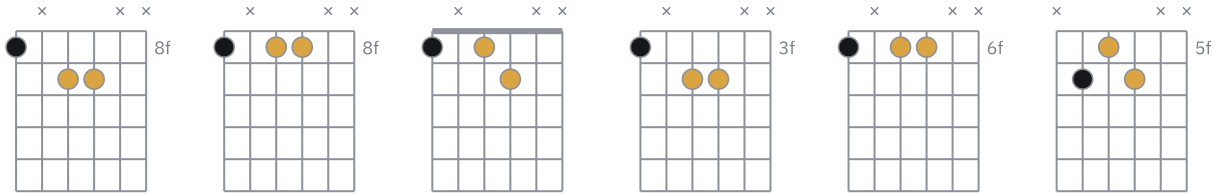
G major with one II7

A–7 D7 and B–7 E–7 are diatonic; A7 is the II7 colour: C♯ . B′: A–7 D7 G6 then D–7 G7 to set up the C chord at the top.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 of the first A as F7 | F7 (Chet's sub for GΔ7) · B′ bar 8 as D7 D♭7 the first time · bar 7–8 of the B as A–7 | D7 or A–7 D7 | G6.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



CΔ7 C E G B

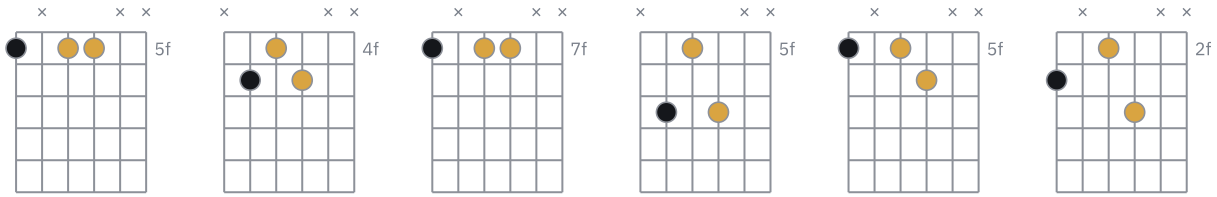
C–7 C E♭ G B♭

F7 F A C E♭

GΔ7 G B D F♯

B♭–7 B♭ D♭ F A♭

E♭7 E♭ G B♭ D♭



A–7 A C E G

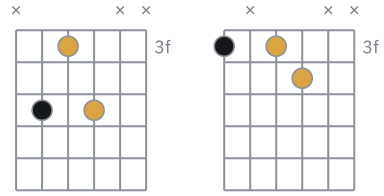
D7 D F♯ A C

B–7 B D F♯ A

E–7 E G B D

A7 A C♯ E G

G6 G B D E



D–7 D F A C

G7 G B D F

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A, B · G major pent G A B D E

C–7 F7 · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

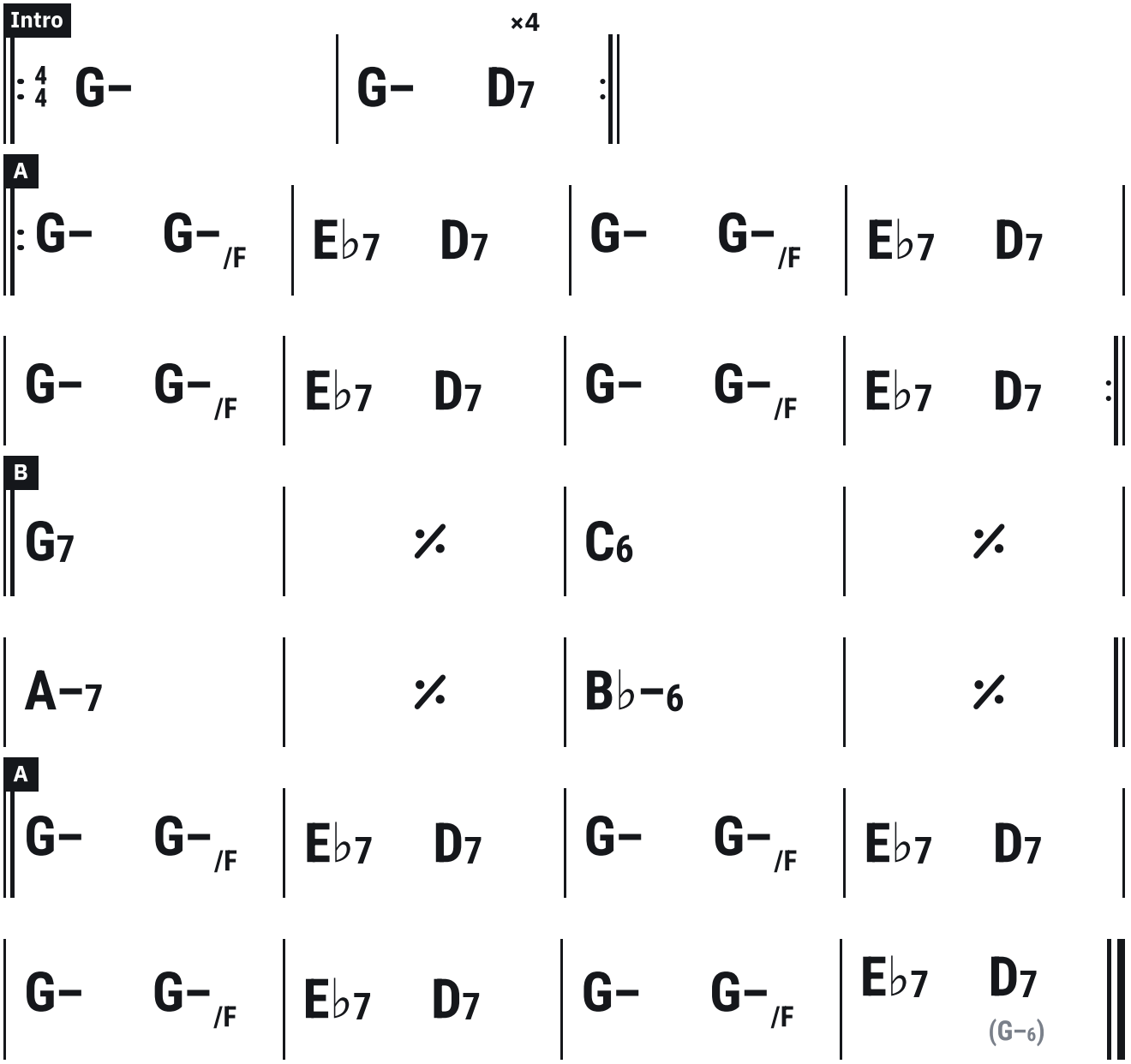
B♭–7 E♭7 · A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

A7 · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

(Medium Up Swing)

Kansas City Stride

Giorgio Cuscito (Tiber River Dixieland)



Key **G–** Form **AABA · 32 + 8-bar intro** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **2011**

Kansas City Stride · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- G–6 (with the F on top for G–/F, or just hold G–6) on beats 1 and 3, E♭7 D7 two beats each: the whole A is three shapes, four to the bar.
- Intro vamp: G–6 four to the bar, with the D7 kick on beats 3–4 of bar 2 as a stab with the drums.
- Bridge: G7 | G7 | C6 | C6 | A–7 | A–7 | B♭–6 | B♭–6: plain shapes, two bars each; B♭–6 at the 6th fret (6th string) slides down to G–6 at the 3rd.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

In	**G–**	B♭ D	**D7**	F♯ C							
A	**G–**	B♭ D	**G–/F**	B♭ D	**E♭7**	G D♭	**D7**	F♯ C			
B	**G7**	B F	**C6**	E A	**A–7**	C G	**B♭–6**	D♭ G			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

The Lester's Bounce riff: G– with an E♭7 D7 slide every second bar

G minor pentatonic and the G blues scale over the whole eight; the riff is the melody. The E♭7 D7 is a ♭VI7 → V7 slide: D♭ (7th of E♭7) down to C (7th of D7), and F♯ on the D7 (G harmonic minor). Anything you play on Lester's Bounce bars 1–4 works here, four times.

B

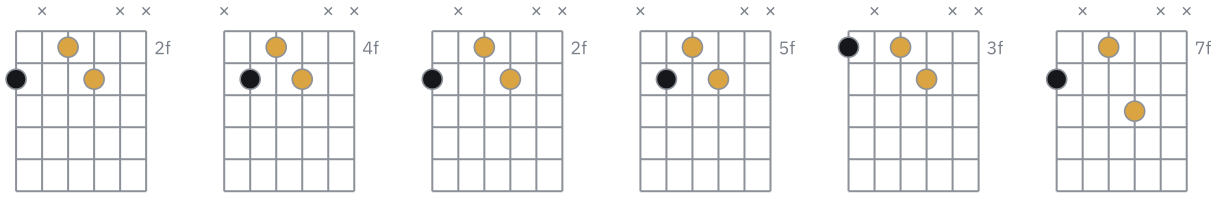
Bright for six bars, dark for two: G7 → C → A–7 → B♭–

C major pentatonic covers G7, C6 and A–7 in one go, with B natural as the colour note against the A's B♭ and F on the G7. Then B♭ minor pentatonic for the B♭–6 bars (D♭ and A♭ are the notes that say minor), and you are a half step above home: slide down into G minor pent on bar 25.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Intro one chord a bar (16 bars) · A bars 7–8 as G– | D7 to break the loop · bridge with C–6 and Aø7 for the all-minor version (that is the Lester's Bounce bridge) · B♭–6 played as E♭9 · last bar G–6.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



G– G B♭ D

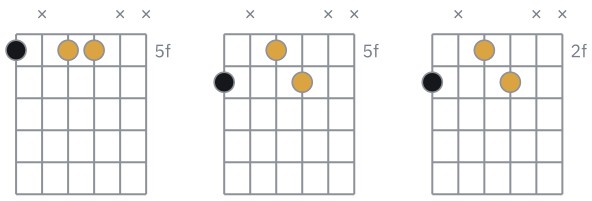
D7 D F♯ A C

G–/F G B♭ D

E♭7 E♭ G B♭ D♭

G7 G B D F

C6 C E G A



A–7 A C E G

B♭–6 B♭ D♭ F G

G–6 G B♭ D E

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

A · G blues scale G B♭ C D♭ D F

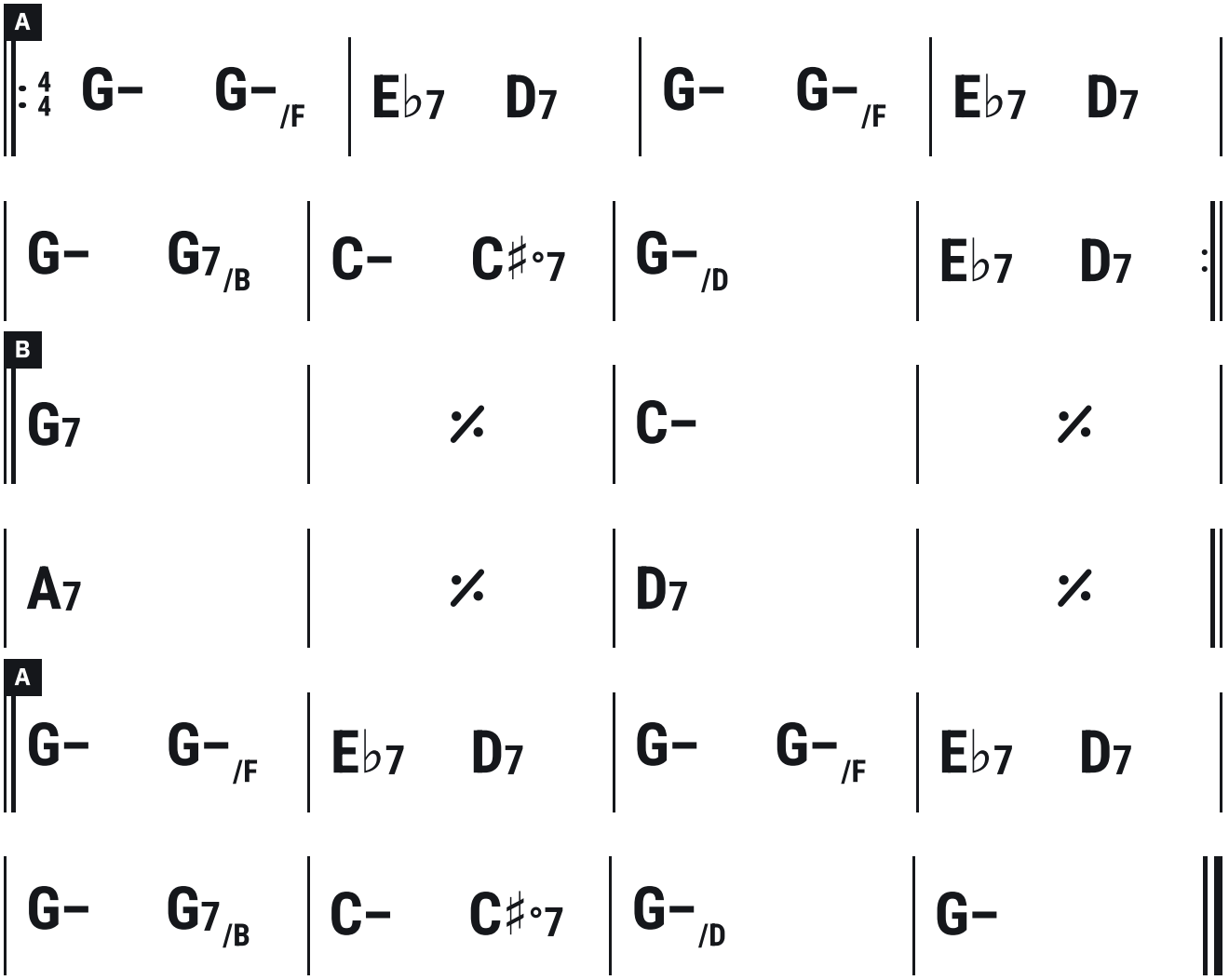
B · C major pent (G7, C, A–7) C D E G A

B · B♭ minor pent (B♭–) B♭ D♭ E♭ F A♭

(Medium Swing)

Lester's Bounce

Your band's chart (Bob Wilber / Antti Sarpila recording)



Key **G–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written

Lester's Bounce · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Four to the bar: G–6 G–/F | E♭7 D7 twice, then G–6, G7, C–6, C♯°7, G–6, E♭7 D7: the climb in bars 5–7 is four shapes a fret apart on the low strings.
- The 4-bar intro vamp is the A loop; play it with the piano's left-hand riff and let the horns enter on bar 5.
- Bridge: G7 | G7 | C–6 | C–6 | A7 | A7 | D7 | D7: two bars a chord; the second ending (bar 16) lands on G–, then the bridge.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **G–** B♭ D **G–/F** B♭ D **E♭7** G D♭ **D7** F♯ C **G7/B** B F **C–** E♭ G **C♯°7** E B♭ **G–/D** B♭ D

B **G7** B F **C–** E♭ G **A7** C♯ G **D7** F♯ C

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G minor riff, chromatic bass in bars 5–7

G minor pentatonic and blues scale over bars 1–4; the bass line G – F – E♭ – D is the hook. Bars 5–7: G7/B (B natural) → C– → C♯°7 (C♯) → G–/D: play the bass line's climb G B C C♯ D in your line and the chords take care of themselves. E♭7 D7 at the end: G on the E♭7, F♯ on the D7.

B

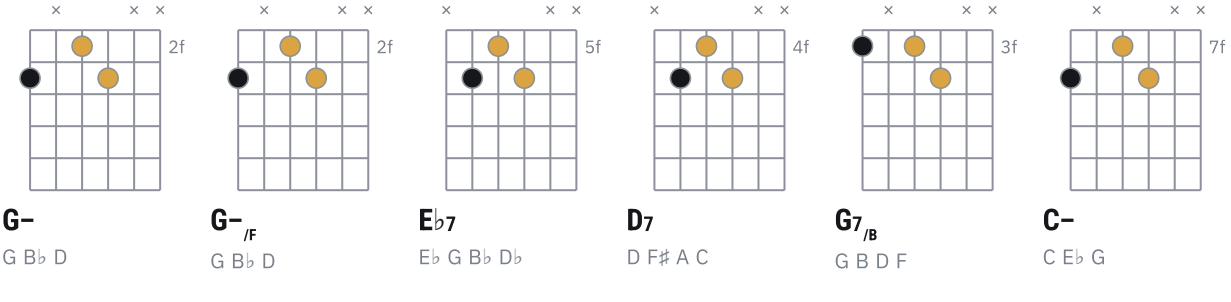
Honeysuckle bridge in minor: G7 → C– → A7 → D7

G7 (B , F) for two, C minor pentatonic for two, A7 (C♯) for two, D7 (F♯) for two. Same shape as the Honeysuckle Rose bridge with the IV turned minor.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Your chart is the source. Bar 6 C♯°7 can be played as A7/C♯; the bridge G7 as G7♭9 for the darker sound.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



G– G B♭ D

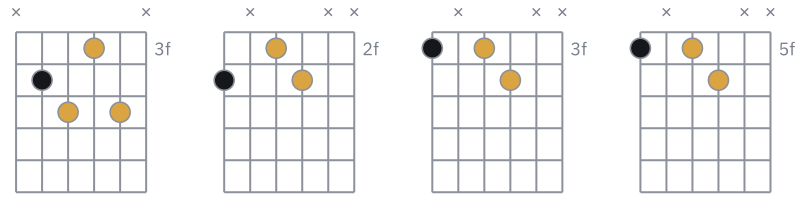
G–/F G B♭ D

E♭7 E♭ G B♭ D♭

D7 D F♯ A C

G7/B G B D F

C– C E♭ G



C♯°7 C♯ E G B♭

G–/D G B♭ D

G7 G B D F

A7 A C♯ E G

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

A · G blues scale G B♭ C D♭ D F

B bars 3–4 · C minor pent C E♭ F G B♭

B · A7: A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

(Medium Swing)

Lullaby of Birdland

George Shearing



Key **F− / A♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **150–200 bpm** Written **1952**

Lullaby of Birdland · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Two chords a bar at 150–200: half-note shells, F–6 Dø7 | Gø7 C7 | F–7 D♭Δ7 | B♭–7 E♭7; the ø7 shapes (four notes) are the workout here.
- From bar 3 the tune is in A♭ major: B♭–7 E♭7 A♭ shapes with the 7th on top falling to the 3rd.
- Bridge: Cø7 F7 | B♭–7 | E♭7 | A♭Δ7 twice, C7 in the last bar; plain 7 shapes for the ♭9 chords and let the piano add the colour.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **F–6** A♭ D · **Dø7** F A♭ C · **Gø7** B♭ D♭ F · **C7** E B♭ · **F–7** A♭ E♭ · **D♭Δ7** F C · **B♭–7** D♭ A♭ · **E♭7** G D♭ · **C–7** E♭ B♭ · **A♭Δ7** C G · **D♭9** F B

B **Cø7** E♭ G♭ B♭ · **F7♭9** G♭ A E♭ · **B♭–7** D♭ A♭ · **E♭7♭9** E G D♭ · **A♭Δ7** C G · **C7♭9** D♭ E B♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F minor for two bars, A♭ major for the rest

F harmonic minor over Dø7–Gø7–C7 (E natural is the note). From bar 3 think A♭ major pentatonic: B♭–7 E♭7 A♭ and C–7 F–7 B♭–7 E♭7 are all one scale. D♭9 in bar 7: C♭ . Gø7 C7 at the end: D♭ then E .

B

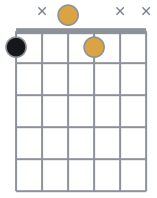
A♭ major, iii–VI–ii–V–I twice

A♭ major pentatonic for the whole bridge; on each F7♭9 play A natural and G♭ , on E♭7♭9 play G and F♭ . The last bar's C7♭9 (E , D♭) is the door back to F minor.

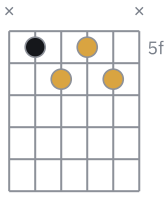
VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as G7♭9 C7♭9 · bars 3–4 as F–7 B♭–7 | E♭7 A♭Δ7 (Real-Book shape) · bridge bars 1–2 as A♭Δ7 | A♭Δ7 in older charts.

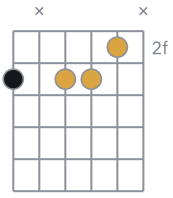
EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



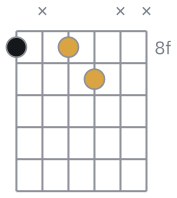
F–6
F A♭ C D



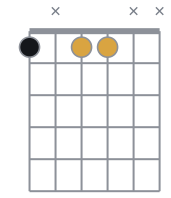
Dø7
D F A♭ C



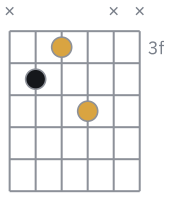
Gø7
G B♭ D♭ F



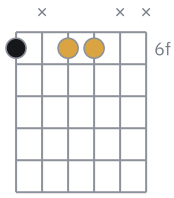
C7
C E G B♭



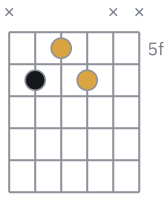
F–7
F A♭ C E♭
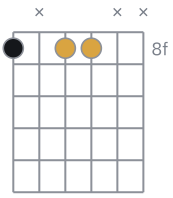


D♭Δ7
D♭ F A♭ C



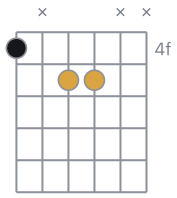
B♭–7
B♭ D♭ F A♭



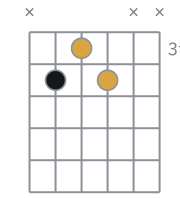
E♭7
E♭ G B♭ D♭



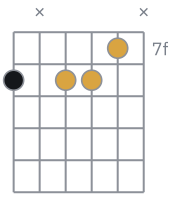
C–7
C E♭ G B♭



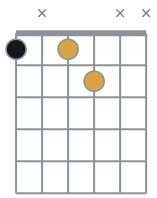
A♭Δ7
A♭ C E♭ G



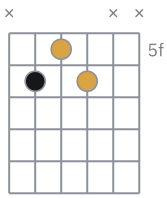
D♭9
D♭ E♭ F A♭ B



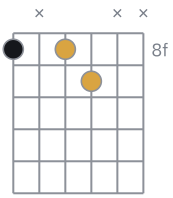
C♭ø7
C E♭ G♭ B♭



F7♭9
F G♭ A C E♭



E♭7♭9
E♭ E G B♭ D♭



C7♭9
C D♭ E G B♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A bars 1–2 · F harmonic minor F G A♭ B♭ C D♭ E
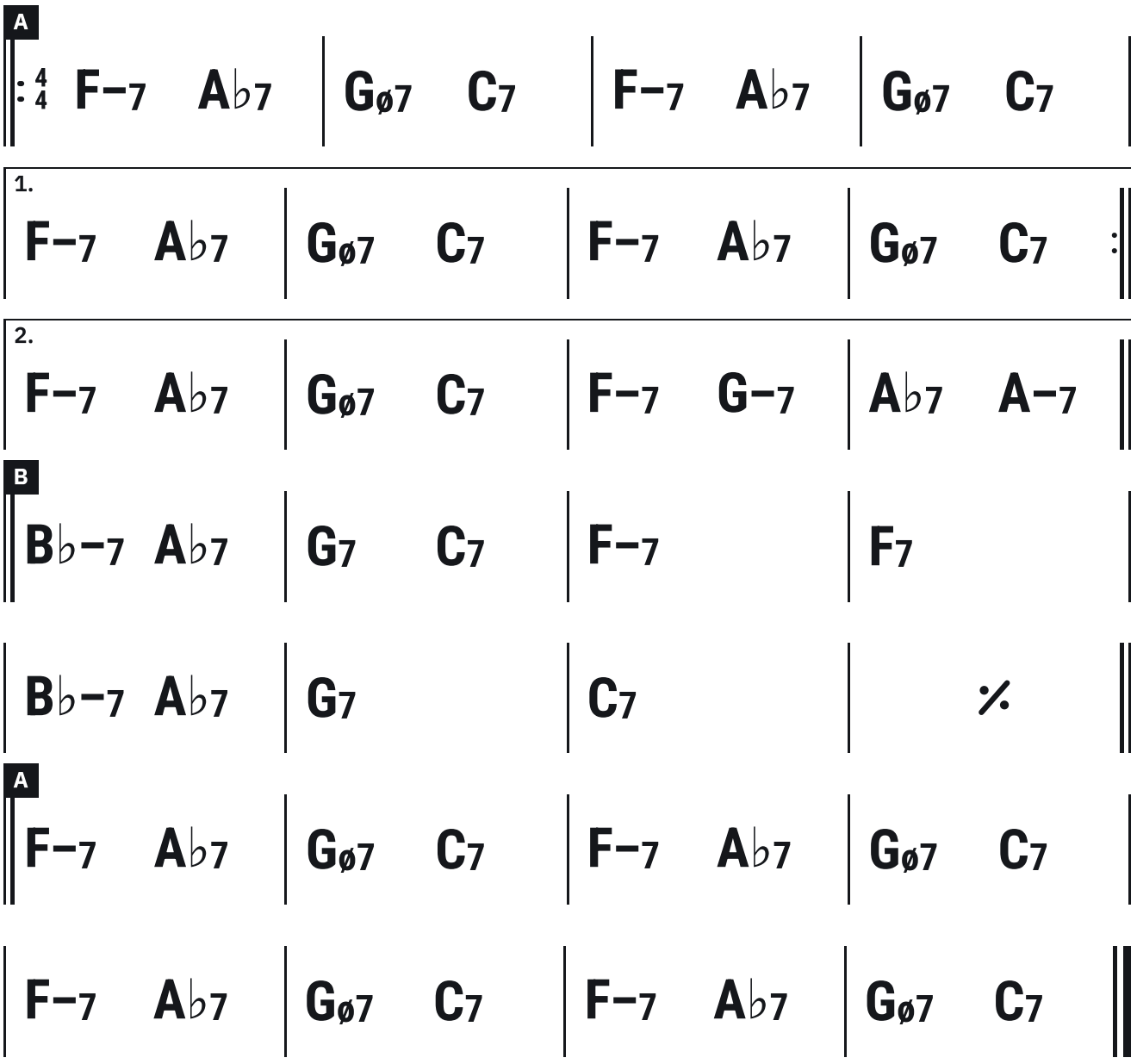
A, B · A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

over F–6 · F minor pent F A♭ B♭ C E♭

(Slow Shuffle)

Moanin'

Bobby Timmons



Key **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Slow lindy / blues shuffle** Dance tempo **100–125 bpm** Written **1958**

Moanin' · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Shuffle feel at 110: strum the shuffle (long–short) on F–7 and hit the answer chord (B♭/F → F) with the horns in bars 2, 4, 6.
- Solo changes: F–7 A♭7 | Gø7 C7: four shapes, two a bar; the A♭7 → G7 → C7 chain is a bass line under the blues scale, so keep the voicings low and plain.
- Bridge: B♭–7 A♭7 | G7 C7 | F–7 | F7 | B♭–7 A♭7 | G7 | C7 | C7; the F7 in bar 4 is the surprise: make the A natural heard.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**A♭7**	C G♭	**Gø7**	B♭ D♭ F	**C7**	E B♭	**G–7**	B♭ F	**A–7**	C G
B	**B♭–7**	D♭ A♭	**A♭7**	C G♭	**G7**	B F	**C7**	E B♭	**F–7**	A♭ E♭	**F7**	A E♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F minor blues, chromatic dominants underneath

F minor blues scale and F dorian over everything; the A♭7 – G7 – C7 chain is just a bass line under the blues scale. Target **E** natural (3rd of C7) at the end of each two-bar unit, then slide back to **A♭**. Gospel grace notes: G into A♭, B into C.

B

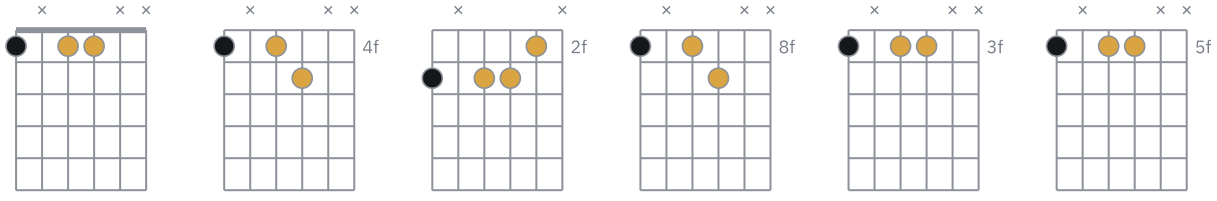
B♭–7 → A♭7 → G7 → C7, then V

Descending bass B♭ – A♭ – G, then C7. Lean on 3rds: **D♭** **C** **B** **E**. F7 in bar 4 is V of B♭–: **A** natural and E♭. Second half opens out: two whole bars of C7, so say something and leave space.

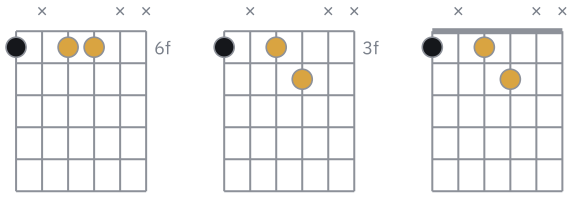
VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Some charts keep the solo A as plain F–7 for eight bars · answer sometimes written B♭ | F7 · bridge bar 4 as F7♭9.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



F–7 F A♭ C E♭ · **A♭7** A♭ C E♭ G♭ · **Gø7** G B♭ D♭ F · **C7** C E G B♭ · **G–7** G B♭ D F · **A–7** A C E G



B♭–7 B♭ D♭ F A♭ · **G7** G B D F · **F7** F A C E♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · F minor pent F A♭ B♭ C E♭

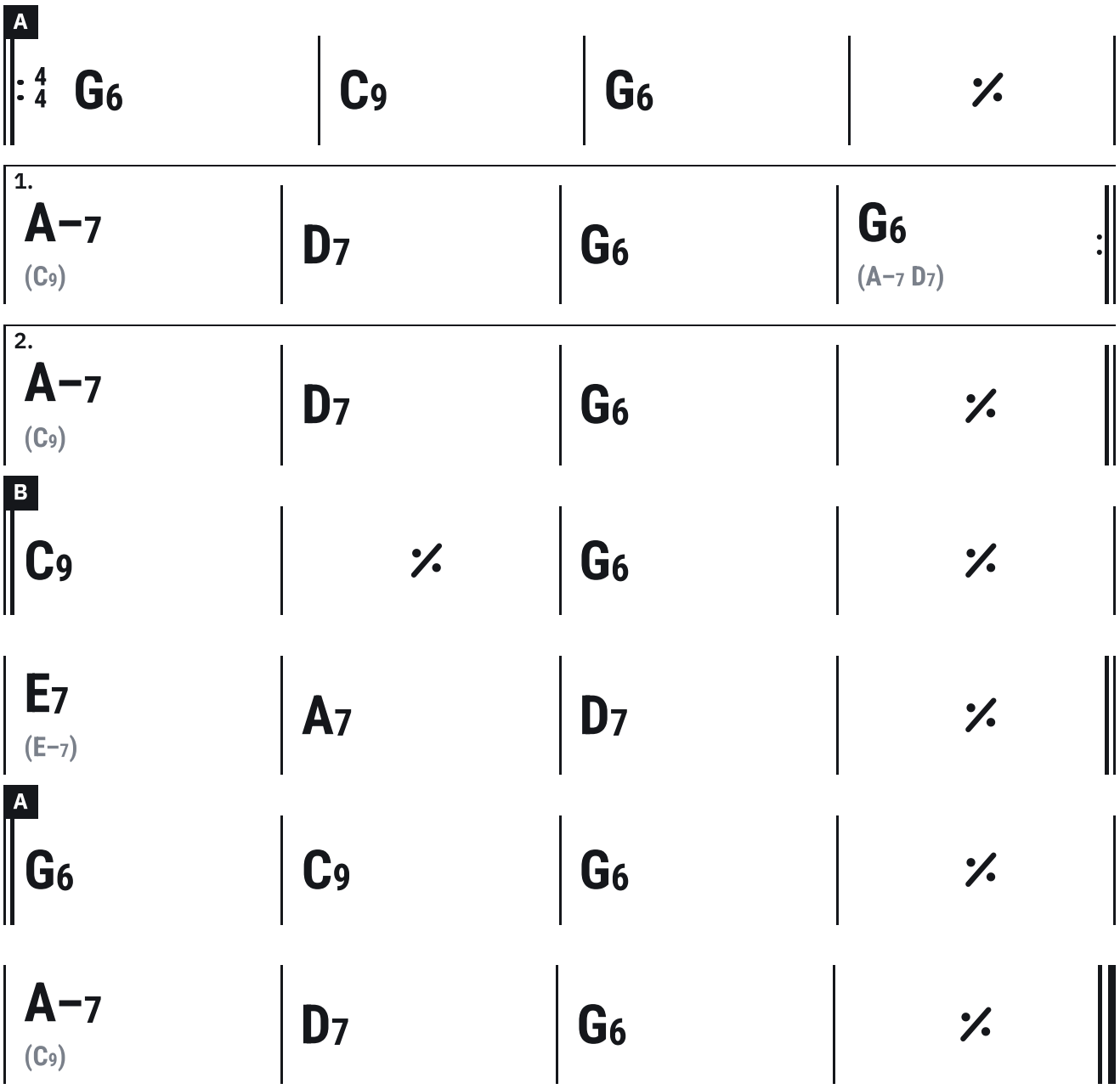
A · F blues scale F A♭ B♭ B C E♭

B · B♭ minor pent B♭ D♭ E♭ F A♭

(Medium Swing)

Oh, Lady Be Good

George & Ira Gershwin



Key **G** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1924**

Oh, Lady Be Good · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Four to the bar on G6 for most of the A; C9 in bar 2 as a plain C7 shape (the 9 is the horns'); A–7 D7 in bars 5–6, home.
- Bridge: C7 for two, G6 for two, then E7 (5th string, 7th fret), A7 (6th string, 5th fret), D7 (5th string, 5th fret): two of the three dominants sit at the 5th fret.
- Keep the strum light and even; it's a riff tune, the time is the content.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	G6	B E	C9	E B♭	A–7	C G	D7	F♯ C			
B	C9	E B♭	G6	B E	E7	G♯ D	A7	C♯ G	D7	F♯ C	

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

G major, four bars, then a ii–V

G major pentatonic plus the blues scale; the C9's B♭ against the band's B is the blues in bar 2. Bars 5–6, A–7 D7: F rising to F♯.

B

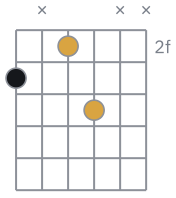
IV, I, then VI7 → II7 → V7

C major for two bars (C9: B♭), G for two, then the chain: E7 wants G♯, A7 wants C♯, D7 wants F♯. Play those three notes on the downbeats and you've played the bridge.

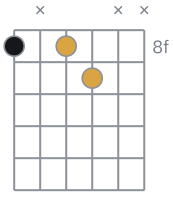
VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 5 as A7 or C9 · bridge bars 1–2 as G7 | G7 (Honeysuckle shape) · bar 8 of A2 as D7 into the bridge.

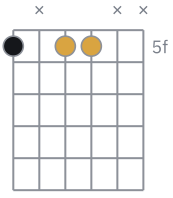
EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



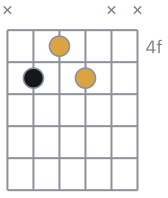
G6
G B D E



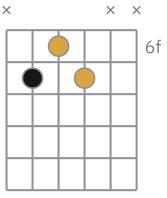
C9
C D E G B♭



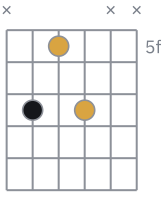
A–7
A C E G



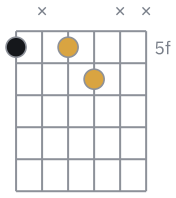
D7
D F♯ A C



E7
E G♯ B D



E–7
E G B D



A7
A C♯ E G

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · G major pent G A B D E

A · G blues scale G B♭ C D♭ D F

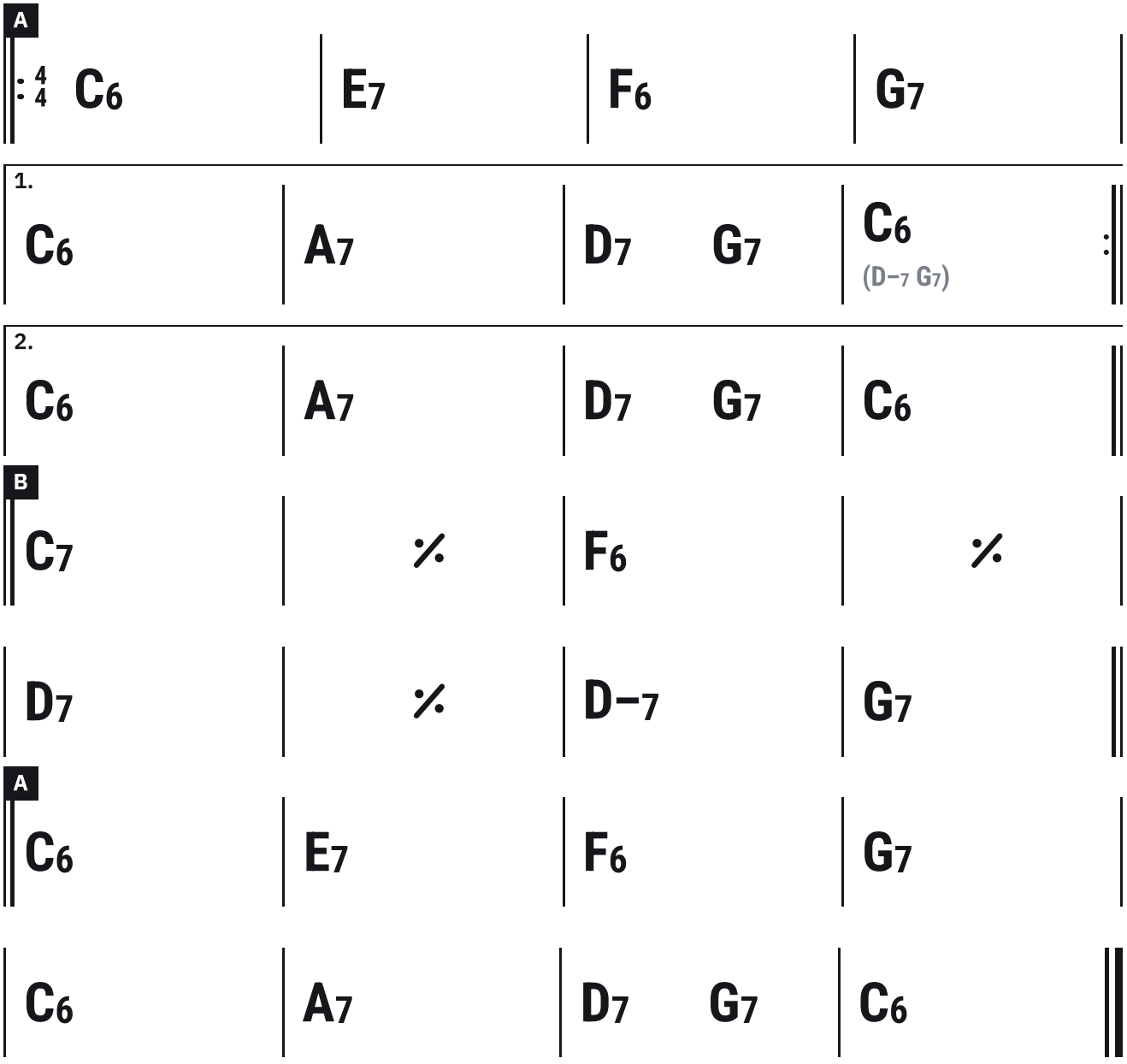
B bars 1–2 · C major pent C D E G A

B · A7: A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

(Medium Swing)

On the Sunny Side of the Street

Jimmy McHugh & Dorothy Fields



Key **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lazy lindy / blues** Dance tempo **110–140 bpm** Written **1930**

On the Sunny Side of the Street · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Half-note strums on the head at 120 (two-feel), four to the bar for solos; C6 | E7 | F6 | G7 | C6 | A7 | D7 G7 | C6 is a shape a bar, all low.
- The three dominants: E7 (5th string, 7th fret), A7 (6th string, 5th fret), D7 (5th string, 5th fret); bar 7 has two, D7 G7, half a bar each.
- Bridge: C7 | C7 | F6 | F6 | D7 | D7 | D–7 | G7: two bars a chord, light.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	C6	E A	E7	G♯ D	F6	A D	G7	B F	A7	C♯ G	D7	F♯ C	
B	C7	E B♭	F6	A D	D7	F♯ C	D–7	F C	G7	B F			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C major, bending three notes in

C major pentatonic all the way, except the three dominants that each ask for one note: E7 wants G♯ (bar 2), A7 wants C♯ (bar 6), D7 wants F♯ (bar 7). Hit those on the beat and the tune is in the room.

B

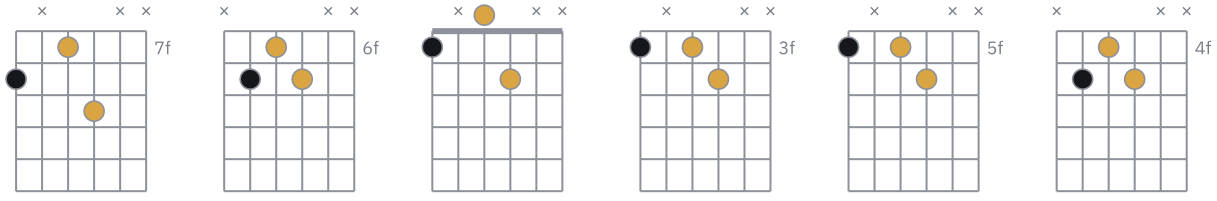
C7 → F → D7 → D–7 G7

C mixolydian (B♭) for two bars, F major for two, D7 (F♯) for two, then ii–V home. C blues scale sits fine over the first four bars.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–7 also played A–7 | D7 | D–7 G7 · bridge as G–7 C7 | G–7 C7 | F6 | F6 | A–7 D7 | A–7 D7 | D–7 | G7, or ending D7 | D7 | G7 | G7.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



C6 C E G A

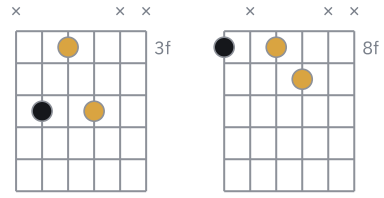
E7 E G♯ B D

F6 F A C D

G7 G B D F

A7 A C♯ E G

D7 D F♯ A C



D–7 D F A C

C7 C E G B♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · C major pent C D E G A

A, B · C blues scale C E♭ F G♭ G B♭
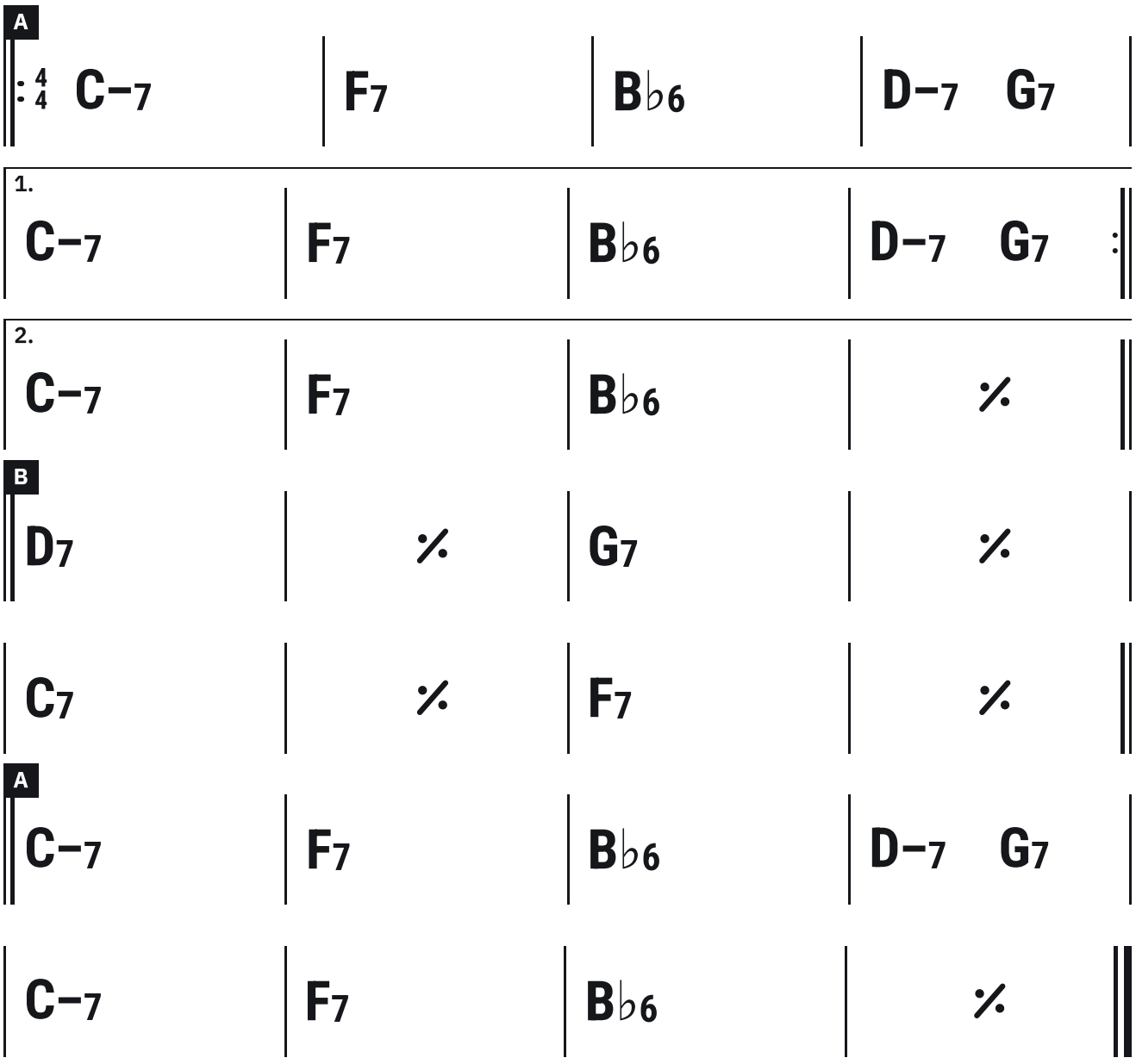
B · F major pent F G A C D

B · D7: D major pent D E F♯ A B

(Medium Up Swing)

Perdido

Juan Tizol



Key **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1941**

Perdido · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Four to the bar: C–7 | F7 | B♭6 | D–7 G7 twice; a shape a bar with the 3rds on top (E♭ → A → D → F, B).
- Some charts write the A as four bars of B♭6 then C–7 F7; the bass line is the same, so follow the bassist.
- Bridge: D7 G7 C7 F7 two bars each (5th-string D7 at the 5th fret, G7 at the 3rd, C7 at the 8th, F7 at the 1st).

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	C–7	E♭	B♭	F7	A	E♭	B♭6	D	G	D–7	F	C	G7	B	F
B	D7	F♯	C	G7	B	F	C7	E	B♭	F7	A	E♭			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

B♭ major with a VI7 pull

The riff is B♭ major pentatonic and so is the solo; the only non-diatonic note you need is **B** natural on G7, which drops you onto C–7 every four bars. Blues scale over the F7s.

B

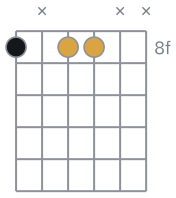
The rhythm bridge: D7 G7 C7 F7

Two bars each; targets **F♯** **B** **E** **A**. Identical to the I Got Rhythm bridge, so anything you play there works here.

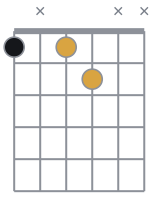
VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A as B♭6 | B♭6 | B♭6 | B♭6 | C–7 F7 | C–7 F7 | B♭6 | B♭6 in some charts · bridge bar 4 as G7♯5 (Hawkins' rhythm section).

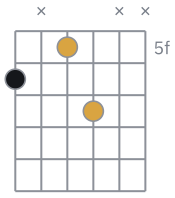
EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



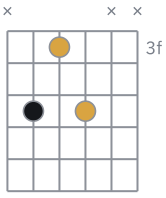
C–7
C E♭ G B♭



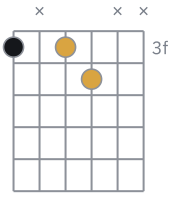
F7
F A C E♭



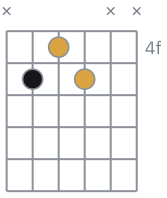
B♭6
B♭ D F G



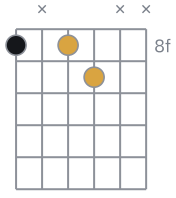
D–7
D F A C



G7
G B D F



D7
D F♯ A C



C7
C E G B♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

A · B♭ blues scale B♭ D♭ E♭ E F A♭

B · D7: D major pent (then G, C, F) D E F♯ A B

(Up Swing)

Puttin' On the Ritz

Irving Berlin



Key **F– → A♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Charleston / Balboa** Dance tempo **200–240 bpm** Written **1929**

Puttin' On the Ritz · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- At 200+, F–6 and C7 only on the A (four to the bar), D♭7 as a one-beat stab in bar 7.
- Bridge: B♭–7 E♭7 | A♭6 | A♭6, twice, in Charleston rhythm (hit on 1, hit on the 'and' of 2) with the piano; D♭7 C7 in the last bar, half a bar each.
- Keep the shapes low and the strum short: the tempo wants a clean 2 and 4.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **F–** A♭ C **C7** E B♭ **D♭7** F B

B **B♭–7** D♭ A♭ **E♭7** G D♭ **A♭6** C F **D♭7** F B **C7** E B♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F minor, C7 = F harmonic minor

F minor pentatonic and blues scale on the F– bars; on C7, E natural with D♭ (F harmonic minor). The D♭7 – C7 slide: D♭7's F/C♭ falls to C7's E /B♭. Berlin's melody is a minor arpeggio shifted across the bar; shift your own three-note cell the same way.

B

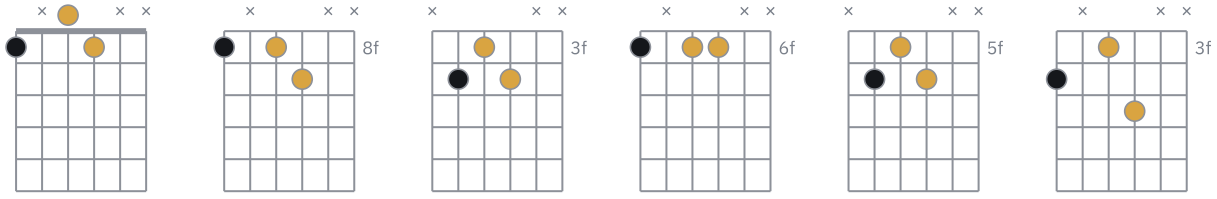
Relative major A♭: ii–V–I twice

B♭ dorian, E♭ mixolydian and A♭ major are one scale: **A♭ major** . Play sunlight for seven bars, then D♭7 – C7 slams the door back to F–; land on E for the C7.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bar 4–5 as one bar C7 and one bar F– in some charts · bridge ending as D♭7 | C7 over two bars.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



F– F A♭ C

C7 C E G B♭

D♭7 D♭ F A♭ B

B♭–7 B♭ D♭ F A♭

E♭7 E♭ G B♭ D♭

A♭6 A♭ C E♭ F

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · F minor pent F A♭ B♭ C E♭

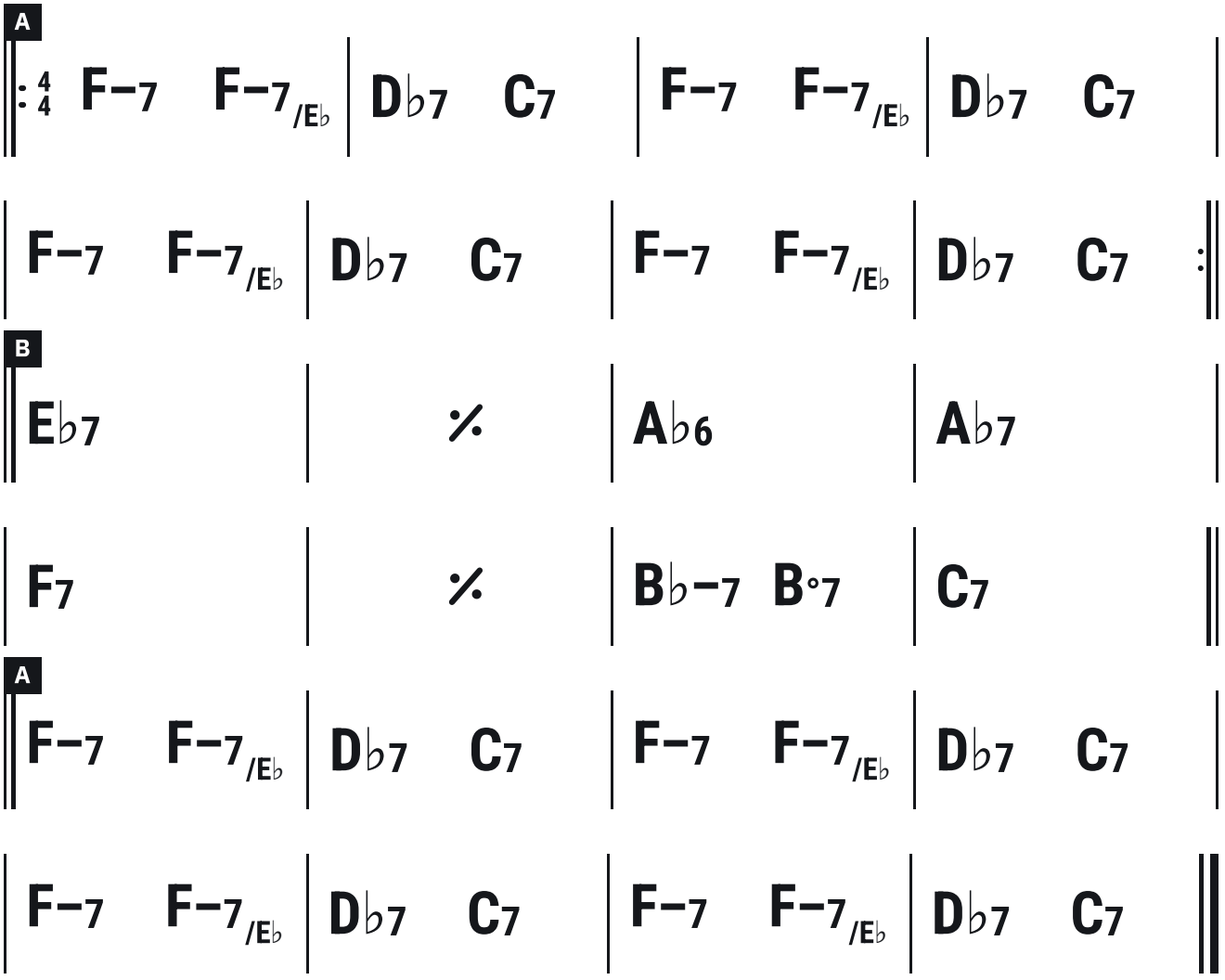
A, over C7 · F harmonic minor F G A♭ B♭ C D♭ E

B · A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

(Up Swing)

Ridin' and Jivin'

Earl Hines, your band's chart



Key **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Fast lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **150 bpm** Written **1939**

Ridin' and Jivin' · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Two chords a bar: F–7, F–7/E♭ (the F–7 shape; the bass has the E♭), D♭7, C7: half-note strums on the loop, four to the bar if the band opens up.
- Bridge: E♭7 | E♭7 | A♭6 | A♭7 | F7 | F7 | B♭–7 B°7 | C7: a shape a bar, the B°7 passing between B♭–7 and C7.
- The 8-bar post-intro vamp is the loop with the horns riffing: play it as a riff (the same rhythm every bar), not as sustained chords.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **F–7** A♭ E♭ **F–7/E♭** A♭ E♭ **D♭7** F B **C7** E B♭

B **E♭7** G D♭ **A♭6** C F **A♭7** C G♭ **F7** A E♭ **B♭–7** D♭ A♭ **B°7** D A♭ **C7** E B♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

F minor over a four-chord loop

F minor pentatonic and blues scale all the way; the loop's bass line F – E♭ – D♭ – C is the hook. Name the chords when you want to: D♭ on D♭7, E natural on C7, then back to A♭.

B

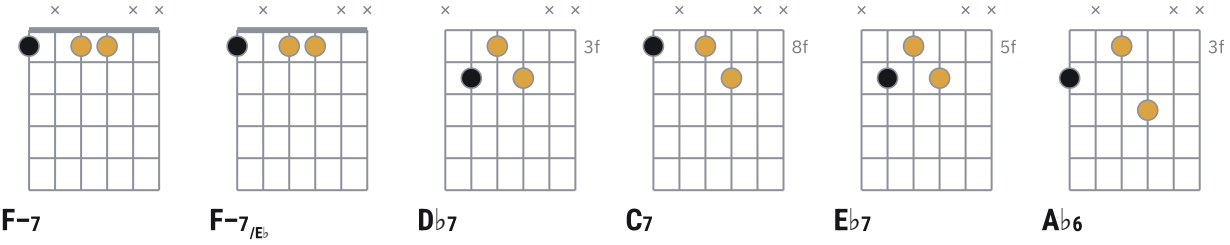
♭VII7 → ♭III → I7 → iv → V

E♭7: E♭ mixolydian (D♭ , G). A♭ then A♭7 (G♭). F7 is the surprise: A natural, two bars of major in a minor tune. B♭–7 B°7 C7: D♭ → D → E , a chromatic climb into the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Your chart is the source. Hines's record has more passing chords in the bridge; the bass line is the same.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



F–7 F A♭ C E♭

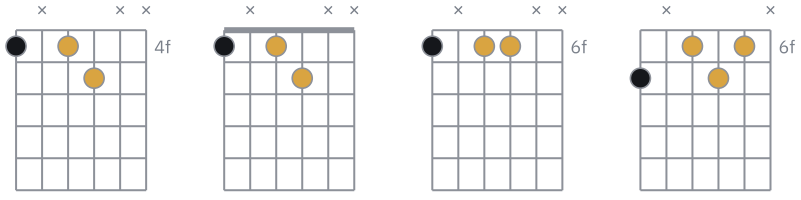
F–7/E♭ F A♭ C E♭

D♭7 D♭ F A♭ B

C7 C E G B♭

E♭7 E♭ G B♭ D♭

A♭6 A♭ C E♭ F



A♭7 A♭ C E♭ G♭

F7 F A C E♭

B♭–7 B♭ D♭ F A♭

B°7 B D F A♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · F minor pent F A♭ B♭ C E♭

A · F blues scale F A♭ B♭ B C E♭

B · A♭ major pent (E♭7, A♭) A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

B bars 5–6 · F major pent (F7) F G A C D

(Medium Swing)

Satin Doll

Duke Ellington & Billy Strayhorn



Key **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / slow swing** Dance tempo **130–160 bpm** Written **1953**

Satin Doll · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Two chords a bar, half-note shells: D–7 G7 | D–7 G7 | E–7 A7 | E–7 A7 | A–7 D7 | A♭–7 D♭7 | C6: the ii–V shapes move up a step, then a half step.
- A♭–7 D♭7 are the A–7 D7 shapes one fret lower (4th fret on the 6th and 5th strings): one position for both bars.
- Bridge: G–7 C7 | G–7 C7 | F6 | F6 | A–7 D7 | A–7 D7 | G7 | G7: plain, in Charleston rhythm with the piano.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	D–7	F C	G7	B F	E–7	G D	A7	C♯ G	A–7	C G	D7	F♯ C	A♭–7	B G♭	D♭7	F B	C6	E A
B	G–7	B♭ F	C7	E B♭	F6	A D	A–7	C G	D7	F♯ C	G7	B F						

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A **Think the target key of each ii–V**

D–7 G7: C major pentatonic. E–7 A7: D major pentatonic (C♯ , F♯). A–7 D7: G major pentatonic (F♯). A♭–7 D♭7: G♭ major pentatonic (C♭ , F), which lands you a half step above C so the resolution is physical. Then C.

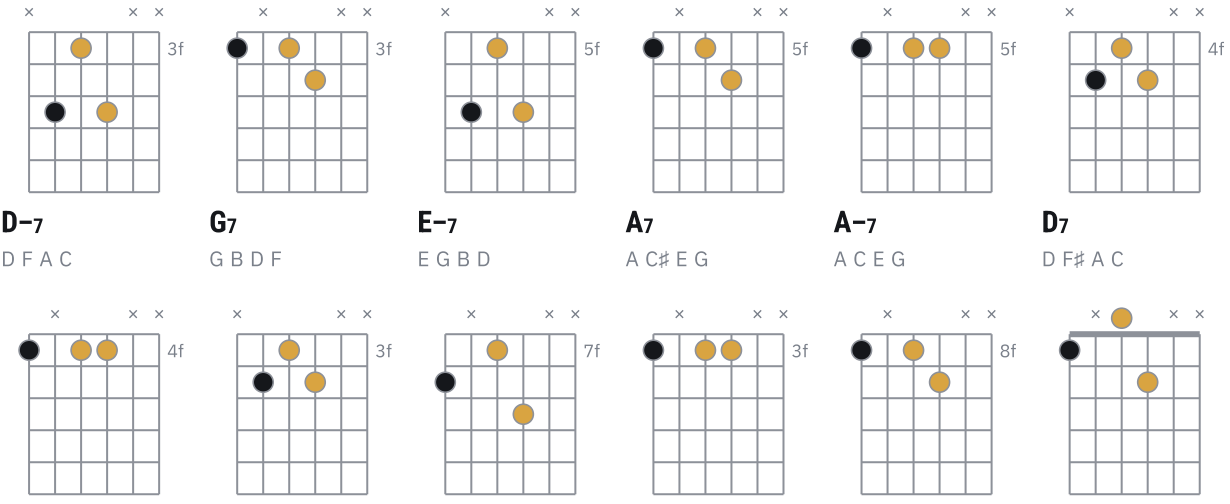
B **F major, then G major, then V**

G–7 C7 F: F major pentatonic (B♭ on the C7). A–7 D7: G major pentatonic (F♯). Two bars of G7: F natural, and leave space for the drummer.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

First-A bar 8 as E–7 A7 · bar 6 as D–7 G7 (the sheet) instead of the tritone sub · bridge bars 7–8 as D–7 G7 | D–7 G7.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



D–7 D F A C

G7 G B D F

E–7 E G B D

A7 A C♯ E G

A–7 A C E G

D7 D F♯ A C

A♭–7 A♭ B E♭ G♭

D♭7 D♭ F A♭ B

C6 C E G A

G–7 G B♭ D F

C7 C E G B♭

F6 F A C D

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

D–7 G7 · C major pent C D E G A

E–7 A7 · D major pent D E F♯ A B

A–7 D7 · G major pent G A B D E
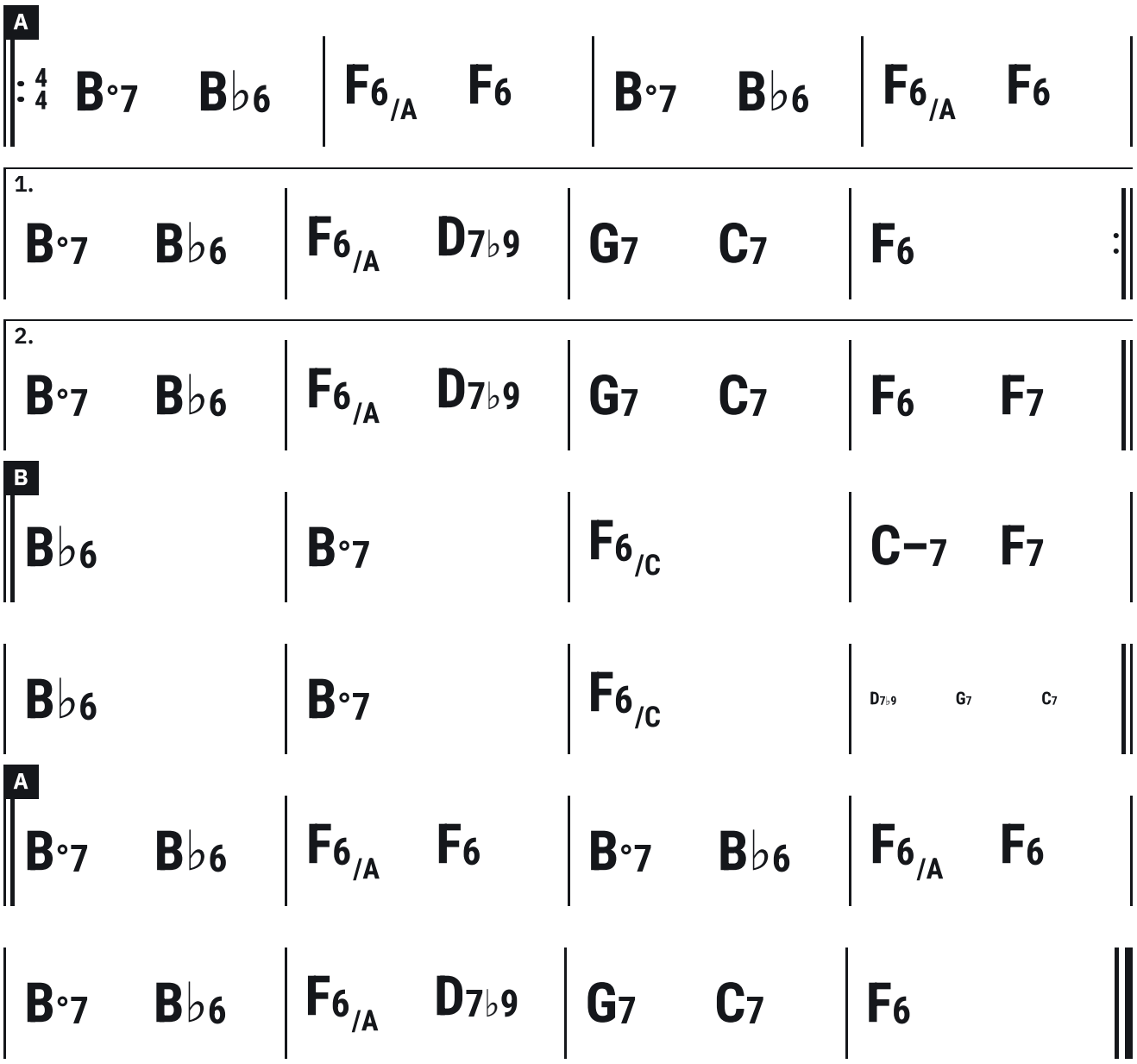
A♭–7 D♭7 · G♭ major pent G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭ E♭

B · F major pent F G A C D

(Medium Swing)

A Smooth One

Benny Goodman & Charlie Christian



Key **F** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lazy lindy** Dance tempo **120 bpm** Written **1941**

A Smooth One · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Christian's riff on the low strings is the tune: walk the 6th string B – B♭ – A – F under three-note shells (B°7 B♭6 | F6/A F6), four to the bar at 120.
- Bridge: B♭6 | B°7 | F6/C | C–7 F7 | B♭6 | B°7 | F6/C | D7♭9 G7 C7: the same riff from IV; the last bar is three chords, one beat, one beat, two beats.
- The tag (F6 | G7 C7 | F6 | G7 C7 | F6) has a no-chord pickup bar: stop with the band and come back on the F6.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	B°7	D A♭	B♭6	D G	F6/A	A D	F6	A D	D7♭9	E♭ F♯ C	G7	B F	C7	E B♭	F7	A E♭
B	B♭6	D G	B°7	D A♭	F6/C	A D	C–7	E♭ B♭	F7	A E♭	D7♭9	E♭ F♯ C	G7	B F	C7	E B♭

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A **F major over a walking bass riff**

F major pentatonic; the riff's bass B – B♭ – A – F is the melody's shadow, so play it in the left hand and solo above it. B°7 is a G7♭9 in disguise: B natural. D7♭9 → F♯ and E♭; G7 → B; C7 → E.

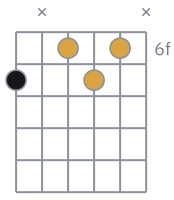
B **The riff from IV, then three dominants in a bar**

B♭ major pentatonic over B♭6, B°7 and F6/C; C–7 F7 is a backdoor ii–V back to B♭ (E♭). The last bar, D7♭9 G7 C7: F♯ B E, one per chord, on the beat.

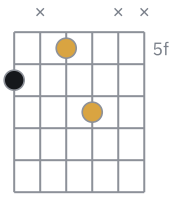
VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Jam charts read the A as F | F7/C B°7 | B♭–6 F/A: B♭–6 is the ear's version of your B♭6 under the melody's D natural · session key F; the Goodman/Christian record may be in A♭.

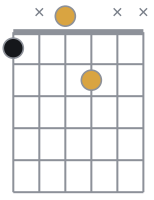
EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



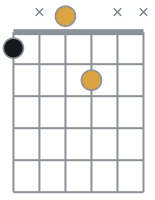
B°7
B D F A♭



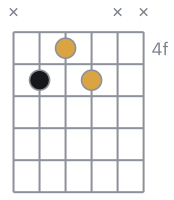
B♭6
B♭ D F G



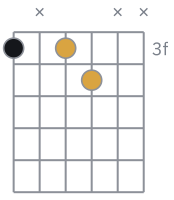
F6/A
F A C D



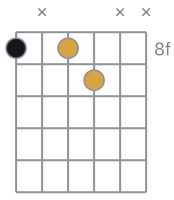
F6
F A C D



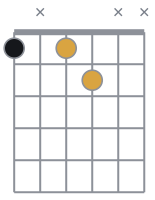
D7♭9
D E♭ F♯ A C



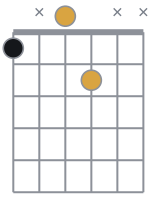
G7
G B D F



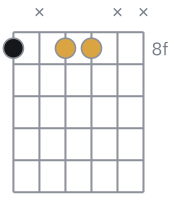
C7
C E G B♭



F7
F A C E♭



F6/C
F A C D



C–7
C E♭ G B♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · F major pent F G A C D

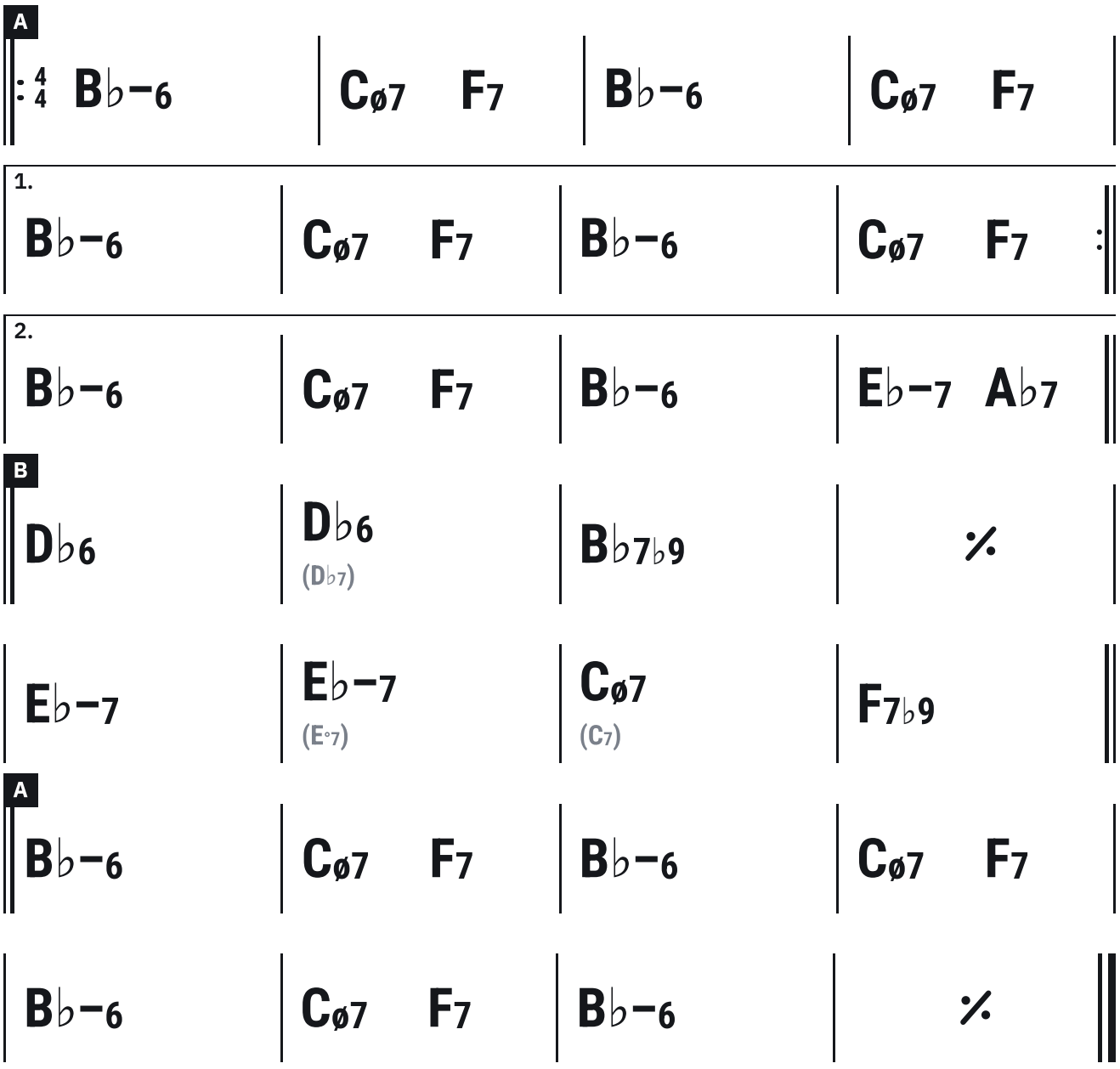
A · F blues scale F A♭ B♭ B C E♭

B · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

(Latin / Swing)

Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise

Sigmund Romberg



Key **B♭−** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Balboa 180–210 · Lindy** Dance tempo **160–190 bpm** Written **1928**

Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Three shapes: B♭–6 (6th string, 6th fret), Cø7 (6th string, 8th fret), F7 (5th string, 8th fret): the whole A is these, one bar each.
- Latin on the A: straight eighths, a chord stab on the 'and' of 2 and on 4; swing four to the bar on the bridge.
- Bridge: D♭6 | D♭6 | B♭7 | B♭7 | E♭–7 | E♭–7 | Cø7 | F7: plain 7 shapes for the ♭9 chords; the piano has the colour.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**B♭–6**	D♭ G	**Cø7**	E♭ G♭ B♭	**F7**	A E♭	**E♭–7**	G♭ D♭	**A♭7**	C G♭			
B	**D♭6**	F B♭	**B♭7♭9**	B D A♭	**E♭–7**	G♭ D♭	**Cø7**	E♭ G♭ B♭	**F7♭9**	G♭ A E♭			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

One minor ii–V–i, eight times

B♭–6 = B♭ melodic minor / B♭ dorian; the G natural is the MJQ colour. F7 = B♭ harmonic minor: G♭ and A. Or do what the MJQ did and treat the A as one B♭ minor zone: B♭ minor pentatonic and blues scale straight across, resolving to D♭ or F on each B♭–6. Tritone sub to try: G♭7 for Cø7–F7.

B

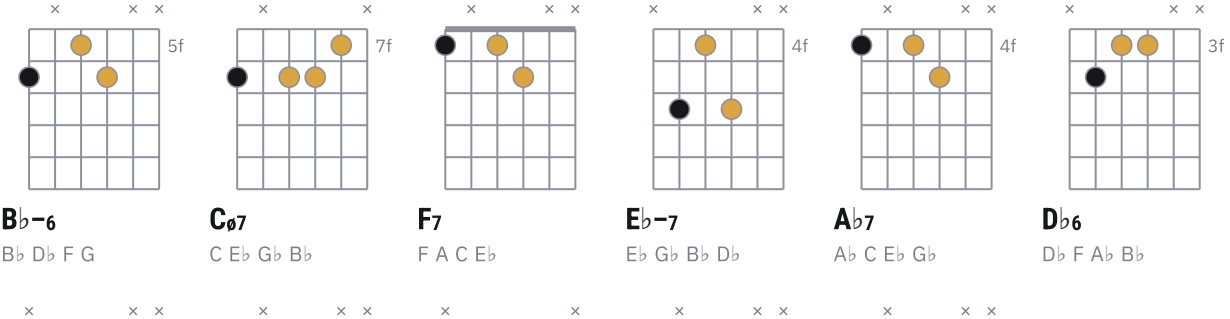
Relative major: D♭ → B♭7♭9 → E♭– → C7 → F7♭9

D♭ major for two bars. B♭7♭9 = E♭ harmonic minor (D natural, C♭, G♭) pulling to E♭–7 (E♭ dorian, G♭ major). Then C7 / Cø7 (E or E♭) into F7♭9 (A + G♭) and back to B♭–. Target 3rds: F → D → G♭ → E → A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bridge in the original sheet (transposed): D♭ | D♭ D♭7/C♭ | B♭7♭9 | B♭7♭9 | E♭– E♭–/D♭ | C7 | F7♭9 | F7♭9 · learnjazzstandards sub: D♭ | Fø7 B♭7 | E♭–7 | Gø7 C7 | F7 · session key C–: everything a whole step up.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



B♭–6 B♭ D♭ F G

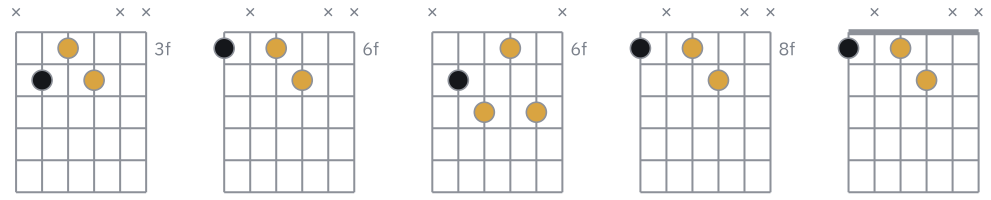
Cø7 C E♭ G♭ B♭

F7 F A C E♭

E♭–7 E♭ G♭ B♭ D♭

A♭7 A♭ C E♭ G♭

D♭6 D♭ F A♭ B♭



D♭7 D♭ F A♭ B

B♭7♭9 B♭ B D F A♭

E°7 E G B♭ D♭

C7 C E G B♭

F7♭9 F G♭ A C E♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · B♭ minor pent B♭ D♭ E♭ F A♭

A, over F7 · B♭ harmonic minor B♭ C D♭ E♭ F G♭ A

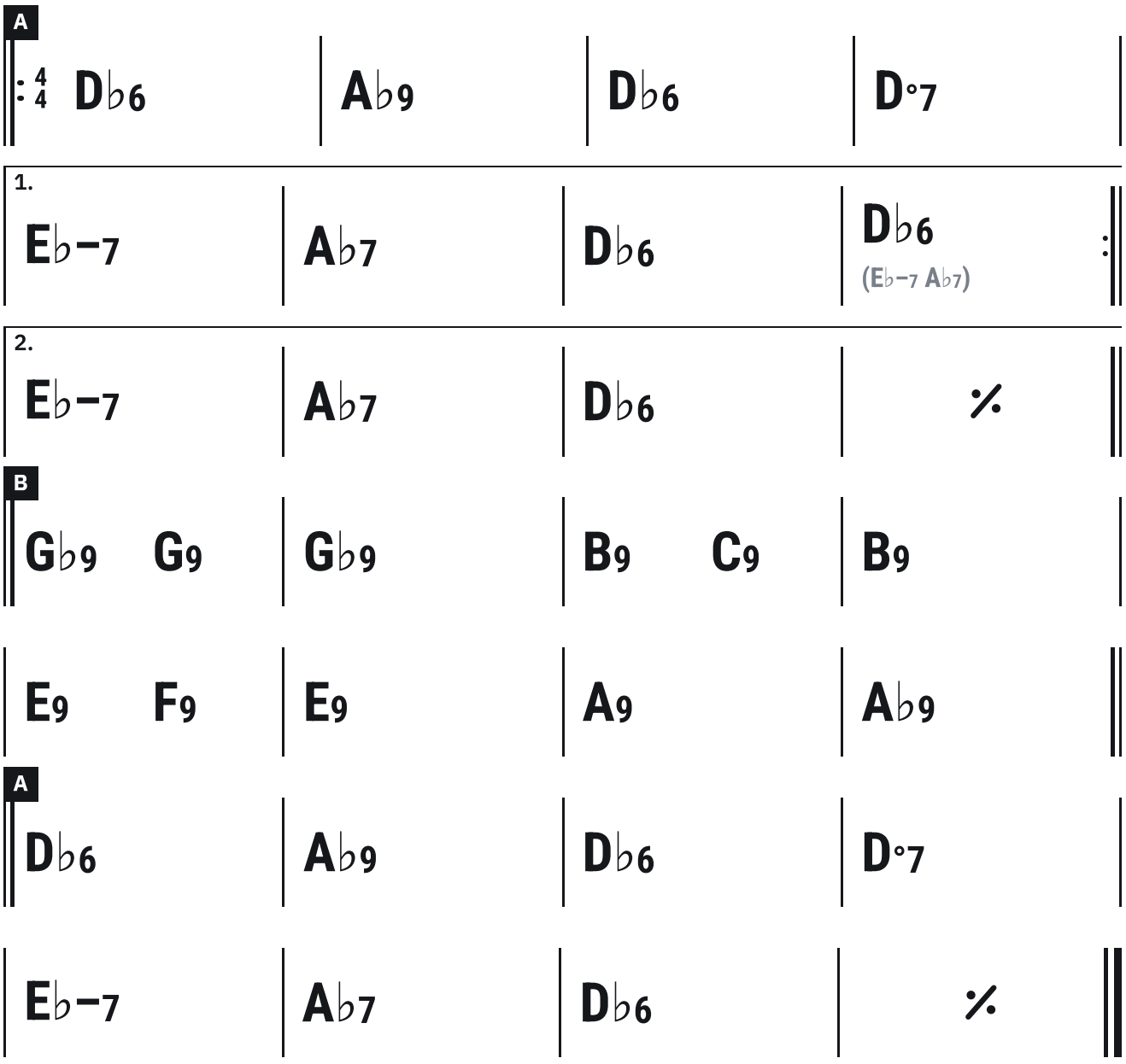
B bars 1–2 · D♭ major pent D♭ E♭ F A♭ B♭

B bars 5–6 · E♭ minor pent E♭ G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭

(Medium Swing)

Stompin' at the Savoy

Edgar Sampson



Key **D♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy 160–190 · Balboa** Dance tempo **190–220 bpm** Written **1934**

Stompin' at the Savoy · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- Four to the bar as a riff figure on D♭6 and A♭7; at Balboa tempo that is the whole A.
- Bridge: G♭7 (G7 push) | G♭7 | B7 (C7) | B7 | E7 (F7) | E7 | A7 | A♭7: the push chord on beats 3–4 is a half-step slide up and back; play it with the piano or leave it.
- D°7 in bar 4 (5th-string shape, 5th fret) and E♭–7 A♭7 in bars 5–6 are the out-chorus changes; stay on D♭6 A♭7 for the head.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	D♭6	F B♭	A♭9	C G♭	D°7	F B	E♭–7	G♭ D♭	A♭7	C G♭									
B	G♭9	B♭ E	G9	B F	B9	D♯ A	C9	E B♭	E9	G♯ D	F9	A E♭	A9	C♯ G	A♭9	C G♭			

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

D♭ major, start to finish

It's a riff tune: D♭ major pentatonic plus the blue E (♭3) covers the whole A. On bar 4, D°7 wants D and B (or think A♭7♭9). Bars 5–6 are a plain ii–V back to D♭.

B

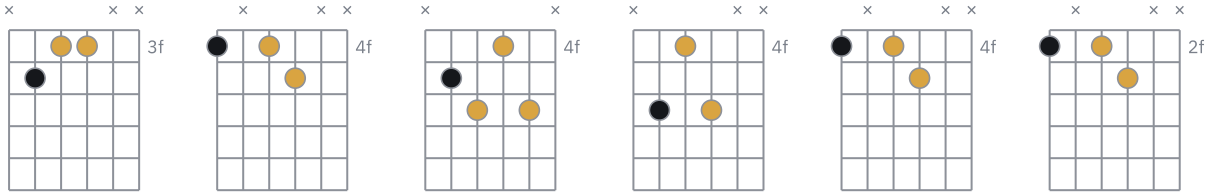
G♭7 → B7 → E7 → A7 → A♭7

Dominants dropping a fourth. Mixolydian on each. Target the 3rds: B♭ D♯ G♯ C♯ C. The 3rd/7th pairs each fall a half step: B♭/E → A/D♯ → G♯/D → G/C♯ → G♭/C. Play that line alone once and you'll never lose the bridge again.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bar 2 as D♭6 A♭7 · bars 7–8 as D♭6 B♭–7 | E♭–7 A♭7 (the Clifford Brown/Max Roach version).

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



D♭6 D♭ F A♭ B♭

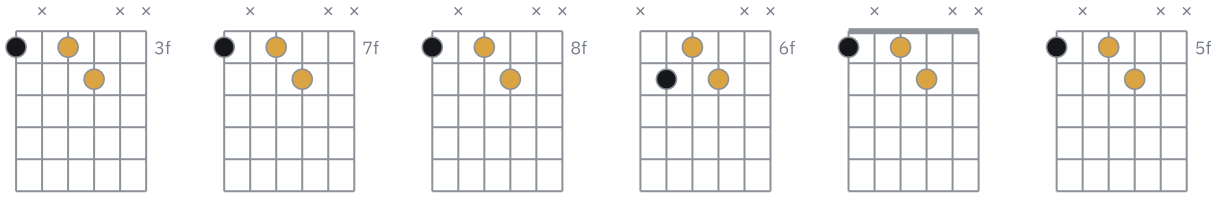
A♭9 A♭ B♭ C E♭ G♭

D°7 D F A♭ B

E♭–7 E♭ G♭ B♭ D♭

A♭7 A♭ C E♭ G♭

G♭9 G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭ E



G9 G A B D F

B9 B C♯ D♯ F♯ A

C9 C D E G B♭

E9 E F♯ G♯ B D

F9 F G A C E♭

A9 A B C♯ E G

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · D♭ major pent D♭ E♭ F A♭ B♭

A · D♭ blues scale D♭ E G♭ G A♭ B

B · G♭7: G♭ major pent G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭ E♭

B · B7: B major pent B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯

B · E7: E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

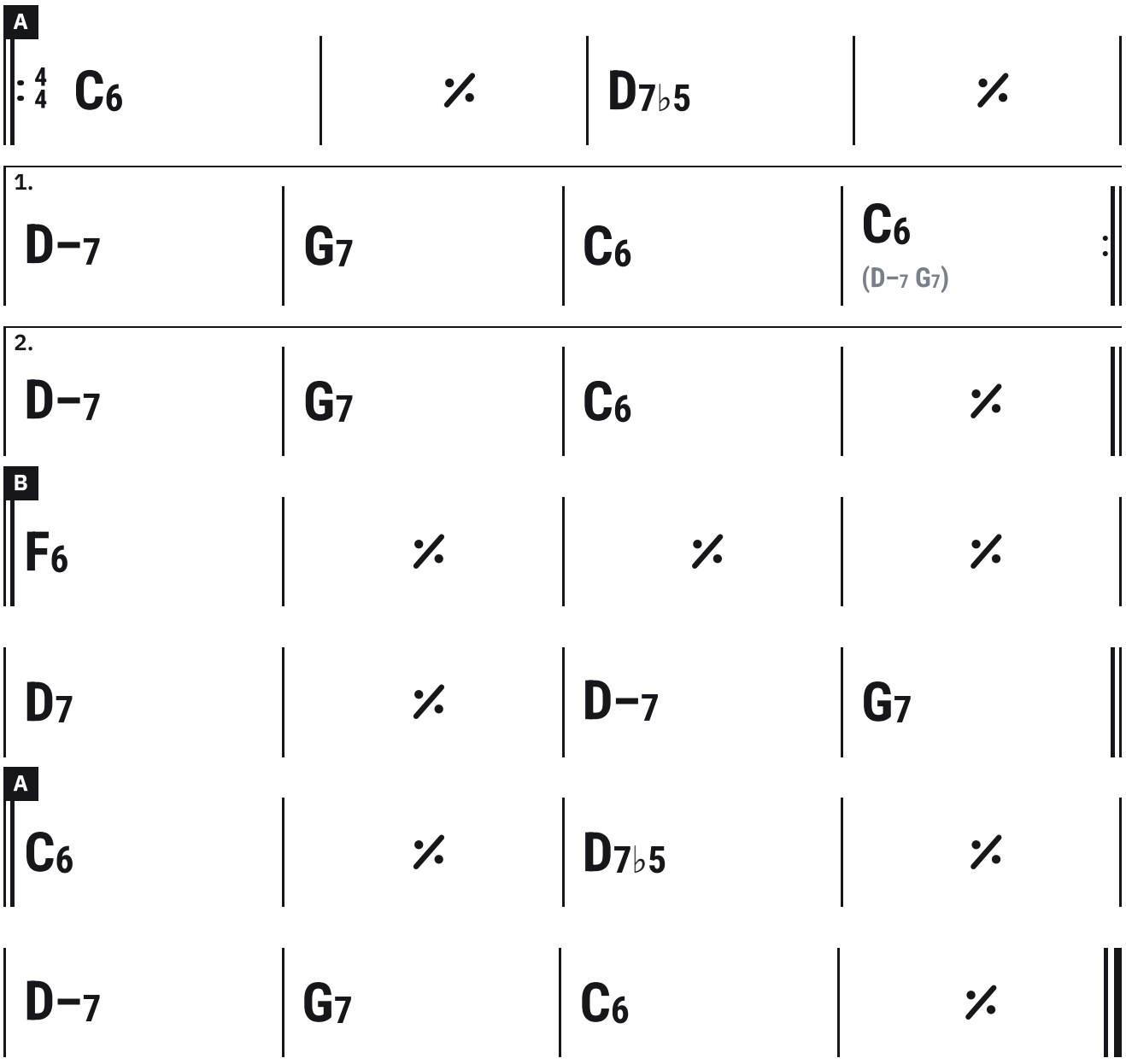
B · A7: A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

B · A♭7: A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

(Medium Up Swing)

Take the “A” Train

Billy Strayhorn



Key **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1941**

Take the “A” Train · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- C6 for two bars, D7♭5 for two (the four-note 7♭5 shape, 5th string, 5th fret), D–7 G7, C6: six shapes for the whole A, four to the bar.
- Bridge: F6 for four bars, D7 for two, D–7 G7: the D7♭5's A♭ becomes a plain A on the bridge's D7.
- Intro is Strayhorn's piano figure: lay out for four bars, enter on bar 1 of the head with the band.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	**C6**	E A	**D7♭5**	F♯ A♭ C	**D–7**	F C	**G7**	B F
B	**F6**	A D	**D7**	F♯ C	**D–7**	F C	**G7**	B F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C major, with one special chord

Bars 1–2: C major pentatonic. Bars 3–4 are the tune's sound: D lydian dominant (D E F♯ **G♯** A B C), the **F♯** and **G♯** together. Bars 5–8: plain ii–V–I in C.

B

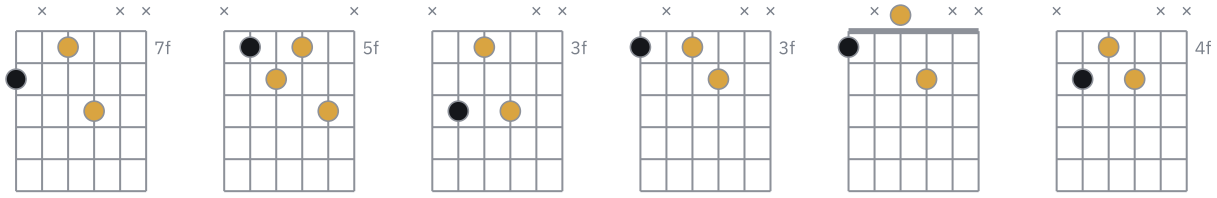
F major (IV), then D7 home

Four bars of F major; then D7 where **F♯** is the money note (C♯ for lydian colour), into D–7 G7 and back to C.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 3–4 as D9♯11 · bridge bars 5–6 as D7 | D7♭9 · some charts split A1's last bar as C6 A7 | D–7 G7.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



C6 C E G A

D7♭5 D F♯ A♭ C

D–7 D F A C

G7 G B D F

F6 F A C D

D7 D F♯ A C

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · C major pent C D E G A

A bars 3–4 · D7♭5 + E D F♯ A♭ C E
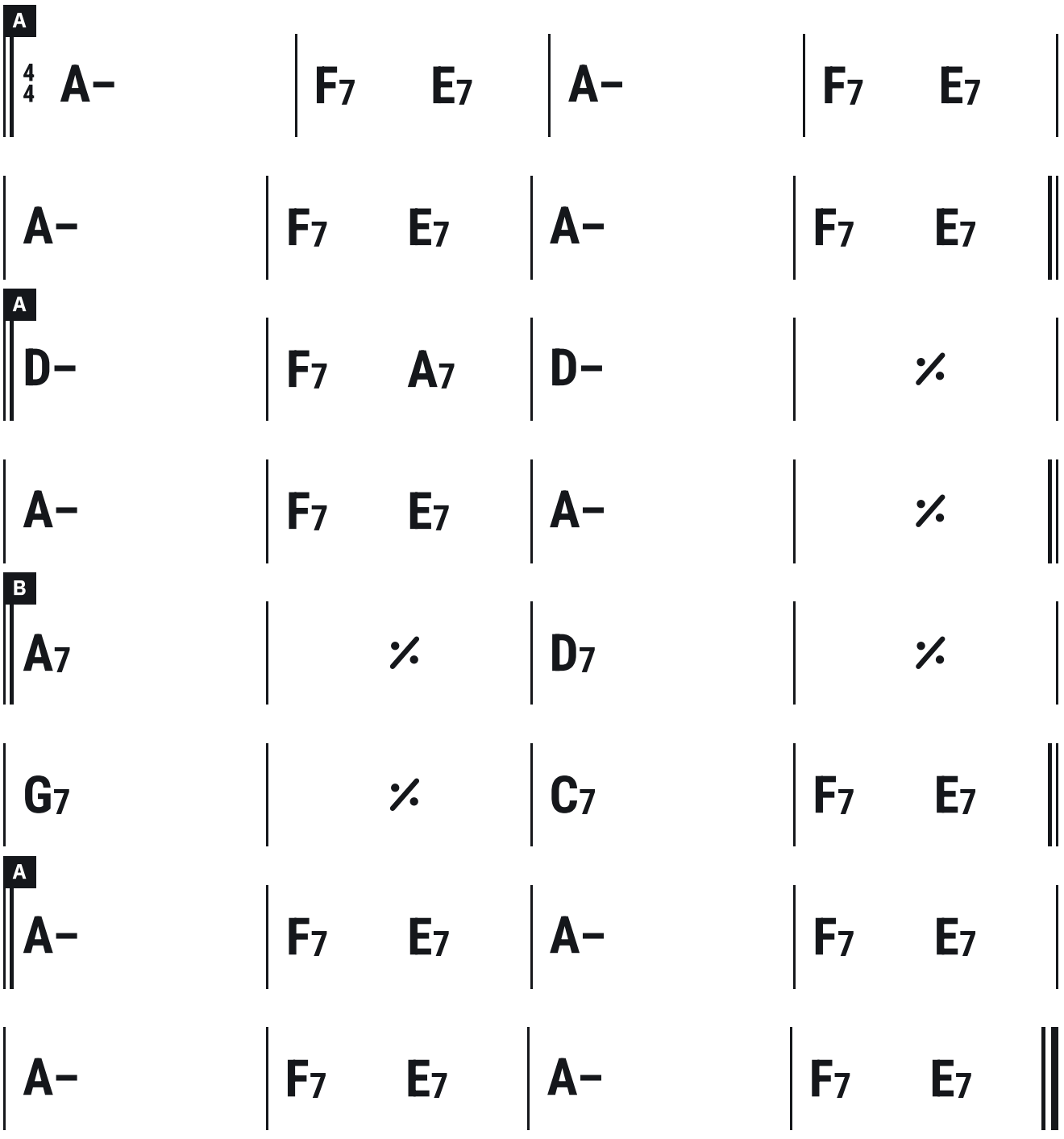
B · F major pent F G A C D

B · D7: D major pent D E F♯ A B

(Medium Up Swing)

Topsy

Eddie Durham & Edgar Battle (for Count Basie)



Key **A–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **165–200 bpm** Written **1937**

Topsy · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- A–6 (6th string, 5th fret) four to the bar on the riff bars; F7 (6th string, 1st fret) and E7 (5th string, 7th fret) as two beats each on the even bars.
- Second A: D–6 for four bars (F7 A7 in bar 10), then A–6 again; the bridge is A7 D7 G7 C7 two bars each, then F7 E7.
- Charlie Christian's 'Swing to Bop' is on these changes: his comping on the Minton's recording (four to the bar, riff accents) is the model.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A **A–** C E **F7** A E♭ **E7** G♯ D **D–** F A **A7** C♯ G

B **A7** C♯ G **D7** F♯ C **G7** B F **C7** E B♭ **F7** A E♭ **E7** G♯ D

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

A minor, with F7 E7 every other bar

A minor pentatonic and the A blues scale carry the riff bars. The F7 E7 bars are a ♭VI7 → V7 slide: E♭ (the 7th of F7) sliding to D (7th of E7), and G♯ on the E7 (A harmonic minor). The second A's D– bars: D minor pentatonic, with C♯ on the A7 in bar 10.

B

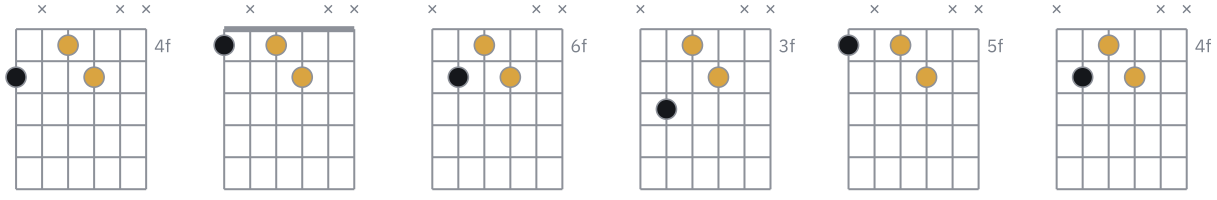
Cycle of dominants: A7 → D7 → G7 → C7, then F7 E7

Two bars each, by their 3rds: C♯ (A7), F♯ (D7), B (G7), E (C7). It's the I Got Rhythm bridge moved up a 5th, so the same lines work. The horns' pickup figure (♯7 – 1 – 2 of each dominant) is the melody; quote it. Bar 24's F7 E7 is the slide home.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

The F7 E7 bars as plain E7 at fast tempos · the second A's D– bars as D–6 · bridge played as A7 | A7 | D7 | D7 | G7 | G7 | C7 | C7 with the F7 E7 moved into the pickup bar · last bar as A– when the tune ends.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



A– A C E

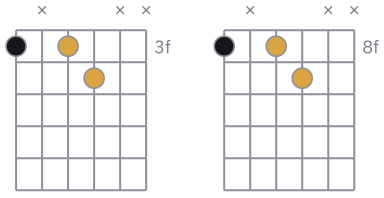
F7 F A C E♭

E7 E G♯ B D

D– D F A

A7 A C♯ E G

D7 D F♯ A C



G7 G B D F

C7 C E G B♭

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · A minor pent A C D E G

A · A blues scale A C D E♭ E G

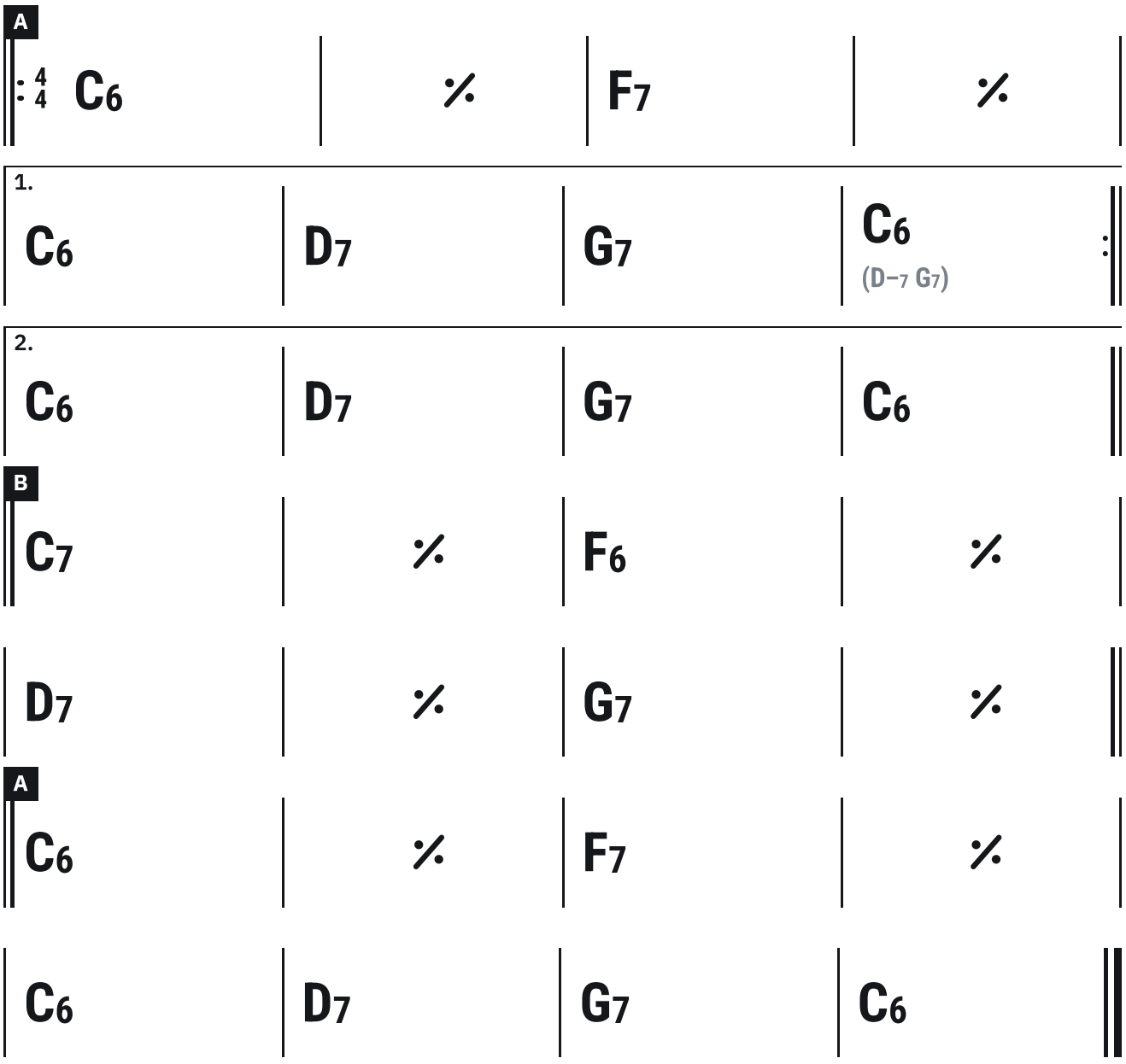
2nd A · D minor pent D F G A C

B · A major pent (then D, G, C) A B C♯ E F♯

(Medium Up Swing)

Undecided

Charlie Shavers



Key **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1938**

Undecided · Guitar

HOW TO PLAY IT · Guitar

- C6 for two bars, F7 for two, C6, D7, G7, C6: six shapes, four to the bar, with a Charleston accent (1 and the 'and' of 2) on the head with the piano.
- Answer the horns' phrase in bars 2 and 4 with a two-beat stab with the piano, then back to four.
- Bridge: C7 | C7 | F6 | F6 | D7 | D7 | G7 | G7: two bars a chord, plain.

KEY NOTES FOR SOLOS · the 3rd and 7th (or 6th) of every chord: land these and the change is heard

A	C6	E A	F7	A E♭	D7	F♯ C	G7	B F
B	C7	E B♭	F6	A D	D7	F♯ C	G7	B F

SOLO MAP · WHAT TO LEAN ON

A

C major with a blues IV

C major pentatonic plus the C blues scale; on the F7 bars play E♭ (its ♭7) against the band. D7 wants F♯, G7 wants F; that's the whole A.

B

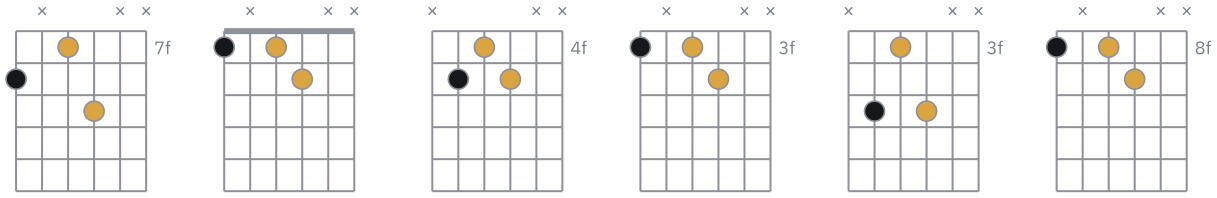
C7 → F → D7 → G7

C mixolydian (B♭) for two, F major for two, D7 (F♯ , C♯ for lydian colour) for two, G7 home. Same bridge as Sunny Side of the Street, so solos transfer.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–7 as D–7 | B♭7 A♭7 | G7 (the chromatic walk-down in the Ames Brothers / Kirby charts) · bar 8 turnaround optional · bridge bars 7–8 as G7 | A–7 D7 into the last A.

EVERY CHORD IN THE CHART · Freddie Green voicings on the low strings; the dark dot is the root



C6
C E G A

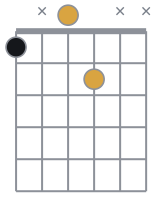
F7
F A C E♭

D7
D F♯ A C

G7
G B D F

D–7
D F A C

C7
C E G B♭



F6
F A C D

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · C major pent C D E G A

F7 bars · C blues scale C E♭ F G♭ G B♭

B · F major pent F G A C D

B · D7: D major pent D E F♯ A B

BASS

Concert pitch, with the chord tones (root, 3rd, 5th, 7th) of every chord.

#	TUNE	KEY	FORM	DANCE TEMPO
01	**Ain't Misbehavin'**	**E♭**	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
02	**All of Me**	**F**	A B A C · 32	150–190 bpm
03	**All the Things You Are**	**A♭**	A A′ B A″ · 36	150–190 bpm
04	**Autumn Leaves**	**C–**	A A B C · 32	100–180 bpm
05	**Battle of Jericho**	**F–**	AABA · 32	150–200 bpm
06	**Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen**	**C–**	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
07	**Blue Drag**	**D–**	AABA · 32	90–120 bpm
08	**Blue Moon**	**E♭**	AABA · 32	110–180 bpm
09	**Blue Skies**	**C– → E♭**	AABA · 32	150–190 bpm
10	**Comes Love**	**A–**	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
11	**Don't Get Around Much Anymore**	**C**	AABA · 32	130–180 bpm
12	**Honeysuckle Rose**	**F**	AABA · 32	150–190 bpm
13	**I Got Rhythm**	**B♭**	AABA · 32	200–240 bpm
14	**It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing)**	**G– → B♭**	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm
15	**Jumpin' at the Woodside**	**B♭**	AABA · 32	200–250 bpm
16	**Just Friends**	**G**	A B A B′ · 32	170–220 bpm
17	**Kansas City Stride**	**G–**	AABA · 32 + 8-bar intro	170–210 bpm
18	**Lester's Bounce**	**G–**	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
19	**Lullaby of Birdland**	**F– / A♭**	AABA · 32	150–200 bpm
20	**Moanin'**	**F–**	AABA · 32	100–125 bpm
21	**Oh, Lady Be Good**	**G**	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
22	**On the Sunny Side of the Street**	**C**	AABA · 32	110–140 bpm
23	**Perdido**	**B♭**	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm
24	**Puttin' On the Ritz**	**F– → A♭**	AABA · 32	200–240 bpm
25	**Ridin' and Jivin'**	**F–**	AABA · 32	150 bpm
26	**Satin Doll**	**C**	AABA · 32	130–160 bpm
27	**A Smooth One**	**F**	AABA · 32	120 bpm
28	**Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise**	**B♭–**	AABA · 32	160–190 bpm
29	**Stompin' at the Savoy**	**D♭**	AABA · 32	190–220 bpm
30	**Take the “A” Train**	**C**	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
31	**Topsy**	**A–**	AABA · 32	165–200 bpm
32	**Undecided**	**C**	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm

(Medium Swing)

Ain't Misbehavin'

Fats Waller, Harry Brooks & Andy Razaf



Key **E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written **1929**

Ain't Misbehavin' · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two-feel on the head (roots on 1 and 3) is the 1929 sound; walk in four for solos.
- Bar 1: E♭ then E natural (the °7 root) into F; bar 4: A♭, then A♭ again as the chord turns minor, so E♭ is your safe second note.
- Turnaround bars: G C | F B♭, the circle of fourths; on the last A play E♭ A♭ in bar 7 and land E♭.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 1 as E♭6 C7/E · bar 2 as F–7 F♯°7 · bar 3 as E♭6 G7 · first-A bar 7 as E♭6 C7 · bridge bars 5–6 as B♭6 | F7 in some charts.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

A · E♭ blues scale E♭ G♭ A♭ A B♭ D♭

B bars 1–2 · C minor pent C E♭ F G B♭

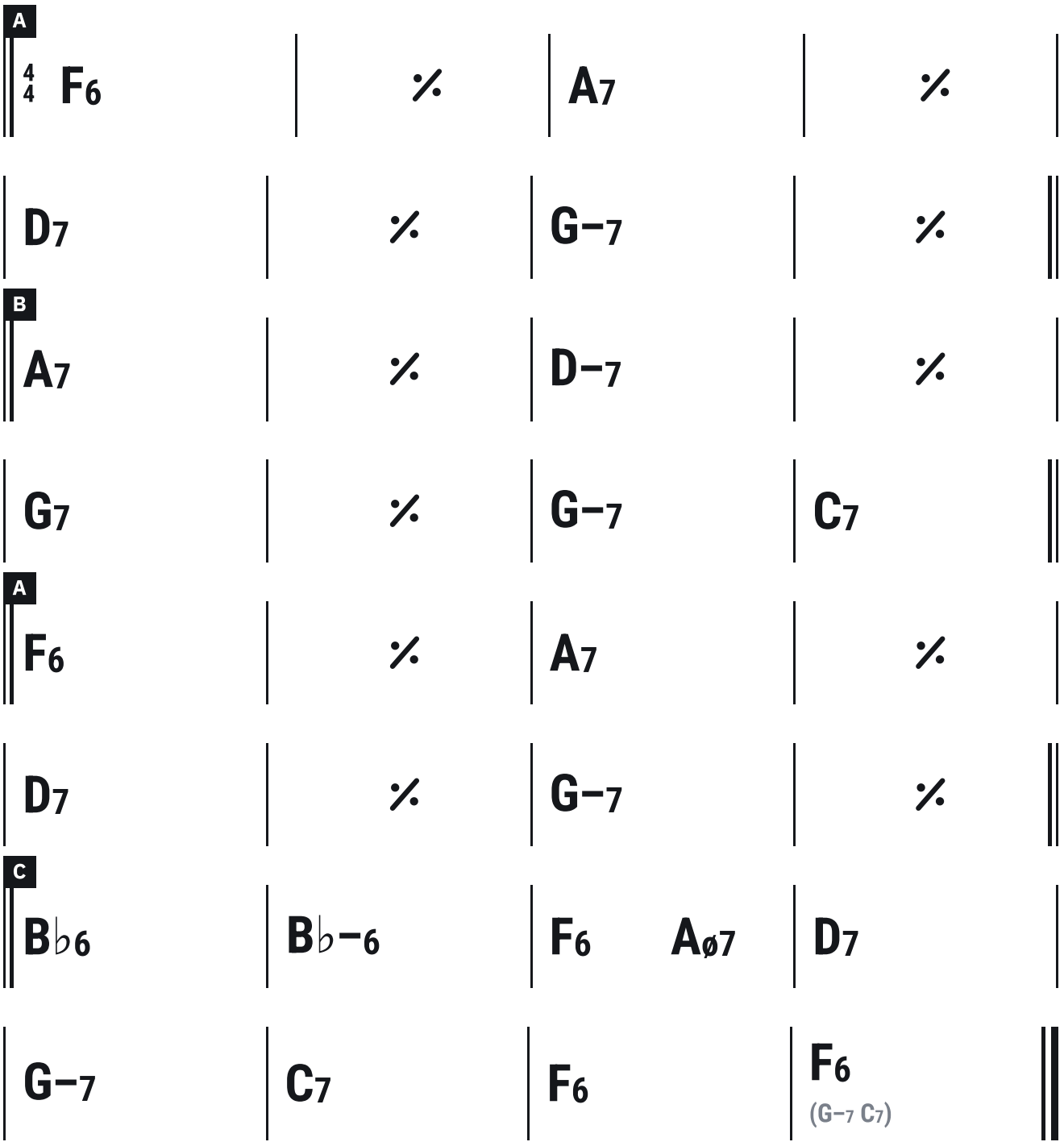
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

E♭6	E♭ G B♭ C
E°7	E G B♭ D♭
F–7	F A♭ C E♭
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
A♭6	A♭ C E♭ F
A♭–6	A♭ B E♭ F
C7	C E G B♭
G7	G B D F
F7	F A C E♭
C–	C E♭ G
A♭7	A♭ C E♭ G♭
C–7	C E♭ G B♭

(Medium Swing)

All of Me

Gerald Marks & Seymour Simons



Key **F** Form **A B A C · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1931**

All of Me · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two-feel on the head (F C | F C), walk in four for solos; two bars a chord gives room for a real line on A7 and D7.
- Through A7 → D7 → G–7 walk A C♯ E G | D F♯ A C | G: the 3rds on beat 2 make the changes audible.
- C section: B♭, B♭ again under the minor chord, F, A (Aø7), D, G, C, F; the tag is G–7 C7 | F6 three times with the singer.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 3–4 of the A as A7 | A7♭9 · C bars 3–4 as F6 | D7 (no Aø7) in older charts · the Real Book's key is C: everything a fourth down.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · F major pent F G A C D

B · D minor pent (A7 → D–) D F G A C

C · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

C · B♭ minor pent (B♭–6) B♭ D♭ E♭ F A♭

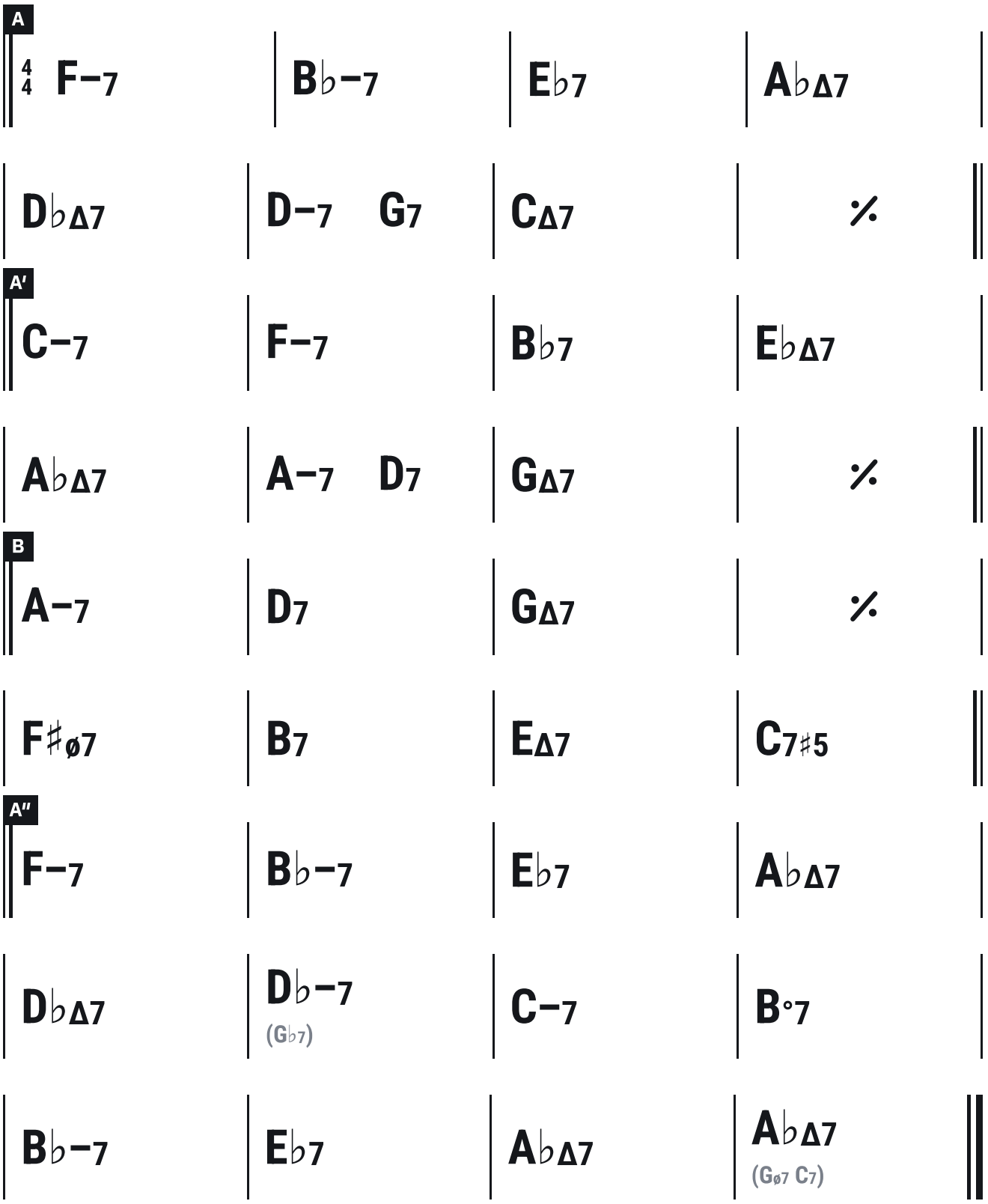
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

F6	F A C D
A7	A C♯ E G
D7	D F♯ A C
G–7	G B♭ D F
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
C7	C E G B♭
B♭6	B♭ D F G
B♭–6	B♭ D♭ F G
Aø7	A C E♭ G

(Medium Swing)

All the Things You Are

Jerome Kern & Oscar Hammerstein II



Key **A♭** Form **A A′ B A″ · 36** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1939**

All the Things You Are · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Four key centres: A♭ → C, E♭ → G, G → E, A♭. Walk the circle of fourths (F B♭ E♭ A♭ D♭) in two on the head and four for solos.
- Bars 29–32 are the bass line of the tune: D♭ – D♭ (the chord turns minor) – C – B, then B♭ E♭ A♭. Play it as written, half notes if the band is in two.
- The Gillespie intro (two chords a half step apart, eight bars) is a pedal: hold the root and let the piano move.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 30 as D♭–7 alone or as G♭7 · bar 24 as C7♭9 or C7alt · last bar's Gø7 C7 is the turnaround into the next chorus, dropped on the out chorus.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

Bars 1–5 · A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

Bars 6–8 · C major pent C D E G A

Bars 9–13 · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

Bars 14–20 · G major pent G A B D E

Bars 21–23 · E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

F–7	F A♭ C E♭
B♭–7	B♭ D♭ F A♭
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
A♭Δ7	A♭ C E♭ G
D♭Δ7	D♭ F A♭ C
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
CΔ7	C E G B
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
E♭Δ7	E♭ G B♭ D
A–7	A C E G
D7	D F♯ A C
GΔ7	G B D F♯
F♯ø7	F♯ A C E
B7	B D♯ F♯ A
EΔ7	E G♯ B D♯
C7♯5	C E G♯ B♭
D♭–7	D♭ E A♭ B
G♭7	G♭ B♭ D♭ E
B°7	B D F A♭
Gø7	G B♭ D♭ F
C7	C E G B♭

(Medium Swing)

Autumn Leaves (Les feuilles mortes)

Joseph Kosma (Prévert / Mercer)

A 4/4 F–7	B♭7	E♭Δ7	A♭Δ7
Dø7	G7	C–	𝄎
A F–7	B♭7	E♭Δ7	A♭Δ7
Dø7	G7	C–	𝄎
B Dø7	G7	C–	𝄎
F–7	B♭7	E♭Δ7	A♭Δ7
C Dø7	G7	C–7 F7	B♭–7 E♭7
A♭Δ7	Dø7 G7	C–	C– (Dø7 G7)

Key **C–** Form **A A B C · 32** Feel **Lindy / ballad** Dance tempo **100–180 bpm** Written **1945**

Autumn Leaves · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two-feel on the head: F B♭ | E♭ A♭ | D G | C: the roots fall in fourths all the way, the easiest walking tune in the book.
- In four for solos: approach each root from a half step above or below on beat 4 (A♭ into G, D♭ into C).
- C section: D G | C F | B♭ E♭ | A♭ | D G | C: the chain drops by whole steps; the ending is Dø7 G7 C– three times or your C alone.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 8 of each A as C–7 or C–6 · C bars 3–4 as C–7 F7 | F–7 B♭7 (a plain ii–V to E♭) · keys: G– (Real Book), E– (original), C– (here).

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A bars 1–4, B bars 5–8 · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

A bars 5–8 · C minor pent C E♭ F G B♭

over G7 · C harmonic minor C D E♭ F G A♭ B

C bars 3–5 · A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

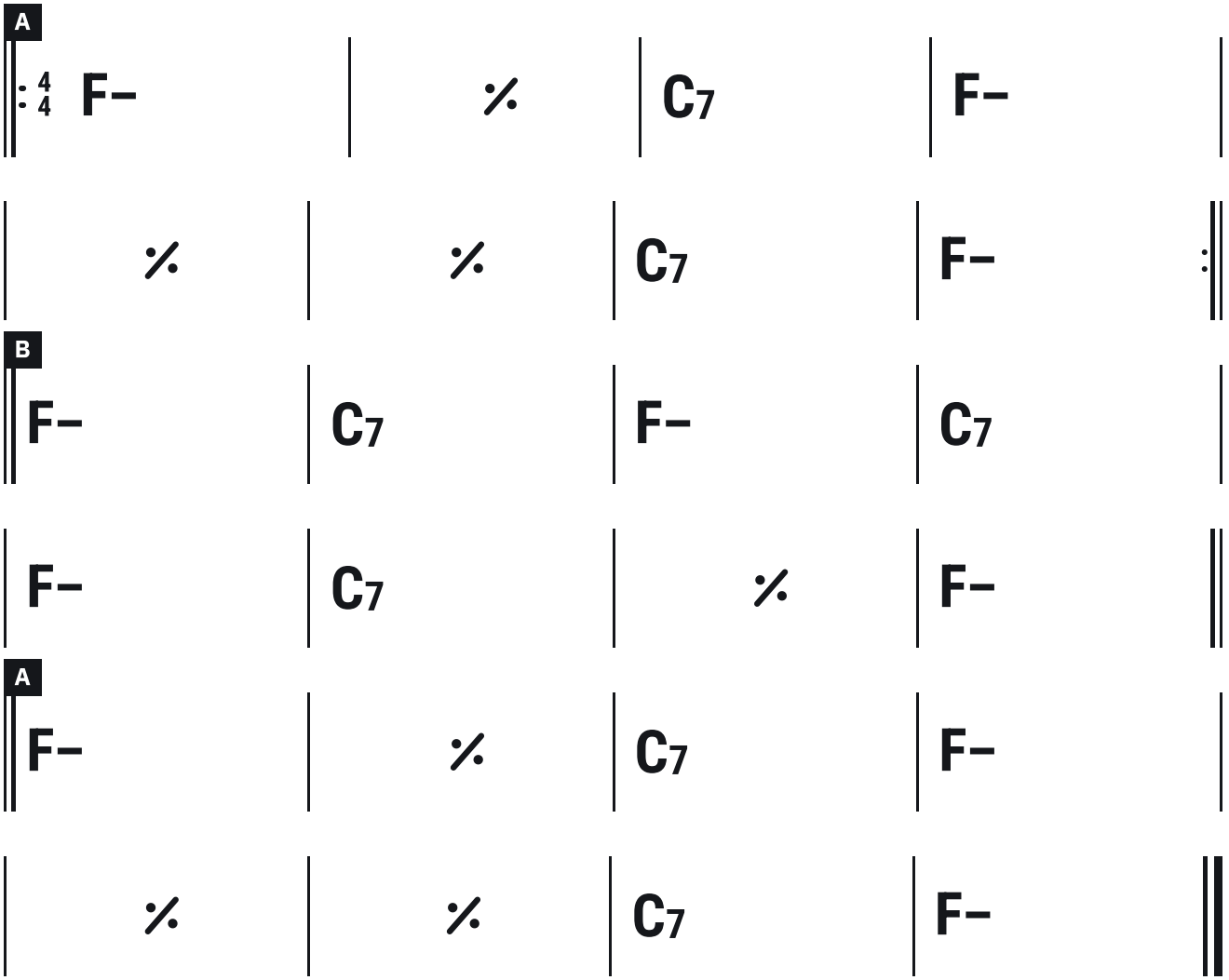
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

F–7	F A♭ C E♭
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
E♭Δ7	E♭ G B♭ D
A♭Δ7	A♭ C E♭ G
Dø7	D F A♭ C
G7	G B D F
C–	C E♭ G
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
B♭–7	B♭ D♭ F A♭
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭

(Medium Swing)

Battle of Jericho (Joshua Fit the Battle)

Traditional spiritual, your band's arrangement



Key **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–200 bpm** Written **trad.**

Battle of Jericho · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Walking bass alone opens the tune: four bars on F (F A♭ C E♭ or F G A♭ C), then the drums join.
- Two-feel on the head (F C | F C), walk in four for solos; on the C7 bars G is the safe second note, E natural the colour.
- The bridge drops to bass and snare: your line is the arrangement there, so play clearly and in time.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

B♭– (iv) in bar 3 of the A if the band wants a third chord · C7♭9 throughout · some bands play the B as F– | F– | C7 | C7 twice.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A, B · F minor pent F A♭ B♭ C E♭

A, B · F blues scale F A♭ B♭ B C E♭

over C7 · F harmonic minor F G A♭ B♭ C D♭ E

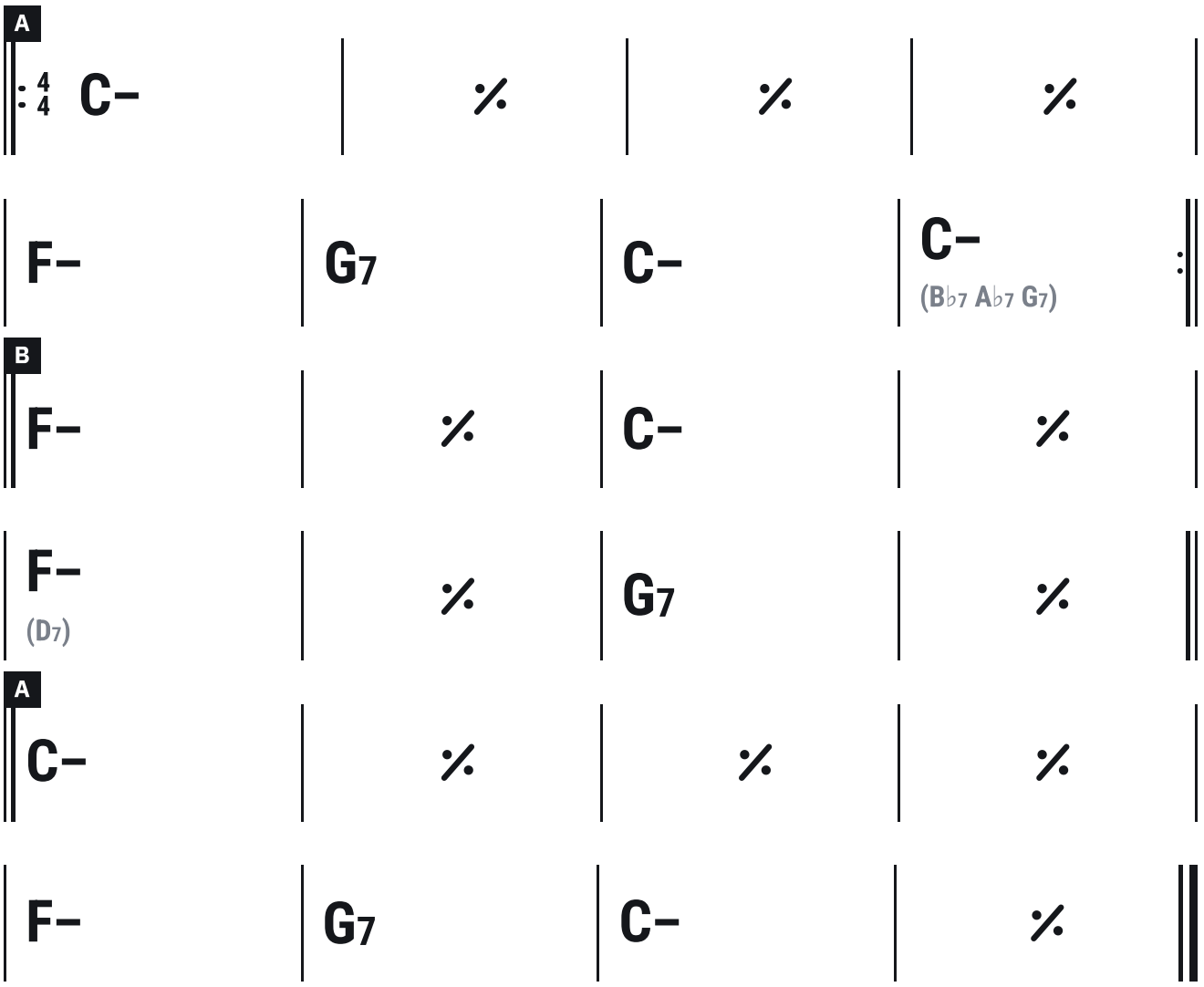
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

F–	F A♭ C
C7	C E G B♭

(Medium Swing)

Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen

Sholom Secunda



Key **C–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1932**

Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Bars 1–4 are your line: C – D – E♭ – F – G – F – E♭ – D, two beats each in two-feel or a bar each in four; everyone is listening for it.
- Bars 5–7: F, G (B natural on beat 3), C. Turnaround B♭ A♭ G in the last bar when the tempo allows.
- Bridge: F– for two bars, C– for two, twice; D7 (D, F♯) to G7 on the second pass if the band takes the II7–V7 option.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 as G7 | G7 · bridge bars 5–6 as D7 | D7 (II7–V7) · turnaround optional at speed.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · C minor pent	C E♭ F G B♭
A · C blues scale	C E♭ F G♭ G B♭
B · F minor pent	F A♭ B♭ C E♭

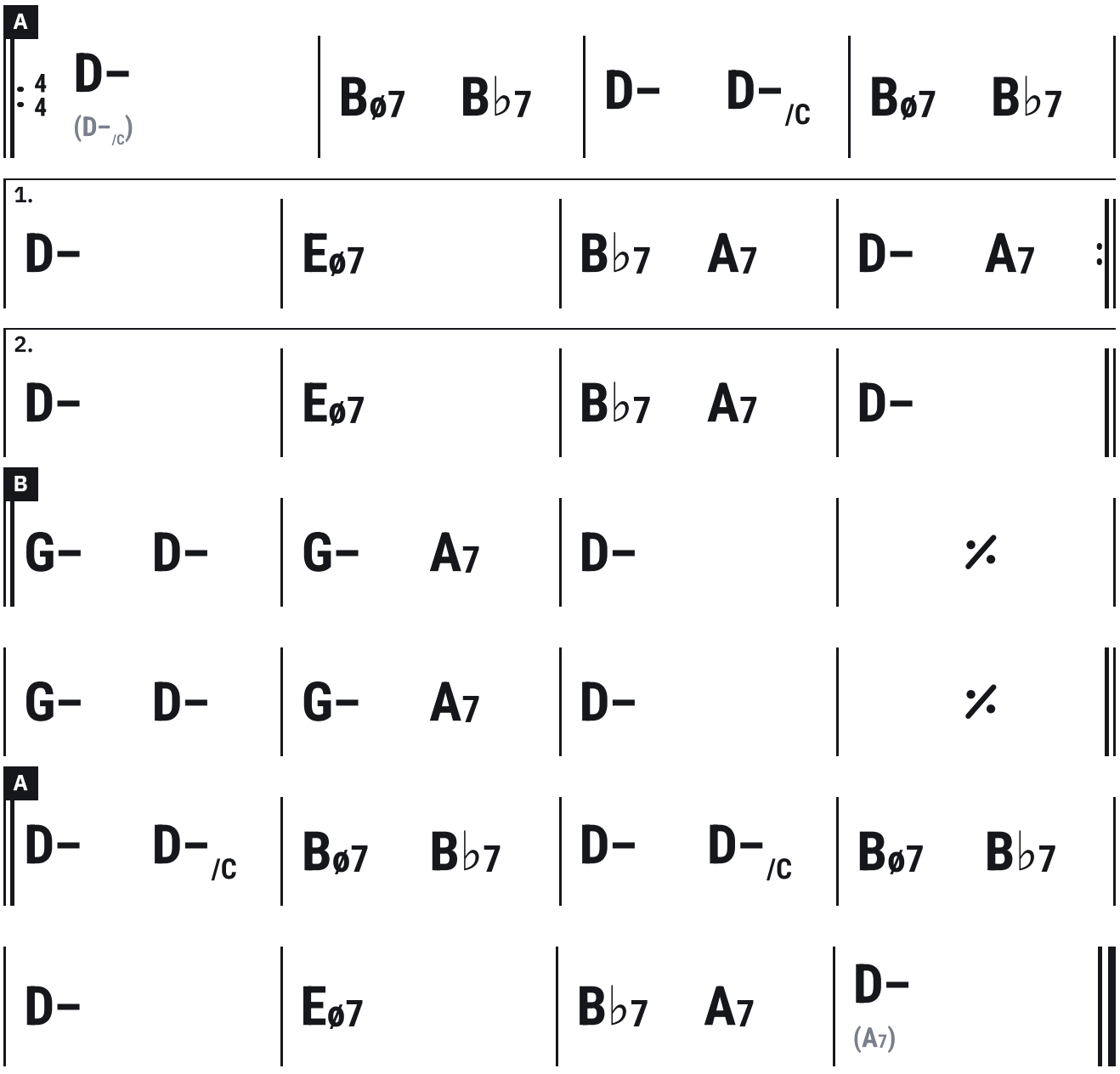
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

C–	C E♭ G
F–	F A♭ C
G7	G B D F
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
A♭7	A♭ C E♭ G♭
D7	D F♯ A C

(Slow Swing)

Blue Drag

Josef Myrow (your Pataswing chart)



Key **D–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Slow lindy / blues** Dance tempo **90–120 bpm** Written **1932**

Blue Drag · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Drag the quarter notes: slightly behind the drummer, two-feel on the head (D A | D A), four for solos at most.
- A section roots: D (C) | B B♭ | D C | B B♭ | D | E | B♭ A | D: the chromatic B → B♭ → A is the hook; play it heavy.
- Ending: B♭ A | D held, then the piano plays the last four bars rit. on D–; hold the D or let it ring.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 6 as A7 or A9 (Django's rhythm section) · bar 2 as B°7 B♭7 · bridge G– as C♯°7 in some gypsy charts.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · D minor pent	D F G A C
A · D blues scale	D F G A♭ A C
B · G minor pent	G B♭ C D F

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

D–	D F A
D–/C	D F A
Bø7	B D F A
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
Eø7	E G B♭ D
A7	A C♯ E G
G–	G B♭ D

(Medium Swing)

Blue Moon

Richard Rodgers & Lorenz Hart



Key **E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / blues** Dance tempo **110–180 bpm** Written **1934**

Blue Moon · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- The loop is yours: E♭ C | F B♭ in two, or E♭ G C E♭ | F A♭ B♭ D in four; the whole tune is this line.
- Bridge bars 5–6: A♭ D♭ | G♭, then F (bar 7), B♭ (bar 8) home; the only place the roots leave the loop.
- Intro and ending are the loop vamped; tag it three times and end on E♭.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bars 7–8 as E♭6 | E♭6 with no turnaround · bridge bar 7 as F7 (the sheet) or F–7 (sessions) · bar 6 of the bridge as G♭Δ7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A, B · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

B bars 5–6 · G♭ major pent G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭ E♭

same notes as E♭ minor pent E♭ G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭

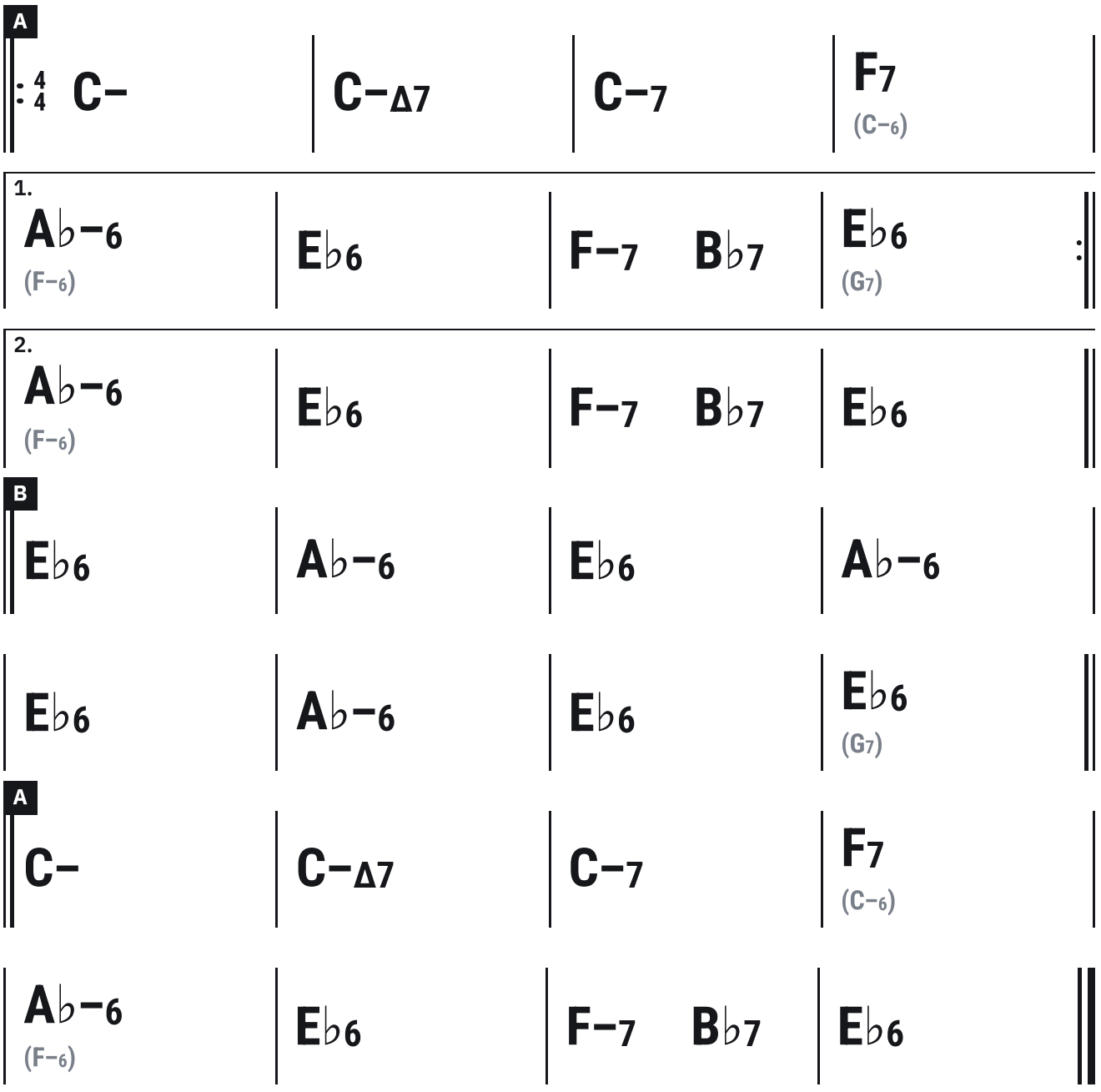
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

E♭6	E♭ G B♭ C
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
F–7	F A♭ C E♭
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
A♭–7	A♭ B E♭ G♭
D♭7	D♭ F A♭ B
G♭6	G♭ B♭ D♭ E♭
F7	F A C E♭

(Medium Up Swing)

Blue Skies

Irving Berlin



Key **C– → E♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1926**

Blue Skies · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Berlin's original keeps the cliché in the bass: C | B | B♭ | A in bars 1–4 (C– | G7/B | E♭/B♭ | F7/A); play it when the piano holds C–, hold C when the piano plays it.
- Bar 5 A♭, bars 6–8 E♭ | F B♭ | E♭: home. Two-feel on the head, four for solos.
- Bridge: E♭ | A♭ | E♭ | A♭ alternating; G7 at the end only if the piano plays it.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bars 1–4 as the descending-bass original: C– | G7/B | E♭/B♭ | F7/A · bar 5 as F–6 or A♭7 · bridge iv as plain A♭6 in older charts · the iReal version ends the bridge Bø7 E7♭9 (in C), i.e. Dø7 G7♭9 here.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A bars 1–5 · C minor pent C E♭ F G B♭

A bars 6–8, B · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

A♭–6 bars · E♭ minor pent E♭ G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭
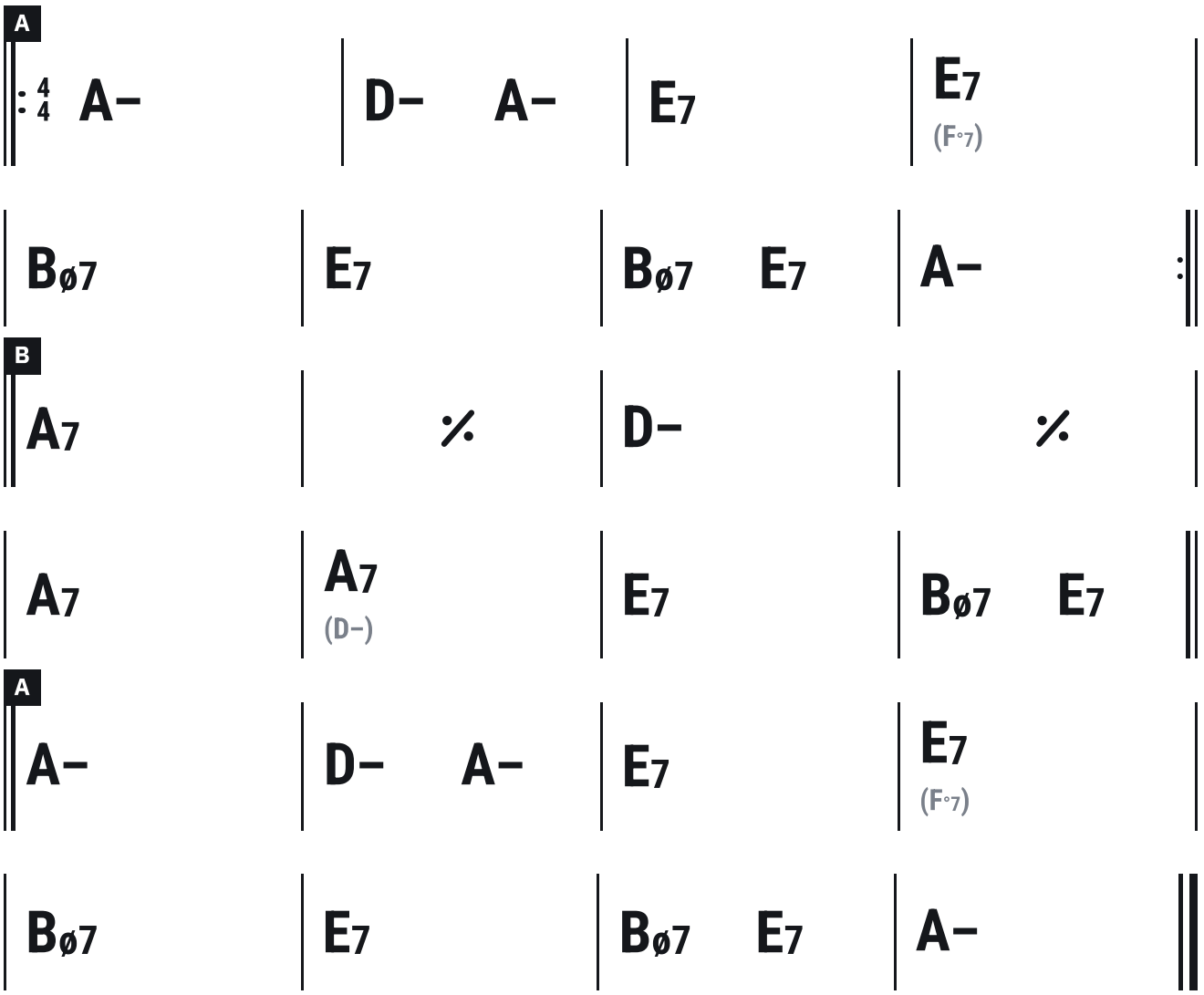
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

C–maj7	C E♭ G
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
C–6	C E♭ G A
A♭–6	A♭ B E♭ F
F–6	F A♭ C D
E♭6	E♭ G B♭ C
F–7	F A♭ C E♭
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
G7	G B D F

(Medium Swing)

Comes Love

Sam H. Stept (Lew Brown & Charles Tobias)



Key **A–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written **1939**

Comes Love · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two-feel on the head: A | D A | E | E | B | E | B E | A: the roots are all a fourth or fifth apart, so the line writes itself; four for solos.
- On the E7 bars (3–4 of each A) walk E F♯ G♯ B or hold E; F on beat 4 before E7 if the piano plays the F°7.
- Bridge: A7 (A, C♯) → D– → A7 → E7: play the C♯ on beat 3 of the A7 bars so the move to D minor is heard.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

F°7 passing chords on the 'and' of 4 before each E7 · bridge bars 5–6 as D– | D– · bar 2 as A– throughout for a modal reading.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · A minor pent A C D E G

over E7 · A harmonic minor A B C D E F G♯

B · D minor pent D F G A C

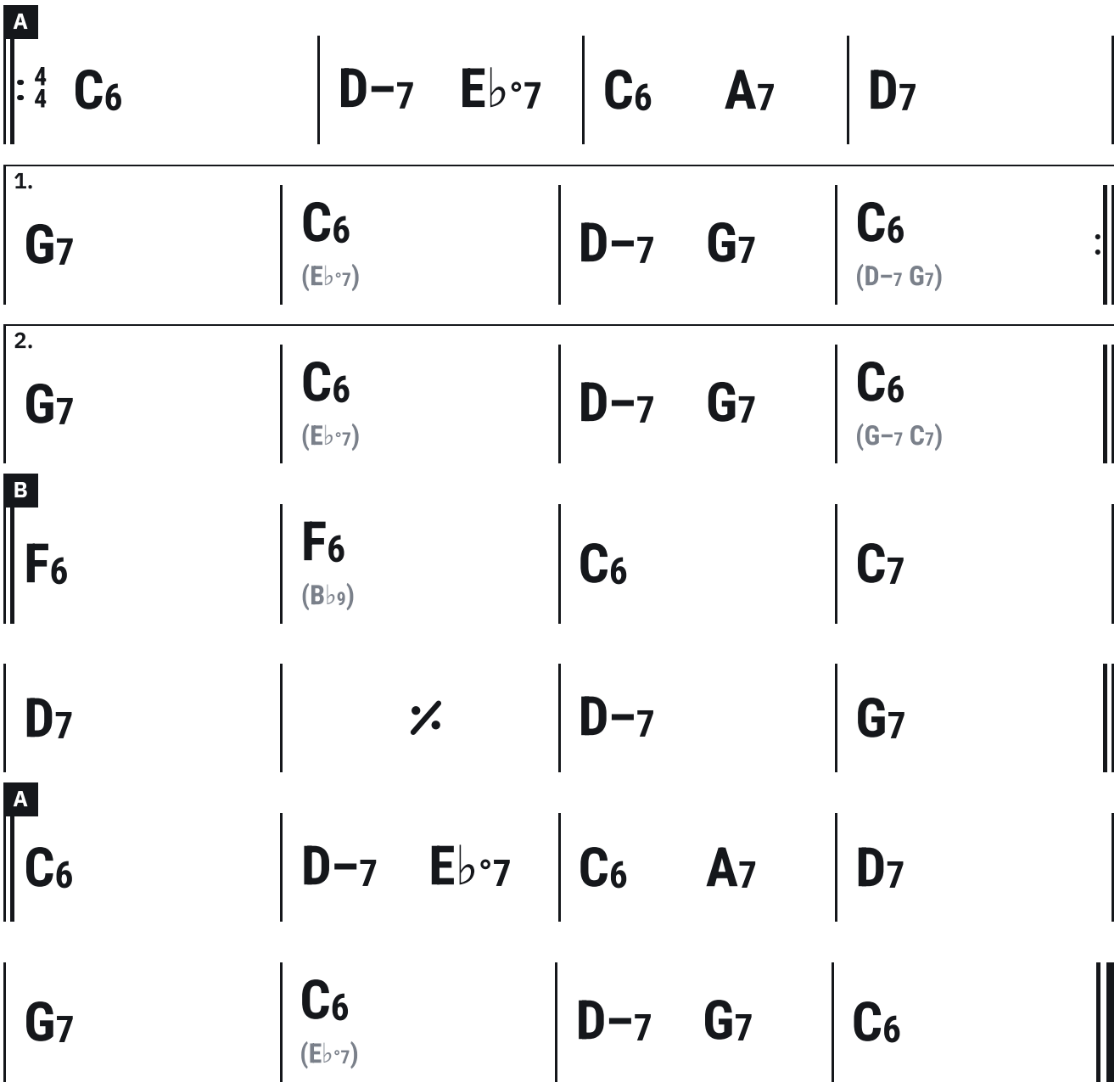
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

A–	A C E
D–	D F A
E7	E G♯ B D
F°7	F A♭ B D
Bø7	B D F A
A7	A C♯ E G

(Medium Swing)

Don't Get Around Much Anymore

Duke Ellington & Bob Russell



Key **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / slow swing** Dance tempo **130–180 bpm** Written **1940**

Don't Get Around Much Anymore · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two-feel on the head: C | D E♭ | C A | D | G | C | D G | C: the E♭ in bar 2 is the °7 root, play it.
- Bars 3–5, A → D → G, is the circle of fifths: walk A C♯ E G | D F♯ A C | G B D F so the 3rds land on beat 2.
- Bridge: F for four bars (B♭ in bar 2 if the piano plays B♭9), C, C7, D for two, D–7 G7; four-feel for solos.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as C♯°7 or F6 F♯°7 · bar 3 as E–7 E♭7 (bebop) · bridge bars 5–6 as A–7 D7 · Real-Book-style bridge: G–7 C7 | F6 | G–7 C7 | F6 | A–7 D7 | A–7 D7 | D–7 | G7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · C major pent C D E G A

B · F major pent F G A C D

D7 bars · D major pent D E F♯ A B

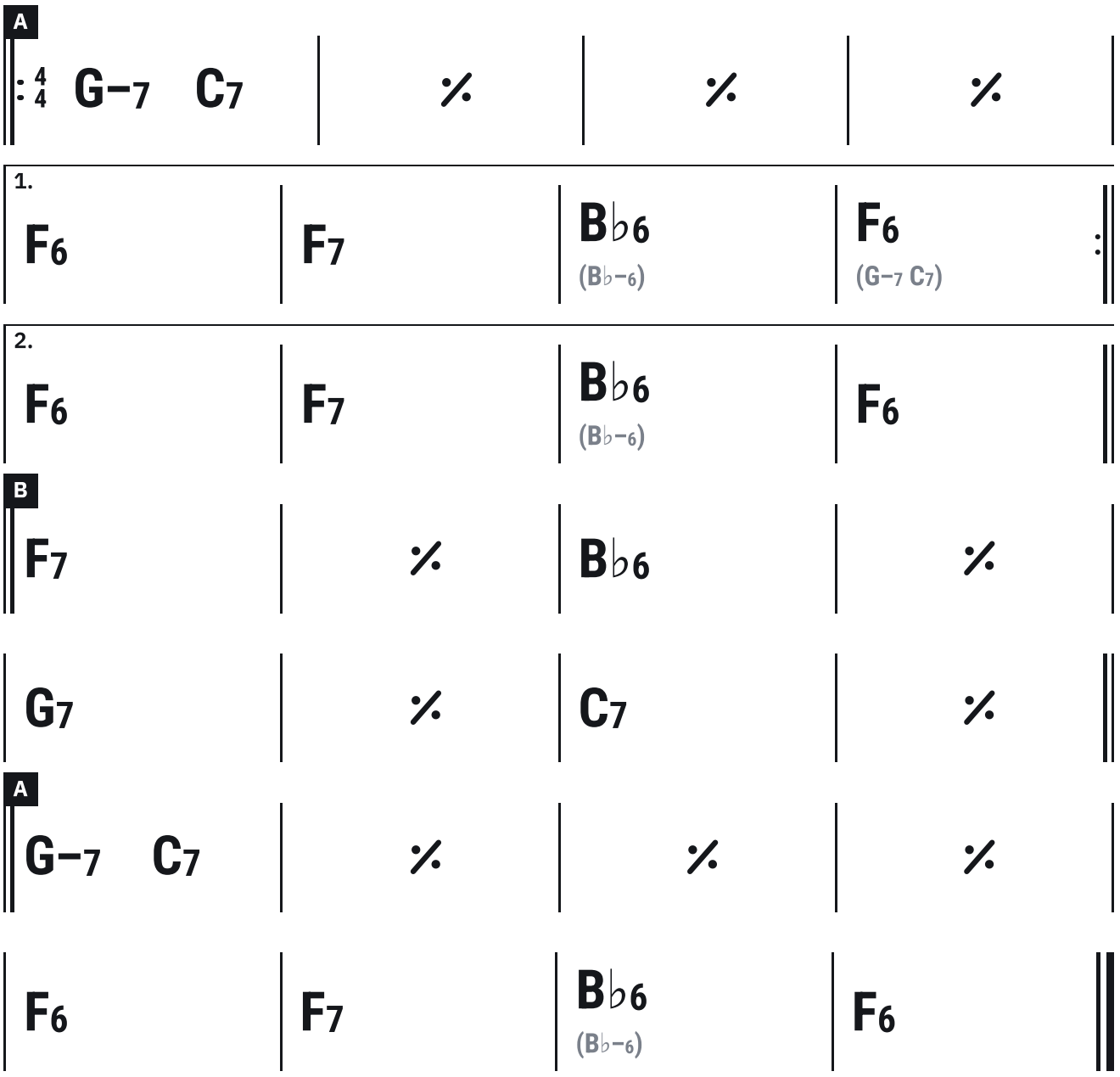
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

C6	C E G A
D–7	D F A C
E♭°7	E♭ G♭ A C
A7	A C♯ E G
D7	D F♯ A C
G7	G B D F
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
F6	F A C D
B♭9	B♭ C D F A♭

(Medium Swing)

Honeysuckle Rose

Fats Waller & Andy Razaf



Key **F** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1929**

Honeysuckle Rose · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Bars 1–4: G C | G C in two, or G B♭ C E in four; don't anticipate the F in bar 5.
- Bars 5–8: F | F | B♭ | F; walk F A C E♭ into B♭ in bar 6 (the E♭ announces the F7).
- Bridge: F for two, B♭ for two, G for two, C for two; the walk-up F F♯ G A B♭ under the band's chords is the stride bass line.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 7–8: B♭6 B♭–6 | F6 D7 (G–7 C7) · bridge bars 7–8 as G–7 | C7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · F major pent F G A C D

A bars 5–8 · F blues scale F A♭ B♭ B C E♭

B · G7: G major pent G A B D E

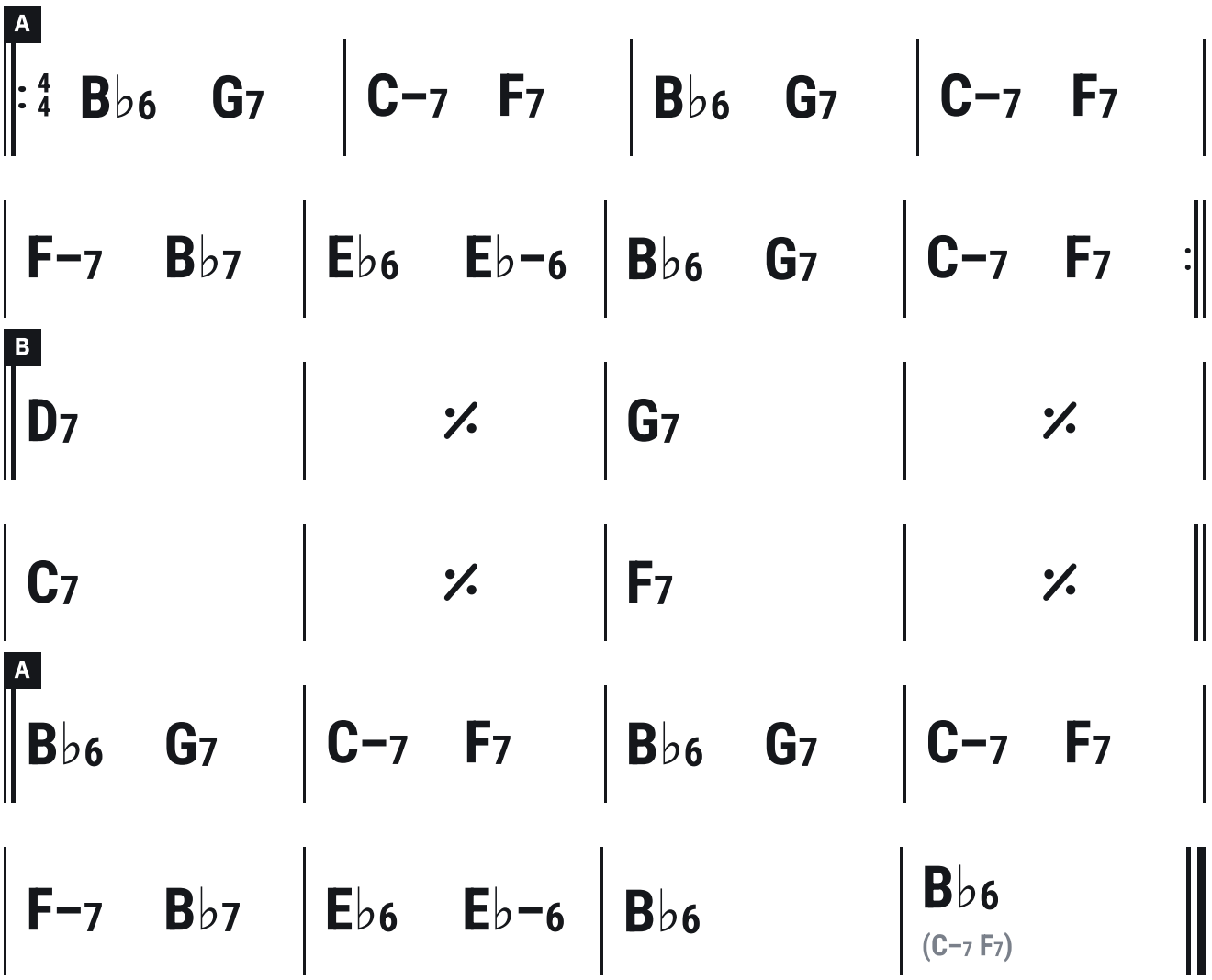
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
F6	F A C D
F7	F A C E♭
B♭6	B♭ D F G
B♭–6	B♭ D♭ F G
G7	G B D F

(Up Swing)

I Got Rhythm (Rhythm Changes)

George Gershwin



Key **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Charleston / fast lindy** Dance tempo **200–240 bpm** Written **1930**

I Got Rhythm · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two chords a bar at 220+: roots on 1 and 3 (B♭ G | C F), passing tones on 2 and 4; the whole tune is this except bars 5–6.
- Bars 5–6: F B♭ | E♭ E♭ (the chord turns minor; G♭ is the colour if you have time for it).
- Bridge: D G C F, two bars each, the circle of fifths; walk D F♯ A C and land each root on the downbeat of its first bar.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as D–7 G7 · bar 6 as E♭6 E°7 · bebop A: B♭ B°7 | C–7 C♯°7 | D–7 D♭7 | C–7 F7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G
B · D7: D major pent D E F♯ A B
B · G7: G major pent G A B D E
B · C7: C major pent C D E G A
B · F7: F major pent F G A C D

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

B♭6	B♭ D F G
G7	G B D F
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
F–7	F A♭ C E♭
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
E♭6	E♭ G B♭ C
E♭–6	E♭ G♭ B♭ C
D7	D F♯ A C
C7	C E G B♭

(Medium Swing)

It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing)

Duke Ellington & Irving Mills



Key **G– → B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1931**

It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing) · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Bars 1–2: hold G (the piano has the cliché) or play G F♯ F E yourself if the piano holds; agree before the count-off.
- Bars 3–4: E♭ then D (half step); bars 5–8: C F | B♭ | D: play the rests of the doo-wah stabs, not the stabs.
- Bridge: B♭ for two, F B♭, E♭ for two, B♭ (G C), F D back into G–; four-feel for solos.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 1–2 as plain G– · doo-wah bars as C–7 | F7 | B♭6 | D7♯5, or with C♯°7 in bar 6 (iReal first ending) · bridge bars 3–4 as B♭7 | B♭7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A bars 1–4 · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

A bars 5–8, B · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

B bars 5–6 · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

G–maj7	G B♭ D
G–7	G B♭ D F
G–6	G B♭ D E
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
D7	D F♯ A C
C7	C E G B♭
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
B♭6	B♭ D F G
F–7	F A♭ C E♭
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
E♭6	E♭ G B♭ C
E♭–6	E♭ G♭ B♭ C

(Up Swing)

Jumpin' at the Woodside

Count Basie (Eddie Durham)



Key **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Fast lindy** Dance tempo **200–250 bpm** Written **1938**

Jumpin' at the Woodside · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Four to the bar from bar one at 240: B♭ for three bars, B♭ (A♭ on 4) into E♭, E♭ (G♭ passing) back to B♭; the bass line is the chart here.
- Bridge: B♭ E♭ C F, two bars each: roots and 5ths, nothing fancier survives the tempo.
- Out: the riff choruses stack on top of you; keep the line unchanged and loud, the dancers are counting on it.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 as E♭7 | E♭7 · bar 8 F7 turnaround · some bands play a rhythm bridge (D7 G7 C7 F7) instead; ask before the count-off.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

A · B♭ blues scale B♭ D♭ E♭ E F A♭

Bars 5–6, B · E♭ major pent E♭ F G B♭ C

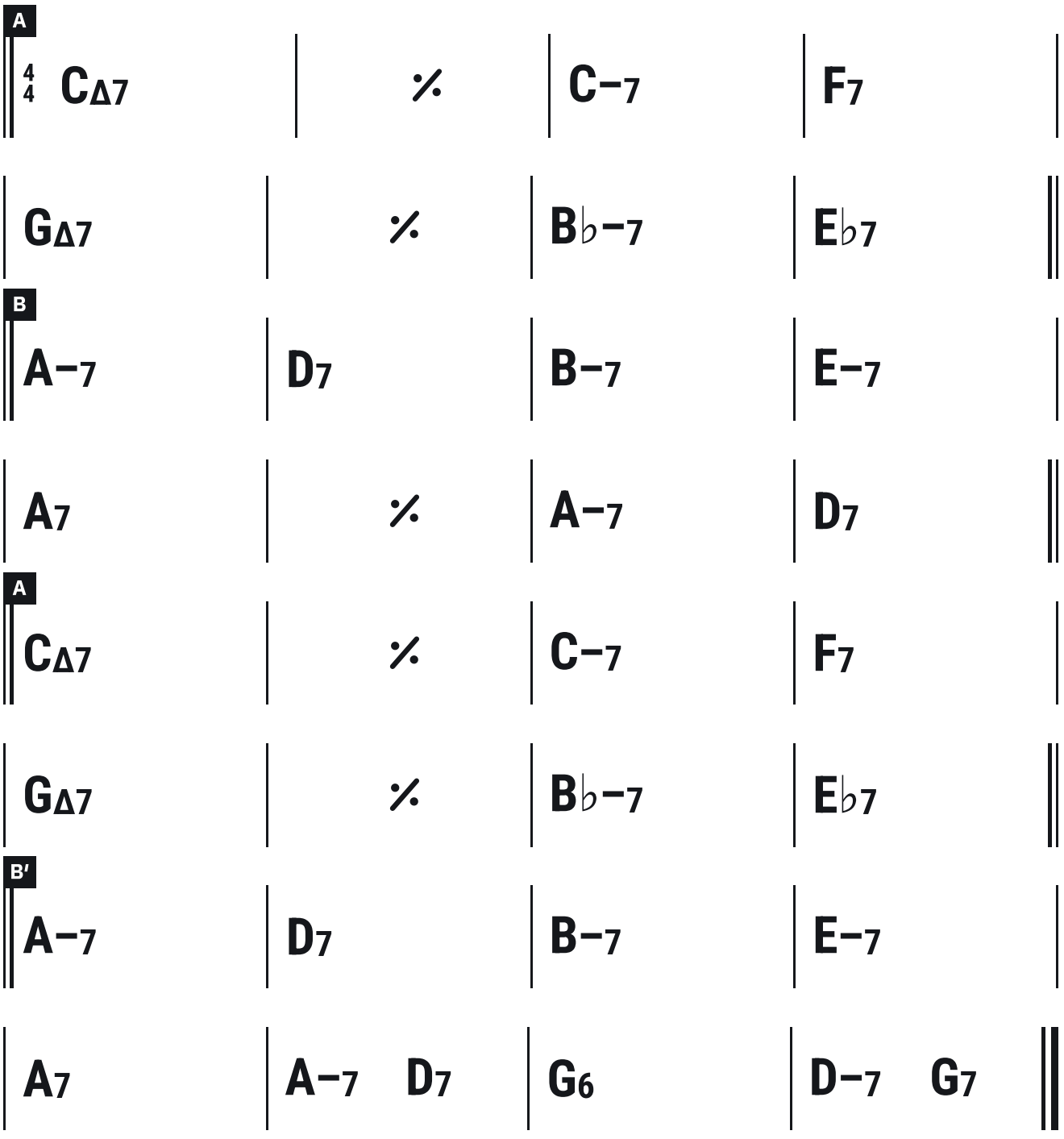
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

B♭6	B♭ D F G
B♭7	B♭ D F A♭
E♭6	E♭ G B♭ C
E♭−6	E♭ G♭ B♭ C
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
F7	F A C E♭
C7	C E G B♭

(Up Swing)

Just Friends

John Klenner & Sam M. Lewis



Key **G** Form **A B A B′ · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **170–220 bpm** Written **1931**

Just Friends · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two-feel on the head (C | C | C F | G | G | B♭ E♭), four for solos; the tune starts on IV, so the first bar is C, not G.
- The backdoor bars: C (E♭ on 3) F | and B♭ (D♭ on 3) E♭ |: the minor 3rd on beat 3 names the backdoor.
- B′ ends D–7 G7 into the next chorus's C; on the last chorus play G6 and stop. Intro = the last four bars (A D | G | D G).

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–6 of the first A as F7 | F7 (Chet's sub for GΔ7) · B′ bar 8 as D7 D♭7 the first time · bar 7–8 of the B as A–7 | D7 or A–7 D7 | G6.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A, B · G major pent G A B D E

C–7 F7 · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

B♭–7 E♭7 · A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

A7 · A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

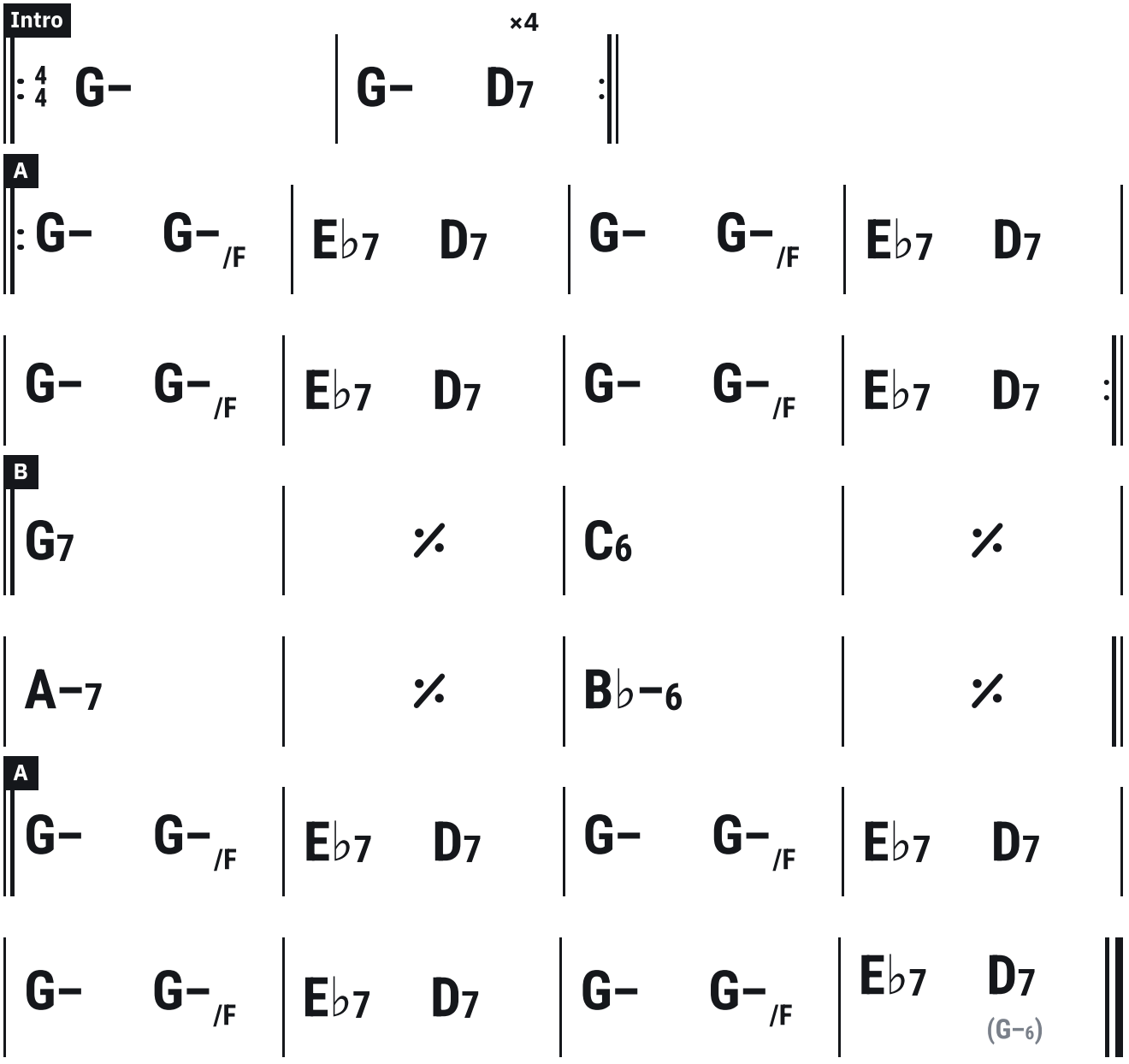
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

C$_{\Delta 7}$	C E G B
C–$_7$	C E♭ G B♭
F$_7$	F A C E♭
G$_{\Delta 7}$	G B D F♯
B♭–$_7$	B♭ D♭ F A♭
E♭$_7$	E♭ G B♭ D♭
A–$_7$	A C E G
D$_7$	D F♯ A C
B–$_7$	B D F♯ A
E–$_7$	E G B D
A$_7$	A C♯ E G
G$_6$	G B D E
D–$_7$	D F A C
G$_7$	G B D F

(Medium Up Swing)

Kansas City Stride

Giorgio Cuscito (Tiber River Dixieland)



Key **G–** Form **AABA · 32 + 8-bar intro** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **2011**

Kansas City Stride · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Intro: G for a bar and a half, D on beats 3–4 of bar 2 (the kick), four times; you join on the second time through.
- A: G F | E♭ D, two beats each, four times: the Lester's Bounce bass line; it's a riff, so play it identically every time.
- Bridge: G for two, C for two, A for two, B♭ for two (D♭ on 3 says minor), then back to G. Out: tag G F | E♭ D three times and land G.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Intro one chord a bar (16 bars) · A bars 7–8 as G– | D7 to break the loop · bridge with C–6 and Aø7 for the all-minor version (that is the Lester's Bounce bridge) · B♭–6 played as E♭9 · last bar G–6.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

A · G blues scale G B♭ C D♭ D F

B · C major pent (G7, C, A–7) C D E G A

B · B♭ minor pent (B♭–) B♭ D♭ E♭ F A♭

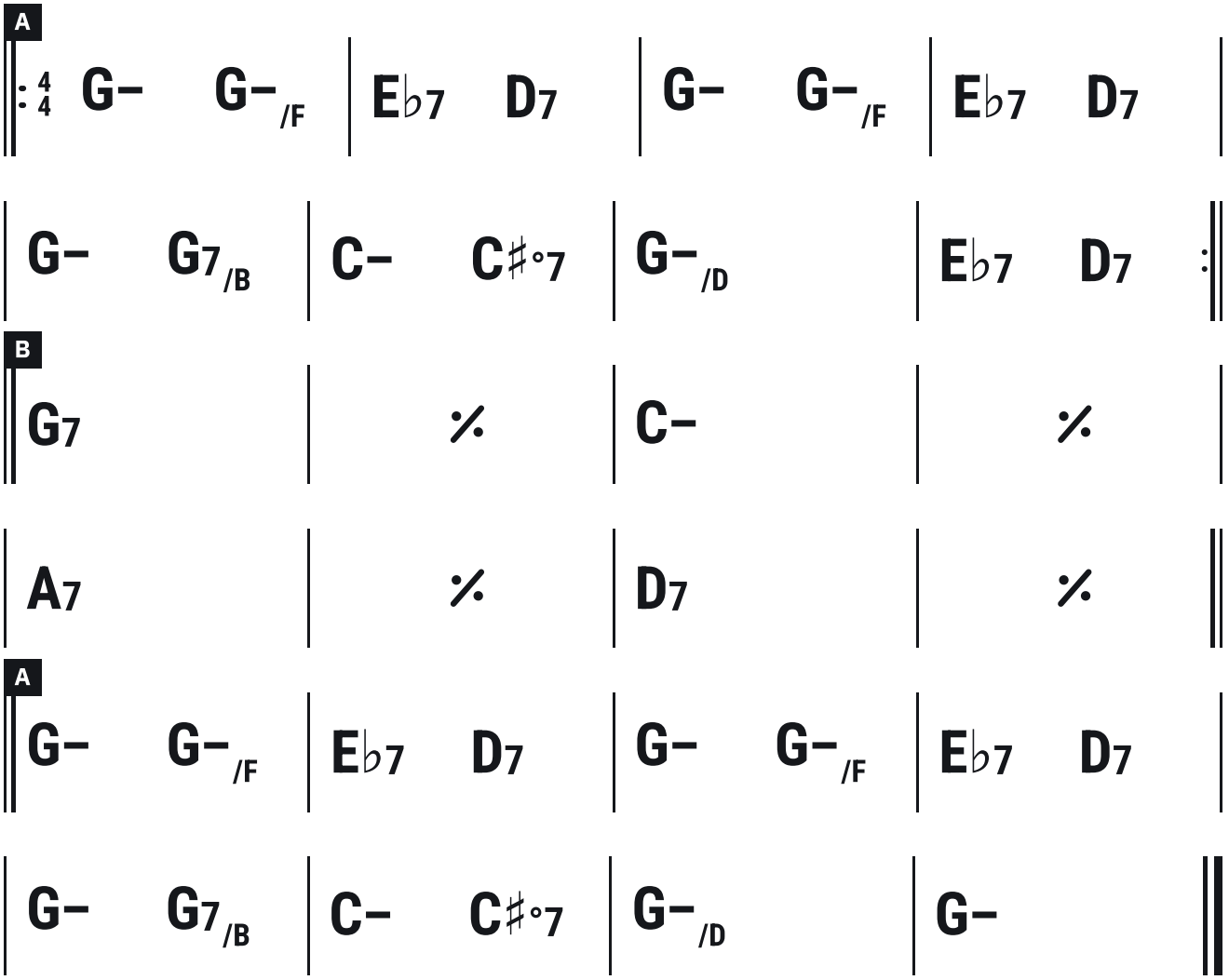
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

G–	G B♭ D
D7	D F♯ A C
G–/F	G B♭ D
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
G7	G B D F
C6	C E G A
A–7	A C E G
B♭–6	B♭ D♭ F G
G–6	G B♭ D E

(Medium Swing)

Lester's Bounce

Your band's chart (Bob Wilber / Antti Sarpila recording)



Key **G–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written

Lester's Bounce · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Bars 1–4: G F | E♭ D twice; bars 5–7: G B | C C♯ | D, the chromatic climb; bar 8: E♭ D. The bass line is the tune, play it identically every chorus.
- Intro: the same loop for four bars, then the horns enter; the two-feel is already in the line, walk in four for solos.
- Bridge: G for two, C for two, A for two, D for two; land each root on the downbeat and keep the 3rds (B, E♭, C♯, F♯) for beat 3.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Your chart is the source. Bar 6 C♯°7 can be played as A7/C♯; the bridge G7 as G7♭9 for the darker sound.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · G minor pent G B♭ C D F

A · G blues scale G B♭ C D♭ D F

B bars 3–4 · C minor pent C E♭ F G B♭

B · A7: A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

G–	G B♭ D
G–/F	G B♭ D
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
D7	D F♯ A C
G7/B	G B D F
C–	C E♭ G
C♯°7	C♯ E G B♭
G–/D	G B♭ D
G7	G B D F
A7	A C♯ E G

(Medium Swing)

Lullaby of Birdland

George Shearing



Key **F− / A♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **150–200 bpm** Written **1952**

Lullaby of Birdland · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two chords a bar: F D | G C | F D♭ | B♭ E♭ | C F | B♭ E♭ | A♭ D♭ | G C: roots on 1 and 3, no walking needed; the line moves in fourths from bar 3 on.
- Two keys a minor third apart: F minor in bars 1–2 and 8, A♭ major in between; Gø7 C7 at the end of A1 and C7♭9 at the end of the bridge both point at F.
- Bridge: C F | B♭ | E♭ | A♭ | C F | B♭ E♭ | A♭ | C: the iii–VI–ii–V–I chain twice; two-feel throughout at Balboa tempo.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 2 as G7♭9 C7♭9 · bars 3–4 as F–7 B♭–7 | E♭7 A♭Δ7 (Real-Book shape) · bridge bars 1–2 as A♭Δ7 | A♭Δ7 in older charts.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A bars 1–2 · F harmonic minor F G A♭ B♭ C D♭ E

A, B · A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

over F–6 · F minor pent F A♭ B♭ C E♭
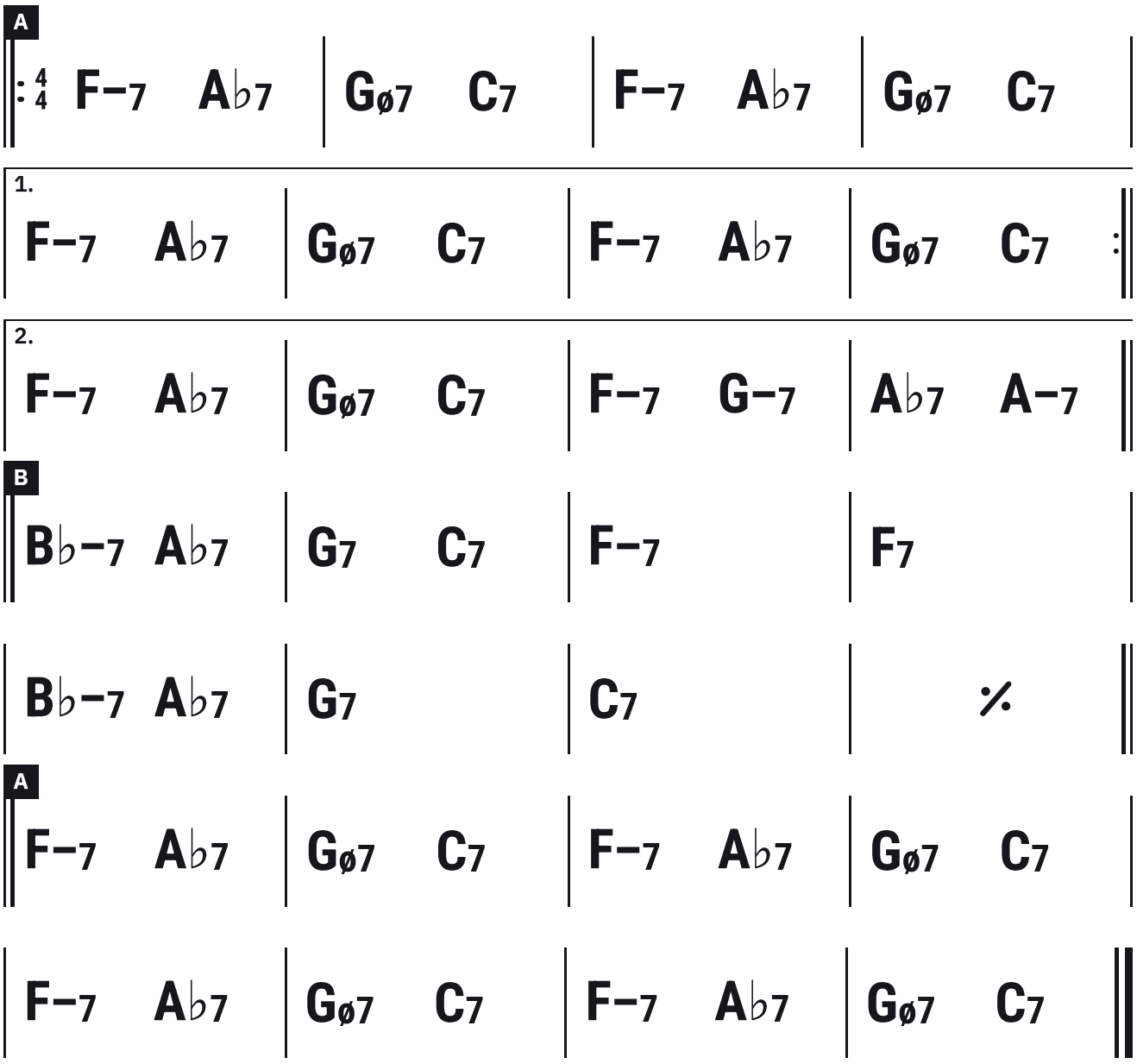
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

F–6	F A♭ C D
Dø7	D F A♭ C
Gø7	G B♭ D♭ F
C7	C E G B♭
F–7	F A♭ C E♭
D♭Δ7	D♭ F A♭ C
B♭–7	B♭ D♭ F A♭
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
C–7	C E♭ G B♭
A♭Δ7	A♭ C E♭ G
D♭9	D♭ E♭ F A♭ B
Cø7	C E♭ G♭ B♭
F7♭9	F G♭ A C E♭
E♭7♭9	E♭ E G B♭ D♭
C7♭9	C D♭ E G B♭

(Slow Shuffle)

Moanin'

Bobby Timmons



Key **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Slow lindy / blues shuffle** Dance tempo **100–125 bpm** Written **1958**

Moanin' · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Shuffle: heavy quarter notes with the triplet feel, F on the call bars; on the answer bars (2, 4, 6) B♭ then F with the band.
- Solo changes: F A♭ | G C: the chromatic A♭ → G → C is the bass line of the tune; heavy and behind the beat.
- Bridge: B♭ A♭ | G C | F | F | B♭ A♭ | G | C | C: descending B♭ – A♭ – G into C7; the second ending walks F G A♭ A into the B♭.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Some charts keep the solo A as plain F–7 for eight bars · answer sometimes written B♭ | F7 · bridge bar 4 as F7♭9.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · F minor pent F A♭ B♭ C E♭

A · F blues scale F A♭ B♭ B C E♭

B · B♭ minor pent B♭ D♭ E♭ F A♭

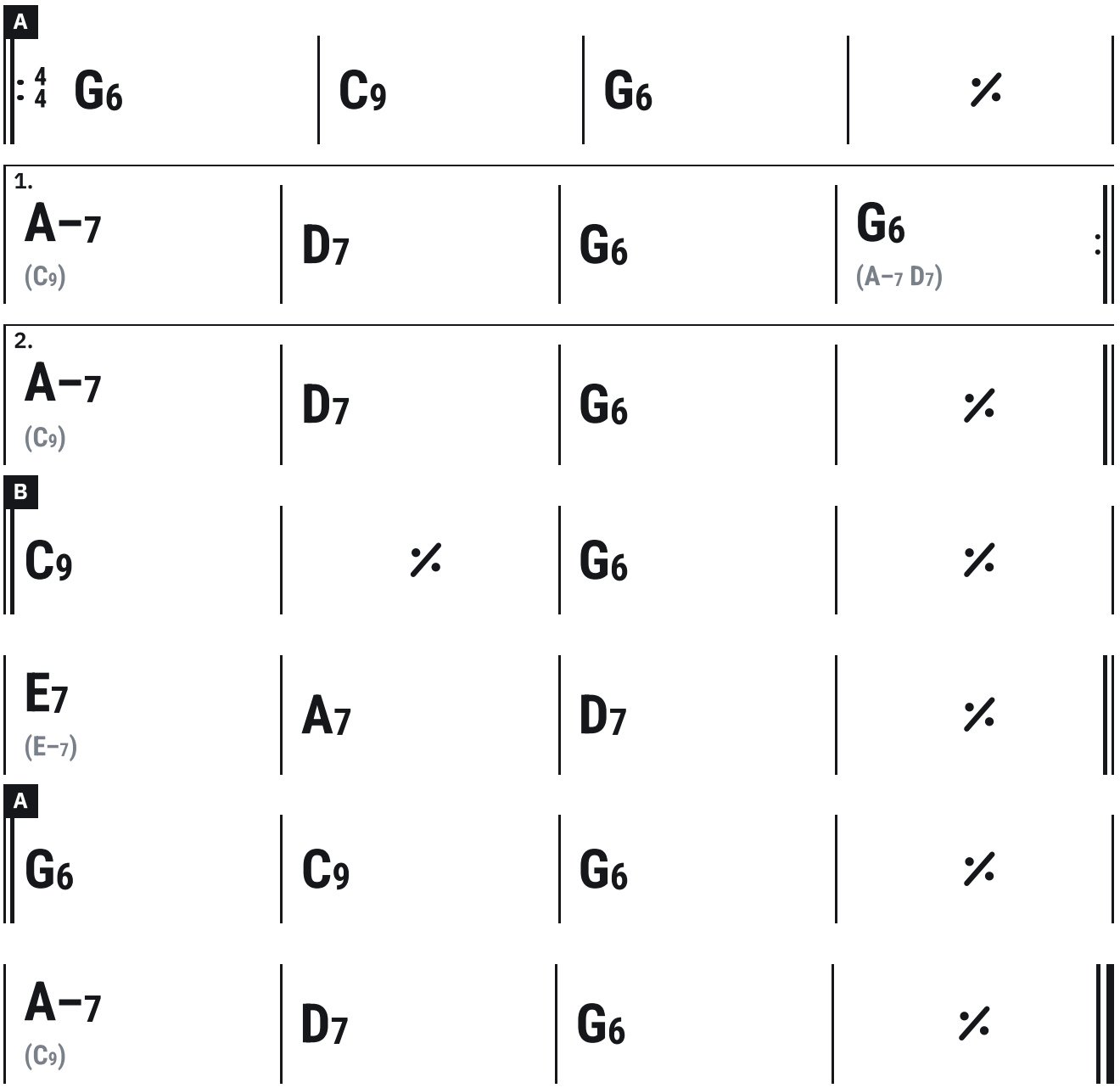
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

F–7	F A♭ C E♭
A♭7	A♭ C E♭ G♭
Gø7	G B♭ D♭ F
C7	C E G B♭
G–7	G B♭ D F
A–7	A C E G
B♭–7	B♭ D♭ F A♭
G7	G B D F
F7	F A C E♭

(Medium Swing)

Oh, Lady Be Good

George & Ira Gershwin



Key **G** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1924**

Oh, Lady Be Good · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two-feel on the head: G | C | G | G | A D | G | G: four bars of G with the IV in bar 2, then a ii–V; four for solos.
- On the C9 bar play C then B♭ on beat 3 so the 'fat IV' is heard; bars 5–6 A then D with F♯ on 3.
- Bridge: C for two, G for two, E A D: the VI7–II7–V7 chain; land G♯ C♯ F♯ on beat 3 of each if the band plays the dominants.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bar 5 as A7 or C9 · bridge bars 1–2 as G7 | G7 (Honeysuckle shape) · bar 8 of A2 as D7 into the bridge.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · G major pent G A B D E

A · G blues scale G B♭ C D♭ D F

B bars 1–2 · C major pent C D E G A

B · A7: A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

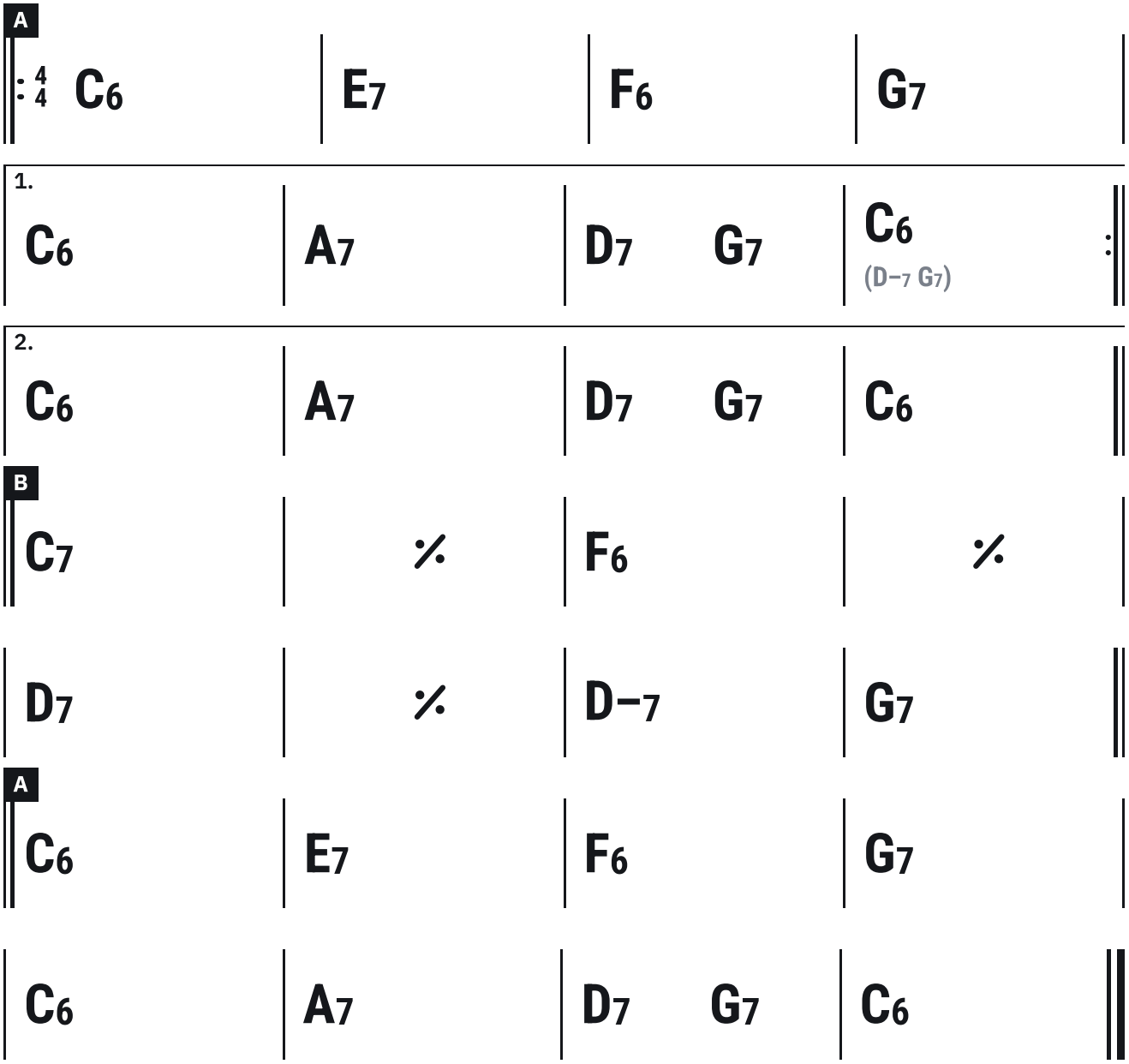
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

G6	G B D E
C9	C D E G B♭
A–7	A C E G
D7	D F♯ A C
E7	E G♯ B D
E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G

(Medium Swing)

On the Sunny Side of the Street

Jimmy McHugh & Dorothy Fields



Key **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lazy lindy / blues** Dance tempo **110–140 bpm** Written **1930**

On the Sunny Side of the Street · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two-feel on the head: C | E | F | G | C | A | D G | C: every root is a step or a fourth away, so the line is the roots themselves.
- On the dominants play the 3rd on beat 3: G♯ (E7), C♯ (A7), F♯ (D7); it is the whole harmony of the tune.
- Bridge: C for two, F for two, D for two, D G: the Montgomery-Ward bridge; walk in four for the solos.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–7 also played A–7 | D7 | D–7 G7 · bridge as G–7 C7 | G–7 C7 | F6 | F6 | A–7 D7 | A–7 D7 | D–7 | G7, or ending D7 | D7 | G7 | G7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · C major pent C D E G A

A, B · C blues scale C E♭ F G♭ G B♭

B · F major pent F G A C D

B · D7: D major pent D E F♯ A B
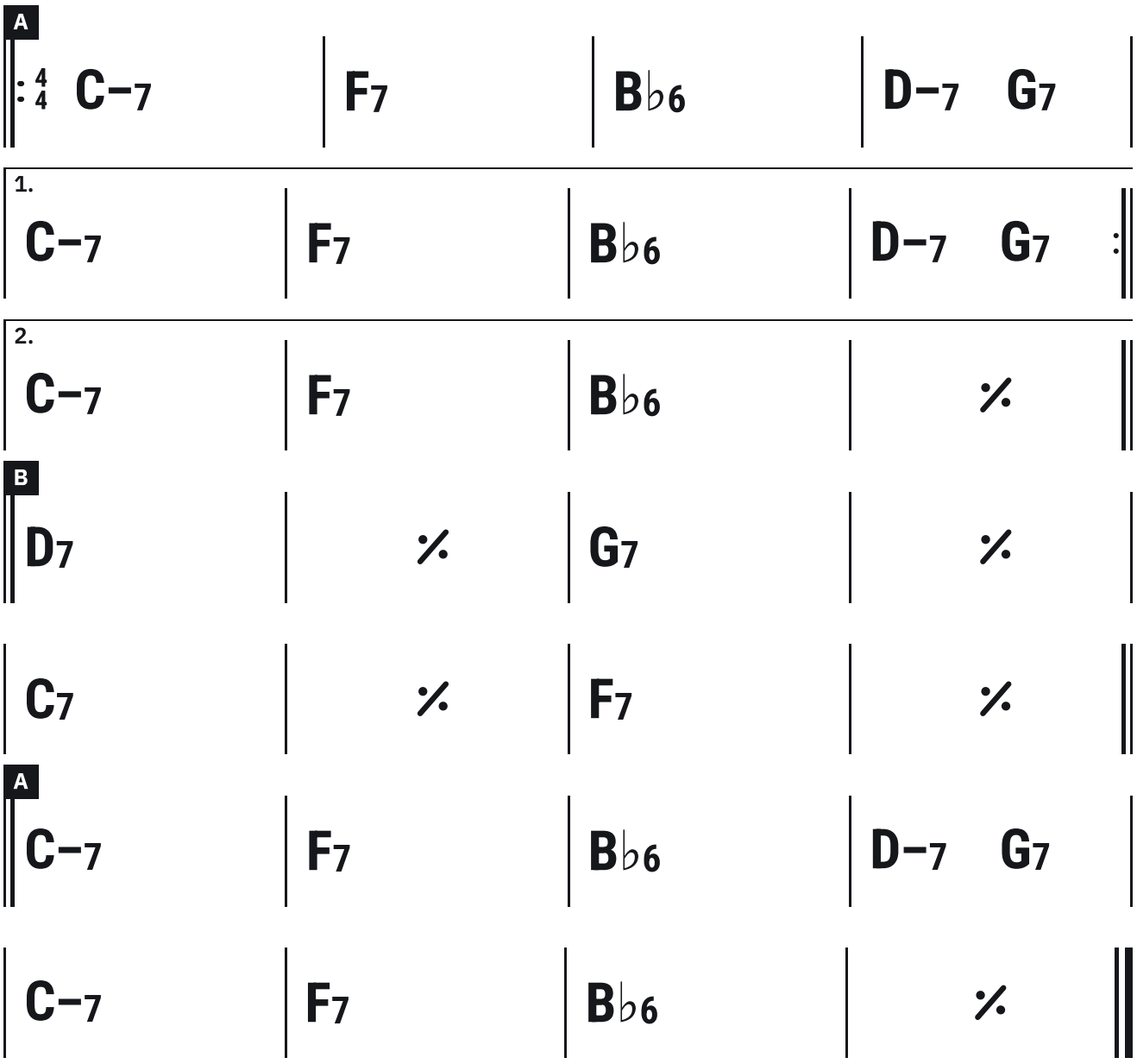
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

C6	C E G A
E7	E G♯ B D
F6	F A C D
G7	G B D F
A7	A C♯ E G
D7	D F♯ A C
D–7	D F A C
C7	C E G B♭

(Medium Up Swing)

Perdido

Juan Tizol



Key **B♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1941**

Perdido · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two-feel on the head (C F | B♭ | D G), walk in four for solos: the ii–V–I–VI loop is the easiest walking line in the book.
- Land B♭ on the downbeat of bar 3 every time; the G7 bar wants B natural on beat 3 so the pull to C– is heard.
- Bridge: D G C F, two bars each; the rhythm-changes bridge, play it the same way.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A as B♭6 | B♭6 | B♭6 | B♭6 | C–7 F7 | C–7 F7 | B♭6 | B♭6 in some charts · bridge bar 4 as G7♯5 (Hawkins' rhythm section).

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

A · B♭ blues scale B♭ D♭ E♭ E F A♭

B · D7: D major pent (then G, C, F) D E F♯ A B

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

C–7	C E♭ G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
B♭6	B♭ D F G
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
D7	D F♯ A C
C7	C E G B♭

(Up Swing)

Puttin' On the Ritz

Irving Berlin



Key **F– → A♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Charleston / Balboa** Dance tempo **200–240 bpm** Written **1929**

Puttin' On the Ritz · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two-feel at Charleston tempo: F | F | F | C | C | F | D♭ C | F: roots and 5ths, nothing else survives 220.
- Bridge: B♭ E♭ | A♭ | A♭ | B♭ E♭ | A♭ | D♭ C: the relative major, ii–V–I twice; land A♭ on the downbeat of bar 3 of the bridge.
- D♭ → C in bar 7 of the A and in the last bar of the bridge is a half-step drop: two heavy quarter notes.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bar 4–5 as one bar C7 and one bar F– in some charts · bridge ending as D♭7 | C7 over two bars.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · F minor pent F A♭ B♭ C E♭

A, over C7 · F harmonic minor F G A♭ B♭ C D♭ E

B · A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

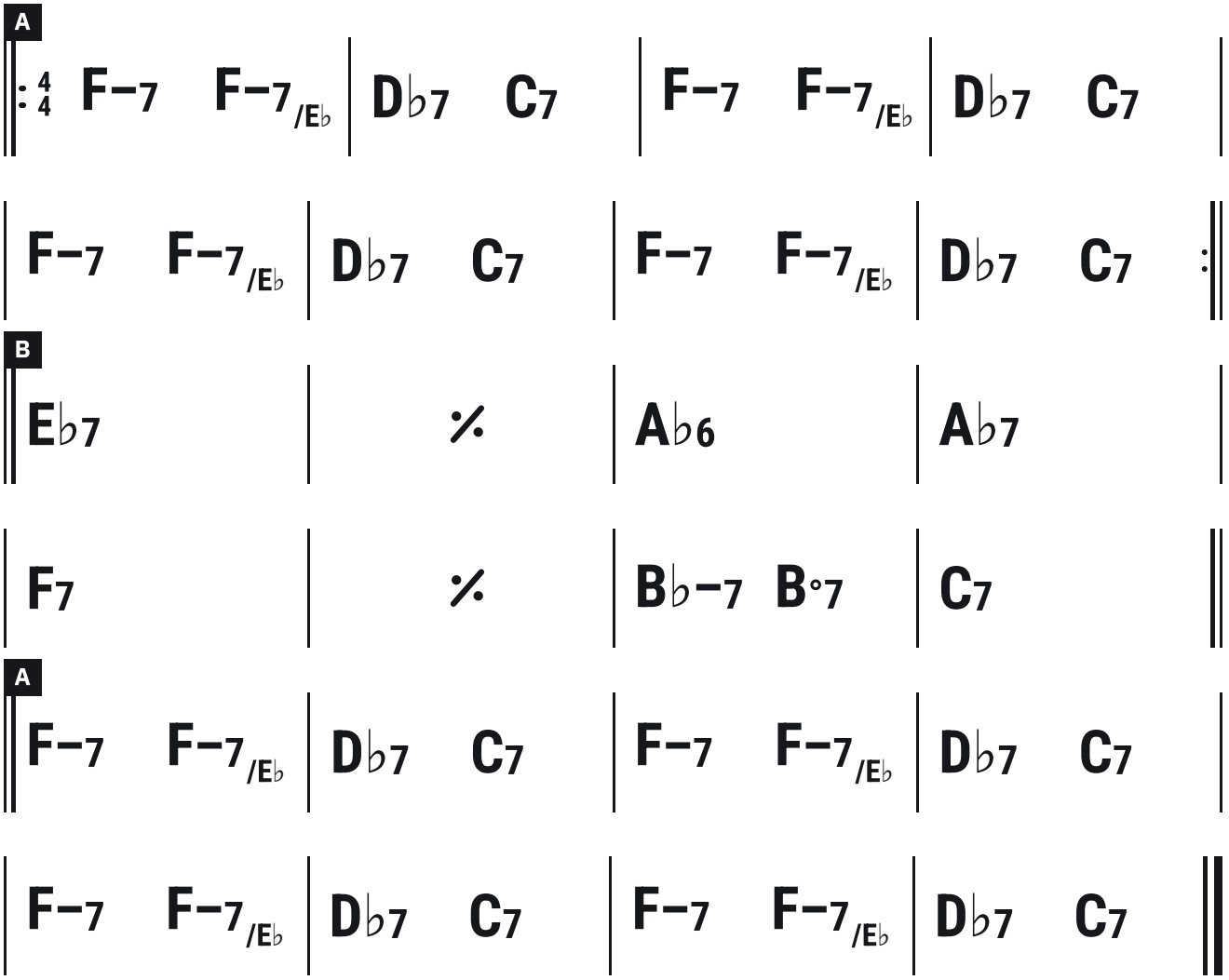
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

F–	F A♭ C
C7	C E G B♭
D♭7	D♭ F A♭ B
B♭–7	B♭ D♭ F A♭
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
A♭6	A♭ C E♭ F

(Up Swing)

Ridin' and Jivin'

Earl Hines, your band's chart



Key **F–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Fast lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **150 bpm** Written **1939**

Ridin' and Jivin' · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- The loop is your line: F E♭ | D♭ C, two beats each, every bar of the A; under solos the chart says roots on 1 and 3, so that's the whole job.
- Intro: 4 bars, then 8 bars of the loop with the horns in; the loop starts in bar 5, so count it.
- Bridge: E♭ for two, A♭ for two (A♭7 in bar 4), F for two, B♭ B | C: the B natural passing into C sets up the last A. The final bars are slow the last time through.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Your chart is the source. Hines's record has more passing chords in the bridge; the bass line is the same.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · F minor pent F A♭ B♭ C E♭

A · F blues scale F A♭ B♭ B C E♭

B · A♭ major pent (E♭7, A♭) A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

B bars 5–6 · F major pent (F7) F G A C D

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

F−7	F A♭ C E♭
F−7/E♭	F A♭ C E♭
D♭7	D♭ F A♭ B
C7	C E G B♭
E♭7	E♭ G B♭ D♭
A♭6	A♭ C E♭ F
A♭7	A♭ C E♭ G♭
F7	F A C E♭
B♭−7	B♭ D♭ F A♭
B°7	B D F A♭

(Medium Swing)

Satin Doll

Duke Ellington & Billy Strayhorn



Key **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / slow swing** Dance tempo **130–160 bpm** Written **1953**

Satin Doll · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two-feel: D G | D G | E A | E A | A D | A♭ D♭ | C: the ii–V roots step up, then the tritone sub a half step above C, which finally resolves; the half-step drop is the tune.
- Walk in four for solos: D F G B over D–7 G7 (roots on 1 and 3, the 3rds on 2 and 4) and move the same four notes up a step for E–7 A7.
- Bridge: G C | G C | F | F | A D | A D | G | G: Montgomery-Ward bridge; two bars of G7 at the end, walk G B D F into the last A.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

First-A bar 8 as E–7 A7 · bar 6 as D–7 G7 (the sheet) instead of the tritone sub · bridge bars 7–8 as D–7 G7 | D–7 G7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

D–7 G7 · C major pent C D E G A

E–7 A7 · D major pent D E F♯ A B

A–7 D7 · G major pent G A B D E

A♭–7 D♭7 · G♭ major pent G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭ E♭

B · F major pent F G A C D
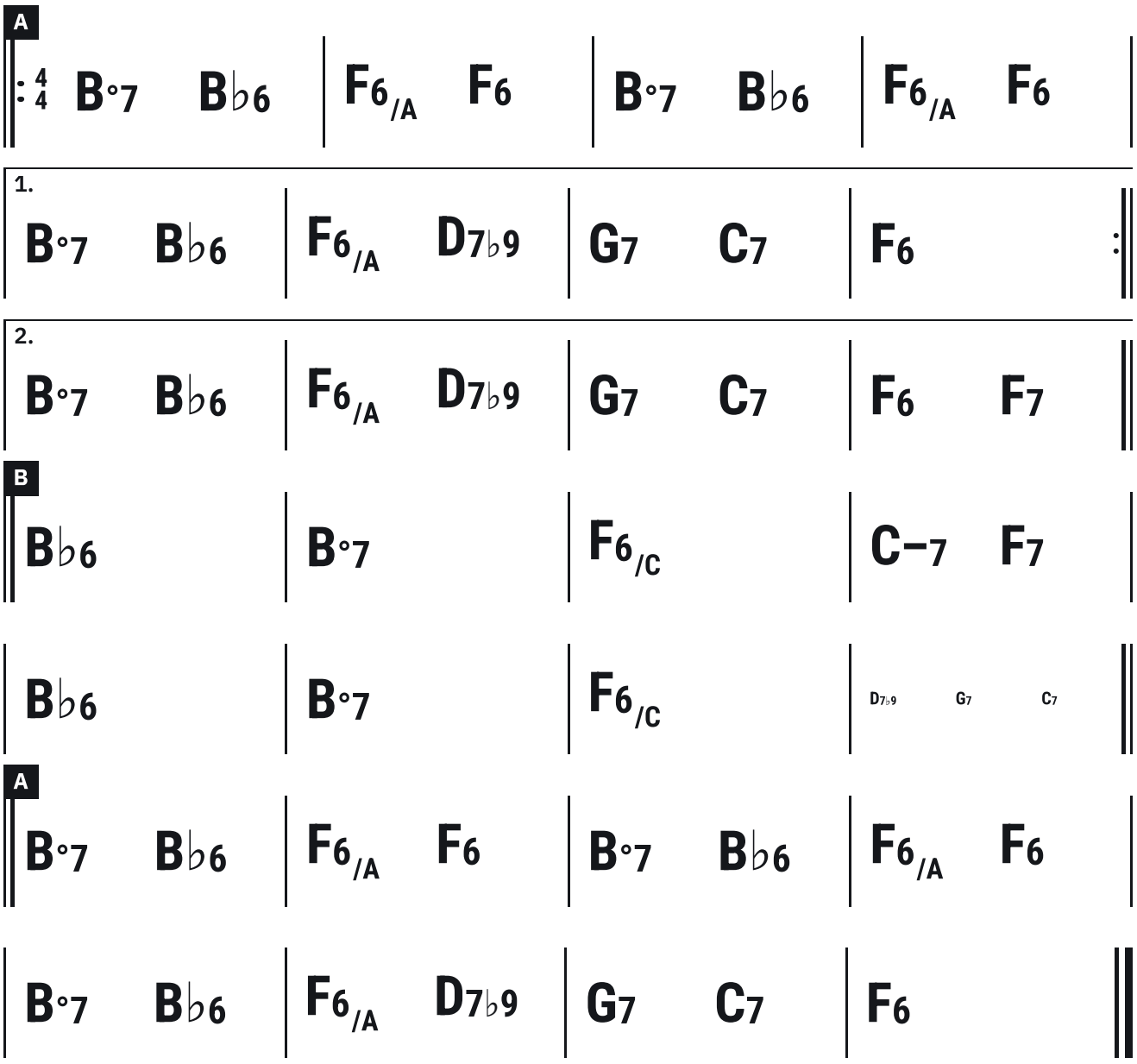
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
E–7	E G B D
A7	A C♯ E G
A–7	A C E G
D7	D F♯ A C
A♭–7	A♭ B E♭ G♭
D♭7	D♭ F A♭ B
C6	C E G A
G–7	G B♭ D F
C7	C E G B♭
F6	F A C D

(Medium Swing)

A Smooth One

Benny Goodman & Charlie Christian



Key **F** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lazy lindy** Dance tempo **120 bpm** Written **1941**

A Smooth One · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Christian's riff is a bass line: B B♭ | A F | B B♭ | A F: in unison with the guitar and the piano's left hand, two beats each, every bar of the A.
- Bars 6–8: A D | G C | F: the only place the line leaves the riff; second ending F F7 (E♭ on 3) into the bridge.
- Bridge: B♭ | B | C | C F | B♭ | B | C | D G C: the riff from IV; the last bar has three roots, one beat, one beat, two beats. Tag: F | G C | F (N.C. pickup) | G C | F.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Jam charts read the A as F | F7/C B°7 | B♭–6 F/A: B♭–6 is the ear's version of your B♭6 under the melody's D natural · session key F; the Goodman/Christian record may be in A♭.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · F major pent F G A C D

A · F blues scale F A♭ B♭ B C E♭

B · B♭ major pent B♭ C D F G

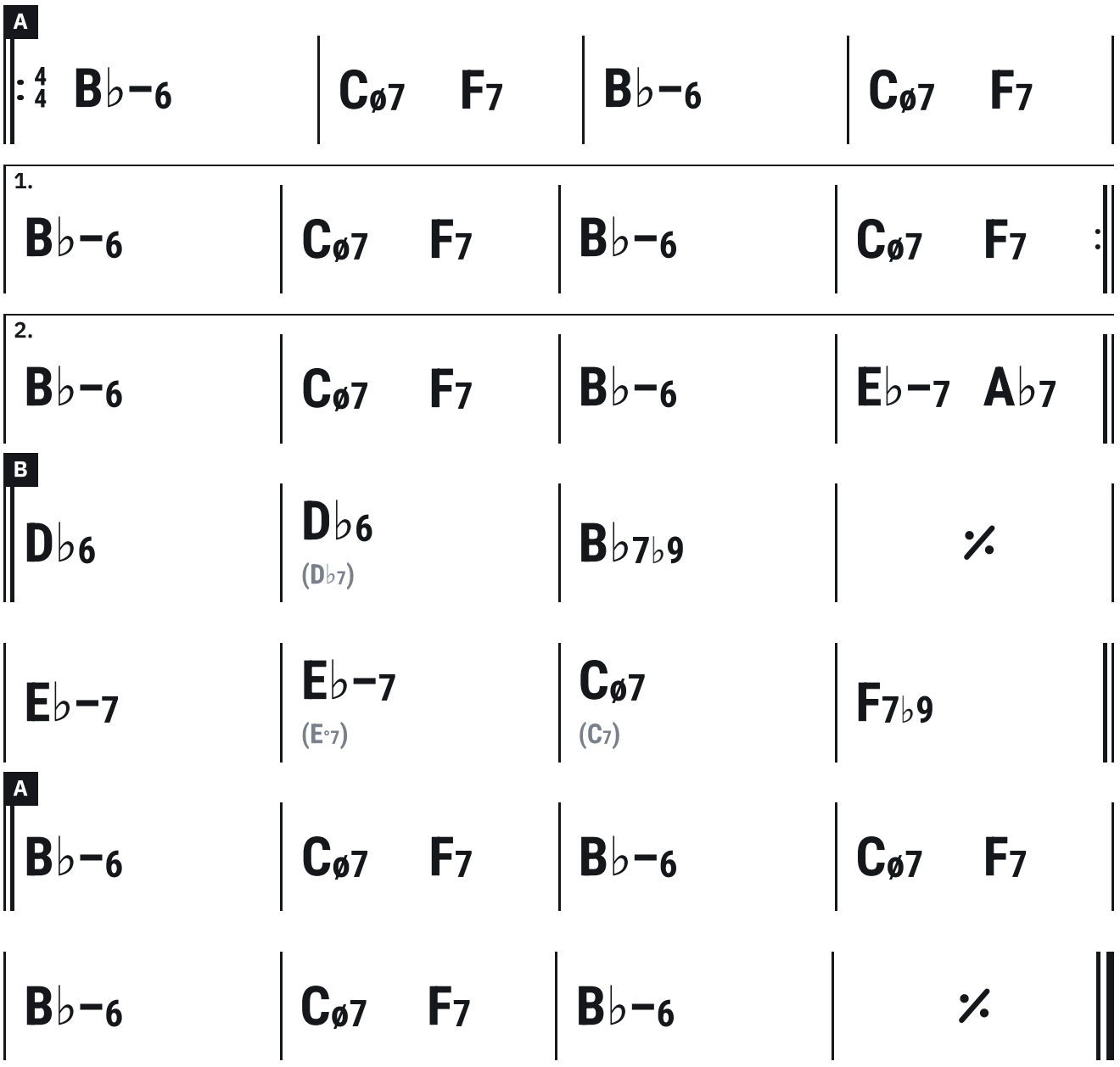
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

B°7	B D F A♭
B♭6	B♭ D F G
F6/A	F A C D
F6	F A C D
D7♭9	D E♭ F♯ A C
G7	G B D F
C7	C E G B♭
F7	F A C E♭
F6/C	F A C D
C–7	C E♭ G B♭

(Latin / Swing)

Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise

Sigmund Romberg



Key **B♭−** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Balboa 180–210 · Lindy** Dance tempo **160–190 bpm** Written **1928**

Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Latin on the A: root and 5th in two (B♭ F), straight eighths, with C F under the Cø7 F7 bars; swing-walk in four on the bridge.
- Second ending E♭ A♭ into the bridge: D♭ for two, B♭ for two, E♭ for two, C F: the relative major.
- The session key is a whole step up: if a guest horn calls it there, every note moves up a step and the shapes stay the same.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bridge in the original sheet (transposed): D♭ | D♭ D♭7/C♭ | B♭7♭9 | B♭7♭9 | E♭– E♭–/D♭ | C7 | F7♭9 | F7♭9 · learnjazzstandards sub: D♭ | Fø7 B♭7 | E♭–7 | Gø7 C7 | F7 · session key C–: everything a whole step up.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · B♭ minor pent B♭ D♭ E♭ F A♭

A, over F7 · B♭ harmonic minor B♭ C D♭ E♭ F G♭ A

B bars 1–2 · D♭ major pent D♭ E♭ F A♭ B♭

B bars 5–6 · E♭ minor pent E♭ G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭

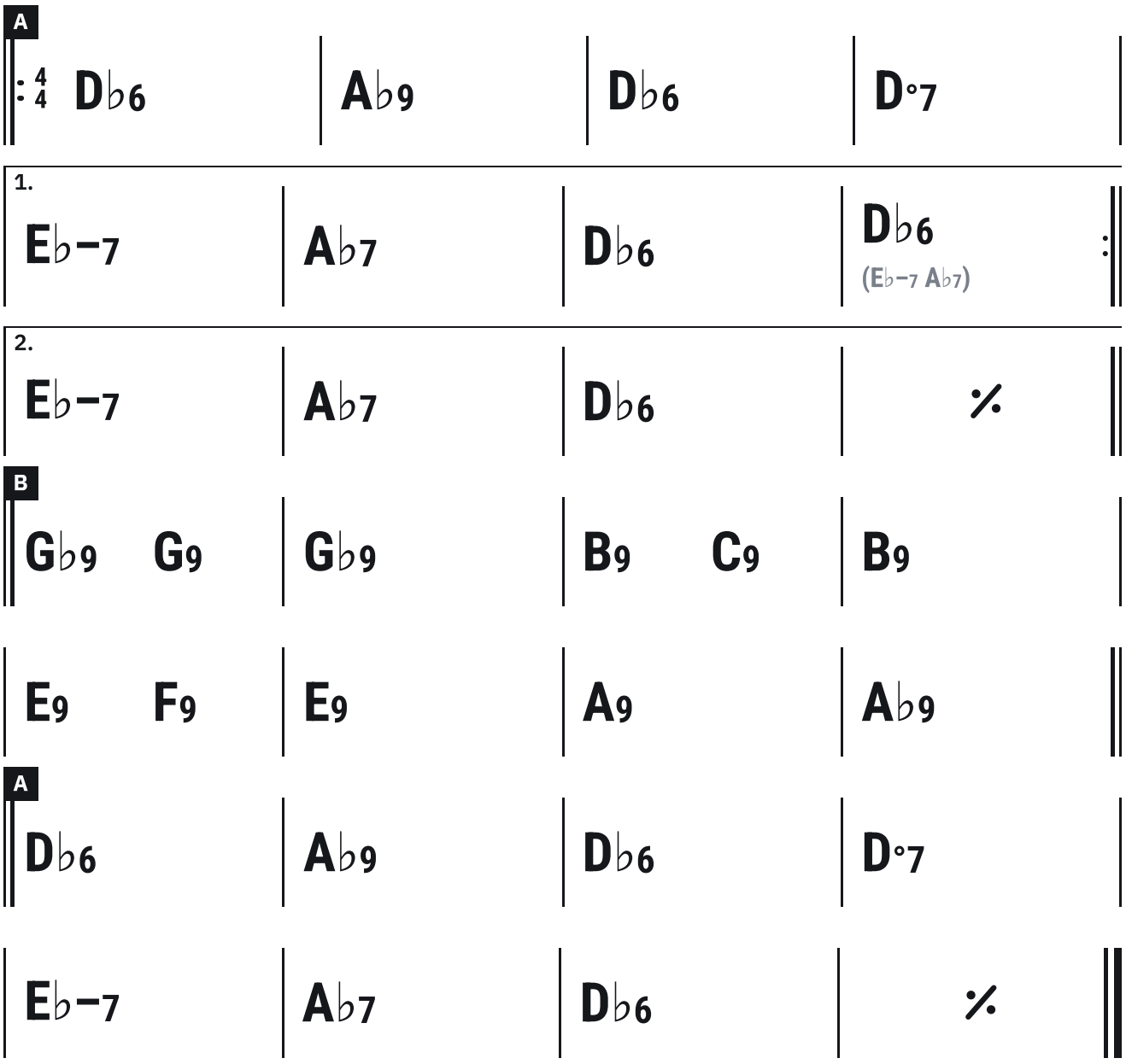
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

B♭–6	B♭ D♭ F G
Cø7	C E♭ G♭ B♭
F7	F A C E♭
E♭–7	E♭ G♭ B♭ D♭
A♭7	A♭ C E♭ G♭
D♭6	D♭ F A♭ B♭
D♭7	D♭ F A♭ B
B♭7♭9	B♭ B D F A♭
E°7	E G B♭ D♭
C7	C E G B♭
F7♭9	F G♭ A C E♭

(Medium Swing)

Stompin' at the Savoy

Edgar Sampson



Key **D♭** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy 160–190 · Balboa** Dance tempo **190–220 bpm** Written **1934**

Stompin' at the Savoy · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two-feel on the A: D♭ | A♭ | D♭ | D (the °7) | E♭ | A♭ | D♭ | D♭: the D natural in bar 4 is the only surprise; walk in four for solos.
- Bridge: G♭ (G) | G♭ | B (C) | B | E (F) | E | A | A♭: dominants dropping a fourth with a half-step push on beats 3–4 of the odd bars; the pushes are optional for you.
- Last A ends on D♭6 with no turnaround on the out chorus; tag the riff if the leader calls it.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

A bar 2 as D♭6 A♭7 · bars 7–8 as D♭6 B♭–7 | E♭–7 A♭7 (the Clifford Brown/Max Roach version).

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · D♭ major pent D♭ E♭ F A♭ B♭

A · D♭ blues scale D♭ E G♭ G A♭ B

B · G♭7: G♭ major pent G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭ E♭

B · B7: B major pent B C♯ D♯ F♯ G♯

B · E7: E major pent E F♯ G♯ B C♯

B · A7: A major pent A B C♯ E F♯

B · A♭7: A♭ major pent A♭ B♭ C E♭ F

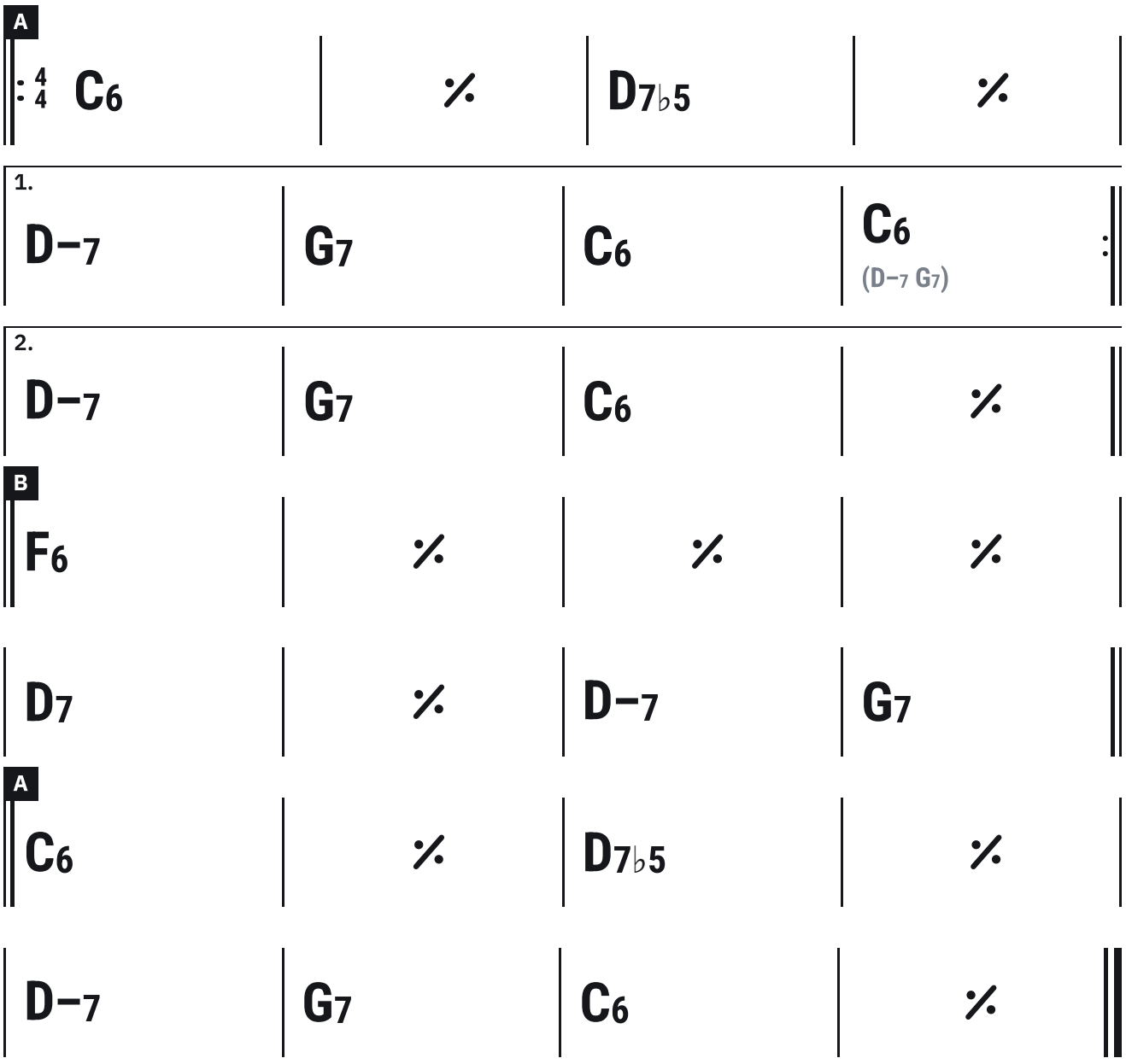
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

D♭6	D♭ F A♭ B♭
A♭9	A♭ B♭ C E♭ G♭
D°7	D F A♭ B
E♭–7	E♭ G♭ B♭ D♭
A♭7	A♭ C E♭ G♭
G♭9	G♭ A♭ B♭ D♭ E
G9	G A B D F
B9	B C♯ D♯ F♯ A
C9	C D E G B♭
E9	E F♯ G♯ B D
F9	F G A C E♭
A9	A B C♯ E G

(Medium Up Swing)

Take the “A” Train

Billy Strayhorn



Key **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1941**

Take the “A” Train · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two-feel on the head: C | C | D | D | D G | C | C: the D7♭5 bars want A♭ on beat 3 (the ♭5) if you want to name the chord; otherwise D and A.
- Walk in four for solos: C E F G | A B C E in bars 1–2, D F♯ A♭ C in bars 3–4, D F G B into C.
- Bridge: F for four bars, D for two, D G: Montgomery-Ward shape; ending: the tag, then A♭ (the ♭VI) before the final C.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 3–4 as D9♯11 · bridge bars 5–6 as D7 | D7♭9 · some charts split A1's last bar as C6 A7 | D–7 G7.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · C major pent C D E G A

A bars 3–4 · D7♭5 + E D F♯ A♭ C E

B · F major pent F G A C D

B · D7: D major pent D E F♯ A B
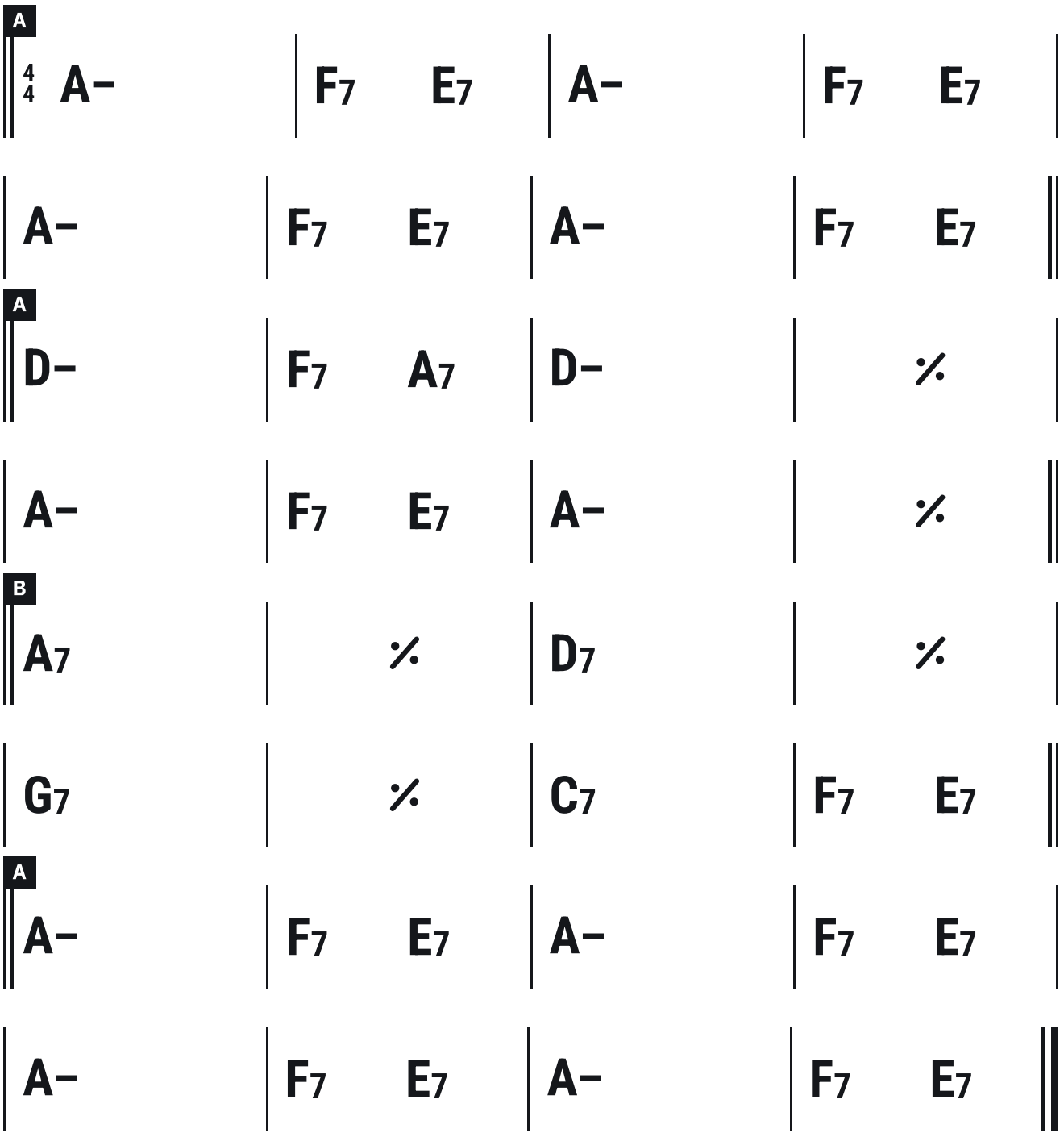
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

C6	C E G A
D7♭5	D F♯ A♭ C
D–7	D F A C
G7	G B D F
F6	F A C D
D7	D F♯ A C

(Medium Up Swing)

Topsy

Eddie Durham & Edgar Battle (for Count Basie)



Key **A–** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **165–200 bpm** Written **1937**

Topsy · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- The part: root – 2 – 3 – 5 under the A– bars (A B C E), F and E on beats 1 and 3 of the turnaround bars; play it exactly, the horns phrase off it.
- Second A: D for four bars (F A in bar 10), then A– again; bar 16 is a bar of A under the horns' pickup.
- Bridge: A D G C, two bars each (cycle of fifths), then F E in bar 24; the last bar of the form is F7 E7 as a turnaround, A– on the final chorus.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

The F7 E7 bars as plain E7 at fast tempos · the second A's D– bars as D–6 · bridge played as A7 | A7 | D7 | D7 | G7 | G7 | C7 | C7 with the F7 E7 moved into the pickup bar · last bar as A– when the tune ends.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · A minor pent A C D E G

A · A blues scale A C D E♭ E G

2nd A · D minor pent D F G A C

B · A major pent (then D, G, C) A B C♯ E F♯

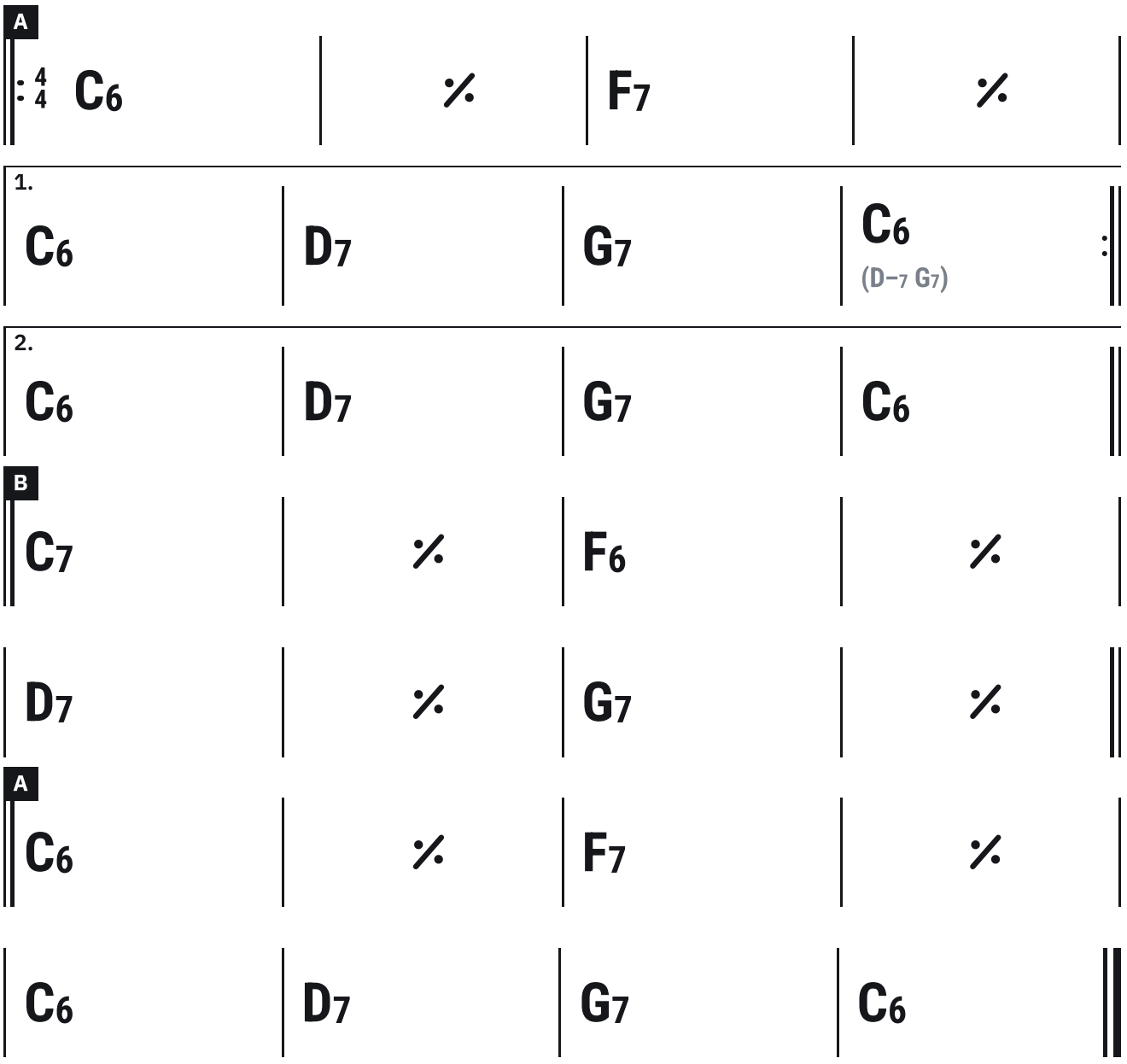
CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

A–	A C E
F7	F A C E♭
E7	E G♯ B D
D–	D F A
A7	A C♯ E G
D7	D F♯ A C
G7	G B D F
C7	C E G B♭

(Medium Up Swing)

Undecided

Charlie Shavers



Key **C** Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1938**

Undecided · Bass

HOW TO PLAY IT · Bass

- Two-feel on the head (C | C | F | F | C | D | G | C); walking C E G A | C E G B♭ into the F7 bars for solos, the B♭ on beat 4 of bar 2 announcing the F7.
- Bar 6 D7: D F♯ A C into G7 (G B D F), then C.
- Bridge: C for two, F for two, D for two, G for two: the Honeysuckle bridge in C; walk the roots in fourths.

VARIANTS YOU'LL MEET

Bars 5–7 as D–7 | B♭7 A♭7 | G7 (the chromatic walk-down in the Ames Brothers / Kirby charts) · bar 8 turnaround optional · bridge bars 7–8 as G7 | A–7 D7 into the last A.

SCALES TO LEAN ON · one octave from the root

A · C major pent C D E G A

F7 bars · C blues scale C E♭ F G♭ G B♭

B · F major pent F G A C D

B · D7: D major pent D E F♯ A B

CHORD TONES · every chord in the chart

C6	C E G A
F7	F A C E♭
D7	D F♯ A C
G7	G B D F
D–7	D F A C
C7	C E G B♭
F6	F A C D

DRUMS

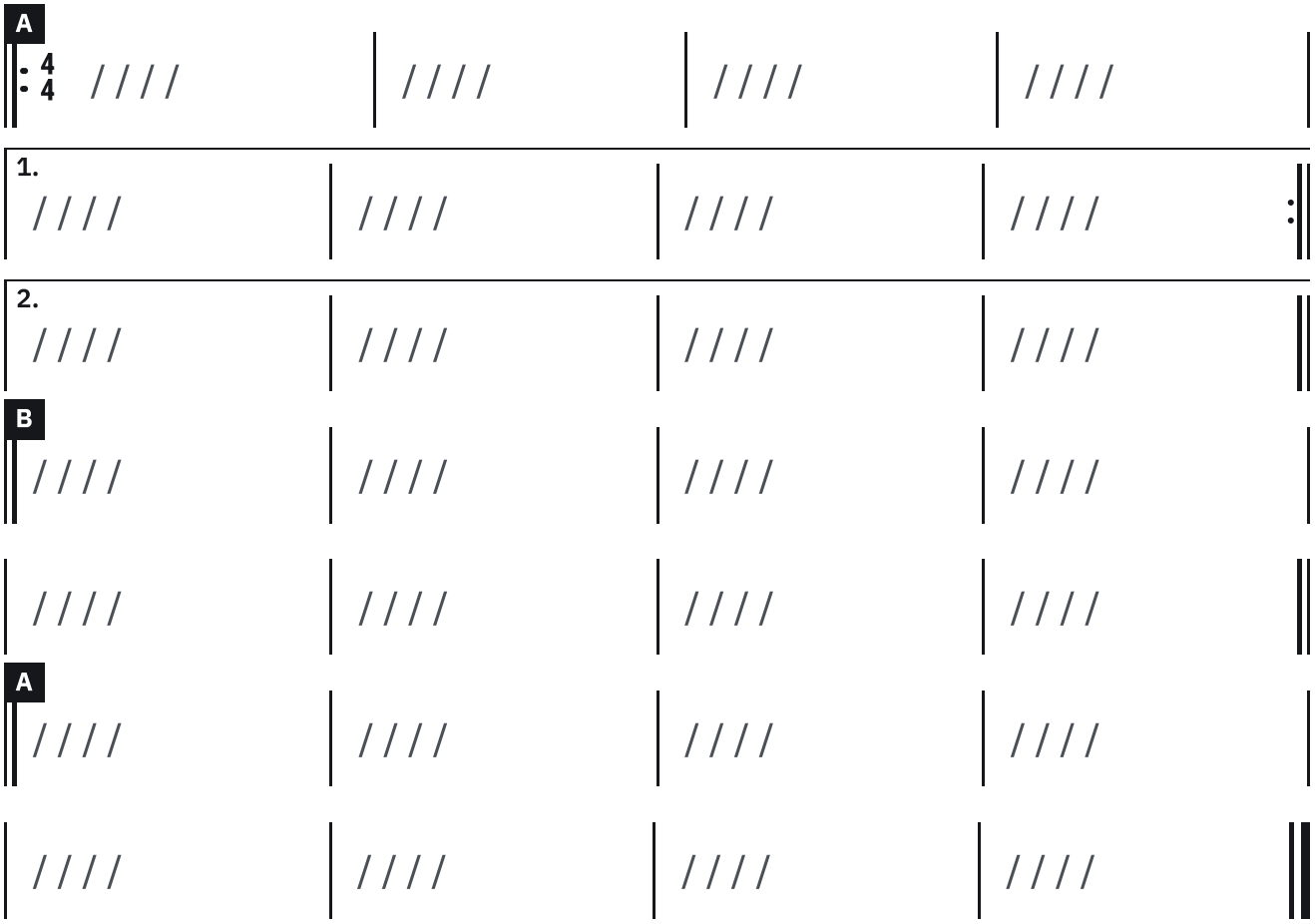
Form charts: sections, repeats and endings, intros and bar counts, with feel, tempo and arrangement.

#	TUNE	FORM	DANCE TEMPO
01	**Ain't Misbehavin'**	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
02	**All of Me**	A B A C · 32	150–190 bpm
03	**All the Things You Are**	A A′ B A″ · 36	150–190 bpm
04	**Autumn Leaves**	A A B C · 32	100–180 bpm
05	**Battle of Jericho**	AABA · 32	150–200 bpm
06	**Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen**	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
07	**Blue Drag**	AABA · 32	90–120 bpm
08	**Blue Moon**	AABA · 32	110–180 bpm
09	**Blue Skies**	AABA · 32	150–190 bpm
10	**Comes Love**	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
11	**Don't Get Around Much Anymore**	AABA · 32	130–180 bpm
12	**Honeysuckle Rose**	AABA · 32	150–190 bpm
13	**I Got Rhythm**	AABA · 32	200–240 bpm
14	**It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing)**	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm
15	**Jumpin' at the Woodside**	AABA · 32	200–250 bpm
16	**Just Friends**	A B A B′ · 32	170–220 bpm
17	**Kansas City Stride**	AABA · 32 + 8-bar intro	170–210 bpm
18	**Lester's Bounce**	AABA · 32	130–170 bpm
19	**Lullaby of Birdland**	AABA · 32	150–200 bpm
20	**Moanin'**	AABA · 32	100–125 bpm
21	**Oh, Lady Be Good**	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
22	**On the Sunny Side of the Street**	AABA · 32	110–140 bpm
23	**Perdido**	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm
24	**Puttin' On the Ritz**	AABA · 32	200–240 bpm
25	**Ridin' and Jivin'**	AABA · 32	150 bpm
26	**Satin Doll**	AABA · 32	130–160 bpm
27	**A Smooth One**	AABA · 32	120 bpm
28	**Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise**	AABA · 32	160–190 bpm
29	**Stompin' at the Savoy**	AABA · 32	190–220 bpm
30	**Take the “A” Train**	AABA · 32	160–200 bpm
31	**Topsy**	AABA · 32	165–200 bpm
32	**Undecided**	AABA · 32	170–210 bpm

(Medium Swing)

Ain't Misbehavin'

Fats Waller, Harry Brooks & Andy Razaf



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written **1929**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

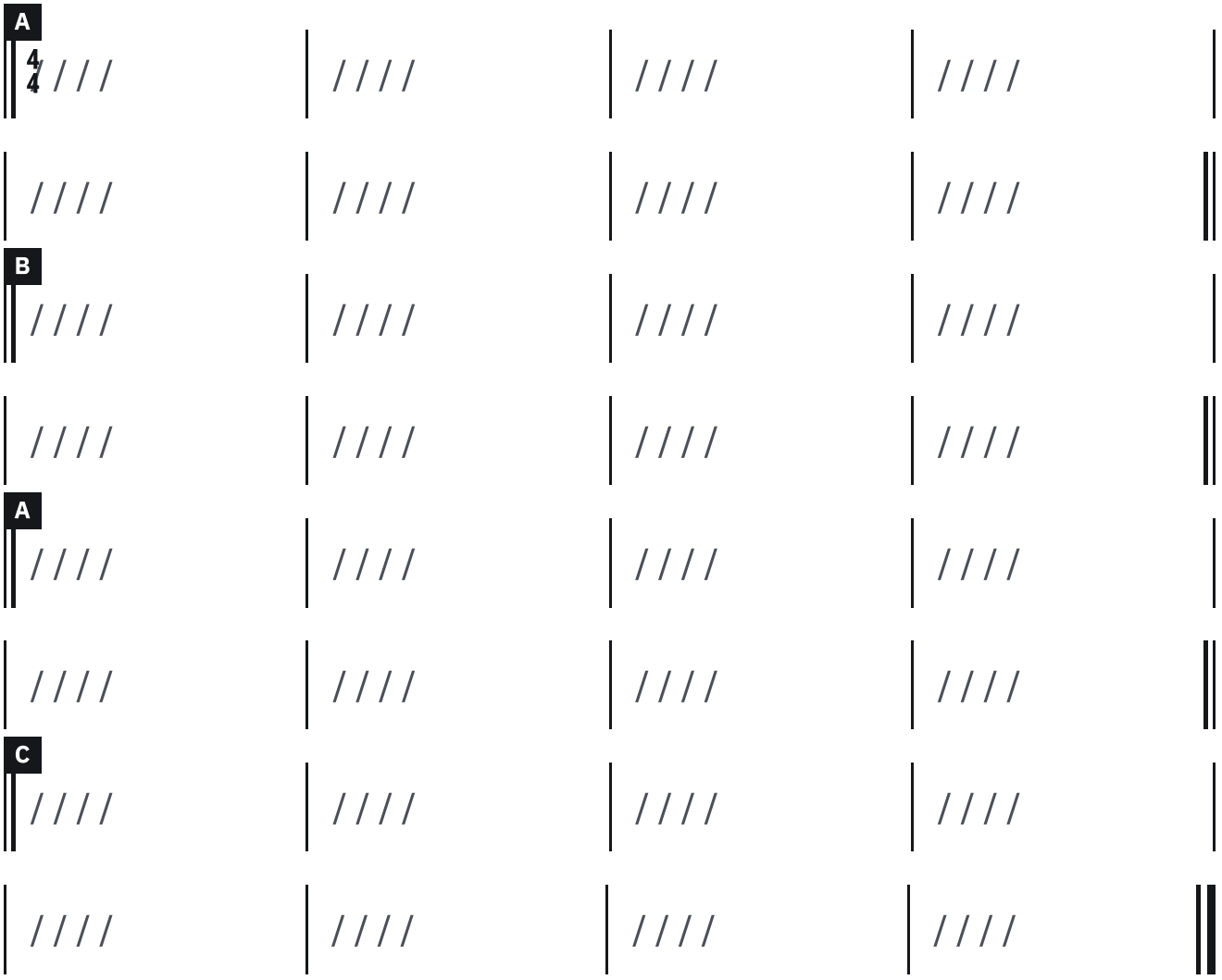
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 130–170: brushes at the slow end, sticks above 150; the Lindy floor wants a steady two-feel on the head.
- Open up to four for solos; mark the bridge (C minor) with a cymbal change or a softer ride.
- The melody has gaps at the end of every second bar: a light fill on beat 4 of bars 2, 4 and 6 answers it without stepping on the horn.

(Medium Swing)

All of Me

Gerald Marks & Seymour Simons



Form **A B A C · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1931**

A 8 · B 8 · A 8 · C 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 150–190 for Lindy; at singer tempo (120) it's a ballad with brushes. Decide at the count-off.
- Head in two, solos in four. The C section is the climax: lift into the B♭–6 and drop back for the last two bars.
- Tag ending: three times G–7 C7 | F6; set up each repeat with a fill on beat 4 and cut the last one together.

(Medium Swing)

All the Things You Are

Jerome Kern & Oscar Hammerstein II



Form **A A′ B A″ · 36** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1939**

A 8 · A′ 8 · B 8 · A″ 12 — 36-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

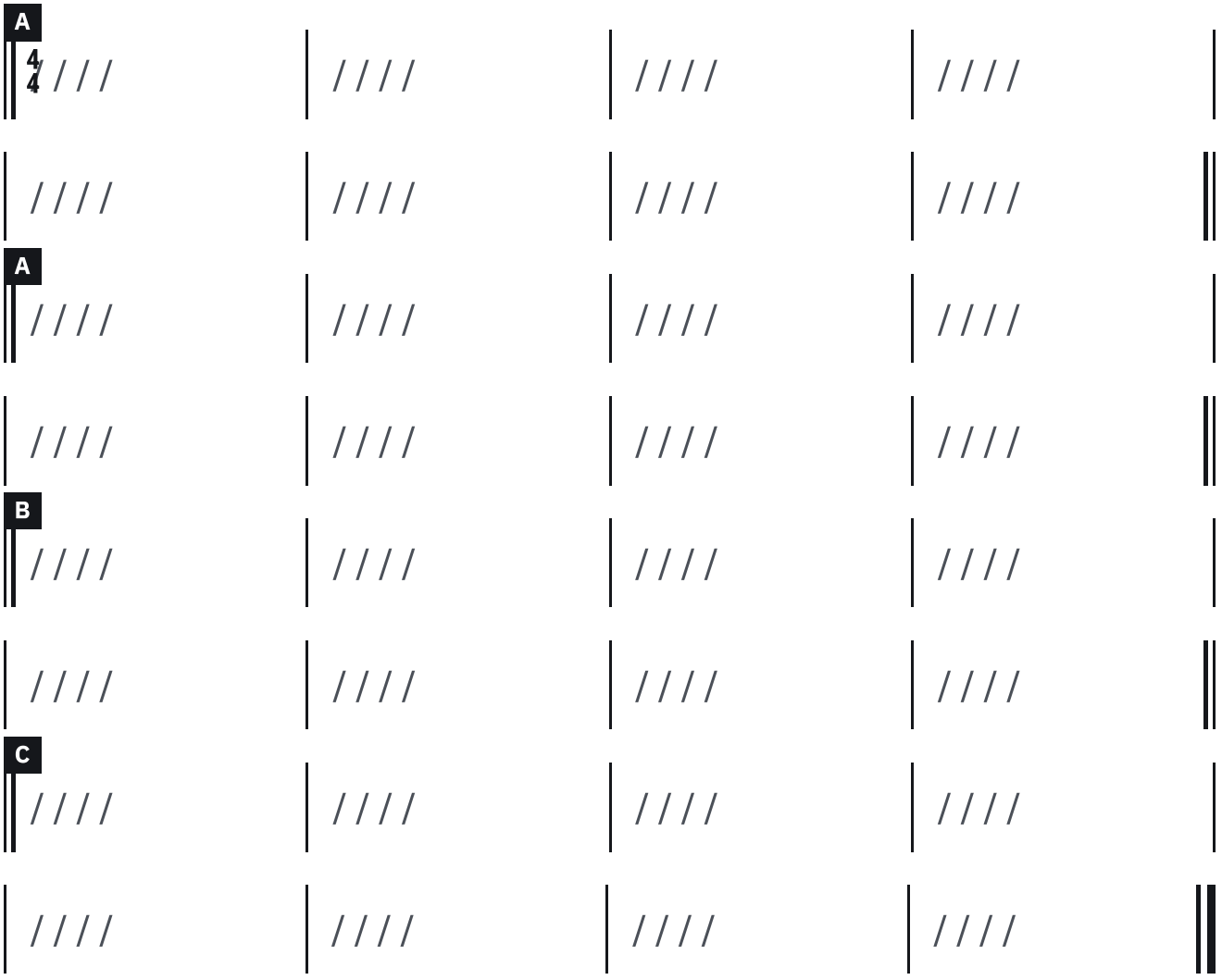
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 150–190, head in two, solos in four; the tune modulates every eight bars, so a ride change at the bridge (bar 17) helps everyone hear the form.
- The last A is twelve bars (25–36): mark bar 29 with a texture change (brushes to sticks, or hi-hat only) so the ending lands together.
- The eight-bar intro is a vamp: time from bar 1, no fills, one set-up into the head.

(Medium Swing)

Autumn Leaves (Les feuilles mortes)

Joseph Kosma (Prévert / Mercer)



Form **A A B C · 32** Feel **Lindy / ballad** Dance tempo **100–180 bpm** Written **1945**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · C 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

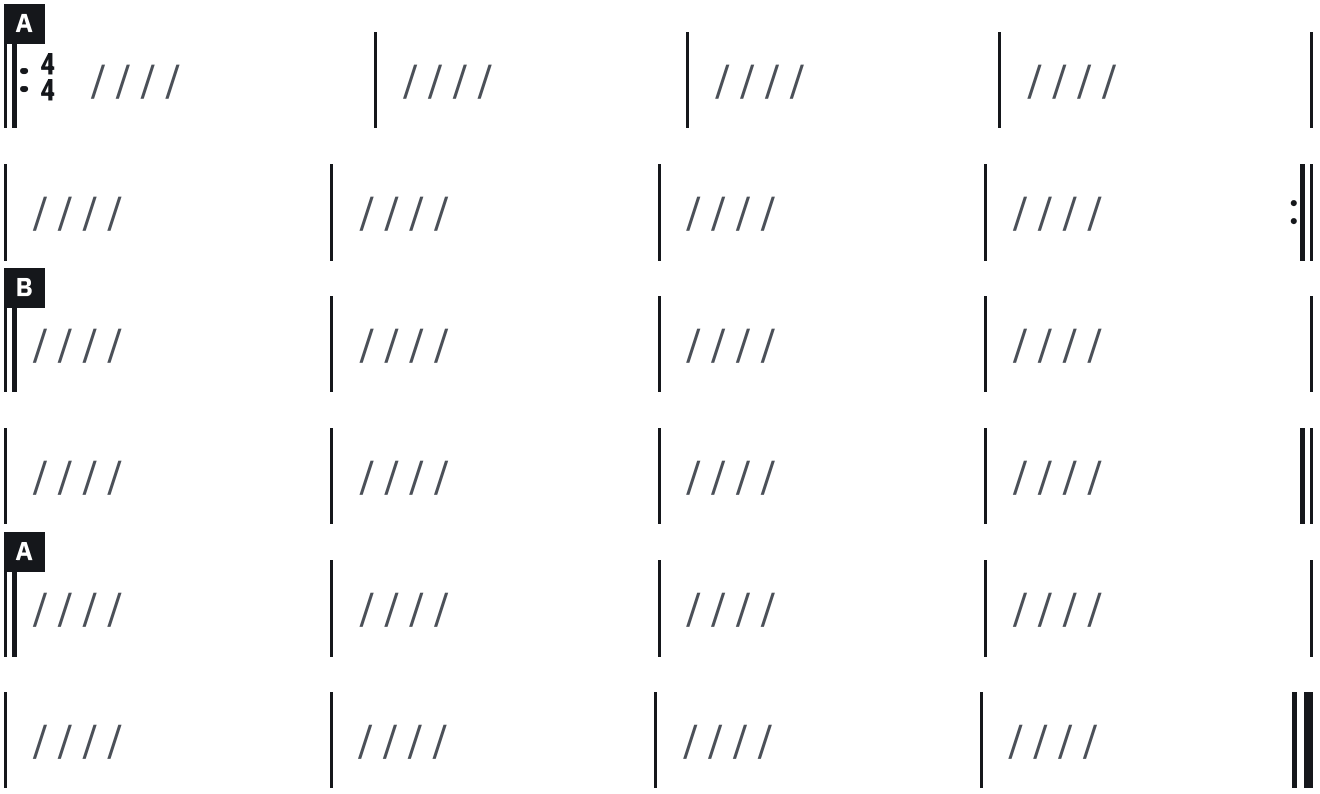
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 100–180: brushes and a blues-dance feel at the slow end, sticks and Lindy at 160. Head in two, solos in four either way.
- If the singer does the rubato verse, stay out until bar 1 of the A; mark the C section (bar 25), since it's new material.
- Ending: tag Dø7 G7 C– three times, or the bass alone on C with you on a cymbal roll.

(Medium Swing)

Battle of Jericho (Joshua Fit the Battle)

Traditional spiritual, your band's arrangement



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–200 bpm** Written **trad.**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

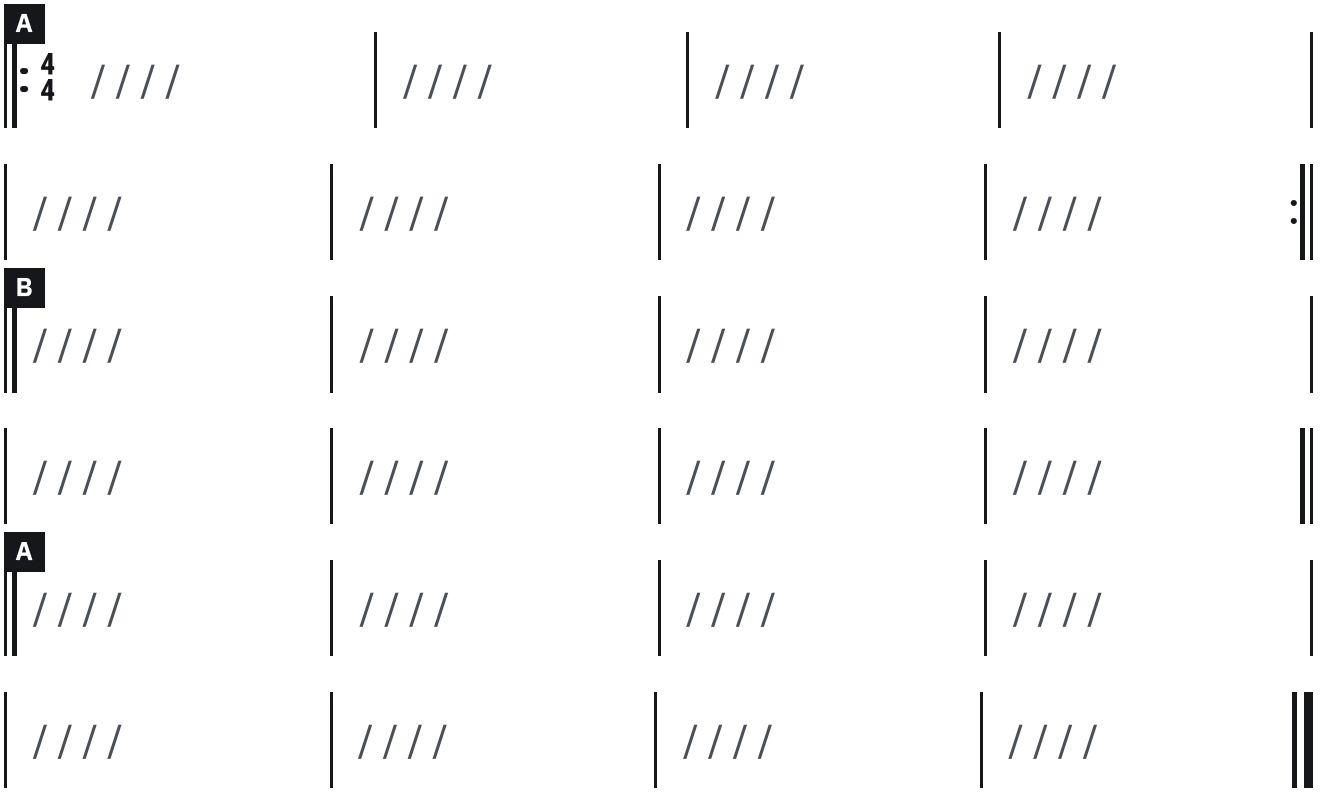
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 150–200, Lindy. Build each A: bars 1–8 soft, 9–16 louder; the bridge drops to bass and snare only; the last A is the shout.
- The intro is four bars of walking bass alone; join in bar 5 (hi-hat on 2 and 4, then ride) and the head starts.
- Two chords, so hits are yours to call: a backbeat on the snare through the bridge is the gospel reference (Bechet's record).

(Medium Swing)

Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen

Sholom Secunda



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1932**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

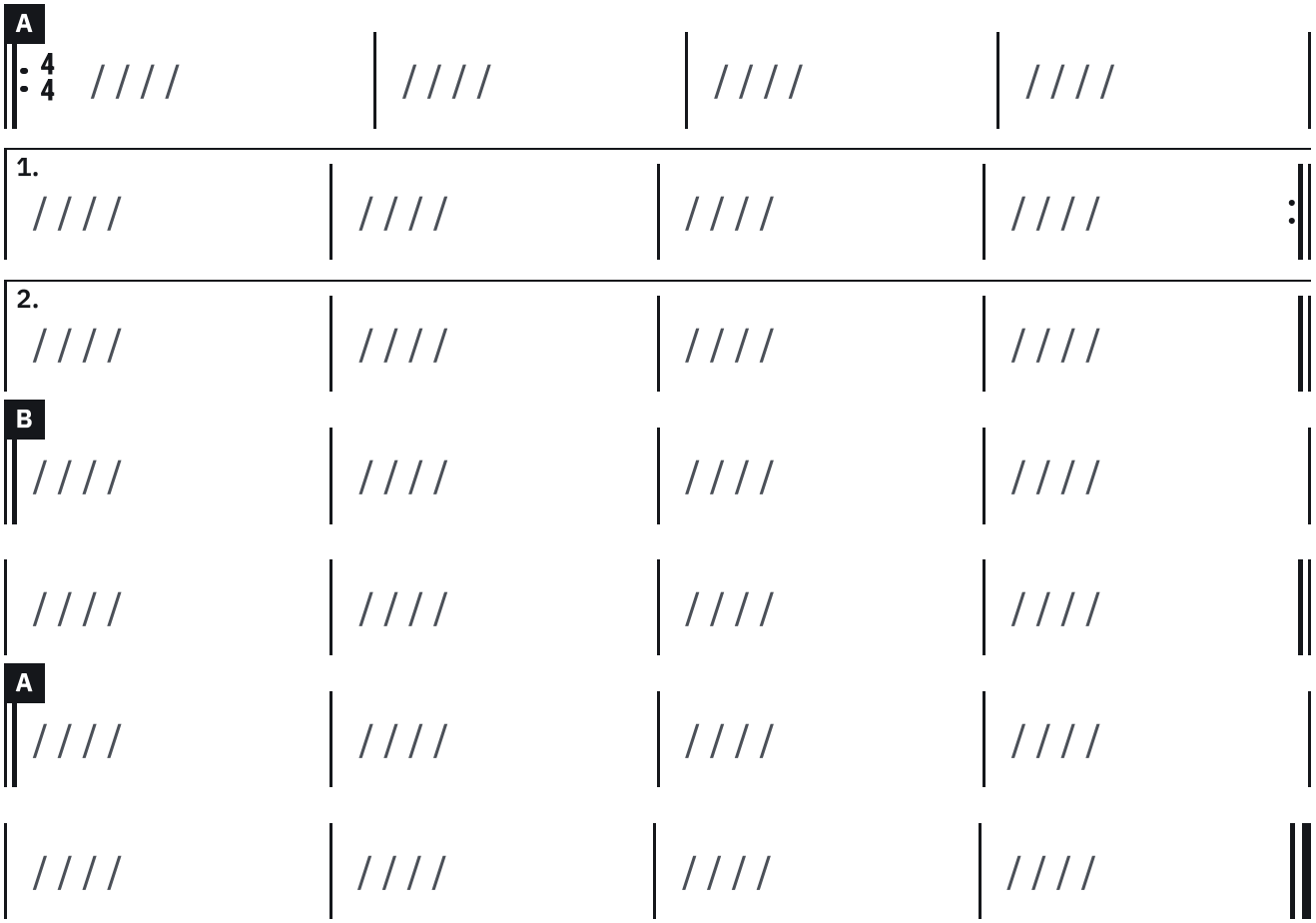
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 160–200, Lindy; head in two with a strong hi-hat on 2 and 4, solos in four.
- The band comps a Charleston figure in bars 1–4: catch the 'and' of 2 with the bass drum or a rim click, then straight time in bars 5–8.
- Bridge: softer ride; last A: shout chorus, backbeat on the snare.

(Slow Swing)

Blue Drag

Josef Myrow (your Pataswing chart)



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Slow lindy / blues** Dance tempo **90–120 bpm** Written **1932**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Slow Swing.

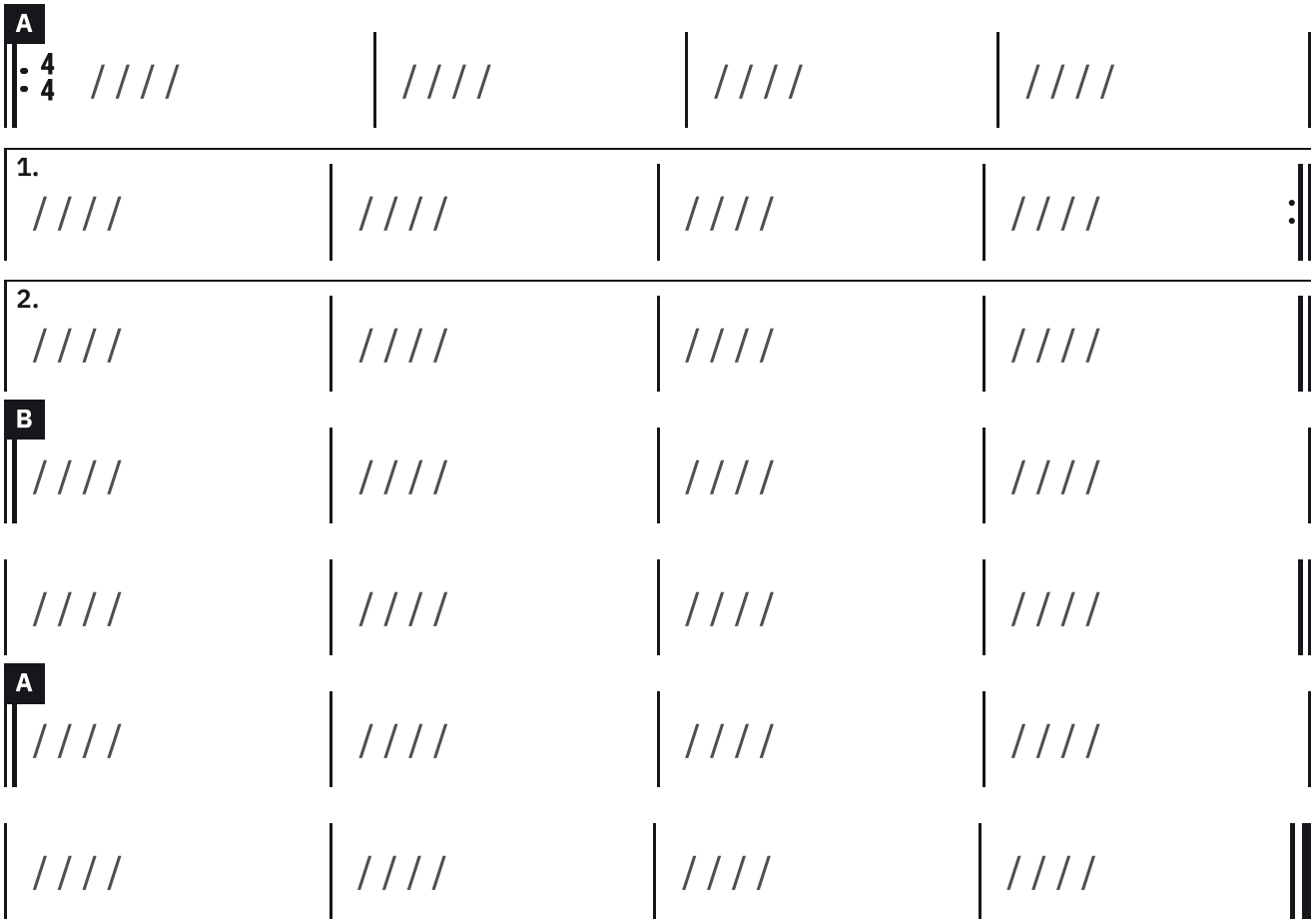
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 90–120, slow shuffle or slow swing with brushes; the title is a drag, so sit behind the beat with the bass.
- Head in two, light; the bridge melody is mostly rests, so keep the time bare (hi-hat and a brush sweep).
- The chromatic pickup into the last A is a horn line: set it up with a press roll into bar 25. Ending: a cymbal roll under the piano's rit.

(Medium Swing)

Blue Moon

Richard Rodgers & Lorenz Hart



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / blues** Dance tempo **110–180 bpm** Written **1934**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

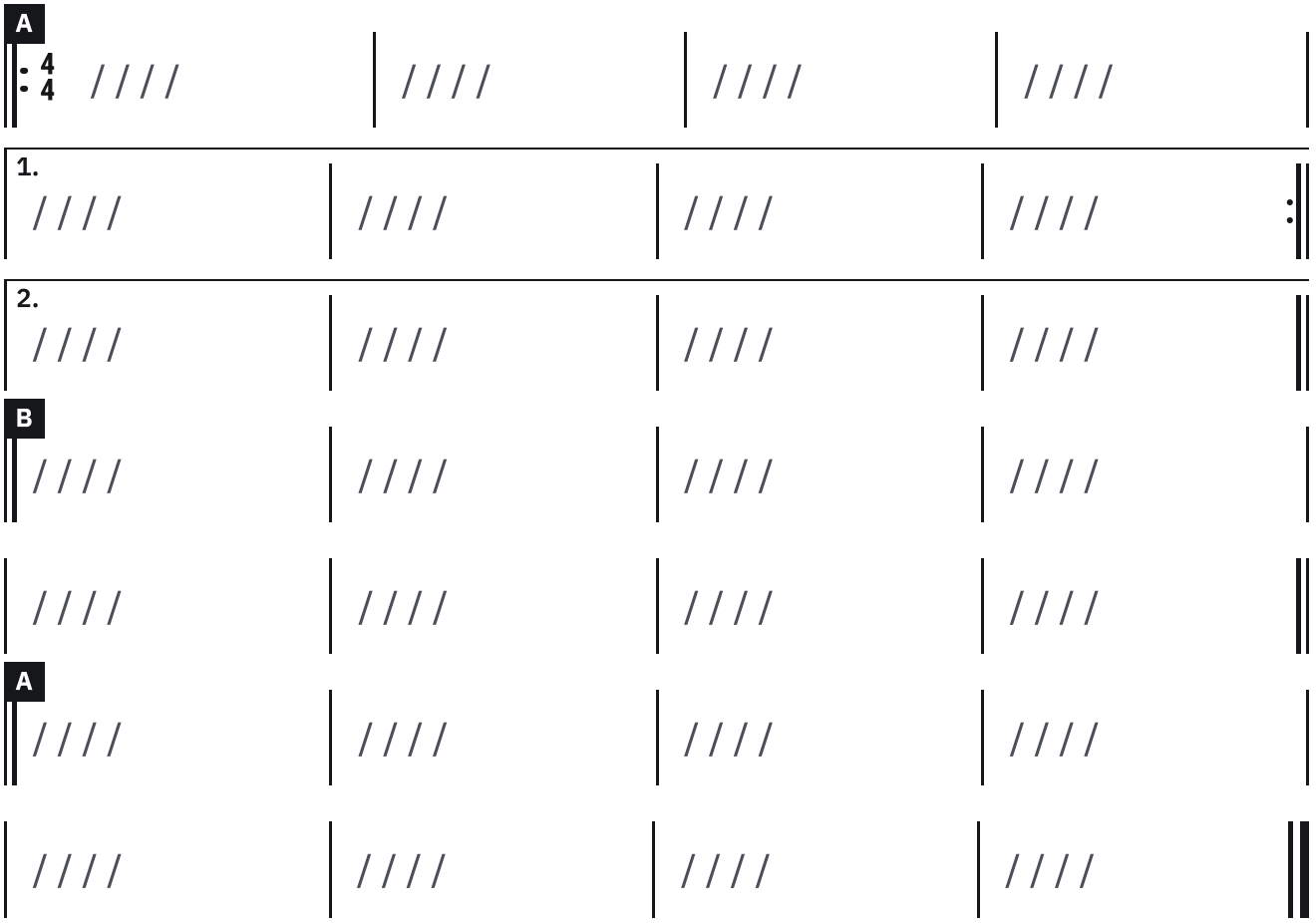
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- Two tempos, two dances: 110 is blues (brushes, triplets), 170 is Lindy (sticks, two-feel head); settle it before the count-off.
- The loop repeats every two bars: keep the time simple and mark the bridge (bar 17) and its G♭ bars (21–22) with a lighter ride.
- Intro and ending are the loop vamped; the tag is three times round the loop, so count the repeats with the piano.

(Medium Up Swing)

Blue Skies

Irving Berlin



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1926**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Up Swing.

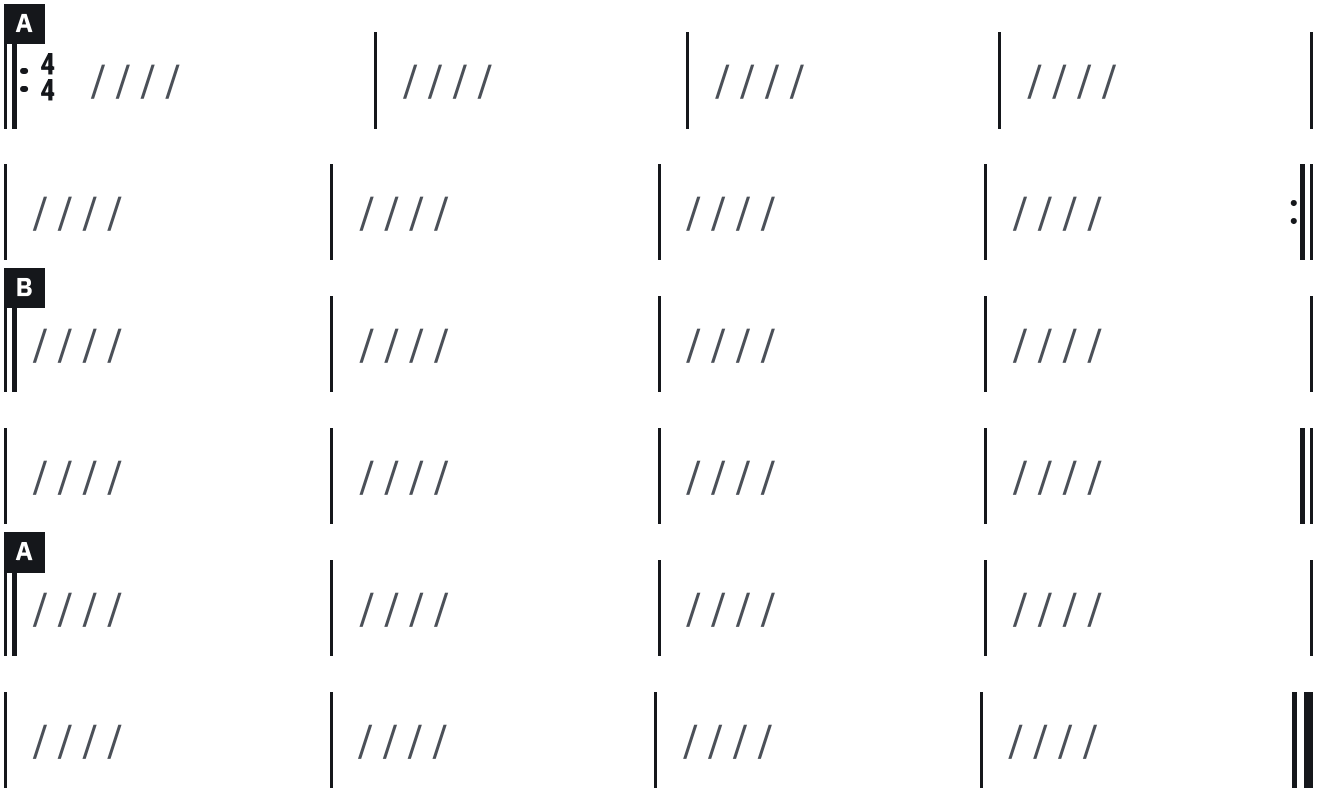
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 150–190, Lindy; head in two, solos in four. The 1938 Goodman Carnegie Hall version is the feel.
- Minor A sections, major bridge: lighten the ride on the bridge so the return to C– is felt.
- The held notes in bars 1–4 leave the time exposed: keep the hi-hat crisp and no fills until bar 5.

(Medium Swing)

Comes Love

Sam H. Stept (Lew Brown & Charles Tobias)



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written **1939**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

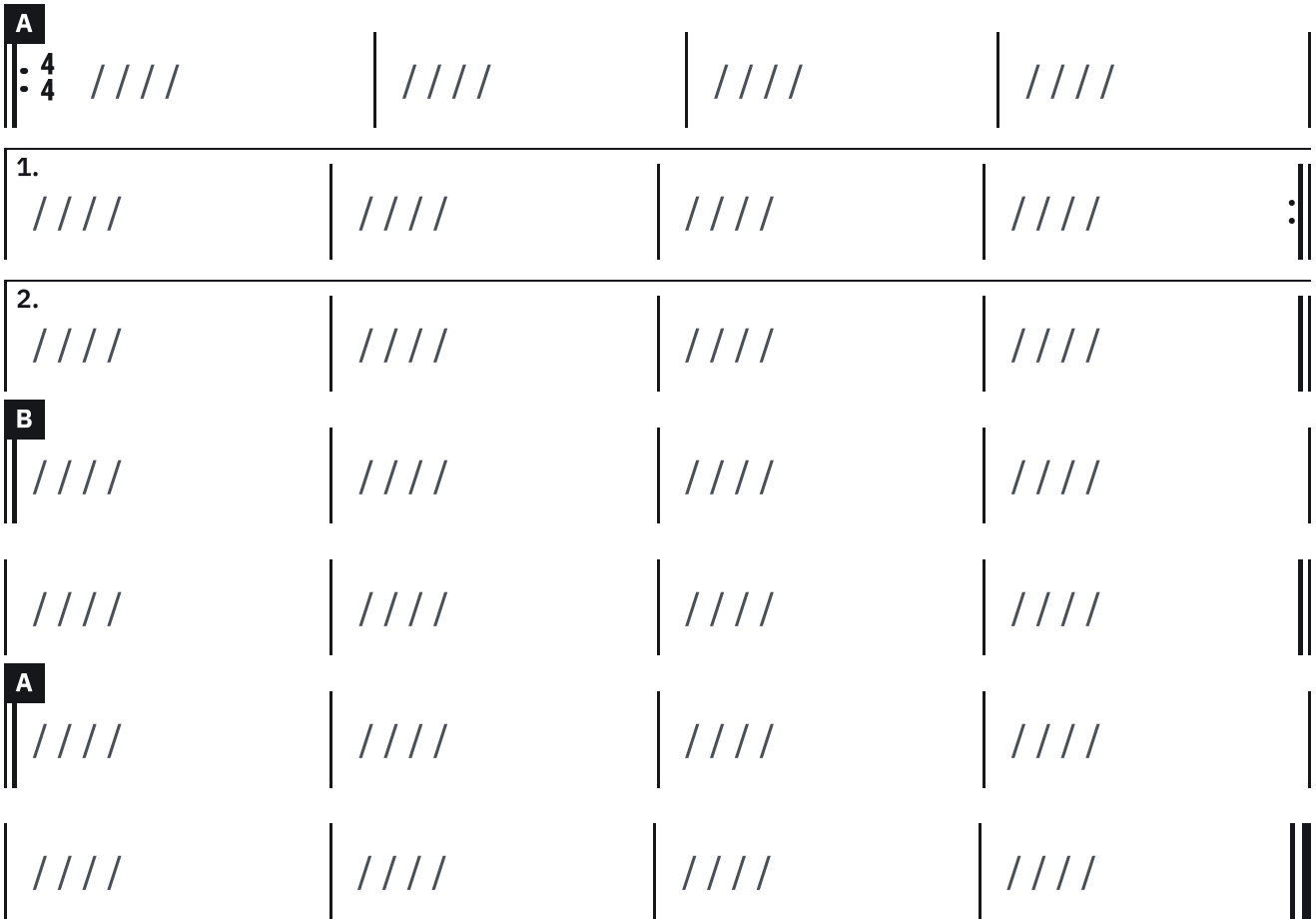
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 130–170 Lindy, or 90 as a ballad with brushes behind a singer; the band decides from the singer.
- Head in two; the title phrase (bars 7–8) is a stab with the horns, so catch it with snare and bass drum together.
- The bridge is the only harmonic change (A7 → D–): a cymbal change at bar 17, back to the ride at 25.

(Medium Swing)

Don't Get Around Much Anymore

Duke Ellington & Bob Russell



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / slow swing** Dance tempo **130–180 bpm** Written **1940**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

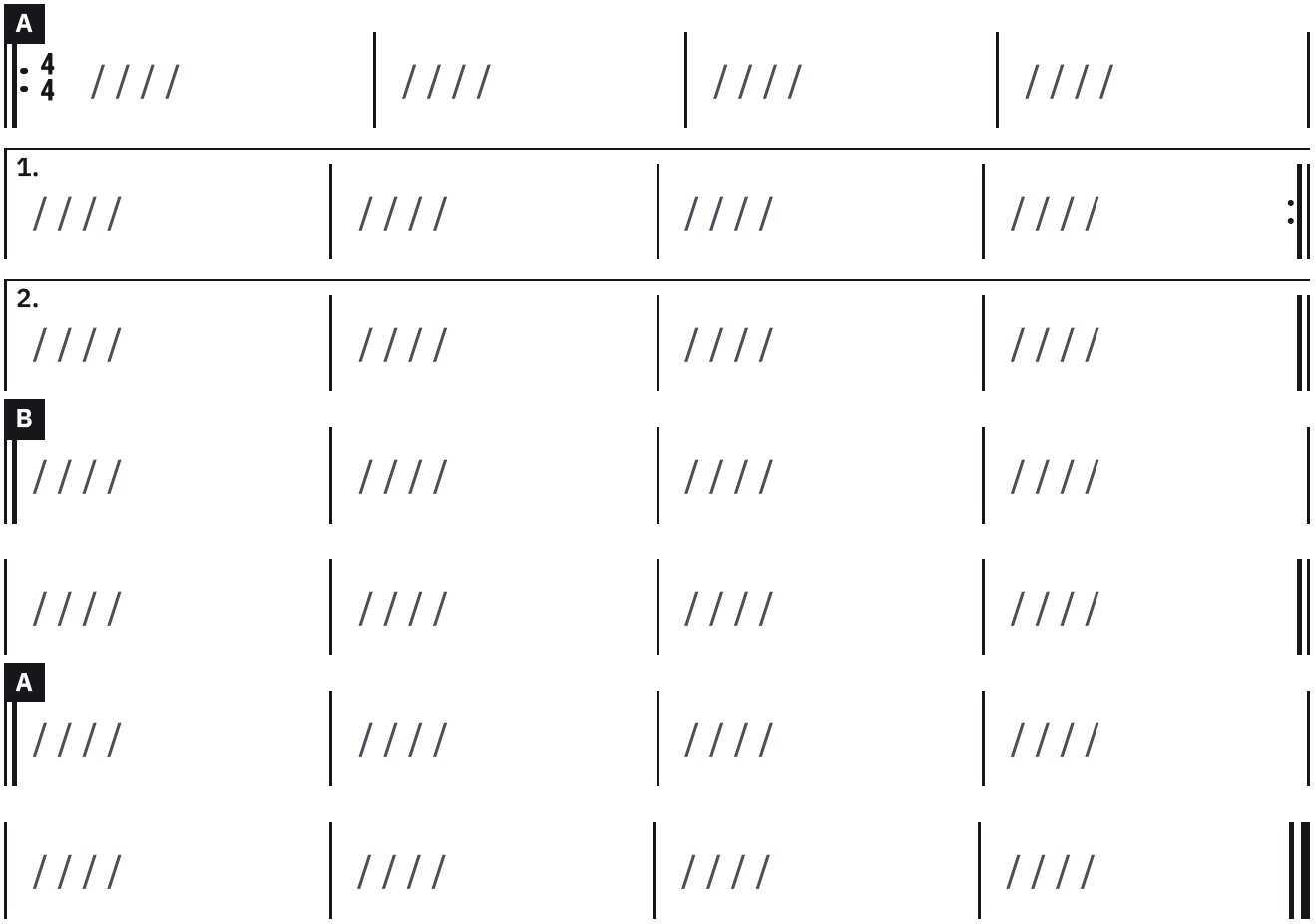
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- Head in two, solos in four: the textbook case; 120 behind a singer with brushes, 170 for the floor with sticks.
- Mark the bridge (bar 17) with a lighter ride; the D7 bars (21–22) are the lift into the last A.
- The melody stops in bars 7–8 of each A: a two-beat fill there, then back to time.

(Medium Swing)

Honeysuckle Rose

Fats Waller & Andy Razaf



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **150–190 bpm** Written **1929**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

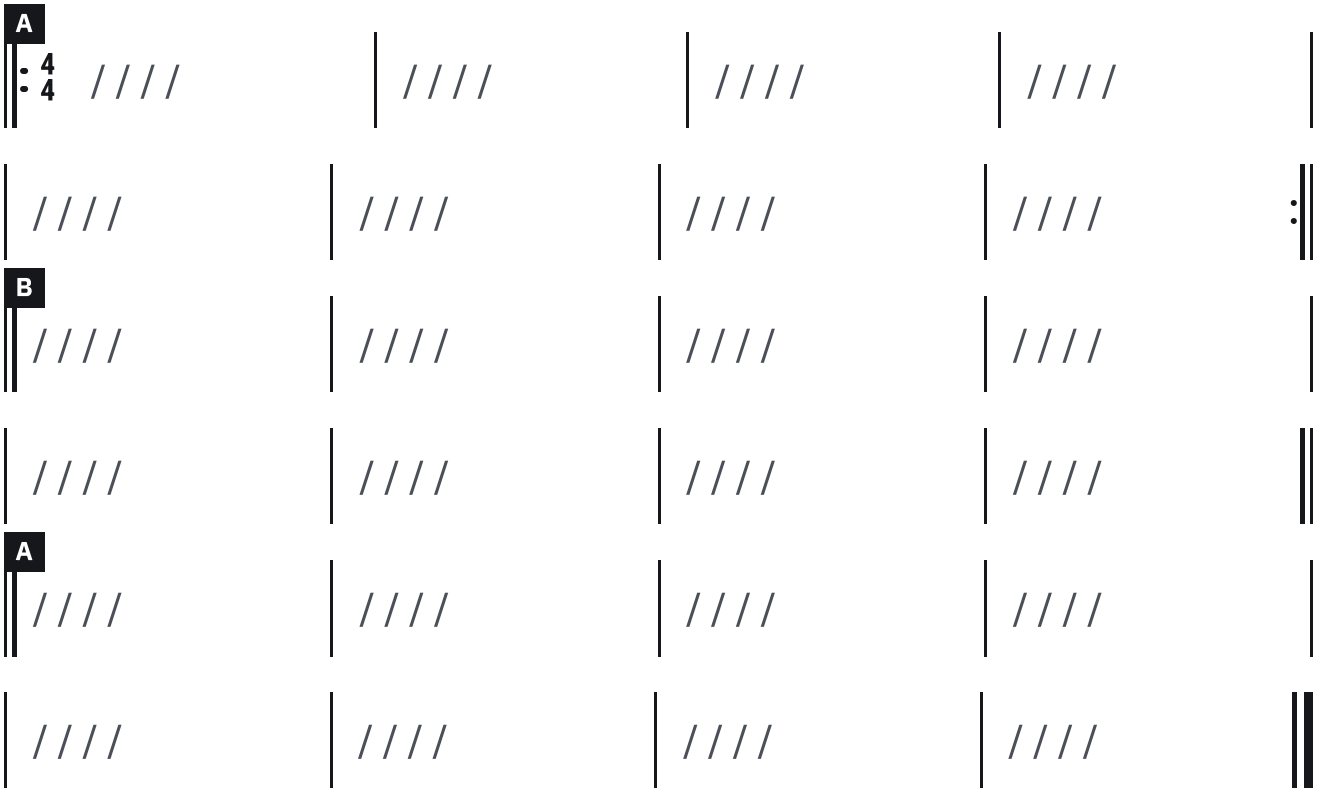
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 150–190 Lindy, head in two, solos in four; the A vamps for four bars, so keep the time dead even there.
- Bars 5–8 of each A are the harmonic movement: a slight lift there and back to the vamp.
- Bridge: two bars a chord; the band walks up into B♭ and into C7; catch the walk-ups with a hi-hat accent on 4.

(Up Swing)

I Got Rhythm (Rhythm Changes)

George Gershwin



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Charleston / fast lindy** Dance tempo **200–240 bpm** Written **1930**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Up Swing.

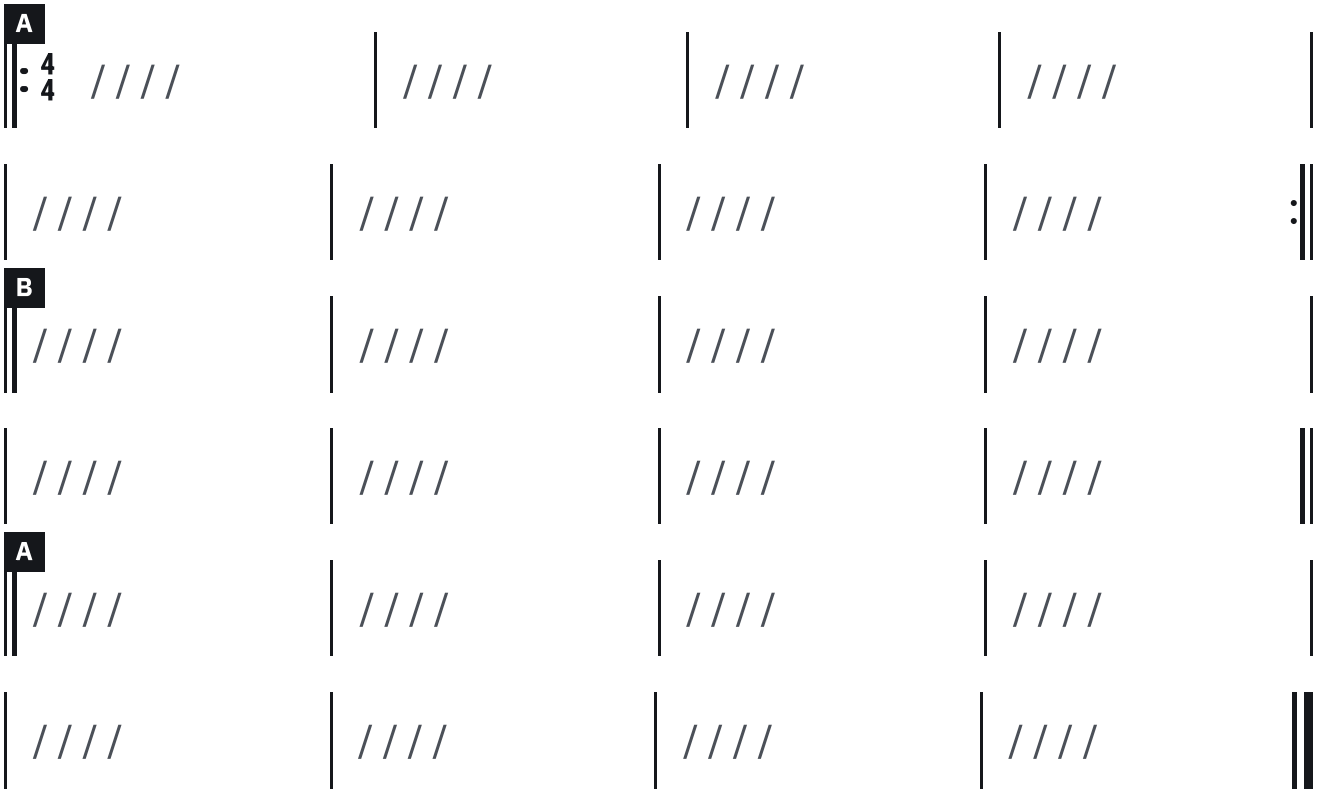
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 200–240, Charleston / fast Lindy: four on the hi-hat or ride from bar one, no two-feel; the dancers want the pulse immediately.
- Intro is four bars of the turnaround at tempo: play time, set the tempo, one fill into the head.
- Bridge (D7 G7 C7 F7) is the only harmonic change, so change the cymbal there; out chorus: the last A as a shout with a Basie tag, three times, the last one cut together.

(Medium Swing)

It Don't Mean a Thing (If It Ain't Got That Swing)

Duke Ellington & Irving Mills



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1931**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

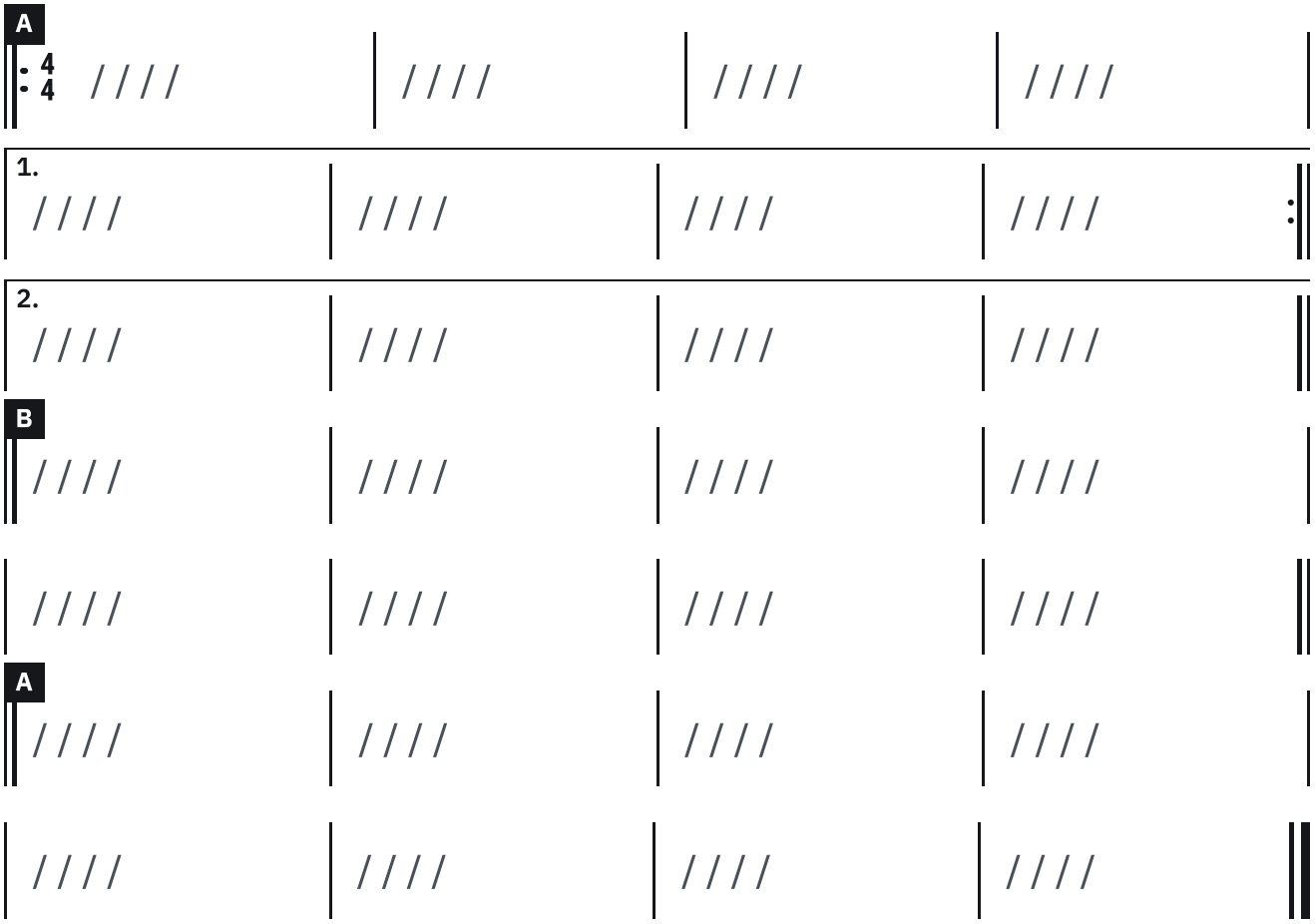
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 170–210 Lindy; the doo-wah bars (5–8 of each A) are stabs on the 'and' of 2 and 4 with the horns: catch them on snare and bass drum, then straight time.
- Head in two, solos in four; the bridge goes major, so lighten the ride there and come back strong at the last A.
- Hi-hat on 2 and 4 is the Ellington feel; the 1932 original has the growl.

(Up Swing)

Jumpin' at the Woodside

Count Basie (Eddie Durham)



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Fast lindy** Dance tempo **200–250 bpm** Written **1938**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Up Swing.

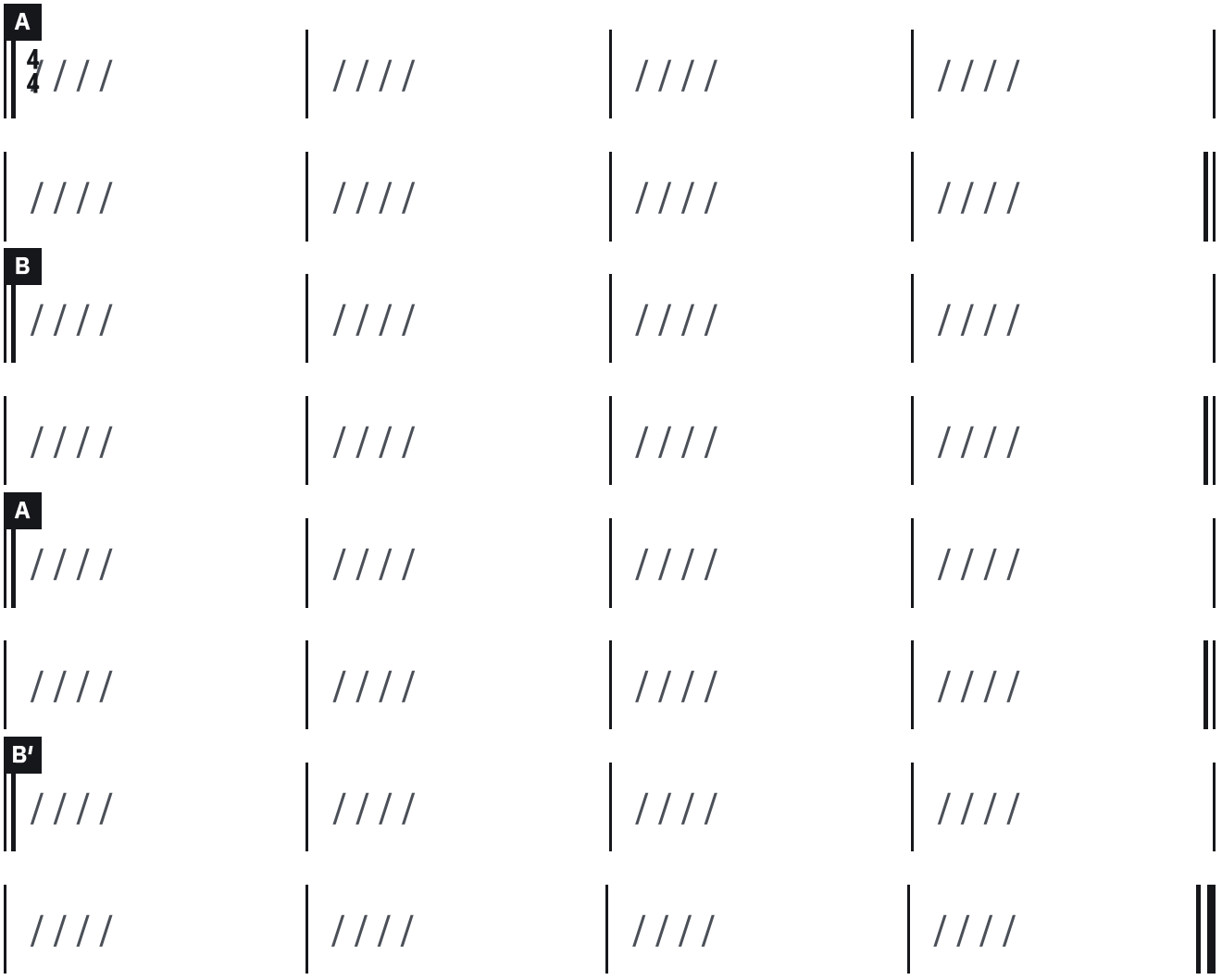
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 200–250, fast Lindy: four on the ride from bar one, hi-hat on 2 and 4, no two-feel; this closes the dance.
- Riff tune: the head is stacked riffs, so build the dynamics chorus by chorus; the bridge (B♭7 E♭ C7 F7) is the only harmonic movement, mark it lightly.
- Out: riff choruses with the band dropping out around them; your backbeat and the riffs are the climax. Big ending on the last B♭.

(Up Swing)

Just Friends

John Klenner & Sam M. Lewis



Form **A B A B′ · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **170–220 bpm** Written **1931**

A 8 · B 8 · A 8 · B′ 8 — 32-bar chorus. Up Swing.

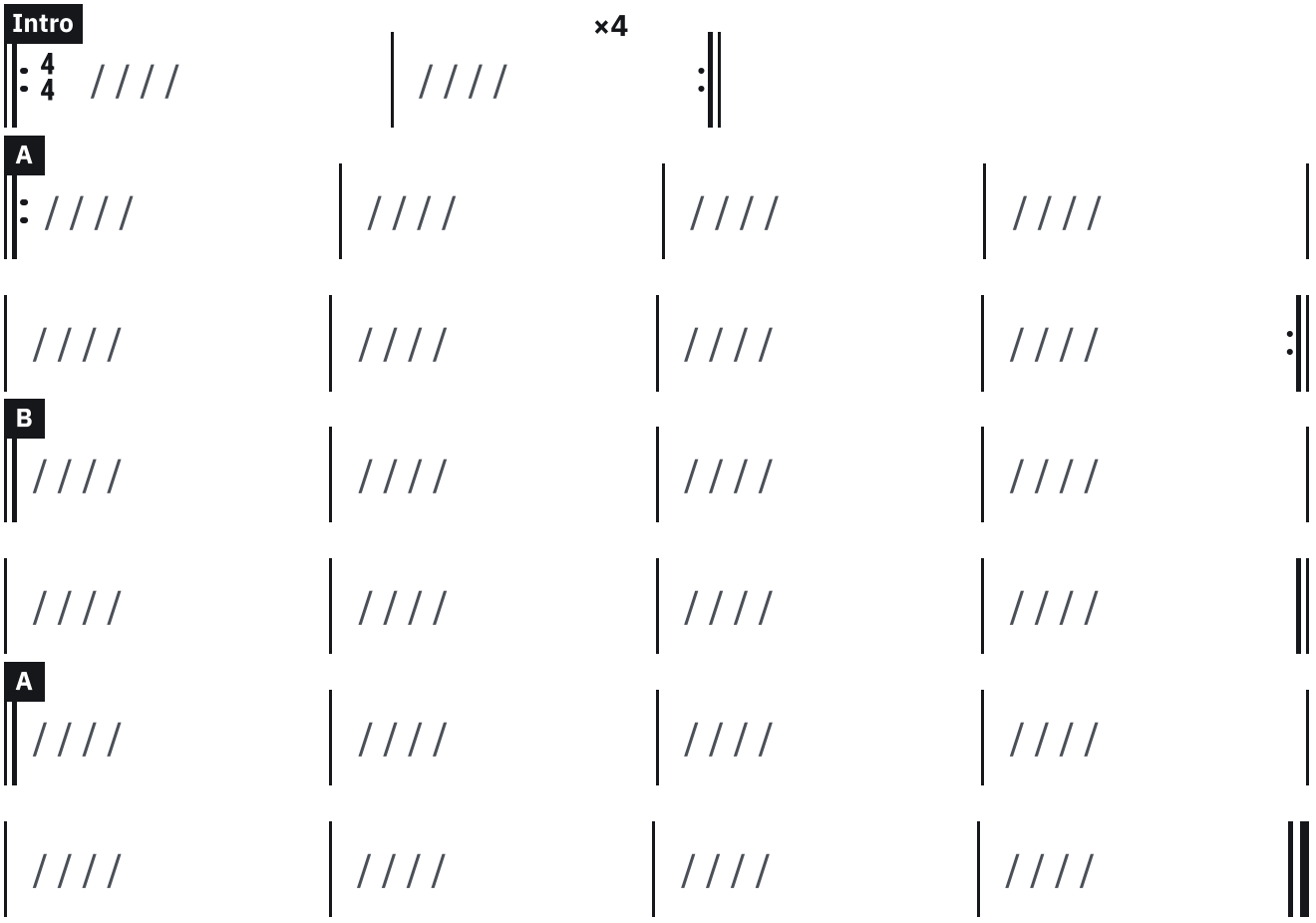
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 170–220: at 200 it's a Balboa tune, so a crisp two-feel on the hi-hat with the ride light; head in two, solos in four.
- The form is A B A B′, not AABA: bar 17 is a return of the A, bar 25 the B′; mark bar 25 so the ending lands.
- Intro and tag are the last four bars (A–7 D7 | G6 | D–7 G7): time through the intro, cut the tag together on G6.

(Medium Up Swing)

Kansas City Stride

Giorgio Cuscito (Tiber River Dixieland)



Form **AABA · 32 + 8-bar intro** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **2011**

Intro 8 bars (2-bar vamp ×4) · A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Up Swing.

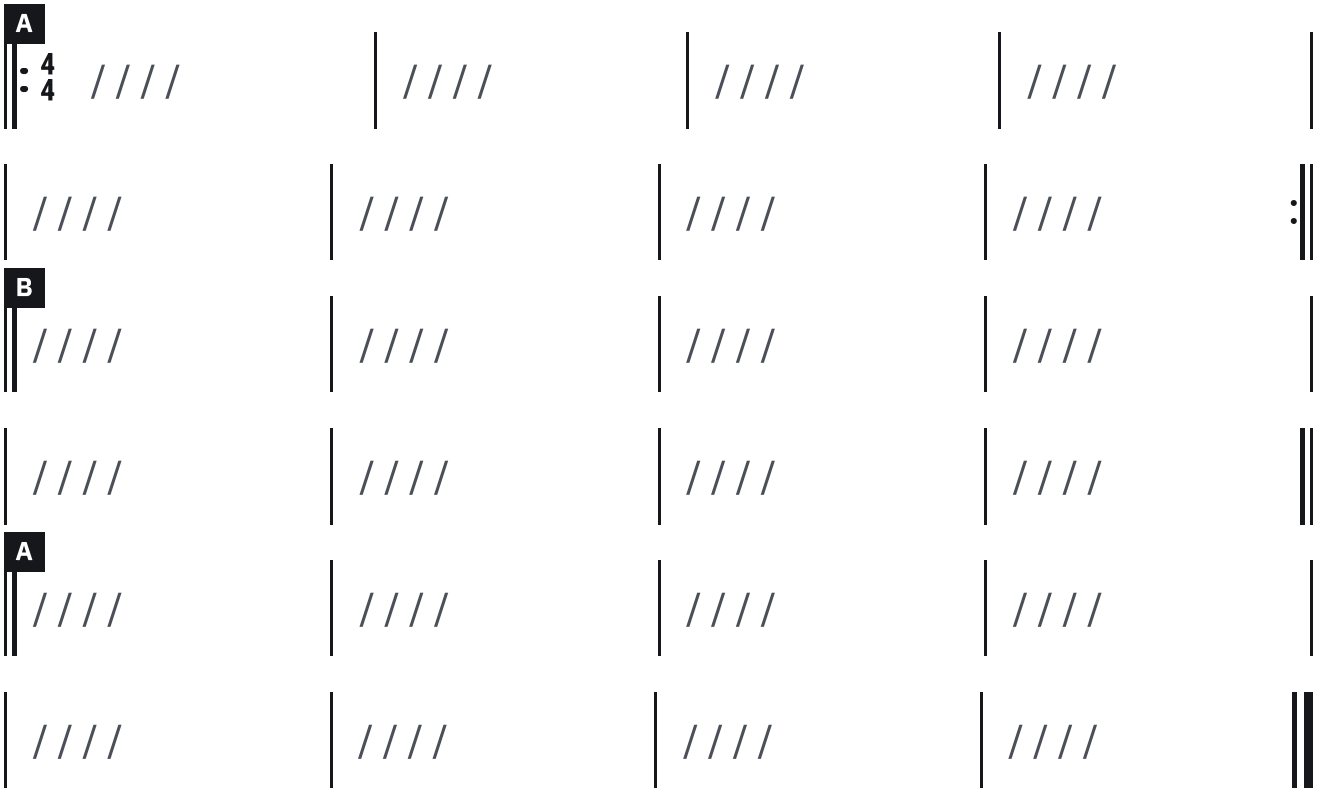
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 170–210, Lindy / Balboa; intro is the Basie build: piano alone, you and the bass join on the second time through (hi-hat on 2 and 4), horns on the third; catch the D7 kick on beats 3–4 of bar 2 every time.
- Head in two, solos in four; the A is a riff with an answer every second bar, so keep the time plain and let the band's riff be the rhythm.
- Bridge: two bars a chord, lighter ride; the last two bars (B♭–6) lift back into the riff. Out: tag the last two bars three times, cut the G–6 together.

(Medium Swing)

Lester's Bounce

Your band's chart (Bob Wilber / Antti Sarpila recording)



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **130–170 bpm** Written

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

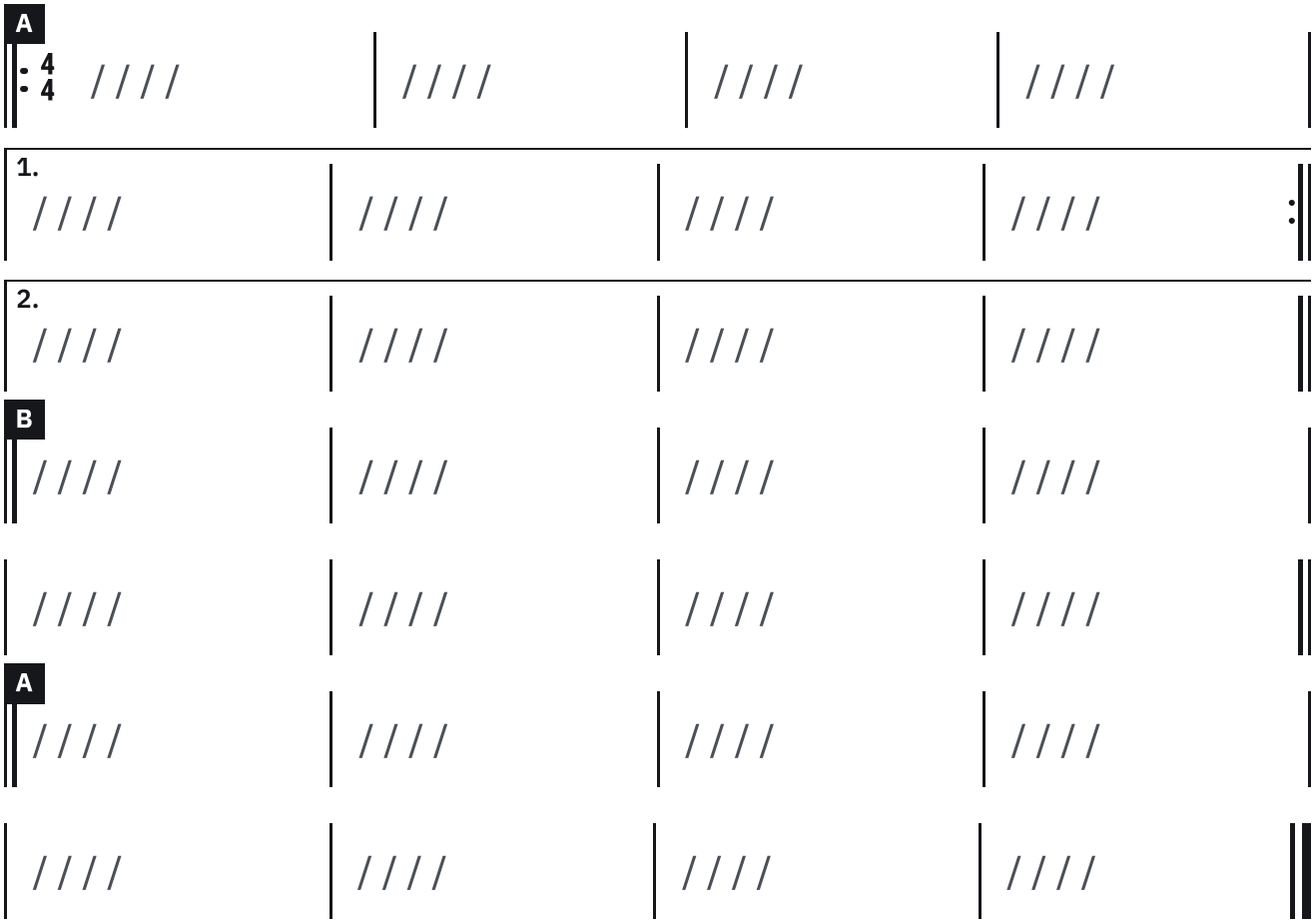
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 130–170, Lazy-lindy tempo (140); the 4-bar intro vamp is the A loop: hi-hat on 2 and 4, then the ride on the head.
- Head in two, solos in four; bars 5–7 of each A are a chromatic climb in bass and horns: build into bar 7 and land bar 8 (E♭7 D7).
- Bridge: two bars a chord (G7 C– A7 D7); a lighter ride, and the D7 bars (23–24) set up the last A.

(Medium Swing)

Lullaby of Birdland

George Shearing



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **150–200 bpm** Written **1952**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

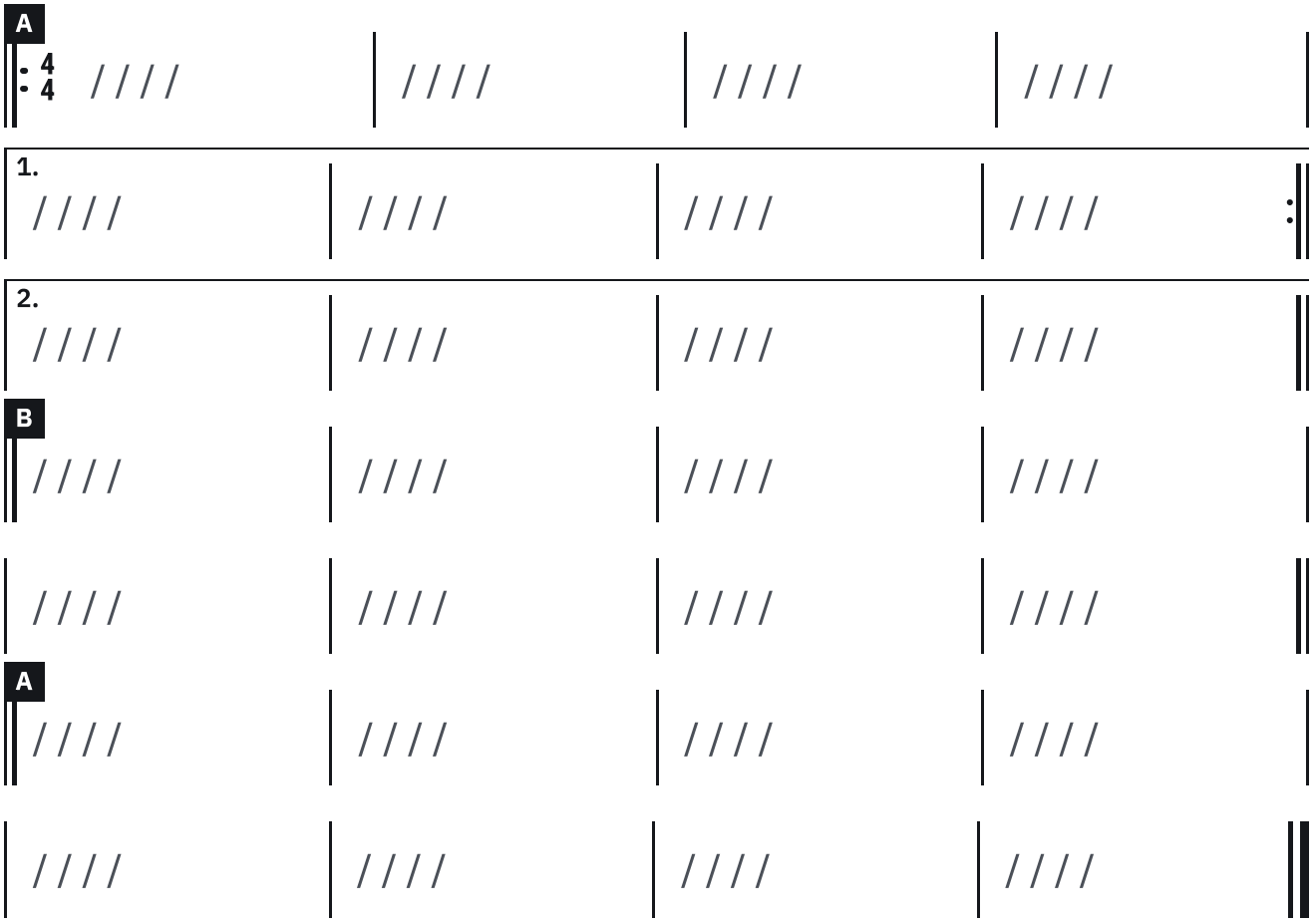
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 150–200: Lindy at the slow end, Balboa above 180; the chords change every two beats, so keep the time plain and the hi-hat crisp.
- Head in two, solos in four; brushes on the head and sticks for solos is period-correct for the Shearing sound.
- Minor A, major bridge: lighten the ride at bar 17 and bring it back at bar 25 with the F minor.

(Slow Shuffle)

Moanin'

Bobby Timmons



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Slow lindy / blues shuffle** Dance tempo **100–125 bpm** Written **1958**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Slow Shuffle.

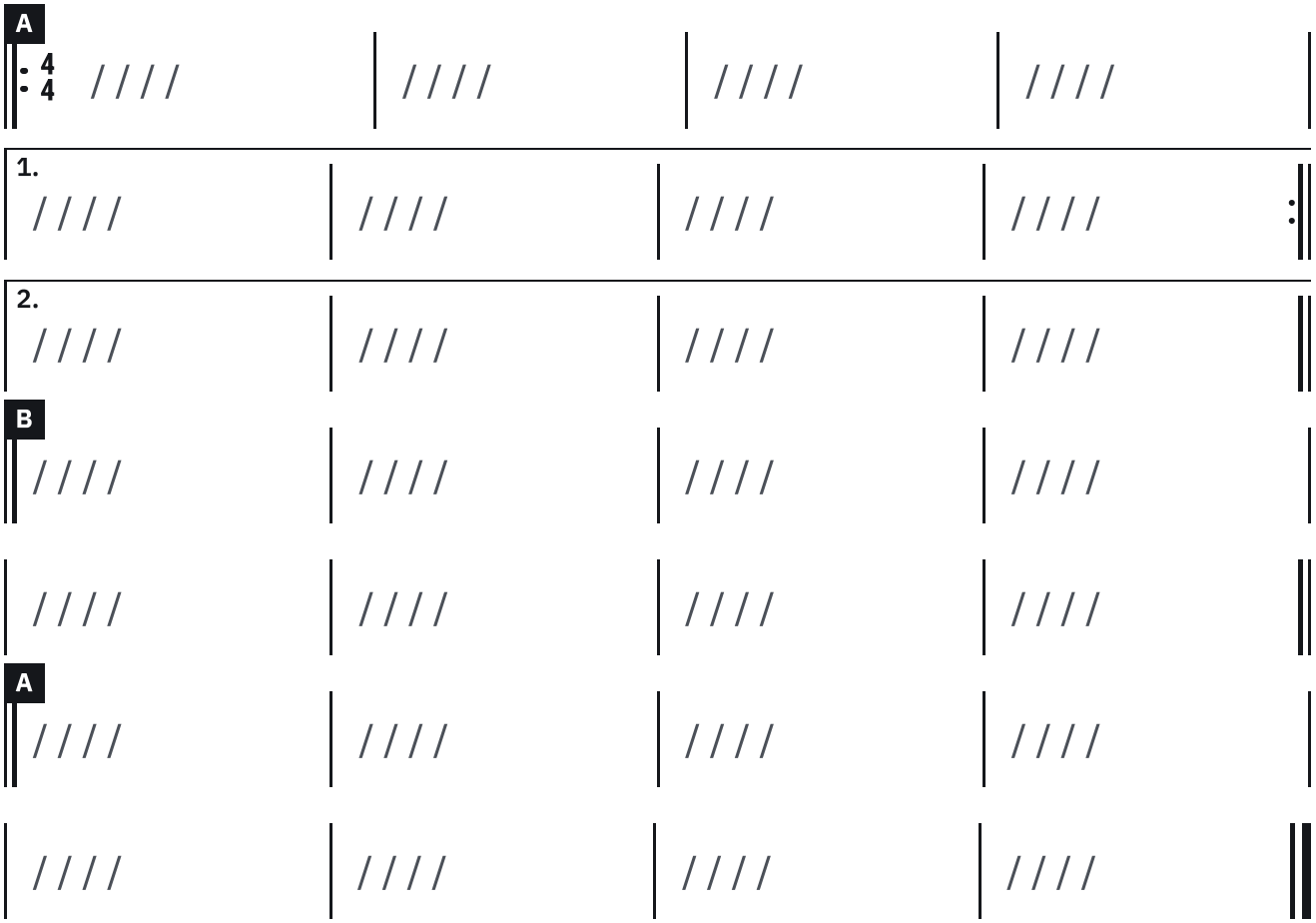
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- Shuffle at 100–125: Blakey's record is the reference, a hard shuffle on the ride with the backbeat on 2 and 4; around 110 it fills a blues floor.
- The head is call (piano, bars 1, 3, 5) and response (band, bars 2, 4, 6): hit the response with the band on snare and bass drum.
- Bridge: the band descends B♭ – A♭ – G into C7; the two bars of C7 at the end (23–24) set up the last A: fill there.

(Medium Swing)

Oh, Lady Be Good

George & Ira Gershwin



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1924**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

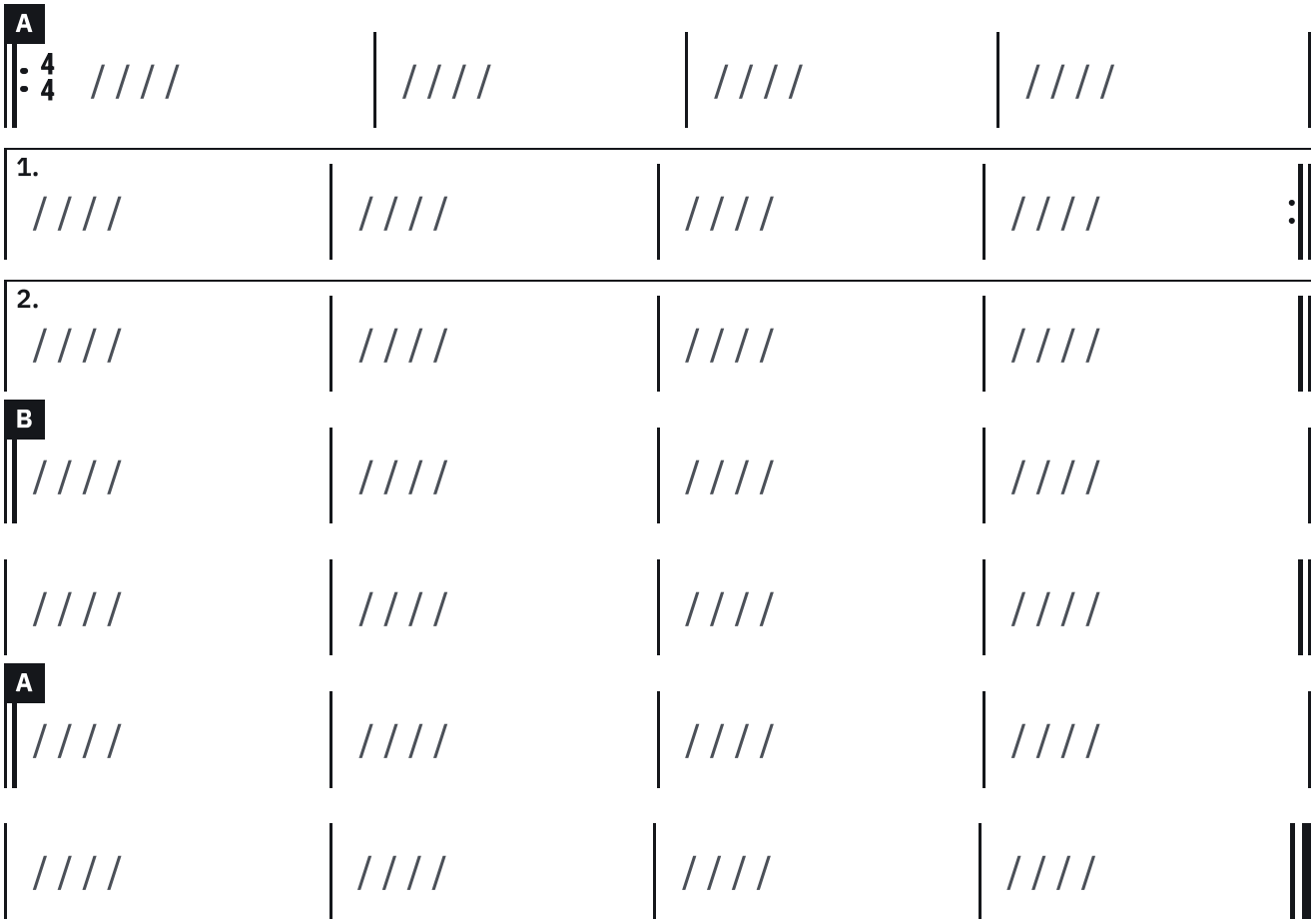
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 160–200 Lindy; head in two, solos in four. Jones-Smith Inc. (1936) is the feel: light ride, hi-hat on 2 and 4, no clutter.
- The A is four bars of G: keep it plain; the bridge dominants (E7 A7 D7, bars 21–24) are the lift, mark them.
- Riff-and-blues tune: fills in the last two bars of each A, nowhere else.

(Medium Swing)

On the Sunny Side of the Street

Jimmy McHugh & Dorothy Fields



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lazy lindy / blues** Dance tempo **110–140 bpm** Written **1930**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

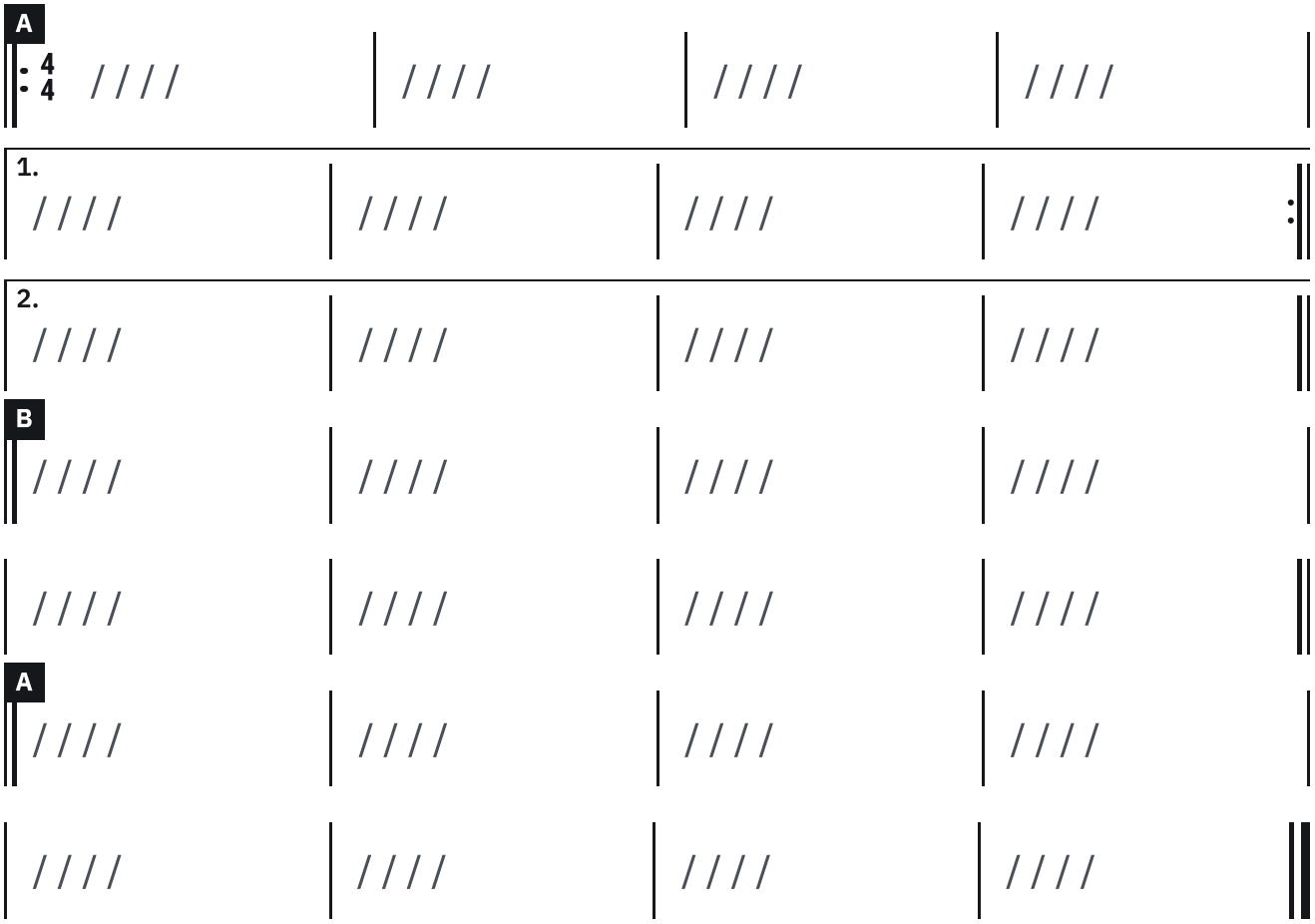
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 110–140: Lazy lindy / blues floor; brushes on the head, sticks for solos if it's 140. Head in two, solos in four.
- The melody has rests in bars 7–8 of each A: a small fill there, nothing elsewhere.
- Intro and tag are four bars (C6 | A7 | D7 G7 | C6): time through the intro, cut the tag together on the last C.

(Medium Up Swing)

Perdido

Juan Tizol



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1941**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Up Swing.

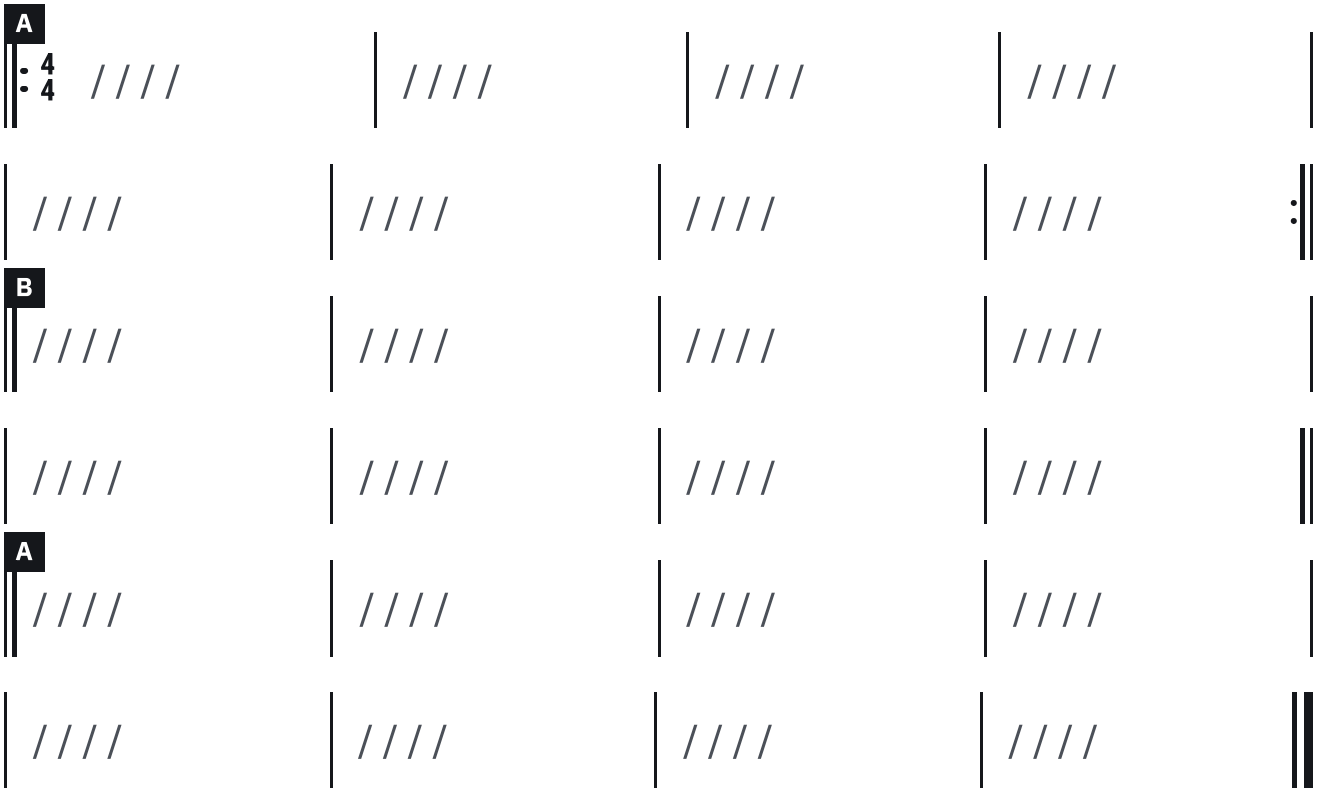
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 170–210, Lindy; count it at 190. Head in two, solos in four; the riff is the horns', so stay plain under it.
- Bridge (D7 G7 C7 F7): the only change of colour, mark it on the ride; back at bar 25.
- Hi-hat on 2 and 4 with a light ride is the Ellington feel.

(Up Swing)

Puttin' On the Ritz

Irving Berlin



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Charleston / Balboa** Dance tempo **200–240 bpm** Written **1929**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Up Swing.

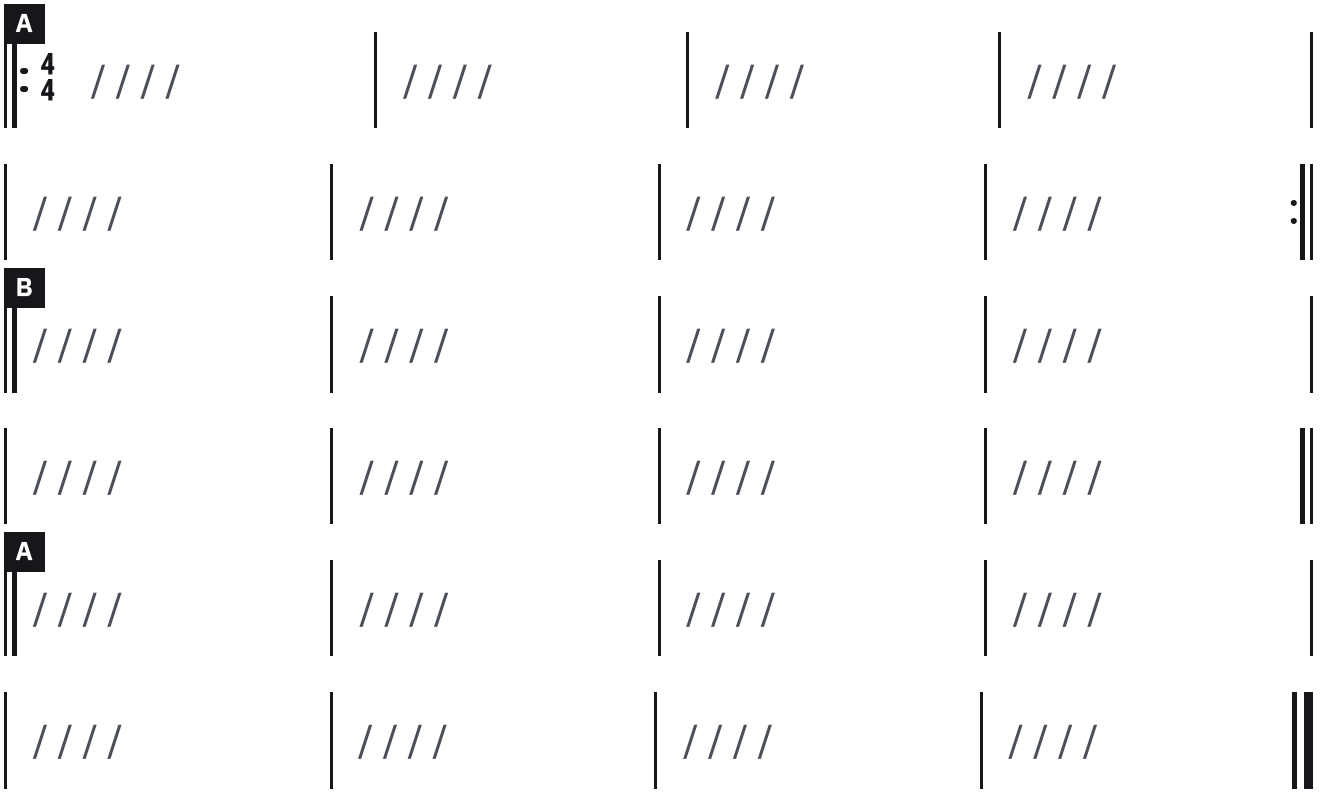
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 200–240, Charleston / Balboa: four on the hi-hat or ride, crisp 2 and 4; no two-feel at this tempo.
- The bridge is written in Charleston rhythm (long–short): play the figure with the band on snare or bass drum, then straight time for the A.
- Minor A, major bridge: cymbal change at bar 17; D♭7 C7 in bar 24 is the slam back, hit it.

(Up Swing)

Ridin' and Jivin'

Earl Hines, your band's chart



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Fast lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **150 bpm** Written **1939**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Up Swing.

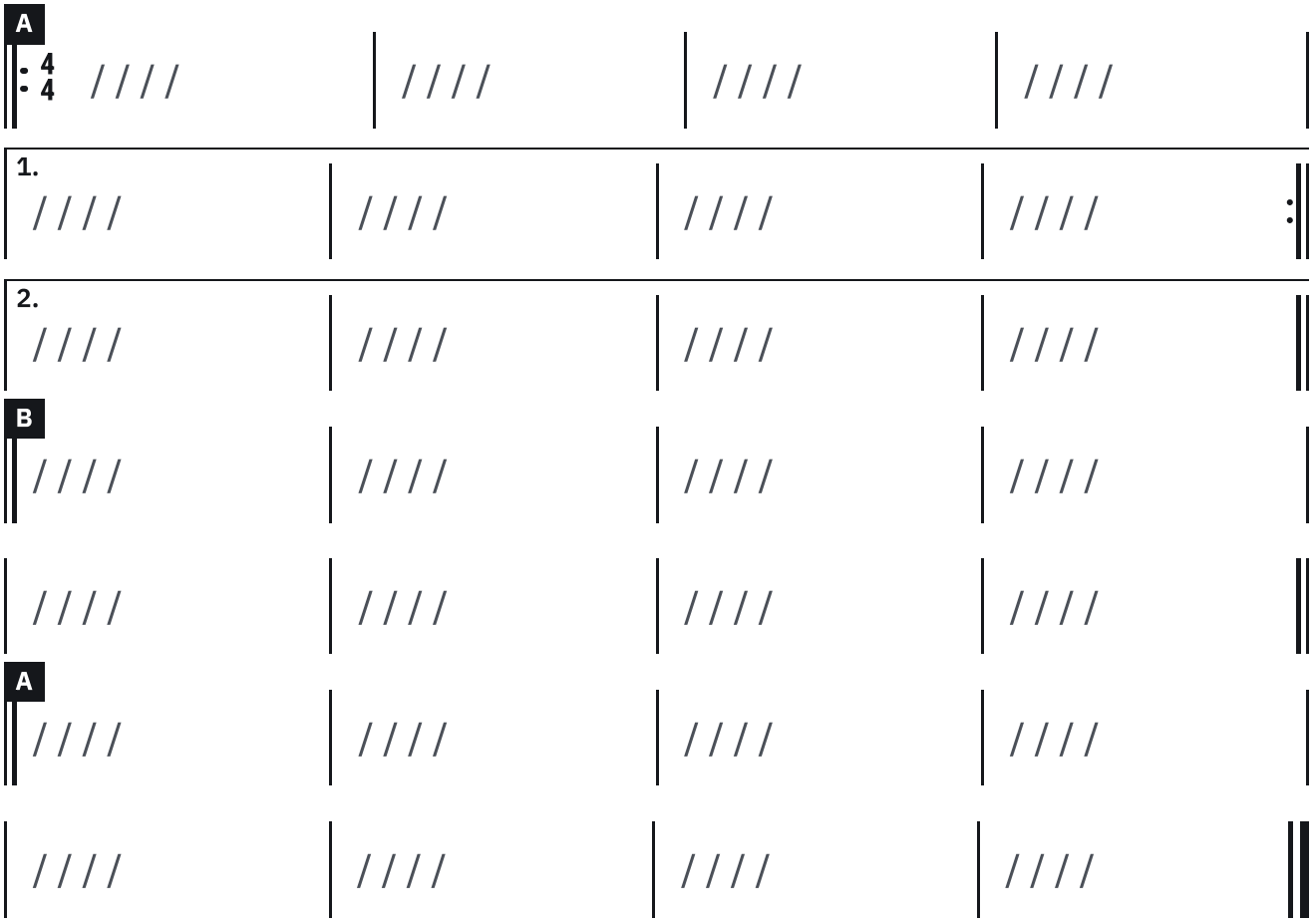
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 150: Balboa / Charleston territory, four on the hi-hat, crisp; the 4-bar intro and the 8-bar post-intro vamp are time only, no fills until the head.
- The A is a riff loop: keep the backbeat steady; the bridge is marked 'slide in F slow' on the score, so a lighter ride there and a build through the chromatic climb (bars 23–24) into the last A.
- Last time through, the final bars are played slow: follow the leader with a roll into the last chord.

(Medium Swing)

Satin Doll

Duke Ellington & Billy Strayhorn



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy / slow swing** Dance tempo **130–160 bpm** Written **1953**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

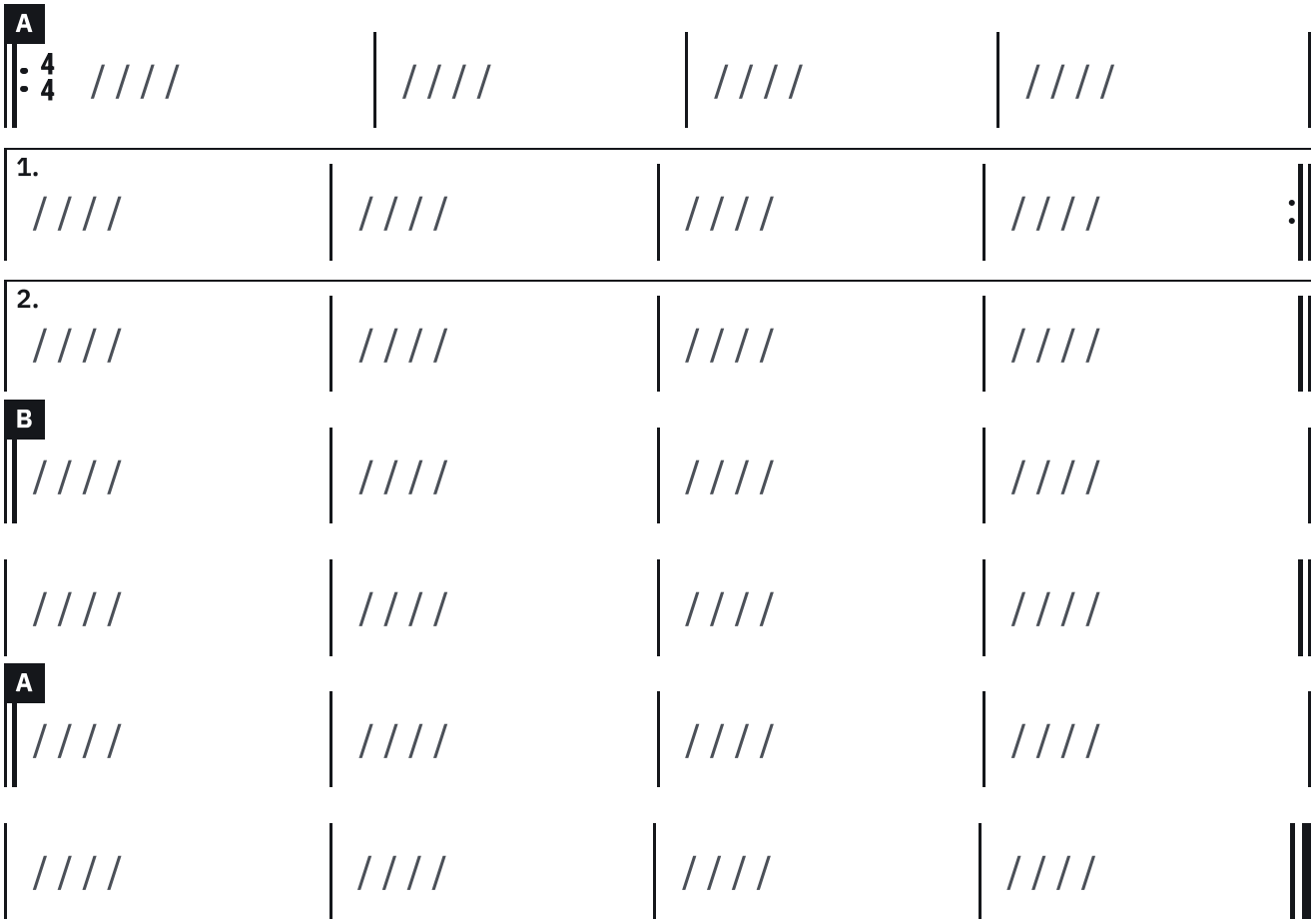
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 130–160, Lindy / slow swing; 140 for the floor, slower for a singer. Head in two, solos in four.
- The band comps a Charleston figure (hit on 1, hit on the 'and' of 2): catch the 'and' of 2 lightly with the bass drum or hi-hat.
- Ellington's intro (two chords, piano) and the tag ending are standard: time through the intro, and the tag is the last two bars three times, cut together.

(Medium Swing)

A Smooth One

Benny Goodman & Charlie Christian



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lazy lindy** Dance tempo **120 bpm** Written **1941**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

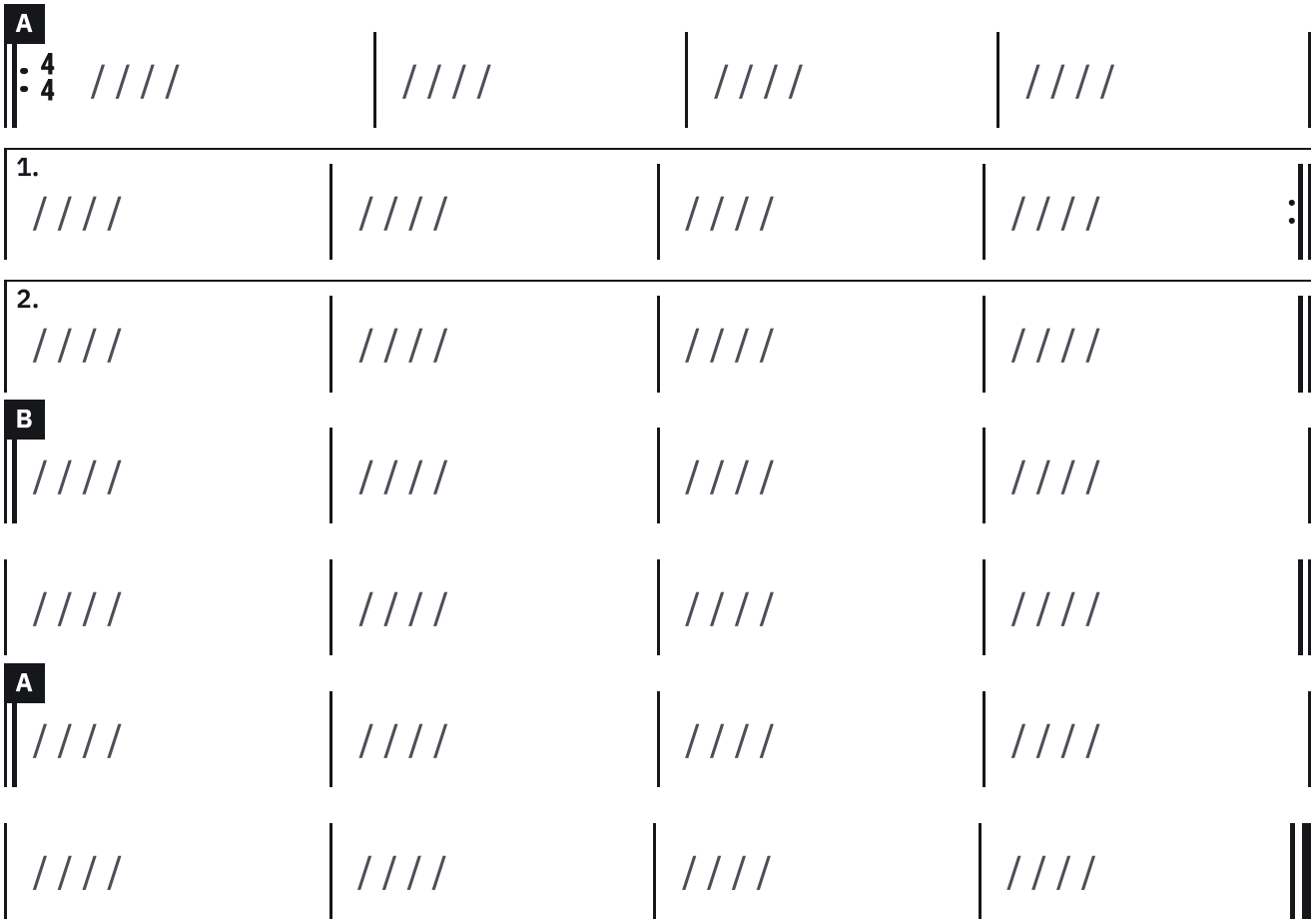
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 120, Lazy lindy: the Goodman Sextet record sits exactly there; brushes or a light ride, hi-hat on 2 and 4, head in two.
- Intro: 8 bars of piano and drums alone, time only; the band enters at the top of the A. The second ending (F6 F7) leads into the bridge.
- The tag: F6 | G7 C7 | F6 | G7 C7 | F6 with a no-chord pickup bar: stop with the band on the pickup bar, come back on the F6, and end together.

(Latin / Swing)

Softly, as in a Morning Sunrise

Sigmund Romberg



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Balboa 180–210 · Lindy** Dance tempo **160–190 bpm** Written **1928**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Latin / Swing.

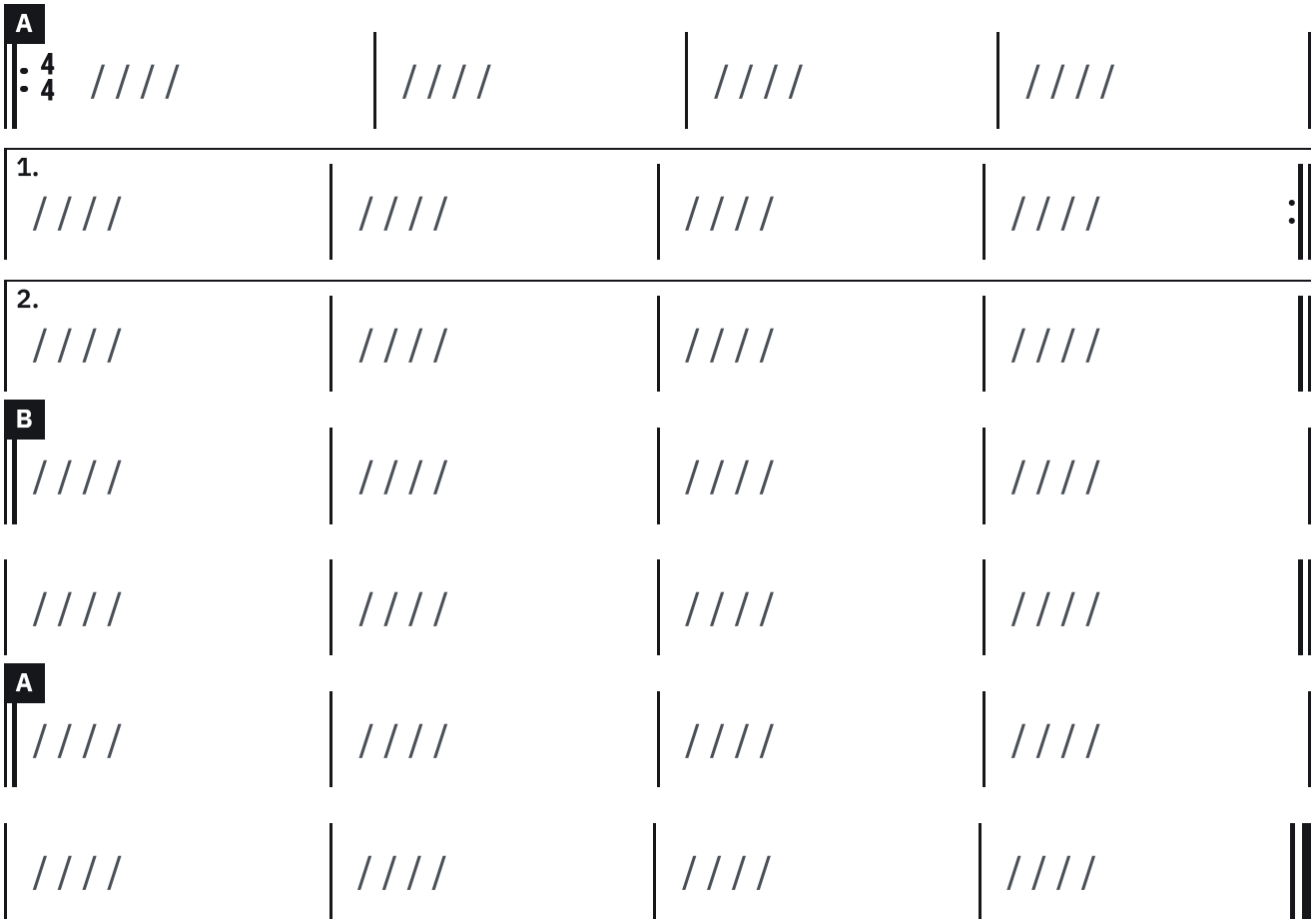
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- Latin on the A (straight eighths, a bolero or rumba pattern on toms or cross-stick), swing on the bridge (ride, hi-hat on 2 and 4): the Artie Shaw arrangement; on the floor it's Bal on the A, Lindy on the bridge.
- 180–210 Balboa or 160–190 Lindy: the switch at bar 17 and back at bar 25 is the arrangement, so make it clean.
- Last A ends on B♭–6 with no turnaround: a cymbal roll under the held chord.

(Medium Swing)

Stompin' at the Savoy

Edgar Sampson



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy 160–190 · Balboa** Dance tempo **190–220 bpm** Written **1934**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Swing.

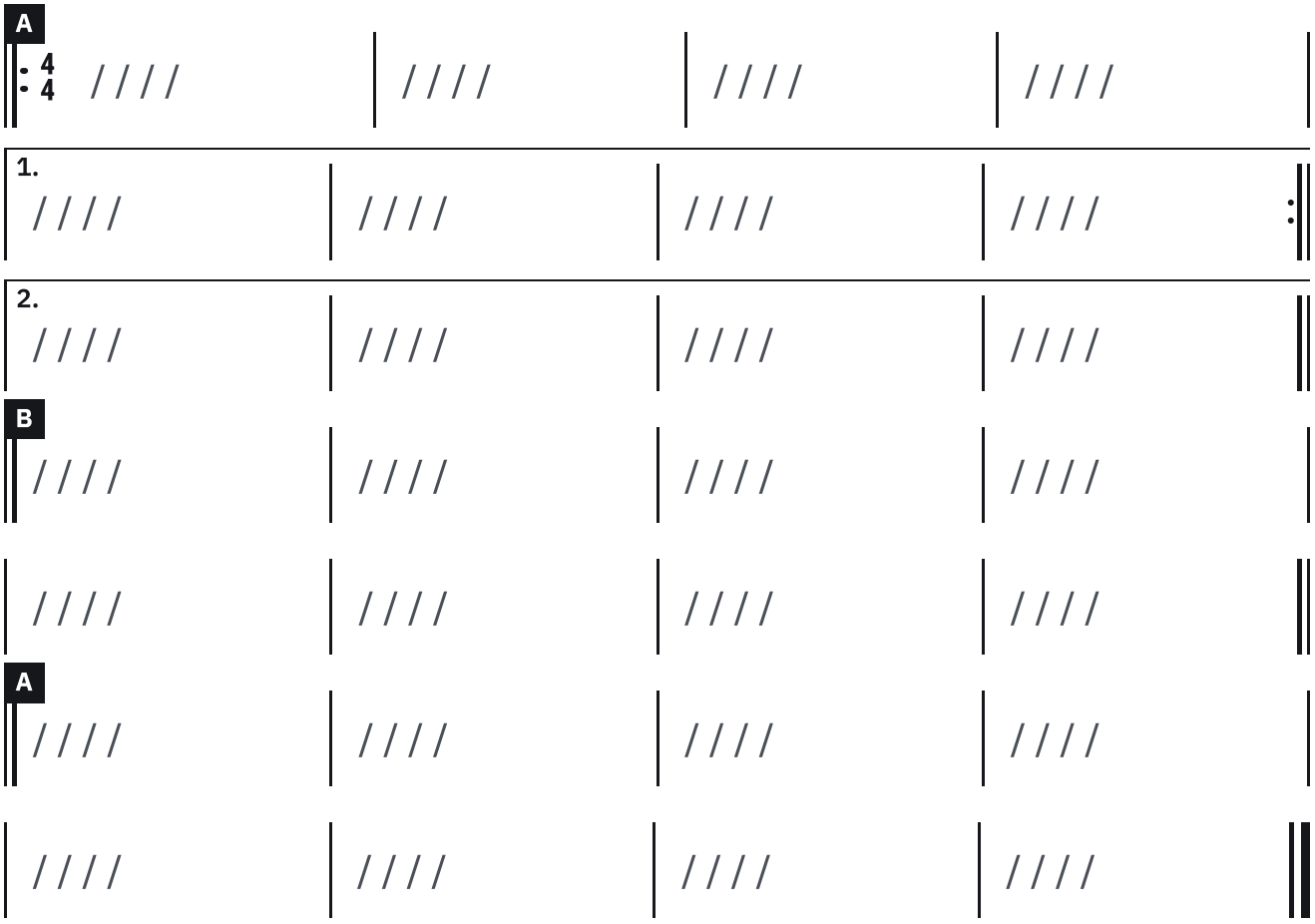
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 160–190 Lindy or 190–220 Balboa: Chick Webb is the drummer here, so the hi-hat on 2 and 4 is the groove and the riff is the band's; head in two, solos in four.
- Bridge (bar 17): the dominants drop a fourth every two bars with a half-step push on beats 3–4 of bars 17, 19 and 21: catch the pushes with the band on the snare.
- Out chorus: the riff stacked up with the full changes; a big backbeat and a cut on the last D♭.

(Medium Up Swing)

Take the “A” Train

Billy Strayhorn



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **160–200 bpm** Written **1941**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Up Swing.

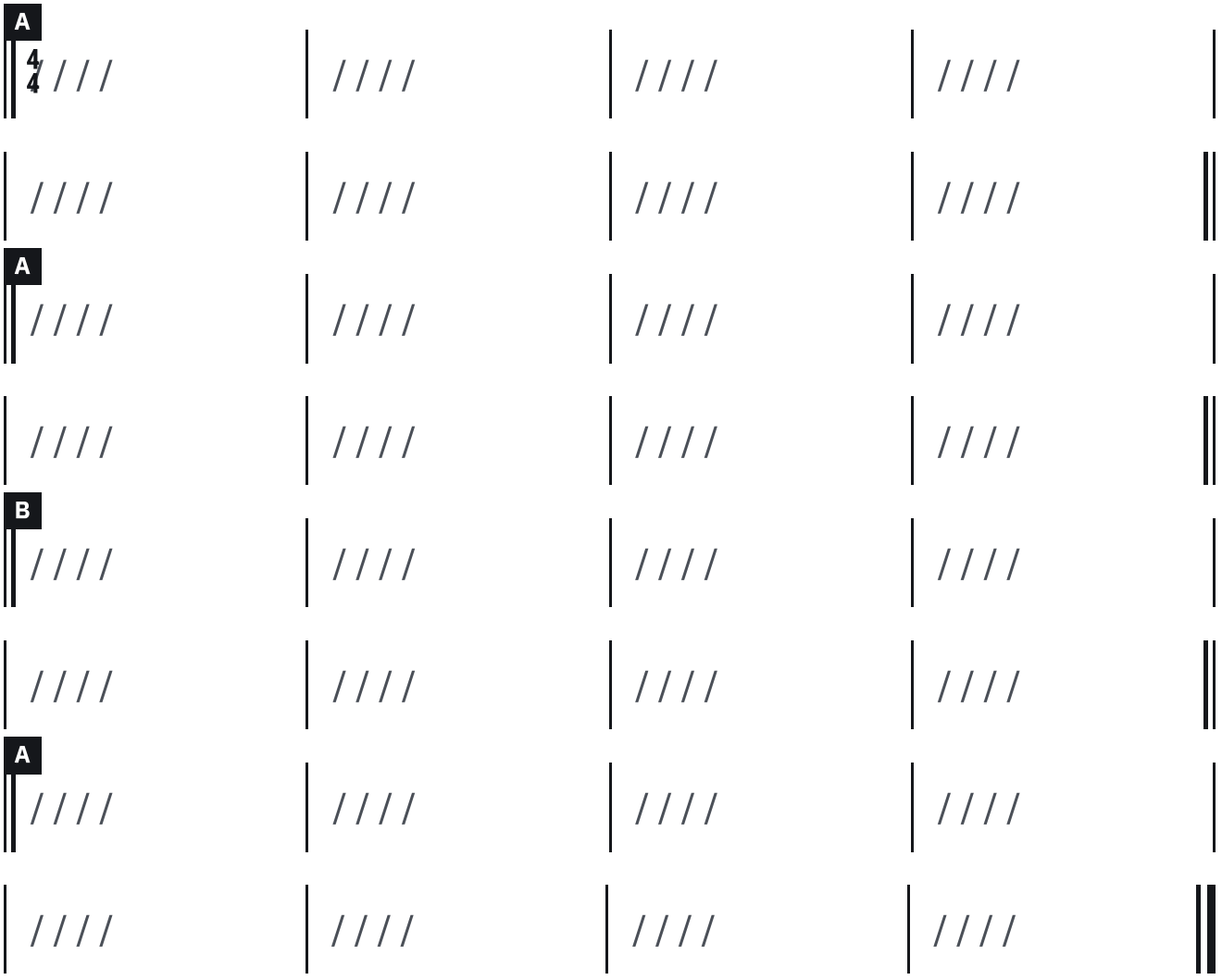
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 160–200 Lindy; Strayhorn's four-bar piano intro is piano alone: enter with the band on bar 1 of the head, hi-hat on 2 and 4, head in two, solos in four.
- Bars 3–4 of each A (D7♭5) are the tune's colour: the band comps a Charleston figure there; catch the 'and' of 2 lightly.
- Ending: the three-note tag repeated (horns), then the A♭6 before the final C6: a roll under the A♭, cut on the C.

(Medium Up Swing)

Topsy

Eddie Durham & Edgar Battle (for Count Basie)



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy · Balboa** Dance tempo **165–200 bpm** Written **1937**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Up Swing.

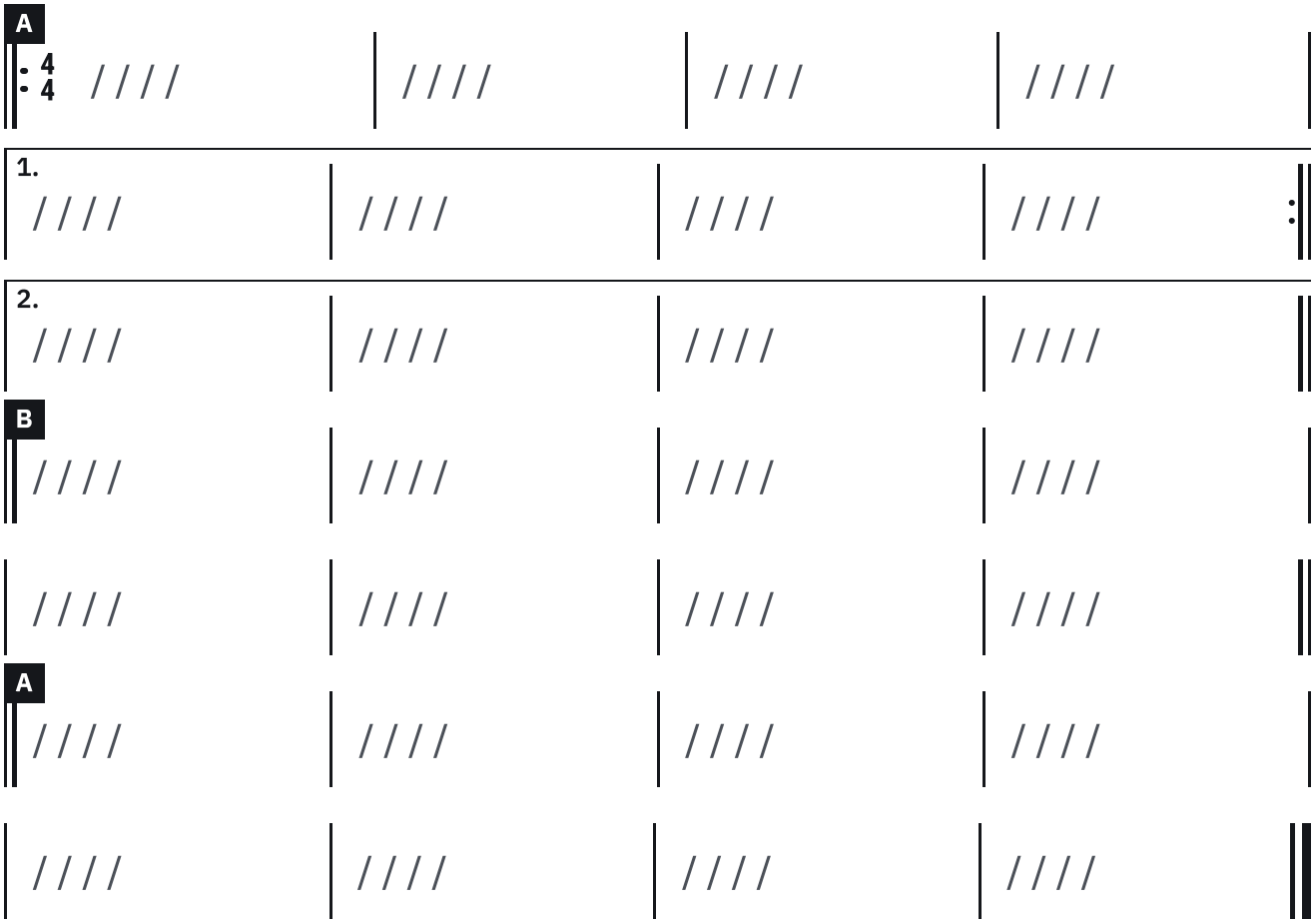
HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 165–200, Lindy / Balboa; Basie 1937 is the original (Jo Jones: hi-hat on 2 and 4, light ride), Royal Crown Revue's version is the neo-swing tempo at 185.
- The A is riff / answer every two bars: keep the time plain and let the F7 E7 bars be the band's hit (beats 1 and 3). The second A goes to D– for four bars; nothing changes for you.
- Bridge: a cycle of dominants, two bars each; the horns' pickup into each is on the 'and' of 4: catch bar 16's pickup (G♯ A B) with a hi-hat accent and the bridge arrives together.

(Medium Up Swing)

Undecided

Charlie Shavers



Form **AABA · 32** Feel **Lindy** Dance tempo **170–210 bpm** Written **1938**

A 8 · A 8 · B 8 · A 8 — 32-bar chorus. Medium Up Swing.

HOW TO PLAY IT · Drums

- 170–210 Lindy, count it at 190; the Webb band's hi-hat on 2 and 4 is the groove, head in two, solos in four.
- Call-and-response head: horns in bars 1 and 3, rhythm section answers in bars 2 and 4: catch the answer stab with the piano on the snare.
- Bridge: two bars a chord, lighter ride at bar 17, back at 25; the last A ends on C6 with no turnaround, cut together.

STILL NEED YOUR SHEET: TUXEDO JUNCTION

Your sheets for Ridin' and Jivin', Lester's Bounce, Blue Drag, A Smooth One, Jericho and Topsy are all charted. Kansas City Stride is in from the changes you gave me. Tuxedo Junction is still missing a bridge I can verify, and two tunes below have no published changes at all. Send a lead sheet (chords and form are enough) and they go in the book.

Tuxedo Junction · your key B♭

Erskine Hawkins, Bill Johnson & Julian Dash, 1939 (Glenn Miller's 1940 hit). Confirmed AABA (Ethan Iverson lists it among the swing-era AABA riff tunes), and the vocal chord sheets give the A strain (I7–IV7 riff, with a ♯IV°–I–VI7–ii–V turnaround), but none of them shows the instrumental bridge. Your chart would settle it in five minutes.

Cute

Neal Hefti for Basie, 1958. Turns out to be an arrangement rather than a jam tune: an eight-bar piano intro, a call-and-response head with brushes, then blues changes under the solos and a 32-bar drum feature (per the Freddie Green and Lush Life transcriptions). Replaced in the book by Perdido.

The Grabtown Grapple

Artie Shaw & Buster Harding; Shaw's Gramercy Five, Victor, 9 January 1945, with Roy Eldridge, Dodo Marmarosa and Barney Kessel. A head arrangement built on riffs, with an eight-bar bridge, so by the sound of it a 32-bar A A B A. Not on Wikipedia's rhythm-changes list, so the A is probably not plain rhythm changes. On your Lazy lindy list via the Hot Sugar Band.

Miser's Serenade

Full title "Gimme, Gimme, Gimme, Gimme (The Miser's Serenade)", by Fred Patrick, Claude Reese, Marvin Fisher and Jack Val. Chris Connor with the Sy Oliver Orchestra, December 1953: Bethlehem's first single. A novelty vocal; no lead sheet was ever published.

LIFTING A RIFF TUNE OFF A RECORD

1. **Find the key:** the last bass note of the record is the tonic nine times out of ten. Check it against the piano.
2. **Count the form in 8s.** Where the riff changes is the bridge. If the riff never changes and the tune is 12 bars, it's a blues: stop here, you know it.
3. **The bridge test (bar 17):** does the bass go to III7 (rhythm bridge: D7 in B♭), to I7 heading for IV (Honeysuckle bridge: B♭7 → E♭), or straight to IV (A-Train bridge: E♭)? Those three cover almost every swing-era riff tune.
4. **The A test (bar 5):** does it push to IV (I7–IV–♯IV°–I, the rhythm/riff A) or stay home on I with a I–VI–II–V turnaround?
5. **Turnarounds** are I–VI–II–V unless you hear something odd. Write it in, play it with the record, fix the one bar that clashes.

ON YOUR LISTS, BUT NOT AABA

- **Autumn Leaves** A A B C · 32 — Ryo Fukui's version on Lazy lindy. The C section is new material, not a return.
- **Fly Me to the Moon** A B A C · 32
- **Mack the Knife** one 16-bar strain, repeated and modulated.
- **Minor Swing** 16 bars — Django's two-chord workout (Bal/charleston list).
- **St. James Infirmary** 8-bar minor — Hugh Laurie, "it's complicated".
- **Summertime** 16 bars
- **Fever · Hit the Road Jack** minor vamps
- **Sing Sing Sing** riff + drum feature

AFTER THESE: TEN MORE AABA, UNCHARTED

- **Lester Leaps In · Cotton Tail · Oleo** — rhythm changes; you have the chart (I Got Rhythm).
- **Scrapple from the Apple** — Honeysuckle A sections, rhythm bridge; two charts you own, stapled.
- **Flying Home** — Hampton/Goodman, the Lindy closer in D♭.
- **Moten Swing** — Basie's riff on the 'You're Driving Me Crazy' changes.
- **Shiny Stockings** — Frank Foster for Basie; the slow-Lindy anthem.
- **Jersey Bounce** — Goodman, a Balboa favourite.
- **Body and Soul** — the ballad; the bridge modulates and so will you.
- **Misty** — Erroll Garner, a pianist's ballad.
- **Georgia on My Mind** — Carmichael; the slow-blues floor.
- **In a Sentimental Mood** — Ellington; the last dance.

CHANGES CROSS-CHECKED AGAINST

- Wikipedia: Stompin' at the Savoy, Montgomery-Ward bridge, Rhythm changes; Jazzomat (HfM Weimar) transcriptions for Savoy and Softly.
- Learn Jazz Standards: Honeysuckle Rose and Softly; Jeremy Kahn on the Softly middle 8.
- JazzStandards.com: Blue Skies and Piano With Jonny: Blue Skies.
- Chord sheets for Bei Mir Bist Du Schoen (acordesweb, Cifra Club), Moanin' (Ultimate Guitar), Puttin' On the Ritz (Ultimate Guitar, transposed), Sunny Side of the Street (Heartwood Guitar, transposed).
- Grabtown Grapple: DAHR Victor ledger, Swing & Beyond. Miser's Serenade: Chris Connor bio-discography. Kansas City Stride composer credit: Tiber River Dixieland. Topsy and Cute: freddiegreen.org Topsy, freddiegreen.org Cute, Lush Life: Cute.
- Transcribed from your own charts: Battle of Jericho (chordsheet.com, Aug 2026), Ridin' and Jivin' (score and parts), Lester's Bounce (score), Blue Drag (arr. Pataswing), A Smooth One (clarinet in B♭ lead sheet, transposed), Topsy (score and parts, 'Chords in C' staff), Kansas City Stride (your changes, written out: intro G– G– G– D7 ×4, A G– G–/F E♭7 D7 ×4, B G7 C A–7 B♭–). Just Friends: Jazzomat: Chet Baker. Comes Love: E-Chords (Nnenna Freelon). Tuxedo Junction form: Ethan Iverson, Core Repertoire. A Smooth One key: jazzguitar.be thread.

- Second batch: JazzStandards.com: Undecided and E-Chords (Ames Brothers); jazzguitar.be on the doo-wah bars and Ultimate Guitar for It Don't Mean a Thing; jazzguitar.be on Woodside = Dinah + Honeysuckle bridge; Ethan Iverson, JazzStandards.com and E-Chords (Doris Day) for Lady Be Good; Guitar Tabs Explorer and E-Chords (Eckstine) for Don't Get Around Much; JazzStandards.com: Blue Moon; Ultimate Guitar, jazzguitar.be and E-Chords (Bennett) for Ain't Misbehavin'; Guitar Composer's Toolbox and Wikipedia for Lullaby of Birdland; Jazzomat: Coleman Hawkins, Perdido.